FMS

The Consulting Club

Faculty of Management Studies
University of Delhi

FMS
Consulting Case Book
2026-27



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Issue #1 2019
Issue #2 2020
Issue #3 2021
Issue #4 2023
Issue #5 2024
Issue #6 2025
Issue #7 2026

Issue 7
August 2026

Foreword

The FMS Casebook issue of August 2025 documents the interview experiences of students across consulting firms to assist the students of FMS Delhi in their preparation for case interviews during placements.

The aim of sharing these experiences is to inform students about the case interview experiences of past batches and to help them prepare for their placements accordingly.

The experiences listed below are not necessarily the best way to handle case interviews. They only serve to give students an idea as to what to expect when they walk into a case interview. Every individual could have his/her unique way of tackling consulting interviews, each of which could be correct.

This document has contributions from students who appeared for campus interviews conducted by consulting firms during the placement process over the past years.

Casebook 2026-27
The Consulting Club, FMS Delhi

Issue 7
August 2026

Acknowledgement

The Club extends its gratitude to everyone who shared their cases and interview experiences, helping us create a comprehensive preparation resource for future batches.

We would also like to thank our entire batch for their efforts, as well as the senior batches for their support in compiling this case book. Their contributions have ensured a wide variety of cases, providing the reader with a thorough understanding of the types of cases they might encounter.

We are especially grateful to the alumni of the Consulting Club, FMS Delhi, for their valuable feedback, which has helped enhance the quality of this book. A special thanks also goes to the contributors of previous editions of the FMS Case Book. Finally, we would like to express our appreciation to the Faculty of Management Studies and its esteemed faculty for giving us this opportunity.

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The Consulting Club,

FMS Delhi

About The Consulting Club, FMS

The Consulting Club is a student-run organization with the agenda of liaising with Global Consults to increase their presence at FMS Delhi, while working towards preparing the students for a career in consulting. In addition to providing practical experience through workshops, guest lectures facilitation, the Club serves as the nucleus for pioneering strategy games and consulting projects and has developed a reputation for unmatched innovation, with activities spanning several spheres like Management Consulting, Risk Advisory, Process/Operations Consulting, IT Consulting, Benchmarking Advisory.

Our Mission: "Why We Exist?"

To develop, enhance and showcase the consulting potential of FMS students, that attracts top consulting firms to campus.

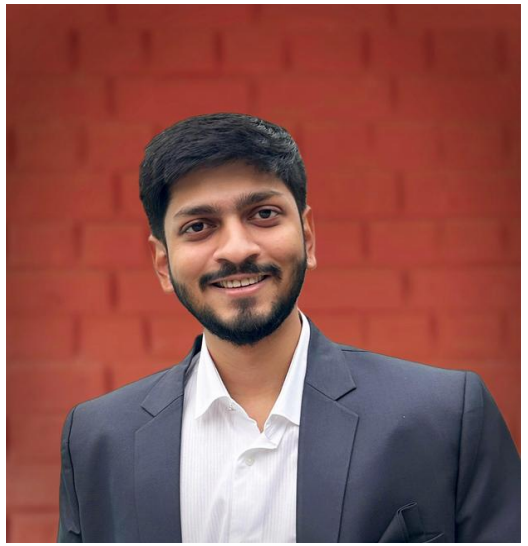
Our Vision: "Where do we want to go in the future?"

Build awareness & generate interest in the consulting domain among students, create & maintain long-term corporate relationships with top consulting firms of the world, and make available all resources necessary to build content and competency on campus.

The Consulting Club,
FMS Delhi

The President's Desk

It gives us immense pleasure to bring to you the FMS Consulting Casebook for the academic year 2026–27.



Consulting preparation is as much about developing a way of thinking as it is about mastering frameworks. Each year, our goal is to build on the strengths of past editions while further enriching the consulting culture at FMS. With this edition, we have sought to create a resource that helps students build that mindset through structured practice, diverse business problems, and insights from real interview experiences.

Beyond the breadth of content, our focus has been on making preparation more practical, rigorous, and reflective of the realities of modern consulting interviews. Every section has been designed to help students move beyond memorising frameworks to develop the structured thinking, business acumen, and adaptability required to solve problems they have never seen before.

We hope this Casebook becomes an integral part of your preparation and helps you push your thinking, sharpen your problem-solving, and take you one step closer to your consulting aspirations.

Wishing you an enriching preparation journey and the very best for what lies ahead!



Kaushik Narkhede
President
The Consulting Club, FMS Delhi

Meet Our Team: Consulting Club (2026-27)



Kaushik Narkhede

President



Alinjar Das



Aniruddh K Singh



Atharva Dikshit



Shashwat Jain



Sooryansh Sharma



Swasti Verma



Vaishali Mangla

Executive Members

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★ Indicates latest additions/ updates to the casebook

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Part A - About Consulting

Main Index

What is Consulting?

What is it?

In very crude terms,

"It is an outsourcing of business objectives, to people with huge accumulated expertise in relevant field who offer customized solutions to the client's stated objectives."

How is it helpful?

Objectives could be of various types:

- Often it is problem within a business that the client is unable to address or even identify, many a times due to lack of qualified personnel.
- It can be related to business expertise that a client doesn't have but requires for planned tasks in present and/or future.
- Also it could be targeted at improving business performance and/or profitability by exploring opportunities to improve, grow or divest.

Top Players

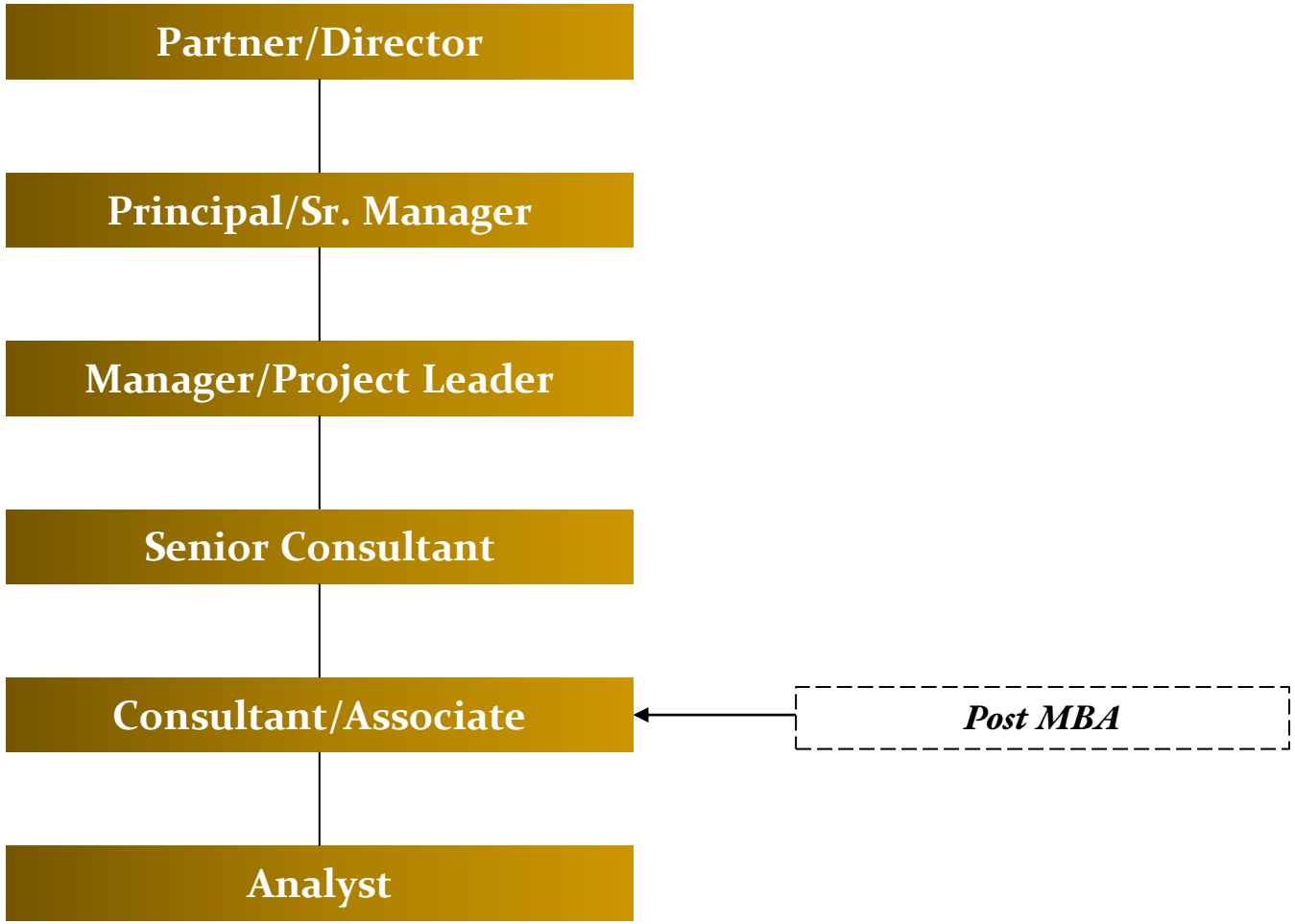
accenture strategy
Alvarez & Marsal
Bain & Company
BCG The Boston Consulting Group
EY Building a better working world
GEP
Kearney
McKinsey & Company
Oliver Wyman

Why is it so sought after?

- With enormous amounts of subject knowledge of accumulated expertise that they possess, consultants can drastically transform a business in a relatively quick span of time.
- From turning around loss making businesses to managing highly important political election strategies, they offer customized solutions for every problem.
- Consultants can pinpoint the challenges that are being faced by their clients today or anticipate the ones that might be in future. This proves them effective in finding and implementing solutions that are concurrent with the client's definition of success.

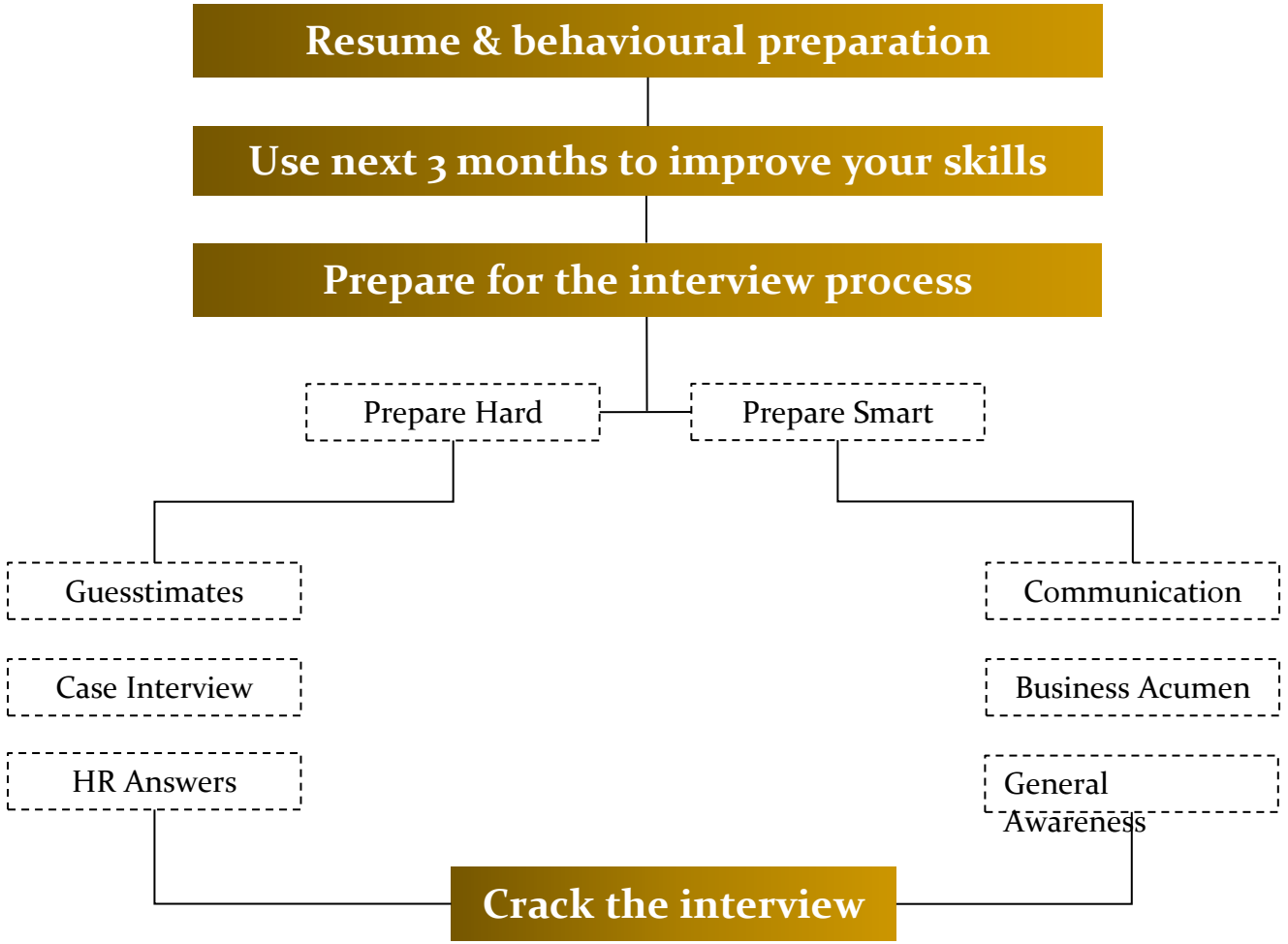
Roles/Hierarchy of a Consulting Firm

Almost all consulting firms follow a flat hierarchy and up or out kind of career trajectory.



Not all firms have the same nomenclature for their roles as above

How to Get into Consulting from Here?



It's a rigorous selection process which requires structured preparation plan and serious efforts. Both the hard part and the smart preparation part are equally important and would require efforts at the individual level.

Part B – Basic Concepts

Main Index

3C's



Government

- What is the Business?
- Where is it present?
- Scale and Trends?



Industry

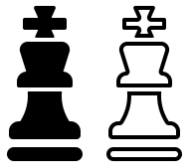


Company

- Who are the customers?
- Where are they present?
- How do they buy?
- Segmentation ?



Customer



Competition

- Major Players & Market Share
- Benchmarking with competitors
- How is the Industry doing?

Other C's:	Collaborators	Channels	Costs	Competencies	Culture

Understanding the layer/level of business at which you are doing the analysis is very important and it sets the context of the case. Useful while opening a case to set context for problem at hand. Other C's could be useful in further analysis of case

4P's and 7P's

- What are the product characteristics?
- Product differentiation (i.e. USP)
- Product segments (i.e. product lines)

Product

- Price in the market
- Price Benchmarking
- Changes in Pricing

Price

- Marketing Activities
- Promotion Mediums
- Ad Strategies

Promotion

Placement

- How is the product distributed to customers
- Inventory-Transportation-Channels

Other 3 P's:

- **People:** Staff involved in entire value chain
- **Processes:** Processes involved in value chain
- **Physical Evidence:** Tangible component of product/service

Useful in the market entry and GTM category. E.g. revenue related problems, new product launch

Porter's Five Forces

Bargaining Power of Buyers

Bargaining Power of Buyers increases with:
- Concentration of buyers – high number of buyers
- Lower switching cost for buyer
- Buyer's ability to integrate backward
- Availability of substitutes
- High Price Elasticity
- Lower Product Differentiation
- Lower Impact on Buyer's product Quality

Bargaining Power of Suppliers

Bargaining Power of Suppliers increases with
- Input differentiation
- Degree of importance of supplier's product/service – Impact on cost or differentiation
- Lower switching cost for suppliers – lower importance of volume sold
- Lower number of substitutes available – less supplier concentration

Industry Rivalry

Industry Rivalry Increases with:
- Industry Growth & Number of Competitors
- High Fixed Costs and Barriers to Exit
- Lower product differentiation & brand recognition
- Highly Specialised Assets

Threat of New Entrants (or Barriers to Entry)

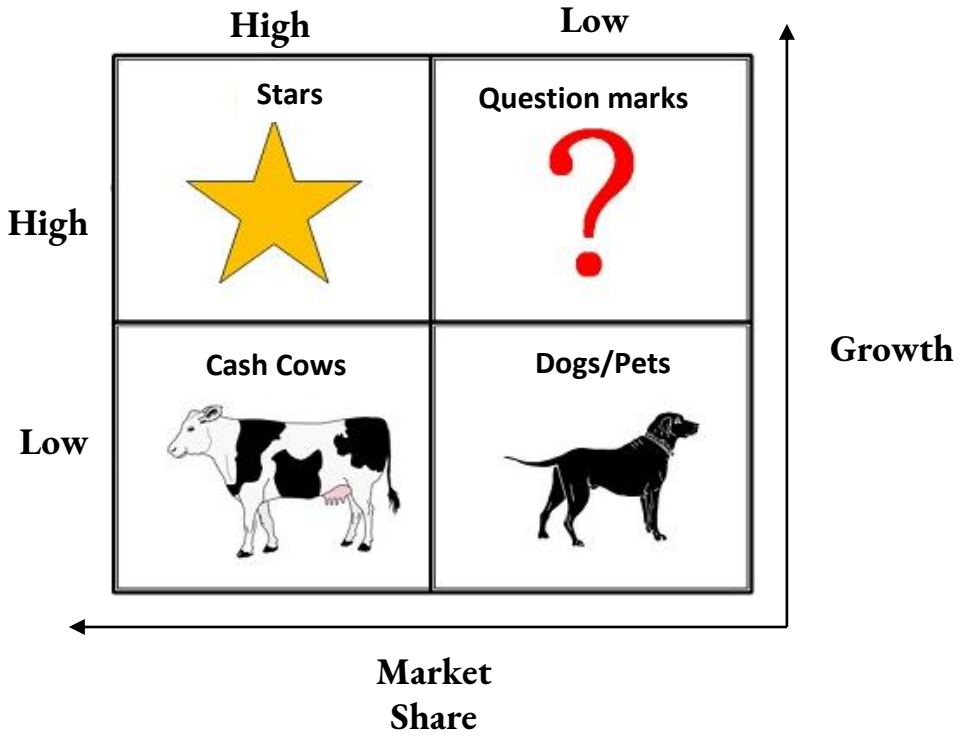
Barriers to Entry increase with:
- Economies of Scale
- Proprietary Product Differentiation
- Brand Recognition
- High Switching Costs for Customers
- Capital Requirements
- Hard to access distribution channels
- Regulatory constraints and restrictions

Threat of Substitutes

Threat of Substitutes increases with:
- Relative performance of Substitutes
- Lower Switching Costs
- Higher Buyer Propensity to Substitute

Useful in various types of cases like market entry, growth strategies, new product launch

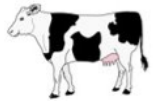
BCG Matrix



Dogs/Pets	**Low Share/Low Growth**	Sustained cash flows but will never be stars; companies should liquidate or divest
Question Marks	**Low Share/High Growth**	Companies can invest (can turn into stars) or discard (can become dogs/pets)
Stars	**High Share/High Growth**	Large cash flows, market-leading; companies can heavily invest to turn into cash cows
Cash cows	**High Share/Low Growth**	Don't require further investment, can be used to reinvest if properly "milked"

Useful while analyzing costs related problems, also in new business setup

BCG Matrix Example: Apple

Growth \ Market Share	High	Low
High	 iPhone   Apple Watch	  Apple TV
Low	  MacBook	  Accessories

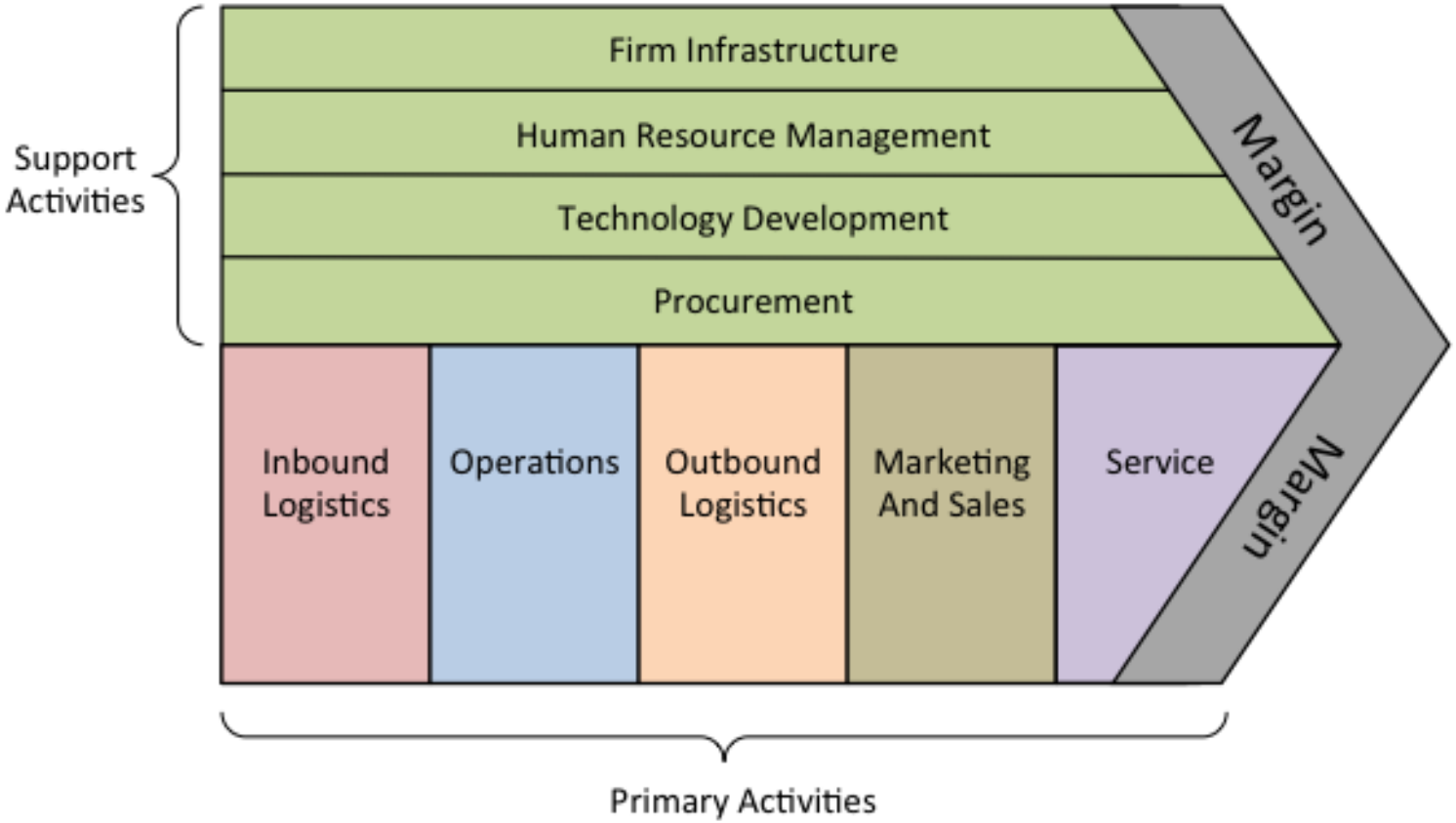
Porter's Value Chain & Process Mapping

Support Activities

- Procurement: Gathering all the inputs, resources
- Technology Development:
  - Hardware, software, equipment, procedures and technical knowledge.
- Human Resource Management: Activities such as
  - Hiring/recruiting, training, compensation, laying off personnel
- Firm Infrastructure:
  - Accounting, legal, finance, planning, public affairs, government relations, quality assurance and general management.

Primary Activities

- Inbound Logistics:
  - Receiving, storing and disseminating inputs
- Operations:
  - Transforming inputs to outputs
- Outbound logistics:
  - Collecting, storing and distributing outputs
- Marketing and Sales:
  - Awareness of products and facilitate purchase
- Service: Post-sales customer service activities



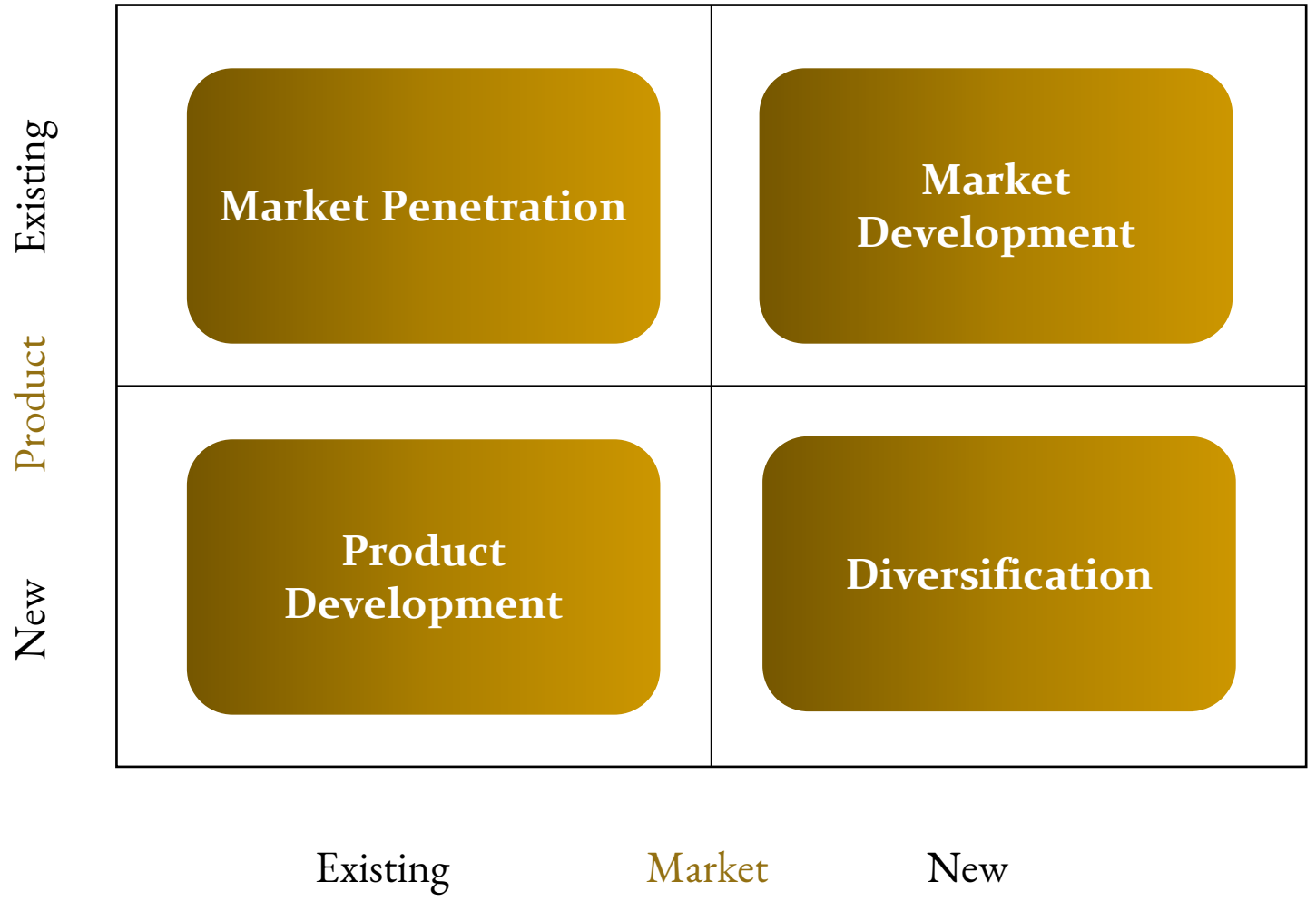
Useful for portfolio analysis, investment decisions, growth strategies

Cost-Based Value Chain

R&D	Raw Material	Processing	Storage & Transportation	Distribution	Marketing	Customer Service
Equipment	Cost of RM	Machinery	Transport for Warehouse	Sales Channel	Marketing Channel	Repairs
Human Capital	Contracts/Bulk Deals	Factory Rent	Storage (Rent, Labour, Inventory)	Sales Force	Sales Force	Spare Parts
Cost of Finance	Quantity Used	Labour Hours	Transport to Customer	Training		Returns
		Technology				Service Contracts
		Capacity Utilization				
		Packaging				
		Utilities				
		Scrap/Wastage				

Useful for cost analysis

Ansoff Matrix

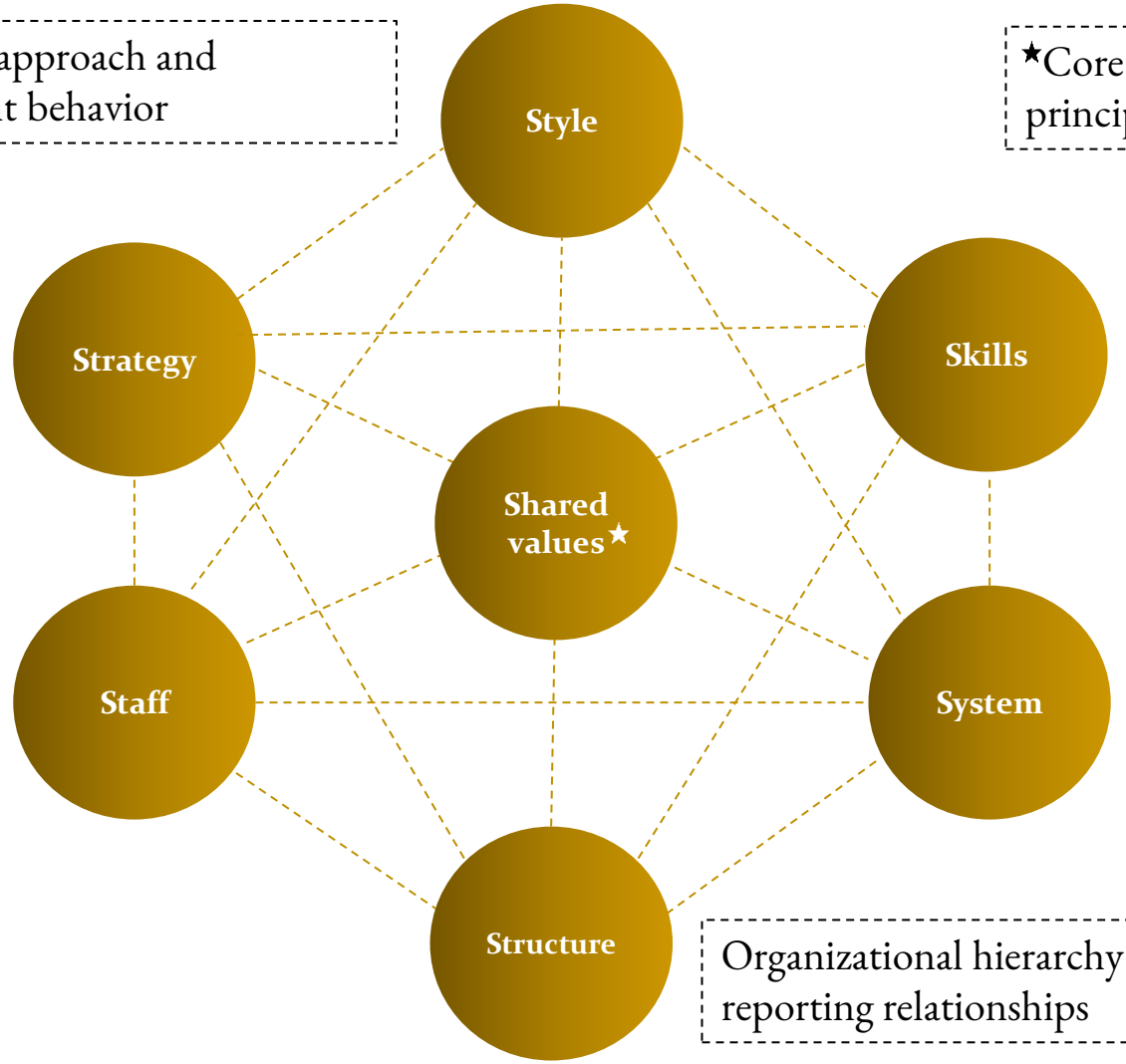


Best suitable for Growth Strategy cases, also handy for Market Entry, Revenue Expansion

Ansoff Matrix Example: Coca Cola

Product \ Market	Existing	New
Existing	**Market Penetration** 	**Market Development** 
New	**Product Development** 	**Related Diversification**  **Unrelated Diversification** 

McKinsey 7s Model



Leadership approach and management behavior

★Core beliefs and cultural guiding principles

Long term plan to gain competitive advantage

Key competencies and organizational strengths

Workforce capabilities and employee demographics

Day to day workflow and business processes

Organizational hierarchy and reporting relationships

Helps guide internal misalignments & guide strategic or operational change. Commonly applied in org restructuring, post merger integration & performance enhancement cases.

The Company Environment

A good strategy aligns a business' internal attributes, things like its mission, vision, capabilities in organization with its external environment.
A useful way to think about the relationship between a company and its environment is that it is nested in three layers: macro environment, industry environment and company environment. All the three layers influence size of market by defining the scope and constraints of the potential market.

Total Addressable Market

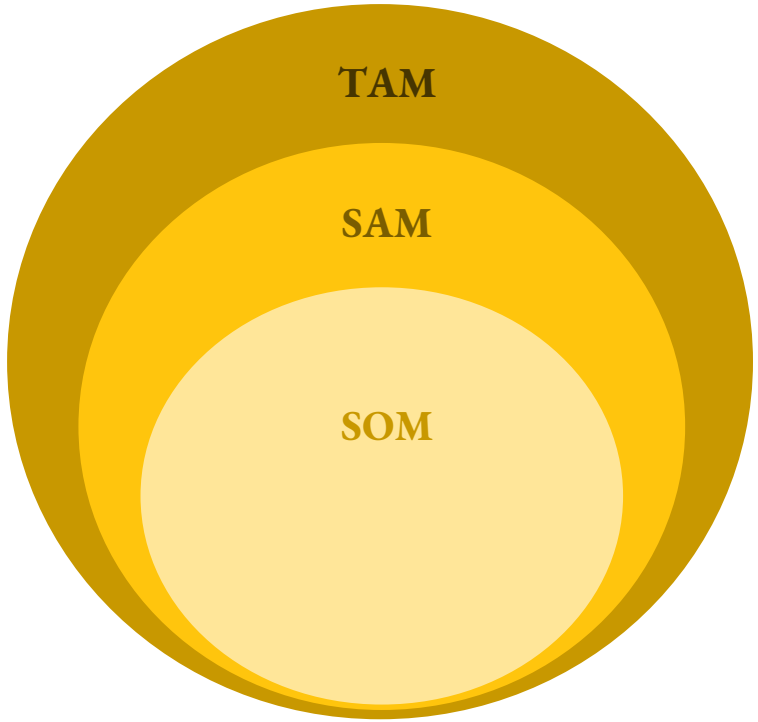
- TAM represents entire potential market demand for a specific product or service.
- It helps businesses assess maximum market opportunity available.

Serviceable Addressable Market

- SAM is a subset of TAM and represents the portion of the market that a company can target and serve.
- It accounts for factors like geographical limitations, regulatory constraints and customer segments.

Serviceable Obtainable Market

- SOM is an even smaller subset of SAM and represents the portion of the market that a company can capture or obtain.
- It considers factors like competition, marketing effectiveness, and market penetration.



Total Addressable Market

To calculate TAM, you typically use a top-down approach, which involves estimating the total market size at a high level.

How big is the cumulative market?

Serviceable Addressable Market

SAM = (TAM) x (Market Penetration Percentage)

How big is the market that can be reached right now?

Serviceable Obtainable Market

SOM = (SAM) x (Market Share Percentage)

What is the market that can be reached with current resources?

PESTEL

PESTEL Analysis can be done to identify the macro/external forces surrounding the organisation

Political:
Extent to which governments and its policies affect an organisation and the industry it is a part of, such as:
- Fiscal policies
- Taxation policies
- Trade policies
- Corruption
- Labour laws

Economic:
Factors affecting the economy of the country directly, hence affecting the organisation directly, such as:
- Unemployment/employment rates
- Interest rates
- FX rates

Social:
Factors affecting the social environment and any emerging trends, such as:
- Population demographics
- Education levels
- Cultural trends
- Lifestyle changes
- Changes in attitudes



Technological:
Considers rate of technological improvements/advancements that affect a market/industry, such as:
- Digital/mobile technology
- Automation
- AI/ML (GenAI)
- R&D advancements
- Awareness of technology

Environmental:
Consists of factors which influence the surrounding environment on the ecological front, such as:
- CSR Initiatives (i.e. sustainability)
- Climate change, carbon footprint
- Recycling, waste disposal, reusing

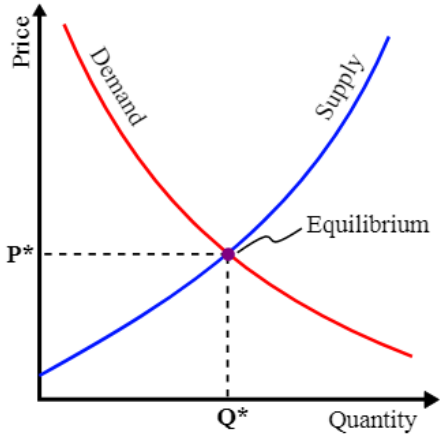
Legal:
Considers the legal factors of the environment in which organisation operates, such as:
- Health and safety standards
- Anti-trust laws
- Employment laws
- Copyright and patent laws
- Consumer protection laws

Note: Legal factors are different from political. Legal factors are to be complied with.

Best suited for market entry cases for macro analysis

Basics of Economics

Supply-Demand



Price Elasticity

$$e = -\frac{dQ/Q}{dp/P}$$

Price elasticity measures the responsiveness of the quantity demanded or supplied of a good to a change in its price.
Elasticity can be described as **elastic**—or very responsive, **unit elastic**, or **inelastic**—not very responsive.

Price Discrimination

First Degree

With first-degree discrimination, the company charges the maximum possible price for each unit consumed.

Second Degree

Second-degree discrimination involves discounts for products or services bought in bulk.

Third Degree

Third-degree discrimination reflects different prices for different consumer groups

Market Characteristics

4 Types of Market Structure

- **Perfect Competition**
- **Monopolistic Competition**
- **Oligopoly**
- **Monopoly**

Most Competitive ⟷ Less Competitive

Basics of Accounting

Important Line Items

- **Revenue/ Topline:** Income generated from business activities
- **Cost of Goods Sold (COGS):** Costs directly attributable to the production of goods/execution of services.
- It includes:
  - Direct Labour
  - Direct raw material
  - Expenses for repair
  - Shipping charges
  - Cost of equipment
  - Production utilities
- **Selling, general & administrative expenses (SG&A):** Major non-production line items, often expressed as % of revenue
- **Overhead:** Non-labour expenses incurred
- **Maintenance:** Cost of bringing back assets to its working condition
- **Depreciation & Amortization:** Reduction of asset value with use
- **Profits/Bottomline:** Revenue – Cost
  - **Gross Profit:** Gross profit refers to a company's profits after subtracting the costs of producing and distributing its products.
  - **Net Profit:** indicates a company's profit after all its expenses have been deducted from revenues.

XYZ Shoe company Income Statement (₹ (in lakhs))

Revenue:	**20X1**	**20X2**	**20X3**
Women's Shoes			
High Heels	1000	750	500
Boots	500	550	600
Sandals	60	66	72
Men's Shoes			
Dress	1100	1100	1100
Casual	500	550	605
Total Revenue	**3160**	**3016**	**2877**
YoY Growth %		*-4.56%*	*-4.61%*
Cost of Goods Sold (Variable / Direct Expenses)			
Materials	1200	1140	1090
Labor	320	304	290
Shipping	80	76	73
Total COGS	1600	1520	1453
Gross Profit	**1560**	**1496**	**1424**
Gross Margin %	*49.37%*	*49.60%*	*49.50%*
Fixed Costs (Indirect Expenses)			
SG&A	500	500	500
D&A	300	330	360
Overhead	100	100	100
Maintenance	50	50	50
Total Fixed Costs	950	980	1010
Total Profit	**610**	**516**	**414**
Margin %	*19.30%*	*17.11%*	*14.39%*

Basics of Accounting

Components of a Balance Sheet

A balance sheet is a financial statement that reports a company's assets, liabilities & shareholder equity

Assets

Current Assets

These are short-term assets because they are generally convertible to cash within a firm's fiscal year

Non-Current Assets

These are a company's long-term investments that have a useful life of more than one year

Liabilities

Current Liabilities

Portion of long-term debt due in <12 months
Accounts payable

Non-Current Liabilities

Long-term debts
Deferred tax liabilities

Shareholder's Equity

Money attributable to the owners of a business or its shareholders

Accounting Equation

Assets = Liabilities + Shareholder's equity

Balance Sheet as on 31st December 20XX			
Assets		**Liabilities**	
Current assets:		**Current liabilities:**	
Cash	105	Accounts payable	20
Accounts receivable	20		
Inventory	25	**Non-current liabilities:**	
Total current assets	**150**		
		Shareholders' equity	
Non-current assets:		Common shares	300
Plant and equipment	200	Retained earnings	
Total non-current assets	**200**	Revenues	120
		Cost of sales	(75)
		Expenses	(15)
			30
Total assets	**350**	**Total liabilities and shareholders' equity**	**350**

Basics of Marketing

Important terms to Remember

Segmentation

Segmentation is the process of dividing the market into smaller groups with similar needs and wants. This can be done using a variety of factors, such as demographics, psychographics and behaviour. Example: A car company segments customers by income & lifestyle.

Targeting

Targeting is the process of identifying and reaching out to a specific group of people that the business wants to focus its marketing efforts on. Example: The car company targets urban families seeking safe, reliable vehicles.

Positioning

Positioning is the act of designing a company's offering and image to occupy a distinctive place in the minds of the target market. The goal is to locate the brand in the minds of consumers to maximize the potential benefit to the firm. Example: The car company positions its SUV as the safest family car with top safety features.

Bundling

Offering multiple products or services together at a combined often discounted price. Bundling adds perceived value and convenience for the customer for instance a fast food combo that includes a burger, fries and a drink for less than buying each item separately.

Cross-Selling

Encouraging customers to purchase complementary or related products. This strategy increases the average order value by suggesting items that enhance the primary products use. Example : Amazon recommending a laptop bag or a mouse when you buy a laptop.

Upselling

Persuading customers to buy a higher end or upgraded version of a product. This approach improves revenue and customer satisfaction by aligning offerings with the buyers potential needs. Example : Suggesting an iPhone Pro instead of the base model for better performance.

Basics of Finance

Important Ratios to Remember

Quick Ratio	(Current Assets – Inventory) / Current Liabilities	This shows you how easily a business's short-term debts will be covered by its existing liquid assets, or cash. If the quick ratio is greater than one, the business is in a good financial position.
Debt to Equity Ratio	Total Liabilities / Shareholder's Equity	This looks at whether a business is borrowing more than it can reasonably pay back using equity as a metric i.e. how risky is the equity of the company.
Working Capital Ratio	Current Assets / Current Liabilities	This looks at how well a company can meets its operating liabilities.. The higher the working capital ratio, the easier it will be for a business to pay off its liabilities using its current assets.
P/E Ratio	Share Price/ Earnings per share	It measures the amount an investor would pay for each dollar earned. This gives you a quick idea if a stock is under or overvalued
Earnings per Share	Net Income / Outstanding shares	This measures the amount of a company's net income that is theoretically available for payment to the holders of its common stock.
Return on Equity Ratio	(Earnings – Dividends) / Shareholders Equity	ROE is a gauge of a corporation's profitability and how efficiently it generates those profits. The higher the ROE, the better a company is at converting its equity financing into profits.
Profit Margin	Profit/ Revenue	This shows you how efficiently a company is managing its overall costs, or how well it converts revenue into profit.

Basics of Finance

Time Value of Money

The time value of money (TVM) is the concept that a sum of money is worth more now than the same sum will be at a future date due to its earnings potential in the interim. It is also referred to as the *present discounted value.*



Annuity

An annuity is an equal and annual series of payments made over a predetermined time period.

Perpetuity

Perpetuity is a type of annuity that lasts forever, into perpetuity. The stream of cash flows continues for an infinite amount of time.

Capital Budgeting

Capital budgeting is a method of estimating the financial viability of a capital investment over the life of the investment.

NPV

The Net Present Value (NPV) method involves discounting a stream of future cash flows back to present value. The cash flows can be either positive (cash received) or negative (cash paid).



Payback Period

It represents the amount of time required for the cash flows generated by the investment to repay the cost of the original investment.

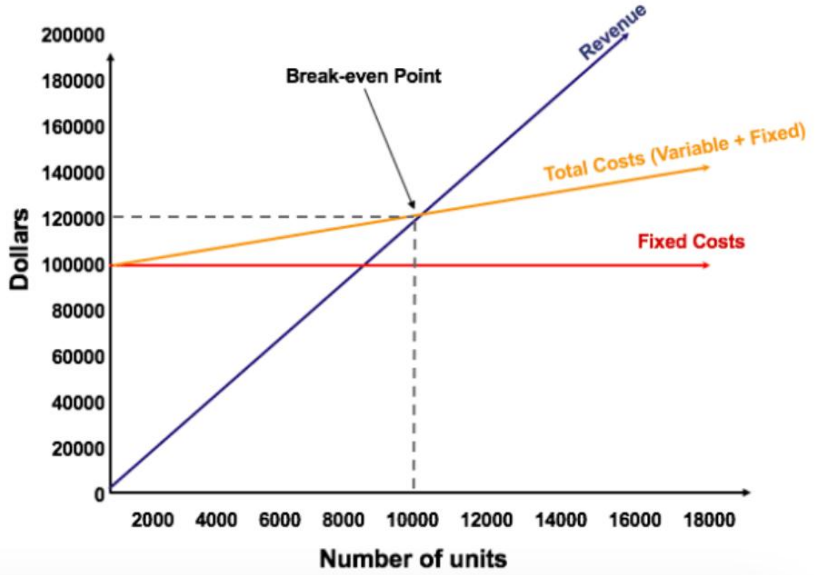
IRR

The Internal Rate of Return is the rate of return from the capital investment or the discount rate for which NPV = 0

Basics of Finance

Break Even Analysis

Break-even analysis refers to the point at which total costs and total revenue are equal. A break-even point analysis is used to determine the number of units or revenue needed to cover total costs (fixed and variable costs).



	Units	Total (₹)	₹ Per unit
Sales	20000.00	1200000.00	60.00
Less: Variable Costs		-900000.00	-45.00
Contribution Margin		300000.00	15.00
Less: Fixed Costs		-240000.00	
Net Income		60000.00	
Contribution Margin % of Sales		25%	
Break Even point		16000.00	

Break Even Point : Fixed Costs/ (Sales Price/ Unit – Variable Cost/Unit)

Other Important Terms you should know :

Contribution Margin (CM): It represents the incremental money generated for each product/unit sold after deducting the variable portion of the firm's costs.

CM : Sales – Variable Cost

Operating Leverage: Operating leverage measures the degree to which a firm or project can increase operating income by increasing revenue. The formula can reveal how well a company is using its fixed-cost items, such as its warehouse and machinery, and equipment, to generate profits.

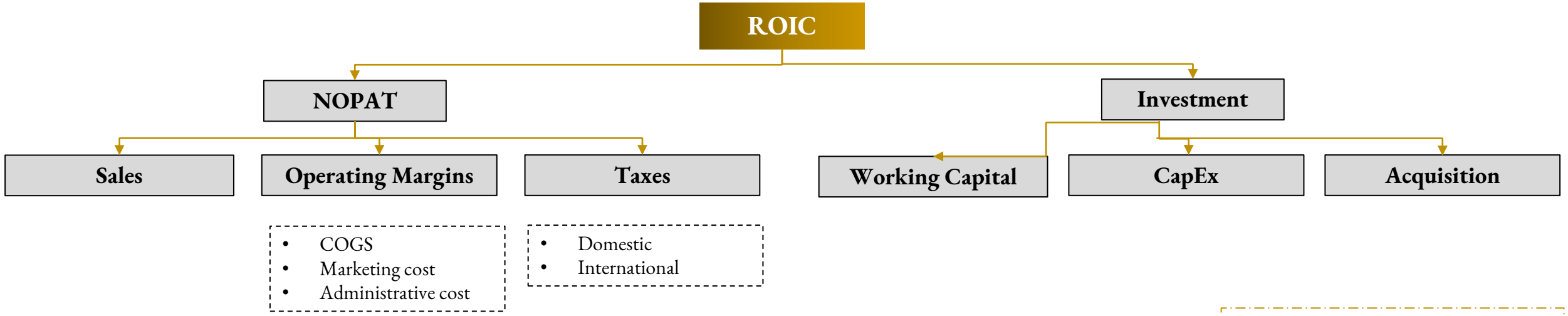
Degree of operating leverage:
% Change in Operating Profits/ % Change in sales

ROIC tree

ROIC (Return on Invested Capital) shows how efficiently a company turns capital into profits. The ROIC Tree helps break efficiency into actionable parts such as margins, asset use, and capital allocation.

By deconstructing ROIC into NOPAT** margin and Capital Turnover, a business can pinpoint:
- Where profitability can be improved (e.g., cost cutting, pricing strategy)
- How to better use its capital (e.g., reduce excess inventory, divest underperforming assets)

ROIC = NOPAT / Investment



**NOPAT : Net Operating Profit After Tax

Useful tool for analyzing a company's financial performance and identifying areas for improvement

Valuation Analysis

Valuation Analysis

Valuation analysis aims to estimate the fair or **intrinsic value** of an asset, such as a business or security. The process varies based on the asset type, its cash flow generation and the purpose of the valuation.

Book Value	Assets - Liabilities	Book value is the net value of a company's assets after deducting liabilities, representing what shareholders might receive in a liquidation. While it reflects the firm's accounting value, it can differ from market value, which is driven by investor perceptions and growth prospects. It helps assess if a stock is over or undervalued.
Market Capitalization	Current share price X Total number of outstanding shares	Market capitalization is a common way to value a publicly listed company. The disadvantages are that this method doesn't reflect a company's true value; value of debt and equity are not included in market capitalization.
Enterprise Value of the firm	Market capitalization + Total debt + Minority interest – (Cash & Cash equivalents)	Enterprise value reflects a company's total worth, including market capitalization, debt & cash. It's important to evaluate how management utilizes debt, as effective use can drive growth, while poor management increases financial risk. This measure provides a fuller picture of a company's financial health compared to market capitalization alone.
Net Income Approach	EBIT / WACC Or (Interest + Net Income) / WACC	Net Income (NI) approach, also known as the Fixed Cost of Equity (K_e), is a traditional approach that suggests that a company's capital structure affects its value. This approach assumes that the risk perception of equity will remain constant regardless of leverage. However, as debt increases in a capital mix, equity will demand a higher risk premium.

Valuation Analysis

Book Value

	(3)	Assets classified as held-for-sale	21	673.91	827.78
	TOTAL ASSETS			370,663.96	336,081.38
II.	EQUITY AND LIABILITIES				
	EQUITY				
	(a)	Equity share capital	23	766.50	766.02
	(b)	Other equity	24	84,151.52	44,555.77
		Equity attributable to owners of Tata Motors Limited		84,918.02	45,321.79
		Non-controlling interests		8,175.91	7,277.72
				93,093.93	52,599.51
	LIABILITIES				
	(1)	NON-CURRENT LIABILITIES			
		(a) Financial liabilities:			
		(i) Borrowings	26	62,148.53	88,695.81
		(ii) Lease liabilities		7,669.52	7,568.49
		(iii) Compulsorily Convertible Preference Shares - liability portion		2,547.90	2,500.00
		(iv) Other financial liabilities	28	1,673.12	5,822.47
		(b) Provisions	31	16,536.66	13,196.53
		(c) Deferred tax liabilities (net)	22	1,143.35	1,406.95
		(d) Other non-current liabilities	32	12,233.95	9,264.29
				103,953.03	128,454.54
	(2)	CURRENT LIABILITIES			
		(a) Financial liabilities:			
		(i) Borrowings	27	36,351.56	36,964.66
		(ii) Lease liabilities		1,092.89	884.48
		(iii) Trade payables	30		
		(a) Total outstanding dues of micro and small enterprises		502.31	316.01
		(b) Total outstanding dues of creditors other than micro and small enterprises		87,540.64	71,739.76
		(c) Acceptances		5,935.57	7,195.99
		(iv) Other financial liabilities	29	15,385.12	13,828.58
		(b) Provisions	31	12,291.47	11,810.66
		(c) Current tax liabilities (net)		1,527.14	1,254.19
		(d) Other current liabilities	33	12,990.30	11,033.00
				173,617.00	155,027.33
	TOTAL EQUITY AND LIABILITIES			370,663.96	336,081.38

The above image shows an excerpt from the Balance Sheet of Tata Motors, FY 2023-24 {All values in ₹ crores}

Book value of firm = Assets - Liabilities
Liabilities = 1,73,617 + 1,03,953 = 2,77,570
Assets = 3,70,663

Book Value = 3,70,663 – 2,77,570 = ₹ 93,093 Crore

Market Capitalization

		Year ended March 31, 2024		Year ended March 31, 2023	
		(Number of shares)	(₹ in crores)	(Number of shares)	(₹ in crores)
(i)	**Ordinary shares**				
	Balance as at April 1	3,32,13,44,325	664.27	3,32,06,62,007	664.13
	Add: Allotment of shares on exercise of stock options by employees	23,94,676	0.48	6,82,318	0.14
	Balance as at March 31	**3,32,37,39,001**	**664.75**	**3,32,13,44,325**	**664.27**
(ii)	**'A' Ordinary shares**				
	Balance as at April 1	50,85,02,896	101.70	50,85,02,896	101.70
	Balance as at March 31	**50,85,02,896**	**101.70**	**50,85,02,896**	**101.70**

The above image shows an excerpt from the Annual Report of Tata Motors, FY 2023-24 {All values in ₹ crores}

Market Capitalization of firm = Share price * Total number of outstanding shares
Total number of outstanding shares = 3,32,32,39,001 + 50,85,02,896 = 383,17,41,897
Share price (As of 1st September, 2024) = ₹ 1100

Market Capitalization = 383,17,41,897 * 1100 ≈ ₹ 4.2 L Crore

Valuation Analysis

Enterprise Value

(2)	**CURRENT ASSETS**				
	(a) Inventories	13		47,788.29	40,755.39
	(b) Financial assets:				
	(i) Investments	10		14,253.24	18,838.31
	(ii) Trade receivables	14		16,951.81	15,737.97
	(iii) Cash and cash equivalents	15	4	40,014.76	31,886.95
	(iv) Bank balances other than (iii) above	16		5,791.93	5,128.61
	(v) Finance receivables	17		24,069.50	23,417.31
	(vi) Loans	11		196.70	123.53
	(vii) Other financial assets	12		8,121.47	4,966.03
	(c) Current tax assets (net)			101.15	259.26
	(d) Other current assets	20		10,429.39	9,587.33
				167,718.24	**150,700.69**
(3)	**Assets classified as held-for-sale**	21		**673.91**	**827.78**
TOTAL ASSETS				**370,663.96**	**336,081.38**
II.	**EQUITY AND LIABILITIES**				
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		Year ended March 31, 2024		Year ended March 31, 2023	
		(Number of shares)	(₹ in crores)	(Number of shares)	(₹ in crores)
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Total number of outstanding shares = 3,32,32,39,001 + 50,85,02,896 = 383,17,41,897
Share price (As of 1st September 2024) = ₹ 1100

Market Capitalization = 383,17,41,897 * 1100 ≈ ₹ 4.2 L Crore ..... A
Total Debt (1 + 2) = 36,351 + 62,148 = 98,499 ..... B
Minority Interest (3) = 8,175 C
Cash and Cash Equivalents (4) = 40,014 ..... D

Enterprise Value = A + B + C – D ≈ 4.86 L Crore

Part C – Basic of Guesstimates and Case Solving

Main Index

MECE Segmentation

MECE = Mutually Exclusive Collectively Exhaustive



Mutually Exclusive

Contents of the segments does not overlap.



Collectively Exhaustive

Together, the statements answer the question or fully describe the overall idea.

Using MECE segmentation is extremely effective in structuring one's analysis, in a case interview, guesstimate or otherwise.

How to be MECE?

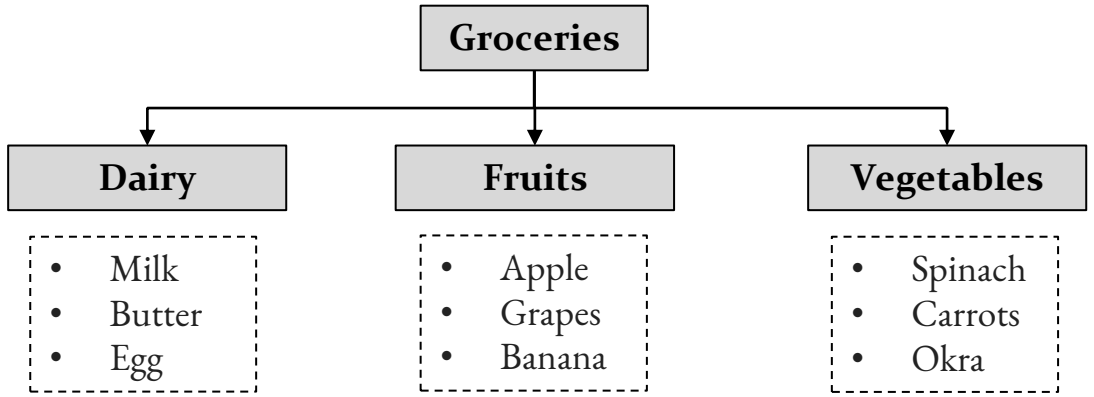
There are 5 tools one can use to be MECE in their cases:

1. Algebraic Structure	Break down problem into equations. • Ex: Revenue = No. of customers x Avg ticket price of each customer x Product mix.
2. Process Structure	Break down problem into the stages of a process • Ex: Value chain, customer journey, billing process, purchase process in e-Commerce
3. Segmentation Structure	Break down problem into divisions of a particular segment • Ex: Income (High, Mid, Low income), Distribution channels (Retail, D2C)
4. Conceptual Frameworks	Break down problem by using established frameworks • Ex: 4P (Product, Price, Place, Promotion), 3C (Customer, Company, Competitor)
5. Opposite Words	Break down problem into inherently opposing words • Ex: Internal vs. External, Supply vs. Demand, Revenue vs. Cost

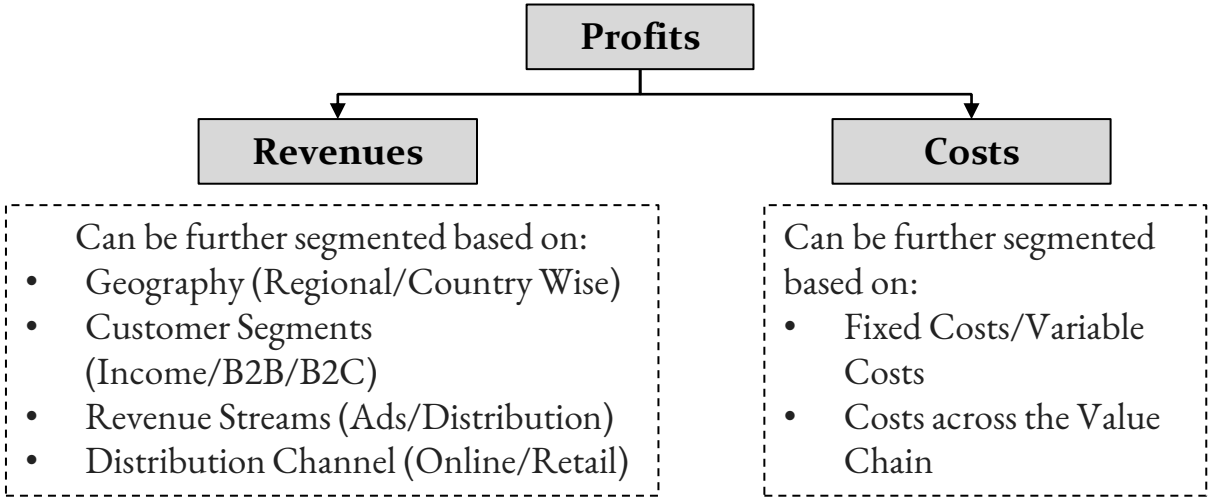
The MECE principle suggests that to understand any large problem, you need to understand your options by sorting them into categories. Doing so will help you avoid dependencies between different branches of the tree and thus sub-problems can be properly isolated.

MECE Segmentation

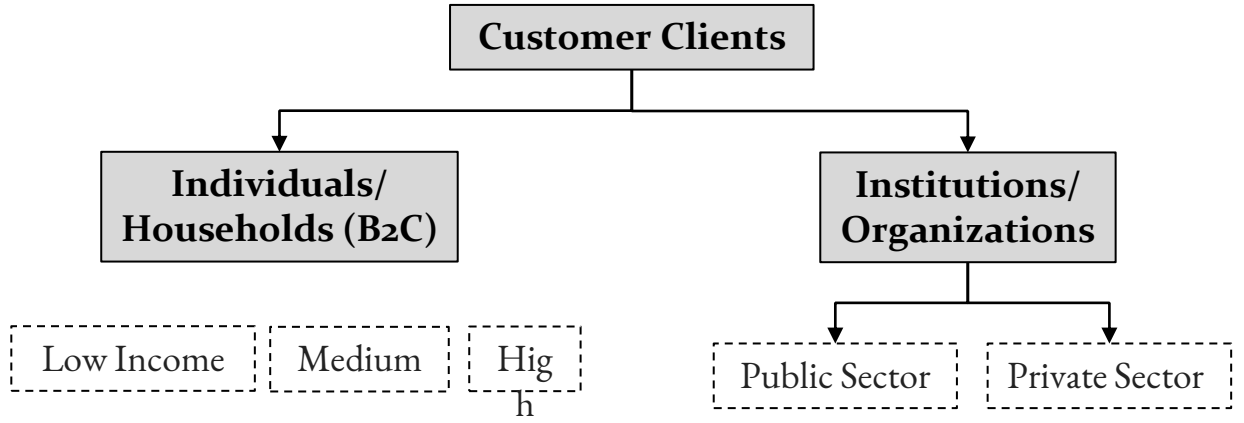
Example 1: Unstructured grocery list: apples, milk, bananas, spinach, carrots, grapes, butter, okra, eggs becomes:



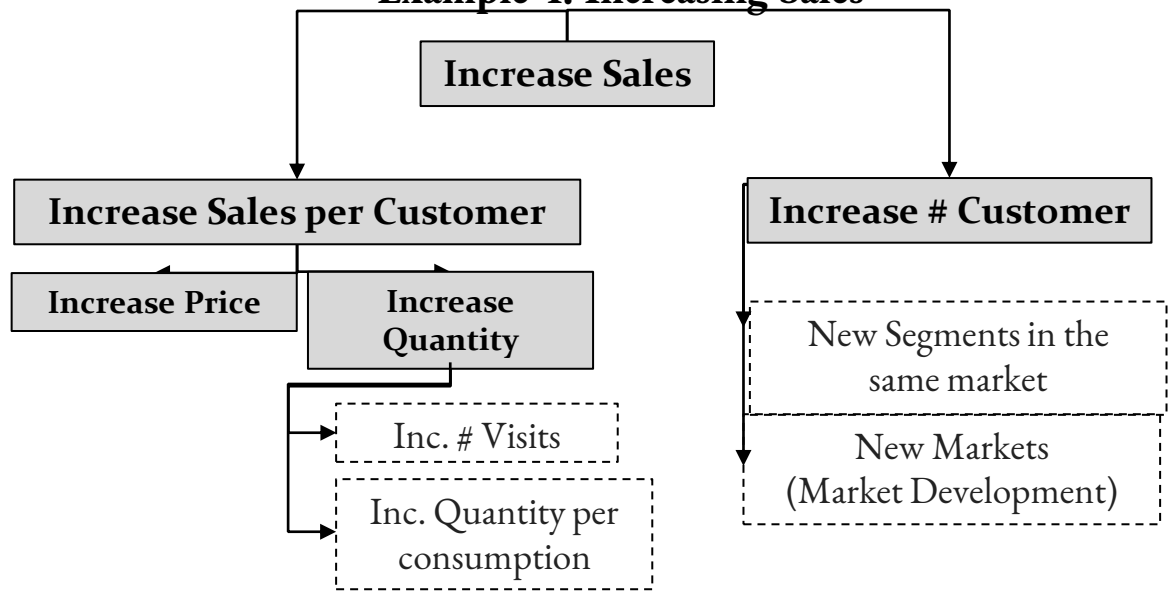
Example 2: Profit Structure



Example 3: Customer Segmentation



Example 4: Increasing Sales



Pareto Principle (80/20 Principle)

- As per the 80/20 Rule (aka Pareto Principle) a small number of causes (the "vital" or "critical" few) drive the vast majority of the results, with roughly 20% of the causes driving 80% of the results.
- It is a ubiquitous phenomenon with examples across multiple industries:



Manufacturer ~20% of the product lines generate ~80% of scrap



Sales organisation ~20% of the product categories account for ~80% of sales



Service facility ~20% of tickets take up ~80% of time

- The primary implication of this concept is that you can realize a lot of impact by investing your effort in addressing a relatively small number of issues and hence, prioritizing of issues is important.
- The key takeaway from this principle in the context of interviews is that while constructing an issue tree or making recommendations (using the pyramid principle) one must prioritize the bigger issues by stating them first.

Introduction to Guesstimates

What is evaluated through Guesstimates?

- Ability to think on your feet
- Approach & Structure
- Quantitative Skills

What is necessary to solve a good Guesstimate?

- Logical Thinking
- Communication & Presentation

Guesstimates: Short, number–intensive estimation Cases
Ideal Time Limit: 15-20 minutes

Top Down and Bottom Up Approach

Supply Side and Demand Side Approach

Introduction to Guesstimates

Define the problem → **Break down into buckets** → **State assumptions & solve**

- ***Confirm about the case statement with interviewer***
- ***Make modification if required and clarify the scope***

- ***Try to express the problem in mathematical equation***

- ***State whatever to be used (any proxy information)***
- ***Back it by logical justification***

Estimate the number of cups of tea consumed per day at FMS Delhi.

- Clarify scope – Students? Faculty? Visitors?
- Timeframe – Daily? Weekly? Monthly?

- No of students
  X
  Avg cup per student per day

- No of students ~ 500
- Type of tea drinkers
  - Low – 1 cup/day (60%)
  - Medium – 2 cup/day (30%)
  - High – 5 cups/day (10%)

Guesstimates Do's & Don'ts

Do's



- Take about a minute to gather your thoughts and decide approach
- Use tree diagrams, normal diagrams, anything that explains your thoughts clearly in a visual way
- Relate your assumptions to facts, experiences and sellable logic
- Keep talking as you write, engage the interviewer

Ideal Flow

1. **Confirm Objective**
2. **Think logically and come up with possible set of approaches**
3. **Explain the best approach & confirm if you should go ahead with it**
4. **State your assumptions first hand**
5. **Lay down structure neatly on paper and solve it step by step**
6. **Make logical assumptions and always confirm them with Interviewer**
7. **Keep communicating & asking the interviewer for buy-ins**
8. **Calculate your answer. Be ready for a conversation around error estimate, other approaches**
9. **If possible, reconfirm & triangulate your answer with a ballpark estimate from another approach**



Don'ts

- Ask too many clarifying questions
- Questions about approach
- Start solving without discussing the approach
- Start with a population set every time
- Be text heavy on your sheet
- Unreadable writing
- Guessing the numbers
- Solving without explaining what you are doing

Approaching Guesstimates

Ideal Flow

Pyramid Approach

Top Down

- Start with **the broadest possible universe**(e.g., population of a country)
- Apply a series of **filters and assumptions** (e.g., age group, users, frequency)
- Gradually **narrow down** to the final estimate
- Useful when **macro data** is more accessible

Bottom Up

- Begin with **micro-level metrics** (e.g., units sold per store/day)
- Build up by **multiplying logical layers** (e.g., no. of stores × days × avg. sales)
- More reliable when you have **access to base-level numbers**
- Used when **assumptions at a small scale**

Supply- Demand Approach

Demand

- Estimate based on **population or usage behavior**
- Identify the **need or frequency** of product/service usage
- Apply segmentation filters (e.g., age, income)
- Works well for products/services that are **consumption-driven**

Supply

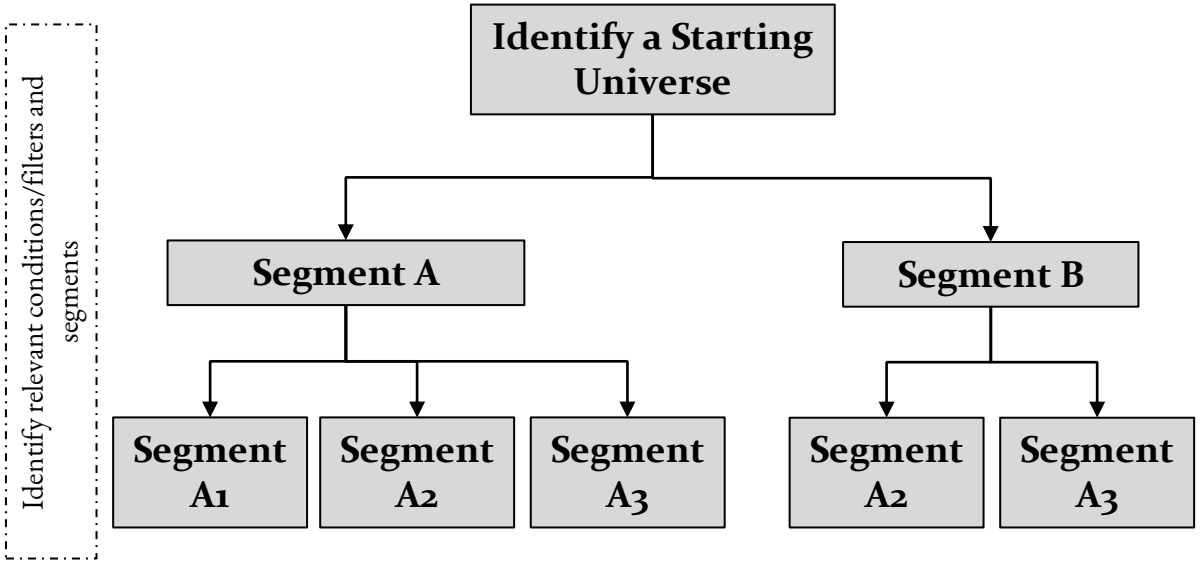
- Estimate the **maximum output** or availability of a product/service
- Consider **factors of production**, capacity limits, working hours, etc.
- Useful when you're asked **how much of something can** be provided

Note: Don't get fixated to one method. Practice all.

Top Down & Bottom Up Approach

Top down approach

- Start with an entire population (in other words, the top level) and then breaking it down until you arrive at an answer.

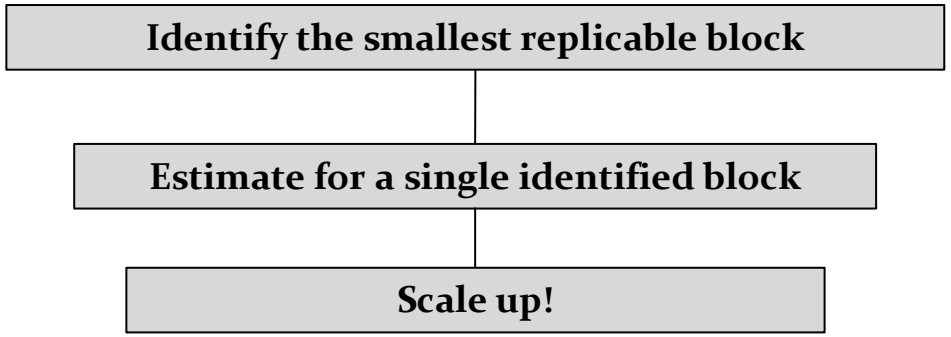


Guesstimate = A1 + A2 + B1 + B2 +B3

- Segments:
  - Demographics (age, sex, income)
  - Psychographics(attitudes, behaviors, values)
  - Geography (city/country, urban vs. rural)
  - And many more depending on the case!

Bottom up approach

- Start from the bottom—some low-level statistic, such as Revenue per store, which does not change across your universe and build your way up to the answer.



- Bottom up approach is much more subjective than top down approach.
- Especially replicable blocks depend on the case in hand, it can be one single store, one family to a single person. Be careful while picking your block and while scaling up.
- Bottom up approach though gives accurate results provided you scale up properly.

Guesstimate Cheat Sheet

Total Population of India ~143 Cr

Gender Split Women/Men: 48:52	Urban to Rural 35:65	Average Household Size 4-5 people
Birth Rate 1.69% Death Rate 0.74%	Population Density 480/km^2	Avg. Life Expectancy 70.4

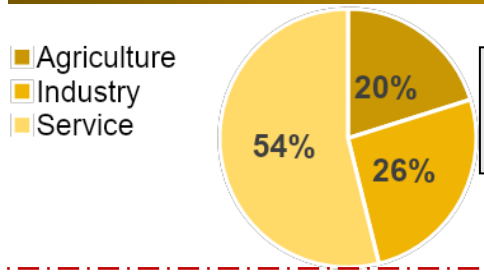
Age-wise Distribution of Population

Age Bracket	Percentage
0-14 Years	26%
15-24 Years	18%
25-34 Years	17%
35-44 Years	14%
45-54 Years	10%
55+ Years	15%

Largest cities (by Population)

Cities	Pop. (Mn)	Cities	Pop. (Mn)
Delhi	32.94	Chennai	11.78
Mumbai	21.3	Hyderabad	10.8
Kolkata	15.33	Ahmedabad	8.65
Bangalore	13.61	Surat	8.06

GDP Distribution



Total GDP (~3.4 Trillion USD)

Geographical Distribution

Length of India	3200 kms (North to South)
Breadth of India	3000 kms (West to East)
Number of States	28
Number of UTs	8
Area of Delhi	1500 square kms
Population of Delhi	3.3 Cr
Area of Mumbai	600 square kms
Population of Mumbai	2.2 Cr

Internet Connectivity Distribution

Internet Penetration 50%

Smart Phone Penetration 71%

Religion split

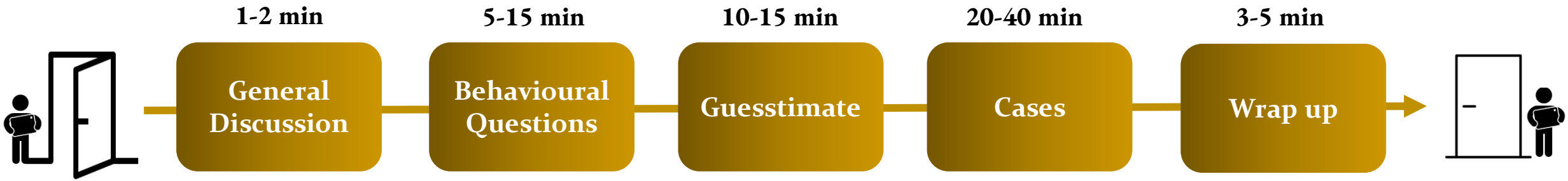
Religion	Hindu	Islam	Christianity	Others
Population	80%	13%	2.3%	4.7%

Income wise distribution of population

Income Segment	Percentage
Lower Income	10%
Lower Middle Income	38%
Middle Income	40%
Upper Middle income	10%
Upper Income	2%

Case Interview Process

Flow of a Consulting Interview



Case Interview:

- Cases form the crux of a consulting interview.
- There could be multiple case rounds with different partners.
- They are trying to test you for your:
  - Analytical ability
  - Quantitative skills
  - Structured problem solving and insight generation
  - Communication and presence
  - Impact and Effectiveness

Interviewer Expectations

It's not about being right. It's about being right in a *client friendly* way. How you are *right* matters a lot.

Things which are not client friendly:

- ❑ Jumping to conclusions
- ❑ Scattered ideas, shooting arrows in the dark
- ❑ Can't be justified by data/facts
- ❑ Logically correct but practically unfeasible
- ❑ Being rude
- ❑ Poor communication

P2P Case Practice

Peer to Peer Case Practice



- Why?
- Interview simulation
- Get used to speaking
- Instant Feedback
- Two-way learning

For Interviewer

- Understand the case properly
- Provide information at right time after right questions
- Be open to different approaches
- Guide the interview in such a way that there is relevant and fruitful discussion
- Feedback and self-learning

For Interviewee

- Understand the Question
- Clarify Objectives
- Set Context to Case
- Define a framework
- Analyze, identify, discuss
- Solutions/Suggestions
- Discuss improvements

Approaching a Case

1. Repeat the question and clarify the objectives
2. Think and understand what more you need to know
3. Set context to the case by asking questions. Be very careful about what you are asking and why.
4. Take time to think and lay down a structure for analysis
5. Involve interviewer in your analysis. Ask relevant question to process down your structure.
6. Make good and relevant suggestions which are specific to the case. Always have a rationale ready for Why?
7. Summarize the case properly. Be brief yet effective.

Case Interview Do's & Don'ts

Do's



- Listen and Interact with the Interviewer.
- Develop your own framework to structure the problem.
- Focus on high impact issues.
- Explore variety of options with creative thinking.
- Demonstrate Business Judgement.
- Make quick and accurate calculations.
- Make a good conclusion to your analysis.



Don'ts

- Incorrect interpretation of case objectives.
- Jumping straight to conclusions.
- Not taking time to think, answering in hurry.
- Panicking if the answer is not apparent.
- Vehemently defending your analysis/suggestions.
- Internalizing the thought process.
- Sticking to artificial framework.

Part D – Basic Frameworks

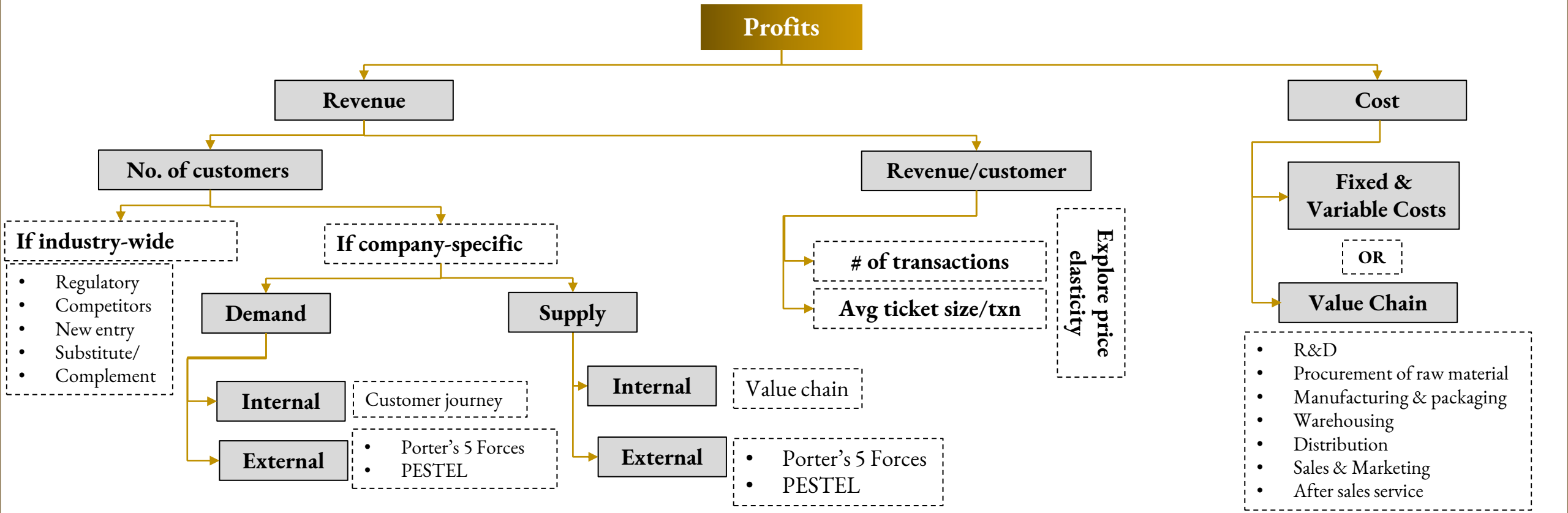
Main Index

Profitability Framework

Understand the question and clarify the Objectives

A profitability case explores the rationale and reasons behind the decline in profits for a company. The case can hence be explored via looking into Revenue and Costs separately or exploring both the aspects to find the root cause of decline.

Set context — Ask about company? Product/customer mix? Revenue streams? Quantum of decline? Timeline of decline? Industry-wide vs company specific?



Market Entry Framework

Understand the question and clarify the Objectives

A market entry case is a relatively open-ended case where in you need to understand the rationale behind entering a new market; and if that rationale can be profitably achieved or not. If the decision of entry is made, how should it be implemented.

Set context — Know about company? What Business? Entry where? Which Product? Why enter? Target/objective? Decided to enter?

Should they Enter?

Product
- Features (USP)
- Pricing
- Competitive benchmarking
- Product Life Cycle

Market Attractiveness
- TG by STP
- Market Size
- Market share & growth rate

Financial Feasibility
- Financing options
- Revenue & Costs i.e. Profits
- Opportunity costs
- Break-even Point/Timeline

Operational Capabilities
- Self-manufacturing i.e. Value-chain analysis
- Off-shore manufacturing
- Import/Export

Risks Associated
- Govt. Regulations
- Patents/IP
- PESTEL
- Porter's 5 Forces

If Yes How?

Entry Options
- Start on own
- Acquire
- Joint Venture

Operational Decisions
- Raw Materials, Workforce
- Manufacturing
- Value Chain Analysis

Sales & Marketing
- Distr Channels
- Promotion
- Pricing

Growth Plan
- How to scale up
- Product/Geography expansion

Conclusion
Summarize the solution

Growth Strategy

Understand the Question and Clarify the Objectives

Growth Strategy related cases are comparatively easier to analyze because avenues for growth are unlimited. You need to understand the current state of business and then come up with practically feasible growth opportunities. Each opportunity needs to be assessed for potential impact vs financial and practical feasibility.

Set context

What Business? Geographies/Location? Current Performance? Products? Target Customer? Competitive Benchmarking? Growth Targets? Capabilities? Bottlenecks?

Growth Strategies

Organic

Revenue (Existing Market)

Old Product/Service

- New & extensive Marketing initiatives & distribution channels
- Pricing strategy
- Customer satisfaction

New Product/Service

- Strategic positioning
- Targeted marketing
- Customer satisfaction (better experiences)

Revenue (New Market)

Old Product/Service

- Explore geog/demographic expansion
- Localized marketing/distribution strategy

New Product/Service

Related Diversification

- Similar product line

Unrelated Diversification

- New product line

Inorganic

Joint Ventures

M&A

- Backward, forward, horizontal, vertical integration

Summary

Proposed growth path, Potential growth prospects, Threats & Challenges

Pricing Strategy

Understand the Question and Clarify the Objectives

Pricing decisions should be taken to maximize the revenue potential by understanding product competitiveness in the market. Understanding competitive products, possible substitutes, price elasticity, cost structures is essential to take a good pricing decision.

Set context — Product/Service characteristics? Product use? Capital Investments? Competitors? Substitutes?

Pricing Factors

Product
- Radical vs Incremental change
- Uses/ Characteristics
- Advantages/Disadvantages

Costing
- R&D cost
- Manufacturing Cost
- Other costs

Competitors
- Competitive products
- Product differentiation
- Price benchmarking

Substitutes
- Available substitute
- Substitute use triggers
- Future substitutes

Customer
- Who is buying
- Their characteristics
- Perceived Value

Pricing Options

Competitive Pricing
- Competitors' price
- +/- Premium/Discount

Cost Based Pricing
- Cost of production + Margin
- Break-even Analysis

Value Based Pricing
- Customer's willingness to pay
- Perceived value of product
- Can take a proxy to consider value

Go To Market Strategy/New Product Launch

Understand the Question and Clarify the Objectives

Provide a blueprint for launching a product in a market, positioning it to achieve competitive advantage. You would typically look at defining the 4Ps after deciding on the target segment. Touching upon all relevant aspects of the problem is much more important that the correct answer. The idea is to identify one/a few issue(s) examining the trade-offs.

Set Context

Objectives, Capabilities, Competition (How many, who all, Market Share, Growth Rate), Customers (Growth Rate, Potential Segments), Products (Existing Products, Substitutes).

Segmentation

Whom to Sell?

Use only relevant bases from the following:
- Geographic
- Demographic
- Psychographic
- Behavioural

Product Development

What to Sell?

- Features
- Packaging
- Use-cases
- Size (SKU)
- Product Name
- Differentiation
- Pricing

Distribution Strategy

Where to Sell?

- Distribution Channel
- Distribution Model
- WC Turnover
- Margins
- Sales Force T&D

Communication Strategy

What to Say?

- Positioning
- Communication Strategy
  - Advertising
  - Personal Selling
  - Sales Promotion
  - Direct Mktg
  - Public Relations

Idea

GTM strategies are supposed to be integrated in nature and thus the processes strongly follow from each other.

Be Selective

The idea is to not do everything, rather to focus on one issue and nail it. E.g. Too many sales channels can lead to channel conflict, Too much communication is expensive.

Merger & Acquisitions

Understand the Question and Clarify the Objectives

M&A cases are focused on decisions regarding a potential merger or acquisition opportunity. You need to understand the synergies involved, do cost vs benefit analysis & due diligence, and recommend whether to take the opportunity or not.

Set context

Objective? Company business? Company geography, value chain, customer? Current portfolio of company? Current Performance? Target Company (Geog., value chain, target market)? Past M&A history in similar space ? Industry Trend ?

1. Hard Fit (Financial Fit)

Deal Price

- Is the deal at a fair price?
- Valuation (Calculate NPV)
- Financially feasible? Can we afford?
- Transaction Type (Merger, acquisition)
- Post M&A costs (Future costs)

Synergies

- Revenue-based synergies (Portfolio/market expansion, pricing power)
- Cost-based synergies (involves value chain)
- Integration of cost/saving
- Competition/Survival

2. Soft Fit (Non-Financial Fit)

Internal Fit

- Cultural, strategic, organizational fit
- Fit of companies: Mission, Vision, Values

External Fit

- Macro-economic risks
- Exploring PESTEL/Porter's Five Forces

3. Due Diligence

Checks and Confirmations

- Strategic Options
- Commercial (Market related)
- Operational (Target related)
- Financial (Target's data, Valuation)
- Legal (Regulatory norms)

4. Implementation

- How can the merger or acquisition be effectively implemented.
- Issues related to cultural integration and operational aspects and targeted benefits

5. Exit Strategies

How, When, why to exit?

- How long to Hold on?
- Strategic Options?
- Very important in Private Equity

Merger & Acquisitions

Understand the Question and Clarify the Objectives

Mergers & acquisitions are key strategic choices for inorganic growth. This framework helps evaluate a merger or acquisition by assessing both financial and non-financial dimensions, to determine whether the opportunity creates sustainable value.

Set scope — Understand the client and the target company, understand the objective of merger

Financial

Cost

Acquisition

- Expenses linked with the process of acquiring
- Regulatory compliance costs
- Advisory fees
- Financing costs
- Legal fees

Integration

- IT system consolidation
- Employee transition
- Rebranding

Operational Benefits

Revenue enhancements

- Cross – selling
- Product expansion
- Increased market share through combined operation

Cost reductions

- Economies of scale
- Supply chain optimization
- Energy & resource efficiency improvements

Value add

Valuation

- Reflects the present value of expected future cash flows, considering current capital structure.
  - DCF
  - Relative
- Adjusts for risk factors
  - market volatility
  - integration challenges

Non Financial

Synergy Realization

Operational

- Benefits derived
- Incentives
- Access to capital
- Diversification of revenue streams
- Financial Reconciliation

Strategic Fit

- Cultural alignment
- Behavioral
- Long – term goals met or not
- Enhanced market positioning

External

- PESTEL analysis
- Porter's forces
- Macroeconomic risks

Exit Option

- IPO
- Total exit
- Partial Exit
- Management buyout

This framework provides an alternative approach to evaluate M&A opportunities by assessing financial, operational, strategic, and external factors.

When Nothing Works (Cheat Sheet)

Sometimes, it may be the case that none of the standard case frameworks can be applied to the business situation at hand. There are certain other approaches you can explore to solve the case in that case.

Set context

Go through the entire Value Chain or Process Undergone (For Process Flow Cases). Drill down into each stage or step to look for inefficiencies, issues or bottlenecks.

Value Chain

Demand Planning & Forecasting	Procurement of Raw Materials	Inbound Logistics	Manufacturing	Storage and Warehousing	Outbound Logistics	Sales and Marketing/ Distribution	After-Sales Services
Volatility? Analytics & Forecasting?	Price? Wastage? Suppliers? Contracts? Discounts? Substitutes?	Transportation Costs? Modes? Network Optimization? Efficiency?	Direct Costs? Machines? Tech? Overheads? Benchmarking? Outsourcing?	Capacity Constraints? SKUs? Technology? Inventory?	Transportation Costs? Modes? Network Optimization? Efficiency?	Channels? Share & Penetration? Marketing Strategy? B2B? B2C?	Quality? Variety? Cost? Benchmarking? Accessibility? Frequency?

Process Flow / Customer Journey

Chart out the entire process journey. Sample Use Cases –
1) Ecommerce Ordering Dissatisfaction
2) Toll Plaza inefficiencies
3) Getting late to office/home

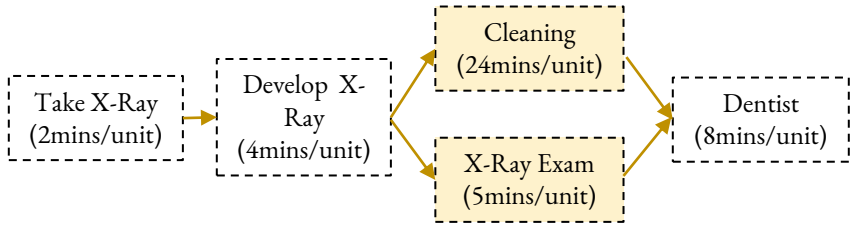
Example: E-Commerce Discovery and Ordering Process Map

Search	Landing Page	Evaluation	Ordering	Delivery	Unboxing	Usage & After Sales
SEO? Ads? Social Media? Emails?	Navigation? Products/page Description? Options?	Product Page? Reviews? Use? Graphics? Bundling?	Cart options? Wishlist? Payment Modes?	Sellers? Shipping Dates? Experience?	Condition of Package? Breakage?	Customer Care? Refund/ Exchange/ Return?

Look for Bottlenecks

- A bottleneck is any area along the production line where work can get backed up for one reason or another.
- Performing a bottleneck analysis can help to identify the cause of a bottleneck, and lead to potential solutions to get a smooth, continuous, even work-flow.

Example: Teeth Check-up and Cleaning Process



5 Senses Framework – Auxiliary Tool

To be used alongside another framework

Sometimes, it may be the case that none of the standard case frameworks can be applied to the business situation at hand. The **5 senses framework** comes into play generally when we are dealing with a **service-based industry** and when the case demands the exploration of the **decline in the customer satisfaction.**
Ex: decline in footfall, bad customer feedback, drop in NPS, decline in market share.

Identify customer friction points in accordance with the various stimuli along the customer journey



The Sense of Vision

What is the customer seeing?

- Unhygienic conditions
- Vapid posters
- Lighting at the store
- View from windows
- Televisions/displays



The Sense of Hearing

What is the customer hearing?

- Music
- Announcements
- Construction
- Arguments/fights
- Interactions with staff



The Sense of Smell

What is the customer smelling?

- Foul smell
- Infestations
- Sanitation
- Fragrance
- Scent



The Sense of Taste

What is the customer tasting? Customer preferences (taste)?

- Product
- Food
- Refreshments
- Preferences / proclivity



The Sense of Touch

What is the customer touching/feeling?

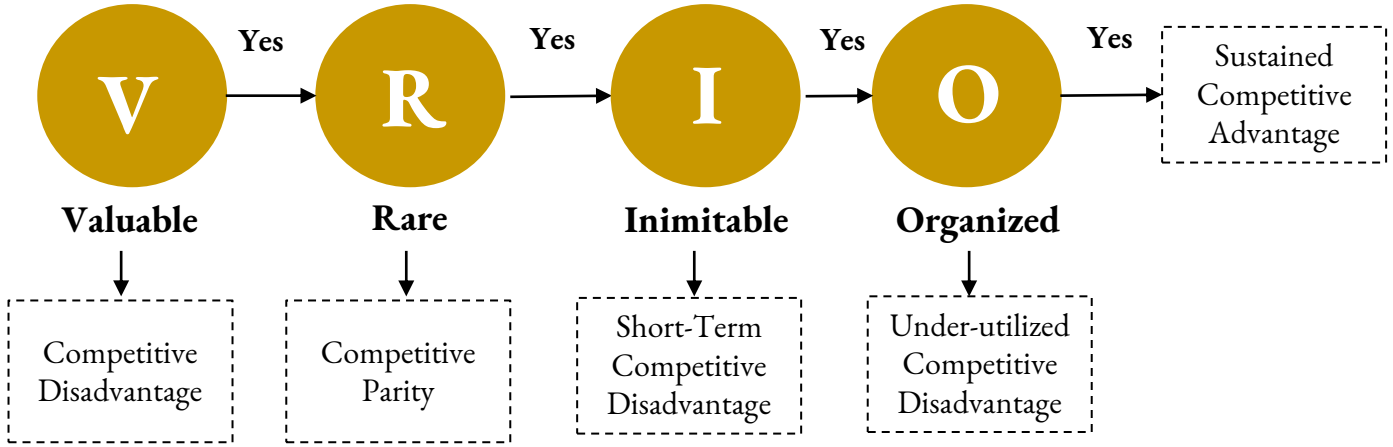
- Feel of the products
- Infrastructure
- Temperature / AC
- Ambience
- Furniture

This is an **auxiliary framework** and needs to be used as a part of the case to explore the various friction points that the customer might come across in their **customer journey.** The idea being that one needs to put themselves in the shoes of the customer and identify friction points

Additional Approaches

VRIO Framework

Used to determine whether a resource can provide sustained competitive advantage to the company



AMO Framework

Employee productivity and effectiveness; to assess salesforce personnel

Ability	Motivation	Opportunity
Hiring Training Learning Skill Development	Incentive structure Performance evaluation & metrics	Career planning Fair appraisal Recognition Empowerment

Tips & Tricks

1. **Use equations** for increase/decrease parameters. Subsequently, focus on each parameter and discuss it further.

Examples:
- Migration Rate = Birth Rate – Death Rate
- Cash Balance = Cash in – Cash out

2. **Decision Making Problems,** following can be considered:

Examples:
- Stakeholder cost-benefit analysis
- Decision trees
- Pay-off matric

3. **Implementation Problems:** Outline the value chain and then get buy-in on focus areas

Various ways of approaching what to do with a resource: Use it, Sell It, Give it away

4. **Problem Solution**:

Examples:
- Investigate 'why' problem exists
- Give solutions to solve problem
- Explore further opportunities

Clarifying Questions Framework

Every case starts with the Generic Bucket (asked always), then narrows into the Case-Specific Bucket based on the question type identified.

Generic Bucket – Ask on Every Case

Company
- What does the company do?
- Where is it based, and what geographies does it operate in?
- What are key revenue streams?
- Where does it sit in value chain?
- Is the company concentrated in any particular geography / segment?
- What is the company's scale?

Customer
- Who exactly is the target customer?
- Which customer segment is affected?
- Do we target premium end customers or mass end customers

Competitor
- What is the client's current market position?
- Has market share changed recently?

Timeline
- When did the problem / opportunity start?
- Was there a specific trigger?
- Is the change sudden or gradual?
- Is this a one-time issue or an ongoing trend?

Budget
- Is there a budget / investment cap?
- Are there operational / capacity constraints?
- Are there geographic / strategic restrictions?
- Are there any non-negotiables for the client?

Product
- What exactly is the product / offering?
- Which product / SKU is in scope?
- What is the product's key differentiator / USP?

Case-Specific Bucket – Pick Based on Question Type

Profitability
- Revenue or cost driven?
- Sudden drop or gradual decline?
- One segment or company-wide?
- Industry wide issue or company specific

Market Entry
- Objective of entry
- Why only this location?
- Regulatory/cultural barriers
- Budget constraint
- Why this geography

Growth
- Lever – customer/geo/product/penetration?
- Target # and by when?
- Why x%? Any data to back it?
- Budget constraint

Pricing
- Current pricing model, if any?
- Single SKU or portfolio?
- Objective of pricing
- Any other similar product?
- USP of our product?

Unconventional
- Exact metric being asked?
- Geographic/time scope?
- Real business question behind the estimate?

M&A
- Buy-side or sell-side?
- Synergy objective (revenue/cost/capability)?
- Financing & deal-size ceiling?
- Integration approach planned?
- Regulatory/antitrust concerns?

Part E – Sector Overview

Main Index

Industry Analysis: Table of Contents

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Legend for Industry Dynamics (Porter's 5 Forces)	
TONE	Threat of New Entrants
BPOS	Bargaining Power of Suppliers
BPOB	Bargaining Power of Buyers
TOS	Threat of Substitutes
CR	Competitive Rivalry
Colour Code (POV of industry player)	
Red	Unfavourable
Orange	Moderately Favourable
Green	Favourable

Understanding Automotive Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

USD 137- 147B (2026-27)

CAGR

7.5% (2026-31)

Market Share of Major Players

MARUTI SUZUKI	TATA MOTORS	Mahindra
USD 44B	USD 19.4B	USD 42.8B
~40%	~14.6%	~13.8%

Industry Dynamics

TONE: Low, more investment required
BPOS: Low, large no. of suppliers, but rare earth metals concentrated in China
BPOB: High, large number of options
TOS: Moderate, More public mobility
CR: High, Lot of competition

KPIs

- Inventory Turnover
- Utilization Rate
- Average Production Downtime
- Production efficiency
- Recall Rates
- Electric Vehicle Adoption Rate

Key Terms

- Crossover SUV
- Component Localization
- OEM (Original Equipment Manufacturer)
- BS-VI (Bharat Stage VI)
- BSBD (Built,Sourced,Developed)

Value Chain

R&D and Inbound Log

- Design of new models with new features
- Procurement of raw materials & components
- Prototyping components
- Warehouse handling

Manufacturing & Assembly

- Production – casting, forming, welding and machining components
- Final assembly of products
- Quality testing and adherence to standards

Outbound Log & Distribution

- Warehousing and transportation of finished vehicles
- Management of dealership network and shipping

Marketing & Sales

- Advertising and promotional activities
- Customer engagement, test drives and managing inventory
- Retail stores, dealerships

After-Sales Service

- Vehicle servicing, maintenance, warranty and repair
- Sales of accessories and replacements
- Service center support

Revenue Drivers

Vehicle sales (~60-70%)
Spare parts/after-sales (~10-15%)
Exports (~15-20%)

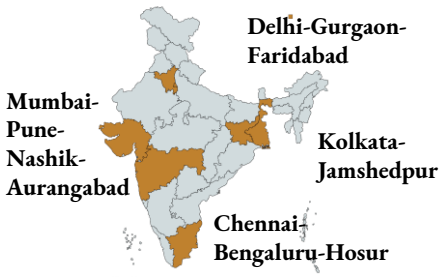
Cost Drivers

Cost of raw materials (~47%) (rare earth/EV motor volatility) Labor cost (~21%) R&D & Gen Exp (~13%) Logistics, Depr & Other (~19%)

Growth Drivers

- Growth of EV industry: A significant growth of 10% (BEV 2026-31) to 18% (broader EV through 2034)
- GST2.0 (2025) rationalization
- Changing consumer behaviour – increasing disposable income
- Digitization of sales of cars
- Strong export growth

Production Clusters



Challenges

- China rear earth dependency
- GST 2.0 dual slab transition
- Stricter environmental regulation/standards
- Rising fuel prices affect demand
- Rising input costs (raw material, R&D)
- Supply chain dependency
- Trade policies and import restrictions

Industry Trends

- Centre launched the $1.3 billion PM E-DRIVE extended 2 yrs (Mar 2028) to boost EV adoption (only e-bus/e-trucks/infra got extension)
- EV market expected to grow at CAGR of 10-18.5% between 2022-2030
- Exports 24% YOY to 6.65M units

Understanding Airline Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

USD 16.53 B (2026)
USD 28.96 B (2031)

CAGR

11.86% (2026-31)

Market Share of Major Players

IndiGo ~66.3%
AIR INDIA ~23.8%
Akasa Air ~6.4%

Industry Dynamics

TONE: Low, more investment required
BPOS: High, ltd no., fuel price fluctuations
BPOB: High, Lower switching costs (India overall DGCA safety score jumped to 85.65
TOS: Moderate, other modes of travel
CR: High, lot of competition, price sensitivity is high

KPIs

- Load Factor
- On-time Performance (OTP)
- Available Seat Kilometer (ASK)
- Cost per Available Seat Kilometer (CASK)
- Revenue per Available Seat Kilometer (RASK)

Key Terms

- Aircraft Turnaround Time
- Hub and Spoke Model
- Tarmac Delay
- Code Share
- Global Distribution System (GDS)

Value Chain

Inbound Logistics

- Aircraft Procurement (Buy or Lease or Design)
- Fuel Procurement
- Route Selection
- Yield Management
- Flight & Crew Scheduling
- Facilities Planning

Operations

- Ticket counter & gate operations
- Gate operations
- Aircraft operations
- On-board service
- Ticket operations
- Baggage Handling

Outbound Logistics

- Baggage & cargo handling
- Flight connections
- Airport facilities and services
- Rental car & hotel reservation systems

Marketing & Sales

- E-tickets
- Promotions
- Advertising
- Travel Agent Program
- Group Sales
- Loyalty and Points Programs

After-Sales Service

- Customer Service and Support
- Complaint Resolution
- Lost Baggage Service
- Feedback service
- Real-time problem identification

Revenue Drivers

Passenger Revenue (~70%)
Ancillary Revenue (~15%)
Cargo Revenue (~5%)

Cost Drivers

Fuel Costs (~35-45%) (ATF 26 price)
Labour Costs (~25%)
Maintenance Costs (~15%)
Leasing Costs (~15%)

Growth Drivers

- Rising middle class and higher disposable income
- Low-cost carrier(LCC) boom
- Modified UDAN launched with Rs 28,840 crore outlay
- Infrastructure Development
- Greater FDIs and PPPs
- Better MRO facilities

Sector Composition



Challenges

- High Operating Costs esp. ATF cost
- AI171 crash heightened safety scrutiny
- Infrastructural Constraints
- High Competition; pressure on price
- High Taxation
- Crew shortages
- Fuel Price volatility (acute ATF crisis
- Sustainability & environmental concern

Industry Trends

- Investment in SAF (sustainable aviation fuel) and green airports. (jewar airport)
- Digital transformation; using technology for data-driven decision making.
- Contactless travel with biometric identification, touchless check-in
- By 2030, the MRO industry is likely to grow over US$ 5.7 billion

Understanding Banking Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

Public Assets: $1,680 B
Private Assets - $1264.28B

Loans - ~$2.24T (FY26)
(16.8% growth rate)

Deposits - ~$2.75T (FY26)
(13.4% growth rate)

Mkt. Cap of Major Banks

HDFC BANK	ICICI	SBI
INR 12.45 Tr	INR 9.95 Tr	INR 9.60 Tr

Industry Dynamics

TOS, TONE: High, market dominated by public players, substitutes such as NBFCs, and insurances gaining traction
BPOB, BPOS: Moderate, market dependent, low switching costs
CR: High, lot of competition

KPIs

- Current-Savings Account Ratio (CASA)
- Loan-Deposit Ratio
- Net Interest Income
- Deposit Growth Rate
- Capital Ratio
- Net Interest Margin
- Non-Performing Assets (NPA) Ratio
- Net Promoter Score (NPS)

Key Terms

- CIBIL Score
- Role of RBI / SEBI
- Repo Rate
- Non-Performing Assets
- DBU (Digital Banking Units)
- Capital / Money Market
- Green Banking

Value Chain

Product Development
- Development of products and digital banking services
- Savings accounts, loans, credit cards, investment options

→

Cust Acquisition & Sales
- Advertising/promoting to customer (cold calls, emails for current users)
- Customer acquisition (account opening, documentation)

→

Product Offerings
- Funding products – deposits, securities
- Investing products – credit, securities
- Services – Account/asset management, issuance

→

Processing & Transactions
- Loan application processing, verification, credit application
- Day-to-day transactions (deposits, withdrawals, settlements, trading)

→

Cust Service & Risk Mgmt
- Maintaining customer relationship, dispute resolution, if any
- Evaluation of borrowers' creditworthiness, stability for granting loans

Revenue Drivers

Interest, Loans/Advances (~60-70%)
Charges/commissions (~15-20%)
Investments (~5-10%)

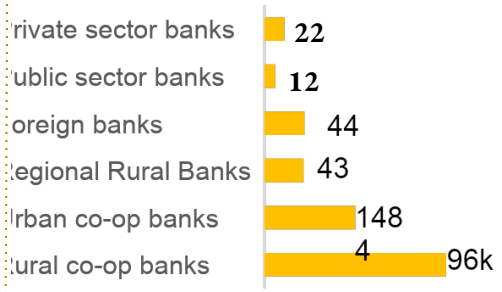
Cost Drivers

Advertising & sales expenses
Labour charges (salaries)
Interest expense & loan recovery

Growth Drivers

- Increasing demand, rising disposable income
- Digital rupee (real but in pilot stage) Digital banking services & tech adoption
- GOI focus is on the industry – schemes such as Jan Dhan Yojana, Digital Rupee
- Focus on (Chatbots)

Number of Banks



Challenges

- Intensifying deposit competition (bank racing to fund 16%+ credit growth
- NBFC linked credit growth drag
- Cybersecurity and data privacy
- Margin compression from repo rate cutting
- Macroeconomic volatility – the economy keeps changing hence affecting lending/borrowing rates

Industry Trends

- Neo-banking: FinTech industry - world's 3rd largest (USD 150B by 2025)
- National financial info registry, streamlining of KYC, central bank digital currency (Digital Rupee)
- UPI hit 23.2 billion transaction worth $313 B in May26 up 26% YOY and now carries 49% of global real time payment value

Understanding Cement Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

~470 M ton (2026)
~640 M ton (2031)

CAGR

~6.3% (2026-31)

Market Share of Major Players

ADITYA BIRLA UltraTech ~28 %

adani Cement ~16 %

Shree Cement ~10%

Industry Dynamics

TONE: Low, capital intensive, raw material access low
BPOS: Moderate, access to quarries, govt control
BPOB: Low, bulk purchase & shortages
TOS: Low, No similar product to cement
CR: High, Large scale players, switching cost less

KPIs

- Lime saturation factor
- Silica modulus
- Alumina modulus
- Clinker factor
- Cement factor
- Heat Value

Key Terms

- Raw Materials: Clay, Limestone, sand & aggregates
- Utilization areas: Factor of safety, Ordinary Portland cement (OPC), Portland pozzolana cement (PPC)

Value Chain

Raw Material Sourcing

- Long-term contracts and leases of quarries
- Mining operations (Coal, gypsum, flyash), sand and clay from sea shores
- Crushing and processing

Clinker Production

- Powdered raw material heated in a kiln to produce clinker
- Further ground with gypsum or other additives to produce cement

Manufacturing & Packaging

- Different types of cement is manufactured based on additives
- Process can be automated to achieve economies of scale

Outbound Logistics

- Warehouse network with moisture-proof space
- Dealing with bulk orders
- Mix of rail, road freight
- T retailers, distributors, construction cos.

Sales and Marketing

- Incentives based relationships with contractors
- Dealer-Distributor networks
- Economies of scale

Revenue Drivers

Sale of cement (~80-90%)
Interest income (~10%)

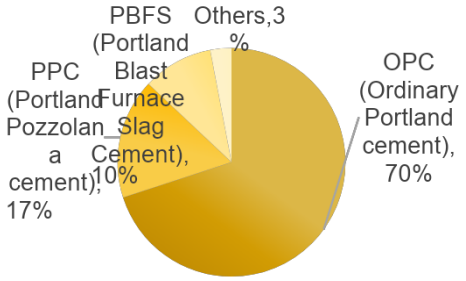
Cost Drivers

Logistics & storage (~30%)
Fuel & transport (~25%)
Raw materials (~20%)
Misc Expenses (~20%)

Growth Drivers

- High quality/quantity of limestone deposits
- Urbanization
- Pvt Infrastructure projects
- Government spending on nation-wide infra
- National Infrastructure Pipeline (NIP) expansion

Sector Composition



Challenges

- Rising input costs (petcoke +19% MOM April'26, diesel +3.9/lt (May'26)
- ICRA has cut its FY27 OPBIDTA/ton estimate by 10-15% to Rs 820-870/MT (from 950-980/MT in 2026)
- The global demand for cement is sluggish due to geopolitical dynamics arising out of Russia-Ukraine war

Industry Trends

- Adani Ambuja ACC merger Jan 26
- FDI inflows (cement and gypsum) - $7.91B in Apr 2000-Sep '24.
- PE/VC investments in real estate and infrastructure - growth of 27%
- Remote working; houses with ticket sizes below Rs. 40-50 lakh saw a boom
- 2nd largest producer contributes 8% globally

Understanding Defense Manuf. Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

USD 18.32B (2025)

CAGR

~5.66% (2026-34)

Market Cap. of Major Players

Public Companies

HAL — INR 3.36 Tr

Bharat Electronics — INR 2.98 Tr

Private Company

TATA Advanced Systems

Industry Dynamics

TONE: Low, due to regulations, capital
BPOS: Moderate, ltd options; adv tech area
BPOB: Low, limited alternatives
TOS: Low as limited options available
CR: Low as few players in market

KPIs

- Defence Budget Allocation
- Defence Expenditure (as % of GDP)
- Defence R&D Spending
- Operational Readiness
- Defence Export & Imports
- Global Power Index (Firepower Score)

Key Terms

- Positive Indigenisation List
- Innovations for Defense Excellence (iDEX)
- Defense Public Sector Undertakings (DPSUs)
- Ordnance Factories Board(OFB)
- DRDO

Value Chain

Research & Design

- Based on RFP, conceptual design, sub-assembly, new tech
- Research & collaboration between labs, institutions
- Testing & validation

Manufacturing & Assembly

- Production of components (software, electronic, mechanical)
- Assembly of components to finished product under the safety standards

Logistics/Transportation

- Sourcing of raw materials, components, and sub-systems
- Partnerships with domestic/international suppliers & vendors

Testing & Sales

- Performance & stress testing to ensure functionality and safety
- Exporting, cross-country opportunities, training given for deployment

After-Sales/Decommission

- Technical support, maintenance, repair, spare parts, upgrades
- Disassembly, recycling, and scrapping of equipment after life cycle

Revenue Drivers

Supply to Indian forces (~60-70%)
Exports (~15-25%)
R&D & Tech Transfer (~10-20%)

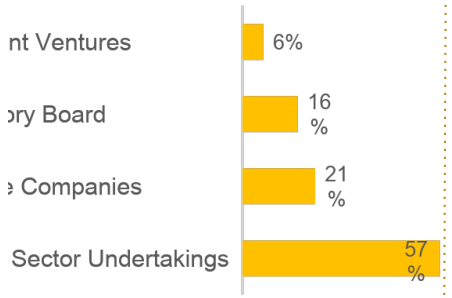
Cost Drivers

Production/Manuf (~40-50%)
Skilled Labor (~20-30%)
R&D (~15-25%)

Growth Drivers

- Growth of Indian defence exports (200%: last 4 years)
- FDI encouragement (74% allowance given for automatic route, 100% for govt route)
- Indigenisation of manufacturing (Aatmanirbhar Bharat)
- More investment in R&D
- Geo-political tension

Sector Composition



Challenges

- Long gestation periods for contracts, lack of continuity in orders
- Red tape: Bureaucratic obstacles
- Lack of technology transfer
- High cost of capital for investments in advanced manufacturing
- Lack of skilled workforce
- Improvements required in infrastructure

Industry Trends

- Defense exports: Rs. 5,900 crore contract to export BrahMos & Astra to Indonesia (2026)
- Budget 2026-27: 14.67% ($86B) allocated
- SRIJAN portal: Online portal; access to vendors to take up items for indigenization
- Defense corridors - UP & Tamil Nadu
- 1000+ defence start-ups (2026)
- Exports tripled in 4 years, and reached ₹38k Cr in 2025-26

Understanding E-Commerce Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

USD 159 B (2026)
USD 333 B (2031)

CAGR

15%(2026-33)

Market Share of Major Players

amazon.in 35%

Flipkart 45%

Industry Dynamics

TONE: Low, ease of setting up ops
BPOS: High, dependent on supplies
BPOB: High, low switching costs
TOS: High, easier and cheaper alternatives available
CR: High, intense price wars, promotion campaigns

KPIs

- Conversion Rate
- Customer Churn Rate
- Inventory Turnover Rate
- Customer Lifetime value
- Average Order Value
- Click-through Rate
- Traffic Monitoring
- Bounce Rate

Key Terms

- Omni-channel
- Hyperlocal
- B2B, B2C, D2C,m-commerce
- Search Engine Optimization
- Drop-shipping
- Cross-selling/Up-selling

Value Chain

Product Sourcing/Design

- E-commerce companies design and develop their own products or source from private label brands
- Manufacturing
- Warehousing

Operations

- Packaging
- Inventory management / demand forecasting
- Order management
- Website/app development to place orders

Outbound Logistics

- Payment processing
- Establishing partnerships with delivery companies
- Shipping and fulfillment activities
- Last mile delivery

Marketing & Sales

- Multi-channel marketing
- Promotional activities
- SEO, online advertising
- Incurring customer acquisition costs
- Content creation

After-Sales Service

- Processing customer feedback, returns and exchanges
- Analyzing data on customer preferences
- Quick support services

Revenue Drivers

Subscription/Membership models
Delivery charges

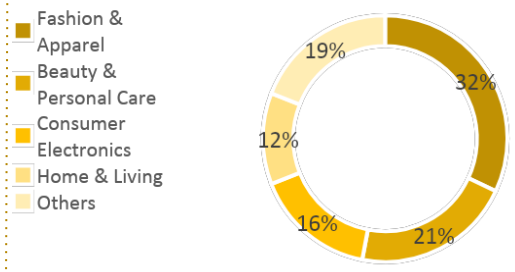
Cost Drivers

Logistics & storage
Reverse Logistics (free returns)
Customer acquisition & marketing
Platform maintenance costs

Growth Drivers

- Increase of digital payments/online transactions
- Growing Indian Beauty and Personal Care
- Emerging technologies (AR/VR/Voice search) for customer experience
- Consumer Behaviour Shifts

Sector Composition



Challenges

- Supply chain disruptions
- In Tier-2/3 cities, there is still dependency on cash payments
- Cybersecurity and data breaches
- Counterfeiting
- Last mile delivery issues
- Increased competition
- Lack of trust

Industry Trends

- Achieved a GMV of approximately Rs. 7.60 lakh crore
- Government initiatives like the National Logistics Policy, ONDC and Digital India
- Subscription-based models, longer customer relationships amidst increasing competition and diversity of choice
- 100% FDI allowed for B2B e-commerce

Understanding Ed-Tech Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

$10.4B (FY26)
$19B (FY30)

CAGR

~16% (2026-30)

Market Cap. of Major Players

- PW: **$4.19 B**
- ERUDITUS Executive Education: **$3.1 B (2024)**
- upGrad: **$1.73 B**

Industry Dynamics

TONE: High, low capital requirement and no strict regulations
BPOS: High, less good quality trainers
BPOB: High, large number of options
TOS: Moderate, physical coaching
CR: High, a lot of new players

KPIs

- Customer Acquisition Payback Period (CAP)
- New Demo Booking Rate
- Customer Lifetime value
- Course Completion rate
- Time-on-app

Key Terms

- MOOC (Massive Open Online Course)
- Adaptive/Synchronous Learning
- Flipped classroom
- Gamification
- Module-based/ marketplace

Value Chain

R&D

- New educational methodologies
- Identifying gaps in existing solutions
- Designing pedagogy

Software/Hardware Dev

- Learning Management Systems (LMS)
- Tablets optimized for learning
- Software platforms

System Integrators

- Bringing together content delivery, and communication tools
- User-friendly and efficient experience

Network Infrastructure

- Seamless access to content through servers, cloud services, and data centres
- Reliable, uninterrupted & fast access to resources

Trainees & Trainers

- Learners or students use the platforms to acquire knowledge and skills.
- Educators, teachers, & facilitators deliver content, assess progress

Revenue Drivers

Paid course subscriptions (50%)
Test preparation (~25%)
Corporate and B2B (~15%)

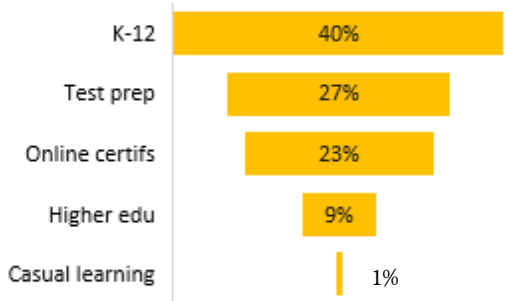
Cost Drivers

Content creation (~25%)
Talent & HR (~20%)
Customer acquisition (~20%)

Growth Drivers

- Penetration of Smart devices
- Young Employable Population
- Government's Digital Initiative such as SWAYAM
- Income inelasticity(0.93) implies inclination to spend on Ed
- Price advantage, enhanced experience

Sector Composition



Challenges

- Evolving regulations and policies
- Technological Obsolescence of EdTech solutions
- Economic downturns or changes in consumer spending habits
- Keeping users engaged in online learning environments difficult
- Digital divide is prevalent

Industry Trends

- Edtech players are merging and partnering to achieve scale and efficiency
- Edtech start-ups received a funding of $204M (Jan – July 2026)
- Use of AR and gamification to make learning interactive
- Budget FY26: US$ 57.57 million) for a Centre of Excellence in AI for Education

Understanding EV Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

USD 54.4 B (2025)
USD 110.7 B (2029)

CAGR

19.44% (2025-29)

Market Share of Major Players

TATA MOTORS ~ 39%
MG ~26%
Mahindra ~ 21%
(Passenger Vehicles)

Industry Dynamics

TONE: High, R&D, manuf & setup costs
BPOS: High, dependent on batteries
BPOB: Moderate, growing interest
TOS: Low, ICE vehicles only alternatives which are not env friendly
CR: High, Competition increasing

KPIs

- Total Cost of Ownership (TCO)
- Range per charge
- Charging sessions between failure
- Charging Speed
- Carbon Emissions Reduction
- Battery Recycling Rate

Key Terms

- Battery Swapping
- Battery as a service (BaaS)
- Charging Infrastructure: (L1, L2, L3)
- Plug-in Hybrid Electric Vehicle (PHEV)

Value Chain

R&D & Raw Material

- Batteries, advanced materials, better techniques, design.
- Raw material extraction - lithium, cobalt, nickel, aluminum, steel

Components, Vehicle Assembly

- Lithium-ion batteries, electric motors, power control systems are manufactured
- Assembly plants – integrating all components

Distribution & Logistics

- Component logistics
- Warehousing and distribution through dealerships, distribution centers, D2C for vehicles
- Payment processing

Marketing & After-Sales

- Advertising, pricing strategies and promotional activities
- Repairs, replacements, sustainable battery recycling & disposal

Charging Infrastructure

- Manufacturing & installation of charging stations
- Distribution and manufacturing of batteries

Revenue Drivers

EV Sales (~60-70%)
Govt incentives (20-30%)
Charging infrastructure (~10-20%)

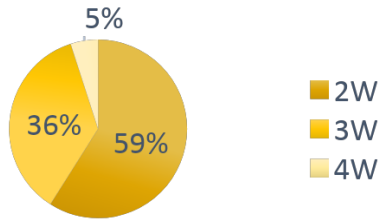
Cost Drivers

Battery cost
Raw material sourcing
Research and development

Growth Drivers

- Environmental Awareness
- Government Incentives
- Lower Operating Costs
- Advancing Battery Technology
- Energy Security
- Corporate Sustainability Initiatives

Sector Composition



Challenges

- High Initial Cost
- Charging Infrastructure still scaling
- Reliance on imported lithium, cobalt, and nickel
- Limited driving range
- Limited Model Options
- No Universal charger

Industry Trends

- 29,151 public EV charging stations installed by Feb 2026
- PLI schemes for manufacturing of components/EVs
- Global EV30@30 campaign; at least 30% new vehicle sales to be electric by 2030.
- Recent discovery; lithium iron phosphate battery (world's first 4C superfast charging)

Understanding FMCG Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

USD 289.1 Bn (2025)
USD 642.9 Bn (2030)

CAGR

16.64% (2025-30)

Market Cap. of Major Players

Hindustan Unilever Limited	ITC Limited	Nestlé
55 Bn USD	40 Bn USD	30 Bn USD

Industry Dynamics

TONE: Low, difficult to set operations
BPOS: Low, small & fragmented suppliers
BPOB: High, Q-commerce platforms hold the leverage
TOS: High, several alternatives available, rising D2C and private-label alternatives
CR: High, intense competition

KPIs

- Sales growth
- Market Share
- Customer Acquisition Cost
- Inventory turnover rate
- Customer retention rate
- SKU rationalization

Key Terms

- Point of Sale (POS)
- Economic Order Quantity (EOQ)
- In-store activation
- Merchandising
- Planogram
- Quick Commerce and Dark Stores

Value Chain

Research & Development

- Research to come up with new products/ new category
- Develop existing products/category

Procurement

- Sourcing of raw materials
- Quality testing
- Storage of raw materials

Manufacturing

- Production
- Quality control & testing
- Packaging & storage

Distribution

- FMCG Distribution Centers (Regional DC) -> Retail DC -> Retail Shop
- Invoicing
- Inventory Management

Marketing & Sales

- Branding and advertising
- Merchandising
- Order Fulfillment
- Consumer purchase
- Post purchase services

Revenue Drivers

Product & Pricing (~35%)
Branding & advertising (~30%)
Distribution (~20%)

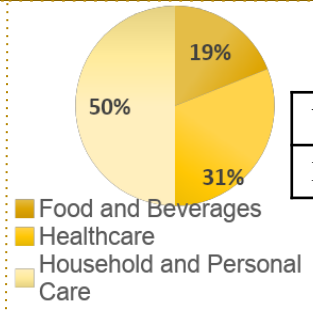
Cost Drivers

Raw material costs (~40-50%)
Distribution & logistics costs(~25%)
Marketing expense(~20-30%)

Growth Drivers

- Increased rural consumption
- quick-commerce expansion (70–80% CAGR)
- Direct Sale to customers
- Product innovation
- Govt initiatives like PLI, SETU scheme
- Increase in pet ownership

Sector Composition



Urban	65%
Rural	35%

Challenges

- Fierce competition
- Rising raw material costs
- Limited storage space; more products
- Supply chain disruptions
- Seasonality and demand variability
- Product shelf life and fragility
- Regulatory compliance and quality control

Industry Trends

- E-commerce and digital engagement to connect with customers directly
- Personalization & customization
- Sustainable and eco-friendly products
- Consumer preference towards healthier and natural products
- Quick commerce & dark-store-led distribution

Understanding Food Delivery Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

USD 43.47 Bn (2024)
USD 265 Bn (2033)

CAGR

22.25 %(2025-33)

Market Cap. of Major Players

zomato — **USD 31.8 Bn**

SWIGGY — **USD 7.4 Bn**

Industry Dynamics

TONE: High, ease of setting up ops
BPOS: High, dependent on restaurants
BPOB: High, buyers seek value for money
TOS: High, alternatives such as home-cooking, dining out always available
CR: High, intensely competitive

KPIs

- Average order time (AOT)
- Average delivery time (ADT)
- % On-time Delivery
- Customer retention rate
- Customer Satisfaction Rate
- Delivery Person Idle time

Key Terms

- Food Aggregators
- Cloud Kitchens
- Contactless Delivery
- Hyperlocal Delivery
- Subscription/Marketplace Models
- Dark Stores

Value Chain

Onboarding Partners

- Restaurants and brands are onboarded onto the delivery application
- The menus are listed on the apps along with combo plans and delas

Placing Orders

- Customers place orders through the delivery platform's website or app, selecting dishes and specifying delivery preferences.

Delivery

- Restaurants can deliver the food via their own delivery network
- Outsourcing it to the food delivery app
- Remote delivery (drones)

Marketing & Sales

- Ordering Platform, Delivery arrangements, Payment, CRM mgmt.
- Promotion campaigns delivery apps, bundling, cross-selling

Other Services & Feedback

- Additional Services to improve performance, Complaints & Queries,
- Customer ratings
- Grocery services, add-on courier services

Revenue Drivers

Commissions from restaurants (~80%)
Ads on delivery apps (~5-10%)
Delivery Fee charged (~10-15%)
Paid subscriptions/ loyalty prg. (~5%)

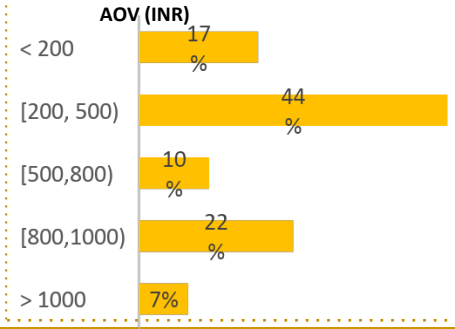
Cost Drivers

Vehicle/delivery cost
Packaging cost
R&D for delivery platform

Growth Drivers

- Disposable income
- Rising trend of ready-to-eat (RTE) / quick home delivery
- Nuclear families
- Internet/ Smartphone penetration
- Expansion to Tier 3/4

Sector Composition



Challenges

- Gig-worker regulation/compliance cost
- Quality Control and Food Safety maintenance
- High competition
- Delivery platforms depend on restaurant partners
- Managing online payments, handling issues related to payment gateways
- Category diversification costs

Industry Trends

- 43% of orders are clocking via D2C
- Indoor habits - restaurants consider adopting cloud kitchens
- Grocery delivery - reaching 2/3 of all food deliveries (2030)
- Healthy choices & personalized menus – driving nutrition
- ONDC: GOI's own app

Understanding Healthcare Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

USD 110B (2023)
USD 193.6B (2032)
Hospital Services market size

CAGR

8%(2023-32)

Market Cap. of Major Players

Private Hospitals

MAX Healthcare	Apollo Hospitals	Fortis
USD 11B	USD 10.6B	USD 6.7B

Industry Dynamics

TONE: Moderate, more capital required
BPOS: High, dependent on supplies
BPOB: High, consumers are hugely dependent on quality care
TOS: Low, limited temporary options
CR: Pvt centres are increasing

KPIs

- Average Length of Stay
- Bed Occupancy Rate
- Patient Room/Bed Turnover Rate
- Staff-to-Patient Ratio
- Treatment Error Rate

Key Terms

- PPP Model in healthcare
- PHC, OPD, Hospice
- NCD (Non-communicable diseases)
- Government initiatives (PMSSY, AB-PMJAY)

Value Chain

Consultation

- Primary care physicians or hospitals as per accessibility
- Ambulatory services / TRIAGE for emergency/disaster care

Diagnosis & Testing

- Diagnosis based on medical history, genetic testing, pathological testing, medical screening/imaging.
- Further testing

Admission

- Ward allocated (General, OPD, Emergency)
- Homecare or hospice are options on the basis of severity of diagnosis

Treatment

- Medicines, equipment, doctors, nurses, medicines, procedure required
- 24x7 check on vitals and information sharing

Post-Treatment

- Payment, insurance, follow-ups, medicine dosage cycle, full-time, part-time care, rehabilitation
- Palliative care – terminally ill

Revenue Drivers

Healthcare services
Pharma industry
Diagnostic services

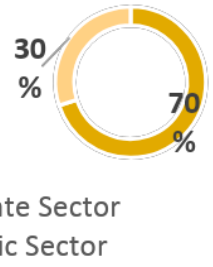
Cost Drivers

Infrastructure & equipment
Workforce salaries
Operational costs

Growth Drivers

- Growing demand fueled by increased life expectancy and population
- Medical Value Travel (MVT) or medical tourism
- GOI's increase in public health expenditure
- Telemedicine

Sector Composition



Challenges

- Demand-supply gap: Lack of infrastructure/access in rural areas, ratio of beds to population (1.3/1000), ratio of physicians to people (0.65/1000)
- Public health preparedness
- Lack of data integration: All patient records not uniformly digitized

Industry Trends

- Consumer wearables, devices (for 24x7 health monitoring)
- AI/ML; patient scheduling and processing
- Telemedicine/Remote health
- Investments in HealthTech startups
- Medical Value Travel (India ranks 7th globally)

Understanding Hospitality Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

USD 32.1B (2024)
USD 59.44B (by 2030)

CAGR

20% (2024-30)

Market Share of Major Players

IHCL ~ 12%
EIH Limited (A MEMBER OF THE OBEROI GROUP) ~8.9%
CHALET HOTELS ~6.7%

Industry Dynamics

TONE: High, more capex required
BPOS: Bulk purchases of supplies
BPOB, TOS: Variety of options
CR: High competition

KPIs

- Occupancy Rate
- Average Daily Rate (ADR)
- Revenue Per Available Room (RevPAR)
- Customer Satisfaction Score(CSAT)

Key Terms

- Global Distribution System(GDS)
- Turn Down Service
- Valet Parking
- Zoning Laws
- MICE

Value Chain

Inbound Logistics

- Contracts with suppliers
- Procurement of food, beverages & other supplies
- Storage and distribution in hotel's departments
- Inventory management

Operations

- Staff Training
- Reservations
- Housekeeping services
- Food & beverage services
- Entertainment & recreational services
- Other additional services

Outbound Logistics

- Distribution of goods to different hotel outlets
- Providing goods and services to the guests
- Fulfillment of on-demand services
- Transportation services

Sales & Marketing

- Advertising & Promotions
- Digital Marketing
- Partnerships & collaborations
- Loyalty Programs for regular customers
- Customer Feedback

Distribution

- Online booking platforms (~30-40%)
- Own Website (~20-30%)
- Direct bookings (Offline) (~20-30%)
- Other Channels

Revenue Drivers

Room Tariff (~60%)
Food & Beverages (~25%)
Events & conferences (~10%)

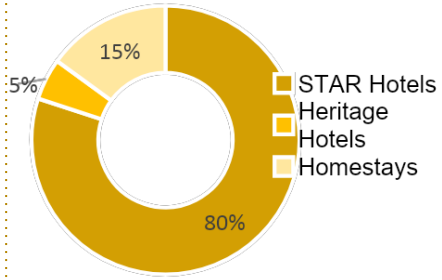
Cost Drivers

Labour Cost (~40%)
F&B Cost(~30%)
Maintenance Cost (~10%)

Growth Drivers

- Rising disposable incomes
- Rise of online booking platforms
- Govt initiatives like e-Visa, UDAN, HRIDAY, Project Mausam
- Higher investments
- Rise in experiential travel

Sector Composition



Challenges

- Hiring & retention of quality staff
- Technological adaptation
- Changing consumer preferences
- Environmental considerations; reducing carbon footprint
- Meeting demand due to increase in travel and tourism

Industry Trends

- The staycation trend is likely to be on a rise
  The wellness industry is booming
- Personalized guest experience using data and technology
- The use of AR/VR to provide immersive experiences
- Focus on sustainability by using eco-friendly products

Understanding IT Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

$254B (by 2024)
$421.5B (by 2029)

CAGR

9.2% (2024-30)

Market Cap. of Major Players

TCS	Infosys	HCLTech	Wipro
$141B	$76B	$53B	$32B

Industry Dynamics

TONE: High, low setup cost
BPOS: Low, less differentiation & fragmented
BPOB: Low, minimal switching costs
TOS: High, rapid innovations possible
CR: High, competing projects & clients

KPIs

- On-time Delivery
- Server downtime
- Number of critical bugs
- SLA Compliance
- Project Backlog
- Quality Audit Results

Key Terms

- Agile methodology
- Digital Transformation
- Application Programming Interface (APIs)
- Software-as-a-service
- Wireframe, ERP, CRM

Value Chain

Strategy to Portfolio

- The technology projects and initiatives to pursue based on the organization's goals
- Create a portfolio of projects
- Strategic planning, project prioritization, budget allocation & resource allocation

Requirement to Display

- Build what the business needs, when it needs
- Documenting functional and technical specifications
- Requirement analysis, design, prototyping, and user experience (UX) design

Request to fulfill

- Implementation of the technology solution
- Catalog, fulfil & manage services usage
- Software development, system integration, testing, and deployment activities

Detect to Correct

- Anticipate & resolve production issues
- Ongoing monitoring, maintenance
- Troubleshooting, debugging, updates, patches, and user support

Revenue Drivers

App Dev & maintenance (40%)
IT Services & Consulting (30%)
System integration (~10%-20%)

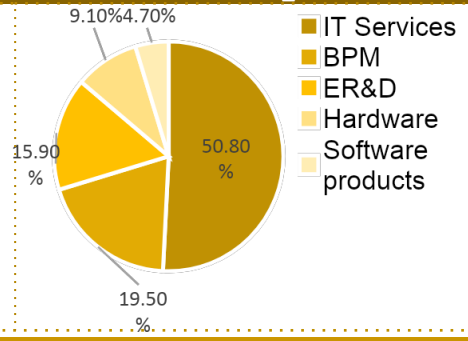
Cost Drivers

Employee costs (~55%)
Infrastructure costs (~10%-15%)
Training & Development (10%)

Growth Drivers

- Easy availability of technically skilled manpower
- Supportive government policies (PLI), SEZs
- Expansion of Global Capability Centers (GCCs)
- Increasing strategic alliance between domestic and international players

Sector Composition



Challenges

- Upskilling the workforce continuously
- Handling sensitive data for international clients, such as for EU
- Clients are increasingly seeking holistic solutions rather than discrete services
- Dependence on a few markets

Industry Trends

- India placed at 61st rank as per Network Readiness Index 2022
- Services around SMAC (Social, Mobile, Analytics, Cloud), IT consulting are fast-growing
- Immersive virtual experiences are becoming valuable enterprise tools for new business models, training, and collaboration

Understanding Logistics Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

USD 317B (2024)
USD 484B (2029)

CAGR

~8.8% (2024-29)

Market Share of Major Players

कॉनकॉर CONCOR	BLUE DART	GATEWAY DISTRIPARKS	AEGIS
USD 5.6B	USD 2B	USD 0.4B	USD 3.2B
~40%	~20%	~10%	~11%

Industry Dynamics

TONE: Moderate, ease of setting up ops
BPOS: High, require transport services
BPOB: Low, fragmented customer base
TOS: Low, in-house logistics lacks efficiency and scale required
CR: High, intense competition

KPIs

- Lead Time
- Turnover Time
- Warehousing Costs
- Inventory Turnover
- Fill Rate
- Backorder Rate
- Delivery Time
- Order Accuracy
- Shipping Time

Key Terms

- Cabotage
- Freight Forwarding
- 3PL Adoption
- Cross-Docking
- Hub & Spoke Model
- Demurrage

Value Chain

Client Requirements

- Understanding the client's requirements and timelines
- Goods are received at distribution centers or picked up from client

Planning & Packaging

- Efficient routes are mapped out and costs are optimized according to client's needs
- Packaging and labeling is done to prevent damage

Warehousing & Storage

- Goods are placed in warehouses to be picked up for last mile delivery
- Package locations in warehouses are optimized according to routes

Outbound Logistics

- Goods are transported via transportation modes such as road, rail, water, air
- Sourcing transportation partners, documentation

Last Mile Delivery

- Delivery to customer's location, real-time updates, notifications
- Customer feedback and complaint management
- Value-added services

Revenue Drivers

E-commerce/Last-mile (~30-40%)
Domestic sector support (~25-35%)
Trade within the country (~20-30%)

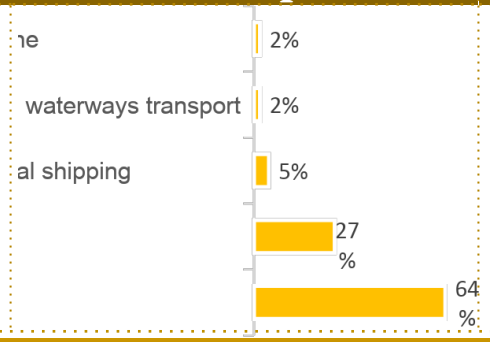
Cost Drivers

Transportation costs (~40-50%)
Workforce costs (~20-30%)
Inventory costs (~15-25%)

Growth Drivers

- E-commerce expansion
- Technology advancement (GPS Tracking, analytics, AI/ML)
- New B2B logistics businesses growing in the industry
- Manufacturing focus in India has increased demand for better warehouses/logistics

Sector Composition



Challenges

- Fragmented sector due to multiple intermediaries
- High costs related to transportation (fuel, toll charges)
- Last-mile challenges due to traffic, congestion
- Lack of connectivity between modes
- No standardization in process

Industry Trends

- Gati Shakti Yojana – multi-modal connectivity, boosts last-mile
- Parivahan portal – Sarathi (licenses), Vahan (vehicle registrations)
- Usage of Blockchain, IoT, AI/ML & green logistics
- GST, Warehousing Act 2007, investments in logistics parks and free trade warehousing zones (FTWZs)

Understanding Media & Entertainment Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

USD 30 Bn (2024)
USD 48 Bn (2030)

CAGR

9% (2024-30)

Market Cap. of Major Players

Television

- Jio Star: 31%
- SONY TEN: 9%
- ZEE: 13%
- SUN TV NETWORK: 9%

SVOD

- JioHotstar: ~19%
- Netflix: ~22%
- prime video: ~23%

Print

- Dainik Bhaskar GROUP: USD 1 B
- HT Media: USD700M

Industry Dynamics

TONE: Low; high costs, big estd. players
BPOS: High for unique content producers
BPOB: High, low switching costs, abundant free/ad-supported options
TOS: High; content piracy & other channels
CR: High; lot of competition, low fixed costs, high price sensitivity

KPIs

- Viewership ratings
- Monthly Active Users (MAU)
- Monthly recurring revenue
- ARPU
- Subscription-vs-ad revenue mix
- Watch time
- Video completion rate

Key Terms

- Broadcast
- TRP/Ratings
- Prime Time
- AVOD/SVOD/FAST
- Storyboard
- Connected TV (CTV)
- In-app Purchases (IAPs)

Value Chain

Procurement

- Due Diligence
- Content Acquisition
- Licensing of copy righted material
- Content cataloging & tracking

Production

- Content creation
- Aggregation of content
- Product/ad. Placement

Product Packaging

- Editorial work
- Format conversion (for different devices)
- Dubbing/subtitling
- Packaging Design
- Promotional materials

Technical Production

- Infrastructure
- Print (IMAX, different reel mechanisms)
- Encoding
- CDNs, adtech, CTV delivery

Distribution

- Channel Selection & platform integration
- Content Delivery Networks (CDNs)
- Rights management
- Sale

Revenue Drivers

Advertisements
Subscription & content sales
Content licensing & distribution

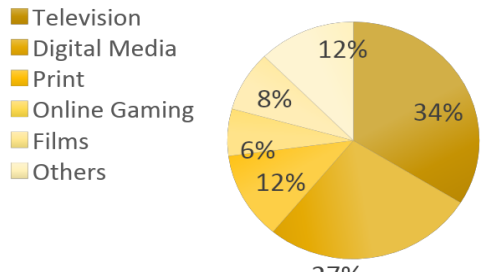
Cost Drivers

Content acquisition
Content creation
Production costs (operating costs)

Growth Drivers

- Digital transformation with increasing internet penetration
- Rise of OTT & regional content
- Live events, gaming, animation
- AI in production
- Increasing buying power
- Govt. initiatives like National Broadband mission, FFO

Sector Composition



Challenges

- Content Piracy and copyright issues
- Real-money gaming ban
- Pay-TV cord-cutting
- Regulation & compliance (uplinking rules, DPDP Act data privacy)
- Monetizing free/ad-supported content

Industry Trends

- JioStar dominance post Reliance–Disney merger
- Digital overtook TV
- Connected TV (CTV) boom
- AI/GenAI in content; regional/vernacular surge
- Live events booming (+44% in 2025); AVOD/FAST channels rising

Understanding NBFC Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

Bank Funding AUM– Rs. 50 L Cr (FY25)

CAGR

15-18% (FY25-28)

Market Cap. of Major Players

- Bajaj Finserv: Rs. 6.8L Cr
- Shriram Finance: Rs. 2.6L Cr
- Chola (Enter a better life): Rs. 1.6 L Cr
- Muthoot Finance: Rs. 1.5L Cr

Industry Dynamics

TONE: Moderate, highly regulations
BPOS: High, reliant on banks/markets
BPOB: Moderate, abundant options
TOS: Low, banks & money Lenders
CR: High, multiple NBFCs in India

KPIs

- Net Interest Margin (NIM)
- Return on Equity (ROE), RoA
- GNPA/NNPA
- Cost of Funds
- Capital Adequacy Ratio (CAR)
- Asset under Management (AUM)

Key Terms

- Asset Liability Management
- Capital Adequacy ratio
- Credit Risk
- Liquidity Risk
- Non-Performing Asset
- Risk Management

Value Chain

Marketing & Sales

- Multi-channel marketing: online advertising, social media, and direct mail
- Digital onboarding
- Product-specific targeting
- Evaluating client needs

Underwriting/Risk Assessment

- Credit scoring via bureau data + AI/ML
- Account Aggregator framework
- Loan is underwritten; set rate, tenor, amount

Fund Procurement/Mgmt

- Underwriting completed, funds are raised via bonds, bank loans, ECBs, co-lending & securitization
- manage assets; collecting payments, investment portfolios, ALM

Disbursement/Collection

- Verification, Signing Documents, Funding, Disbursement based on type
- Collection of interest payments, repayments

Compliance

- Report to regulatory authorities such as RBI
- Engage in securitization; pooling loans, converting to tradable securities for fund raising

Revenue Drivers

Interest Income (~60-70%)
Commission Income (~10-15%)
Investment Income (~5-10%)

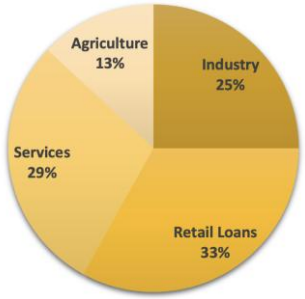
Cost Drivers

Cost of funds/operations
Digital infrastructure
credit costs/provisioning

Growth Drivers

- Retail credit penetration in Tier 2/3 & rural
- Secured lending after unsecured tightening
- Co-lending with banks
- Digital public infra
- AI-led underwriting
- GST rationalisation
- PMJDY, Mudra

Sector Composition



Credit given to sectors (FY24)

Challenges

- Compliance regulations; 621 compliances, 35 one-time approvals required for NBFC in a state
- Refinancing; not favourable as major sources are banks, cap. markets
- Tax deductions not permitted for non-performing assets (NPAs)
- Credit risk; lack of info on defaulters
- Asset-quality stress (unsecured, MFI)

Industry Trends

- Risk-weight rollback reviving credit
- Co-lending 2.0 with banks/fintechs
- Unified RBI rules (gold, digital lending)
- Shift to secured lending
- AI underwriting + Account Aggregator
- Platforms like IRDAI's "Bima Sugam" are simplifying policy purchase and comparison

Understanding Oil & Gas Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

40.1 BCM (2024)
51.7 BCM (by 2030)

CAGR

5.2% (2024-29)

Market Cap. of Major Players

- Reliance Industries Limited: INR 17.5L Cr
- ONGC: INR 3.31L Cr
- IndianOil: INR 2L Cr

Industry Dynamics

TONE: Low, capex-heavy, licensing
BPOS: High, import-dependent (OPEC+/Russia)
BPOB: Low, inelastic, essential demand
TOS: Moderate, alt. EVs, renewables, biofuels
CR: High, intense competition, govt

KPIs

- Lease Operating Expenses
- Reserve Replacement Ratio
- Barrels of Oil Equivalent (BOE)
- Natural Gas Coefficient (CFE)
- Capital Project efficiency
- E&P output
- Gross Refining Margin (GRM)

Key Terms

- OPEC+
- Futures Contract
- Catalytic Cracking
- Distillation & Fractionation
- GOSP (Gas Oil Separation Plant)
- City Gas Distribution (CGD)
- LNG

Value Chain

Exploration

- Surveys to gauge potential
- Identification of appropriate site
- Field Development Planning

Production

- Sanctioning of the project
- Infrastructure creation
- Strike Oil
- Extract and split oil, water and gas
- EOR at mature fields

Transportation

- Crude is transported by tankers, pipelines, trucks and rail roads
- Natural Gas is shifted by pipelines and LPG tankers, LNG

Storage

- Ground tanks is used for crude and finished oil products
- Underground spaces (reservoirs) is used for natural gas
- Strategic reserves

Refining & Marketing

- Transform crude into petroleum products
- 3 Stages: separation, conversion and treatment
- Marketed via B2C and B2B channels

Revenue Drivers

Refined-product (diesel + petrol)
Crude & Natural Gas
Petrochemicals

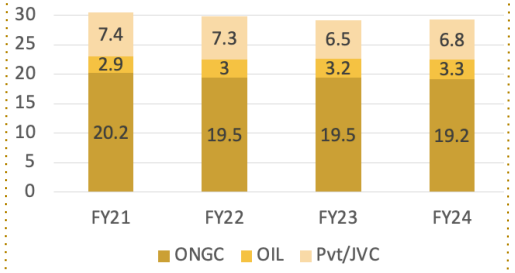
Cost Drivers

Crude feedstock
Transportation
Refining & opex

Growth Drivers

- Rising energy demand
- Refinery-petrochemical integration
- City Gas Distribution expansion
- gas-share target 15% by 2030
- Ethanol blending
- SPR expansion

Sector Composition



Challenges

- High import dependence (~88%); price & FX exposure
- Declining domestic output at ageing fields
- Energy transition - EVs, renewables, biofuels eroding demand
- Geopolitics - OPEC+, Russia sanctions, US tariff pressure on Russian crude
- Climate/net-zero policy & decarbonization capex

Industry Trends

- Oilfields (Amendment) Act 2025
- Heavy reliance on discounted Russian crude (~34-36% of imports)
- Ethanol blending
- National Green Hydrogen Mission + PSU net-zero roadmaps
- SPR expansion
- 100% FDI (auto route) in upstream & private refining; 49% for PSU refiners

Understanding Pharmaceutical Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

USD 130 Bn (2030)
USD 450 Bn (2047)

CAGR

21% (2026-30)

Revenues of Major Players

SUN PHARMA	Dr.Reddy's	Cipla
$6.38B	$3.58B	$3B

Industry Dynamics

TONE: Low, lot of regulations, R&D costs for innovative drugs
BPOS: High, reliance on suppliers
BPOB: Oligopsony, price control
TOS: Moderate, Ayurveda, Homeopathy
CR: High, int'l and domestic players

KPIs

- R&D Expense Ratio
- Time-to-market
- Clinical trial performance
- No. of New Drugs Developed
- Patent Application & Approval

Key Terms

- Active Pharmaceutical Ingredient (APIs)
- Biologics & Biosimilars
- Over the counter (OTC)
- Good Manufacturing Practices (GMP)
- Pharmacokinetics

Value Chain

R&D

- Exploration, research and study (GOI, Academic Institutes, Pvt labs)
- Disease biology, genetic disposition, formula
- Similar disease pathways

Testing & Approval

- Pre-clinical testing, clinical trials in 3 phases
- Safety, usage and efficacy is approved based on trials
- Regulatory bodies (CDSCO, FDA) approve drug/patent

Manufacturing

- API Synthesis
- Formulation development
- Manufacturing facilities for mass production
- Packing/labeling/batch production

Distribution

- Channels: wholesalers, distributors, pharma stores
- Online 24x7 retailers
- Hospital pharmacies
- Healthcare providers

Marketing & After-Sales

- Promoting to healthcare providers through sales reps and samples
- Promotional content/doctor referrals

Revenue Drivers

Drug sales (~50-60%)
Exports (~20-30%)
Branded/OTC Drugs (~5-10%)

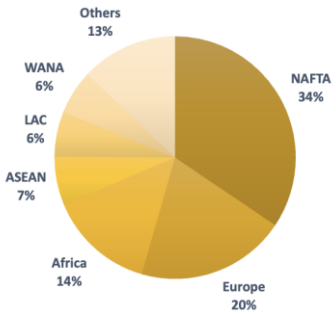
Cost Drivers

Raw materials/R&D (~25-30%)
Manufacturing costs (~20-25%)
IP/Patent/Distr/Mkting (~10-20%)

Growth Drivers

- Increased healthcare spend due to insurance penetration
- Growing market for generic drugs
- Govt. initiatives like tax incentives for manufacturing APIs and Strengthening of Pharmaceutical Industry

Sector Composition



Export destinations for Indian Pharma Companies

Challenges

- Regulatory risk: Heavily regulated
- R&D costs: High R&D costs reduce profitability
- Consumer behaviour changes
- Competition from Generic Drugs: Cheap & difficult to compete with
- Supply Chain Disruption
- Patent Expiration: drop in prices

Industry Trends

- 100% FDI permitted by GoI (Greenfield)
- Union Budget 2025-26: Allocation of US$ 602 million for the Department of Pharmaceuticals
- India Biopharma SHAKTI initiative (Rs. 10,000 crore) to boost domestic biopharma capabilities
- Digitization of value chain
- Increase in M&A activity for diversification in emerging markets (Biosimilars, biologics)

Understanding Power Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

USD 140 bn (in 2026)
USD 216 bn (by 2031)

CAGR

7.37% (2026-31)

Market Cap. (2025)

adani Transmission — **USD 3.3B**

पावरग्रिड POWERGRID — **USD 5.7 BN**

एनटीपीसी NTPC — **USD 21.9 B**

Industry Dynamics

TONE: Low, capex investment, high red tape-ism, dominated by PSUs
BPOS: High, COAL India only supplier
BPOB: Low, limited distributors
TOS: Moderate, limited substitutes
CR: High, intense competition with alternate power sources

KPIs

- Plant Load Factor (PLF)
- Capacity Utilization Rate
- Transmission & Distribution (T&D) Losses
- Outage Frequency and Duration
- Safety Incident Rate

Key Terms

- Decentralized Energy Resources (DERs)
- Smart Grids
- Carbon Pricing & CCUS
- Green Hydrogen
- Small Modular Reactors (SMRs)

Value Chain

Resource Acquisition

- Resource Exploration and Assessment
- Procurement
- Extraction & Harvesting
- Field Development Planning

Generation

- Licensing
- Infrastructure Setup
- Conversion to Electricity process
- Waste Management & Emissions Control

Transmission

- Laying High Voltage lines and Sub-station setup
- Grid control centers and load dispatch centers
- Grid Stability and Security infrastructure

Distribution

- Laying Low voltage lines & Distribution Stations
- Metering and Data Collection
- Distribution Management System (DMS)

Service & Management

- Billing & Customer Service
- Maintenance and Infra Management
- Load and Grid Management

Revenue Drivers

Electricity outreach
Dynamic Pricing (Smart Grids)

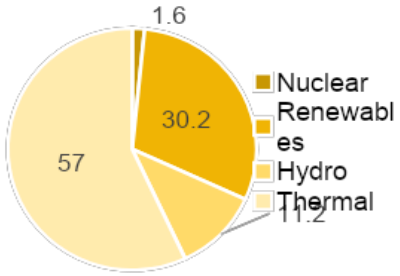
Cost Drivers

Licensing
Infrastructure setup
Raw Material & Manpower

Growth Drivers

- Increasing electrification and per-capita usage
- Government electricity outreach policies: PM-Surya Ghar
- Tax incentives & subsidies
- Advanced Energy storage solutions

Sector Composition



Challenges

- Maximize efficiency to minimize Carbon Pricing and Emissions Regulations
- Climate change policies
- Limited availability of the fossil fuel reserves
- Decentralized Energy Resources (DERs)

Industry Trends

- Development of 'green city' in every Indian state, using renewable energy.
- Non-fossil installed capacity crossed **300.5 GW** (~54% of total 552 GW grid capacity), on track for 500 GW by 2030.
- Decentralized Rooftop Solar Boom accelerated by the PM Surya Ghar scheme
- 100% FDI allowed in power sector for generation (except atomic power), transmission, distribution.

Understanding Telecom Industry

Industry Overview

Market Size

USD 40.6 Bn (2026)
USD 72.3 Bn (2034)

CAGR

~7.5% (2026-34)

Market Share of Major Players

Jio ~40%
airtel ~38%
VI ~15%

Industry Dynamics

TONE: Low, huge capex needed (R&D)
BPOS: Low, limited suppliers available
BPOB: High, size of buyers is high
TOS: Low, no direct substitute available
CR: High, intense competition

KPIs

- Churn rate
- Disconnect
- Subscriber Acquisition Cost
- Net Promotor Score (NPS)
- Average Customer Satisfaction Score (CSAT)

Key Terms

- VoLTE, VoIP
- Data provisions
- XaaS
- White space spectrum
- Backhaul
- CSP
- DoS, DDoS

Value Chain

Telecom Infrastructure

- Acquiring new spectrums & frequency bandwidths
- Building/maintaining towers, base stations, fiber-optic cables.

R&D & Testing

- Development of tech such as IoT, 5G and AI-driven solutions
- New antenna and device testing
- Safety, quality testing

Manufacturing

- Network layout based on new technology
- Creation of a scalable service enablement platform
- Field testing

Distribution

- Warehouse network
- In store, online
- Expansion to new areas
- Services – data, voice, value-added services

Sales, Marketing & Support

- Brand development
- Advertising, promotions on large scale
- Service-centric operator for queries, complaints, feedback

Revenue Drivers

Data services (~50-60%)
Voice services (~20-30%)
VAS (~10-15%)

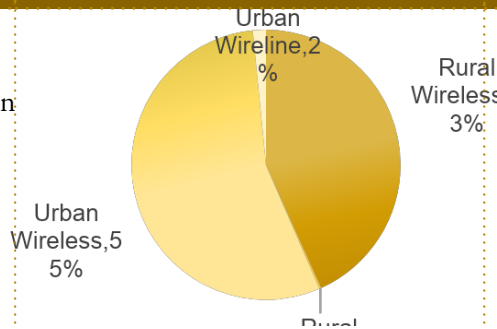
Cost Drivers

Spectrum cost
Advertising
Support network

Growth Drivers

- 5G spectrums
- Satcom
- Increasing smartphone penetration
- Evolving consumption patterns
- Government Regulation and Polices

Sector Composition



Challenges

- Data privacy and security
- High price sensitivity
- Poor management of sustainability agenda
- Inability to accelerate efficiencies through digitization
- Adaptability to changing regulatory landscape

Industry Trends

- Over 21 million households moving to 5G FWA
- Commercial Launch of Satellite Broadband (Satcom)
- Sequential prepaid/postpaid tariff hikes along with 5G monetization driving industry average ARPU toward target limits

Part F – Tech Insights

Main Index

Tech Insights: Table of Contents

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2.	Understanding Google	89
3.	Understanding Global Cloud	90

Understanding AI/ML

Market Size & CAGR

India	CAGR
$7.8B (2025)	20.2%

Global	
$184B (2024)	CAGR
$826B (2030)	39.4%

Product Types

Machine Learning
Natural Language Processing (NLP)
AI-driven Robots
Speech Recognition
Predictive Analytics
AI Chatbots & GenAI

Growth Factors

Cloud Computing and Scalability
Open-Source Software and Libraries
New breed of chips
Data availability

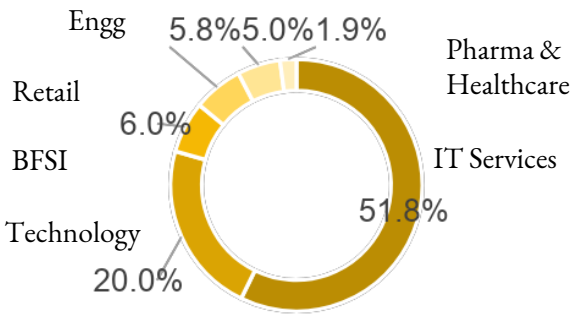
Government Initiatives

- AI for ALL to promote adoption & use of AI technologies
- The National Programme on AI (NPAI) to foster innovation, inclusion and adoption for social impact.
- Drone Shakti to commercialize the use of drones in different industries.
- Government has set up centres of excellence in AI across the country to promote R&D.
- AI Startup ecosystem support & use of AI in governance to improve efficiency

Key Terminologies

- LLM
- NFTs
- Industrial metaverse
- Digital Twin
- Edge AI
- GPT
- Hyper Automation

AI Market Share by Industry (2021)



Indian AI market segmentation

- IoT/Industry 4.0
- Cloud platforms
- Hardware and OEM
- Consumer software/SaaS
- Enterprise software/SaaS
- SI and IT integrators/consulting
- End-user enterprises

Trends

- Natural Language Processing (NLP) to Minimize Language Barriers.
- Robot-assisted surgeries.
- Banks use AI and RPA to eliminate human errors.
- Monitoring social media using NLP.
- Deep learning techniques in autonomous cars.

Generative AI

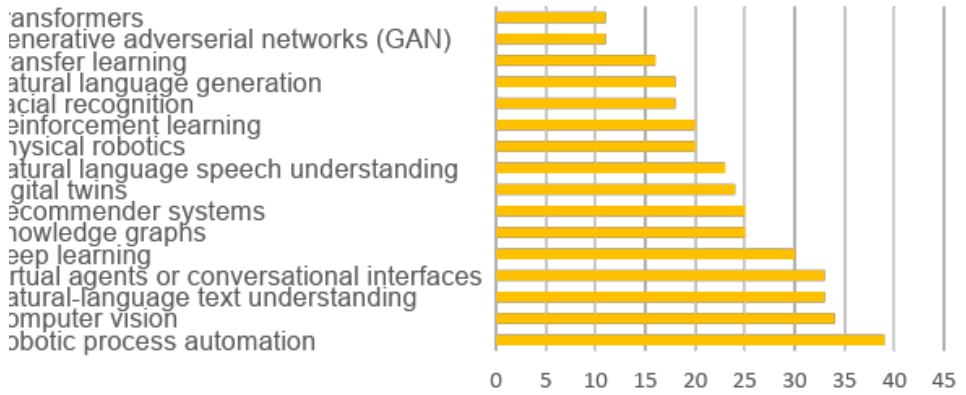
- Gen AI applications: ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Jasper, Claude, Gemini
- **ChatGPT** created by Open AI launched in Nov 2022 receives **2.5 billion prompts** per day from over **100 million active users**.
- About **75 percent** of the value that generative AI use cases could deliver are across four areas:

1) Customer Operations: Improved issue resolution by 14% an hr and time spent in issue handling by 9%
2) Marketing & Sales : can increase productivity by 5-15%
3) Software engineering: speeds up developer work as a coding assistant.
4) R&D: reduces research and design time by improving simulation & time testing

Use Cases

- Human-like NPCs to interact with the players in games.
- Network Investment optimization in Telecom.
- Automated data governance.
- Lead Scoring.
- Financial fraud monitoring.
- Precision farming

AI Capability adaption rate in businesses (2022)



Understanding Google

Overview

Market Cap - $2.31 Trillion
Revenues - $348.16 Bn (2024)
Net Income - ~$90 Bn (2024)
Google India's Revenue - $94 Bn
Processes 13.7 Bn search everyday

Model Type

Follows hidden revenue business model, where users are kept out of the equation so they don't pay for the product or service offered.

Revenue Stream

- Google Search & other
- Google Network Members
- YouTube ads
- Google Other
- Google Cloud
- Other Bets

Ads
- Ad-words
- Ad-Sense

Cloud
- G-Suite
- Maps
- Docs

Hardware
- Phones
- Home Assistant
- Chromecast

Pricing Types

- **Cost Per Click –** Based on interests/clicks.
- **Cost per mile/views –** Based on impressions

- **Ad-words** - Helps advertisers display advertisements in the Google content network.
- Constitutes 80% of the ads revenue.
- **Ad-Sense** - Helps other website owners display advertisements on their own website.
- This time allows small businesses and blogs to generate ads revenue on their own.
- In return, Google gets one-third of the revenue generated.
- Constitutes 20% of ads revenue.

Google Analytics: Shows website owners track of visitors to their sites and how people use them. Costings for web search and android search varies but due to sheer volume of android devices, it is extremely profitable.

- # of android users worldwide – **3.6 billion monthly active users**
- **# Apps – 2.6 Million**

- **Mobile advertising** -main source
- Google pays Apple billions to be default search engine on iPhone
- **App Store –** A 35% commission of every purchase of App and even in-app purchases.
- In exchange offers the platform and cloud infrastructure for delivering notifications.
- **Media side of the Play Store** - Paid music, movies, books, and subscriptions on Google Apps like Play Music, Play Movies

Android has no licensing fees & it is beneficial because every phone user sign in with their unique account when setting up a phone. This helps in analyzing user data to improve the relevancy of the ads .

- Real-time mobile-based payments system. (UPI)
- Most downloaded fintech app globally in 2018.

- **Market Share in India – 36.8%**
- Revenue Potential – $2-4 billion
- About 80% of all online search volume, & revenue, come from commerce-related searches. Up till now, most of the information Google has on its users only helped it map their intent, not their spends. Payments bridges this gap.
- Payments unlocks potential in revenue by tapping merchants through Maps & advertising.
- UPI sees about 30% transactions being made to merchants.
- For online merchant transactions, Google Pay is the market leader (60% share).
- It has the second highest share after PhonePe.

- **Ads** are the major source of revenue.
- 2 types of Ads

1. **Local search ads** are featured businesses which appear as top results when searched on Maps
2. **Promoted Pins:** Google Maps uses a 'pin' like symbol to indicate the location of a place. For e.g., McDonald's in US pays a fee to Google to have its signature 'M' logo to be embedded in each map.

- **Google Maps API** - Customized API is geared towards businesses that benefit from having a tailored version of the Maps in their online or mobile applications. E.g. Ola, Uber, Pokémon Go
- **Partnerships –** They partnered with cab-hailing companies and added the option of discovering available cabs and their pricing within the Google Maps App.

Google Phones



- Pixel 8 & 8 Pro
- Accessories: Stand, Cases, Headphones, cables & Adaptors

Chrome Cast



Chromecast is a streaming media adapter that allows users to play online content such as videos and music on a digital television.

Nest Hub

Voice-control multipl
compatible devices, all
from a single dashboar



Google Home

Smart speaker and voice Assistant.
Play your music. Call your friends. Ask it questions.



Understanding Global Cloud

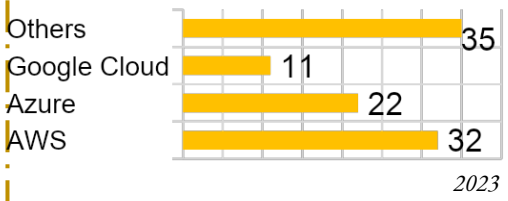
Sector

On Demand Cloud IaaS (Infrastructure as a Service)
Services – 100+
Industry Size – $619+ Bn. (2023), CAGR – 14.1% (2023-30), Players – 30+
Big Players - 5

Product Types

Virtual Machine Service
Simple Storage System
RDBMS
Isolated Cloud Resources
VPNs

Market Share & Major Players



* Others includes major players like Alibaba Cloud & IBM Cloud

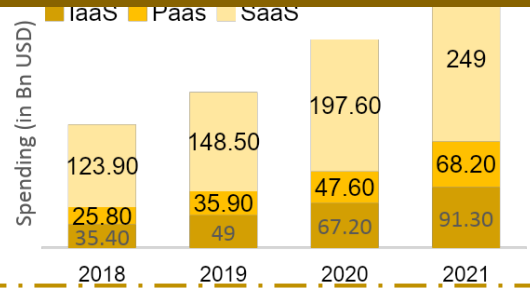
Distribution

Divided into no. of global regions, each has multiple availability zones. Allow users to set geographical limits on their services.

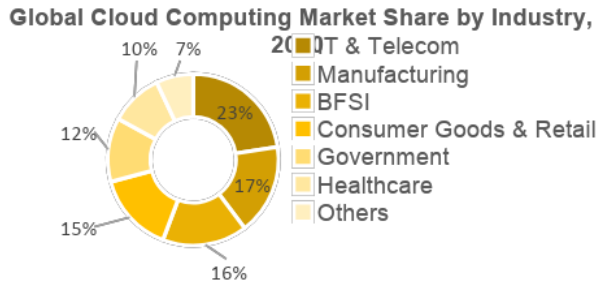
Growth Factors

Marginality & Scalability
Network Effect
Demand for Remote Desktops
Start-up Ecosystem
Increased Data Consumption

Global IT Service Revenue, by model



Cloud Computing Market Share



Fees

- "Pay-as-you go" model.
- Based on hardware/OS/networking features chosen.
- Pay for a single virtual computer, a dedicated physical computer, or clusters.
- The customer gets free "credits" in the beginning to set up their cloud computing structure on cloud platforms
- Once these credits are used up and the customer has needs more server capacities, he can flexibly use as much server capacity as he needs and is billed accordingly.

Pricing Models

On Demand

- You pay for compute capacity by the hour or the second depending on which instances you run.
- You can increase or decrease your compute capacity depending on the demands of your application
- Only pay the specified per hourly rates for the instance you use.

Spot Instances

- Spot instances allow you to bid on spare computing capacity for up to 90% off the On-Demand price.

Dedicated Hosts

- A Dedicated Host is a physical server dedicated for use.
- Reduce costs by bundling software licenses, including Windows Server, SQL Server.

Savings Plan

- Savings Plans are a flexible pricing model that offer low prices in exchange for a commitment to a consistent amount of usage (measured in $/hour) for a 1 or 3 year term.

Reserved Spots

- For applications that have steady state or predictable usage.
- Annual & prepaid service

Major Services over Cloud

- Compute
- Storage
- Data management
- Migration
- Networking & Content delivery
- Development tools & application services
- Management & monitoring
- Security, Identity, & Compliance
- Analytics
- Artificial intelligence & IoT
- Mobile development
- Notifications
- Business Productivity

Advantages of Cloud

- **Trading Capex for variable Opex** : Minimize overhead for investment, maintenance, and management.
- **Economies of Scale**
- **Flexible Capacity & Agility:** As a company grows, Cloud provides resources to aid in expansion and as the business model allows for flexible usage,
- Guaranteed 24*7 services and support.
- **Security**: Ensure security with modern cloud security standards and diversifying the physical locations in which data is held.
- **Global Reach & Scalability**

Part G – Behavioural Preparation

Main Index

Primer to Behavioural Prep

Consulting firms assess your ability to successfully work with teams and judge how well you understand their firm and yourself

Some questions to prepare for:

Tell me about yourself

- Answer should give a bird's-eye view of your CV
- Answer should be succinct, short and cover major aspects of your career and interests

Questions about you/your CV

- Make sure you know your CV thoroughly and can converse about the talking points
- Make sure to mention any learnings, a situation where you took leadership and initiative in your answer

Use Rule of Three for the following:

Why do you want to pursue a career in Consulting?

- Answers should map your past career to your choice of consulting as a career
- Answers should include a professional/experience which shows your aforementioned quality

Strengths & Weaknesses

- Give content of the challenges you faced, what helped you overcome these challenges and your learnings obtained from them

What makes you a good fit for consulting?

- Talk about a quality that consulting careers require and how you exhibited that quality in your life
- Deep dive into what makes a consultant i.e. various aspects of a consulting career, ideal consultant.

Why company 'X'?

- Research in depth about the company and try to map their philosophy to yours
- Talk to people who have had an experience with company 'X'
- Make sure your answer is in line with regards to your personal beliefs

Frequently Asked Questions

- Why did you pick your school?
- A time you were a team player
- What do you know about the job & the firm?
- What accomplishments have given you the greatest satisfaction?
- A time you showed leadership skills
- A time you took initiative
- Have you ever failed at anything?
- Tell me about a recent crisis you handled
- Tell me about the most interesting project you worked on
- Why should I hire you?
- Tell me more about your hobby/achievements
- What experience/skills do you feel are particularly transferable to our organisation?
- Tell me something about yourself which is not in the CV
- How has the process been so far for you?
- A common talking point with the interviewer
- How has your MBA been so far?

You should know how to carry a conversation with the interviewer

Non-Verbal Communication

The interviewer wants to see if you are someone they can let interact with the client and if they can spend hours working with you on a project. Certain things including confidence, passion, curiosity and positivity need to be conveyed to the interviewer.

Non-verbal communication during a case interview plays a big role in doing so.

Do's



- Carry yourself in a calm and composed manner
- Be confident, sit straight and maintain eye contact
- Nod subtly when receiving information that you asked for
- Have a smile in the end no matter how the case went



Don'ts

- Get intimidated by the case when a tricky one comes
- Panic and look tensed and confused
- Fiddle with the pen or any other object around
- Look here and there while speaking or thinking

Developing the traits for Non- verbal Communication

- Consider case solving a fun experience to gain confidence. It helps to avoid shakiness and fumbling tone during the interview.
- Gain the technical knowledge about case solving by practicing a good number of cases with different people and ask for their feedback.
- Practice connect with people even without any purpose to learn the art of building rapport as it is required in driving the interview.
- Record yourself or practice in front of a mirror to analyze and work upon your non-verbal communication.

Part H – Practice Guesstimates

Main Index

Practice Guesstimates: Table of Contents

★ Indicates latest additions/ updates to the casebook

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★ Indicates latest additions/ updates to the casebook

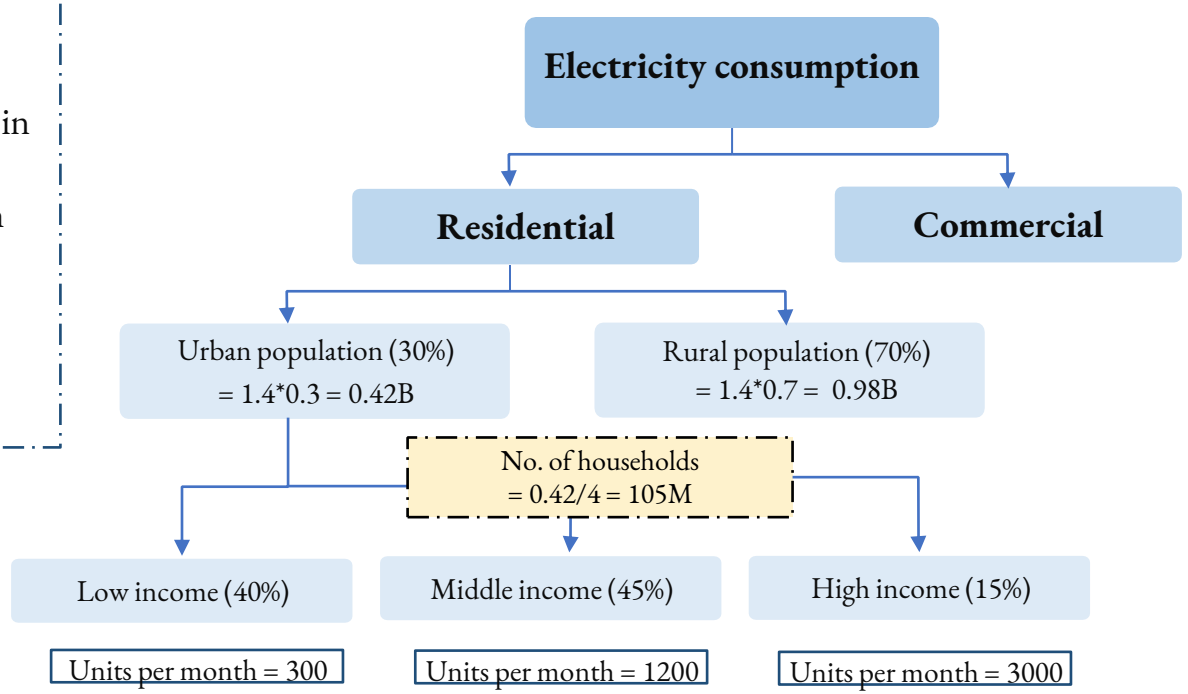
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Electricity Consumption

Estimate the monthly residential electricity consumption in urban India.

Assumptions

- Focusing on residential use case
- Average Household Size is 4 in Urban areas and 6 in Rural areas
- Monthly units consumption = % of households in income segment * # of households
- Indian population = 1.4B
- Urban population : rural population = 3:7



Electricity consumption:

Low income = 105*0.4*300 = 12600 units
Middle income = 105*0.45*1200 = 56700 units
High income = 105*0.15*3000 = 47250 units

Total monthly consumption = 116550M units

Number of Umbrellas Sold

Estimate the number of umbrellas sold in Mumbai in a year

Assumptions

- Average no. of members in a household = 4
- The average useful life of an umbrella in:

Low income: 6 years
Middle income: 6 years
High income: 4 years (replace earlier)

Methodology

- We start by determining number of households in Mumbai
- We split the households by income level
- We estimate the number of umbrellas per household and multiply the same with total no. of households
- The total number of umbrellas are divided by their useful life in each income group
- The sum of the umbrellas demanded across income groups is then calculated

Total umbrellas = No of umbrellas in households/ Average useful life of an umbrellas

Population of Mumbai (2 cr)= 50 lac households

	Low Income	Middle Income	High Income
	(35%) = 17.5 lacs	(50%) = 25 lacs	(15%) = 7.5 lacs
Average number of umbrellas for households	1.5 (26.25 lac umbrellas)	2.5 (62.5 lac umbrellas)	4 (30 lac umbrellas)
Average life span of an umbrella	6 years	6 years	4 years

Total no of umbrellas = (Lower income+ Middle income + High income)

26.25 lacs/6 + 62.5 lacs/6+ 30 lacs/ 4 = 22.29 lacs

No of Umbrellas sold in Mumbai in a year = 22.29 lacs

Toll Plaza

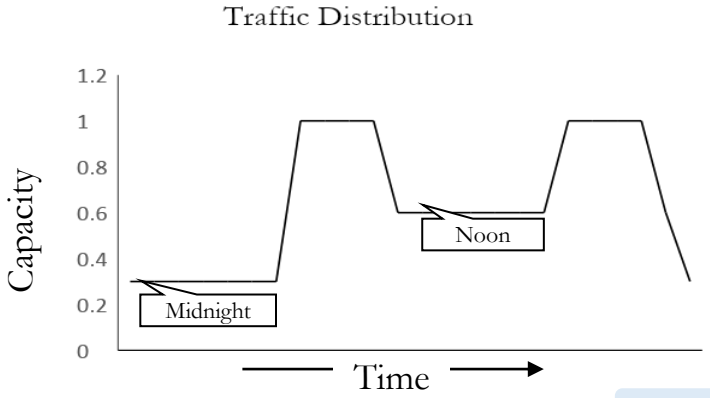
Estimate daily revenues of Delhi-Gurgaon toll plaza

Assumptions

- Toll plaza operates 24x7
- 2/3 wheelers do not have to pay toll fare
- Toll fare is the only revenue source
- Traffic across booths is uniform

Methodology

- Daily revenue = (Daily revenue per toll booth) x (# toll booths)
- For one toll booth, the # vehicles crossing it will vary with time of the day (peak / non-peak hours)
- Average time for a car to pass the booth = 15 secs; Hence, 4 cars can cross the booth in a minute
- Therefore, capacity = max. vehicles that can cross a booth in an hour = 240 vehicles / hour



Revenue per toll booth

We are treating the toll booth as a bottleneck to estimate traffic throughout the day

- **# vehicle per booth**
  - High traffic hours: 8 hours /day, Full capacity
  - Medium traffic hours: 8 hours /day, 60 % capacity
  - Low traffic hours: 8 hours /day, 30 % capacity
- **Fare per vehicle**
  - 4 wheelers: 70% of daily traffic, Fare – INR 30
  - > 4 wheelers (trucks): 30% of daily traffic, Fare – INR 70

'High traffic hours' include morning and evening office peak hours. 'Medium traffic hours' include afternoon and late night hours. 'Low traffic hours' include hours from ~11 PM to 7 AM.

Total # vehicles per booth = (8)x(240)x(1+0.6+0.3) ~ 3600

Weighted Fare = (0.7)x(30) + (0.3)x(70) = INR 42

Daily revenue = (3600)x(42)x(20) ~ INR 30 lacs

TOI Revenues

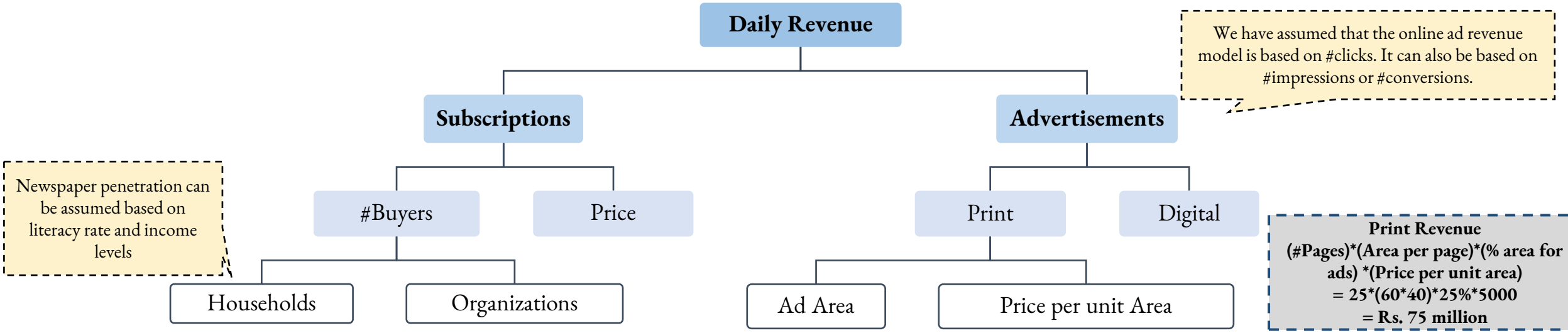
Estimate daily revenues of Times of India

Assumptions

- Households order 1 copy of ToI each
- No online subscription model for ToI
- Print ads are priced only on area basis
- Digital ads are priced on CTR basis

Methodology

- Revenue Streams = Revenue from newspaper circulation + Advertising Revenue
- Newspapers can be bought by individuals/households or organizations (libraries, offices, schools)
- Advertising Revenue Streams = Printed Ads on the paper + Ads on website/mobile apps
- Digital revenue is calculated based on the number of online users who click the advertisement



We have assumed that the online ad revenue model is based on #clicks. It can also be based on #impressions or #conversions.

Newspaper penetration can be assumed based on literacy rate and income levels

Print Revenue
(#Pages)*(Area per page)*(% area for ads) *(Price per unit area)
= 25*(60*40)*25%*5000
= Rs. 75 million

#Household Buyers = (#Households)*(English Newspaper penetration)*(ToI's Mkt. Share)
#Households Buyers = 300 mil * (50%*20%)*25% = 7.5 million
#Organizational Buyers = 50% of Household buyers = 3.75 million
#Revenue = 7.5 + 3.75 = 11.25 * 5 = Rs. 56.25 million

Digital Revenue
(#Users)*(Number of ads)*(Click Through Rate)*(Cost per click) =
25 mil *10*0.5%*10= Rs. 12.5 million

Total Revenue = 56.25 + 75 + 12.5 = Rs. 144 million

Smart Watches

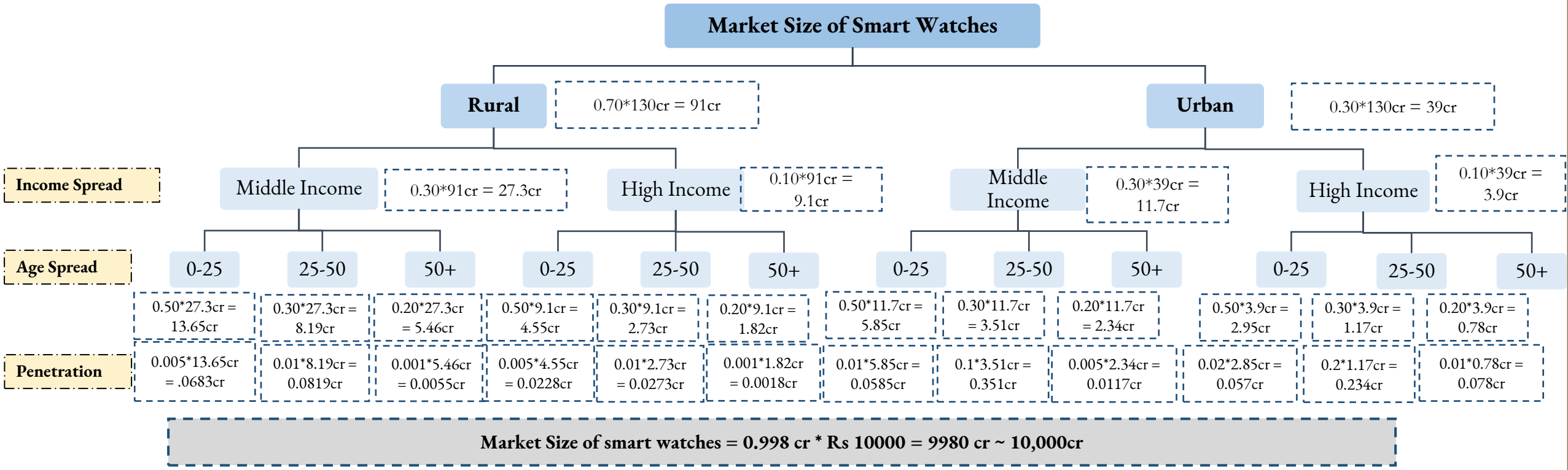
Estimate the market size of Smart Watches in India

Assumptions

- Average price of Smart Watch is Rs. 10k (considering watches range from 3k-30k)
- Penetration in rural area will be much lower than in urban area
- Market exists only in middle & high income groups
- Income Spread is uniform in Rural & Urban

Methodology

- Population of India = 130 Cr; Urban = 30%; Rural = 70%
- Age Group classification: 0-25 = 50%; 25-50= 30%; 50+= 20%
- Income Spread: BPL = 20%; Low Income= 40%; Middle Income= 30%; High Income= 10%
- In Urban India 1% of 0-25 will own one, 10% of 25-50 will own one and roughly 0.5% of 50+ will own one in the middle-income population while in the higher income population, the penetration would be roughly double. In Rural India, 0.5% will own one in age group 0-25, 1% will own one in 25-50 and 0.1% will own one in 50+



Market Size of smart watches = 0.998 cr * Rs 10000 = 9980 cr ~ 10,000cr

Smokers in India

Estimate the number of Smokers in India

Assumptions

- Smokers can be divided into 4 categories- Chain smoker, Regular smoker, smoking with alcohol and occasional smoker
- Cigarettes can be filtered and non-filtered
- Population having filtered cigarettes to be estimated
- Sex Ratio – 1:1

Methodology

- Total smokers= Smokers in urban area + Smokers in rural area
- Urban and Rural areas to be divided into 3 classes each- High income , Middle income & low income
- Every class will have different proportion of male & female smoking cigarettes
- Probability of smoking will depend on the respective age group
- Low income group will not consume filtered cigarettes

Total Population

- **Rural (60%)**
  - High Income (15%)
  - Mid Income (35%) **(Non-filtered)**
  - Low Income (50%) **(Non-filtered)**
- **Urban (40%)**
  - High Income (30%)
  - Mid Income (50%)
  - Low Income (20%) **(Non-filtered)**

Total Smokers= = 68.35mn

Rural High Income Group

	Male			Female		
Age Group	%	Prob	Total	%	Prob	Total
0-18	10%	-	-	10%	-	-
18-30	15%	0.3	4.5%	15%	0.15	2.25%
30-50	15%	0.15	2.25%	15%	0.05	0.75%
>50	10%	-	-	10%	-	-

Urban High Income Group

	Male			Female		
Age Group	%	Prob	Total	%	Prob	Total
0-18	10%	0.05	0.5%	10%	-	-
18-30	15%	0.5	7.5%	15%	0.25	3.75%
30-50	15%	0.3	4.5%	15%	0.15	2.25%
>50	10%	0.05	0.5%	10%	-	-

Urban Mid Income Group

	Male			Female		
Age Group	%	Prob	Total	%	Prob	Total
0-18	10%	-	-	10%	-	-
18-30	15%	0.3	4.5%	15%	0.15	2.25%
30-50	15%	0.2	3%	15%	0.05	0.75%
>50	10%	-	-	10%	-	-

Cheese Burst Pizzas

Estimate the number of cheese bursts pizzas sold by Dominos daily

Assumptions

- Working hours from 11AM to 11 PM
- Peak hrs - 2-4PM & 7-10PM(occupancy rate-80%), Non Peak- 7 hrs(occupancy rate-50%)
- An outlet is able to serve in a 4 km radius on average.
- Services available- Dine in or Home Delivery
- 40% of Pizza orders are Cheese burst orders.
- 1 Order has approximately 1.5 pizzas.
- On avg. it takes 5min to receive & 15 to process = 20mins
- 3 orders can be processed in parallel.
- Delhi constitutes 10% of total metropolitan area
- No Dominos outlets in rural areas.

We'll divide country in 3 categories:
- Metropolitans(20%)
- Urban and Suburban areas(30%)
- Rural Areas(50%)

Methodology

- Daily orders from one outlet= 0.4*3*[(Peak hrs/20mins)*0.8+(Non peak hrs/20)*0.5]+50% of calculated figure for online and home delivery orders]
- No. of Cheese bursts can be calculated for one city i.e. Delhi and then extrapolated to arrive at a national figure
- Area of Delhi= 1600 sq.km. and one outlet serves 4 km radius
- Therefore no. of outlets in Delhi= 1600/3.14*4*4= 32
- Consumption of pizzas in urban and suburban areas = 50% of that of metropolitan areas

Number of Cheese Bursts per outlet

- **Non Peak (7 hours)**
  - In Store Purchase
    - Orders = 3*(420/20)*0.5 = ~ 32
  - Online & Home Delivery
    - Online orders= 0.5*32= 16
- **Peak (5 hours)**
  - In Store Purchase
    - Orders = 3*(300/20)*0.8= 36
  - Online & Home Delivery
    - Online orders= 0.5*36= 18

Cheese bursts orders = 0.4*102 = ~ 41

Pizzas per orders = 41*1.5 = 61

All over Delhi = stores * per store= 32*61= 1952

Since Delhi's area = 10% of total metropolitan area, no. of cheese bursts sold in metropolitans= 10* 1952 = 19520

Cheese bursts sold daily in urban and suburban areas= 0.5*(19520)*1.5 = 14640

Total Cheese bursts sold daily = 34160

Petrol Pumps

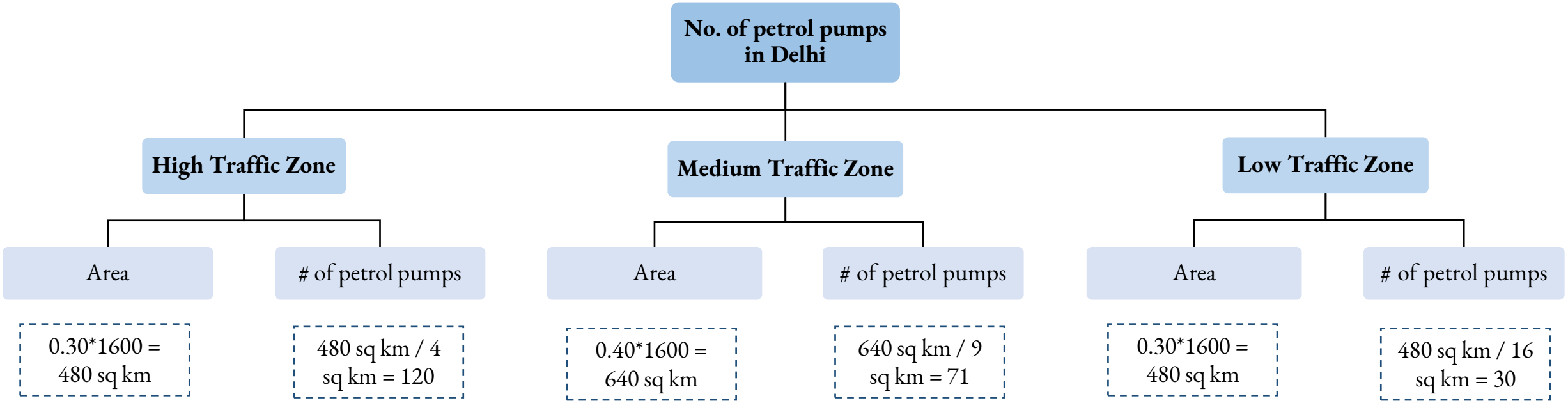
Estimate the number of Petrol Pumps in Delhi (Approach 1)

Assumptions

- High Traffic Zone = 30%; Medium Traffic Zone = 40%; Low Traffic Zone = 30%
- Distance between petrol pumps in:
- High traffic zone = 2km; Medium Traffic Zone = 3km; Low Traffic Zone = 4km

Methodology

- Area of Delhi = 1600 sq. km
- Area served by 1 petrol pump in:
  - High traffic Zone = 2x2 sq. km = 4 sq. km
  - Medium traffic Zone = 3x3 sq. km = 9 sq. km
  - Low traffic Zone = 4x4 sq. km = 16 sq. km



Total No. of petrol pumps = 120 + 71 + 30 = 221

Petrol Pumps

Estimate the number of Petrol Pumps in India (Approach 2)

Assumptions

- Avg. distance travelled by user does not vary across vehicles and = 30 km/day
- Non-peak time hours of a petrol pump can be surmised in a single number = 50% in this case
- Pooling usage internalized in distance assumption

Methodology

- We use a demand side approach for this
- Number of Petrol Pumps = Demand of Petrol / Petrol supplied by a pump (avg)
- Demand of Petrol = Distance travelled by a vehicle user (avg) * (Number of bike users /Bike mileage + Number of Car users / Car mileage)
- Petrol Supplied by a pump = Overall Petrol Suppling Capacity * Weighted Average of Usage ratio

Number of Petrol Pumps

- **Demand of Petrol**
  - 2 wheeler
  - 4 wheeler
- **Petrol Pump usage ratio**
  - Peak Time
  - Non-Peak Time
- **Petrol Pump Capacity**

Empirical Assumptions

2 wheeler	4 wheeler	Peak Time	Non-Peak Time	Petrol Pump Capacity
25 crore users 70 km/l mileage	15 crore users 10 km/l mileage	4 hours 100%	10 hours 50%	Avg time to fill 15 l petrol = 3 min Avg booths = 4 Capacity = 15*4*(4*60/3 = 16800 l

Demand of Petrol = [Avg distance = 30 km] * [25cr/70 km/l + 15cr/10 km/l] = 55.7 crore litre

Petrol Supplied per pump = [Avg Usage Ratio = (1*4+0.5*10)/14 = 0.64]*[Capacity = 16,800 l] = 10,800 litre

Number of Petrol Pumps = [Demand = 55.7 Cr ltr] / [Per Pump Supply = 10,800 ltr] = 51,587 = 51,500 (approx.)

Petrol Pumps

Estimate the number of Petrol Pumps in India (Approach 3)

Assumptions

- Petrol pump operated 12 hours a day
- Uniform petrol consumption by a car
- Arrival rate uniform across peak hours
- Arrival rate different across non peak hours
- Considering only 4 wheelers in the analysis
- Assuming average size of a household = 5 members.
- Total population of India = 1.25 Billion

Methodology

- # of pumps in India = (# of cars in India) / (number of cars serviced by a petrol pump) * (frequency of visits to a petrol pump by a car)
- For a petrol pump , peak hours (7 am to 11 am) and (4 pm to 8 pm) = 8 hours
- Car arrival rate in peak hours = 4 cars in 5 minutes
- Car arrival rate in non-peak hours = 4 cars in 10 minutes
- This implies total cars serviced daily = 8*(4/5)*60 + 4*(4/10)*60= 384+96= 480 cars serviced a day.
- Assuming an average car needs petrol twice in a month

- 50% households = 0 vehicles
- 30% households = 1 vehicle
- 20% households = 2 vehicles

→ 0.7 vehicles per household

of cars in India

Total households in India = (1250/5) = 250 million

×

Average number of cars in each household

Total number of cars in India = 250*0.7 = 175 million private vehicles.

+

Assuming commercial vehicles form 20% of the total private vehicles = 35 million commercial vehicles

Total 210 million vehicles in India . Assuming each vehicle needs fuel twice in a month we get = (2/30)*210= 14 million vehicles using fuel daily

Number of petrol pumps = (# of cars visiting a petrol pump) / (# of cars serviced by a petrol pump

14million/480= 30000 petrol stations in India . Asuming each station has 4 pumps = **120000 pumps**

TT Balls (Part 1)

Estimate the number of TT balls used in a day in Delhi

Assumptions

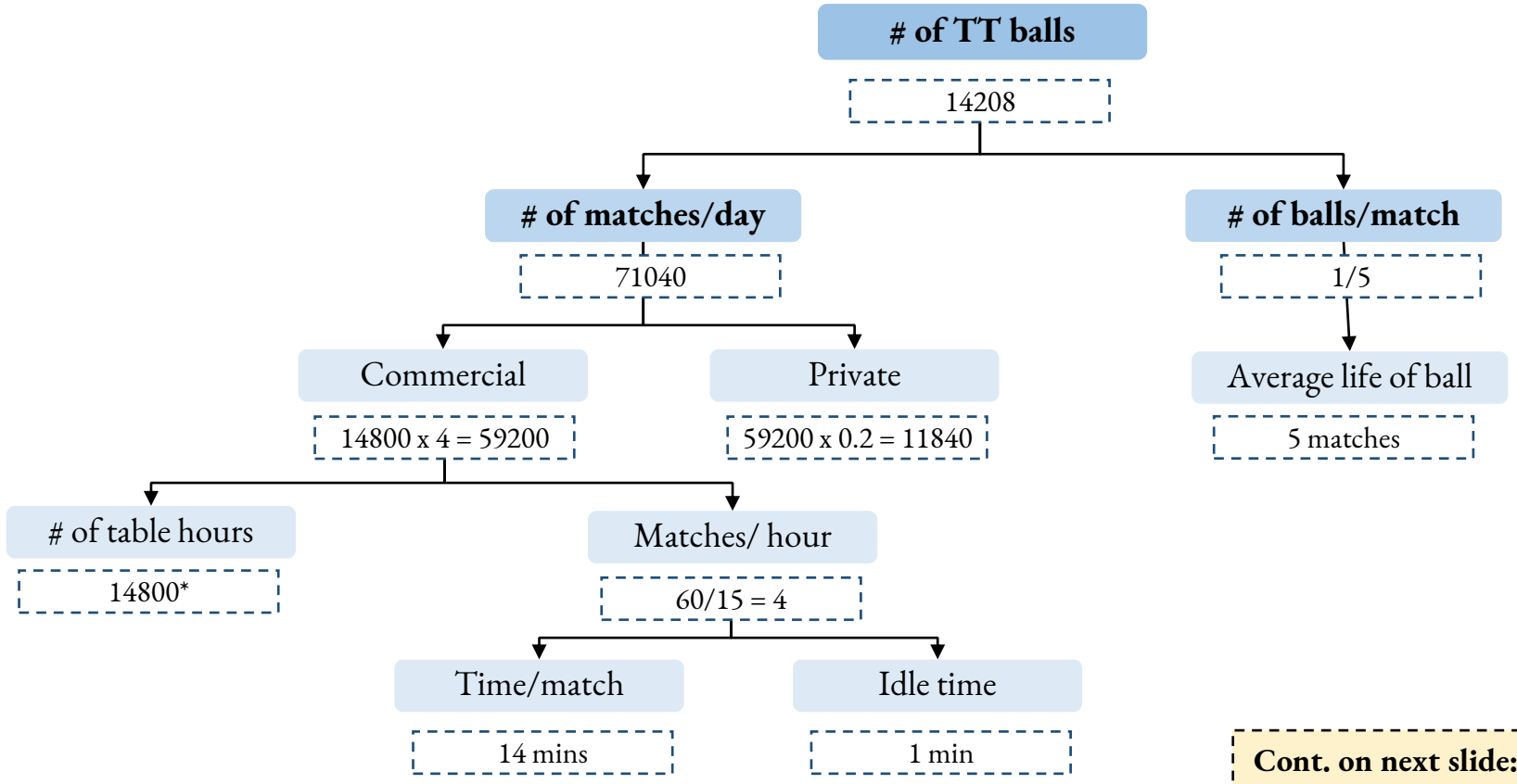
- Considering only matches in commercial spaces for calculation
- Using a factor of 20% for private spaces
- Considering all matches to be similar (for avg. life of a ball)

Methodology

- Solved from demand side
- #Matches per hour = 1/(Time per match + Idle time)
- Time per match = 14 minutes (for simplicity; assuming 11-point match)
- Avg. Life of a ball = 5 matches

G1 – Guesstimate the number of TT balls used in a day in Delhi
G2 – Estimate the number of TT matches played everyday
G3 – Estimate the number of TT racquets used in a lifetime by an international player & many more

Basic Thoughts:-
Approaches – Demand side and Supply Side (try both)
Be ready with enough information about the manufacturing aspects of the sport or make assumptions



*Refer to the next Slide for calculations

Cont. on next slide:-

TT Balls (Part 2)

Estimate the number of TT balls used in a day in Delhi

of Table Hours Available

14800

Large Spaces

100*60 = 6000

of Spaces

200*1/2 = 100

- **# Regions - 200**
- **# of Spaces – 1/2**

Hours per Space

60

- **# Tables - 5**
- **# Hours Open - 12**

Methodology:-

Need proxy for #regions – Use metro stations

Total metro stations = 200

commercial spaces per region=>

For Large spaces = 1 space per 2 regions

For Medium spaces = 1 space per 1 region

For small spaces = 2 spaces per 1 regions

Hours available per space =>

For Large spaces = 12 hours

For Medium spaces = 8 hours

For small spaces = 5 hours

(Assuming full capacity utilization)

Medium Spaces

4800

of Spaces

200*1 = 200

- **# Regions - 200**
- **# of Spaces – 1**

Hours per Space

24

- **# Tables - 3**
- **# Hours Open - 8**

Methodology:-

Tables per space=>

For Large spaces = 5 tables

For Medium spaces = 3 tables

For small spaces = 2 tables

Small Spaces

4000

of Spaces

200*2 = 400

- **# Regions - 200**
- **# of Spaces – 2**

Hours per Space

10

- **# Tables - 2**
- **# Hours Open - 5**

Methodology:-

Total number of table hours available = Hours available in :-

Large Spaces + Medium Spaces + Small Spaces

For any space:-

Hours available = Number of spaces * Hours per space

Number of spaces = (Number of regions * number of spaces per region)

Hours per space = (Number of tables * number of hours open)

Total number of TT balls used in a day = 14800 * 4 * 1.2 * (1/5) = 14208 ~14200 TT Balls

White Shirts in Delhi

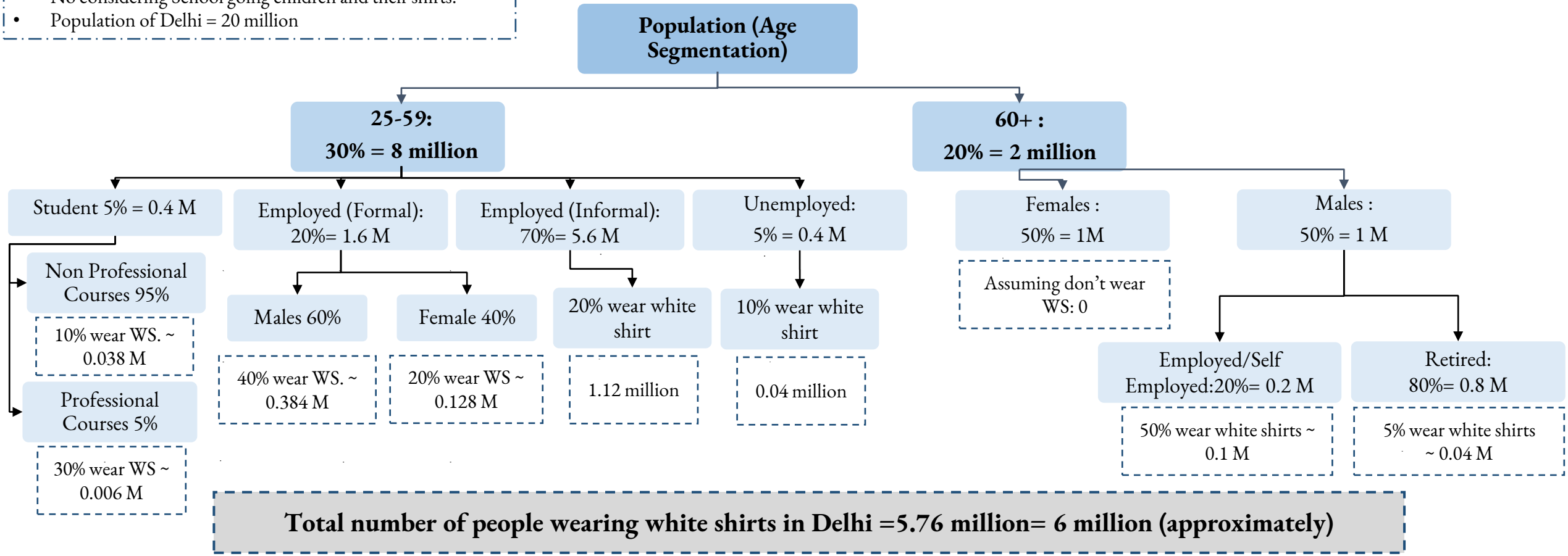
Estimate the number of people wearing a white shirt (WS) in Delhi on any particular day.

Assumption

- Calculations are done for a working weekday i.e. assuming offices, schools and various institutions are open
- One person is wearing one shirt a day.
- No considering School going children and their shirts.
- Population of Delhi = 20 million

Methodology

- Population segmentation has been done across various age groups.
- Calculation for each age group is done on the basis of observed/experienced characteristics.
- Various percentages are used based either on memorised or experienced statistics.



Total number of people wearing white shirts in Delhi =5.76 million= 6 million (approximately)

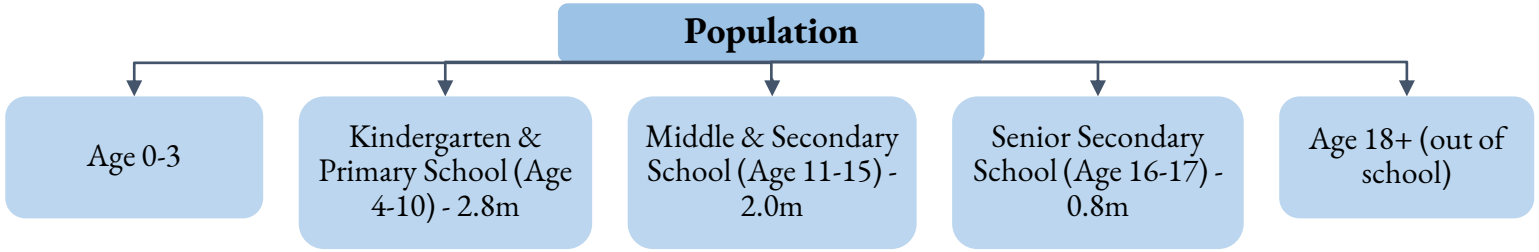
Delhi Schools

Estimate the number of Schools in Delhi

Total Number of Schools = **School going children in Delhi** / **Avg. children in one school**

Part 1: Estimating no. of school going children in Delhi

We know that the population of Delhi is around 20 million. Since India is a young country, we can assume 50% is under 25. So population under 25 would be 10 million. **Let's equally divide the population under 25 across every year**, which would be equal to 400,000. For ex, population aged 4-10 will be 7*400000 = 2.8m

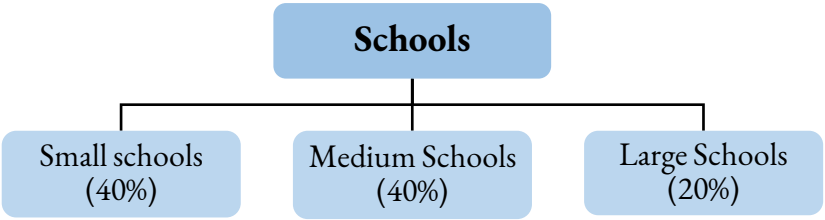


% Going to School			
	Kindergarten & Primary School	Middle & Secondary	Senior Secondary
Middle Class & Above (40%)	100%	100%	100%
Lower Class (40%)	90%	75%	50%
BPL (20%)	50%	25%	0%

Total: (1.0 * 2.8 + 1.0 * 2.0 + 1.0 * 0.8) * 0.4 + (0.9 * 2.8 + 0.75 * 2.0 + 0.5 * 0.8) * 0.4 + (0.5 * 2.8 + 0.25 * 2.0 + 0) * 0.2 = 4.388

Hence estimated school going children = 4.388 million

Part 2: Avg. children in one school



	Small	Medium	Large
Class Size/Section	20/3	30/4	40/6
Standards	Up till 10	Up till 12	Up till 12

Avg Student in one school = (20 * 3 * 10) * 0.4 + (30 * 4 *12) * 0.4 + (40 * 6 * 12) * 0.2

= 600 * 0.4 + 1440 * 0.4 + 2880 * 0.2

= 240 + 576 + 576 = 1392

Total Number of Schools in Delhi = 43,88,000 / 1392 ~ 4,400,000 / 1400 = 3142 ~3150

To triangulate this number, you can take a 5km sq. area, estimate the number of schools and extend it for the entire city

Daily Departing Flights

Estimate number of flights departing from Delhi Airport in a Day

Assumptions

- Airport doesn't operate at max. utilisation
- Turnaround time –
  - Domestic flight – 1.5hr
  - International Flight – 3hrs
- Terminal at IGI –30 (Domestic), 40 (Intl.)
- Every terminal has 2 hangars

Methodology

- Total departing flights (total out-bound flights) in a day = Total In-Bound Flights in a day = Total Flights Operating from an airport
- No of flights operating from one hangar = (24hrs/avg. turnaround time) [Turnaround time is the time a flight would stay in a hangar]
- No of flights operating from one terminal = 2 x (No of flights operating from one hangar)
- There is a possibility that a flight landing in Delhi, might not depart that day itself. But there would also be flight which depart on a day that did not land on that particular day. Hence it should have a balancing effect.

Maximum Operating Flights

Domestic Flights

- No. of domestic terminals: 30
- No. of domestic flights operating from one terminal: 2 x (24/1.5) = 32

Max. Domestic Flights = 32 x 30 = 960

International Flights

- No. of international terminals: 40
- No. of international flights operating from one terminal: 2 x (24/3) = 16

Max. Intl. Flights = 16 x 40 = 640

Utilisation rates have been considered to be different for different hours for domestic flights only. For international flights, uniform rusk of 50% has been assumed

To triangulate the number, we can use the alternate approach from the demand side, by figuring out how many people would be departing from Delhi on one day divided by the avg. number of people in one flight

Hours of the day

6:00am – 9:00 am	9:00am – 6:00 pm	6:00pm – 9:00 pm	9:00pm – 12:00 am	12:00am – 6:00 am
Domestic Flight Rush				
100%	60%	100%	60%	20%

Avg. Utilisation for Domestic Flights = (6 x 100 + 12 x 60 + 6 x 20) = 60%

Total flight departures = Operating Domestic Flights + Operating Intl. Flights = (0.6 x 960) + (0.5 x 640) = 896 flights

Tractors in India (Part 1)

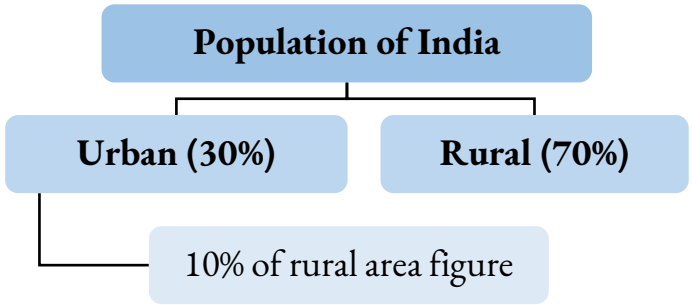
Estimate the number of tractors sold per year in India

Assumptions

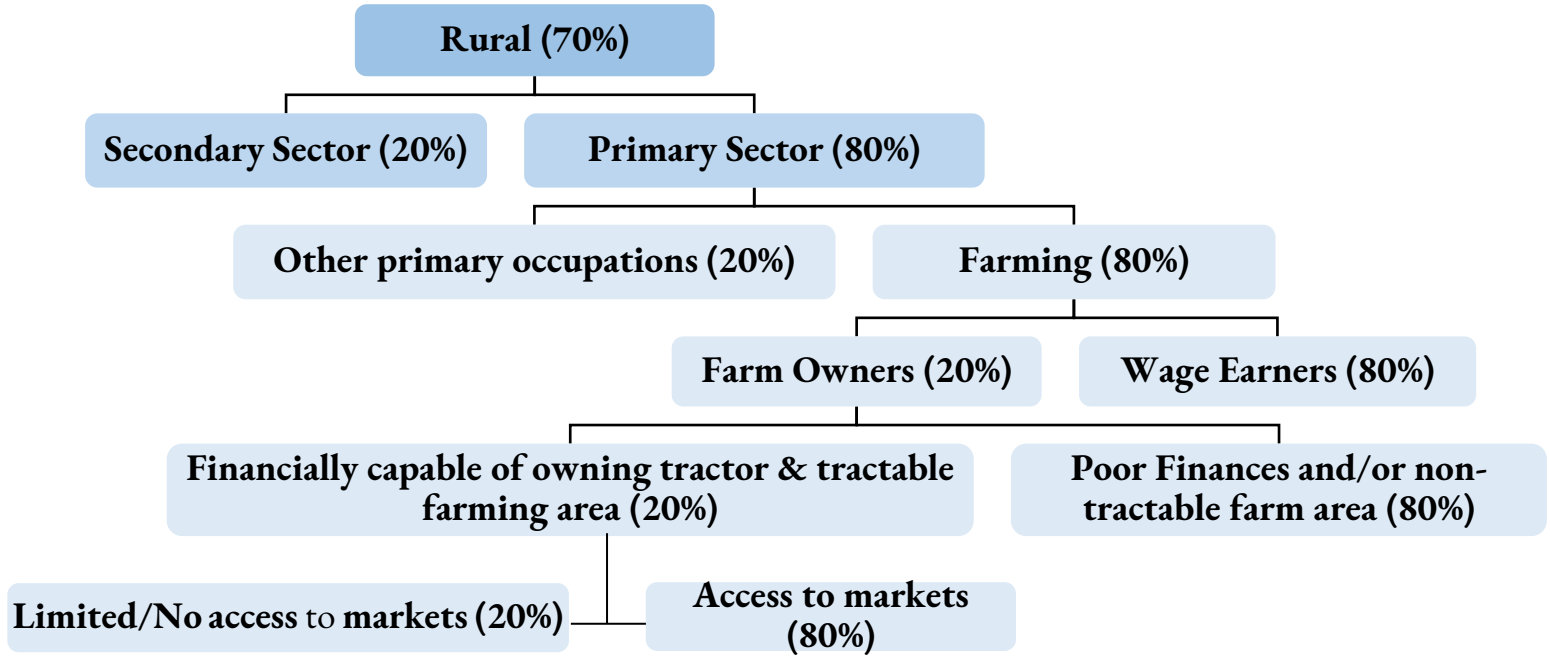
- Tractors are only being used for agricultural purposes in the primary sector
- There is uniform supply of tractors around the country
- All the tractors in consideration are functional and others have been disposed off effectively.
- Each farm-owner has only one tractor for her land/ one tractor per farming household

Methodology

- The population of India = 130cr.; Rural= 70% & Urban= 30%; Avg. household size= 5
- Avg. life of tractor is 5 years (approx.)
- Methodology = [# of tractors in rural areas + # of tractors in urban areas (10% of figure from rural areas)] / (avg. life)
- Applying 80/20 rule to estimate figures that are not commonly known



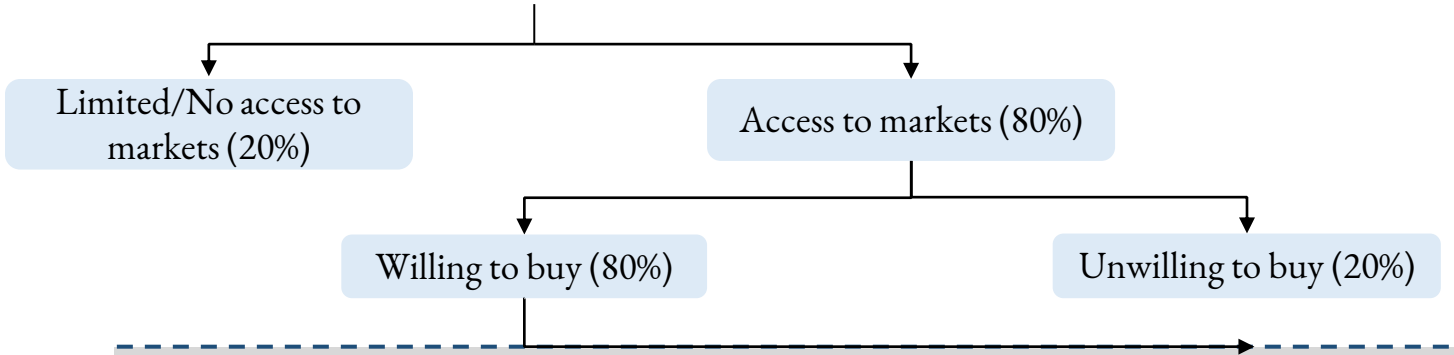
To filter down to target population, See the need, accessibility, affordability, preference for tractors



Cont. on next slide:-

Tractors in India (Part 2)

Estimate the number of tractors sold per year in India



Final Calculation

Number of tractors

= [# of tractors in rural areas + # of tractors in urban areas (10% of figure from rural areas)] / (avg. life)

= [(# of tractors in rural area) * 1.1] / 5

= [(26 cr. *0.7*0.8*0.8*0.2*0.2*0.8*0.8) * 1.1] / 5

= **6.56 lac.**

Area of India = 32.9 lac sq. km
= 32.9 cr. hectares

Arable land ~ 50%
Tractable area ~ 40% of arable area

Average usage of tractor ~ 5 hectares daily
Average 3 weeks of harvest per season

Triangulation & Sanity Check (Area based approach)

Alternate Approach

Number of tractors

= [Area of India * %Arable land * %Tractable area]/[Tractor usage per day * days of harvest]

= [32.9 * 10^7 * 0.5 * 0.4] / [5 * 21]

= **6.27 lac.**

EV Market Size

Estimate the market size of EV in India

Assumptions

- Considering market for only 4 wheeler passenger vehicles.
- Only available in tier 1 cities.
- Premium Car Segment – Price > Rs. 10,00,000.
- Average years a car is used by rich people – 5 years.
- Average years a car is used by middle class – 7 years.
- EV is currently in introduction stage in India, so not considering second hand EV.
- All families in rich sector own a car, 50% middle class families own a car.
- Demographic Divide: Uber Rich = 2%, Middle Class = 38%, Poor = 60%.

Methodology

- Population of 5 major tier 1 cities in India – Approx. 90 million.
- Average household size – 4.5 member/family.
- Poor wont choose a costly EV.
- In middle class, 50% families will have a car. Among them, 80% will buy normal cars, and 20% premium cars.
- In elite class 100% population will have a car, all will be buying premium cars.
- Innovators/Environmentalist among rich - 10%, who will adopt to EV. Innovators/Environmentalist among middle class- 5%, who will adopt to EV.

Tier 1 Cities

Population – 90 million
#families ~ 20 million

Income Spread and product lifecycle factor

Poor

Population = 60%
#families = 12 million
Car buyers = 0

Middle Class

Population = 38%
#families = 7.6 million
Car buyers ~ 50%
Lifecycle ~ 7 years

Uber Rich

Population = 2%
#families = 400,000
Car buyers ~ 100%
All Premium
Lifecycle ~ 5 years

Penetration Factors/Acceptability Factor

Normal Cars

#families ~ 440,000
Average Price = Rs. 6,00,000
Penetration - 5%

Premium Cars

#families ~ 110,000
Average Price = Rs. 22,00,000
Penetration – 5%

Normal Cars

Premium Cars

#families ~ 80,000
Average Price = Rs. 22,00,000
Penetration – 10%

Market Size of electric vehicles = # of normal EV*Avg. cost of non-premium EV + # of premium EV*avg. cost of premium EV
= 22,000*5,00,000 + 13,500*22,00,000 ~ Rs. 40 billion

Flat Screen Televisions

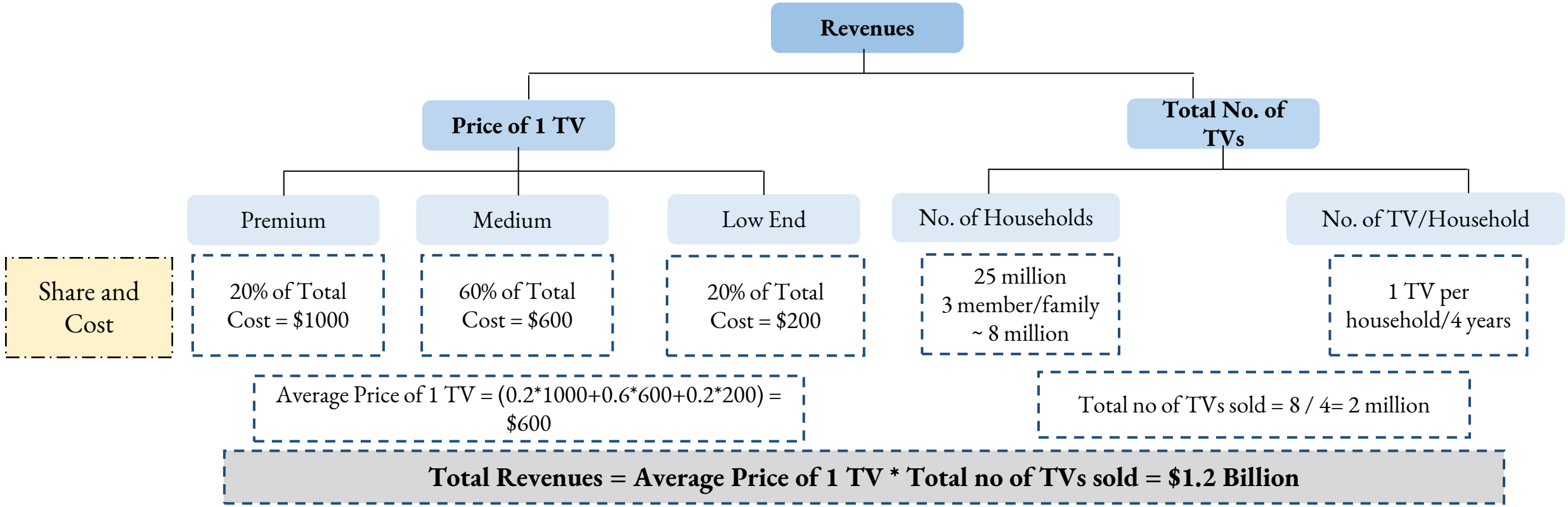
Estimate the revenue of flat screen televisions sold in Australia in the past 12 months

Assumptions

- Population: 25 million people
- Size of average household : 3 people
- Average life of TVs = 4 years
- Average number of TVs / household = 1

Methodology

- No of households = Total Population/Average size of household
- No of TVs per household is considered by taking an average of all the households (Across all categories)
- Calculating the average price of 1 TV, assuming price under each category
- Here we are not considering reused TVs; only **fresh purchases**



Amazon India

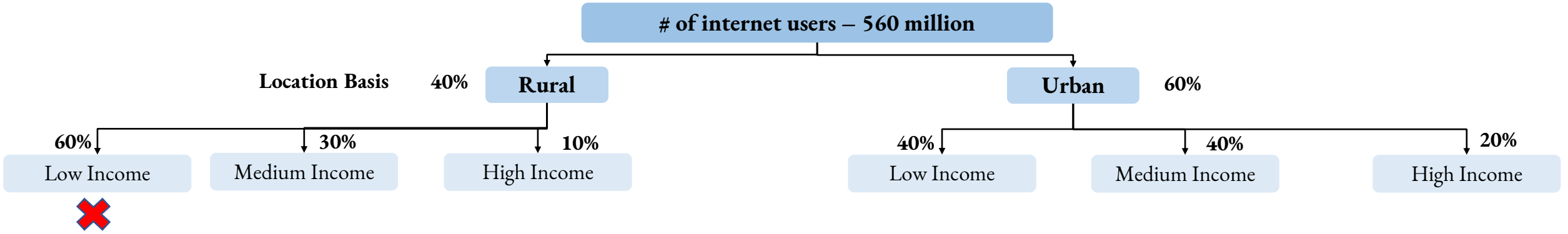
Guesstimate the number of daily orders of Amazon India

Assumptions

- No of mobile users in India – 800 million.
- No. of internet users – 70% of mobile users.
- Urban Internet Users – 60%
- Rural Internet Users – 40%
- Users belong to Age group 10-55.
- Rural low income group's buying pattern is negligible.

Methodology

- Population of India – 1.3 billion. No of mobile users – 800 million.
- Frequency of buying varies across age groups and income.
- Considering just the sales of Amazon India, not its grocery or any other chain.
- Amazon has around 35% market share in India e-commerce industry. Flipkart – 45%, rest others.
- Considering 50% of the population is aged below 25 and uniform distribution of population across ages.
- Considering life expectancy of 65 years.



Income Group	Rural – Medium Income			Rural – High Income			Urban – Low Income			Urban – Medium Income			Urban – High Income		
Age	10-25	25-40	40-55	10-25	25-40	40-55	10-25	25-40	40-55	10-25	25-40	40-55	10-25	25-40	40-55
Orders/Yr	2	2	0	4	6	3	2	4	0	4	6	3	9	12	6
Total Orders/day	1.1L	69K	0	73K	69K	35K	2.2L	2.7L	35K	4.4L	4.2L	2L	5L	4.1L	2L

Summing all order values gives the total orders delivered in a day around 30 lacs. Out of this around 35% belongs to Amazon, that would give a figure of around 10 lakh packages per day.

Daily revenue of Airport

Estimate the daily revenue of an airport

Assumptions

1. Considering only the most substantial revenue streams.
2. Assuming that shops pay only a fixed rent.
3. Number of flights per hour is a function of the kind of rush.
4. Assume that the primary revenue source from advertisements are billboards.
5. No. of Flights per hour is a function of the no. of airstrips.

Methodology

- Advertisement Revenue= revenue from billboards & experience areas.
- Area of billboards * price/m2. Assuming Price/m2 is 200 for a day. Assuming 6 experience areas and 75k/day as charge.
- Airline charges: Fixed charges (domestic) : 50k, Fixed charges (international) : 100k.
- Average shop charges = 4000/day; parking charges = 100.
- No of airstrips – 3, Low rush – 1 flight per strip ; Medium – 2 flights per strip High – 4 flights per strip

Revenues of an airport

Airlines

- Fixed Fees
  - Domestic
  - International
  - = # airlines* fees/airline
  - = 10 * 50000 = 5 lacs
  - = 15*100000 = 15 lacs
- Per Landing revenues
  - Domestic
  - International

Flights	Domestic	Int.
# flights	297	99
Flights/hr	2500	7500
Total	7.425	7.425

Shops

of shops x Rent/shop

250*4000 = **10 lacs**

Rush Hour	Low	Medium	High
Hours	6	6	12
Flights/hr	6	12	24
Flights/day	36	72	288

Parking

of vehicles x Fees/vehicle

of people / people/vehicle (3)

of flights x people/flight

= 396*200/3*100
= 2.64 lacs (Assuming 10% vehicles are parked)

Advertisement

Area of billboards

- Experience Areas
  - Taking 6 experience areas
- Billboards

Type	Small	Medium	Large
Number	500	250	50
Size (sq. ft)	2*2	3*5	8*10
Total	2000	3750	4000
=9750*200 = 19.5 lacs			

= 4.5 + 19.5 =24 lacs

Summing all values gives the total revenue as 20 + 14.85 + 2.64 + 24 = Rs. 61.5 lacs/day.

Automobile Tire Market

What is the size of automobile tire market in India in 2020?

Assumptions

- By size we mean the number of automobile tires
- Consider only 4 wheeler passenger vehicles
- Average household size is 6 for rural and 4 for urban
- Lower income segment don't own cars and Urban high incomes own 2 cars per family,
- Average life of 12 years for cars and 5 years for tires
- Each new car has 5 tires (4 operational + 1 spare)

Methodology

- Total number of 4 wheelers = Number of cars owned by rural + urban households
- Urban and Rural areas to be divided into 3 classes each- High income , Middle income & low income
- Every class will have different proportion of families owning the car
- Total Number of 4-wheelers(N) owned can be divided in New (N/12) and Old (11N/12)
- New cars will have 5 new tires and old cars will have 5 old tires replaced over 5 years

Total Population (1.4 bn)

- **Rural (70%)**
  - High Income (15%)
  - Mid Income (35%)
  - Low Income (50%)
- **Urban (30%)**
  - High Income (30%)
  - Mid Income (50%)
  - Low Income (20%)

#Households	=1.4*0.7*0.15/6 = 24mn	=1.4*0.7*0.35/6 = 57mn	=1.4*0.7*0.5/6 = 81mn	=1.4*0.3*0.3/4 = 31mn	=1.4*0.3*0.5/4 = 52mn	=1.4*0.3*0.5/4 = 52mn
Penetration of 4-wheelers	80%	10%	0%	95%	60%	0%
# 4-wheelers per household	1	1	0	2	1	0

Total #4-wheelers = 115 mn

- **New 4-wheelers ~ 10 mn** → Number of tires per year = 10*5 = 50
- **Old 4-wheelers ~ 105 mn** → Number of tires per year = 105*5/5 = 105

Total # Tires ~ 155mn

Wine Consumption

Estimate the number of bottles of wine consumed in India in a week.

Assumptions

- Rural, older and urban-lower income group people don't consume wine.
- Wine in India is consumed for both drinking and cooking purposes.
- Penetration of wine drinkers in India is 40% of the total alcohol drinkers.
- Wine consumed for cooking purposes would be 5% of the total wine consumed for drinking purpose.

Methodology

- Demand side approach is used
- Number of bottles of wine consumed (drinking) = Number of glass of wine consumed per week/ Number of glasses in an average wine bottle
- Number of glass of wine consumer (per week) = Total wine drinkers * #glasses of wine consumed by an average drinker per week
- Number of bottles of wine consumed = Total bottles of wine consumed for drinking + cooking purposes

Total Population (1.4 bn)

Rural people won't drink wine

Rural (70%)

Urban (30%)

Children (0-19 yrs) (20%)

Older population (65yrs+) (10%)

Working Population (19-65 yrs) (70%)

Lower Income (40%)

Middle Income (40%)

High Income (20%)

70% drink alcohol

90% drink alcohol

#People who drink alcohol (Urban area)	=1.4*0.3*0.7*(0.4*0.7+0.2*0.9) =13mn
% of wine drinkers in India	40%
Total wine drinkers in India	13mn * 0.4 = ~5mn
#Wine Glasses consumed by an average wine drinker	2 glasses/week
#Glass of wine consumed per week in India	~10mn
#Glasses in an average wine bottle	8 glasses

#Bottles of wine consumed for drinking purpose = 1.25mn

#Bottles of wine consumed for cooking purposes = 5%*1.25mn = ~0.05mn

Total #Bottle of wine consumed in India in a week ~1.3mn

Bisleri Water Bottle (Part 1)

Predict the user base of 1 litre Bisleri water bottle in Delhi

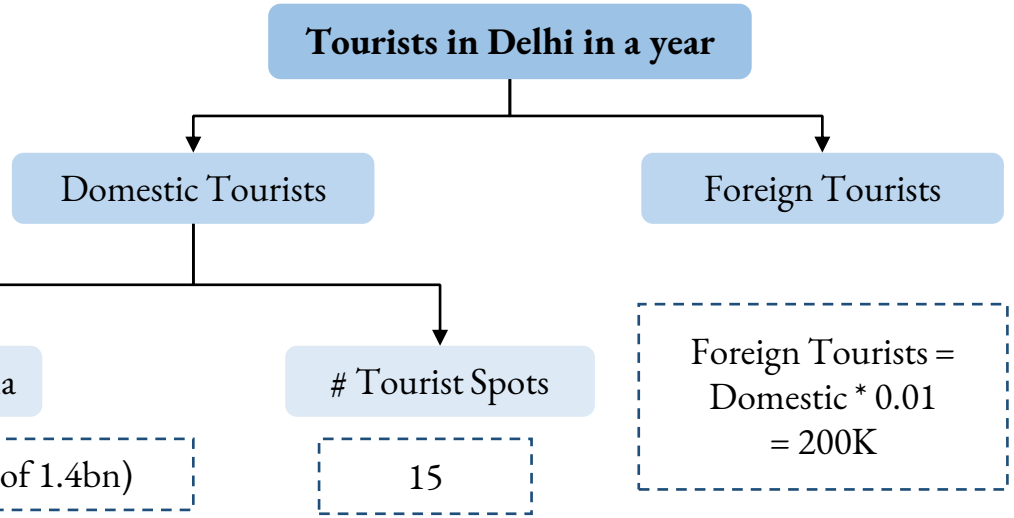
Assumptions

- Yearly tourists will be our potential customer base and restaurants will be potential business that buys Bisleri Bottle
- Tourists and Restaurants are Direct Customers
- Foreign tourists are 1% of domestic tourists in Delhi
- High Income Indians prefer to travel internationally

Methodology

- User Base = Tourists in a year + restaurants in Delhi
- Tourists that Delhi experience in a year = Domestic Tourists + Foreign Tourists
- Domestic Tourists in Delhi = # People who go on trip somewhere in India/# Tourists Spots
- Foreign Tourists = 20% of Domestic Tourists

Income Group	%	Penetration	Total
High	10%	40%	0.04
Medium	30%	80%	0.24
Low	60%	10%	0.06



Percentage of tourists buying mineral water bottle = 50% of Domestic Tourists + 100% of Foreign Tourists
= 0.5*20 million + 200K
= 10.2 million

Percentage of tourists buying Bisleri = 50%

Potential Customer base in a year = 5.1 million

Bisleri Water Bottle (Part 2)

Predict the user base of 1 litre Bisleri water bottle in Delhi

Assumptions

- 3,4,5 Star and Mall restaurants = 50% 1 & 2 star
- Bachelors prefer to order and dine out only during special occasion
- Working Hour of a restaurant = 8

Methodology

- # Restaurants in Delhi = # People who dine out per day/Average daily capacity of a restaurant

Category	%	Penetration	Frequency
Office Goers Parties	30%	50%	Once in 2 weeks
Bachelors	30%	50%	Once a week
Family	20/4	50%	Once a month

Population of Delhi = 20 million

Restaurants in Delhi

- 1 & 2 Star
  - # People who dine out daily
  - Avg. Daily Capacity
- 3, 4 & 5 Star & Mall restaurant

Total = 0.3*0.5*20million/14 + 0.3*0.5*20 million/7 + 5million*0.5*4/30 ~ 980K

Seating capacity * occupancy rate * working hours
= 40*0.4*8 = 96

Total # 3,4, 5 star & Mall restaurant = 0.5*10.2K
= 5.1K

Total # 1 & 2 star restaurant = 980k/96 = 10,200K

Total restaurants in Delhi = 15.3k

User base of Bisleri Water Bottle = Tourists + 50% of all restaurants = 5.1 million tourists & 7,650 restaurants

Sanitizer Demand

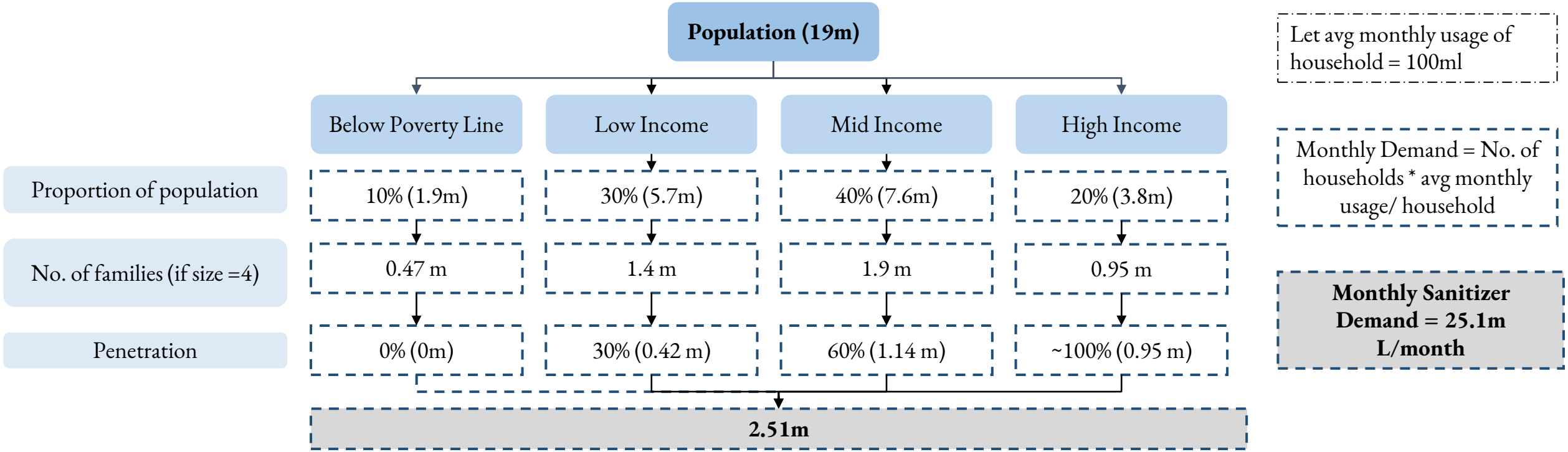
Estimate the amount of sanitizers used in Delhi in a month

Assumptions

- Only personal use sanitizers estimated.
- If a family uses sanitizers, the usage remains same across all income segments. (usage = 100ml/month/family
- Family size remains the same across all income segments (=4)
- Penetration of sanitizers is 0% in below poverty line section of economy as increases as income increases

Methodology

- Amount of sanitizers used = Consumption/ family * number of families using sanitizers
- To estimate number of families using sanitizers, we start with the population of Delhi and divide it into income segments
- Number of families in each segment is calculated
- Based on observation, penetration in each segment is decided and then number of families using sanitizers in each segment is estimated
- Number of families is multiplied by average consumption to get the sanitizer demand in a month



Let avg monthly usage of household = 100ml

Monthly Demand = No. of households * avg monthly usage/ household

Monthly Sanitizer Demand = 25.1m L/month

BCom(H) Admissions in DU

Estimate the number of BCom (H) admissions in DU

Assumptions

- Equal number of Tier 1, 2 & 3 colleges offering BCom
- 80 colleges under DU, 70% offers BCom
- Tier 1, 2 & 3 colleges reserves 80%, 60% and 40% of their BCom seats respectively for BCom (H) admissions
- Less number of seats will remain vacant in top tier colleges at the end of admission cycle

Methodology

- DU colleges are to be divided into 3 categories – Tier 1, Tier 2 and Tier 3 colleges
- Total number of BCom (H) admissions = Number of students in Tier 1 + Tier 2 + Tier 3 colleges
- Number of admissions in a college = Total #seats * % seats reserved for specific course * {1-% seats that will remain vacant}
- There are two different courses offered under BCom – BCom (Honors) & BCom (Program)
- Top tier colleges will have more BCom (H) seats as compared to the other tier colleges

Colleges offering BCom(H) (80*0.6)

- **Tier 1 (16)**
- **Tier 2 (16)**
- **Tier 3 (16)**

#BCom Seats	=16*500 = 8000	=16*500 = 8000	=16*500 = 8000
% of BCom (H) seats	80%	60%	40%
% of vacant BCom (H) seats at the end of admission cycle	5%	15%	20%

Total #BCom seats = 24000

- **BCom (H) seats (Tier 1) ~ 6400** → **Number of students = 6400*0.95 = ~6080**
- **BCom (H) seats (Tier 2) ~4800** → **Number of students = 4800*0.85 = ~4080**
- **BCom (H) seats (Tier 3) ~3200** → **Number of students = 3200*0.8 = ~2560**

Total #BCom (H) students ~ 12,720

Credit Cards Issued

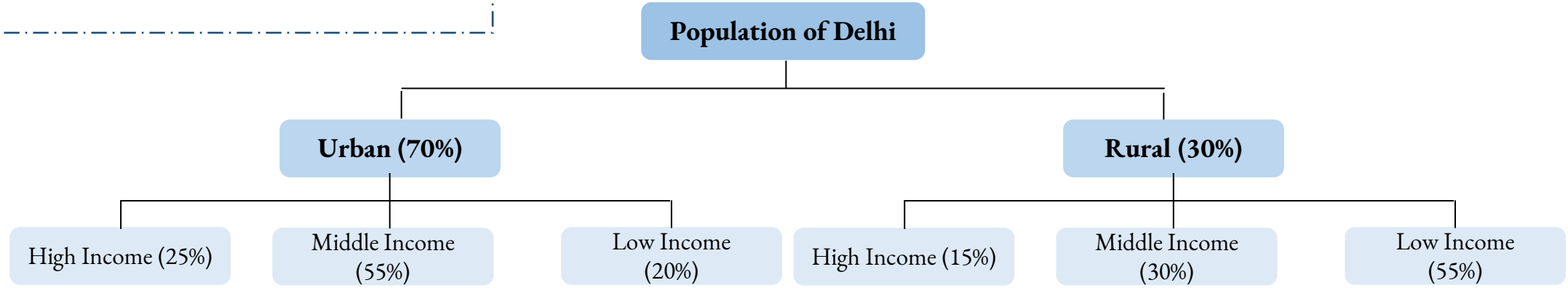
Estimate the number of credit cards issued in Delhi per annum

Assumptions

- Population of Delhi : 20 million
- Size of average household : 4 people
- Average life of card = 3 years
- Average number of cards / household = 1
- High income and Middle income groups of Urban population and High income group of Rural population own credit cards

Methodology

- No of households = Total Population/Average size of household
- No of cards per household is considered by taking an average of all the households (Across all categories)
- Considering that all households of high income group of rural population own a card would compensate for multiple cards in households of high income group of urban population.
- Considering only upper middle income group of urban population owning cards, we take 50% of the middle income segment for simplicity.



Population owning credit cards
= 20 million [0.70 (0.25 + 0.55 * 0.50) + 0.30 (0.15)]
= 8.25 million

4 member/family
So, 8.25/4
=2.0625

1 card works for 3 years
So, 2.0625/3
=0.6875

Total Credit cards issued in Delhi per annum = 687500

Revenue of Dream 11

Assuming Dream11 is starting its business in India (2018), Estimate its total possible revenue in the first year

Assumptions

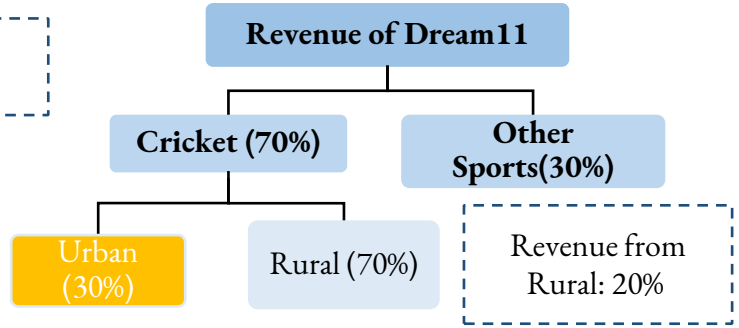
- 70% of total revenue is generated by cricket
- No other competitor are present in the online fantasy gaming sector
- Focus is more on the urban market as it's the first year of business

Methodology

- We start with calculating the revenue from cricket and will adjust for other sports in the end
- Filters for geography (urban & rural), gender, sports viewership, cricket viewership, digital payments and frequency of usage are utilized to arrive at the final numbers
- The calculated value for urban (cricket) is extrapolated to include all sports and demography

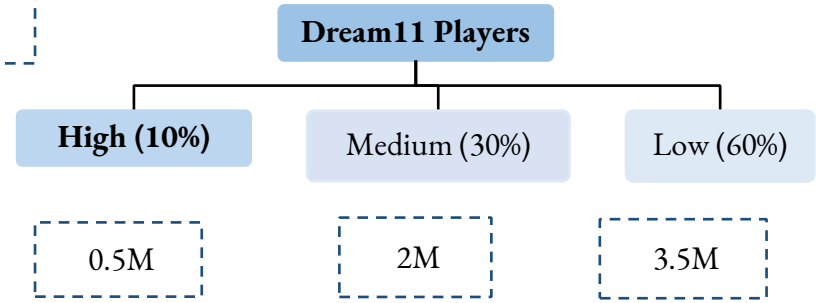
population 400 M

Revenue from Urban: 80%



Dream11 players 6 M

Frequency



Age	18-25 (15%)		26-40 (20%)		40+ (%0%)	
	Male 30M	Female 30M	Male 40M	Female 40M	Male 100M	Female 100M
% watch sports	60% 18M	40% 12M	50% 20M	30% 12M	40% 40M	20% 20M
% watch cricket (70%)	13M	8M	14M	8M	30M	14M
% Use digital payments	70% 9M	70% 6M	80% 11M	80% 6M	50% 15M	50% 7M
% play fantasy sports	20 % 2M	15% 1M	15% 1.5M	10% 0.5M	5% 0.8M	-

# bets placed	60/year	48/year	18/year
Avg. value per bet	500	250	100

Total Revenue from cricket (urban) = 4530 Cr

Total Revenue accounting all demography and sports = 8090 Cr

Revenue of Pickpocket

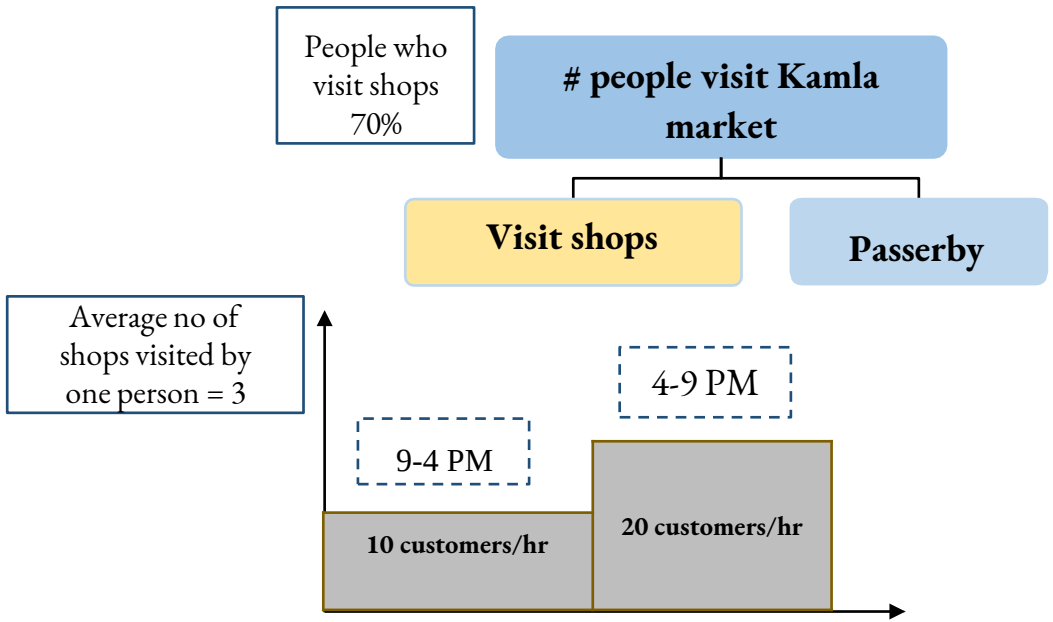
Estimate the earnings of a pickpocket working in the market area of a metropolitan city

Assumptions

- The pickpocket operates only in one market
- 70% of people visiting the market visit at least one shop
- Customer count per shop is considered constant for ease of calculation but could be segregated further.

Methodology

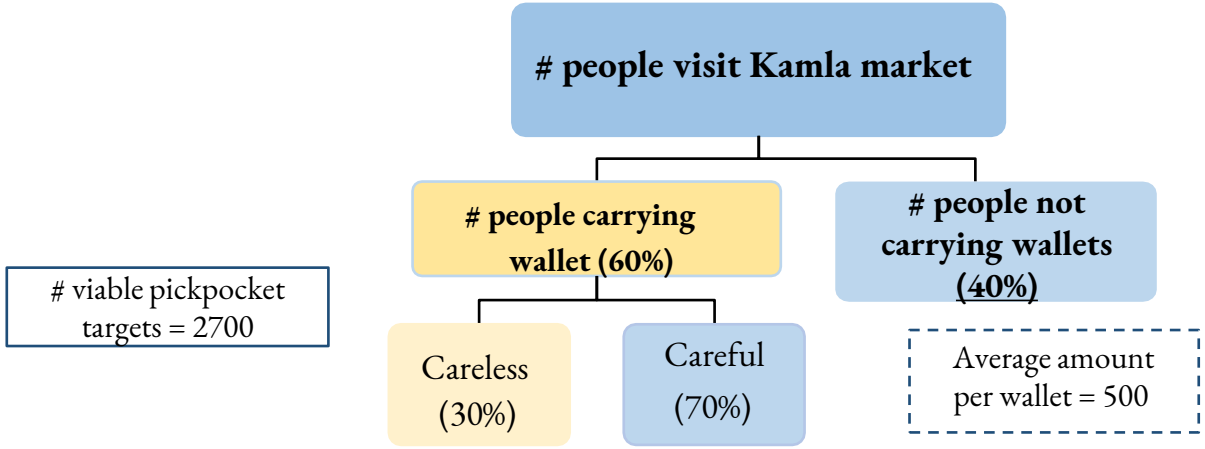
- We start with calculating the total number of people present in the market at any time based on shop timings and customer count.
- Further we segregate the customers based on the number of people who carry wallets and pickpockets success frequency.
- Finally an average wallet value is used to calculate the total revenue of the pickpocket.



Total number of people = (No of shops)*(customers per shops)/(Avg. no of shops visited by one person)

#people in the market who visit shops = 150*200/3 = 10000

Accounting for 30% of people who are passerby = 10/7 * 10000 = 14000



Revenue (day) = (# viable targets)*(% attempted (3%))*(% successful (10%))*(Avg. amount per wallet)

Revenue = 2500

Number of Movie Screens

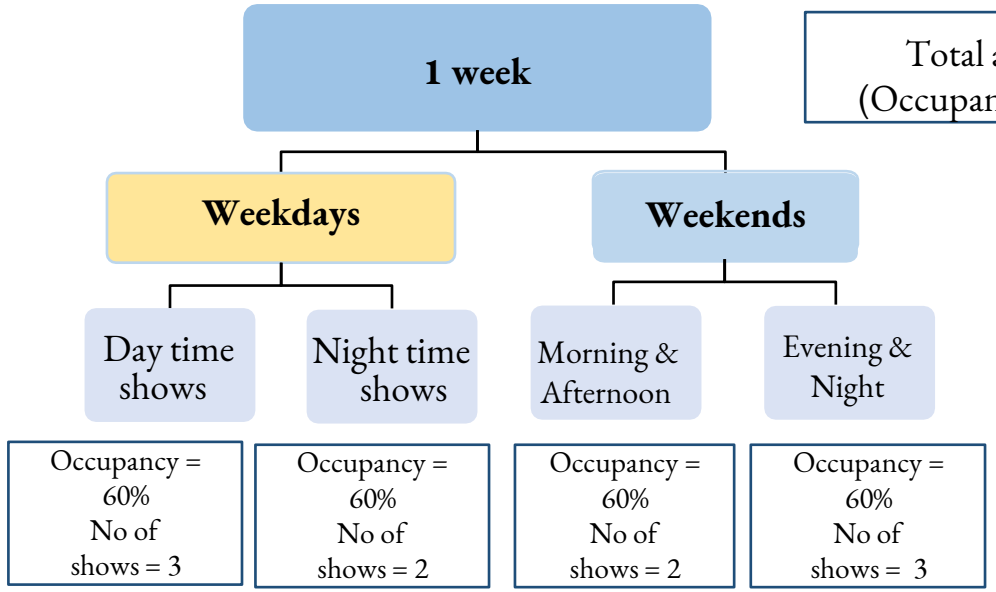
Estimate the number of movie screens in Delhi

Assumptions

- No of seats in a screen is 300
- Operational hours in a day = 15 hours
- 1 show during morning, afternoon, and evening
- 2 shows during night time
- Frequency of a movie buff is 4 and casual watchers is 1 movie per month

Methodology

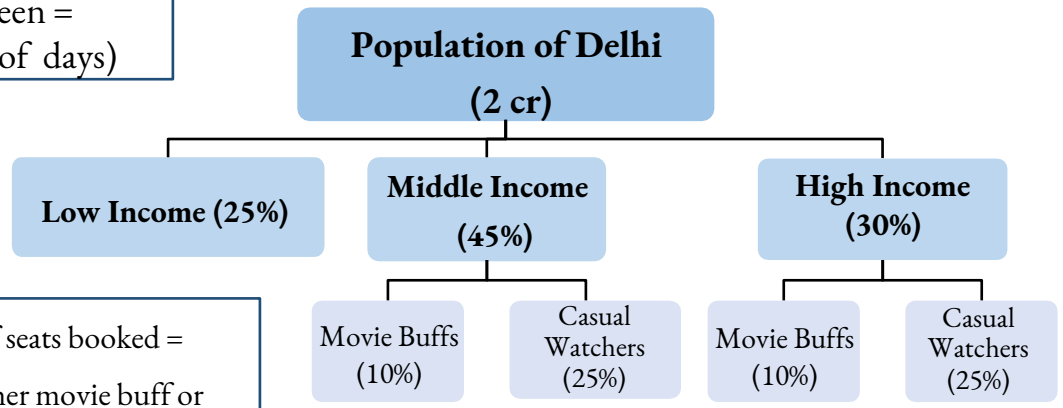
- We start by splitting the population into income groups
- Further we segregate the people into movie buffs and casual watchers
- We calculate the number of people watching movies on a single screen
- Using the total number of movie watchers in a month we can identify the number of movie screens required to cater to the demand.



For a month one screen can cater to 32000 seats

Total audience catered by a screen = (Occupancy)*(No of shows)*(No of days)

Total number of seats booked = (No of people either movie buff or casual watchers)*(Frequency)



Total no of seats booked (Middle income + High income) = (90L*10%*4 + 90L*25%*1) + (60L*10%*4+60L*25%*1) = 97.5L

No of Screens = 97.5L/32000 = 300 screens

Petrol Consumption

Estimate the quantity of petrol used per day (in litre) for transportation in NCR

Assumptions

- Diesel and CNG is used by public transport and commercial
- vehicle (busses, vans, and trucks)
- Average distance traveled by each vehicle (per day) = 20 km
- Mileage (in km/liter) : 2-Wheeler = 50, 4-Wheeler = 10

Methodology

- Calculate the Number of households
- Calculate Vehicles per household.
- Calculate the consumption by each vehicle.
- Scale up the consumption to the entire population

Average no. of vehicles possessed by households

Vehicle	BPL	Low Income	Middle Income	High Income
2 wheelers	0	0.5	1	1.5
4 wheelers	0	0	1	2

Total number of vehicles

Vehicle	BPL	Low Income	Middle Income	High Income
2 wheelers	0	15 lakh	15 lakh	4.5 lakh
4 wheelers	0	0	15 lakh	6 lakh

Population of NCR (2cr)

Average members per household = 5

Total # of Households = 60L

- **BPL (20%) = 2L**
- **Low Income (50%) = 30L**
- **Middle Income (25%) = 15L**
- **Upper Income (5%) = 3L**

Vehicle	Distance Travelled (km)	Litres of Fuel Used (Distance/Mileage)
2 wheelers	20*(15,00,000 + 15,00,000+ 4,50,000) = 6,90,00,000	13,80,000
4 wheelers	20*(15,00,000 + 6,00,000) = 4,00,00,000	40,00,000

Total Fuel Used = 53,80,000 Litres

Assuming the 20% consumption is of diesel, Petrol Used in NCR (by NCR People) is 0.8 * 53,80,000 = 43,04,000

Assuming 10% of the consumption is by non-residents of Delhi, the quantity of petrol used per day (in liter) for transportation in Delhi

= **1.1 * (43,04,000) ≈ 48,00,000 Litres**

Swiggy Drivers

Estimate the number of Swiggy drivers in Mumbai

Assumptions

- Lower income strata not considered for analysis
- Market share of Swiggy = 45%
- 1 order is delivered by a driver in 30 minutes during peak hours (from restaurant to delivery location)
- The order requirement during peak hours is double the normal hour

Methodology

- No. of Swiggy drivers would be the number required to deliver orders during the peak hours
- Let no. of orders = Population x Smartphone penetration x Internet penetration x Market share of Swiggy x Frequency of orders

Population of Mumbai 2 crore

Income	Upper Income (10%)	Middle Income (40%)	Lower Income (50%)
	20L	80L	1 crore

Income Segment	Smartphone Penetration	Internet Penetration	Online food delivery	Total
Upper Income	100%	100%	70%	14L
Middle Income	80%	80%	40%	20.4L ~20L
Lower Income	40%	10%	1%	4,000

Total # of people preferring online food delivery = 34L

Total No. of people using Swiggy for ordering food = 34L * 45% = 15.3L ~ **15L**

Swiggy Users (15L)

High Order Frequency (2%)	Medium Order Frequency (20%)	Low Order Frequency (78%)
0.3L	3L	11.7L
10 orders per week	5 orders per week	1 order per week

Total # of orders per week = (0.3x 10 + 3 x 5 + 11.7 x 1.5) = 35.55L

of orders/ hr = 51/18*7 = 28.2K

Order during peak hours = ~56 K

of drivers required to meet this demand = Peak orders/ Orders delivered by a driver in 1hr

Total No. of Swiggy drivers = 28K

Delhi Metro Passengers

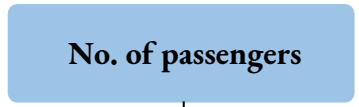
Estimate the number of passengers in Delhi Metro per day for yellow line

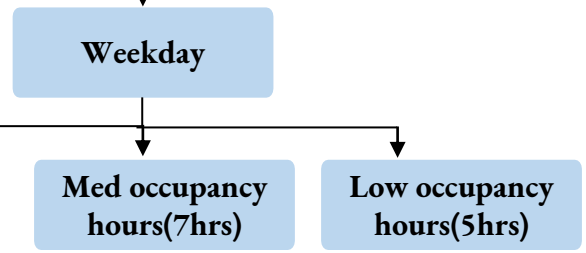
Assumptions

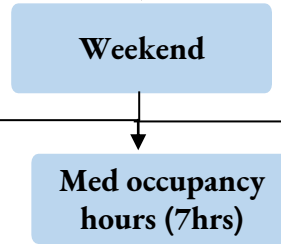
- Hours of operations of Delhi metro is from 5:30 AM to 11:30 PM Capacity per coach is 50 and no. of coaches is 6.
- If time interval between two trains is 2 min for one direction, for both directions, it would 1 min

Methodology

- We will use a bottom up approach to find the number of passengers/coach and extrapolate it to find no. of passengers/day.
- No. of passengers per day = #. of passengers/hr * Hours of operations/ day
- No. of passengers per hour= # of metro trains/ hr * no. of coaches * capacity/coach* % occupancy







	High occupancy hours (6hrs)	Med occupancy hours(7hrs)	Low occupancy hours(5hrs)	High occupancy hours(3hrs)	Med occupancy hours (7hrs)	Low occupancy hours (8hrs)
Occupancy %	150 %	100 %	40 %	120 %	90 %	30 %
Frequency of trains / min	1	2/3	1/2	1	2/3	1/2
# of passengers	60*50*6*1.5 =27K	40*50*7*1 =14K	30*50*5*0.4 =3K	60*50*3*1.2 =10.8K	40*50*7*0.9 =12.6K	30*50*8*0.3 =3.6K
# of Passengers/day	= (44*5+27*2)/7 = 39.1K ~39K					

Total No. of Delhi Metro passengers per day in yellow line = 39K

Toothbrushes

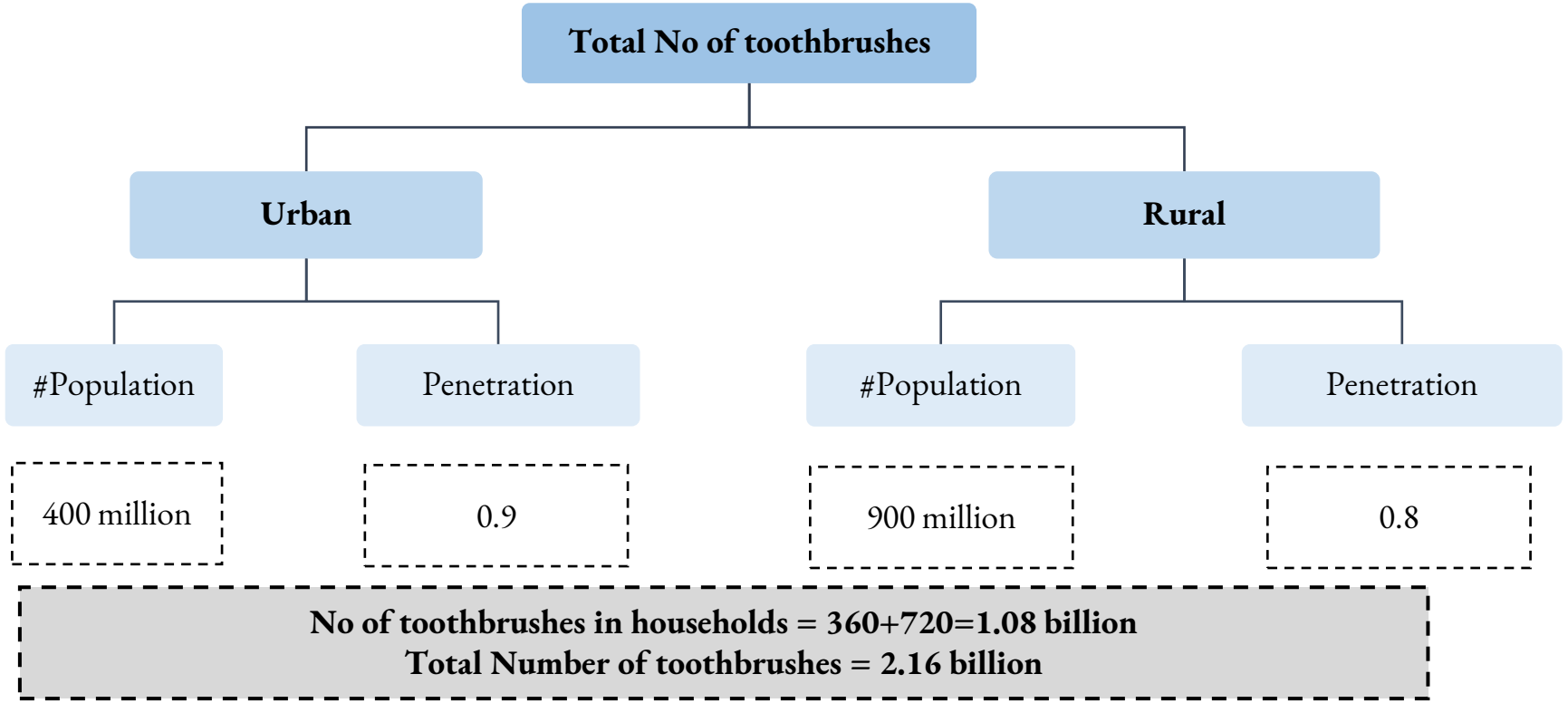
If a UFO sucked all the toothbrushes in India, how many would it have?

Assumptions

- Toothbrush penetration-90% urban and 80% rural
- Replacement frequency- 2 months Urban; 4 Months Rural

Methodology

- Total no of toothbrushes = No of toothbrushes in Households + No of toothbrushes in supply chain(retailers/distributors)
- No of toothbrushes in the supply chain can be assumed to be equal to 1 replacement cycle.
- Therefore just double the no of toothbrushes in households to account for the total number.



Distance Travelled by Q-Comm Drivers

Estimate the daily distance travelled by the drivers of Zepto, a quick commerce delivery platform in Delhi.

Assumptions

- Only the distance travelled for orders is counted
- Not all Areas are serviceable. So it's assumed that 70% of area is only serviceable
- Households are considered as majority of quick commerce orders are grocery orders and are ordered by households
- Average size of household (including families, bachelors co-living) is assumed to be 4
- Low income group are exempted
- Users are further classified into 3 categories on the basis of weekly orders

Methodology

- We start by splitting the population into households and then into income groups
- Respective penetration percentages are multiplied to obtain the figure of service addressable market
- The total users are further segregated on the basis of order frequency which is in terms of weekly orders
- Then the total weekly order is further simplified to daily orders and multiplied by zepto market share to obtain zepto's share of daily orders. Then its multiplied by average distance per order to obtain daily distance travelled by zepto drivers

Formula : Daily distance travelled = (daily orders) * (average distance travelled per order)

Households in Delhi
20 Mn / 4 = 5 Million

Serviceable households
= 70%*5= 3.5 Million

- **Low income (30%)**
- **Middle income (50%)** → Quick commerce users (60%)
- **High income (20%)** → Quick commerce users (90%)

Total quick commerce users= 3.5 Mn (50%*60% + 20%*90%) = 1.68 Mn

Total users
1.68 million₹

- **Frequent users (30%)** — **3 orders / week**
  Frequent users weekly orders = 30% of total users * 3 = 1.51
- **Normal users (30%)** — **2 orders / week**
  Normal users Weekly orders = 30% Of total users * 2 = 1
- **Rare users (40%)** — **1 order/ week**
  Rare users weekly orders = 40% of total users * 1 = 0.67

Total weekly orders = 1.51 + 1 + 0.67 = 3.18 Mn

=> Daily quick commerce orders = 3.18 / 7 = 0.45 Mn

Market share of Zepto = 20 %

=> So, Total zepto orders delivered daily = 0.09 million

Average distance travelled per order = 5 kms

So, daily distance travelled by zepto drivers
= 5 * 0.09 Mn kms
= 0.45 Lakh kms

Mutual Fund Market in India

Estimate the market size of mutual funds in India.

Assumptions

- Percentage of savings is assumed
- Percentage of portfolio in riskier investments is assumed
- Income wise willingness to invest in mutual funds is assumed

Methodology

- Dividing population into urban rural
- Further into income class
- Taking average savings for each class and % of portfolio with riskier investments. Also taking into account the risk appetite of investors

Population of India

Urban (30%)

Rural (70%)

	Urban: High Income (25%)	Urban: Middle Income (55%)	Urban: Low Income (20%)	Rural: High Income (15%)	Rural: Middle Income (30%)	Rural: Low Income (55%)
Average Income	20L	5L	3L	15L	5L	1L
Savings %	50%	40%	20%	50%	40%	20%
% of portfolio with Riskier Investments	70%	50%	10%	10%	5%	Nil

Income Segment	High Risk Takers(40% allocation to Mutual Funds)	Medium Risk Takers(60% allocation to Mutual Funds)	Low Risk Takers(90% allocation to Mutual Funds)
Upper Income (Population %)	50%	30%	20%
Middle Income (Population %)	30%	50%	20%
Lower Income (Population %)	20%	40%	40%

Calculations

Urban

High Income- 140*10^7*0.3*0.25*20*10^5*0.5*0.7*(0.4*0.5+0.3*0.6+0.2*0.9)= 41 trillion

Middle Income- 140*10^7*0.3*0.55*5*10^5*0.4*0.5*(0.4*0.3+0.5*0.6+0.2*0.9)=13 trillion

Lower Class- 140*10^7*0.3*0.2*3*10^5*0.2*0.1*(0.4*0.2+0.4*0.6+0.4*0.9)- 3 trillion

Rural

High Income- 140*10^7*0.7*0.15*15*10^5*0.5*0.1*(0.4*0.5+0.3*0.6+0.2*0.9)= 6 trillion

Middle Income- 140*10^7*0.7*0.3*5*10^5*0.4*0.05*(0.4*0.5+0.3*0.6+0.2*0.9)=1.5 trillion

Total=**INR 64.5 Trillion**

Number of Car Tyres in Delhi

Estimate the number of car tyres in Delhi

Assumptions

- No of tyres in a car are 5 - 4 operational and 1 spare
- Lower Middle have 0.4, Upper middle have 0.8, Upper Class have 1.8 and HNIs have 3 cars per family. Ignoring Lower Income Groups altogether.
- Average size of a family is 4
- Only people residing in Delhi are considered.
- Scrap and yet-to-be sold cars aren't considered.

Methodology

- We start by splitting the population into income groups. This is done to estimate the number of cars
- Further we segregate the middle income groups into lower middle class and upper middle class. Similarly, we segregate the High Income groups into Upper class and HNIs
- We calculate the number of families owning a car. Hence, finding out the total number of cars.
- Using the total number of cars in the territory, we can calculate the total number of tyres that are present in Delhi

Population of Delhi (To calculate Personal Vehicles) (3 cr)

- **Middle Income (45%)**
  - Lower Middle (70%) → Number of Cars = 3 Crore* 0.45*0.7* 0.4/4 = 9.45 Lakh
  - Upper Middle (30%) → Number of Cars = 3 Crore* 0.45*0.3*0.8/ 4 = 8.1 Lakh
- **High Income (15%)**
  - Upper (90%) → Number of Cars = 3 Crore* 0.15*0.9*1.8/4 = 18.225 Lakh
  - HNIs (10%) → Number of Cars = 3 Crore* 0.15*0.1*3/4 = 3.375 Lakh

Total Cars in a group = (Population of Delhi)*(Percentage of Group)*(Percentage of Sub-Group)*(Cars per Family)/(Family Size)

Total number of families= Total number of people in a particular subgroup/(Family Size)

Number of Cars in Delhi

- **Personal Vehicles**
- **Private Vehicles (Taxis)**

Assuming that 10% of the people owning personal vehicle use taxis daily. Dividing that by the number of average trips one taxi makes in a day(i.e 10). We will get the number of taxis in Delhi.

{(Population Group)*0.1/10 = 1.79 Lakh}

Total no of tyres (Middle income Cars + High income Cars + Taxi Cars)*5

= (9.45 + 8.1 + 18.225 + 3.375 + 1.79)*5 ≈ 2.05 crore

No of Tyres ≈ 2.05 Crores

ATM Withdrawals

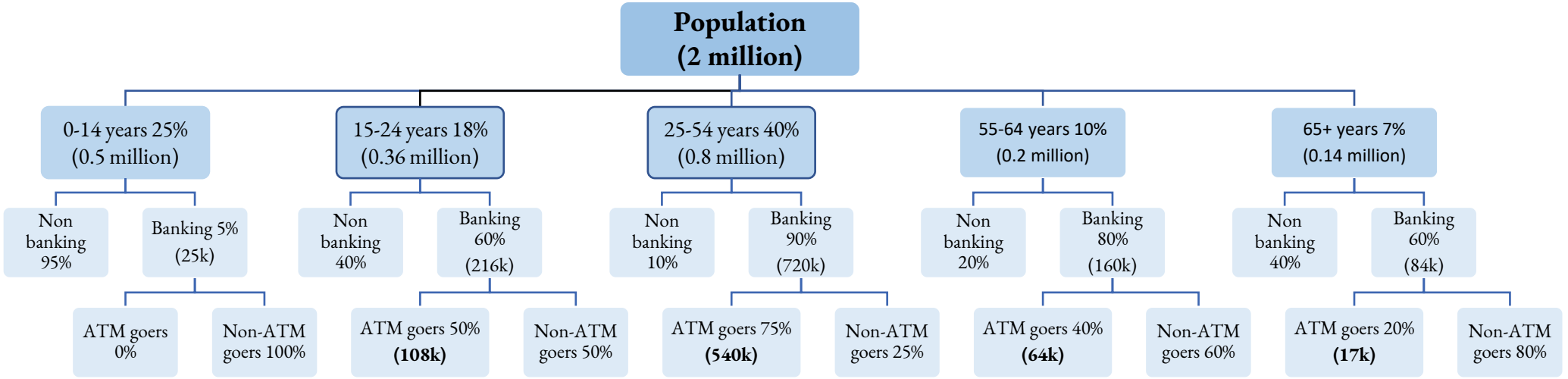
Estimate the number of ATM withdrawals made in a Tier 2 Indian city in a month

Assumptions

- Tier 2 cities like Indore, Lucknow, Kochi have a population of 2 million
- The people who use an ATM, use it every month

Methodology

- Top-down approach
- Start with the city population. Find the banked population. Find the proportion of the banked population who use ATM. Multiply by the frequency of withdrawals to get total monthly withdrawals.



Frequency of Withdrawals

Age brackets	Frequency
15-24	1.5
25-54	2.5
55-64	2
65+	1

Monthly withdrawals

108k x 1.5 = 162k
540k x 2.5 = 1350k
64k x 2 = 128k
17k x 1= 17k

Total ATM withdrawals in a tier 2 city in a month = 16.6 lakh

Dog Food

Estimate the amount of dog food consumed in India

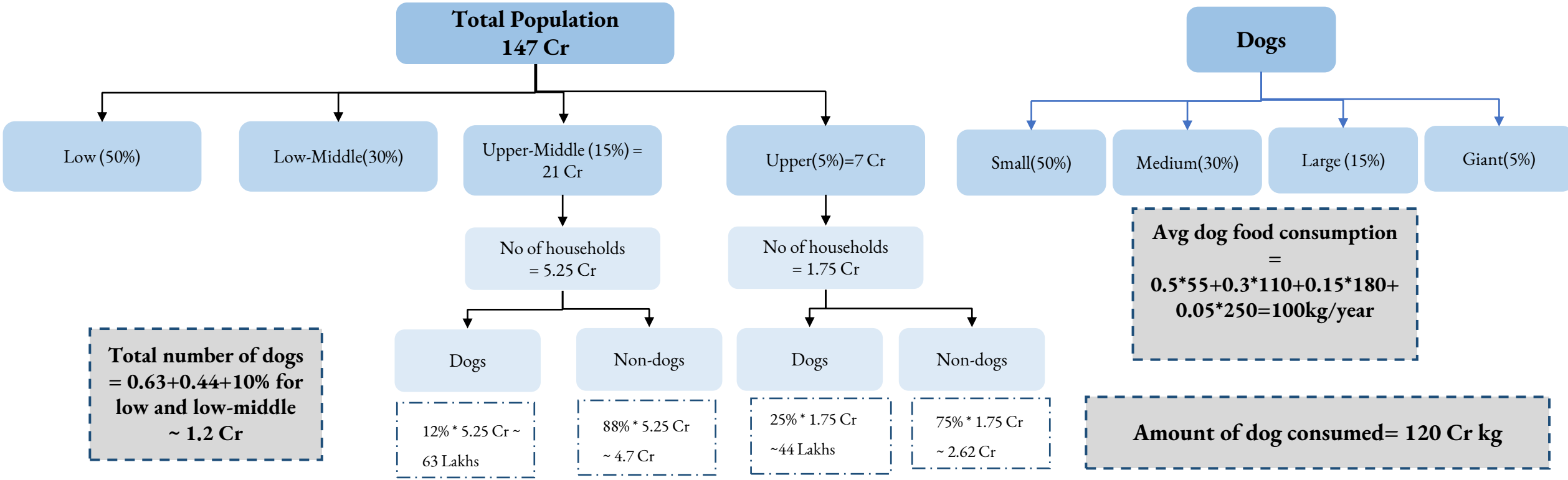
Assumptions

Average annual food consumption by dog type:

- Small – 55 kg/year
- Medium – 110 kg/year
- Large – 180 kg/year
- Giant – 250 kg/year

Methodology

- Amount of dog food consumed = Total number of dogs * dog food consumption per dog
- Segment total population into income categories
- Apply dog ownership % to estimate number of dogs per segment
- Determine total number of dogs in India
- Apply size-based weight distribution and average food consumption



Daily Milk Production in Odisha

Estimate the daily Milk production in the state of Odisha

Assumptions

- Population: 4 Cr million people
- Size of average household : 5 people
- Only Milk from cows to be considered produced at farmer's end
- Only rural farmers own cattle
- Ownership of cattle varies across income segments: Lower (10%), Middle(30%) and Upper (50%)
- Cattle numbers varies across income segments : Lower – 1, Middle – 3, Upper – 8/family

Methodology

- Supply side approach is considered as Odisha is relatively a backward state
- Only Milk produced at farmers end is considered, co-operative dairies are not present in Odisha
- Milk Produced/day = (# of cows in state) x (Milk Produced per cow) x (% of Cows lactating at any given time)
- # of Cows = # of Cows owned by Rural Families + # of Cows owned by Urban Families

Milk Production/ day

- # of Cows
  - **Urban(30%)** — 30% of 80 Lakhs = 24 Lakh Families
  - Rural(70%) — 70% of 80 Lakhs = 56 Lakh Families
    - Non – Agri Based(35%)
    - Agri Based(65%) — 65% of 80 Lakhs = 36.4 Lakh Families
      - Lower Income(40%) — 40% of 36.4 * 10% * 1 Cow/ Family = 1.456 Lakhs
      - Middle Income(40%) — 40% of 36.4 30% * 3 Cow/Family = 13.104 Lakhs
      - Upper Income(10%) — 10% of 36.4 50% * 8 Cow/Family = 14.56 Lakhs
- Milk Produced/Cow(4.5L/day)
- % of Cows Lactating at any given time(50%)

Milk Production /Day = # of Cows * Milk Produced/Cow(4.5L/day) * % of Cows Lactating at any given time(50%)
= (1.456 + 13.104 + 14.56)* 4.5* 50%
= 65.52 Lakh/ L per day

Number of hotel rooms

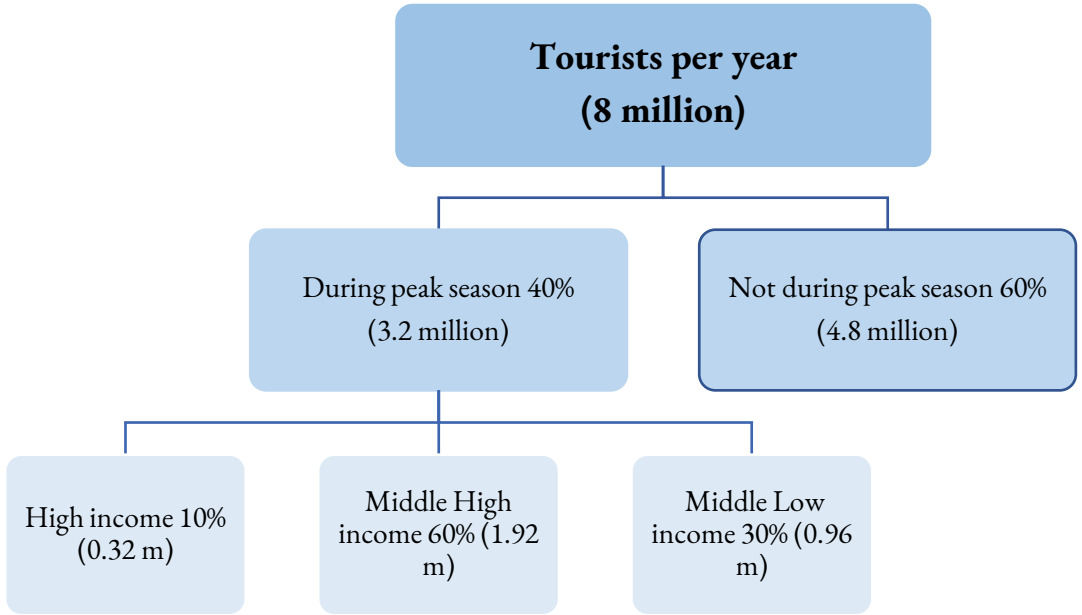
Estimate the number of hotel room nights booked in Goa during peak season

Assumptions

- Only tourists book hotel rooms
- Peak season is from November to February – 3 months window
- 8 million tourists visited Goa last year
- Average night stay = 4 ; Average of 2 people in a room

Methodology

- Goa tourist arrivals
- Number of tourists needing hotel rooms
- Average stay – room required per night
- Total room nights



Income Group	Avg. Stay	People/Room	Total Room Nights
High	7 nights	1.5	0.32M × 7 ÷ 1.5 ≈ 1.5M
Middle high	4 nights	2.0	1.92M × 4 ÷ 2 = 3.84M
Middle low	3 nights	3.0	0.96M × 3 ÷ 3 = 0.96M

Adding them

1.5m + 3.84m + 0.96m = 6.3 m

Total Room nights during peak season in Goa =6.3 million

Slow-Moving Vehicles in an Airport

Estimate the number of slow-moving vehicles in an airport

Assumptions

- Considering only the most substantial use-cases.
- Number of flights per hour is a function of rush hours and runways.
- Miscellaneous use-cases include non-client uses such as staff movement, crew transfer, medical/emergency support, sanitation, refueling, etc.

Methodology

- Calculate #flights to calculate #passengers to calculate # of passengers requiring slow-moving vehicles for travel.
- From #passengers, calculate #luggage and then #slow-moving vehicles for transferring the luggage.
- Calculate #cargo planes, then divide them basis capacity. Calculate #slow-moving vehicles required to transfer the cargo.
- There are more detailed ways of solving this guesstimate; this approach was followed due to paucity of time.

Slow-moving Vehicles in an Airport

Passenger Movement

Rush Hour	Low	Med	High
Hours	6	6	12
Flights/hr	6	12	24
Flights/day	**36**	**72**	**288**

of passengers = #Runways* #Flights*Avg #Passengers/Flight = 4*400*180 = 288000

Segment	%
Elderly/physically challenged	5%
Premium/VIP/business class	2%
Long-distance gates	8%

#Passengers = 288000*15% = ≈43000

Assuming each cart can carry ≈4 people & each trip takes ≈5 mins, # carts = ≈90

Baggage Movement

Assuming 80% passengers carry bags incl. the people who carry extra bags, # of bags = 288000*80% = 230400

Assuming each carriage can carry ≈1500 kgs., an avg. luggage weighs 15 kgs, and each carriage can carry 100 luggage, every cart can carry 400 luggage.

Check-in closes ≈45 mins. before departure, leaving ≈30 mins for baggage transfer to flight. Assuming each round trip takes 5 mins, 6 trips are possible for each vehicle. # of vehicles reqd. = (23040/100)/6 ≈40

Cargo Movement

Around 1 Mn. tons of cargo gets transported via major airports annually, implying ≈2700 tons of cargo gets transported daily.

Flight Size	Capacity	# Flights
Small	5-10 tons	30
Large	10-50 tons	60

Assuming one cart carries around half a ton (from before), each of them making 2-3 trips per offloading and 2-3 flights landing at similar times, #carts reqd. ≈60

Miscellaneous

For refuelling, assuming it to be around half of the # of flights in a busy hour, # of carts reqd. = 12

For other purposes, assuming it to be around 10% of the # of passengers, # of carts ≈10

Total number of carts = 212. Adding 10% for repairs and maintenance, total number of slow-moving vehicles = 233

LED Bulbs

Estimate the number of LED bulbs sold in Kerala

Assumptions

- Single LEDs are not taken into consideration
- Kerala has 100% rural electrification
- Average LED bulb life is 3 years
- Establishment per people

Retail store and shops	Services	Food and Beverages	Institutions	Offices
1/100	1/200	1/500	1/1000	1/50

Number of establishments

Retail store and shops	Services	Food and Beverages	Institutions	Offices
35m/100	35m/200	35m/500	35m/1000	35m/50

Bulbs per establishments

Retail store and shops	Services	Food and Beverages	Institutions	Offices
4	11	10	20	15

Total number of Bulbs in the establishments

Retail store and shops	Services	Food and Beverages	Institutions	Offices
1.4m	2m	7m	0.7m	10.5m

Methodology

- Find the number of LED bulbs in use both in household and commercially.
- Annual replacement rate = 1/3* number of LED bulbs used
- New sales= 5% of LED bulb used

Population of Kerala (35 million)

Households in Kerala (9 million)

Low income 20% (1.8 million)

Area	Bulbs
1.5 Rooms	1.5
1 Hall	1
1 Toilet	1
1 Kitchen	1
Outdoor	1

5.5 x 1.8 m =10 m

Middle income 60% (5.4 million)

Area	Bulbs
3 Rooms	3
1 Hall	1
2.5 Toilet	2.5
1 Kitchen	1
Outdoor	3

10.5 x 5.4 m =56.7 m

High income 20% (1.8 million)

Area	Bulbs
6 Rooms	1.5
1 Hall	1
7 Toilet	1
1 Kitchen	1
2 Study	2
Outdoor	6

14.5 x 1.8 m =26 m

Household

Number of LED bulbs used= 93 million
Annual replacement rate= 1/3
Bulbs replaced= (1/3 x 93 m)=31 million
New sales= (5% x 93 m)=4.65 million
Total LED bulbs sold= 35.65 million

Commercial

Number of LED bulbs used= 21.6 million
Annual replacement rate= 1/3
Bulbs replaced= (1/3 x 21.6 m)= 7.2 million
New sales= (5% x 21.6 m)= 1 million
Total LED bulbs sold= 8.2 million

Total No. of LED bulbs sold (35.65 m + 8.2 m) = 43.85 million

F1 racing fans in India

Estimate the number of F1 racing fans in India

Assumptions

- Viewer = watched ≥1 race/session in a season, any platform
- India is OTT-led for F1; internet access is the hard gate
- Rural F1 interest is negligible; F1 is premium, English/digital skewed
- 15–34 is the core: young, urban, digital-first fans

Methodology

- Flow: Population → Urban/Rural → Internet access → Age → Sport interest → F1 interest → Viewers
- Use urban online population as detailed base: ~35 Cr
- Effective rate of watching F1 = sport interest × F1 interest × actual watch-rate

India Population
~140 Cr

Urban area
35% ~ 50 Cr

Internet penetration
70% ~ 35 Cr

Rural population
65% ~ 90 Cr

Negligible interest

Age group	No. of people	Like sports	Interested in F1	Watch rate of F1	Effective rate	F1 Viewers
0-14	3 Cr	20%	10%	50%	~1%	~0.3M
15-24	8 Cr	70%	30%	80%	~17%	~13.4M
25-34	8 Cr	70%	30%	75%	~16%	~12.6M
35-44	6 Cr	50%	20%	60%	~6%	~3.6M
45-54	5 Cr	40%	15%	50%	~3%	~1.5M
55+	5 Cr	30%	10%	40%	~1%	~0.6M
TOTAL						**~32M**

Total F1 viewers in India = 32M

Number of slides prepared

Estimate the number of slides prepared by 1st year FMS students in an academic year

Assumptions

- Considering only MBA FT students (300 students)
- Final slides submitted (ignoring the iterations part)
- Assuming no student exchange program
- Ignoring the diverse internship curriculum

Methodology

- Course Work (16 courses- avg 3 credits/course) submission including both individual and group
- Clubs (8 major clubs with max usage from oil task and night task)
- Case competition (assuming 70% participation and 50% success rate)
- Triangulate the total slides prepared to get number of slides/student to get feasibility checks

Key piece involving PPTs

Course Work (16 courses)

	Individual	Group
% courses with projects	30%	50%
% based on PPTs	50%	50%
Avg slides/ course	10 slides	20 slides
# students /groups	300 students	60 groups (5 students/group)
	7.2K slides	4.8K slides

Clubs

Oil Task				Night Task
No. of clubs	Oil task /club	# Students till 3rd list	# Slides/ student	
8	4	150	5 slides/	
24K slides				
Night Task – 20% of Oil Task				4.8K slides

Case Competition

# Students participating (70% = 210)	# Students not participating (30% = 90)

- # Approx no. of teams ~52 (4 students/team)
- # competitions registers ~208 (4 case comps/team)
- # progressing to case round ~50% 104
- 832 slides (6 slides/competition)

Total number of slides prepared: 41,632 slides

Four-Wheelers Sold in India

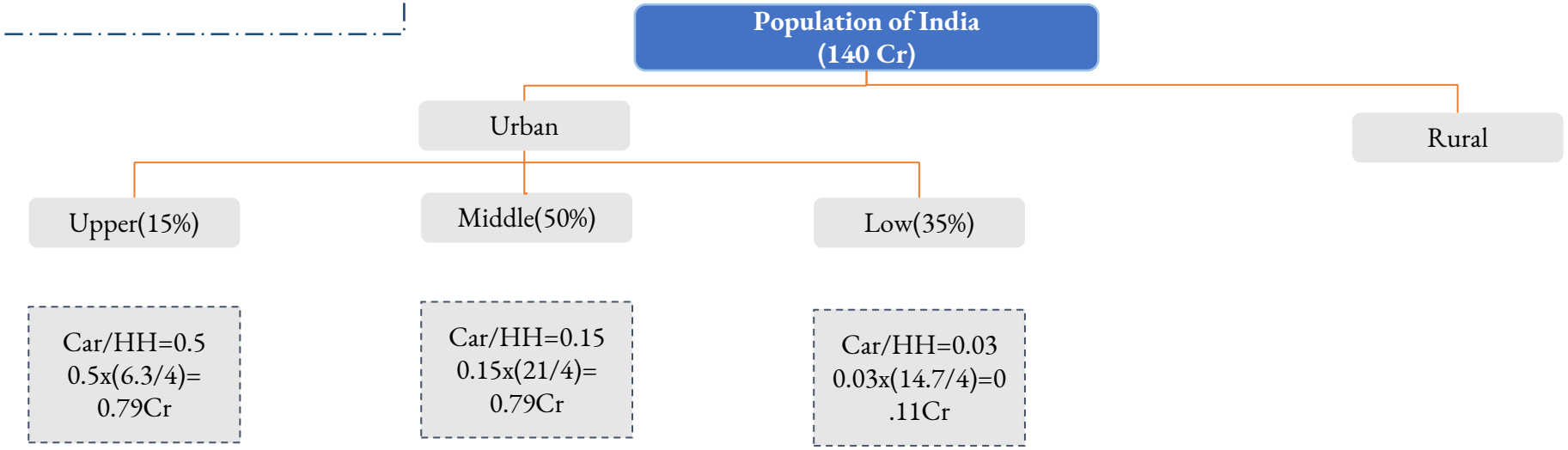
Estimate the number of four-wheeler vehicles sold in India in a year

Assumptions

- Population of India ~140 crore
- Urban : Rural population split = 30% : 70%
- Focus on new car sales (not used-car resale)
- Average vehicle replacement cycle = 5 years

Methodology

- Estimate today's on-road four-wheeler stock via income-segment car ownership across urban population
- Apply an average replacement rate to get replacement demand
- Add first-time buyer demand separately (not just replacement)
- Sum both for total annual sales



Total on-road 4-wheeler stock ≈ 1.7 Cr (urban)
Replacement demand = Stock / 5 yrs = 0.34 Cr
New/first-time buyer demand (~20% of replacement) = 0.07 Cr
Total annual four-wheeler sales ≈ 0.41 Cr (~41 lakh units/year)

Total annual four-wheeler sales ≈ 0.41 Cr (~41 lakh units/year)

Part I – Practice Cases

Main Index

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★ Indicates latest additions/ updates to the casebook

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Profitability

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Apple Orchard Farmer

Your client is a farmer who owns an apple orchard. He has seen reduction in profit in the past year. Find reasons and recommend solutions.

Reiterating the problem statement, our client owns an apple orchard. He has seen reduction in profit in the past last year. I need to find reasons and recommend solutions.

Yes, you are right. Please go ahead!

I would like to know more about our client. Does our client manage only manufacturing or distribution as well? And where is our man

The farmer is located in Northern India and owns 30 acres of land dedicated to apple production only.

Okay! To understand the business better, I would like to know about competitors and their practices, and understand the chain from the farm to final customers.

Although there are no new regulations in the industry, all farmers have been impacted and are having a tough time. I would like you to list out who the members of the chain in this business could be..

That would be my pleasure, Ma'am. I think there would be a system of Distributors to take the produce to the retailers who finally sell it to customers. Or there can be wholesalers as well. But since apples expire after a short duration, I think they would be directly sold to the customers.

That's right. There are no wholesalers and there are 2 distributors in the chain as well.

Okay. Apart from direct consumption in raw form, are there any other usage of apple like juices?

Yes, they are widely used in gifting, candies, sweets, jams and beverages.

That seems to be a really important piece of information for the problem. I think since the company has observed reduction in profits, I would like to break the profit structure into Revenues and Costs. Do you want me to look at any particular component first?

I think you can start with revenues as there hasn't been much changes on the cost side.

Okay. Revenues can be expressed as Price/unit and total units. Have the prices changed in recent?

No, the prices have been fairly constant for past 3-4 years.

Has there been a major change in the supply demand equilibrium recently?

As matter of fact, supply has remained same but the demand is decreasing due to unknown reasons.

Let me analyse the demand from 4 angles: Awareness, Accessibility, Affordability, Acceptability. I would like to know if there have been any major changes in these factors.

That's an impressive way to look at the demand. The farmer is not able to reach the market fluently.

Oh that seems like there is a problem in the accessibility component of the demand. The major stakeholders here are the farmer, distributors, retailers and customers. How are the distributors and retailers performing compared to the previously set benchmark?

There seems to be a falling response from retailers. Can you think of potential reasons for the same?

Sure, Ma'am. I think there can a be wide array of reasons for potential fall in response. I would like to classify them into 2 buckets – Direct Industry and Processing Industry. The direct industry would include Modern Trade, Hotels, Export, Gifting while the processing industry, includes candies, jam & beverages. Are there any particular complains about any particular product line?

Yeah, the apple based beverage industry has been hit because of the false rumours of alcohol present in the drink. The loyal customer base has decided to move away from the beverages as a result.

Well, that's unfortunate. Have there been any steps taken to counter this situation?

Since we couldn't identify the problem earlier, there were no plans in place. Can you suggest some?

Since farmer is running the business on his own and the complete industry is fragmented so a common action is less feasible. We can definitely salvage to sustain. Hence we should try finding other places to sell apples. Maybe export more apples. Assuming apples are unsold, stock apple in cold storages for next year. A far reached solution could be having a detailed test done and publishing results in media.

Those are really helpful suggestions. Thank you for your analysis.

Apple Orchard Farmer

Profitability | Easy | Bain & Co.

Your client is a farmer who owns an apple orchard. He has seen reduction in profit in the past year. Find reasons and recommend solutions.

Case Facts & Notes

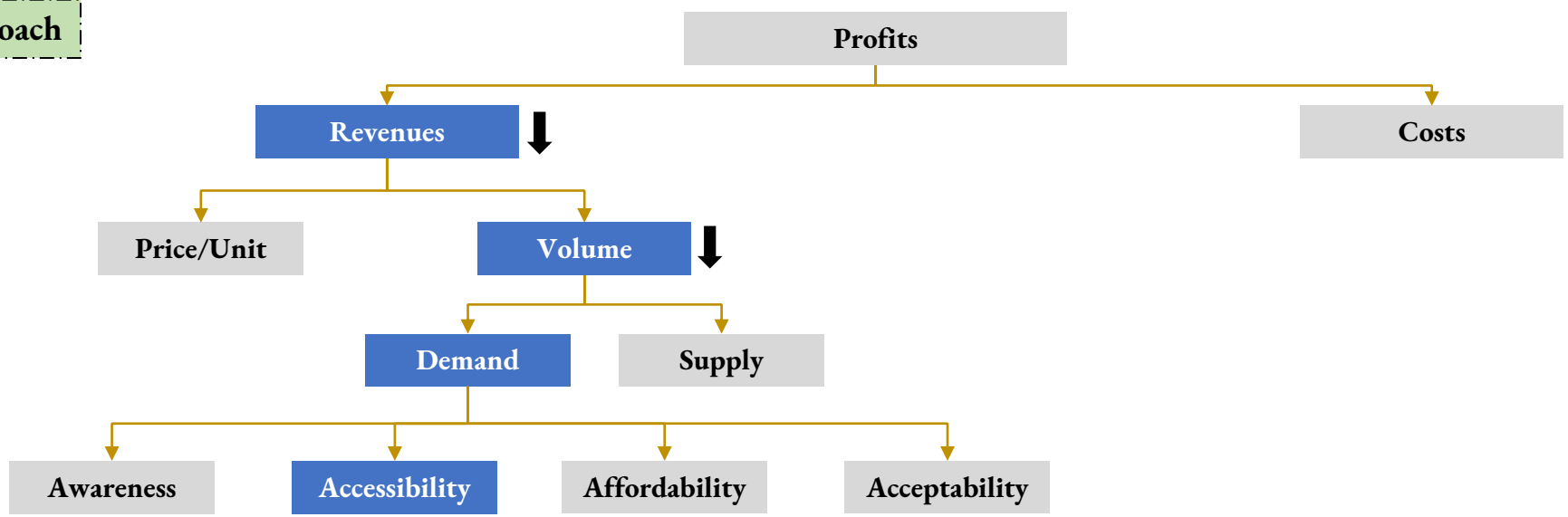
- **Context** - Farmer in north India. Owns 30 acre of land for apple production only.
- **Industry Scenario** – All players in the industry impacted.
- **Change in Regulation** – None
- **Uses** - Gifting, Candies, Sweets, Jams, Beverages
- **Value Chain**

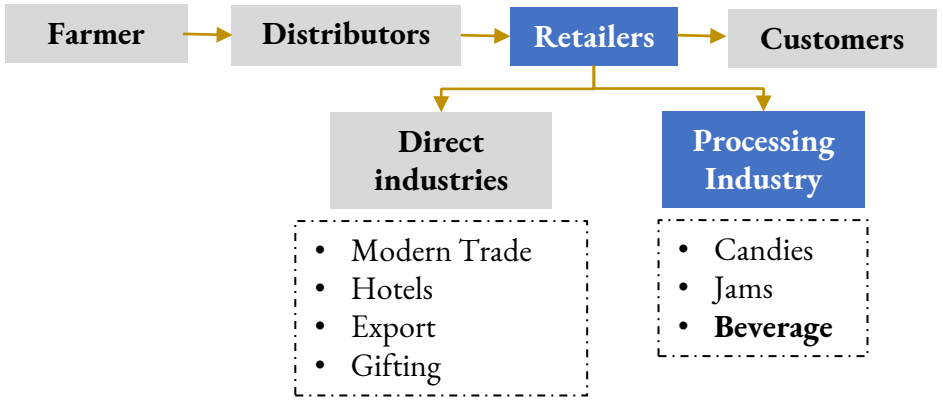
2 Distributors

Retailers

Customers

Approach





Apple based Beverage industry hit

Rumors of alcohol in drink have impacted demand of these beverages.

Recommendations

- Try finding other places to sell apple. Export more apple.
- Since apples are unsold, stock in cold storage for next year.

Retail Chain

A chain of retail stores recently increased the number of stores. However, with increase in the stores, the profitability has dropped.

I would like to clarify a few things before I start analyzing the case.

Sure.

Can you tell me the type of retail stores we are taking about? Where are they located? And the number of stores the chain has with a break-up of new vs old stores?

It is general retail store which is operational round the clock just like the chain of 24Seven. All the stores are in Delhi with 35 stores out of which 5 are new and 30 are existing stores.

I follow that the store is in the process of expansion. What are the products being offered by the old stores? Also, are the products offered in new stores same or different?

The offerings of old and new stores are the same. The products offered are packaged foods, groceries and personal care

Can you tell me about the target customer segment the stores aims to serve? The younger or older generation? I believe if its operational 24*7, it is targeted more towards younger generation

Yes, the customers visiting the store are 20-30 years old.

Okay. Have the profits gone down or profitability per store reduced? Also, is it just for new stores or are all the stores facing the same issue?

Profits have gone down, and the problem is with all the stores.

Are there any recent regulatory changes which would hinder operations of retail stores?

No change.

I would like to proceed with dividing profit in revenue and cost. Revenue can be further broken down into # of stores and revenue per store. Since the problem is across all the stores, I would not delve on old vs new stores separately. Cost can be broken down into # of stores and cost per store, which could be further broken into fixed and variable cost. Is the structure good to proceed or am I missing something? Also, would you like me to investigate revenue side or cost side first?

The structure looks fine to me. Kindly investigate the revenue side.

I can see number of stores have gone up; I believe revenue per store has reduced over time?

Yes, the revenue per store has gone down.

Revenue can be further broken down into Average ticket size and # of customers? Has there been a reduction in either of these or both?

Average ticket size has remained same though the number of customers per store has reduced

The reduction in number of customers could be due to our inability to supply the products or demand has reduced?

There are no concerns on supply side, can you further investigate demand side of it?

Demand can be impacted due to internal or external factors. Any change in internal policies of the store?

No change.

Any change in landscape? Industry has stagnated or change in competition landscape like entry of new player/new stores by current players or change in customer's perception of the stores?

Industry is fairly growing at 5%. No changes in both competitive landscape and customer's perception. There is no major change in the total number of customers visiting the chain, but 80% of the sales take place between 6pm-2 am

That is interesting. Total # of customers visiting the chain is same but # of customer per store has reduced which means the customers are getting divided into increased stores. Also, the timeline of 6PM- 2AM suggest that Stores essentially used for emergency buying post 6pm or for midnight cravings.

That's correct

Do you want to me explore the cost side of it?

Not required as of now. Can you suggest ways to increase the revenue?

Are we open to idea of changes which would require major expenses?

No, the client doesn't want to incur major expenses

So, the client can either increase the average ticket size or increase number of customers/store. To increase the average ticket size, We can introduce new product categories like stationery, fresh groceries; start home delivery in nearby areas for bigger orders; & add loyalty programs to regular shopper. To increase the # of customers, the client needs to work on marketing campaign & promote the chain as a day store similar to a kirana store to increase revenue during daytime & to increase revenue post daylight, highlight safety aspects & provide home deliveries.

Sounds good to me. We shall move to the next rounds now. Thanks for your time.

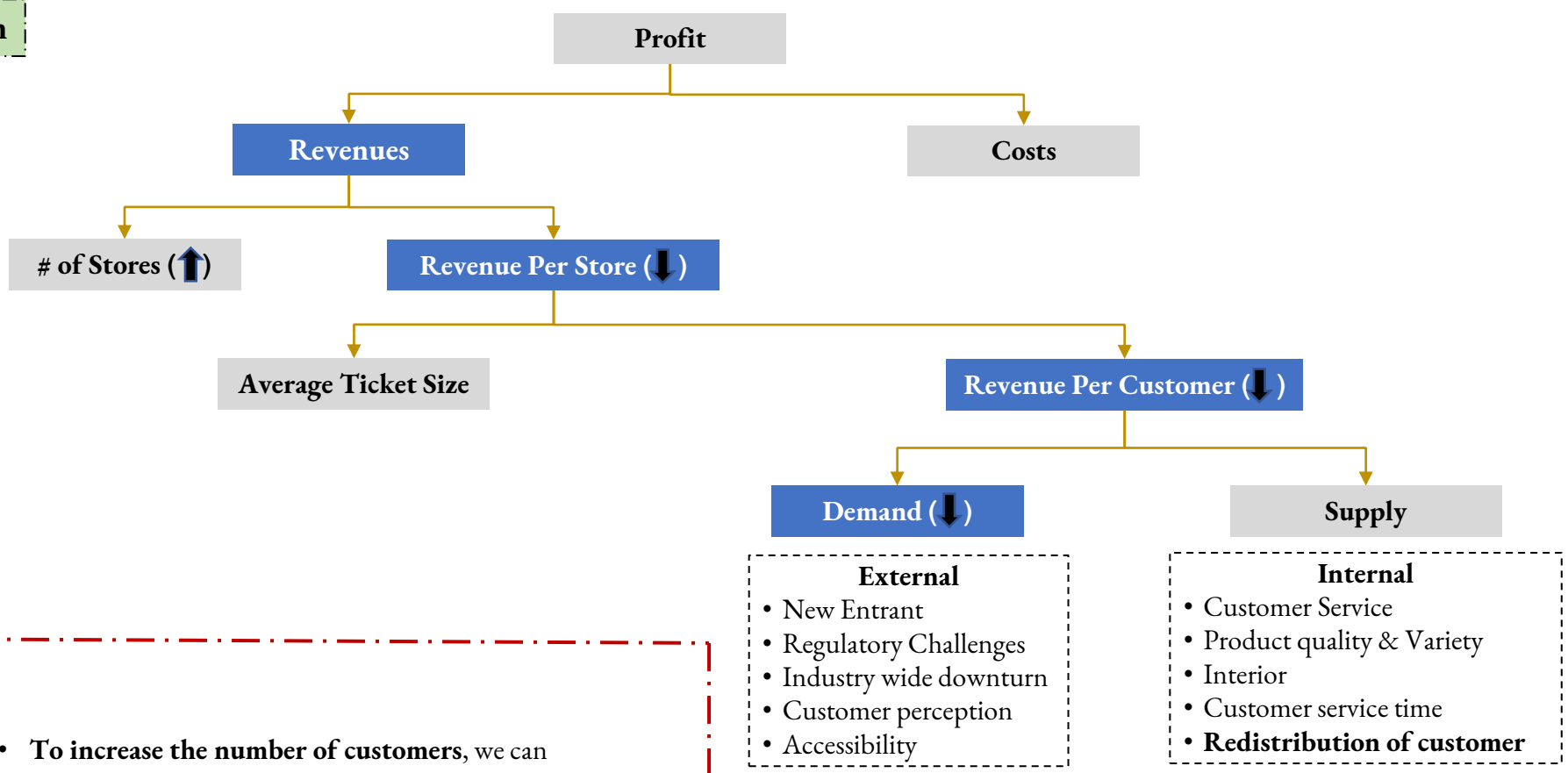
Retail Chain

A chain of retail stores recently increased the number of stores. However, with increase in the stores, the profitability has dropped.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company**-It is general retail store chain like 24Seven. All the stores are in Delhi with 35 stores out of which 5 are new and 30 are existing stores.
- **Products** - Packaged foods, groceries and personal care.
- **Customers** – 20-30 years old
- **Regulatory Changes** - None

Approach



Recommendations

- **To increase the average ticket size**, we can
  - Introduce new product categories like stationery, fresh groceries.
  - Start home delivery in nearby areas for bigger orders.
  - Add loyalty programs to regular shopper.
- **To increase the number of customers**, we can
  - Work on marketing campaign
  - Promote the chain as a day store similar to a kirana store to increase revenue during daytime
  - To increase revenue post daylight, highlight safety aspects & provide home deliveries.

E-Commerce Company

Your client is an e-commerce player, who started new operations, but is not doing as well as they were expecting. You are to analyze the root cause

Hi. I would like to clarify a few things before I start analyzing the case.

Sure

Can I assume that the e-commerce player is operating in India where it is facing the aforesaid issues?

Yes. You can assume India.

I follow that the client is in the process of expansion. What was the objective behind entering India?

Client saw India as a growing and affluent market option to tap into.

What is the state of e-commerce industry when this is taking place, normal or is it changing? Is the industry facing some issues?

You can assume that it is same as before.

Also, could you tell me about their expectation mismatch?

They have met 50-60% of their targets.

Can you tell me more about our client as well as the competitive landscape?

Client's main business is Fashion (70%), operating in a fairly consolidated market with 3 players having 80% market share and client wants to capture 5-6% of this market. The client also has some business in the household and the electronics category which constitutes the remaining 30%. Also, they have an application based UI.

I feel that I have the necessary information to jump into the case. In the 3 categories that the client does business in, is there any particular category which is doing worse than other categories?

No, its fairly same across all the categories.

Right, that means the products listed on our application is not an issue. I like to draw the customer journey which takes place on our application so as to understand the missing piece. Does that sound okay?

Yes, you can proceed

Firstly, the customer would on board on our application, then browse for products, select a product, and then head out for checkout and payment. Do we have information at what step are customers leaving our application?

It is at the time of browsing when they're leaving the application

Right, I'm dividing the aspects of browsing in 3 parts: Catalogue, Pricing, and UI. Since we have the target unmet across categories, I don't think catalogue is the main problem here, and since the market is competitive the pricing could be an issue. So is it fine if I dwell into UI?

Go on

I'm dividing the UI journey of a customer into 3 parts: pre- browsing, during browsing, post-browsing. Pre browsing would include downloading and sign-up, during browsing, customers would see stacked products and upon clicking a product, they'd reached the product page, and after browsing, they'd go on cart page followed by checkout

Good. You've almost cracked the case. The problem with our client's UI was that after going back from a product page, instead of continuing from the scrolled down page, the application used to go on the top of stacked product page.

I can see why this is causing problems for the application users. The client should consider hiring product managers who stay in constant touch with consumers at every step and ensure that such issues are resolved as quickly as possible

That seems like a good recommendation to me. Thanks!

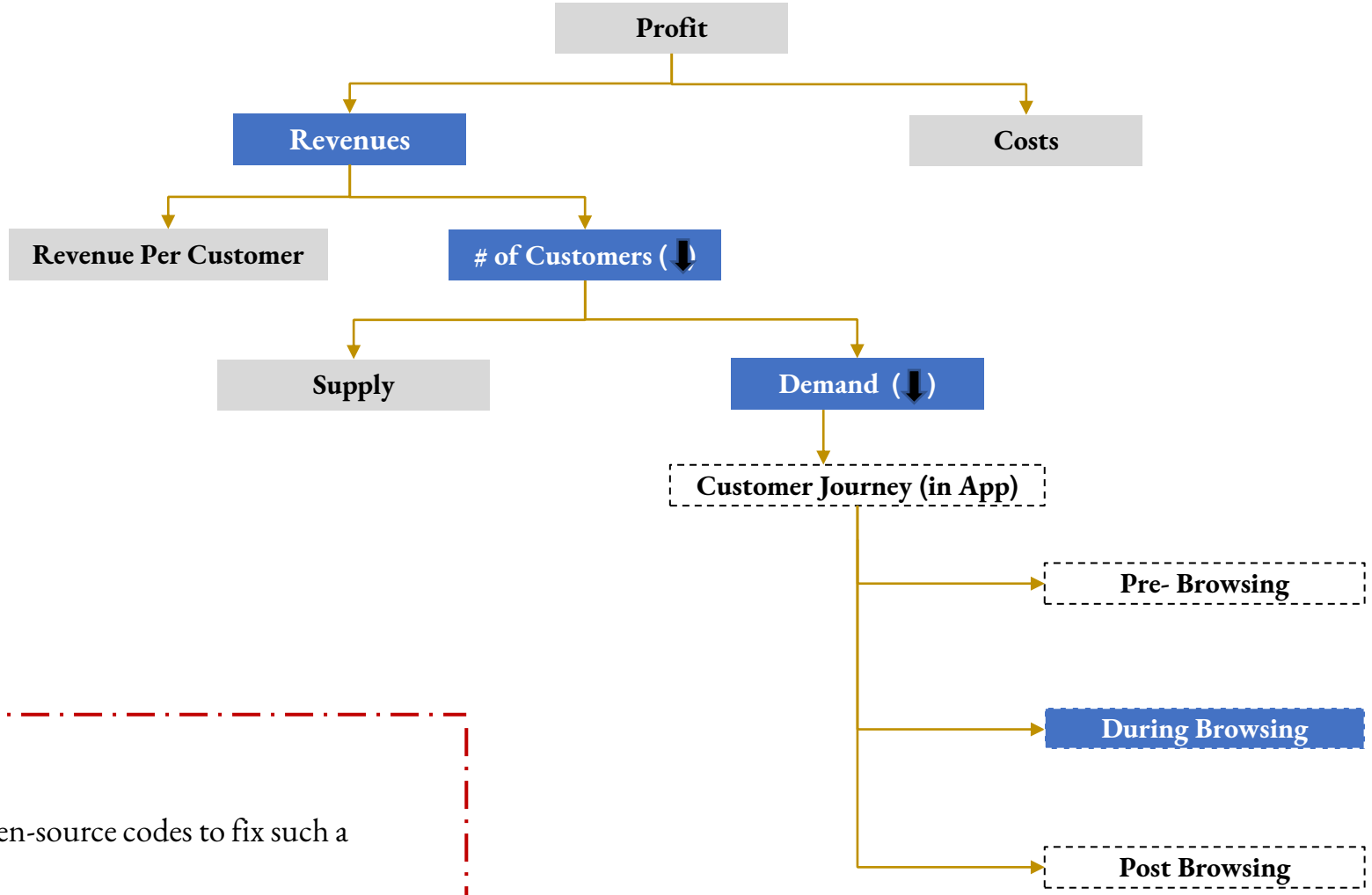
E-Commerce Company

Your client is an e-commerce player, who started new operations, but is not doing as well as they were expecting. You are to analyze the root cause

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company**- New entrant in the Indian E-commerce space; mismatch in actual growth and growth expectations
- **Products** – Fashion Products
- **Competitive landscape**– 3 players commanding 80% of the market share; not an industry wide problem
- **Regulatory Changes** - None

Approach



Recommendations

- Ask the developers to fix the problem; use open-source codes to fix such a problem
- Hire product managers that are in constant touch with the consumers and can quickly revert back with the problems that the consumers are facing

Garbage Collecting Company

Your client is a garbage collecting company involved in the scrap dealing business. He has seen reduction in profits. Find reasons and recommend solutions.

Reiterating the problem statement, our client is a garbage collecting company involved in the scrap dealing business. He has seen reduction in profit. I need to find reasons and recommend solutions.

Yes, you are right. Please go ahead!

I would like to know more about our client. Does our client collect garbage from residential areas or industrial areas and at what location? Also want to understand more about the type of scrap business they are involved.

They are located in Pune and collect the garbage from the residential apartments of suburban areas. They deal with all kinds of waste that can be recycled.

Okay! Can you please confirm if we have any competitors?

No. We have no competitors in this area.

Got it. May I know the quantum of decline and since when this is happening? Also is this a sudden decline?

It has been for 3 months. Our profits decreased by 20%. It's a gradual decline.

Okay. Got it. The problem with decline in profits can be because of the increase in the costs or decline in revenues or a combination of both. Can you please confirm the same?

Yes, its an issue with the increasing costs.

The increase in costs can be analysed via value chain approach or fixed vs variable cost. Can you confirm if you are okay with value chain approach or the other?

Yes, you may analyse the value chain

Okay. The steps in a value chain of garbage collection would involve Scheduling/Planning of the collection, collection and loading, Transportation to the dump yard, Unloading and segregation, Treatment of waste that can be sold to scrap and selling the scrap to the buyers. May I know if we are facing issue with any of the stage in particular?

Yes, its is correct. We are facing an issue of increased costs at the stage of collection and loading.

I want to look at the fixed vs variable costs involved in this stage. The variable costs might include the wages of the employees, cost of the equipment, gear used and fixed cost includes the rental cost of the truck or the emis, insurance being paid. Can you please confirm if the approach is fine and if we are facing issue with any any of these factors?

We are facing an issue with the increased wages.

In a work like this, the employees are usually paid mostly on an hourly basis and Wages can be further broken down into No of employees* No of hrs/employee* Wage/hr. May I know if the issue is lying within any of these factors?

Yes, we have seen an increase in the number of hrs/employees. Can you think what can be some possible reasons?

I can think the issues can be categorised into Man, Equipment or Method of operation related. Is the approach fine with you?

Okay, can you explain the issues under each category?

Sure. With Man the issues can be related to Ability, Motivation and Opportunities and these can lead to them taking more time than required. Second, can be the issues related to equipment in terms of quality or quantity. Third, the method issues can be about any change in the way the garbage is collected. May I know if the issue is within one of these categories?

Yeah, there is a change in the method of garbage collection. The secretary of the residential areas asked us to collect garbage from home to home instead of one big dump at the end of the street.. However, this lead to increase in time of collection and is going beyond the time we planned thus increasing the duration and leading to increase in the wages to be paid. Can you suggest some steps to be taken to counter this issue?

Instead of door-to-door collection, on discussion with the secretary, we can collect the waste from the common bin from each apartment without them having to dump it at the end of street. Also, to further reduce our segregation costs, separate bins for wet and dry waste is also suggested.

Sounds good. Thank you for your time.

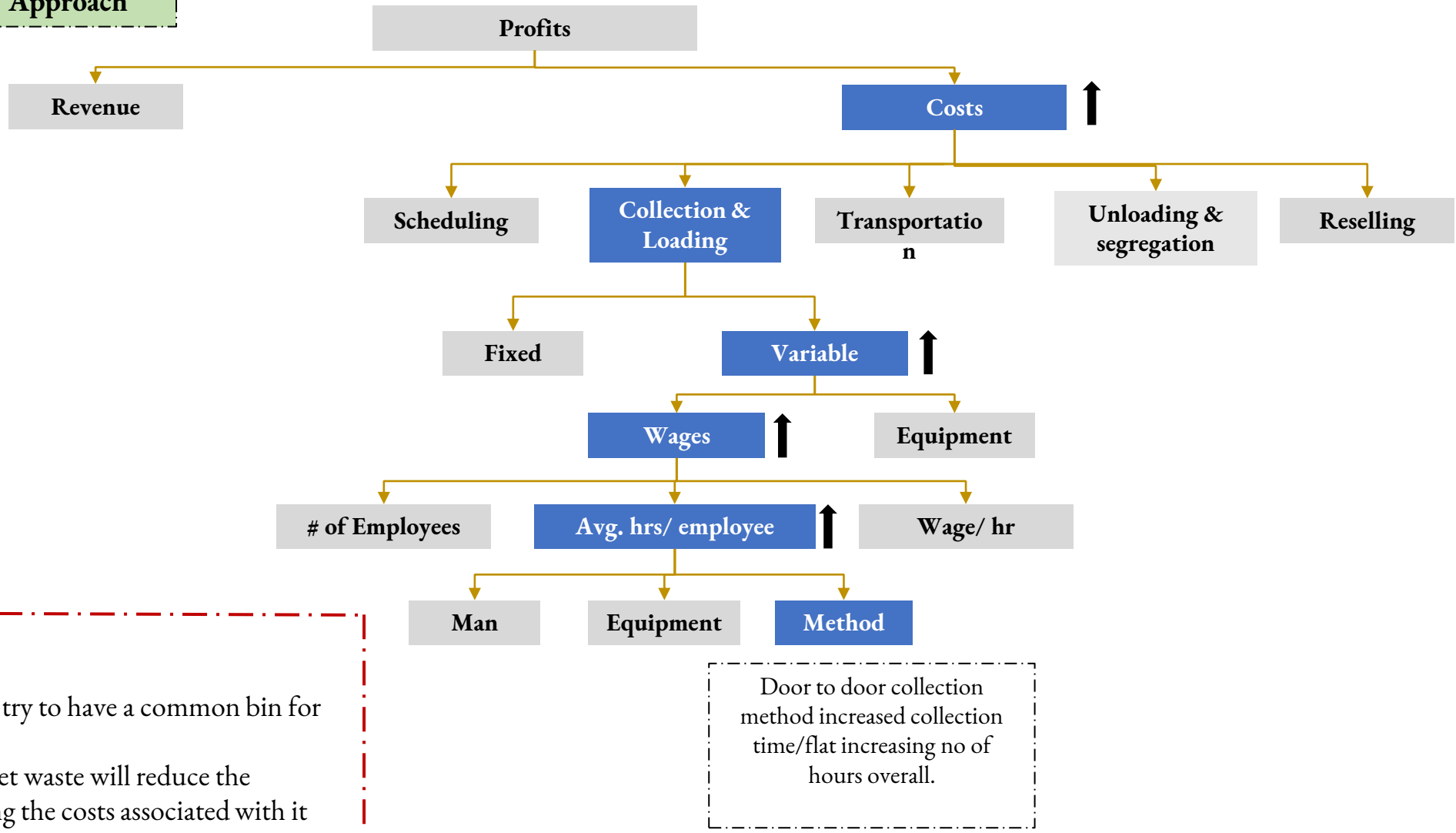
Garbage Collecting Company

Your client is a garbage collecting company involved in the scrap dealing business. He has seen reduction in profits. Find reasons and recommend solutions.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company** – Garbage collecting company and reselling to 3rd parties
- **Location** – Mumbai Suburban Areas with residential flats
- **Duration** – 3 months
- **Industry Scenario** – Only client is impacted
- **Quantum of decline** – 20%

Approach



Recommendations

- Instead of door-to-door collection, try to have a common bin for each apartment .
- Having separate bins for dry and wet waste will reduce the segregation work, hence by reducing the costs associated with it

Biscuit Manufacturer

Your client is a biscuit manufacturer and wants to increase profitability.

Sure, I would like to clarify a few things before I start.

Sure.

What is the current level of profitability of the client? Has it declined over time? Also, what is the scale of operations of the client?

The client manufacturers multiple varieties of biscuits, which are sold all across India (it is similar to GoodDay). The profits were 18% in the last six months, which were higher earlier (25%).

Has the decline been observed across product lines or for a few products only?

The profits have reduced across product lines.

At what stages does the client operate in the supply chain? Is it responsible for the delivery till retailers as well?

The client is the manufacturer of biscuits, stores the inventory at warehouses spread across India, sells the same either via distributors or supplies to grocery stores, supermarkets and online retailers.

Ok. Is the decline in a particular region or is it PAN India? Also, does the issue pertain only to our client or is it industry wide?

The decline is PAN India. The issue is only being faced by our client.

The client has been facing a lower profit % since the past six months. The reasons for the same could be a decrease in revenue or an increase in costs.

Okay, I would like you to look into how you could analyze revenue.

Revenue could further be analysed basis the number of products (volume) and the price per product, price could be a product of the price per unit and the product mix.

Fine. I would like you to look at costs.

Costs can be broken down by value chain. First, the client will plan and procure raw materials, which will be transported in. Then the manufacturing of the final products will be carried out, which will be stored and transported out (carriage outwards). There would be sales and marketing activities carried out, post which the products will reach the distributors and retail chains. Would you want me to look into any specific steps in the value chain?

Yes, there is an issue in the manufacturing process.

Okay. The manufacturing process can further be broken down into people, processes & machines.

People and machines are the same as earlier. I would like you to further analyze the process.

Sure, the process can be derived by (Number of units produced) * (Cost per unit produced). Number of units would further consist of (Capacity)*(Capacity utilization%) and Cost per unit produced consists of Variable costs per unit and fixed costs per unit.

The variable cost per unit has gone up.

Okay, the variable cost per unit can be further divided into labor costs p.u., fuel costs p.u and operational costs like quality checks, packaging, ingredients sourcing, etc. p.u. Has there been an increase in any one/ few of these costs?

The packaging costs per unit have increased.

The causes could be divided into internal and external factors. Internal factors can consist of a change in supplier, inefficiencies, increase in cost of material or a change in packing process. External factors can be a change in norms/ rules, industrywide shift towards biodegradable packaging.

Yes, there have been new regulations introduced for packing materials, where the earlier material of 100 microns has been replaced by 250 microns packing materials. Also, there has been a build up of inventory of the old packing material due to this shift, along with the increase in costs of the 250 micron packing. Hence, this is the reason for an increase in costs.

Could you also go through recommendations now?

In short term, we can engage with suppliers for bulk discounts or long-term contracts at fixed rates to reduce the per-unit cost of the 250-micron packaging material. In long term, we can leverage the shift to more robust 250-micron packaging as part of a sustainability initiative to appeal to environmentally conscious consumers. This could allow the brand to charge a premium for its products, thereby offsetting the packaging cost increase.

Sounds good. Thank you for your time.

Biscuit Manufacturer

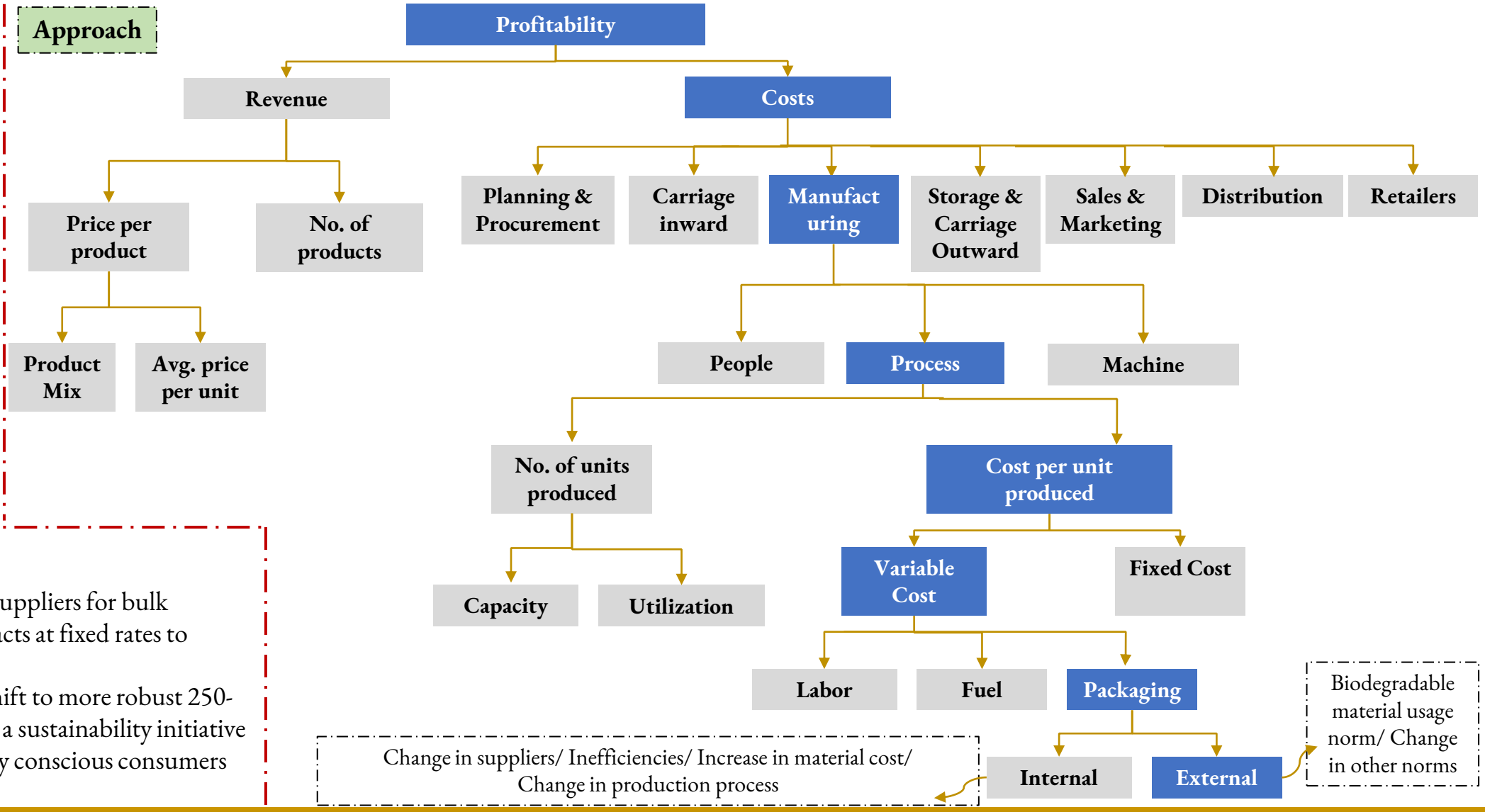
Profitability | Easy |McKinsey & Co.

Your client is a biscuit manufacturer and wants to increase profitability.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Duration** – Last 6 months
- **Quantum of decline** – From 25% to 18%
- **Operations** – Manufactures, stores and sells via distributers
- **Geography** – Pan-India
- **Company vs. Industry** – only an issue with company
- **Product** – Multiple variety of biscuits
- Decline across product line

Approach



Recommendations

- **Short term :** Engage with suppliers for bulk discounts/ long-term contracts at fixed rates to reduce the per-unit cost
- **Long term:** Leverage the shift to more robust 250-micron packaging as part of a sustainability initiative to appeal to environmentally conscious consumers & charge premium.

Automobile Company Sales

You client is an automobile company experiencing lower sales recently. Figure out the problem & suggest ways to increases sales in the next 3 months

So, just to clarify, I would re-iterate the problem statement. Our client is an automobile company facing declining sales recently & they want us to find out the problem & suggest ways to increase sales in next 3 months.

Yes, absolutely right. Go ahead!

Before delving deeper into the Case, I would like to ask a few clarifying questions. Is that fine?

Sure, go ahead!

Does the client operate only in India & are there any other operations run by the client?

So, the client only manufactures personal cars. It is based out of India & serves Indian market.

Also, since when is the client facing this problem?

Since last 3 months.

Thank you sir! Do we have any information regarding what kind of different products our client manufactures?

Yes! So, the client manufactures only a single product, i.e., Single model of a Single type of car.

One last question. Do we know about the presence of the client in its value chain? I mean in which all segments of the automobile value segment the client operates?

Good question! So you can consider that the client operates all across a general automobile value chain from manufacturing till after sales services.

Sure sir, thank you! Just provide me a couple of minutes to gather my thoughts and analyse the problem.

Sure!

Sir, since this is a case of declining sales, it will have two components: Quantity sold & Price/Unit. Do we have any information regarding which of these have changed, i.e., either increased, decreased or remained constant in last 3 months?

Sure! So, the quantity sold has gone down in last 3 months & the Price/ Unit has remained unchanged.

Since the quantity sold has declined, it can be due to either a supply side issue or a demand side issue. What is the case with our client?

Yes, good observation. You can consider it a demand side issue.

Thank you sir! So, the demand side issue can be further segmented into 2 segments of Marketing & Customer pull. Do we know on which of these two fronts our client has not been performing well in last 3 months?

Yes! Consider it to be related to Customer pull issue.

So, we can divide Customer pull issue into four issue of Product visibility, Product likability, Affordability & feasibility. So, doe know which of these four factors related our client's product is affecting the client's customer segment?

That is quite insightful. Yes, the issue is related with the product feasibility.

Since the automobile sector is highly regulated, is there any regulatory issue that our client is facing due to which the product feasibility is impacted?

Yes, the Government has announced to introduce BS VI regulations soon encouraging people to stop buying for now and wait till later when the company will give heavy discounts. Do you have any recommendations?

Yes Sir! Since we have a target to increase sales in next 3 months, I can come up with following two recommendations. First, Client shall focus on exporting its product & second, it shall focus on making sales through billing earlier and receiving money later. This will result to increase in sales

Good job! Looks good to me. Hope to see you in the next round.

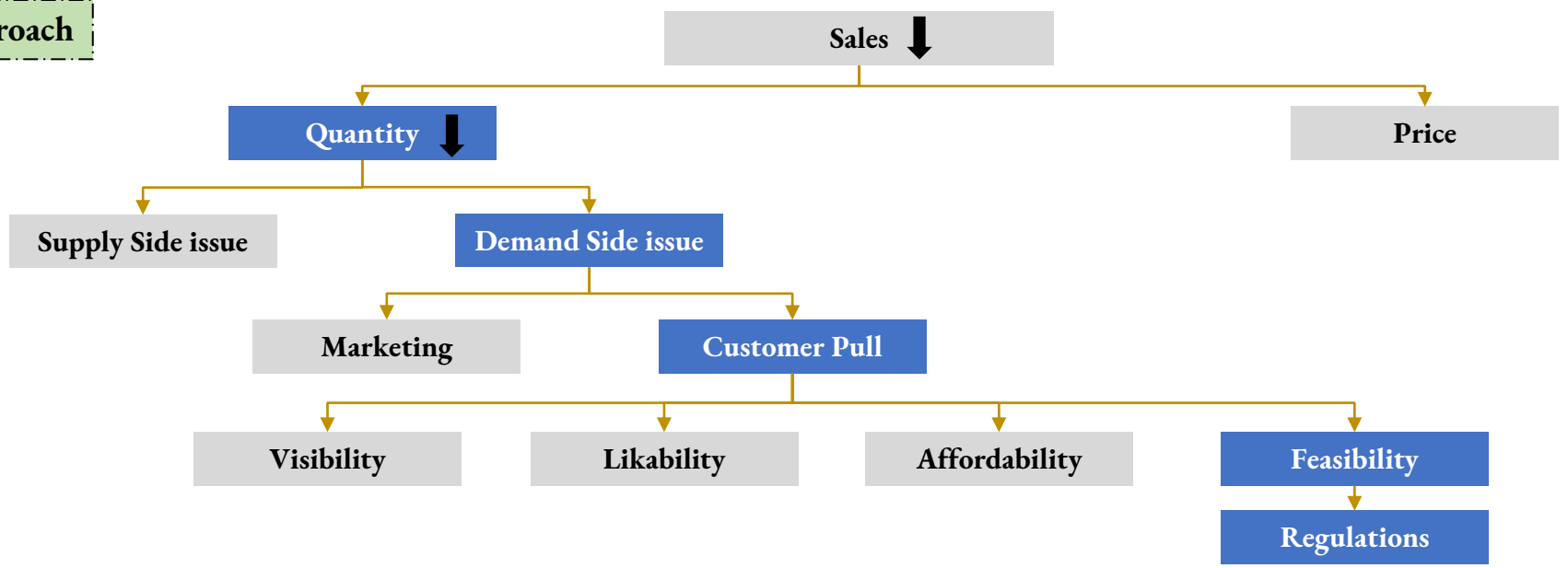
Automobile Company Sales

You client is an automobile company experiencing lower sales recently. Figure out the problem & suggest ways to increases sales in the next 3 months

Case Facts & Notes

- **Client-**
  - Manufactures Personal Cars
  - Based out of India, serves India
- **Product-**
  - Single Product, i.e., Single Model of a Single Car
- **Period-** Since last 3 months
- **Value Chain-**
  - Present across the general automobile value chain

Approach



Government has announced to introduce BS IV regulations soon encouraging people to stop buying for now and wait till later when the company will give heavy discounts.

Analysis

- The company can improve sales by focusing on the 4Ps
  - Product: Modifying the product to conform to BS IV norms
  - Price: Introducing discounts right now on non BS IV compliant models
  - Promotion: No change
  - Place: Reaching more dealerships, if possible
- Also current strategy is not able to make the product reach the people in time.
- Problem is stock is present but it is difficult to make the stock reach people in short amount of time.

Recommendations

- Focus on exporting the Products
- Making sales through billing earlier and receiving money later. This will result to increase in sales.

Automobile Dealership

Your client is an owner of automobile dealership in Delhi NCR and is experiencing flat sales. Find reasons and give recommendations.

So, our client is an owner of automobile dealership in Delhi NCR who is experiencing flat sales and I need to find reasons for the same and give recommendations to solve the problem?

Yes

Sir I would like to ask a few clarifying questions.

Sure, go ahead!

What does the client's business look like, what kind of services are provided by the client and where is the dealership located and what is the size of dealership?

Apart from selling cars in the showrooms the client provides post sales car servicing and the client has 10 sales showrooms and 4 service showrooms spread across Delhi NCR.

What is the product mix of the client?

The sell Skoda and Audi cars, both Volkswagen brands and they deal in the premium segment of car market

How long the client has been facing this problem and how is the competitive landscape, is it a industry wide problem, has there been changes in government regulations/laws?

The client has been facing this problem since the past two years and it's not an industry wide problem, there has not been any change in the government regulations/laws.

Is our client the only distributor of these cars in the city or are there other dealers as well, and how are these brands performing in the market, if there are other dealers for these brands as well are they facing the same problem?

There are other dealers as well in Delhi NCR, the brands themselves are strong and performing well and other dealers are not facing the same problem.

Thank you! Just provide me a couple of minute of gather my thoughts and analyse the problem.

Is this a supply side problem or a demand side problem, as in is our client not being able to serve customers because of constraints or there are not enough customers in the first place?

It's a demand side problem, number of customers of the client has not been growing

Since we already know that the demand for these particular brands is high and other distributors are doing well, the problem has to be internal. So should I look into these factors?

Yes

Well, the different factors that can effect the customer experience in a premium car dealership can include things like the location, aesthetics, operational hours of the showroom, sales personnel skills, quality of post sales services. Do we have a measure of these things for our client?

The client has a customer feedback program and customer feedback has dropped and post sales service quality has dropped according to the feedback.

Scores on surveys taken at the dealership have dropped and post sales service quality has dropped. This could be due to multiple reasons, like Quality of salespeople has dropped or they have not been trained properly or process of providing service has become obsolete or has been altered wrongly

Yes, these are the reasons the quality of post sales services has dropped, can you suggest ways to improve this?

To increase the quality of after sales service the client can retrain sales and service staff, the client can link bonuses/ incentives to dealership survey scores for all employees of dealership, so that they have a stake in the overall performance of the dealership. The client can review the current practices for after sales services and compare them with historical trends, if they are not up to the industry standards the client should improve that as well

Yes, these recommendations sound good.

Automobile Dealership

Your client is an owner of automobile dealership in Delhi NCR and is experiencing flat sales. Find reasons and give recommendations.

Case Facts & Notes

- 10 Sales Showrooms and 4 Service Showrooms
- Sells cars of Volkswagen, Skoda and Audi (premium)
- Sales flat across the board from 2 years
- Not an industry wide problem and no change in fuel prices.
- No Regulatory Changes have taken place
- Identify Reasons/causes and give recommendations

Approach

Factors that contribute towards Sales

Internal factors (specific/micro)

- **Customer Feedback**
  - Surveys(paper forms/ at the showroom)*
  - Tele-calling (7-14 days after sale)
  - Questionnaires through mobile/email
  - Post sales maintenance support (car service)
  - Online Reviews: Justdial, Sulekha.
- **Sales Personnel Skills**
- **Aesthetics**
- **Location**
- **Hours of Operations**
- **Employee Compensation**

External Factors (Macro)

- **Demand of Cars**
- **Competitions** – Doing things differently: payment options, margins, skills
- **Customers** – Target group, buying patterns

Root Causes

1st Level:
Customer Feedback has dropped

→

2nd Level:
Scores on surveys taken at the dealership have dropped.
Post sales service quality has dropped

→

Possible Reasons
Quality of sales people has dropped/ have not been trained properly
Change in process of providing service has become obsolete/ has been altered wrongly

Recommendations

- Retraining of sales and service staff
- Linking bonuses/ incentives to dealership survey scores for all employees of dealership
- Review of service process and quality with comparison to history and current trends

Kids' TV Channel

Our client is a Kids' TV Channel that is facing a dip in revenues and advertisers are moving out of contracts. Help them fix their problems.

Okay, so just before we begin, I'd like to confirm my understanding. Our client is a Kids TV Channel that has declining revenues & advertisers are moving out of contacts. We've been hired to solve this issue? Right?

Yes, that's right.

Okay, then in that case I would like to ask a few clarifying questions.

Sure, go ahead!

Where is the Channel based out of and viewed? Since when are they facing these issues?

The channel is based in the US and it's an add-on channel that doesn't come with the regular package. This issue of declining revenues has been prevailing since the past couple of years.

Thank you sir! Regarding the problem – Are our competitors also facing the same issue?

Not really. Some of our competitors are doing fine while some have also faced a hit like us.

Okay, then in that case I think we should see what are the different revenue streams for our channel that have taken a hit and then view what are the competitors are doing differently in terms of those revenue streams. Is that fine?

Yes, that seems to be a fair approach. Go ahead.

Thank you! Then first, I'd lay out the different revenue streams I believe the channel has and then we could look into the specifics?

Sure

Okay, so according to me, I can currently think of four different areas from where the channel could earn money. Please correct me if I'm wrong. I think there is advertising revenue for sure also a fee must be charged from the channel's end to package and air the content based on the no. of subscribers and timing of the show. Lastly I think there must be some indirect sources too like merchandising and more.

Yes, that's absolutely right! You can divide fee you mentioned regarding subscribers and time into two. One is a regular TV Show fee that has to be given to a channel for choosing a particular slot, while the other is a distributor fee charged per subscriber.

Okay, thank you. In the past few years has any one of these streams specifically taken a hit?

Yes, distributor fee has reduced.

I can think of two reasons for that to happen. Either our subscribers have declined in number or we've reduced our distribution fee per subscriber.

Yes, you're right. Our subscriber-base has declined.

Okay, so I will try and enlist the reasons for this. These can be internal or external. By internal, I mean it can be that our content quality has reduced or we're having too many ads causing viewers to shift while by external, probably our competitors have launched a new show or service or customer preferences are changing.

Internally, nothing has changed. But you're right about the competitors doing things differently. They've launched an On Demand Video Service

That explains a lot. It could be the case that subscribers must have shifted to this new service. Not only this, the general shift of preferences is also towards internet based entertainment. If we could also launch such a service, our revenues might regain momentum. We could also compensate lost revenue by focussing on other things like merchandising, altering the show mix and increasing advertisements on different areas of the screen.

Yes, that's absolutely right. These sound like good suggestions. Could you calculate what monetary benefit we might gain on launching this new service?

Sure, sir. If I consider one show with 9 seasons and 22 episodes per season which is the general case, we can multiply that to the average viewers per episode and per subscriber fee to get total benefit. Is that sufficient or I should get into the specifics?

That sounds good, it should suffice. Thank you!

Kids' TV Channel

Our client is a Kids' TV Channel that is facing a dip in revenues and advertisers are moving out of contracts. Help them fix their problems.

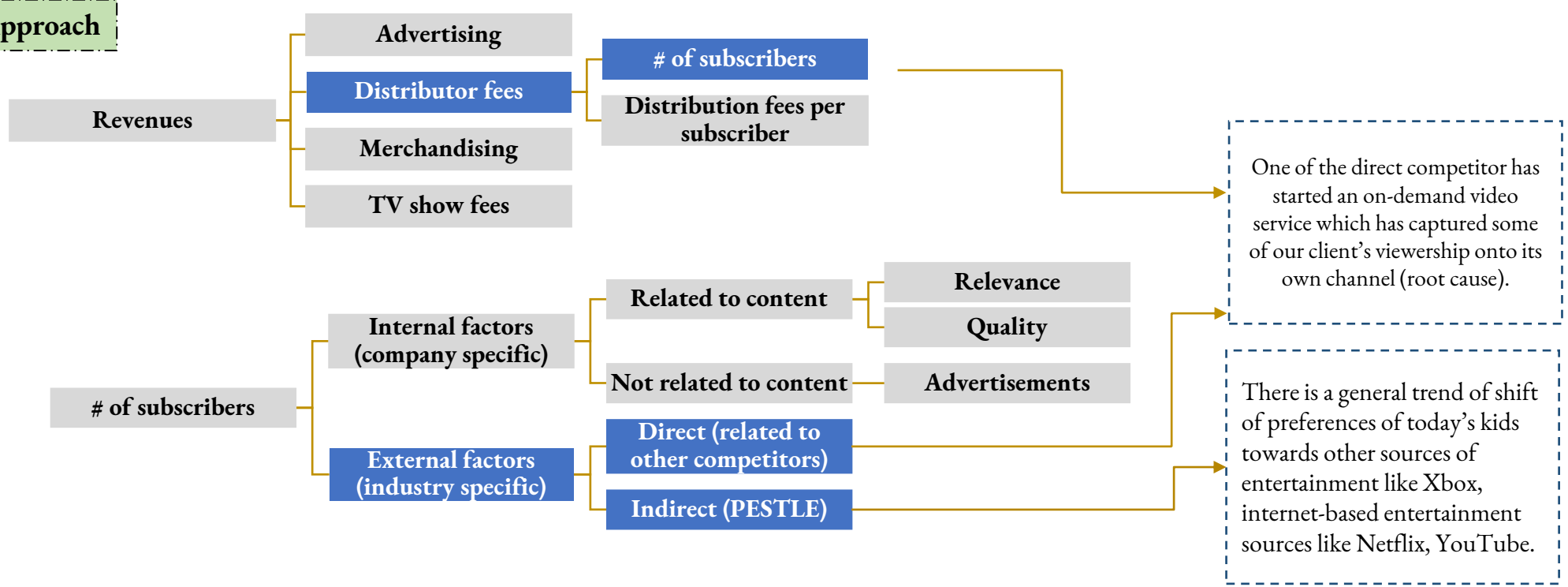
Case Facts & Notes

- Kids TV Channel based in US
- Facing these problems for past couple of years
- Add-on channel (not a part of regular channel package)

Channel Roles:

- Content Creation
- Content Packaging
- Content Distribution

Approach



Recommendations

1. To tackle the root problem, we can launch a on-demand video service on our channel
2. We can also circumvent the root problem by compensating the lost revenue from other sources of revenues. Suggestions for this could be
   a. Focus on merchandising revenues
   b. Changing show mix by introducing popular shows at prime time
   c. Introducing advertisements in screen headers and footers

Benefit of Introducing an on-demand video channel:
Total benefit = (Price charged) × (Average viewership per episode) × (No. of episodes/Season)* (No of Seasons)
.
Price charged: $4 per subscriber **Average viewership: 10000 per episode**
No. of episode in one season: 22 **No. of seasons: 9**

Total benefit: $7.92 million.

Apparel Company

Your client is an apparel company in the Middle-East, and has a trade mindset. Following the oil crisis they want to reduce the prices of their goods and want to reduce their costs to be able to do the same. Suggest how they should go about it.

So our client is an apparel company operating in the middle east and wants us to come up with a strategy to reduce their costs? What exactly is implied by trade mindset?

Yes, so our client procures finished goods from manufacturing hubs and then supplies it to retail stores in the middle east, primarily UAE and Saudi Arabia.

Okay, so they provide their specific requirements to manufacturers and then sell the same to their clients, which are other stores? If that is the case I'd like to know about the types of product and from where they procure

That's right. They sell cotton apparel and source from manufacturing hubs in China, India, Bangladesh

Thank you. Before I analyse the operations of our client, I'd like to understand their motivation behind reducing prices and why they want to reduce costs to achieve it? I'd also like to know if there is any specific timeline across which they want to reduce costs.

Demand in these countries has gone down due to the crisis and the client feels reducing prices would work in their favor. They do not want to substantially reduce their profit margins and hence would like to reduce costs. They would prefer quick reductions, but are open to both short and long term solutions.

So, I'm trying to think of the entire value chain for the company and the various cost heads. What I've come up with now is that the company first procures the clothes from manufacturers i.e. inbound logistics, then it is brought to the country of sale, where the products will be stored, post which there is distribution, followed by retailing. The client would also incur marketing & admin costs. Should I go ahead with analysing the associated costs in each head, if it can be lowered and how?

Okay, that seems like a fair approach. Lets only analyse till the distribution, as our client is only limited to that. Lets assume that the marketing and administrative costs are optimised.

I'll begin with the costs related to procurement, which I think would be dependent on 3 factors – raw material used, design complexity and manufacturer chosen. The design complexity would affect the labour requirements and the machine requirements, whereas the manufacturer would affect the margin they take over their costs, the operational efficiency of the manufacturing plants, labour cost, rent which would be specific to the location.

How can you reduce costs for these?

Our client can reduce their costs drastically if they change their raw material, which from my understanding would make up a large portion of the costs. If they have been using higher quality of cotton, shifting to a lower gsm fabric would be effective. This is also likely to not have that great an effect on the demand, as the oil crisis would also change the consumer preferences, who would now be willing to purchase clothes of lower quality than before. They can reduce the design complexities of their orders, which would reduce the labour requirements. Further the company can look to procure from manufacturers which charge lower margins or in locations with lower associated costs, even if it affects the final quality as due to changing preferences, customers would now be satisfied with lower quality apparel as well.

These seem like good suggestions, especially factoring in how each would effect the end consumers of our products. You were also right about raw material, it is actually 60% of the procurement cost to our client. Is there any other way that you can think of to reduce costs?

Yes we can also look at the inbound logistics costs. Assuming that the quantity we procure does not change, this cost will depend on distance of shipment and mode of shipment (to determine price). One solution to reduce this would be to procure from locations within or near the Middle East. This will not only reduce the transportation costs, but also the storage costs as lesser inventory would need to be maintained owing to reduced lead times. However these countries will have higher raw material cost (India, Bangladesh have cheapest cotton), so the trade off between decreased logistics cost and increased raw material costs would have to be evaluated.

Lets assume the decrease in logistics cost is higher than increase in raw materials cost. Can you now give your final recommendations to the client?

In the short term the client should look to shift lower quality and hence lower cost raw material. In the long term they should begin procurement from manufacturing hubs in the Middle East or develop capabilities do so if their finances allow. This would reduce both transportation and warehouse costs.

Apparel Company

Your client is an apparel company in the Middle-East, and has a trade mindset. Following the oil crisis they want to reduce the prices of their goods and want to reduce their costs to be able to do the same. Suggest how they should go about it.

Case Facts & Notes

- Wants to decrease cost in light of recent oil crisis (to decrease price to customers and drive sales)
- Sells cotton apparel to large scale retailers in UAE and Saudi Arabia
- Procures final products from manufacturing hubs in India, China, Bangladesh
- Not involved in manufacturing (gives design to factories and then picks up final products) and retailing

Approach

Procurement → **Inbound Logistics** → **Warehousing** → **Distribution** → **Marketing & Admin Costs**

Procurement

Raw Material Costs

Raw Material makes up 60% of the procurement cost. Shifting to lower GSM cotton would drastically bring down costs

Manufacturing Unit Costs

- **Labor**
- **Machining**

  - Shift to lower complexity designs
  - Will decrease labor costs and usage of complex machinery/ machining processes

- **Rent**
- **Utilities**

  - Client can try to negotiate rent terms
  - Can not change utility costs (electricity, fuel) as it would be fixed for a location
  - Procure from a manufacturing unit with lower utility and rent costs

- **Manufacturers' Margin**

  - Negotiate with existing manufacturers to reduce their profit margin.

Inbound Logistics

Distance

- Explore options of procuring from manufacturing hubs in nearby countries
- Will reduce the transportation cost and warehousing cost (lesser inventory to be maintained due to lower lead times)
- Reduction in transportation cost would have to be higher than increase in raw material costs (India, Bangladesh have cheapest cotton)

Cost per km

- Cost per km is highest for air freight followed by ships and lowest for road transport.
- Can shift to road transport when procuring from nearby countries

Recommendations

Short Term:

- Shift to lower quality (GSM) fabric
- Use simple designs to reduce labour and machinery costs.

Long Term:

- Start Procuring from nearby locations
- Change mode of transportation to road transportation

Quick Service Restaurant

Your client is a quick service restaurant and is experiencing high manpower operating costs. Find reasons and give recommendations.

Sir, just to be on the same page, I will repeat what I understood from the question. So our client is a quick service restaurant and wants to reduce its manpower operating costs.

Yes, go ahead!

Sir I would like to ask a few clarifying questions.

Sure, go ahead!

What is a quick service restaurant? Geography? What does it serve? Standalone or a chain?

Consider fast food chains. It's a pizza chain spread across India. They make and deliver pizzas.

Thank you sir! Regarding the problem – Since when is the restaurant experiencing this problem? Is it concentrated in a particular geography? Are only we suffering or are competitors are also impacted?

Well they have been experiencing this problem for the past 2-3 years. They are experiencing this problem pan India but its majorly concentrated to Metro and Tier-1 cities. As far as we know, the competitors are also impacted by it.

Thank you sir! How is the competitive landscape and has there been a change in government regulations/laws regarding manpower that might be impacting the industry?

No, there has been no change related to labour laws. The industry is fragmented with 2 big players and lot of small players. Plus each city have local chains and eateries that add to the competition. We have 30% market share in Tier-1 and Metro cities and 40% in Tier-2 cities, where we exist.

Thank you sir! Regarding service, what all kind of service are we providing?

Good question! The restaurant provide dine-in, drive-by and delivery service. Anything else you would like to know?

No sir, thank you! Just provide me a couple of minute of gather my thoughts and analyse the problem.

Sir, considering a store, manpower costs can be divided into chefs/cooks, servers, managers, billing, delivery, maintenance & security. Is there a particular head you would like me to look into?

Let's assume the problem is the store level only and I would like you to dive in delivery costs. What factors make delivery costs?

Delivery costs would include wages, insurance, spillage, and probably vehicle maintenance. Are any of these heads changed?

Are you sure vehicle maintenance will come in manpower costs? The company wages of employees have increased.

Has the pay structure changed?

Yes, it was earlier fixed pay model. Now its changed to fixed + variable kind of structure. Why do you think this happened?

Maybe industry model has changed sir. Or competitors introduced new pay structure and to keep up the company had to change its pay structure too. Maybe due to entry of food aggregators.

Yes, due to entry of food aggregators, the delivery employees were leaving the client for better pay. Thus they had to increase the pay. I want you to analyse the change in pay.

Sure sit, fixed pay would be factor of no. of working days, working hours and hour rate. Variable pay would depend on number of deliveries. Do we have the data regarding this.

Yes, a delivery employee on an average has 24 working days, has a 8 hour workday, and is paid ₹ 50 per hour. Apart from it, they are paid ₹ 5/delivery and can deliver 30 order per day. Also suggest ways to reduce costs. Earlier pay - ₹ 10000/month

New costs: ₹ 13200. That's an increase of 32%. Regarding solutions: We can ooutsource delivery activity to Swiggy and Zomato after doing a cost benefit analysis. That might save on the delivery charges. We can also introduce a loyalty bonus to retain employees, or we can introduce/increase delivery charges to recover the costs.

Quick Service Restaurant

Your client is a quick service restaurant and is experiencing high manpower operating costs. Find reasons and give recommendations.

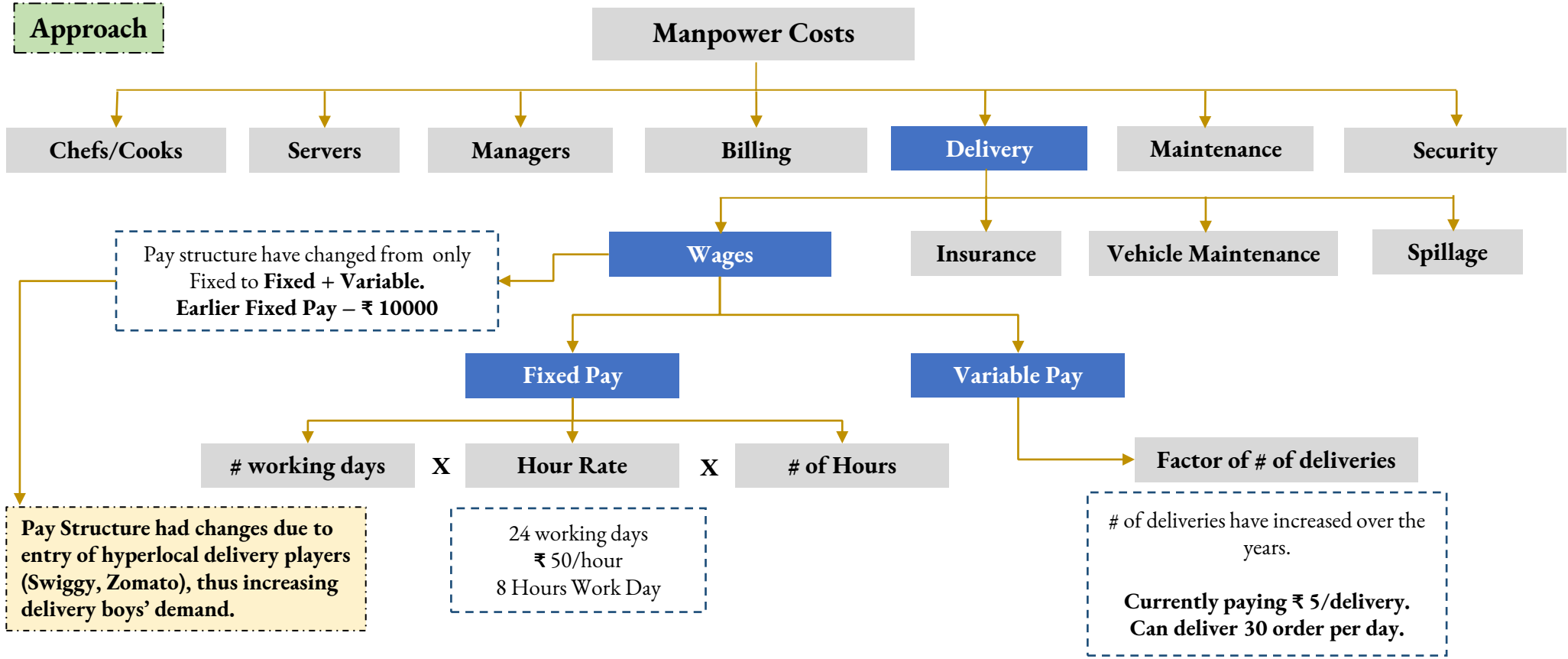
Case Facts & Notes

- It is a Quick Service
- Restaurant chain of Pizzas - Make & Deliver Pizza
- Experiencing problem since past 2-3 years
- Problem visible in 40% of the restaurants across chain. Pan India – Tier 1 cities
- No changes in government regulations.
- Impacting competitors too.

Activities

- Dine-In
- Drive By
- Delivery

Approach



Recommendations

- Outsourcing delivery activity to Swiggy and Zomato after doing a cost benefit analysis. That can save on the delivery charges.
- Introducing a loyalty bonus to retain employees.
- Start charging delivery charges for Pizza delivery to recover costs. Currently, they don't charge
- Increase prices of pizza by a little amount(1-2%) to cover for the increased costs. People won't mind paying Rs. 410 for a Rs.400 pizza.

Fixed Pay Now – ₹ 9600
Variable Potential – ₹ 3600
Total pay = ₹ 13200
Increment of 32% per person.

Steel Manufacturer

Your client is a Steel manufacturer observing declining profits from the past 2 years. They want you to figure out what is going wrong.

So, just to be on the same page, I would re-iterate the problem statement. Our client is a Steel manufacturer facing declining profits from the last 2 years and wants us to figure out the problem.

Yes, absolutely right. Go ahead!

Before delving deeper into the Case, I would like to ask a few clarifying questions. Is that fine?

Sure, go ahead!

In which Geography does the client operate? Is there a single plant or multiple plants?

So, our client operates in India with multiple plants in North, East & South-West.

Also, does the client operate in Upstream, mid-stream or downstream segments of Steel manufacturing?

That's a really nice question. So, our Client is involved in both Upstream & downstream manufacturing. In Upstream, it manufactures Hot Rolled Steel (HRS) Coils & in Downstream operations, it uses HRS Coils to manufacture further items.

Thank you sir! Do we have any information regarding our Customer segments & their proportion in our business?

Yes. So, we have 3 Customer segments: OEMs (Auto, Appliances), Trade (Distributors, SMEs & Retailers) & Export with a proportion of 50%, 40% & 10% each respectively.

Moreover, what is happening with our competitors & how is the Overall industry performing?

Good question! We don't have data specific to any particular competitor, but the industry is experiencing a decline of around 10% as compared to 30% decline in profits for our client. Is there anything else you would want to ask at this stage?

No sir, thank you! Just provide me a couple of minutes to gather my thoughts and analyse the problem.

Sure!

Sir, since the problem is regarding declining profits, it will involve Micro factors of Revenue & Costs for our Client & Also other Macro factors such as Political, Economic & Technological affecting the entire industry. I would first like to look into Macro factors which are affecting the entire industry as a whole & then narrow down to the Revenue & Cost factors for our client.

Sure, Go ahead!

Has there been any recent Political, economic or technological change impacting entire steel industry?

Yes, indeed. There have been sanctions on Iran leading to higher fuel costs & reduced exports & due to cheaper manufacturing , China has flooded International markets with its steel, leading to further reduced demand. There has been no major economic change in last 2 years.

I see. This has led to 10% decline in profits for the steel industry players. But since our client is facing more decline, there are some others factors affecting our client specifically.

Yes, indeed.

Since, Profits is Revenue minus Costs. Can you tell me which of these is increasing, decreasing or constant leading to overall declining Profits.

So, Revenue is declining & Costs are increasing.

Sure. I would like to delve first into cost side & like to look into the entire value chain of our client to see what are the factors leading to increasing costs. Give me a few seconds to make the value Chain.

Yes, the value chain you have made is absolutely right. Due to decline in demand for our client, we started defaulting on our payments 1 year ago. We have 3-4 major Contractual suppliers. The payment has also changed from credit-based to advance-based leading to declining inputs, reputation & working capital.

I thinks that's the specific problem for our client. Increasing fuel & financing costs have led to increased cost/ Unit production. Also, since the demand has dipped our client is not able to overcome increasing costs. Which has led to higher declining profits for them. Give me few seconds to come up with recommendations.

Sure. Good job!

Steel Manufacturer

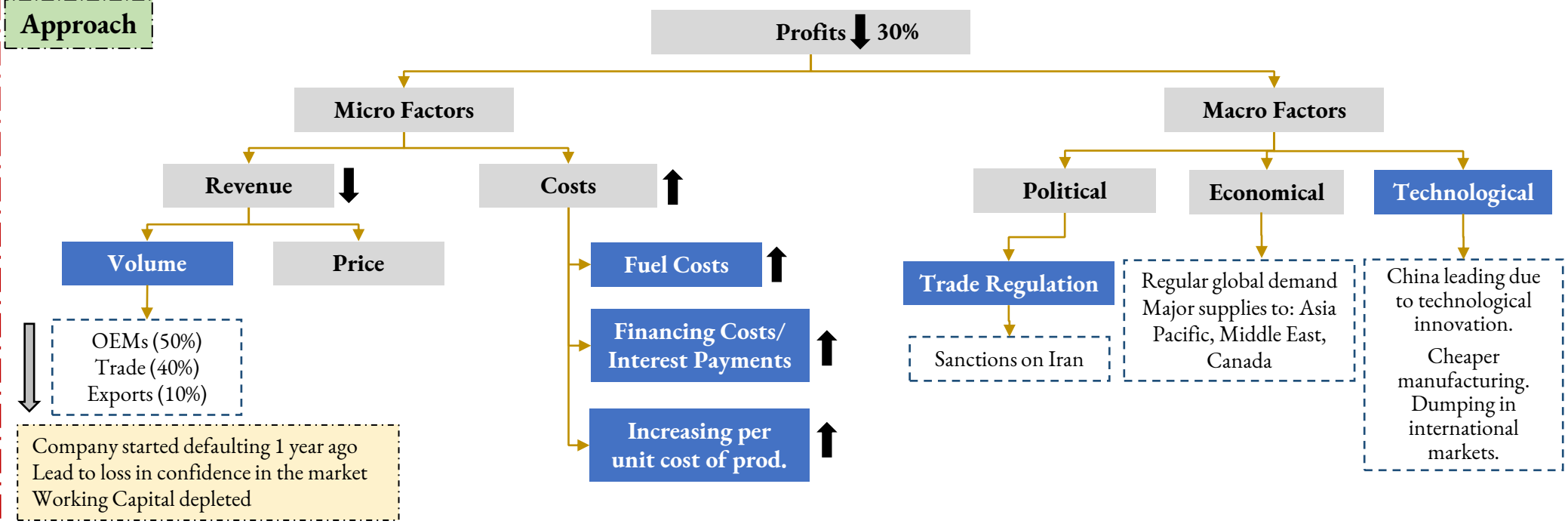
Profitability | Moderate | BCG

Your client is a Steel manufacturer observing declining profits from the past 2 years. They want you to figure out what is going wrong.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company** - Operations in India. Plants in North, East, South-West
- **Product** - Hot rolled steel coils. Downstream uses HRS coils.
- **Customers**
  - OEMs. (Auto, appliances)
  - Trade (Distributors, SMEs, Retailers)
  - Export (Distributors)
- Market is experiencing a 10% decline in comparison to 30% decline to our company.

Approach



Recommendations

- Focus on customers with higher margins & lower advance requirements.
- Consider changing prices to remain profitable
- Govt. lobbying to curb steel dumping by China.

Sourcing

- 3-4 Major suppliers
- Raw Materials: Coal, Iron Ore, Limestone
- Contractual Relationship
- Declining inputs
- Declining reputation among suppliers
- Moved from credit based to advance based payment system

Inbound Logistics

- Smooth Flow
- Optimized
- Increasing fuel costs

Bigger players have their own mines

Production

- Capacity: 5.4 MT
- No bottlenecks
- Under-production
- Increasing per unit production costs
- Low capacity utilization

Lower production costs for competition due to economies of scale

Outbound Logistics

- Smooth Flow
- Optimized
- Increasing fuel costs

Customer Pull

- Down to 3.2MT from 4.3MT
- Approx. 25% decline in demand
- Reputation on decline
- Credit payment (1 month cycle)

Competitor Benchmarking

Fast Food Delivery Company

Profitability | Easy

Your client is a fast food delivery company. He has seen reduction in profits. Find reasons and recommend solutions.

Reiterating the problem statement, our client is a fast-food delivery company that has seen a decline in profits recently. We need to find the reasons and suggest solutions.

Yes, you are right. Please go ahead!

To start, I would like to know more about our client. Where does the company operate, and is this profit decline across the entire business or in a particular segment?

The company operates in major metro cities across India, and the issue seems to be across all markets.

Got it. To understand the problem better, have there been any changes in competition or the overall demand for food delivery?

Competition has remained intense but stable, and the demand for food delivery has actually increased post-pandemic.

Interesting. So demand is strong, yet profits are declining. Let me understand more about the client's customer base. Do they serve a specific segment, like corporate clients or mostly individual customers?

The majority of customers are individuals ordering via an app, mostly quick meals and combos.

Thank you. Since we're investigating profit decline, I'd like to break down profit into Revenue and Cost. Which side do you think we should look at first?

Revenue has remained stable and even grown slightly. The main concern is on the cost side.

Alright. Costs could include food preparation, labor, delivery, and packaging. Have any of these cost elements increased recently?

Yes, the cost of packaging has increased significantly. The delivery boxes, which were designed to last for 3 months, now need to be replaced every month.

That's a big jump. Do we know why these boxes are wearing out faster than expected?

Yes, the material used in the latest batch of boxes wasn't as durable as earlier ones. This happened after switching to a new supplier to cut initial costs.

Understood. So, while the intention was to save costs, it backfired by tripling the replacement frequency and driving up total packaging costs. Do we know the financial impact?

Yes, packaging cost has gone up by 40%, and since packaging is a significant cost component in delivery, margins have dropped sharply.

Thanks for clarifying. Here's how I would summarize the situation:
Revenue: Stable or slightly increasing.
Costs: Spiked due to poor-quality delivery boxes needing frequent replacement.
Root Cause: A cost-cutting decision on supplier choice that led to durability issues.
Shall I move to recommendations?

Yes, please.

Here are my recommendations:
Short-Term:
Switch back to the previous supplier or negotiate with the current one to improve quality without a big cost increase.
Conduct quality checks for durability before procurement in the future to prevent such issues.
Medium-Term:
Explore alternative packaging materials (biodegradable but durable) to ensure sustainability and cost control.
Implement vendor performance tracking with penalties for deviations in agreed quality.
Long-Term:
Consider reusable packaging solutions for frequent customers to cut recurring box costs.

Great. That concludes the case. Thank you for your analysis.

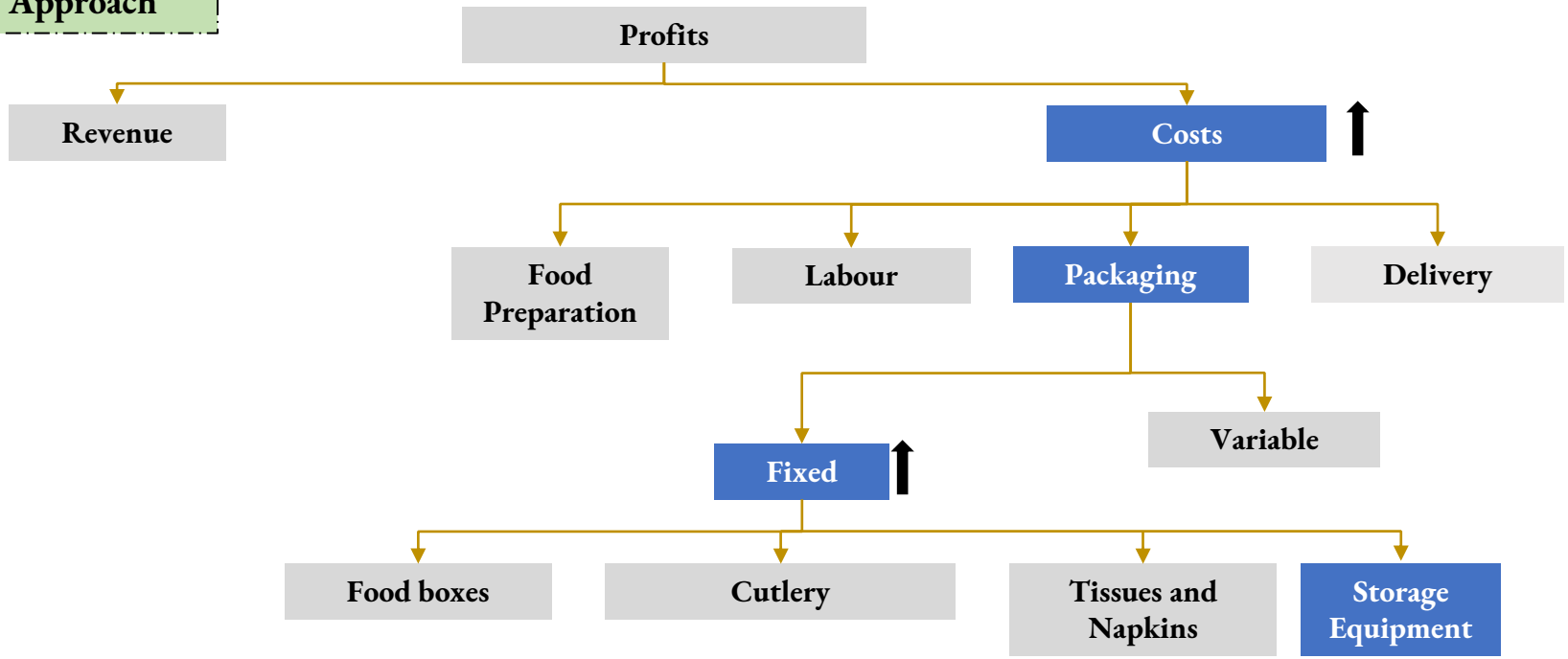
Fast Food Delivery Company

Your client is a fast food delivery company. He has seen reduction in profits. Find reasons and recommend solutions.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company** – Fast food delivery company - delivering via 2-wheelers
- **Location** – Major metro cities.
- **Duration** – 3 months
- **Industry Scenario** – Only client is impacted

Approach



Used for delivery – supposed to be replaced every 3 months, instead, wears out in a month or so.

Recommendations

- Switch back to the previous supplier or negotiate with the current one to improve quality without a big cost increase.
- Explore alternative packaging materials (biodegradable but durable) to ensure sustainability and cost control.
- Implement vendor performance tracking with penalties for deviations in agreed quality.

PG Rental Accommodation

Profitability | Easy

Your client is a PG rental chain who is facing a decline in profit. Find reasons and recommend solutions.

Reiterating the problem statement, our client owns a PG rental chain. He has seen reduction in profit in the past last year. I need to find reasons and recommend solutions.

Yes, you are right. Please go ahead!

I would like to know more about our client. Where does our client operate in and is it facing a decline in profit in a particular area or across the entire chain?

The client operates in Delhi and owns 10+ buildings of PG. However, only one of them is facing major decline.

Okay! To understand the problem better, I would like to know about any competitor or alternate accommodations that are there near this facility?

No. Nothing has changed in the competitor landscape as such. Infact we are the most affordable given the quality of living experience we provide.

Understood. Do we have any set of customers that drive majority of our revenue – for example students, or office goers or is it a balanced mix of all?

Given the location is near colleges, majority of our tenants are students living for 1-2 years.

Alright. Since when are we facing this issue and what is the quantum of this decline?

There is a decline of almost 25% seen in the past 4 months

I think since the company has observed reduction in profits, I would like to break the profit structure into Revenues and Costs. Do you want me to look at any particular component first?

I think you can start with revenues as there hasn't been much changes on the cost side.

Okay. Revenues can be expressed as Price and occupancy rate. Have the prices changed in recent?

No, the prices have been fairly constant for past 3-4 years.

Has there been a decline in the demand of PGs in general or our rooms in particular?

As matter of fact, demand of PGs has remained same but our rooms are not getting booked.

Are there any internal factors affecting the demand – any change from our end regarding the room or the facilities or amenities we provide – that might change the living experience?

There hasn't been any change from the company's end. Maybe you can look at different external factors.

Sure. As I understand there hasn't been any new competitor in the market, I think there is some external factor that is negatively affecting the living experience of our tenants – like an obscene sight, a foul smell, or loud music or construction noise?

There was a garbage dump opened 100 meters from the property 6 months ago.

Well, that's unfortunate. Have there been any steps taken to counter this situation?

Since we couldn't identify the problem earlier, there were no plans in place. Can you suggest some?

These will be my recommendations:
Mitigate odor inside the property - Install air purifiers, odor-neutralizing systems, and seal windows.
Target short-stay customers like interns or tourists who are less affected by long-term environmental issues.
Lobby municipal authorities or collaborate with neighboring businesses to demand waste management improvements.

Those are really helpful suggestions. Thank you for your analysis.

PG Rental Accommodation

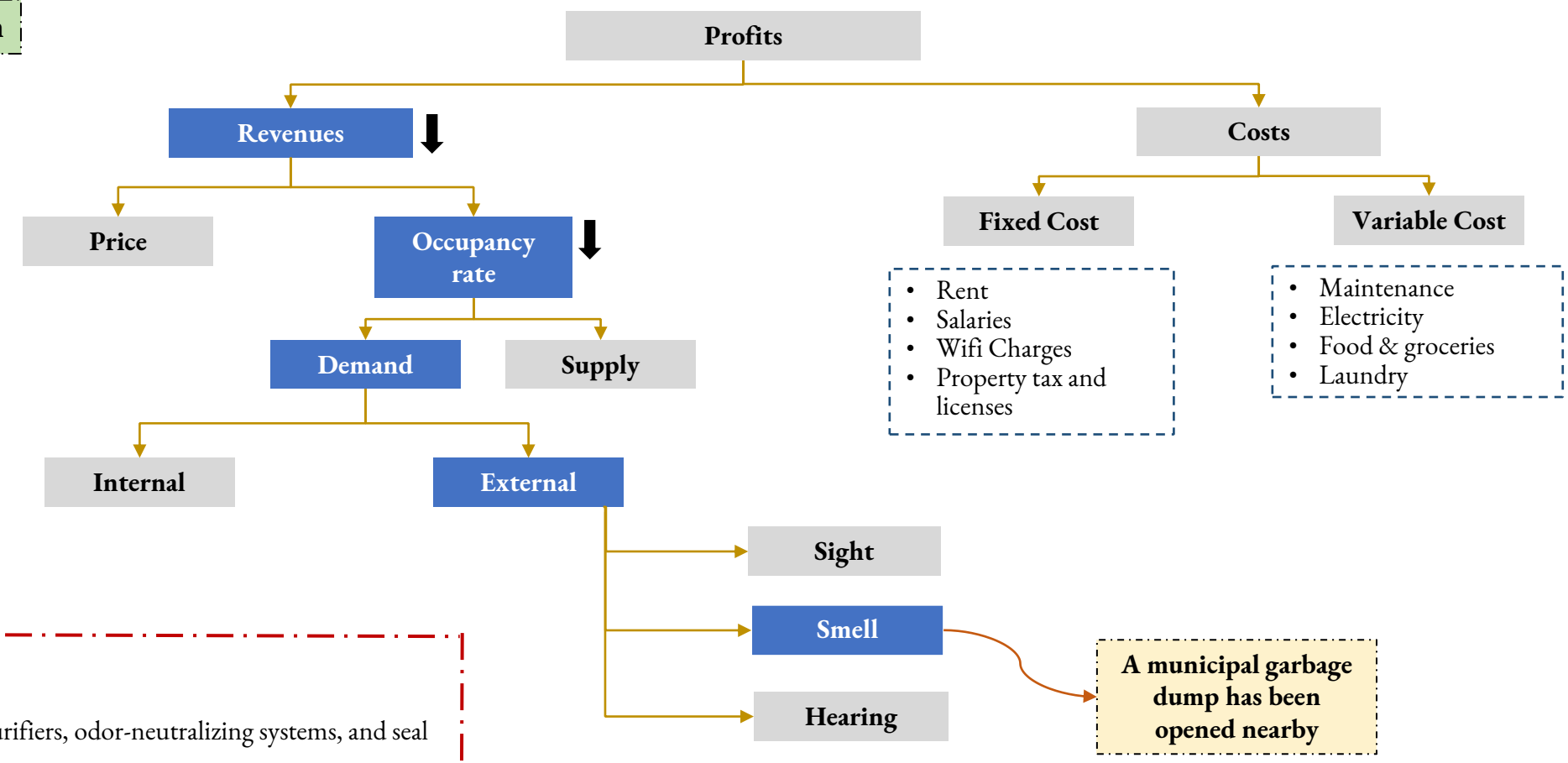
Profitability | Easy

Your client is a PG rental chain who is facing a decline in profit. Find reasons and recommend solutions.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Context -** PG Rentals in Delhi. Own 10+ properties. 1 showing decline in revenue.
- **Customers –** Students staying for 1-2 years
- **Competitions –** None

Approach



Recommendations

- Mitigate odor inside the property - Install air purifiers, odor-neutralizing systems, and seal windows.
- Target short-stay customers like interns or tourists who are less affected by long-term environmental issues.
- Lobby municipal authorities or collaborate with neighboring businesses to demand waste management improvements.

Pet Grooming Chain

Profitability | Easy-Moderate

Your client is a pet grooming chain that has seen a decline in profitability. They'd like your help in diagnosing the issue.

Sure. I'd like to clarify a few things before I begin. What services does the client offer and to which pets?

The client offers standard grooming services like bathing, nail trimming, haircutting, flea treatments for both dogs and cats.

How many branches does the client operate and where?

They operate in three cities - Delhi, Bangalore, and Hyderabad.

Is the decline seen in all of them?

Good question! The Delhi branch has shown a 10–15% decline in profitability over the last three months.

Thank you sir! Please allow me a couple of seconds to structure my approach.
Since there has been a decline in profitability, it could be due to a decline in revenue, an increase in costs or both. Do we have any information regarding these metrics?

Yes, can you analyse the costs for the chain in depth?

Yes, sir. I'll break the costs down into Fixed Costs and Variable Costs. Which ones would you like me to explore first?

You can start with variable costs.

Yes, sir. We can break variable costs down into three major components – consumables, maintenance costs and utilities. Is there a particular head you would like me to look into?

Let's focus on the utility costs for now. How would you break it down?

Utility costs would majorly include electricity and water. Have both of them increased , sir, or just one?

Let's say the issue is on both sides. Please continue with your analysis.

I would say water would be majorly utilised by the staff for personal uses, for bathing and cleaning pets and for cleaning the equipment. Electricity would again be utilised either for general consumption like fans, ACs, etc. or for grooming pets. The major appliances for this would be hair dryers and water geysers.

Correct. There has been an increase in the amount of water used for bathing pets. There has also been an increase in the amount of electricity used for the pets.

Okay, sir. Focusing on pet bathing first, the increase in water usage could be due to inefficiency in the process, inefficiency in the equipment used for washing or due to the shop staff. Do we have any details about these factors?

Yes, so the issue stems from repetitive rinsing of the pets due to inexperience of the staff. Can you focus on the other issue now?

Yes, sir. In relation to increased water usage for bathing pets, we would also be running the water geysers for longer than required to generate more hot water which could be increasing our electricity usage. Is that the case here?

Correct! According to you, how can the grooming chain fix these issues?

In the short term, I'd recommend training junior staff to reduce water wastage. We can also create performance benchmarks and reward efficient employees to reinforce good practices.
In the long term, we can Invest in renewable energy sources or efficient equipment to reduce electricity consumption and Introduce greywater recycling systems to reuse bathing water.

Sounds good. Thank you for your time.

Pet Grooming Chain

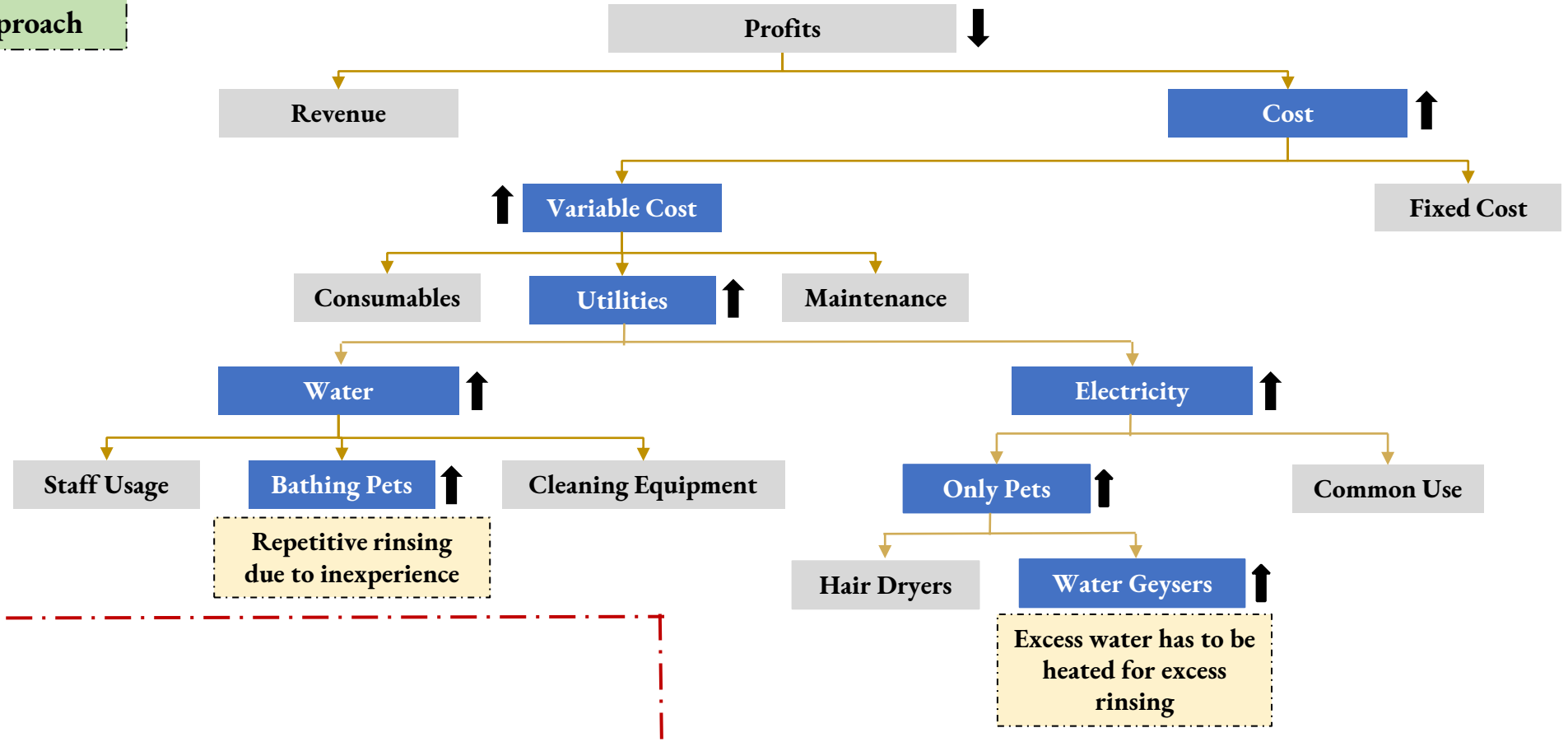
Profitability | Easy-Moderate

Your client is a pet grooming chain that has seen a decline in profitability. They'd like your help in diagnosing the issue.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Services Offered** – Bathing, nail trimming, haircutting and flea treatment for dogs and cats.
- **Locations** – Delhi, Mumbai, Bangalore
- **Problem Location** – Delhi
- **Quantum** – 10-15%
- **Duration** – 3 months

Approach



Recommendations

Short-term:

- Train junior staff to reduce water wastage.
- Create performance benchmarks and reward efficient employees to reinforce good practices.

Long-term:

- Invest in renewable energy sources or efficient equipment to reduce electricity consumption.
- Introduce greywater recycling systems to reuse bathing water.

Toy Manufacturer

Your client is a toy manufacturer facing a decline in profitability. They want your help to identify the problem and recommend solutions.

Okay, I would like to reconfirm the problem statement before proceeding forward, our client is a toy manufacturer facing decline in revenue. We have to identify the reason and recommend solutions, is that correct?

Yes, absolutely! Go ahead.

Okay. My first question is do we know since when have they been facing this decline?

Decline has been since past 6 months.

I would like to understand a bit about our client now. Where are they based out of? Also, what does their value chain look like? Do they sell to the distributors/ other retail stores, or do they have their own stores?

Our client is based out of Bangalore but they only sell through their own stores which is present across almost across all regions of the country.

Understood, what kind of toys do they make and which age group are they targeting? Also, what's the price points of these toys. As far as my understanding goes, since it has its own stores, I believe the toys would be priced in the premium range. Is my understanding correct?

They make all kinds of toys relevant for the age group 0-15 years. Answering your second question, yes, the toys sold by the client fall in the premium category.

Okay, are there are major competitors in this category and are they also facing a similar decline in profitability or is the issue specific to our client?

There are 2-3 competitors in this category but they aren't facing this issue. It's specific to our client.

Alright, since you mentioned that there are stores present pan-India, are we facing the decline in some particular geographical location or is the issue widespread?

The decline has been in particular store in Delhi.

One last question before I begin the analysis, is sale of toys the only source of revenue? Or do we have some auxiliary services like food stalls or other stalls as well?

You can consider sale of toys to be the only source of revenue.

Okay! Since, there has been a decline in revenues, it could either be due to a decline in number of customers or revenue/customer or both.

Yes, absolutely! The client has been witnessing a decline in both.

Alright! For revenue/ customer, the decline could be due to decrease in avg. ticket size/purchase or the frequency of purchase from the customer. Do we have information on which of the two is the case, here?

Okay, so our client has witnessed a decline in frequency of purchase/customer.

Okay, before analyzing the reasons for the same, I would first like to explore fall in the number of customers part as well. Does this seem fine?

Sure, go ahead.

Thank you! The fall in number of customer could be due to either internal issues or external issues. Is there some specific aspect you want me to look at or should I explore both?

Let's look at fall in number of customers due to internal issues.

In order to identify the reason, I would like to explore the journey of a customer for buying a toy. So, I would like to break it into 3 parts – Pre Purchase, Purchase and Post Purchase. Pre Purchase phase would include need for purchase of toy, awareness of the toy store, accessibility of the store. Purchase phase would include the experience of the store and the affordability of the product and purchase and Post Purchase would include purchase analysis of the bought product. Do you want me to look at some specific part of this journey?

This is a thorough outlay of the experience. So, let's look at store experience for now.

Okay, this is primarily influenced by two things - Experience related to sales representative (helpful, courteous and polite) and experience of the toys and surroundings of the store which includes the look, feel, sound and smell of the toys and the surroundings. Have we been experiencing a problem with respect to any of these?

You're quite close. The smell of the store is bad as a public toilet has opened next to the client's store. What would be your recommendations to the client to deal with this issue?

Alright, so in the short term, we can use air fresheners to combat the bad odour. We should close the windows or any openings which could be leading to that bas odour. We should also contact the local municipality (NDMC) for regular cleaning. In the long term, we can build smell-proof walls or any other odour limiting barrier. We can also consider relocation to some other place.

Alright, thank you. We can end the case.

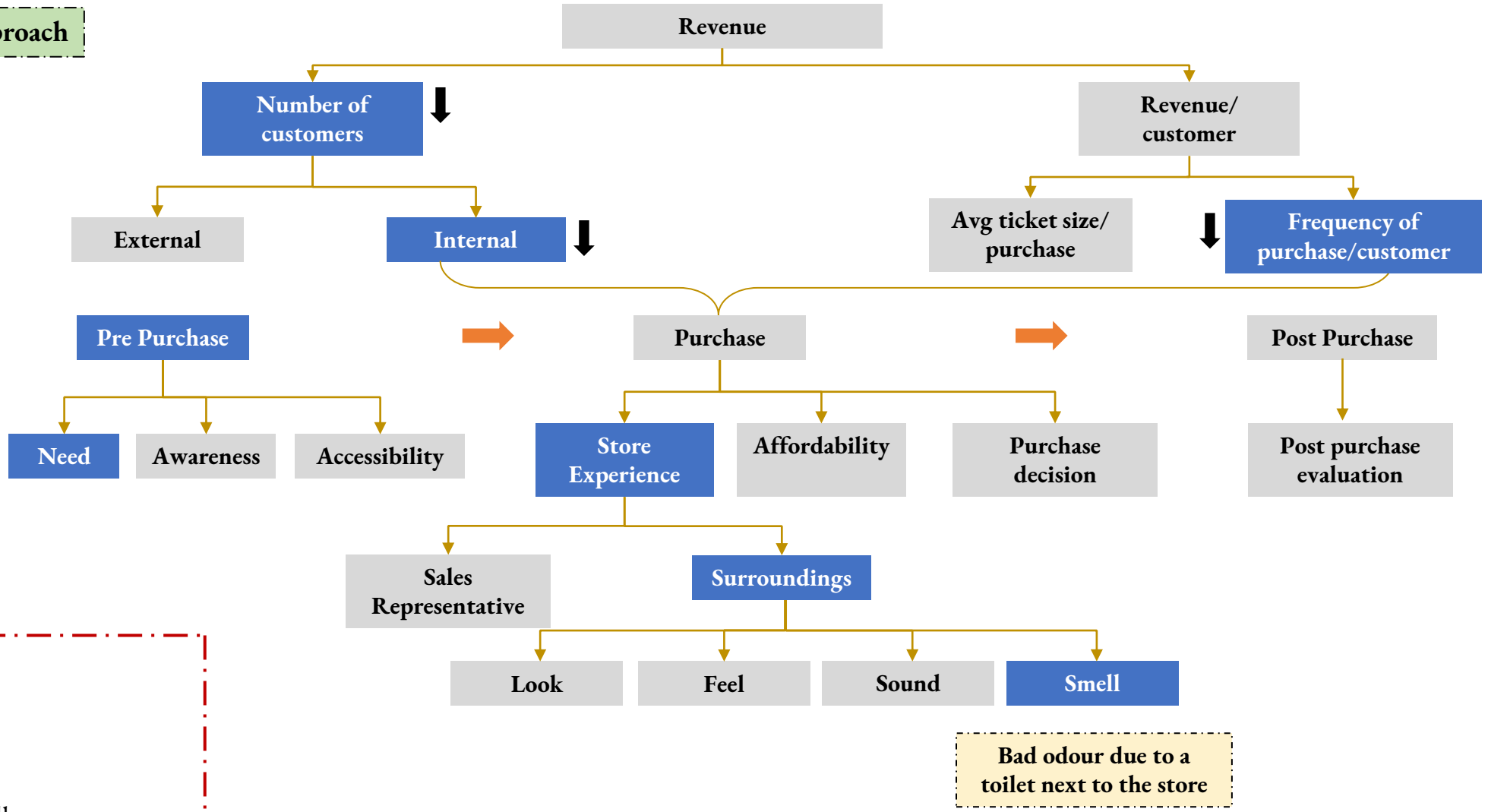
Toy Manufacturer

Your client is a toy manufacturer facing a decline in profitability. They want your help to identify the problem and recommend solutions.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Duration** – Last 6 months
- **Operations** - Sales through own stores
- **Geography** – Pan-India
- **Company vs. Industry** – only an issue with company
- **Customers** – Premium segment
- **Product** – for age 0-15 years
- Decline in a store in Delhi

Approach



Recommendations

- **Short term :** Use room freshener
- Close windows and other openings
- Contact NDMC
- **Long term :** Build smell proof walls
- Relocate

Airline Company

Your client is an Indian airline company that has been seeing a decline in their profitability from past few months. Find reasons and give recommendations.

Just to be on same side, our client is an Indian airline company that has been seeing a decline in their profitability.

Yes

First, I would like to ask some clarifying questions regarding the client here. Where does our client operates – domestically or internationally and do they cater to passenger or cargo?

The client has its operation in India, Sri Lanka, Bangladesh and Middle East. The company is a premium airline majorly used by HNIs.

How long the client has been facing this problem and how is the competitive landscape, is it a industry wide problem?

There has been a 15% decline in profitability. There are quite a few players in the market but only our client has been impacted.

Since, profit is a function of revenue and cost, have we seen any increase in cost or decrease in revenue or both have been impacted?

Our revenues have gone up by 3% since we started a new route last year.

Ok, so in this case I would focus on cost. The cost for a company can be broadly classified into: Operating cost, financing cost and investing cost. Do we have any information on what of these have been impacted?

Could you please give a brief overview for all 3 costs.

Sure.
Operating cost mainly deals with the day-to-day expenses of the airline company such as maintenance cost, hangar fees, fuel charges, salaries of employees etc. This can also include in flight services as well as the insurances involved.
Financing cost deals in how company will fund its operation either through debt (loan, bonds) or equity (stocks, shareholders).
Investing cost deals with acquiring or disposing of long-term assets.

Our operating costs have increased in line with the launch of the new route; however, the revenue generated from this route is successfully offsetting the additional costs incurred. Also, the client has not made any new capital investments, there has been no impact on investing costs.

Ok, in that case I would dive into the cost related to financing. Before moving forward, do we have any idea on how our client finance its operations and have they taken any new fund? By financing options I want to ask about are we raising them through debt or equity?

The client finances the operation through funds from domestic and international market by taking up loans, and for your second question, no – they haven't taken any new loan.

Since the funding is sourced both domestically and internationally, do we have any information on which of the two financing costs has increased?

Yes, the costs from international aspects have increased.

I would like to break down this cost into two major components: Loan taken and Interest paid. Since we have ruled out any new loan, there could have been an increase in the interest that client has to pay to international stakeholders, which might arise due to any of the following reasons
Recent change in Foreign Exchange rates, Repricing of the existing loans a spart of periodic adjustments, Change in creditor's country monetary policy.

Yes, recently Foreign Exchange rate has increased for Malaysian bank – one of our creditors and hence, our cost increased. We can close the case now. Thanks

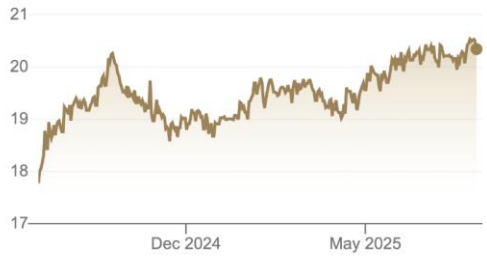
Airline Company

Your client is an Indian airline company that has been seeing a decline in their profitability from past few months. Find reasons and give recommendations.

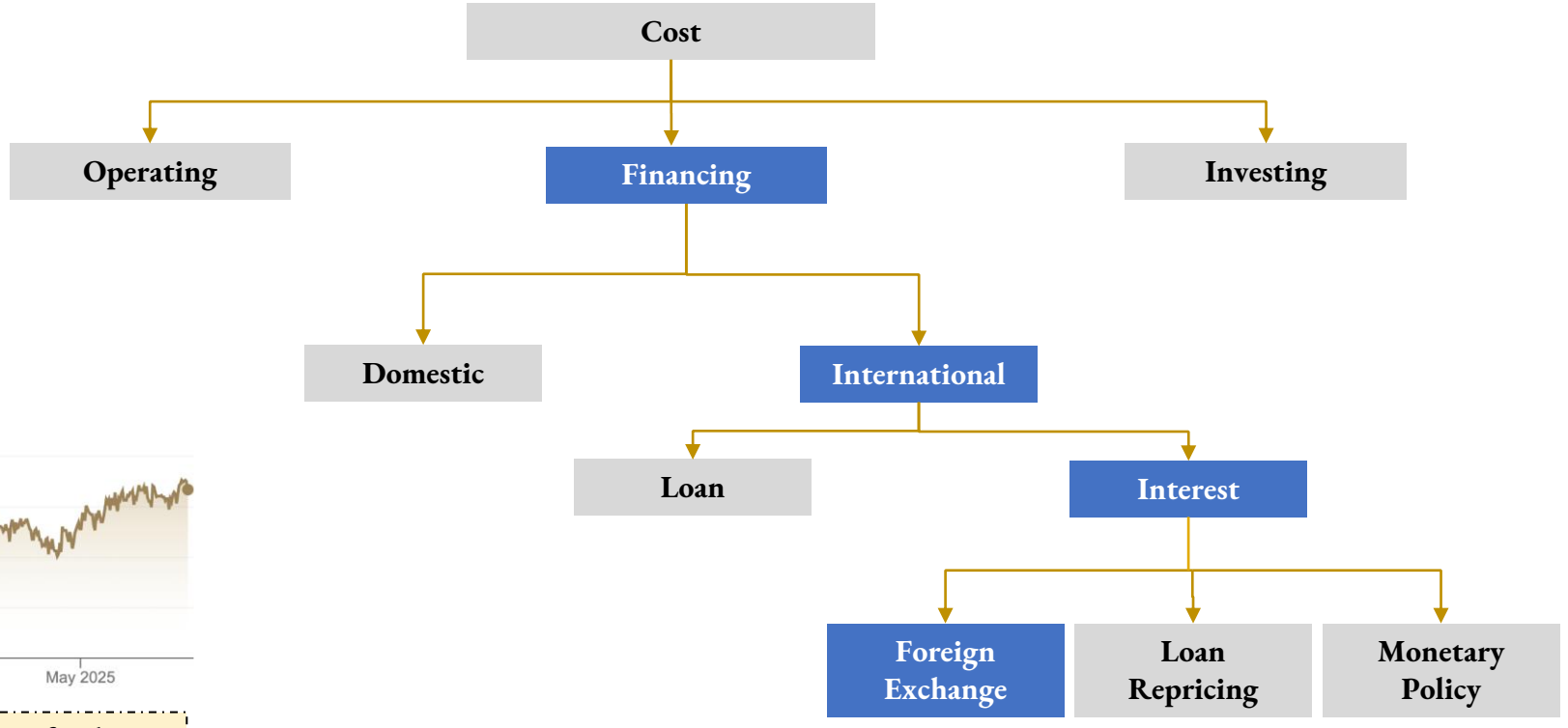
Case Facts & Notes

- **Context** – Airline is facing decline in profits since 2 months.
- **Airline type** – only passengers
- **Customers** – Only HNI
- **Geography** - India, Sri Lanka, Bangladesh and Middle East

Approach



Foreign exchange rate of Malaysia



Recommendations

- Use currency hedging instruments (forwards, options, swaps) to lock in exchange rates and reduce volatility in interest payments to international lenders.
- Reduce exposure to foreign-denominated debt

Insurance Company

Your Client is an insurance company that is having poor quarters. You have to diagnose the problem and recommend solutions.

Before moving forward I want to reiterate the problem statement - client is an insurance company that is experiencing poor quarters. I have to analyze why.

Yes, that is correct.

I have a few questions that I would like to ask to understand the problem much better. What does a poor quarter mean in this context? Also what products does the client offer, and what is their geographical footprint?

Poor quarter means that our revenues have been falling. The client has a pan India presence and mainly deals in providing life insurance.

Next, I would like to know the timeframe and the intensity of the decline? Also has the client faced such a drop in the past?

There has been a 10% decline in revenue from the past 5-6 quarters. No to second question.

I want to understand the client's position in the market and the overall industry landscape for life insurance. Further, is this issue specific to our client or the whole industry is facing?

There is one major player that has 40% market share and in general the industry is fragmented with our client being one of the players. And we have seen that there are 3-4 other players also facing this issue.

Lastly, I want to understand the channels through which the client operates.

Good question. So the client mainly deals through offline channels with 70% of revenue coming from direct sales agents. And the remaining 30% from online or third party websites. But we are seeing the decline from offline channels.

Revenue for an insurance company depends on the number of premiums sold and investment or interest income generated. Do we know which one of this has been affected?

We have seen that the number of premiums being sold has decreased recently.

There can be two major reasons that the number of premiums has gone down. Either it could be an internal issue where the client might not be able to advertise the products or evaluate the premiums. Or it can be an external issue such as any new regulation or law being passed.

There has been no significant developments in the external environment.

Okay, in that case I would like to dive deeper into the customer journey. I would break the journey into three major components:
Pre-purchase: It depends mainly on the need of the premium along with the awareness created by the client and accessibility of the premiums to people.
During purchase: It encompasses the process being followed starting from document verification to paying the principal of the insurance.
Post purchase: It mainly deals with the claim processing and customer services.

The major issue we see is during purchase. Can you elaborate more on the process aspect during enrollment?

Sure. I would like to include two major factors - firstly, time spent in document collection & verification; secondly underwriting process.

One of the issues is that we have witnessed an increase in waiting time for document validation. This is because we have added a new layer of verification. Could you please look at what could be other issues?

Sure. Once the documents are verified and analyzed; risk and premium are calculated. It might be that the risk is not being evaluated correctly and hence, the premiums are priced abruptly.

You have got it right, so there have been some issues with risk calculation from the past few quarters. Could you please figure out why we are facing this issue?

Yes sure. But before moving forward I want to clarify how we are handling the underwriting process, I mean do we have an internal team or do we outsource to any vendor for risk calculation.

We have an outsourced vendor for this process.

Okay, then there might be some issue in the code of the outsourced vendor that is causing wrong premium calculation. Also since you mentioned in the beginning that few other companies are also facing the issue, they might be partnering with the same vendor and hence they are affected too.

Correct, all the companies that use their services have been facing the issue for a few quarters now. Could you provide some recommendations for the same.

I would like to bucket my recommendations as - Short term: where we can look for a new vendor for the underwriting process and Long term: where we can have an inhouse team for the process.

Insurance Company

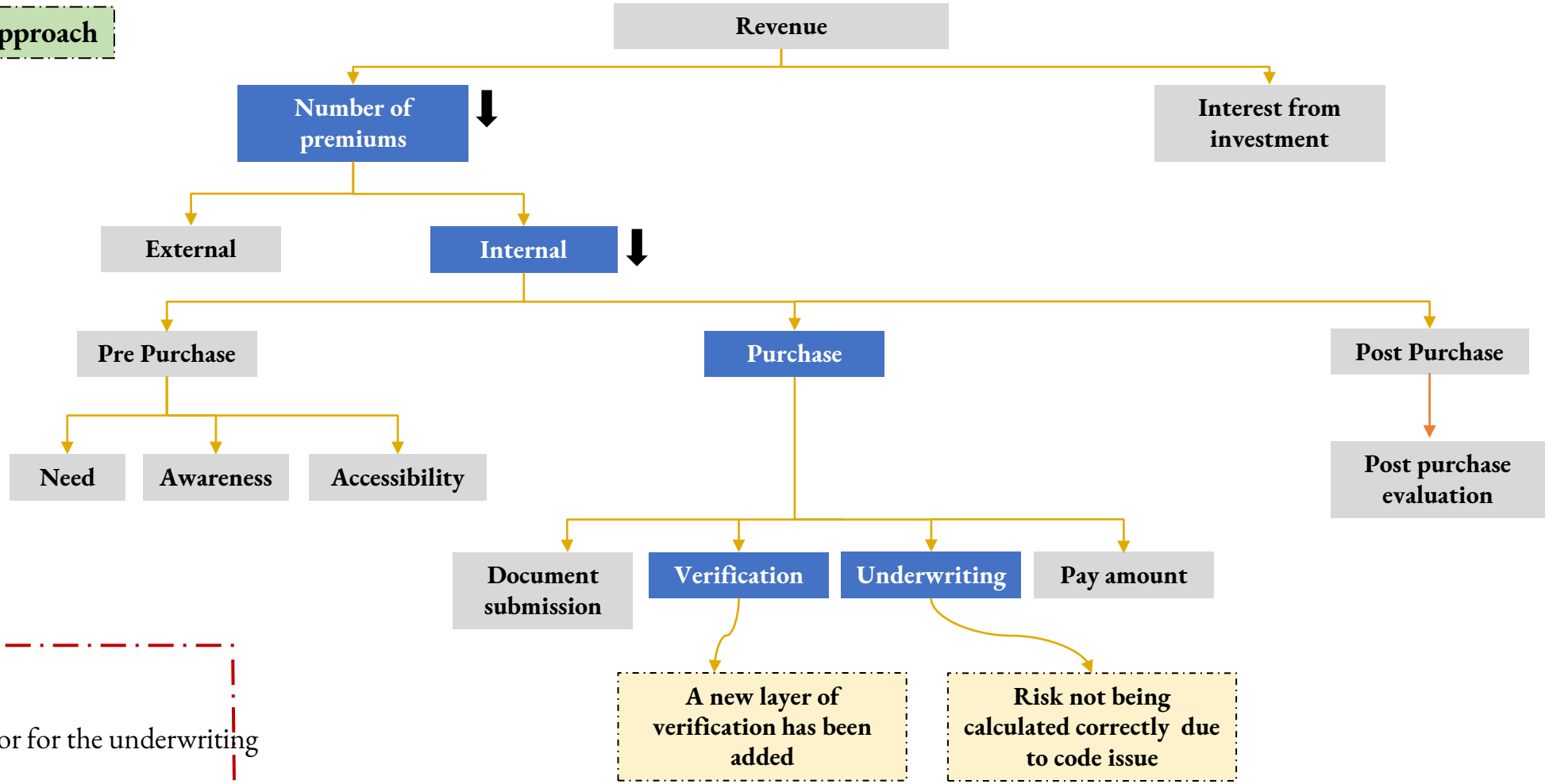
Profitability | Moderate | Kearney

Your Client is an insurance company that is having poor quarters. You have to diagnose the problem and recommend solutions.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Duration** – Last 6 quarters
- **Operations** – direct sales agent i.e. offline channel and online presence
- **Product** – life insurance
- **Geography** – Pan-India
- **Company vs. Industry** – 3-4 players in the market has been affected

Approach



Recommendations

- **Short term :** Look for a new vendor for the underwriting process
- **Long term :** We can have an inhouse team for the underwriting process.

Pharmaceutical Analysis

Your client is a Pharma company with $100 million cost of operation, distribution for which is Procurement cost - $80 million and Overhead cost - $20 million. The current profit margin is 5% over cost. The CEO has asked us to increase the absolute profit.

Before we begin, I'd like to confirm my understanding. Our client is a pharma company and wants to increase absolute profits. Is my understanding correct?

Yes. First, I would like you to tell me what are the various options to increase profit?

Sure. Since Profit is Revenue – Cost, we can either increase revenue, decrease cost or increase revenue and decrease cost simultaneously.

Good, Let's say in the first scenario we explored the second option and were able to decrease the procurement cost by 10% while keeping the revenue constant. Now I want you to give me the increase in Revenue that will lead to same increase in profit as in the first scenario.

From the question we can calculate the current absolute profit as 5% of $100 million = $5 million. After the procurement cost decreased by 10% i.e. $8 million, there will be a net increase in Profit leading to the total absolute profit of ($5 million) + ($8 million) = $13 million. Now for the second scenario we need to increase the revenue in a way that the final profit equals to $13 million. Revenue is price per unit * number of unit sold. Hence we can either increase price or we can increase the number of units sold. Which option would you like me to explore.

As you know price of drugs are regulated by government and other bodies it will be difficult for us to implement. Let us explore the second option.

When we look into increasing the revenue by increasing units sold, our variable cost will also increase. Hence, in order to evaluate the same I would like to know the distribution of cost across variable and fixed costs.

Variable cost is 75% and Fixed is 25% of total cost.

Thank You Sir. I will take some time to write the equation. Now, our target profit = $13 million which can also be written as New Revenue – New Cost. If we assume that increase in revenue is x%, there will be a x% increase in variable cost as well. Hence New Revenue = Old Revenue (1+x) = 105(1+x) and New Cost = Fixed Cost + Variable Cost(1+x) = 25 + 75(1+x). RHS = 105(1+x)-25-75(1+x) = 5 + 30x. LHS = Target Profit = $13 million. Equating RHS = LHS we get x = 8/30 and hence new Revenue = $133 million.

Good. Now that you have explored both the option, I would like you to tell me which is the best option for the company to implement.

I would suggest the company to go with decreasing the cost, since decreasing cost is something that company can control. On the other hand, increasing revenue depends upon market and various other conditions which are not in company's control.

How will you suggest the company go with reducing the cost?

A pharmaceutical company incurs different cost like R&D, manufacturing, distribution, sales promotion, administrative and external service cost. Since, I have had an experience of working on sales strategy for Pharma client; I would like to start with suggesting cost reduction in sales promotion. We can look into 1) retargeting the physicians reached to make sure we are reaching the physicians who have higher potential for writing our drugs 2) resizing the number of sales representative on field to ensure optimal expenditure 3) realigning the representatives to ensure maximum and more effective reach to the physicians.

Good. I think we can wrap up the case here. Thank You.

Pharmaceutical Analysis

Your client is a Pharma company with $100 million cost of operation, distribution for which is Procurement cost - $80 million and Overhead cost - $20 million. The current profit margin is 5% over cost. The CEO has asked us to increase the absolute profit.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Context** – CEO of a Pharmaceutical company wants to analyze options for increasing profit
- **Cost**– Procurement Cost = $80 million and Overhead Cost = $72 million
- **1st scenario: Cost reduction**– 10% decrease in procurement cost
- **Final Target Profit** – ($5 + $8) million = $13 million
- **Revenue Increase** – x% increase in revenue leads to x% increase in variable cost
- **Fixed Cost** = $25 million
- **Variable Cost** = $75 million

Approach

Old Profit = $5 million → New Profit = $13 million

Old Revenues = $105 million ↑

- Price/Unit
- **Volume** ↑

2nd Scenario – Revenue Increase keeping Fixed Cost constant

Target Profit = New Revenue – New Cost
13 million = Old Revenue (1+x) – Fixed Cost – Variable Cost (1+x)
13 million = 105(1+x) – 25 – 75 (1+x)
13 million = (5 + 30x) million
x = 8/30
Hence, New Revenue = 105(1+8/30) = $133 million

Old Costs = $100 million ↓

- Overhead Cost = $20 million
- **Procurement Cost** ↓ = $80 million (10% decrease) = $72 million

1st scenario – Cost decrease keeping Revenue Constant

Recommendations

- The new revenue to reach target profit of $13 million is $133 million
- Cost reduction (in company's control) is a better alternative than increasing revenue (which depends on market)
- In order to reduce cost – reduce cost incurred in sales promotion - Retargeting, Resizing and Realignment

Power Plant

Your client is an Electricity Power plant that has been experiencing a dip in profit for the last 3 months. Find out the reason and provide solutions.

I would like to ask a few clarifying questions. What kind of electricity generation plant is it? Thermal, Solar, Hydro or any other kind. Where is the plant located? Is it facing this problem in multiple locations? Who are the customers? Is there any competition? If yes, are they also facing a decline?

It is a coal gasification plant located in Pune. The direct customer is the government, which then distributes the electricity to all the customers of Pune. There is no competition.

Okay. I have two questions here. What is the difference between a thermal plant where coal is burnt and the heat is used to create steam which then rotates the turbine and a coal gasification plant? Is the company under any contract with the government for providing electricity and if so, have there been any changes in the contract in the last 3 months.

In a coal gasification plant, the ashes or small sized coal is removed and the remaining coal is burnt slowly at a controlled temperature. The gas generated through this is used to rotate the turbine. The company is in a yearly fixed contract with the government. However, there haven't been any changes in the contract.

Thank you for the information. When we talk about declining profits, we relate it to either increase in revenues, decrease in costs or both. May I know the status of the revenue and cost in the last 3 months?

Revenue has remained the same but the Cost has increased.

Okay, so I would like to branch out different types of costs and analyze the area where we have seen an increase in cost.

Sure, go ahead.

The different types of costs are Raw Material Cost which is coal in this case, Manufacturing cost or cost involved in producing electricity, Labor cost, Rent and Utilities cost and other miscellaneous costs which include administrative, selling and advertising expenses. Have we observed increase in any of these costs?

Yes, the total raw material cost has increased.

Okay, so if there is an increase in Raw material cost then it can be either due to increase in Price charged for coal, increase in quantity of coal bought or increase in any shipping cost incurred to bring in the coal to the plant.

Yes, the plant has been buying extra coal for the last 3 months.

That is interesting. I observe that there is no increase in revenue which means the amount of electricity the client is producing has remained same but the amount of coal coming in has increased. Am I correct in my assumption? If yes, may I know where is this extra coal being used?

You are right. We were not able to produce the same amount of electricity with the initial amount of coal that was coming in. Hence, we have started buying more coal. Can you find out the reason behind this increased requirement of coal used in the plant?

Sure. I could think of three possible reasons. 1. The quality of coal incoming has deteriorated which can probably be due to the increased humidity in Pune, 2. The electricity generation procedure has lost its efficiency because of malfunctioning of a machine or reduced capabilities of the labor employed or 3. There could be an increase in wastage of coal in any stage of electricity generation starting from procuring raw material to distributing the electricity. Let me know if there is any other reason that I should explore.

The quality of the coal procured and the efficiency of process is intact. However, we have observed wastage in the coal.

Okay. So now, I would like to analyze the journey of coal. The stages that the coal goes through before finally getting converted into electricity are Procurement, Storage, Transportation from one station to other and Processing. May I know in which particular stage have we observed an increase in coal wastage?

Please focus on the storage stage.

Power Plant

Your client is an Electricity Power plant that has been experiencing a dip in profit for the last 3 months. Find out the reason and provide solutions.

Alright. If there has been an increase in wastage of coal in the storage stage, I would like to know how do we store the coal, what is the process followed to put in and then retrieve the coal and if there has been any significant changes to the way the coal is stored as compared to how it was stored 3 months back.

The coal is stacked one above the other in a warehouse. 3 months back the way the coal is taken out changed from LIFO to FIFO. Can you think of a problem arising due to this change?

Since coal is not a perishable commodity, I don't think there will be any affect on the quality of coal even if it gets stored for extra time. Considering that the coal is stacked one above the other, changing the process of retrieving the coal from LIFO to FIFO can probably lead to breaking or crushing of coal at the lower end due to more unnecessary movement.

Yes, you are right. Crushing of coal is leading to an increase in wastage of coal. Can you provide some solution for the same.

Sure. I have 3 recommendations on how to reduce the wastage of coal - 1. If it is possible, let us change the procedure of retrieving coal back to LIFO, 2. We can change the way coal is stored like creating separate bunches of coal to avoid breakage of coal, 3. Optimize the amount of coal ordered every day, so that the amount of coal stored everyday decreases. I have one more recommendation which will help us increase the revenue.

Sure, What do you have in mind?

The ashes or small sized coal due to breaking or crushing can be sold to thermal power plants as their process of electric generation includes crushing of coal.

Amazing! We can wrap up the case now. Thank you.

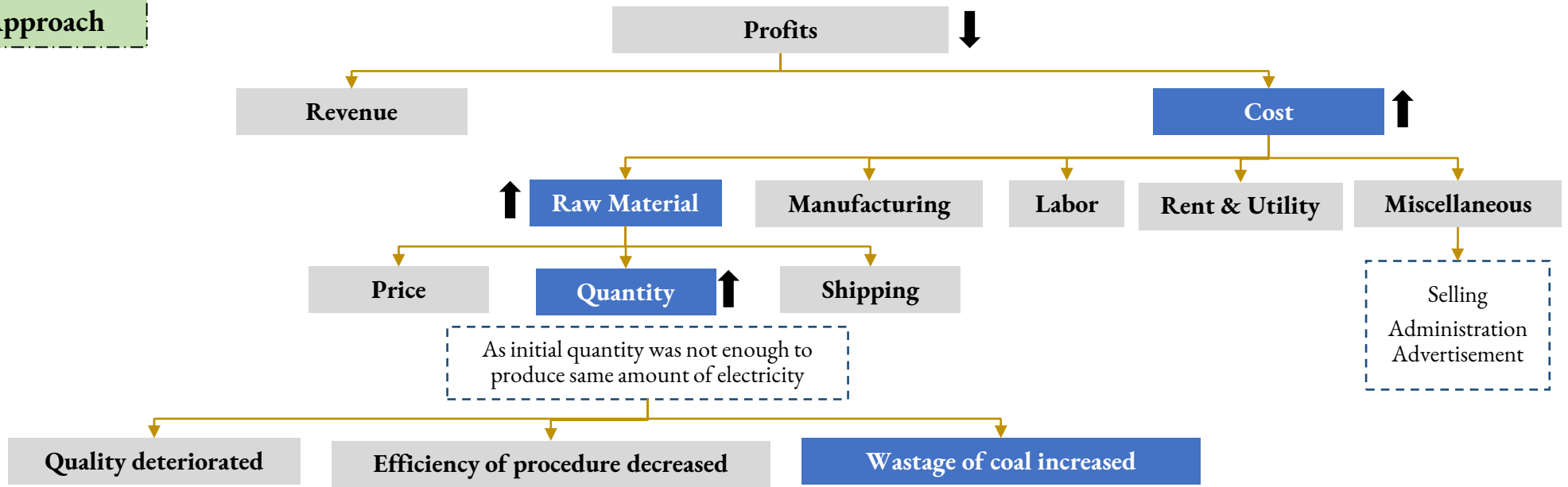
Power Plant

Your client is an Electricity Power plant that has been experiencing a dip in profit for the last 3 months. Find out the reason and provide solutions.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company** –Power Plant in Pune
- **Customers** – Direct customer is government which distributes to the city of Pune. Fixed yearly contract.
- **Competition** – No competition. Monopoly
- **Procedure** – Coal Gasification plant burns ash-free, big lumps of coal in a gas fire at a controlled temperature.

Approach



Recommendations

- Change the procedure of retrieving coal back to LIFO if the reason for change is not a constraint.
- Change the way coal is stored, like creating separate bunches of coal to avoid breakage of coal
- Optimize the amount of coal ordered every day, so that the amount of coal stored everyday decreases.
- Sell the broken or minus sized coal to other thermal plants

Procurement

- Buying the coal
- Unloading the coal
- Moving to storage
- No issues in this stage

Storage

- Coal stored in warehouses
- Coal is stacked up one above the other
- Process of retrieving the coal changed from LIFO to FIFO

Coal at the lower end of stack gets crushed and breaks. Hence more wastage

Transfer

- Moving the coal from one station to other
- Conveyor belts used to transfer the coal
- Smooth process, No issues here

Processing

- Remove ash content. Minus sized coal is removed
- Gasifier – Burn the coal at a low temperature in a controlled way to get the maximum gas to run turbine

Airline Profitability

Your client is an airline, and they are facing decline in profits. Find reasons and recommend solutions.

Reiterating the problem statement, our client owns an airline. They are facing decline in profits. I have to identify the reason & recommend solutions.

Yes, you are right. Please go ahead!

I would like to know more about the problem. What is the decline in profit and how long have we been facing this issue? Is this an Industry wide issue or is it client specific?

Alright, you can assume 15% decline in profits since past 3 months and it is a client specific issue.

I would like to know more about our client. What geographies do they operate in? What type of aircrafts do they operate?

The client only does domestic flights in India and they only operate single aisle aircrafts.

Also, this decline in profits, is it specific to any route or uniform across all routes?

Good question but this decline is uniform across all routes.

Alright, I feel I have enough information about the problem. I would like to start solving the case.

Sure, go ahead

Profit can be divided into revenue and cost, do we have any data to support if this is a revenue side issue, cost side issue or both?

Both the revenue has declined and costs have increased. Let's 1st look at revenue side.

Okay. Airlines generate revenue from tickets, inflight services and extra baggage services, is this decline specific to any of them?

Right, client is facing decline in revenue from baggage services.

Revenue form extra baggage can be termed as number of passengers * extra baggage per passenger * price per kg of extra baggage. Do we have any data to support that any of them have gone down?

As matter of fact, number of passengers and price per kg of extra baggage remained same but extra baggage per passenger has decreased.

Interesting, this can be due to people not bringing in extra baggage or we changing the baggage allowance limit? Since, the prices per kg of extra baggage are same and only we are facing this problem in the industry. Have we changed any rules regarding baggage allowance limit per person?

Good, we have recently updated our loyalty program wherein people are allowed more baggage without any extra charge. Can you now look into the cost side?

Sure, the cost can be divided into 3 parts: pre-flight, during flight and post flight. Pre-flight would include procurement & ground operations, during flight would include fuel, inflight services etc. and post flight would include after sales service and sales & marketing

Let's look at the fuel costs.

Sure, fuel cost will be a function of distance, weight, efficiency and fuel prices. Considering we have allowed people to carry more baggage, there might be increase in the weight. But to be exhaustive have we seen increase in any of the above factors?

No, we haven't seen increase in any other factor than weight per flight which as you rightly pointed out is due to people carrying more baggage. Can you quickly recommend some solutions?

Sure, client should revise its loyalty programme as soon as possible. They can look at giving discounts rather than increasing the baggage limit. Apart from this in order to engage/retain the customers they can look at bundling their services like window seat + meal or taxi service + extra baggage etc.

Thank you, we can end the case here.

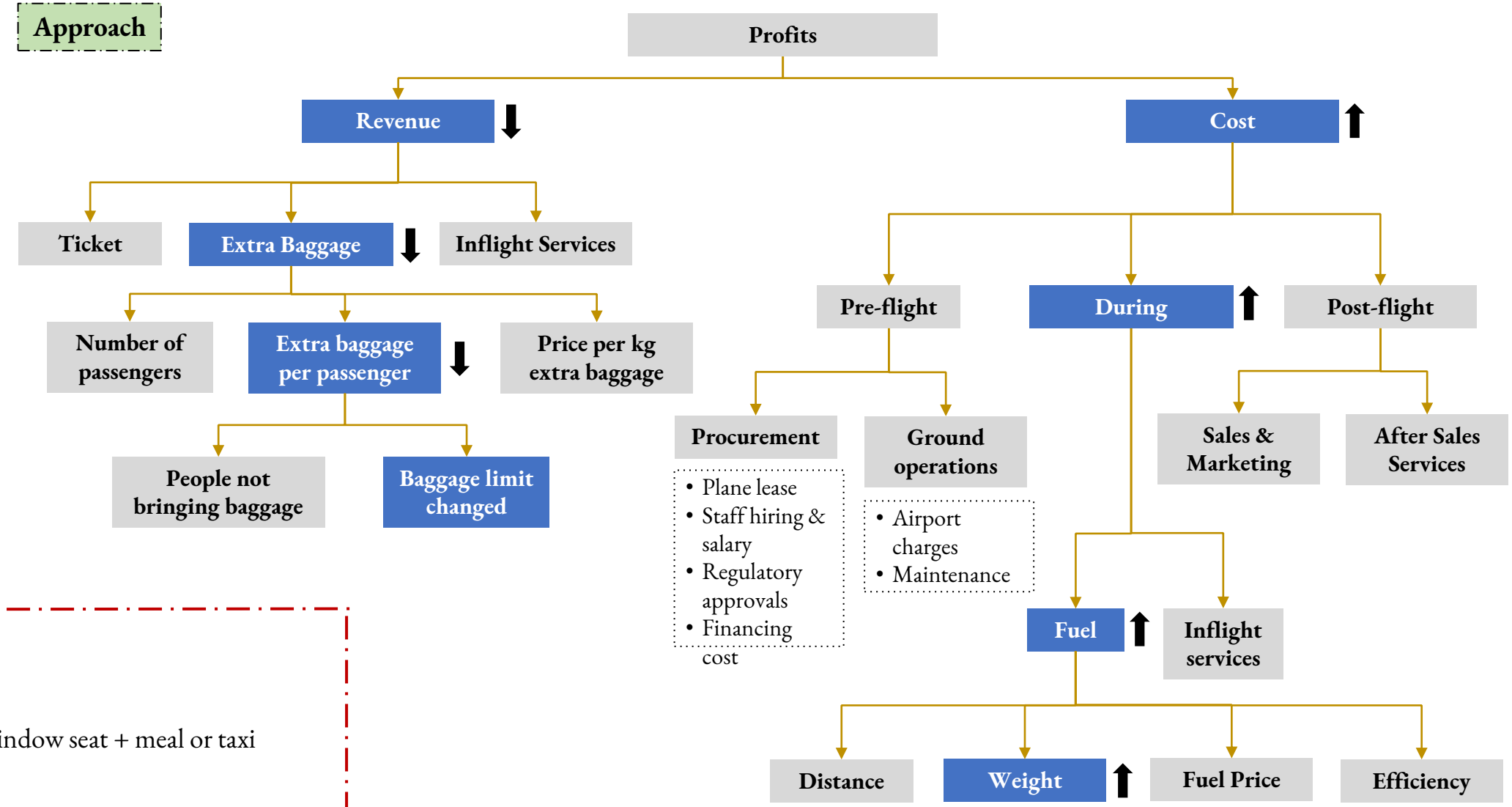
Airline Profitability

Your client is an airline, and they are facing decline in profits. Find reasons and recommend solutions.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Context** – Airline is facing decline in profits since 3 months.
- **Industry Scenario** – Only client is impacted
- **Revenue sources** – Ticket, baggage, inflight services

Approach



Recommendations

- Update Loyalty Program
- Bundling their services like window seat + meal or taxi service + extra baggage etc.

Shopping Mall in South Delhi

Your client operates a shopping mall in South Delhi. They want to increase their advertisement revenue

So, just to be on the same page, I would re-iterate the problem statement. Our client operates a shopping mall in South Delhi & wants to increase their ad revenue.

Yes, absolutely right. Go ahead!

Before delving deeper into the case, I would like to ask a few clarifying questions. Is that fine?

Sure, go ahead!

How big or popular is this shopping mall & what is the proportion of ads in its revenue?

So, it is one of the largest & most popular malls in all of Delhi & ads have currently 8% revenue share.

Also, What are the various categories of Ads that our client indulges in & who are its clients for these ads?

That's a good question. So, you can consider the ads categories to be firstly, Displays which are either billboards or standees & secondly, some events/exhibitions held in the mall. We have both internal as well as external clients. Internal clients are in-mall outlets. External clients include exhibitions held by car or other vehicle dealers & other events being held by some various firms & organizations. In mall-outlets are more frequents clients & events are least frequent.

Thank you sir! One last question. How do we benchmark our ad revenues?

So, we benchmark it with similar businesses, Past ad revenue numbers & also compare ad revenue between different ad categories.

Ok Sir. Just provide me a couple of minute of gather my thoughts and analyse the problem.

Sure!

So, Ads revenue will depend upon 3 factors: Allotted space, average revenue/ unit space & % utilization. I would like to look into these factors one by one & suggest ways of increasing overall revenue using these. Is that fine with you?

Sure! Go ahead.

Allotted space can be divided into space optimization & new space. We consider gross revenue/space from existing spaces used for advertising & optimize use looking in visibility & footfall. We can optimize ad mix/year & charge more for spaces with high visibility & footfall. For new space, we look into internal (elevators, washroom) & external spaces (Parking lots, rooftops)

This looks good. Go ahead!

Ad revenue/unit space can be divided into new categories, new methods & pricing models. We can hold entertainment/ festival events. We can advertise on kiosks, uniforms, sign boards, foot-maps

This looks interesting.

In new methods we can include digital screens. Ads will be replaced easily & take less space. We can use customized kiosks to handle basic level exhibitions. This will take less space & increase revenue /space. We can look into pricing model too. It has 2 challenges: right price & convincing clients. We shall link prices to response of mall consumers to extract maximum revenue potential of ads.

These are really good insights. What about the % utilization?

Yes sir. So, % utilization can be further segmented into client management & maintenance of spaces. Under client management, we can start doing e-listing of spaces for external clients & use separate internal platform for internal clients. We can offer packaged offerings to our clients such as fully managed events/exhibitions. We also shall look into data with respect to client exposure.

This looks good to me. On what factors do you think choice of ads for our client will depend?

So the choice will depend upon various like medium of advertisement, associated cost, potential exposure to the customers, relevance of ad for the mall audience, middle agencies involved & ease of implementation.

Good Job! Hope to see you in the next round.

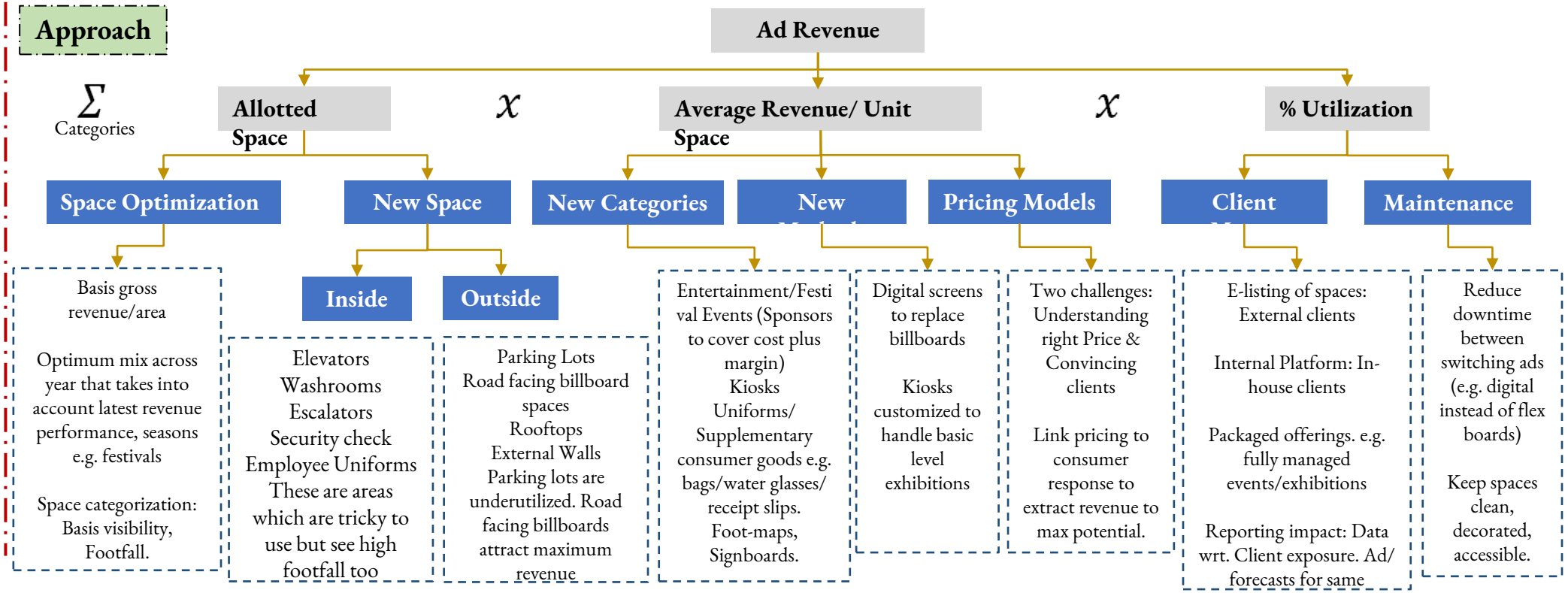
Shopping Mall in South Delhi

Your client operates a shopping mall in South Delhi. They want to increase their advertisement revenue

Case Facts & Notes

- **Shopping Mall** – One of the largest & most popular in Delhi. Facilities, Customer base.
- **Current Status** – 8% revenue share for ads. Categories: Displays (Billboards /Standees). Events/Exhibitions.
- **Benchmarking with:** Competitors, Similar businesses, Past numbers, Between Categories
- **Clients:**
  - Mainly In-mall outlets
  - Car dealers in exhibition
  - Events: wide base, less frequent

Approach



Supplementary Aspects

How clients choose between two Ad options

Important Factors

Nature of offering: Medium of advertising
Price: Cost associated with options
Reach: Potential exposure to consumers
Relevance: Between their business & mall audience
Middle Agencies: Have significant influence on their final choice
Ease of implementation: Critical when it comes to events

Analytical Pricing Model for an Advertisement

Price = $f_{internal}$ (Location, Size, Medium, Internal cost, Time, Special Features) + $f_{external}$(Season, Mall popularity, Competition)

Function relating these parameters can be derived based on:

Existing data such as footfall. (Better collection of data is essential)
Competitive Benchmarking with similar businesses e.g. Gaming Arcades
Understanding Elasticities basis operational experience

Food Manufacturer Case

Your client is a food product manufacturing corporation and has observed a decline in profits. Figure out the problem.

Sir, just to be on the same page, our client is a food manufacturing corporation and they are observing a decline in profits and I have to help in figuring out the problem.

Yes, that's right.

Can I ask a few clarifying questions regarding the case?

Sure, go ahead!

In which geography are we based? What markets do we serve?

We are based out of India, and serve the entire country.

What is our product? Are we just into manufacturing or other parts of the value chain too?

We are a Biscuit manufacturing company and present across the entire value chain. Consider Parle.

Thank you! And do we have multiple products? Or just a single type of biscuit.

For this particular case, Consider we are a single product company. Take Parle-G as proxy.

Thank you sir! And since when have we been facing this problem?

Almost 6 months.

Is it an industry-wide problem?

Good question! It seems that the industry has been immune to this issue.

Okay Sir! I would like to take a few moments to structure my thoughts before we move ahead. I will approach this problem by dividing profits into revenues and costs. What would you like me to approach first?

Since there are no changes in revenues, I would like you to look into costs.

Okay, then I will breakdown costs using value chain based approach.

So we break the value chain into raw material, transportation, manufacturing, packaging, warehousing, outbound logistics, sales and marketing. Would you like me to look into a particular head.

I want you to look into Warehousing costs.

Okay. Warehousing costs can be broken into rent, labour and food wastage costs. Since biscuit is product that comes with expiry, wastage costs might be a big risk.

Yes, you are right! We are facing issues in food losses only.

Okay, so losses in food can be due to pests or due our own system of inventory management. Are we facing some kind of pests related issues?

No

So the problem can be in our own management. Can you help me understand the logistics process of this company?

Now that inventory management has been identified as the problem area, consider this. The warehouse used to have 2 doors (entry and exit door). The exit door no longer exists. How could this be a problem? Also suggest solution/s.

Sure sir! Just give me a minute to think. It is possible that the goods are stored away from the entry door first and near the exit door in the end. During distribution, goods are collected from near the entry door first and away from the entry door last i.e. LIFO model of inventory management is in place. LIFO model will result in losses since biscuit is a perishable good and has a limited shelf life.

Good! What will you recommend?

There are 2 immediate solutions that I can think of. One is to shift to FIFO type of inventory management. Second would be open the previously closed door to facilitate FIFO.

Okay! Thank you. You can leave now!

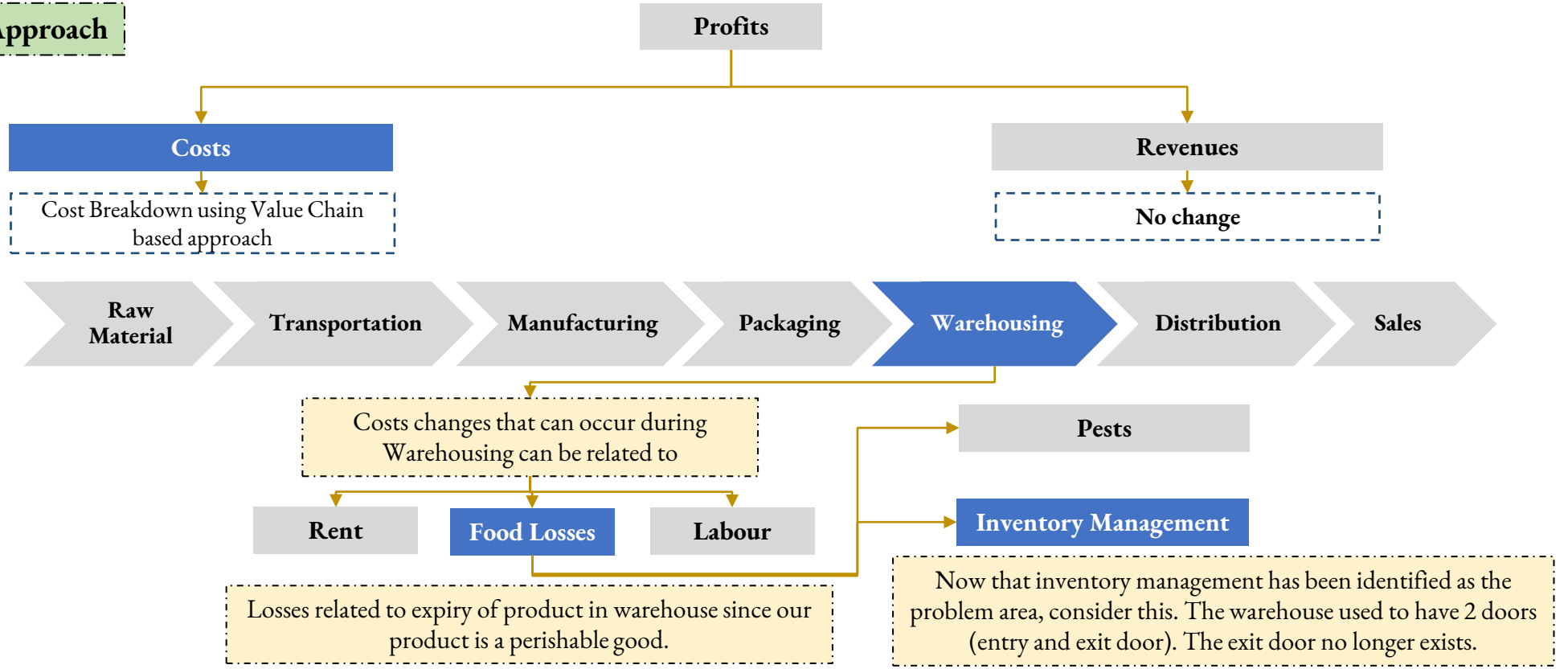
Food Manufacturer Case

Your client is a food product manufacturing corporation and has observed a decline in profits. Figure out the problem.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company**–Biscuit manufacturing company
- **Geography**-Based out of India, serves India
- **Product**- Single product. Proxy-Parle G
- **Value Chain** – Present across the entire value chain
- **Duration of the Problem** -6 months
- Just Us

Approach



Recommendations

Shift to FIFO model of inventory management.
Open the closed date.

- It is possible that the goods are stored away from the entry door first and near the entry door in the end.
- During distribution, goods are collected from near the entry door first and away from the entry door last i.e. LIFO model of inventory management is in place
- LIFO model will result in losses since biscuit is a perishable good and has a limited shelf life.

IT Services Client

The client is an IT Services firm, interested in improving the bottom-line of the India Region, help them chart their way forward

Thank you sir, so just to reiterate and confirm, our client is an IT Services firm and they want to improve their bottom-line in India.

Yes, that's right

Okay, so I had a few questions to clarify my thoughts.

Sure, go ahead.

Where are we located apart from India, and are there any benchmarks we have in mind compared to other locations or companies about increasing the bottom-line?

In India, we're located in New Delhi, Apart from that, we're located in New York, US. There isn't any benchmark but we're not doing as well as New York on some parameters.

Okay, thank you. So, I believe to improve bottom-line, we need to either increase our revenues or decrease our costs and spending? Is there any which you want me to focus on?

There isn't much scope to increase revenue. Let's look at the cost side.

Alright, so for an IT Services firm, if I think of costs, major would be infrastructural and administrative, software development costs, and the employee costs.

Yes, that's right. You can explore more on each of these. We label them as SG&A and employee costs respectively.

Okay, talking about SG&A, it would include I believe it would include hardware, software costs, and also all the Outsourcing costs while the employee costs would depend on the number of employees, their utilisation and wages. Should I discover if there is scope to improve any of these?

Yes, that's true. SG&A does not have much scope to reduce costs while I would definitely want you to explore the employee related costs. The factors you've mentioned are fine.

Okay, thank you. So in that case, I would want to ask if we have any information about how many employees we have and also about their utilisation rates to see if they are over or under staffed.

Sure, so you can have a look at these data points for number of employees, utilisation rates and number of employees in both New Delhi and New York. (Provides datasheet)
Number of Employees: 1) New Delhi – 5000 Employees, 75% utilization, 2) New York – 10,000 Employees, 85% utilization
Avg Cost Per Employees: 1) New Delhi - $700 each, 2) New York - $800 each

Thanks! So analysing this sheet, I can see that in New Delhi, utilisation levels are lower than New York and there seems to be a clear case of overstaffing.

Yes, so what would you suggest to the firm in this case.

I believe to increase worker utilisation rates should be the firm's first priority and as a benchmark we can keep the New York office numbers a first target.

Alright, that sounds good, how do you aim to achieve those increased rates.

That could be done in two ways, either we could take the hard decision of laying off people or we can try and get more projects for the firm, which I'm sure the company would anyway have been trying to do.

Yes, that's right. If you were to layoff, how many would you need to?

(Performs calculations) Given the data at hand, I think we would need to layoff a little less than 600 workers from the New Delhi office, saving on major costs and improving the bottom-line.

Okay, that seems fair. Anything you would want to suggest the company before taking such a move?

Well, these are decisions that might cause a hit on the brand image of the company so they should be done keeping in mind the employees' futures in terms of the negotiation or settlement that is made when they're asked to leave and also while being conscious of the negative press we might accumulate. If we can get over these two important considerations carefully, I think this would be in the right interest of the firm.

Alright, that should be good to go!

IT Services Client

The client is an IT Services firm, interested in improving the bottom-line of the India Region, help them chart their way forward

Case Facts & Notes

- It is an IT Services Player present in India (New Delhi) and US (New York)
- Provide BPO Services and customized Software Development
- Clients are present across all sectors
- **Objective:** Improve Bottom-line as soon as possible

Approach

Bottomline Improvement

- **Increase in Revenues**
- **Decrease in Major Costs**
  - **Employee Costs**
    - **Average Cost per Employee**
      - As per industry standards
    - **No of Employees**
      - Problem not restricted to any one department
    - **Employee Utilization Factor**
      - Higher utilization would lead to lower employee cost per project
  - **Selling, General and Administrative Expenses**
    - Critical component as acquiring clients for both BPO and Software Development is the driver of topline
    - No Scope of Improvement

Basic Facts:

No of Employees:

- New Delhi – 5000 Employees, 75% utilization
- New York – 10,000 Employees, 85% utilization

Avg Cost Per Employees:

- New Delhi - $700 each
- New York - $800 each

Recommendations

Cost Savings

- **Layoffs**
- **Increase in Projects**

There needs to be increase in employee utilization at New Delhi Office. For this, if layoffs are considered, total layoffs required would be 5000(1- (75%/85%)) i.e. 588 employees, saving Rs 411,000 approx.

If projects increase, an increase in topline could lead to an increase in bottom-line too. But economics and impact of employee utilization should still be taken into consideration

Steel Manufacturer Costs

Your client is the CEO of a Steel Manufacturing Company and he thinks that his transportation costs are very high. Help him understand if he is correct.

So, just to be on the same page, I would re-iterate the problem statement. Our client is CEO of a Steel manufacturing company and he thinks that his transportation costs are very high & we have to help him understand if he is correct.

Yes, absolutely right. Go ahead!

Before delving deeper into the Case, I would like to ask a few clarifying questions. Is that fine?

Sure, go ahead!

In which Geography does the client operate? Is there a single plant or multiple plants?

So, our client operates across Delhi, Kolkata, Chennai, Mumbai & Pune. They have 2 plants.

Also, does the client operate any other operation apart from that of Steel manufacturing?

Yes, they operate in transportation & distribution segment apart from steel manufacturing.

Thank you sir! Do we have any information regarding our Customer segments & their proportion in our business?

Our client operates in B2B segment, but we don't have any customer segment wise data.

Moreover, what do we know about the competition in the industry?

So, it is a fragmented market with many competitors. Our client is one of the major players.

Also, what are the Products that our client makes?

So, the Client makes Steel rods & nails & uses finished steel as the raw material. But the client controls only the outbound logistics.

Since, the client is also involved in the transportation & distribution apart from manufacturing, do we have any information related to any regulation which affects our client's business?

Yes, so the client has to pay Toll/State tax at each border for inter-state travel. That's all we have.

Sure sir, thank you! Just give me a couple of minutes to gather my thoughts & analyse the problem.

Sure, Go ahead!

Because this is related to costs, I would like to look into the value chain of our client's business. I have drawn the value chain from Inbound Logistics to Final delivery. But, since our client controls only outbound logistics, I would like to focus on that.

Sure!

Does our client owns its own vehicles for transportation & distribution or does it rent them? Do we have any data regarding that?

Yes, we have. So, our client uses 3rd Party vendors to rent trucks. The average truck rental is Rs.25/Km. Average route length is around 1000 Km & on an average there are 30 trips annually.

Thank you for this data. So, this comes to a cost of around Rs. 7. Lacs/year for a single truck. But to see how the client is doing on the cost front, we need some data to benchmark. If the client wishes to own his own truck, the cost that he incurs annually in that case can be a good benchmark for us to see how is he doing right now on cost front. Do we have any data regarding that?

Yes. (Interviewer gives a data sheet mentioning all the relevant costs)

In this case, the annual cost/truck comes to around Rs. 13,30,000 which is a lot more than current.

Yes. So what do you recommend?

I think owning trucks doesn't look like a relevant option for our client. But, to further reduce the cost I have following recommendations: We can try to negotiate cost with the current vendor or change the vendor if we get lower bid. We can try to utilize the full capacity of trucks in each trip so that number of trips can be reduced annually. Further, we can also look into the option of Route optimization which would reduce the average route length in each trip for our client. Also, if it's possible we can look into the cheaper modes of transport such as railways for bulk transport of our items which might help us to reduce our costs.

These recommendations look good to me. Well done!

Steel Manufacturer Costs

Your client is the CEO of a Steel Manufacturing Company and he thinks that his transportation costs are very high. Help him understand if he is correct.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Client** - Steel Manufacturer- Major Player. Transportation/ Distribution along with Manufacturing. 2 Plants
- **Customers** - Mainly B2B across Delhi, Mumbai, Pune, Chennai, Kolkata.
- **Product** - Finished steel as raw material. Steel rods & nails. We only control Outbound logistics.
- **Competitors** - Fragmented Mkt. Client is one of major players making steel rods & nails.
- **Regulation/Route** - Toll/State tax at each border for inter-state travel.

Approach

Value Chain

Inbound Logistics (Raw Materials) → Manufacturing/ Processing → Warehousing → **Outbound Logistics** → Final Delivery

Client is using 3rd Party Vendors (Truck Rentals)
Truck Rental: Rs. 25/Km
Route Distance: 1000 Km
No. of trips: 30 (Annually)
Total Cost: Rs. 30*1000*25
= **Rs. 7,50,000/yr**.

Note: Since we only have to concentrate only on Outbound Logistics, we analyse it further (confirm with interviewer)

To assess whether this figure is high, we need a benchmark,
What if the client wishes to purchase his own transport and own up the complete outbound logistics:
Cost of Truck Rs. 30 Lakhs ; Life 10 yrs. (Salvage value 0); Mileage 5km/ltr.

Description	Value (Rs.)	Amount (Annual)
Fuel	50/Ltr.	3,00,000
Driver Salary	10000/trip	3,00,000
Toll	100/100 km	30,000
Depreciation	3,00,000/yr.	3,00,000
Maintenance		3,00,000
Tyre Replacement		1,00,000
Total		**13,30,000**

Recommendations

- Change of Vendor OR Negotiate with current vendor
- Utilise the full truck load capacity to reduce the number of trips
- Route optimization
- Use cheaper means of transport: Railways for bulk transport

Women Apparel Chain

Cost Reduction | Moderate | Bain & Co.

Your Client is a big 'women apparel' retailer is facing margins problem. They are experiencing a constant sales growth but there is a cost problem in the retail side. They want you to find out the problem & give recommendations.

I would re-iterate the problem statement first to be on the same page. Our Client is a big 'women apparel' retailer facing margins problem. They are experiencing constant sales growth but there is a cost problem in the retail side & they want us to find out the problem & give recommendations

Yes, absolutely right. Go ahead!

Before delving deeper into the Case, I would like to ask a few clarifying questions. Is that fine?

Sure, go ahead!

Where is the client based out of & where does it operate?

The client is based out of USA & owns a retail chain operating in USA.

Also, does the client sell its products only via its own stores or through some other channels as well?

They sell only via their own retail stores.

Thank you sir! Do we have any information regarding what kind of different products our client sells?

You can consider the client sells Women merchandise. That shall suffice the requirements of this case.

Sure sir, thank you! Just provide me a couple of minutes to gather my thoughts and analyse the problem.

Sure!

Sir, Since this is a Cost problem, I would like to divide the Costs into two components, Fixed & Variable costs. Fixed costs can be further segmented into 5 types: Rent, Utilities, Salary, Machinery & Administration costs. Variable costs can be segmented into 3 types: Raw materials, Transportation & Miscellaneous costs. Do we have any information regarding which cost segment is a cause of concern for our client?

Yes! I would like you to look into the fixed cost component of Salaries.

Sure sir! I would like to look into the structure of the retail side of our business as in where all do we pay salaries. I can think of Retail shop service staff, maintenance staff. Do we have any information on what are the various layers at which we pay salaries & how much?

That' a nice observation. I would like to give you some data regarding our salary structure. We have 4 layers in our value Chain: Regional Sales Heads (4), Divisional Sales Heads (10), Territorial Heads (16) & Shop Sales Heads (60). The per employee salary at these 4 layers are: $350, $300, $280 & $100 respectively. Looking at this data can you tell me your observations?

Thank you sir! So, Total Salaries at these 4 layers are : $1400, $3000, $4480 & $6000 respectively. What I can see is the salary expenditures at Territorial Head & Shop Sales Head levels are relatively higher. So, I am thinking of looking into these.

Sure! Go ahead.

I would want to benchmark our Salary expenditure at these levels with our competitors to check whether the compensation that we are paying at these levels are fair or not & also if our staffs are working at comparable efficiency or not. Do we have any information regarding these factors?

That is quite insightful. Yes, I have some data for you. Our competitor has 5 people manning each store whereas we have 6 people manning each store. What do you understand out of this?

I think then we have identified the problem. There are two situations possible. Either the efficiency is not up to the mark or there is some problem in the training

So, what do you recommend then?

Sir! I have two recommendations. Firstly, our client shall look into why we need 6 people as compared to 5. We shall take into account # of customer walk-ins & shift durations & act accordingly. Secondly, We Shall also analyze our Training process & look into Curriculum, duration & evaluation criteria & take corrective measures

Good job! This looks perfect. We are done.

Women Apparel Chain

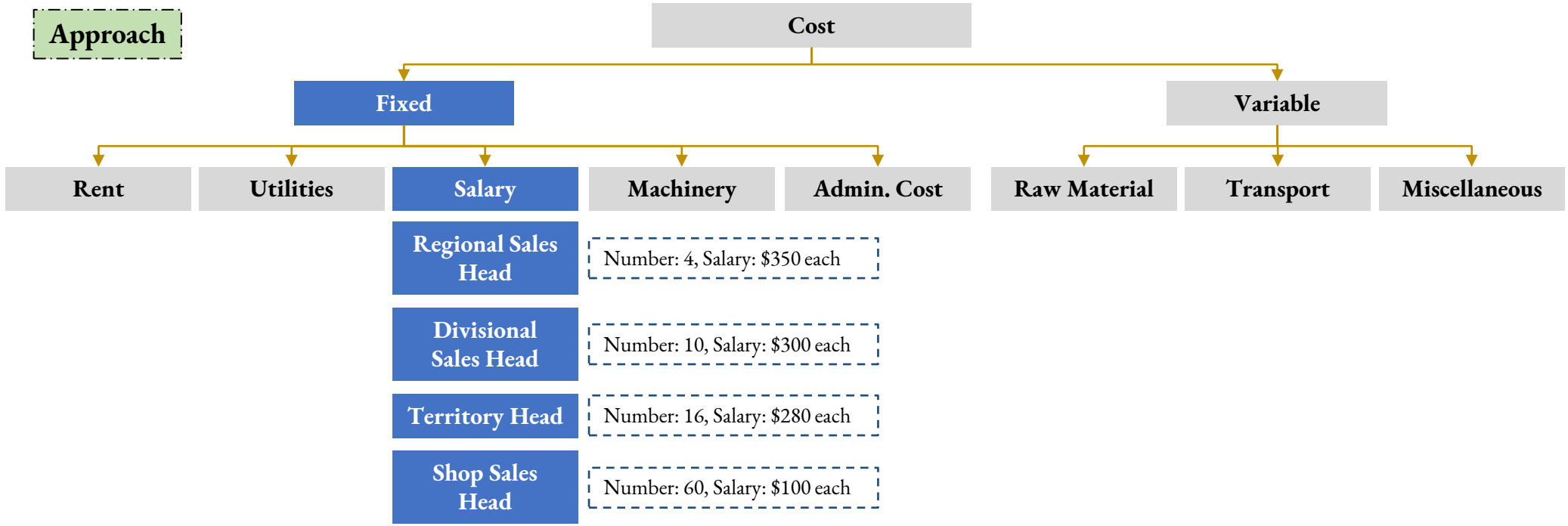
Cost Reduction | Moderate | Bain & Co.

Your Client is a big 'women apparel' retailer is facing margins problem. They are experiencing a constant sales growth but there is a cost problem in the retail side. They want you to find out the problem & give recommendations.

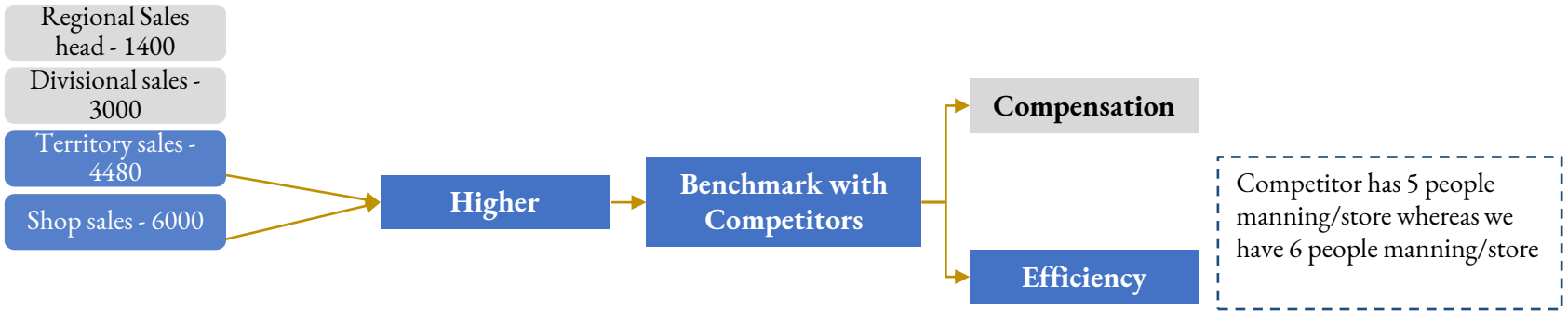
Case Facts & Notes

- **Client-**
  - Owns a retail chain operating in USA
  - Sells only via own stores
- **Product-**
  - Sells Women Merchandise

Approach



Analysis



Recommendation

- Client shall look into why we need 6 people as compared to 5. We shall take into account # of customer walk-ins & shift durations & act accordingly.
- We Shall also analyze our Training process & look into Curriculum, duration & evaluation criteria & take corrective measures.

2024 Olympic TV Rights

Your client is a major TV Network, wants to know how much to bid on the TV rights for the 2024 Olympic Games. Bid is to be paid in 2019.

Sir, just to be on the same page, our client is a TV network company, which wishes to bid for the 2024 Olympics Games TV rights. I have to help them figure this amount in 2019. I would like to ask some clarifying questions.

Yes, you are right. Go ahead!

What is the objective of this bidding?

For a TV network the objective is to maximise profits.

Okay, then we will have to look at costs of bidding and revenues we can generate from the telecast. Can I assume that advertisements on the channel is the major source of revenue?

Yes, they will only show the Olympics on their one flagship channel.

And in what region are we planning to telecast the Olympics.

Good question. Consider USA.

Okay and Can I assume that Olympic programming will replace regularly scheduled programming.

Yes, Go ahead!

Okay for exact calculation of the advertisement revenue I will need specific data related to Olympics, so we will come back to it again. I would like to explore costs first. Do we have any data for coverage costs?

Consider all costs associated with coverage are $500 Million

Okay. Should I consider other costs too? Like opportunity costs of missing out on other content and revenue from them?

Yes, consider opportunity costs too. The value is $1M/hour.

If that all on the cost side. I would to move to revenue side. How long are the Olympic games?

The duration of the Games is 16 days. This comprises of one day each for opening and closing ceremony and 14 days of events.

And can I assume that Opening and closing ceremony will have higher viewership. Even certain times of the day and events will have higher viewership than other and we consider that in our pricing model?

Yes, you are right. Event Broadcast timings- a) Weekdays: 9am – 12 pm, 2pm – 5pm, and 11 pm. b) Weekends: 11am – 9pm. Duration of opening & closing ceremony: 3 hrs each

Okay, and how much are we charging per ad to customers. Also, since its Olympics I will assume all slots will be filled.

- Ad costs**:** $400K/30 seconds during prime time and half of this ($200K/30) during non-prime time.
- Prime Time is considered anytime after 7pm on a weekday, and all day during the weekends.
- Ad duration: 10 min/hour
- Opening and closing ceremony ads costs 50% above primetime costs

Okay based on the above data, the revenue come out to be $952M. Total costs are $500 + 146 hours * 1M/hour = $646M. Thus the profits come out to be $306M. So we can bid anything below $306M.

Are you forgetting something?

Oh yes, the bid is to be made in 2019. These profits are in 2024. So we will have to discount them to present value. Do we have the value for cost of capital?

Take Cost of Capital as 10%**.**

Based on this, the bid price shouldn't be greater than $190M in 2019.

Good! It was nice doing a case with you. You may go now!

Thank You!

2024 Olympic TV Rights

Your client is a major TV Network, wants to know how much to bid on the TV rights for the 2024 Olympic Games. Bid is to be paid in 2019.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Objective** – For a TV network the objective is profits.
- **Revenue Sources**-a) Advertisements on the channel is the major source of revenue
- **Region** - USA
- **Duration of the Games**- 16 days. This comprises of one day each for opening and closing ceremony and 14 days of events.
- **Event Broadcast timings- a)** Weekdays: 9am – 12 pm, 2pm – 5pm, and 7-11 pm. b) Weekends: 11am – 9pm
- Olympic programming will replace regularly scheduled programming.
- **Costs associated with coverage:** $500 Million
- **Opportunity Costs from other programming:** $1M / hour
- **Ad costs:** $400K/30 seconds during prime time and half of this ($200K/30) during non-prime time.
- Prime Time is considered anytime after 7pm on a weekday, and all day during the weekends.
- They will only show the Olympics on their one flagship channel
- Ad duration: 10 min/hour
- Opening and closing ceremony ads costs 50% above primetime costs
- **Duration of opening & closing ceremony:** 3 hrs each
- Cost of Capital : 10%

Recommendations

To earn a profit, the bid amount should be less than **$190M.**

Approach

Evaluating the costs and the revenues. → Costs will also include opportunity cost arising from other programs → Using Time Value of Money(TVM) concept to adjust for prepayment in 2019

Profits

- **Costs**
  - **Coverage Cost**
    - **$500 Million**: includes all fixed and variables costs for travel, equipment, salaries.
  - **Opportunity Costs**
    - **$1 Million/hour:** Total opportunity costs= 146 hours* $1 million =**$146 Million**
- **Revenues**
  - **Advertisement Revenue**
    - **Revenue from primetime + Non primetime + Ceremony hours = $640M+$240M+$72M= $952M**

Slot	Total no. of hours	Ad Revenue (per min.)	Ad Minutes	Total Ad revenue
Primetime	4*10+4*10=80	$800K	800	800*0.8=$640M
Non Primetime	6*10= 60	$400K	600	600*0.4=$240M
Ceremony	3+3=6	$1200K	60	60*1.2=$72M

Total Expected Profits

= Revenue - Costs
= $952M-$146M-$500M= $306M

TVM concept:
Profits have been calculated in 2024
Since bid amount paid in 2019, these need to be discounted to present value.

Profit Calculation in 2019:
Profits in 2019 = Profit in 2024 discounted 5 times
=$306M/(1.1^5) =$190M

Domestic Airline

Your client is a leading domestic airline in India. They have observed a decline in profits for past 4 months. They have approached you to identify the reasons

If I may confirm, our client is a domestic airline that has witnessed a decline in profits over the past four months and wants us to identify the root cause and recommend solutions.

Correct

Before I begin, I have a few clarifying questions. Has the decline been observed across all routes?

Yes, across most domestic routes.

Has the industry also witnessed a similar decline?

Yes, industry has faced a decline in profits but we have faced the

Could you quantify the decline in profits?

Profits have declined by nearly 20%.

Is our objective to restore historical profitability while maintaining our service levels?

Yes.

Got it. Let me summarize. We are facing a 20% decline in profits over the last four months, while competitors remain unaffected. May I take a minute to structure my thoughts?

Sure

I would like to divide profits into two buckets: Revenue and Costs. I would first identify which bucket is responsible for the decline before drilling down further.

Yes. Our analysis suggests that the issue lies on the revenue side.

I would further divide revenue into the number of tickets sold and the revenue earned per ticket. Revenue per ticket would include ticket prices as well as ancillary revenues such as baggage fees, food & beverages, seat selection and lounge services.

Good approach. The decline is primarily due to a reduction in the number of tickets sold.

I would divide the number of tickets sold into demand-side and supply-side factors.

Makes sense. The issue lies on the supply side.

Since the issue is operational, I would analyze the airline's value chain consisting of ticket sales, passenger check-in, passenger boarding, flight operations, passenger deboarding and turnaround operations.

The issue lies within flight operations.

Within flight operations, I would divide it into the number of airports served, the number of flights operated and airport-related issues.

The issue lies with the number of flights being operated.

I would further divide the number of flights into aircraft availability, employee availability and operational issues.

Good. The issue lies with employee availability.

Within employees, I would analyze pilots, cabin crew and ground staff.

The issue lies with pilots.

I would divide pilots into the number of pilots available and the number of flying hours available per pilot.

The issue lies with the flying hours.

I would divide flying hours into internal and external factors such as scheduling, leave management, regulations and weather.

Good structure. The issue lies within the external factors. Due to revised DGCA regulations, pilots are exhausting their permissible flying hours sooner, resulting in fewer flights being operated.

Understood. Since fewer flights are operating, ticket availability has reduced, leading to fewer tickets sold and consequently lower revenues and profits. I would now like to recommend some solutions.

Please go ahead.

In the short term, the airline should optimize pilot rostering, prioritize high-demand routes and lease pilots wherever feasible. In the long term, it should strengthen pilot hiring, expand training capacity and invest in AI-based crew scheduling systems.

Sounds good. Thank you, we can conclude the case here.

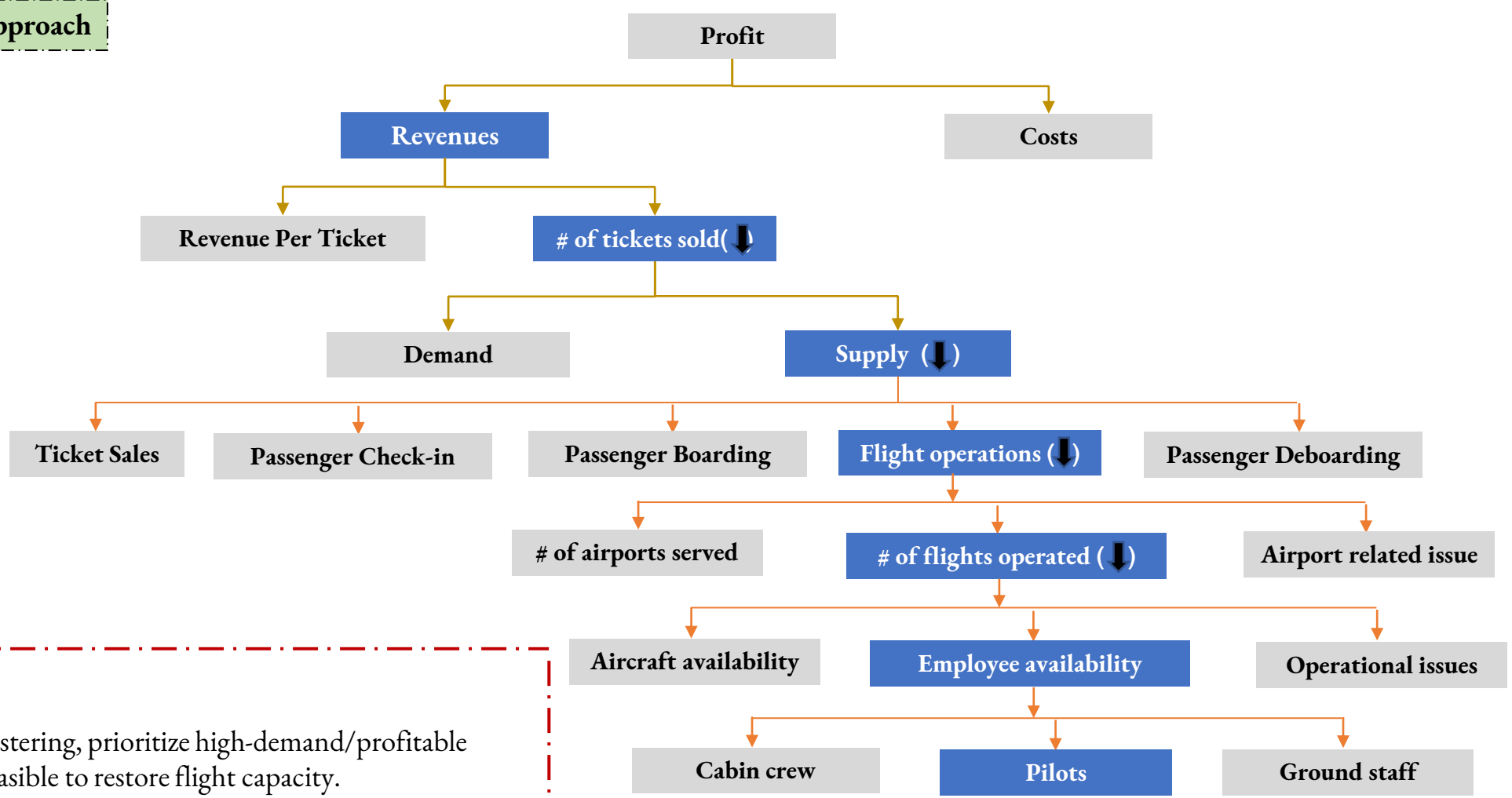
Domestic Airline

Your client is a leading domestic airline in India. They have observed a decline in profits for past 4 months. They have approached you to identify the reasons

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company** – Leading domestic airline
- **Operations** – Primarily domestic routes
- **Duration** – 4 months
- **Industry Scenario** – Client-specific issue
- **Profit Decline** – 20%

Approach



Recommendations

- **Short Term:** Optimize pilot rostering, prioritize high-demand/profitable routes, and lease pilots where feasible to restore flight capacity.
- **Long Term:** Strengthen pilot hiring and training, invest in AI-based crew scheduling, and improve network planning to maximize aircraft utilization

Video Game Studio

Profitability | Hard | BCG

Your client is a video game studio facing decline in profits. Find reasons and recommend solutions.

To be on the same page, our client is a video game studio facing decline in profit. I need to find reasons and recommend solutions.

Yes, you are right. Please go ahead!

I would like to know more about our client's business model. Is it an app or web based game or is it a physical arcade setup game?

It is an app based game. The client develops and distributes the game which are available to download.

Okay! Is it available on both mobile and laptop? Moreover, how many games have the client developed and is the decline across portfolio of games?

The app is available on both mobile and laptop. The client has a portfolio of games but only one game is facing decline in profit which is a multiplayer shooting game.

Got it. Where is the client based and in which geographies is the game licensed? Also, are the competitors also facing similar decline?

The client is headquartered in Gurugram. The game is available across Tier 1 cities in India. The competitors are not seeing decline in their profits.

Before we get into pricing – what are the game's main revenue streams? I assume it could be something like subscription, advertising, any in-app purchases.

Yes, you're right.

Thanks. To understand the pricing model – is it freemium, or do all players pay? Are the charges the same for everyone?

An upfront fee is charged when players start playing; weapons and characters can also be bought in-game. Charges are the same for everyone.

That helps. Lastly, what has been the quantum and time period of decline in profits?

The profits have fallen by 30% since past 3 months.

Okay, so the profits could be falling either due to decrease in revenue or increase in cost or both. Do we have visibility over it?

Revenue has fallen while costs have stayed the same.

Have we seen a change in all of the revenue streams – subscription fees, advertising and in-app purchases or any one of two of them?

Upfront fees have fallen, in-app purchases have risen slightly, and advertising revenue has stayed similar..

Understood. So, revenue from upfront fees can be broken down as (number of paid players × upfront fee charged per player). Accordingly, has there been a change in the number of paid players, the fee charged per player, or both?

Good breakdown. The fee charged per player has stayed the same. However, the total number of paid players has declined.

Got it. Since it's client-specific, I'd look across accessibility, app design, payment, support services, and game experience. Within game experience, it could be a balance issue, a technical issue like bugs or lag, or a content issue like characters, items, or maps. Have we made any recent changes there?

Good instinct — yes, on the content side, the client introduced a new weapon, and it's extremely powerful. In fact, it can increase a player's number of kills exponentially upon purchase. What do you make of that?

If the weapon can boost kills that much, outcomes are being decided by purchasing power more than skill — shifting the game from skill-based to 'pay-to-win.' That probably also explains the slight rise in in-app purchases we noted earlier – players buying the weapon. It could be pushing skilled players away too.

Good instinct. The weapon draws in casual players, but professional gamers — who value skill-based play — are leaving in greater numbers, so paid players are down overall.

Understood. And that should be precisely why revenue from in-app purchases have gone up as casual players are purchasing the expensive weapon a lot more.

Spot on! Can you help with some recommendations now?

Sure, I have three short-term recommendations: first, reduce the power of the weapon so it just supplements rather than replaces the need for skill; second, restrict the weapon's usage to a certain number of times per day, and third, increase the price of the weapon so that players are disincentivised to use it frequently, which also increases overall revenue. I'd add one long-term recommendation as well: design separate versions of the game for casual and professional gamers, tailored to their distinct requirements.

Sounds good. We can close the case here.

Video Game Studio

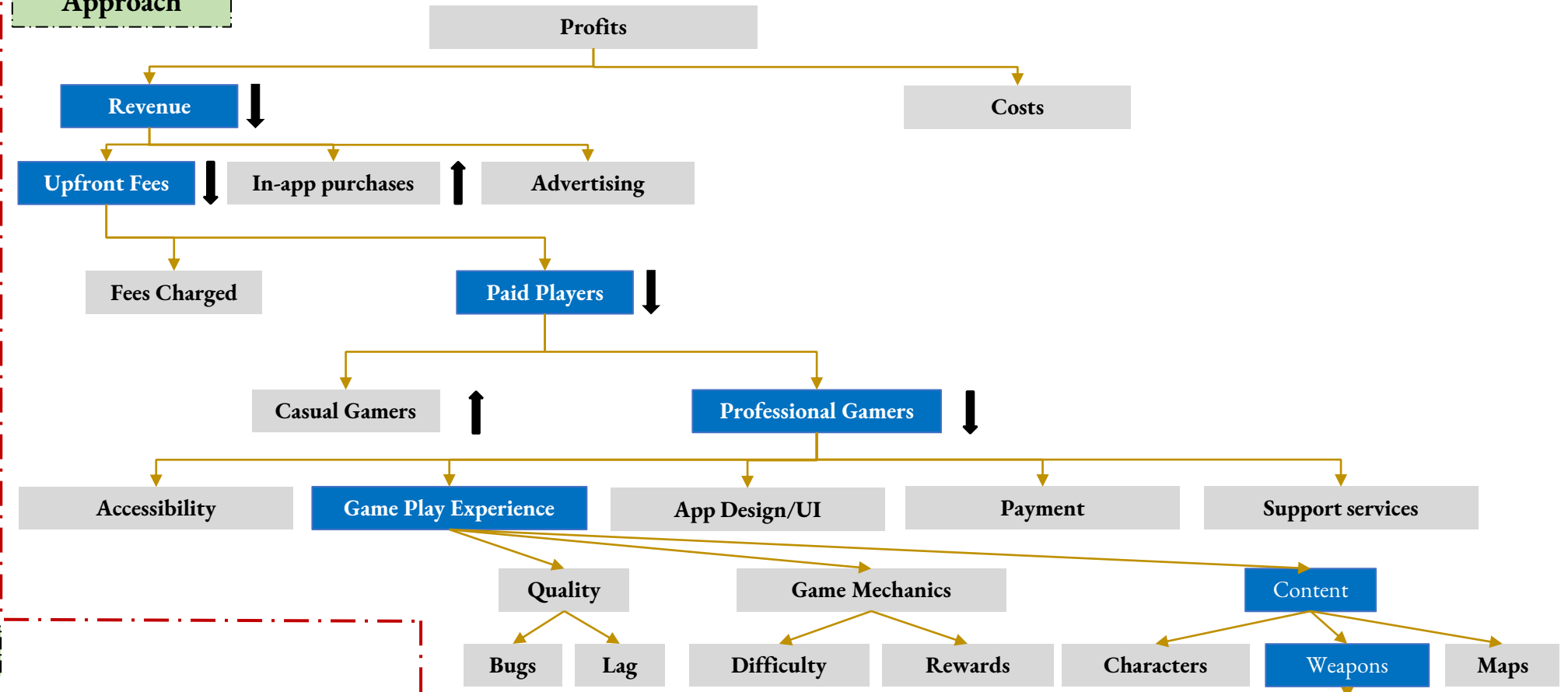
Profitability | Hard | BCG

Your client is a video game studio facing decline in profits. Find reasons and recommend solutions.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company** – Video Game Studio
- **Location** –HQ in Gurugram
- **Duration** – 3 months
- **Industry Scenario** – Only client is impacted
- **Quantum of decline** – 30%

Approach



Recommendations

1. Reduce the power of weapon.
2. Restrict the weapon usage per day.
3. Increase the price of weapon.
4. Design separate versions/landscapes of the game for casual and professional gamers.

National Coffee Chain

A coffee chain has experienced declining sales over the past 4–5 years. Identify the reason and suggest solutions.

To begin with, I would like to understand the business better. Could you tell me about the product assortment, pricing and the typical customer segment? Additionally, where are the stores usually located?

The product assortment is very similar to other coffee chains such as Starbucks or Café Coffee Day. They sell different types of coffee along with snacks at comparable price points. The primary customers are young professionals and office goers. Most of the stores are located in Tier 1 metro cities.

That is helpful. Could you also help me understand the revenue mix across different channels such as in-store dining, takeaway and online delivery platforms?

Approximately 80–90% of the business comes from customers visiting the stores and consuming there. The remaining 10–20% comes from takeaway orders and online delivery platforms such as Zomato.

Since the problem mentioned is declining sales, I would like to analyse profitability by breaking it into revenues and costs to identify where the issue lies. Profit = Revenue – Cost. Have there been any significant changes in costs in the last few years?

No, the cost structure has largely remained stable. The major issue is not related to costs but rather to declining sales.

Then I will analyse the revenue side. Revenue = Number of customers × Revenue per customer. Has there been any change in the average order value?

No, the average order value has remained the same.

Then the decline in revenue must be due to a reduction in the number of customers visiting the stores. To understand this further, I would like to analyse whether the issue is related to supply or demand. Have there been any operational issues such as store closures, reduced capacity or supply constraints?

No, supply-side factors are functioning normally.

In that case, the issue seems to be on the demand side. I would like to further break demand issues into internal factors related to the company and external factors related to the environment. Have there been any internal changes such as deterioration in service quality, product quality or pricing?

No, there have not been any significant internal changes.

Then the decline is likely driven by external factors. I would like to understand where exactly are the chains located in cities and whether the decline in customers is specific to our stores or whether overall footfall in the surrounding area has reduced.

Chains are located in office spaces and the number of people visiting the entire area has declined.

Since most of the stores are located in office spaces, one possible hypothesis is that fewer people are visiting offices compared to earlier.

Yes, that is the key driver.

This could be due to changes in workplace policies after COVID, where many companies shifted to hybrid or work-from-home models, reducing daily office attendance.

Correct. After COVID, many organizations adopted hybrid or remote work policies. As a result, fewer people visit office areas regularly, leading to reduced footfall and lower sales for the coffee chain.

Given this root cause, a few potential recommendations could be considered. The coffee chain could expand into locations with higher residential footfall such as malls or residential neighborhoods, strengthen online delivery and takeaway channels, and introduce targeted promotions for remote workers. Additionally, partnerships with offices or coworking spaces could help attract customers on the days when employees visit the office.

That sounds reasonable. Thank you for the structured analysis.

National Coffee Chain

A coffee chain has experienced declining sales over the past 4–5 years. Identify the reason and suggest solutions.

Case Facts & Notes

Company – Similar to Starbucks/CCD. Coffee + snacks at comparable prices.

Location – Tier 1 metros; office districts & commercial areas.

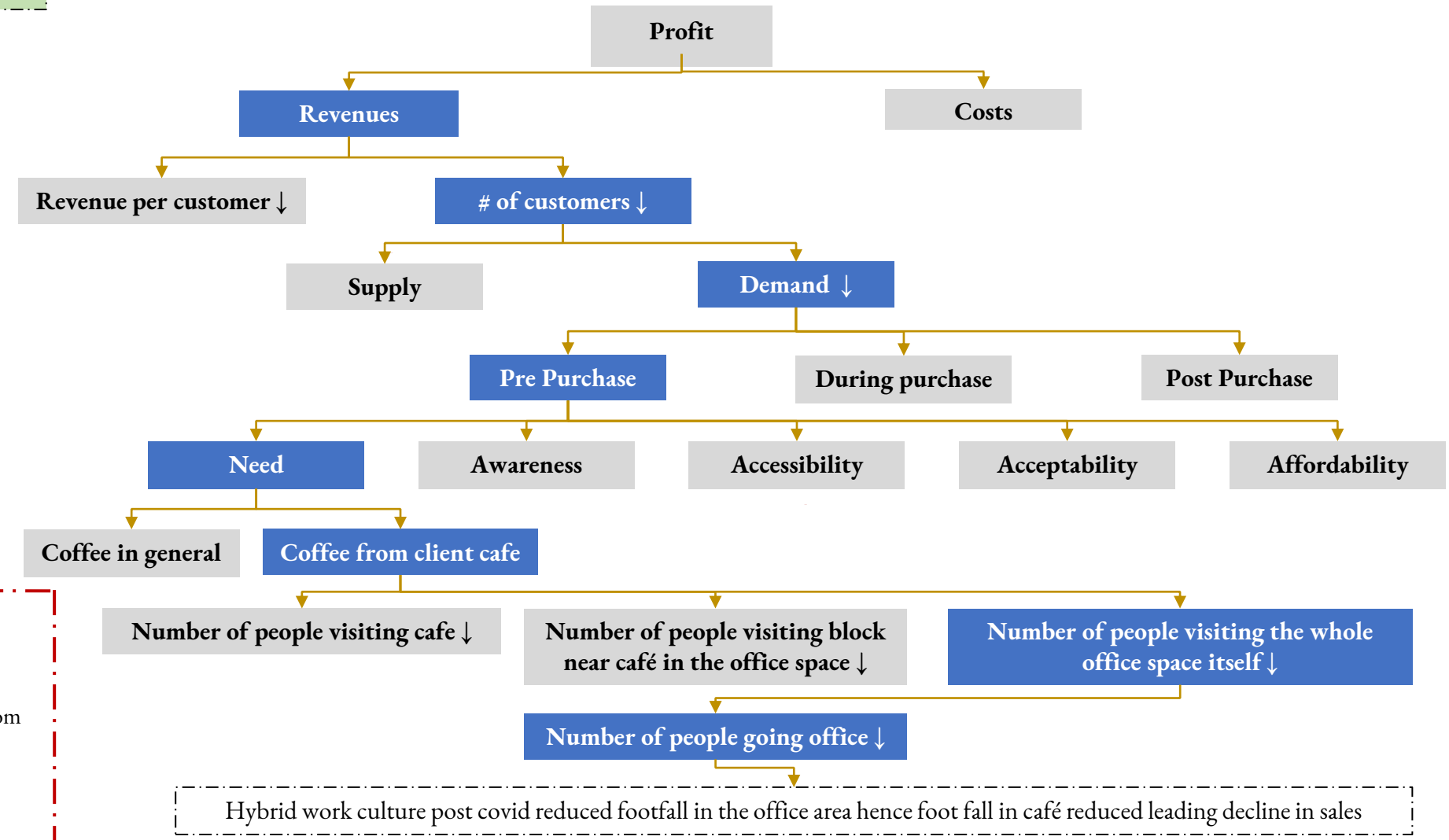
Customers – Young professionals and office-goers.

Channel – 80–90% in-store; 10–20% takeaway & online (Zomato).

Industry wide or company specific – company specific

Product lines – Drinks, dessert and food menu

Approach



Recommendations

To increase the number of customers,

- Position the cafe to other customer cohort apart from office goers and open new cafes in other areas
- Sell to office goers maybe through online mode to their homes as they are customers

Market Entry

Case Index | Main Index

Home Insurance Entry

Your client is a multinational insurance company and wants to enter the home insurance segment in the Indian market. It already has presence in health and life insurance segment in the Indian markets. How should they go about it.

So our client is multinational insurance company with presence in health and life insurance segment and wants to enter the home insurance segment

Yes

Sir I would like to ask a few clarifying questions.

Sure, go ahead!

What are the reasons the client has decided to enter this particulate segment and what are we are offering?

The client is looking to enter this market because there is a projected real-estate boom in the next 5 years, hence potential in the home insurance segment.

What is the market for home insurance currently, who are the major players?

No significant competitors and the market penetration is also very low.

Thank you! Just provide me a couple of minute of gather my thoughts and analyse the problem.

Okay

So I would like to first look at the target consumers for our product, analyse our strengths figure out the business structure and then analyse and the risk and barriers.

Okay, that sound alright

So looking at the target customers, a house can only be afforded by middle and higher income people. For middle-class, owning a house is a dream as well as they are risk averse, hence they would be interested in insurance products. But even high income people will be interested if they find value.

Okay

The client is already present in the Health and life insurance market, how do people buy insurance from our client?

The client has trained on ground agents which sell insurance directly to people.

Since we already have trained on ground agents, we can train them to sell this product and we can also look to hire new agents to get new customers immediately. We can also have strategic partnerships with banks where customers go to get loans.

Okay

Also because of low penetration and insignificant competitors, the possibility of a tie up or an acquisition seems unviable. So, the client should follow a market-development strategy, working on awareness. The client can get significant advantage by being the first mover.

Right

As far as risks go, since we are targeting mainly middle class consumers, they are very price sensitive and will move even if the competitors have marginally better prices. Hence, we would need to give special attention to the price point we fix.

Okay

My final recommendations thus are, following a market development strategy, focussing on awareness since there is low penetration and no significant competitor To sell the product the client should have training sessions for on ground agents for selling insurance products and strategic partnership with retail banks who can push home insurance products whenever they issue home loans The roll-out would be slow and gradual. Also since we are educating the masses, we are educating them for the competitors too. Therefore, we need to pay attention on our price because even if the competitors have marginally better prices, the consumers would shift to them, being price sensitive.

Yes, these recommendations sound good.

Home Insurance Entry

Your client is a multinational insurance company and wants to enter the home insurance segment in the Indian market. It already has presence in health and life insurance segment in the Indian markets. How should they go about it.

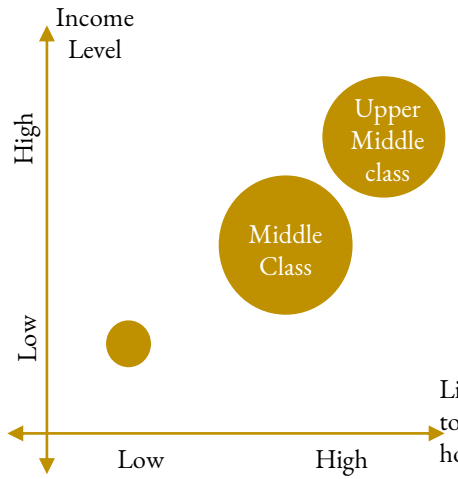
Case Facts & Notes

- Projected real-estate boom in the next 5 years, hence potential in the home insurance segment
- Home insurance products to
  - New houses
  - Existing houses
- Very low home insurance penetration
- No significant competitor in that segment

Approach

Objective of market Entry → **Target Customers** → **Analyze strengths** → **Business structure** → **Risks & Barriers**

The client has already decided to enter the home insurance segment. Now, we can further segment and identify our potential target segment.



"Customer lifetime value analysis" by taking into account their acquisition cost and the revenue earned per customer over their lifetime. This will give a quantitative assurance the market segment we are entering makes financial sense.

Income segmentation serves as a proxy for likeliness that a person will buy a house

- Very few people in low-income segment own a house
- For middle-class, owning a house is a dream as well as they are risk averse, hence they would be interested in insurance products
- Upper middle class would also be interested

Population
- **Lower Class & BPL**
- **Middle class**
- **Upper middle class**

Low penetration and no significant competitor, market-development strategy

Awareness
- Training existing **on-ground** agents
- Developing specialized **teams**
- **Strategic tie-ups**

1. on-ground agents, can be trained for selling insurance products.
2. Strategic partnership with retail bank to push home insurance products

Market Structure
- **Start from scratch**
- **Joint venture**
- **Acquisition**

Recommendations

- Low penetration and no significant competitor, the client should follow a market-development strategy, working on awareness
- Training sessions for on ground agents for selling insurance products, strategic partnership with retail bank who can push home insurance products whenever they issue home loans
- The roll-out would be slow and gradual. Also since we are educating the masses, then we are also educating them for the competitors. So even if the competitors have marginally better prices, then people would go for them as people in this segment would be price sensitive.

Author Entering New Genre

Our client is an established author. He now wants to enter the horror genre. How should he go about it?

Before I structure my approach, could I clarify a couple of things?

Sure, go ahead.

What has the author written so far?

He has written contemporary fiction so far.

Where is the client based out of and where are his readers based out of primarily?

The author is Indian, and that is also his home base, most of his readers are from India.

And are we advising the author directly, or does he own the publishing and distribution side?

The author himself is our client. He works with an established publisher for printing, distribution and marketing, but retains creative control.

Got it. I think I have sufficient information for now; I'd like to start the case. Would it be okay if I ask some questions as we progress?

Absolutely. Let us start.

I'd look at four things: market attractiveness, financials, operational feasibility and risks. I'll then make a recommendation.

Sounds good. Start with attractiveness.

In his current genre, he already has readers, a publisher and known competitors. Horror gives him a new reader base, but also a new set of established competitors. Should I size the opportunity?

Yes, please do.

I'd start with India's population and narrow it to urban readers in the relevant age group. Then I'd look at regular book readers, the share interested in horror, and finally those willing to try a new author.

Can you put some rough numbers to that?

Sure. If roughly a third of India is urban, around two-fifths of that is in the core reading age group, about 15% read books regularly, a fifth of those are interested in horror, and a quarter of that group is open to a new author, we get an addressable readership in the low double-digit lakhs. That seems enough to justify a first print run and a digital push.

That's reasonable. Now, let's set financials aside for now. How would he reach these readers operationally?

He already has a publisher handling printing, distribution and marketing, so I'd build on that rather than create a new setup. For visibility, I'd use genre-appropriate cover design, shelf placement and retail tie-ups, for example, Penguin India or event giveaways. For engagement, I'd use book signings, meet-ups and Reddit or Instagram communities. I'd also cross-promote to his existing fan base and explore film or OTT licensing if the work gains traction.

Sounds good. What risks would you flag with this switch of genre?

Two stand out. First, brand dilution if the horror work feels inconsistent with his existing readership. Second, competitive intensity, since established horror authors already have loyal audiences. I'd mitigate this by positioning the horror titles as a distinct sub-brand while using his existing credibility to build initial trust.

Makes sense. What's your overall recommendation?

I'd enter horror as a distinct sub-brand, leveraging the existing publisher relationship rather than starting from scratch. I'd first validate the opportunity through the reader funnel, then focus on visibility and community-building to convert existing fans and new horror readers. I'd track early feedback closely and manage the brand and competitive risks as we scale.

Sounds great, I think we can end the case here.

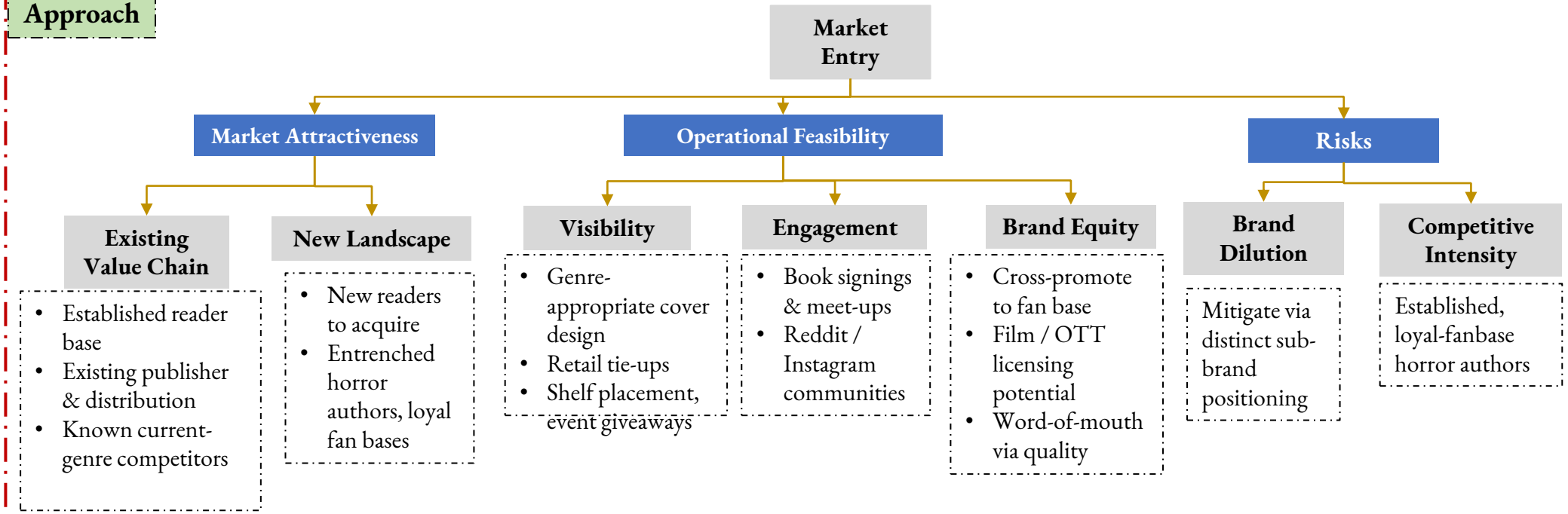
Author Entering New Genre

Our client is an established author. He now wants to enter the horror genre. How should he go about it?

Case Facts & Notes

- **Client** – an established Indian author, currently writing contemporary fiction
- India is both his home base and his primary market
- Client is the author himself, not the publishing house share
- Works with an existing, established publisher for printing, distribution & marketing; retains creative control
- **Objective** – enter the horror genre, building on his existing brand

Approach



Recommendations

- Enter the horror genre as a distinct sub-brand, building on the author's existing publisher relationship rather than starting from scratch.
- Invest in genre-appropriate covers and secure prominent retail placement/tie-ups (e.g. Penguin India) to build visibility.
- Build community engagement through signings, meet-ups and digital channels (Reddit, Instagram) to drive trial. Cross-sell to the existing fan base and explore licensing (film/OTT) as a longer-term monetisation lever.
- Manage brand-dilution and competitive-intensity risk through clear sub-brand positioning and consistent quality to sustain word-of-mouth

Fabrication Plant

The client is a semiconductor chip manufacturer who wants to set up a fabrication plant in India. They want you to provide a go or no-go decision.

Before proceeding with the case, I want to reiterate the problem statement. Client is a semiconductor chip manufacturer who wants to set up a fabrication plant in India.

Yes, absolutely right. Go ahead!

Before delving deeper into the case, I would like to ask a few clarifying questions. Is that fine? Also to clarify, a fabrication plant is a facility where raw materials are transformed into finished products i.e., a one-stop destination for production.

Yes, that's correct!!

Firstly, I want to understand what is the objective of the firm in entering the Indian market? Also do they have any budget constraints?

They want to diversify their supply chain. They have sufficient budgets.

Could you provide me some information about the company such as where they are based and their market share. Also do they operate in the whole value chain for chip manufacturing? And what is the Indian landscape for this industry?

The client is based in East Asia and there exists a monopolistic competition where our client is the only company in the country. And, yes for the second question. India's semiconductor industry doesn't have any native high-end semiconductor equipment companies.

I would also want to understand the customer base for the client. Do they cater to all the industries that require semiconductor chips such as electronics, automobile or any particular. I am assuming that they deal in B2B.

Sure! The client operates only at B2B setup and the finished products are shipped locally as well as internationally. For the case, let us keep only to electronics businesses.

Thanks, I have good understanding about the client now. My approach to analyze the case would be to first understand market attractiveness, and then proceed to financial and operation feasibility.

Sure, go ahead!

I would like to classify market broadly into two categories: People and Industry.
As for people, the demand for electronics has increased recently mainly due to the increased purchasing power and EMIs option available. Given that semiconductor chips are a major component of electronics, the market looks attractive form the demand side. Also with a growing demand for automobile vehicles owning to the shift towards EV vehicle, there is a scope for diversification too.
And for industry, electronics sector has been growing at a CAGR of 7%.

That sounds pretty good.

Now moving into financial feasibility, I would like to consider the major buckets such as cost which I would analyze taking both capital investment and operational costs, and revenue streams.

This looks comprehensive, but let us come to the financial feasibility later on and move on to operation aspects.

Sure. I would structure the value chain as following –
Research & Development -> Establishment of plant -> Procurement of raw materials -> Inbound logistics -> Manufacturing of chips -> Chip (wafer) testing -> Outbound logistics -> Post sales services -> Return Logistics.
At each stage of the value chain, I'd like to evaluate potential internal and external constraints. For internal constraints, I'll assess the nature and quantity of resources required and whether the firm currently possesses these capabilities. On the external side, I'll consider factors like government regulations and policy frameworks. Would you prefer that I explore a specific stage in detail first, or should I analyze each stage one by one?

This sounds good, can you think of any bottleneck or risk associated with the value chain you have mentioned above.

Sure. I would like to focus risk on two major aspects.
Internal: Quality of raw material if extracted in India might not match the standard level required for chip manufacturing and labor might not have the desired skill for extraction of raw materials and designing of chips.
External: Setup can be seen as non-sustainable if not able to reduce carbon footprint to the desired value and face regulation difficulties.

Fabrication Plant

The client is a semiconductor chip manufacturer who wants to set up a fabrication plant in India. They want you to provide a go or no-go decision.

This sounds comprehensive, you can start with the financial feasibility now.

For the financial feasibility, I would like to analyze the break even point for the client.
Revenue will depend on number of chips sold x average price per chip.
Cost stream will include capital investments on machinery and plant and operational costs of raw materials, transportation, warehousing, labor, chip testing and so on. There might be some one-time costs such as licensing fees for specific technology used in chip manufacturing.
We can then use the break even unit formula for calculation :
Volume = Total Fixed Cost / (Selling price per chip – Variable cost per chip)

This sounds comprehensive, could you analyze some factors for setting up the plant.

For setting up the plant, I would like to these 2 factors-
Proximity: This can break down into qualitative factor such as availability of skilled labor, regulatory environment, ease of doing business, and proximity to academic or R&D institutions and quantitative factors such as the logistic cost involved.
Since, India imports most of the semiconductor related raw materials, setting up a plant near port would be better. This would also reduce the lead time and supply chain risks.
Government initiatives: Looking for areas that fall in SEZ (Special Economic Zone) to make most of the benefits provided.

We can close the case now.

Fabrication Plant

The client is a semiconductor chip manufacturer who wants to set up a fabrication plant in India. They want you to provide a go or no-go decision.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Client-**
  - East-Asian company
  - Monopolistic market in home country
  - Source raw material □ manufacturing of chips □ export + local
  - B2B (electronics)
- **Objective** – diversify the supply chain

Approach

Fab plant

Market Attractiveness

- People – Demand for electronics have increased
- Industry – Growing at 7%

Operational Feasibility

- R&D
- Plant Location
- Raw Materials
- IL
- Manufacturing
- Testing
- OL
- Post sales

Financial Feasibility

Break Even

Cost streams

- Capital investment
- Operational Cost

Revenue streams

No of chips
X
Avg price per chip

Taking average price as there can be multiple chips as per the size and functionality

Setting up plant

- **Proximity**
  - Qualitative – skilled labor, raw materials
  - Quantitative – transportation cost
- **Govt. initiatives**
  - Special Economic zones

Risk involved

- Unskilled labor, poor quality of raw materials
- Environmental and governmental pressure to meet the regulations

Sports Bike

Your client is sports bike manufacturer in Europe and they want to enter the US market. You have to analyze the proposal and give recommendations.

Okay, I'd like to understand what's the objective behind entering the US market? Also, do they have a timeline in mind in which they want to enter?

Right, so like any other business, they want to maximize their revenues. Hence, they are looking to explore newer markets like USA. No, they haven't yet decided on a timeline as of now.

Alright! I want to understand our client better. Since you mentioned they are a sports bike manufacturer, do they only manufacture sports bike or other bikes as well? Also, do we know about the target segment?

Our client only manufactures sports bikes. There are other models of sports bikes and but they all fall in the premium range. I'd like you to give me your understand of who do you think should be the target customer?

Okay, our target segment primarily would be young population of upper and upper middle class aged between 20-35 who are enthusiastic about bikes.

Yes, absolutely!

Do we have information regarding the current position of our client in Europe and since how long have been there in this market?

Okay, there are 4-5 major players in this segment but we are the market leader holding ~50% of the market share and have been in this industry for the last 25 years. Why is the second question helpful, though?

So, this would help me understand the standing of our client in the European market and accordingly figure out the next steps. For ex: If it would have been in this market only for a year or so then deciding to enter a new market may not be the ideal option.

Sure, that makes sense. You can proceed with your questions.

I would also like to understand the value chain of our client better. Do they sell via distributors/dealers or through their own stores only ? Also, are they an OEM or do they source certain parts and components and then assemble it?

Okay. So, since the client's bike fall in the premium range, they sell through their own stores only. And they are an OEM i.e they manufacture everything in-house.

Okay, in order to analyze whether we should enter or not, I think we should look at essentially four aspects - 1) Market attractiveness 2) Financial Viability 3) Operational Feasibility and 4) Major risks & synergies associated with entering the market.

In market attractiveness, we should look at the market size, major competitors in this space in US & the market share that we will able to capture. In the financial viability, I want to look at the investment required and if we are capable of making that investment. We can also do a break even analysis to understand if it's a good proposal. In operational feasibility, we need to analyze the parts of the value chain and check our capabilities.

Seems good! Let's look at the market size first. Walk me through the approach of estimating the market size for a sports bike in US.

Sure. In order to estimate the market size, we should look at population of US, segment it by gender, male population would be our major segment so we can consider only men. Then we can divide the population on the basis of income. Since, it's a premium sports bike, upper class and upper middle class would be our users as discussed before. Then we should do an age segmentation. Age group 20-35 would be our TG as they are looking for premium bikes. Then we should look at what % of them are bike users (and among bike users what % of them would like sports bike. Do you want me calculate the number?

No, this suffices. Let's look at the financial viability part and do a break even analysis. Can you tell me the major costs incurred?

Sure. We can break down the costs under two heads: Fixed costs and Variable costs. Under fixed costs, we will have R&D costs, plant and machinery cost, maintenance cost, administrative expenses, sales & marketing cost (some part of this would be variable as well) and permanent employee costs. Under variable costs, we will have raw material costs, labour costs, shipping and logistics costs and other variable overhead costs.

Sure. Suppose the price of a bike is 1 Cr. The fixed cost is 20 Cr. Initial investment required is 100 Cr. The variable cost is 50% of the price of the bike. If we are to break-even in a year, how many bikes should be sold/ year?

Okay. So, for BE point, total costs = total revenues. Since, we are to break even in a year, our total costs would be 120 Cr + 0.5Q Cr and total revenue would be Q Cr. Solving for Q gives me 240 as the ans. So, at least 240 bikes need to be sold in a year to break even within a year.

Okay, thank you! We can wrap up this case, here.

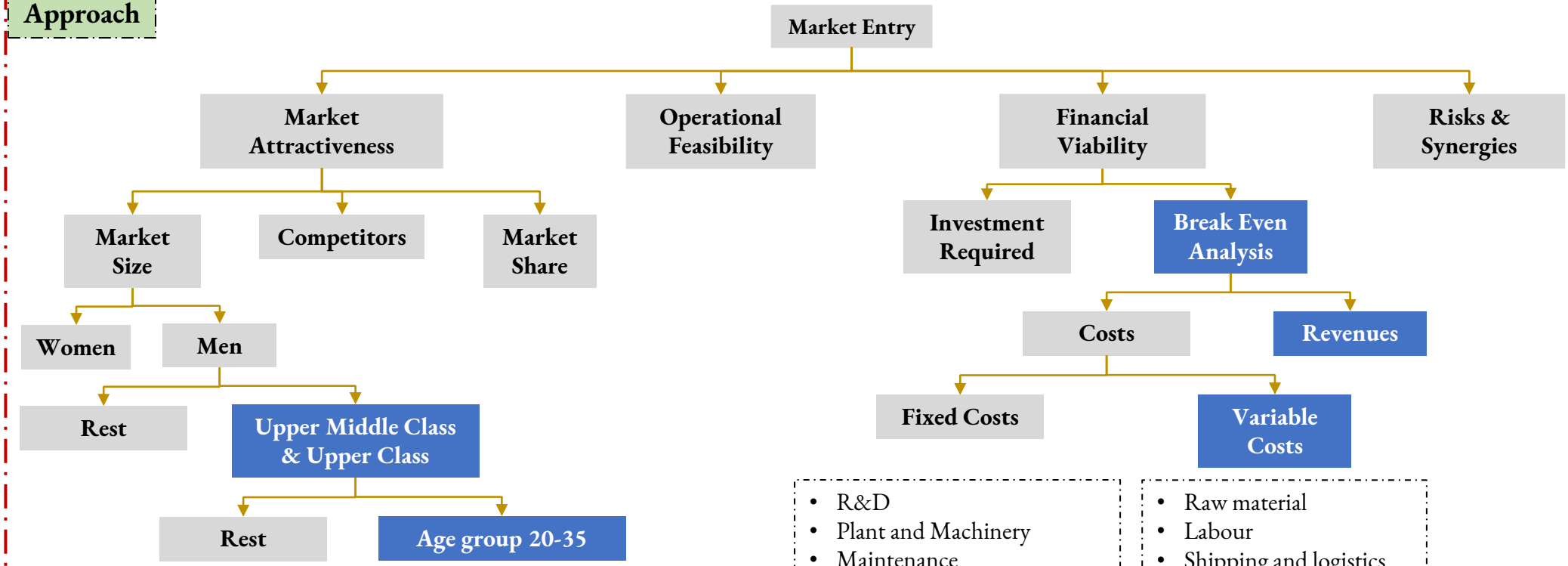
Sports Bike

Your client is sports bike manufacturer in Europe and they want to enter the US market. You have to analyze the proposal and give recommendations.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Objective** – Maximum Revenue
- **Company** – sells only sports bike through own stores, is an OEM.
- **Current Position** – Market leader with ~50% market share
- **Customers**- young upper middle and upper class aged between 20-35 years looking for premium bikes
- **Competitors**- 4-5 players, but not a threat

Approach



% of bike users * % of who will prefer sports bike

Total Costs = Total Revenues
100+20+ 0.5 Q = Q
0.5 Q = 120
Q= 240

Recommendations

- In order to break even in a year, they should sell at least 240 bikes in a year.

Medical Implant Manufacturer

A Chinese medical implant manufacturer wants to enter the Indian market with its knee implant. Should the client enter, and if yes, how?

Thank you. I'd like to understand the objective behind entering the Indian market, is this purely a revenue addition strategy, and do they have a timeline in mind for entry?

they want to maximize revenue, they're looking to add a new, sizeable revenue stream. No strategic pressure at home. They haven't fixed a timeline, but assume a target of breaking even within the first year of entry.

Is the client an OEM, or do they source and assemble? And do they sell through distributors, or would they need to build hospital relationships directly?

They're an OEM, manufacture everything in-house. No existing distribution, hospital, or surgeon relationships in India.

Is this a single standardized implant, or does the client have a range at different price points?

Single product line - an advanced premium silicone knee implant. What do you think the target segment should look like?

Given it's a premium surgical product, I don't think there's a single "buyer", it's an institutional sale. The patient (elderly, athletes, accident victims) is the end user, but the surgeon recommends the implant, and the hospital procures it. So the decision chain runs patient → surgeon → hospital. Does that hold?

That's right.

Do we know where the client stands competitively — price, material, lifespan versus local Indian players? And have they sold in India before?

No prior presence in India. The client's implant is advanced silicone, priced at ~₹75,000/unit, ~15-year lifespan. Local Indian players sell plastic-material implants at ₹25,000–35,000, with an 8–10 year lifespan.

How does the competitive landscape in India look overall — is it fragmented, or concentrated among a few large players? And roughly what share do the top players hold?

It's fairly fragmented — 4-5 major local players, none holding more than 15-20% share individually.

Has the client attempted a market entry like this before, either in another geography or category? Anything we should carry forward from that experience?

No prior international market entry. This would be their first expansion outside China. Good question to ask, but no prior playbook to draw from here.

Okay, so to evaluate whether the client should enter, and how, I'd like to look at five things: one, competitive advantage; two, market attractiveness — size and growth; three, financial feasibility — a break-even check against the first-year target; four, operational feasibility — the value chain and the gating factor to entry; and five, risks and barriers to entry and exit. I'll start with competitive advantage.

Sounds good, let's start with competitive advantage.

Looking at the numbers you gave me, the client is at a 2–3x price premium over local players, but backed by a real material and lifespan upgrade. That tells me they're not competing on price, they're competing on durability and reduced revision-surgery risk. I'd like to check that this actually holds up across the buying chain: the patient benefits from fewer revision surgeries, the surgeon benefits from a lower complication/reoperation rate which protects their reputation and the hospital benefits from better outcomes data, though they may still be sensitive to the higher upfront procurement cost. Given the market is fragmented with no dominant player, that premium positioning should also be easier to establish than if we were up against one or two entrenched incumbents. Does that read on the competitive positioning hold?

Yes, that's a fair read — the material and lifespan edge is the client's core differentiator here, and the fragmentation does work in their favor. Let's move to market attractiveness, could you estimate the total market for us?

Sure. I'd size this top-down: total population, narrowed to urban since the institutional sales channel is far more developed in cities then to the age-50+ segment where knee-replacement incidence concentrates and then apply a penetration rate for this specific premium product. Does this approach seem fair?

Yes, go ahead.

India's population is ~140 Cr. Urban at 30% gives 42 Cr. Age 50+ at 20% of that gives 8.4 Cr. Applying a 5% penetration rate for this premium implant gives ~42 lakh units as the addressable market.

Perfect, we can proceed with this.

Okay, so before proceeding to financial feasibility, would like to understand if we have any expectations on how much market share we would achieve in the first year?

Assume a 5% market share in year one

Medical Implant Manufacturer

A Chinese medical implant manufacturer wants to enter the Indian market with its knee implant. Should the client enter, and if yes, how?

Okay, and do we have any information available on fixed cost and variable cost required per unit?

variable cost of ₹60,000/unit, and a fixed cost of entry — regulatory certification, warehousing, local sales force — of ₹200 Cr.

Market size is 42 lakh units. At 5% share, that's 2.1 lakh units sold in year one. Contribution margin per unit is ₹75,000 – ₹60,000 = ₹15,000. Total contribution is 2.1 lakh × ₹15,000 = ₹315 Cr. Against a ₹200 Cr fixed cost, that leaves a surplus of ₹115 Cr. So the client not only breaks even in year one, it clears the target with room to spare.

Okay, so what do you think about the decision of entry?

It confirms the economics support entry. The question now is really about execution speed and risk, not whether the numbers work. I'd like to check operational feasibility next. What's the gating factor to bringing this product to market in India?

What would you guess?

I'd expect regulatory certification to be the binding constraint rather than manufacturing or logistics — it likely requires clinical or bridging studies and CDSCO approval, and the client's manufacturing is already solved via its China operations.

Correct. Certification typically takes 12–18 months, and that's the real gating factor.

Given that gate, and the fact that the client has no existing distribution or hospital relationships in India, I'd want to check the risk picture before landing on entry mode

What would you flag?

Geopolitical sensitivity, since this is a Chinese manufacturer entering India; replication risk on the silicone IP if a local partner reverse-engineers it; adoption risk if hospitals switch slower than modeled; and potential "Make in India" policy pressure over time.

Go ahead and close it out..

My recommendation is a phased entry. The financials clearly support entering as a 5% share alone clears the year-one break-even target with a ₹115 Cr buffer, and the fragmented competitive landscape gives room to establish the premium positioning. But given the 12–18 month regulatory gate, the client's lack of any existing distribution or hospital relationships, and no prior international entry experience to draw on, I'd enter via a joint venture with a local distributor or hospital network rather than a greenfield build. It compresses the certification and relationship-building timeline and gets the client to its financial target faster. I'd keep manufacturing and the core silicone formulation in-house to protect against replication risk, and revisit greenfield manufacturing in India once the client has built a track record with hospitals both to capture more margin and to stay ahead of any local-manufacturing policy pressure.

Sounds great, I think we can end the case here

Medical Implant Manufacturer

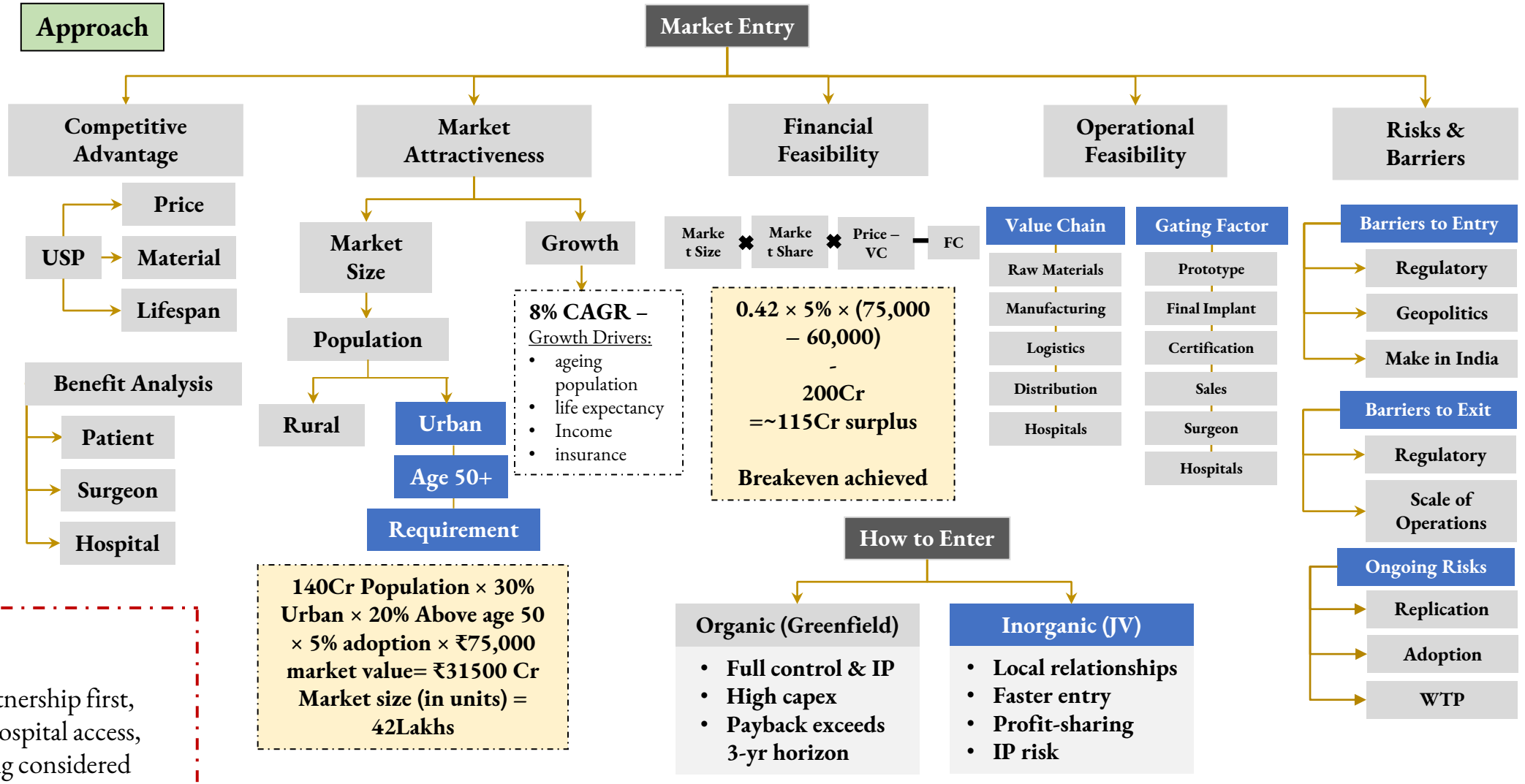
Market Entry | Moderate | McKinsey

A Chinese medical implant manufacturer wants to enter the Indian market with its knee implant. Should the client enter, and if yes, how?

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company** – Chinese medical implant manufacturer, no existing presence in India
- **Products** – advanced-silicone knee implant, ₹75,000/unit, ~15-year lifespan
- **Target** – Institutional sale chain: patients (elderly, athletes, accident victims) → surgeons → hospitals
- **Competition** – Local players at ₹25,000–35,000/unit, plastic material, ~8–10-year lifespan
- **Objective** – Revenue addition; ~3-year decision horizon. Breakeven target – 1 year

Approach



Recommendations

Phased entry via JV/local partnership first, using local distribution and hospital access, with greenfield manufacturing considered later.

Football fantasy game app

Your client is an established fantasy-gaming company in India with a successful cricket-fantasy application. The company is considering entering the football-fantasy gaming market in India. Analyse whether it should enter the market and provide recommendations.

Thank you. Before proceeding, what is the client's objective and current position?

The client wants growth and diversification.

How will the proposed football-fantasy app work?

Users download the app, receive a ₹200 joining coupon, create fantasy teams from football matches, play contests or against friends, and make player-performance predictions. Winnings go to an in-app wallet and can be redeemed through partners; there is no direct cash-out.

How does the company earn revenue? And do we know the revenue per customer? And any financial constraint or expectations?

Through advertising + in-app spends + percentage on wins. Average blended revenue is ₹1,500 per active user/month. We want to break even in 1 year.

Where does the client lie in the value chain?

Owns most core activities; football data/content is an incremental capability gap

What is the competitive landscape?

Several fantasy players, but cricket-dominated; football has relatively lower competition.

Are there any major regulatory restrictions on entering the market?

There are some regulatory requirements for importing and selling pet food, but no major barriers to entry.

Great. Proceeding with the case, I will assess market attractiveness, financial feasibility, operational feasibility and macro risks, followed by a Go/No-Go recommendation

Sure.

Starting with market attractiveness. For market size, I will use the following approach: Population → Urban/Rural → Smartphone penetration → Age 18–35 → Fantasy game interest → Football-fantasy game interest

That sounds reasonable. Please go ahead.

This gives an addressable football-fantasy audience of approximately 2.37 Cr users. Given our established brand, cricket-app user base, operating synergies and lower competition in football, I would assume 10% Year-1 share = 23.7 lakh users.

Moving to financial feasibility, do we know the engagement pattern and revenue per user?

You can proceed with your understanding for such an app.

Assuming 20% occasional users active for 3 months, 50% moderate for 6 months and 30% heavy for 12 months. As per our discussion, average blended revenue is ₹1,500 per active user/month.

Go ahead

The weighted average usage is therefore 7.2 months, giving annual revenue of ₹10,800 per user. With 23.7 lakh Year-1 users, expected revenue is approximately ₹2,560 Cr. What major incremental cost should I consider?

Every new customer receives the ₹200 joining bonus.

So the Year-1 joining-bonus cost is 23.7 lakh × ₹200 = ₹47.4 Cr. Each customer generates ₹10,800 revenue against a ₹200 acquisition incentive, leaving approximately ₹10,600 contribution per user before other operating costs. Financially, the proposition therefore appears attractive.

Agreed. Please assess operational feasibility.

Moving on to operational feasibility. I would analyse the value chain as Product Design → Football Data → Technology → Customer Acquisition → Contest Operations → Payments/Wallet → Partner Redemption → Customer Support.

What bottlenecks do you see?

The major ones are reliable live football data, conversion of existing cricket users, platform scalability during matches, fraud/scoring accuracy, and the partner-redemption ecosystem, particularly because there is no direct cash-out facility.

What about broader risks?

I would assess them using PESTLE. The most important are legal/regulatory risks, followed by social/reputational issues around responsible gaming and technological risks such as cybersecurity and platform downtime.

Please synthesize your recommendation.

Football fantasy game app

Your client is an established fantasy-gaming company in India with a successful cricket-fantasy application. The company is considering entering the football-fantasy gaming market in India. Analyse whether it should enter the market and provide recommendations.

I would recommend a GO, subject to regulatory validation. The market is attractive, with an estimated 2.37 Cr addressable users and an achievable Year-1 customer base of approximately 23.7 lakh given the client's existing cricket-fantasy platform and brand. Financially, each acquired user generates approximately ₹10,800 annual revenue against only ₹200 of joining incentive, making the unit economics highly attractive based on the information provided. Operationally, most capabilities already exist, although the client must address football-data reliability, platform scalability, fraud management and partner redemption. The biggest gating factor before proceeding is the legal and regulatory environment.

Football fantasy game app

Your client is an established fantasy-gaming company in India with a successful cricket-fantasy application. The company is considering entering the football-fantasy gaming market in India. Analyse whether it should enter the market and provide recommendations.

Case Facts & Notes

- Indian fantasy-gaming player with successful cricket app.
- Product - football-fantasy app; ₹200 joining coupon; in-app wallet; partner redemption; no direct cash-out
- Revenue - ads + in-app spends + % on wins; ₹1,500 per active user/month.
- Competition - several fantasy players, but cricket dominated
- Objective - growth and diversification

Approach

Market Entry

- **Market Attractiveness**
  - **Market Size**

Stage	Urban	Rural
Population	143 Cr	
Urban/Rural	50 Cr	93 Cr
Smartphone penetration	42.5 Cr	55.8 Cr
Age 18-35	17.0 Cr	22.3 Cr
Fantasy game interest	3.4 Cr	2.23 Cr
Football fantasy game interest	1.70 Cr	0.67 Cr

  - **Competitors**: several players, but market is cricket dominated
  - **Market share in yr 1**: 10% Year-1 capture feasible due to brand + fantasy cricket app+ existing synergies

Addressable Market ≈ 2.37 Cr users

- **Financial viability**
  - **Investment Required**
  - **Break Even Analysis**
    - No. of Users = 23.7 L
    - Active months/user: 7.2
    - Revenue/user/year: ₹1,500 × 7.2 = ₹10,800
    - Joining bonus/user: ₹200
    - Break-even period/user: ₹200 / ₹1,500 = 0.13 month (~4 days)
    - Contribution/user: ₹10,600
    - Total contribution after bonus ≈ ₹2,512 Cr

User Type	% Users	Active Months
Occasional	20%	3
Moderate	50%	6
Heavy	30%	12

Active months/user: 7.2

- **Operational feasibility**
  - **Product Design**: Adapt football scoring & formats
  - **Football Data**: PROBLEM: live data accuracy / licensing
  - **Technology Platform**: PROBLEM: match-time scalability
  - **Acquisition**: PROBLEM: cricket → football conversion
  - **Contest Ops**: PROBLEM: fraud & scoring disputes
  - **Payments / Wallet**: PROBLEM: security, settlement, gateway
  - **Partner Redemption**: PROBLEM: no cash-out; partner integration
  - **Support / Retention**: PROBLEM: sustained engagement
- **Macro Risks**
  - **Political:** Policy uncertainty on online gaming
  - **Economical**: Discretionary spend may weaken
  - **Social**: addiction, minors, reputation
  - **Tech**: cybersecurity, downtime, data privacy
  - **Legal**: gaming law, KYC, wallet/redemption, tax
  - **Env**: Low direct environmental risk

Recommendations

- GO synthesis, subject to regulatory validation.
- Enter because market is attractive, unit economics are positive, and strong synergies already exist.
- Key watch-outs: live football data, user conversion, fraud control, and partner

Pet Nutrition

Market Entry | Moderate | BCG

Your client is a leading European premium pet nutrition company. They are considering entering the Indian market and have approached you to assess whether they should enter

Thank you. Before starting, I would like to clarify a few things about the company, its products and the objective.

Sure, please go ahead.

Could you tell me more about the company's products and current operations?

The company sells premium dog and cat food, treats and nutritional supplements. It operates across several European markets and has no current presence in India.

Who would be our target customers in India?

We would primarily target urban middle-income and high-income pet-owning households.

What is the objective of entering the Indian market?

The client wants to build a ₹500 crore business within five years.

Who are the major competitors in the market?

There are established international and Indian pet-food brands, along with several emerging D2C players.

Are there any major regulatory restrictions on entering the market?

There are some regulatory requirements for importing and selling pet food, but no major barriers to entry.

Great. Let me summarize. We are a European premium pet nutrition company with no current Indian presence, targeting urban pet owners, with an objective of building a ₹500 crore business in five years. May I take a minute to structure my thoughts?

Sure.

I would assess the opportunity across four areas: Market Attractiveness, Financial Feasibility, Operational Feasibility and Risks. Under market attractiveness, I would look at market size, growth, customer segments and competition. Under financial feasibility, I would assess the investment required, revenue potential, costs and break-even. Operational feasibility would cover product-market fit, distribution, supply chain and marketing capabilities. Finally, I would evaluate key competitive, regulatory and execution risks.

That sounds reasonable. Please start with market attractiveness.

I would first estimate the addressable market. I would start with urban households, estimate pet ownership, packaged pet-food penetration and finally the proportion willing to purchase premium products.

Go ahead.

Assuming there are 100 million urban households, 5% own a dog or cat, 60% of these purchase packaged pet food and 20% are willing to purchase premium products, we would have 600,000 addressable households.

Correct.

If the average annual spend on premium pet food is ₹25,000 per household, the current addressable market would be approximately ₹150 crore.

Good. The premium segment is expected to grow at around 25% annually.

At 25% annual growth, the market could grow to roughly ₹460 crore in five years, which makes the client's ₹500 crore target ambitious but potentially achievable with a strong market share. I would therefore like to assess the financial feasibility.

Sure

I would compare the investment required with the potential revenue and costs. What level of initial investment would be required?

Approximately ₹100 crore, primarily towards marketing, distribution and setting up the supply chain.

And what would be our expected gross margin?

Around 40%.

Given the market's expected growth, the opportunity appears financially feasible, provided the company can capture a meaningful share of the market and manage its customer acquisition costs. I would now like to assess operational feasibility.

Please proceed.

Pet Nutrition

Your client is a leading European premium pet nutrition company. They are considering entering the Indian market and have approached you to assess whether they should enter

I would evaluate four areas: product-market fit, distribution, supply chain and marketing. Our premium health-focused products appear well suited to affluent urban consumers. However, we currently lack local distribution and market knowledge. I would therefore assess whether we can build these capabilities or leverage an existing player.

Good point. What would you recommend?

For distribution, we could use pet stores, modern retail and e-commerce platforms. For supply chain, we could initially import products and later consider local manufacturing as volumes increase.

Sounds reasonable. What risks do you foresee?

The key risks would be lower-than-expected willingness to pay, strong competition from established brands, regulatory changes and execution challenges while building distribution.

Overall, I would recommend entering the Indian market through a phased approach, initially targeting affluent urban consumers and leveraging existing distribution partners. We should scale investment as demand is validated and consider local manufacturing once sufficient scale is achieved.

Good. Thank you. We can conclude the case here.

That sounds reasonable. Please start with market attractiveness.

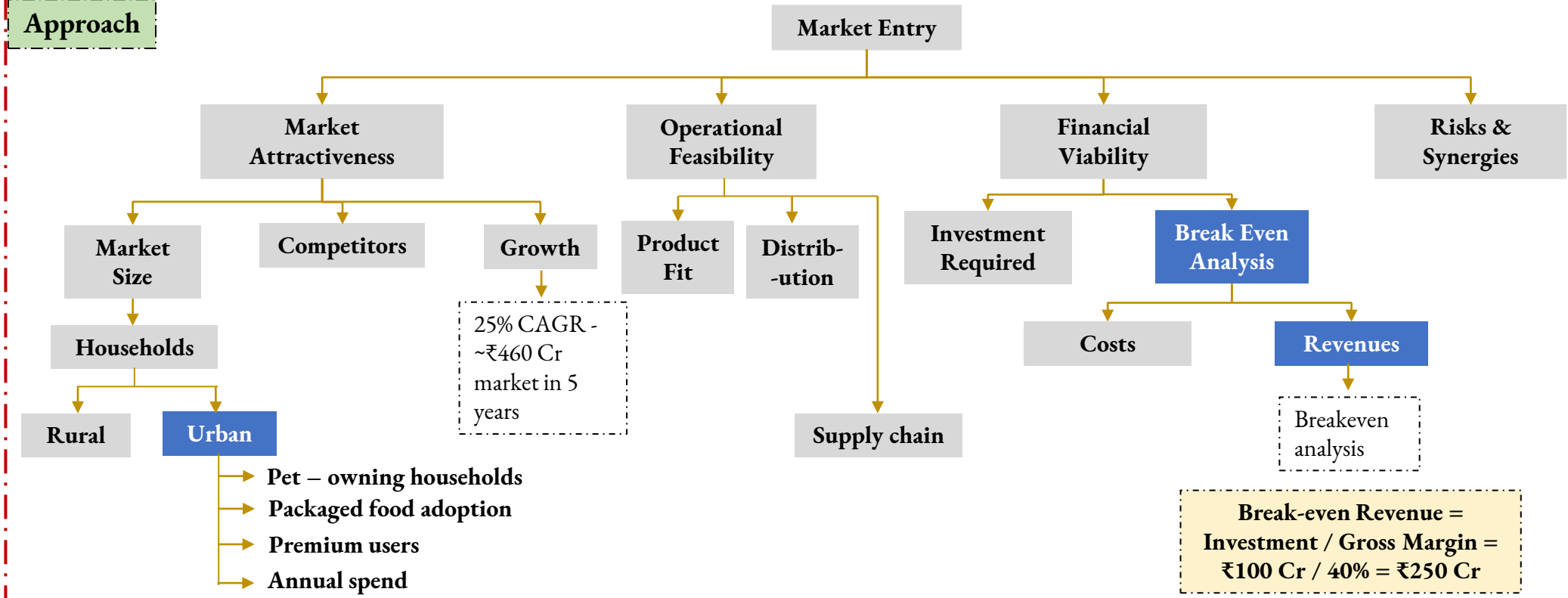
Pet Nutrition

Your client is a leading European premium pet nutrition company. They are considering entering the Indian market and have approached you to assess whether they should enter

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company** – European premium pet nutrition player with no presence in India
- **Products** – Premium pet food, treats & nutritional supplements
- **Target** – Urban middle & high-income pet-owning households
- **Competition** – Established Indian/international brands + emerging D2C players
- **Objective** – Build a **₹500 Cr business in 5 years**
- **Market** – Current addressable market ~**₹150 Cr**, growing at **25% CAGR**

Approach



100M urban households × 5% pet ownership × 60% packaged food penetration × 20% premium adoption × ₹25,000 annual spend = ₹150 Cr

Recommendations

- **Enter through strategic partnerships** to leverage existing distribution networks.
- **Focus initially on affluent urban consumers** with premium positioning.

Home Automation Player

A European Home Automation Player wishes to enter the Indian Market. You have to figure out how they should go about it.

Thank you sir, I'd just like to confirm that our client is a European Home Automation Player that wishes to enter the Indian market and we have to find a way to go about it. Right?

Yes, that's right

Okay, so do they want to assess first if the market is attractive enough or has that stage passed?

They're expecting you to do that analysis too.

Okay, in that case before starting, I'd like to ask a few clarifying questions

Sure, go ahead.

Thank you! Could you give me a bit more information about our products, where we're based and who our customers are?

Sure. They deal in mainly two automation components, cameras for security and appliance automation kits for appliance lighting control. The HQ is in Europe while the manufacturing is carried out in China. Who do you think our customers would be now that you have an idea about the business?

Well, I think that for homes, only relatively better off families would install such technologies while on the other hand, I think it would be common in commercial buildings and offices

Yes, that's right. Could you assess the market potential for the client now?

Sure, do we have an idea about existing competition? Also I would want to know what our benchmark is so that we can know if the market size obtained is good enough.

You can consider there are 2 major players Philips and Havells who are already into this kind of automation while others are relatively smaller. They aim to achieve breakeven in 3-4 years & would prefer a market size of $1Bn.

Okay, thank you. So I'll start to estimate the market size by estimating it for households first and then consider that a mark-up of 50% on that would be the commercial demand. Is that fair?

That sounds good.

Great, so to calculate household demand, I would divide the total no of households in the country into those from rural and urban areas, considering only urban households would install this system. Then within the urban households, I would consider only the upper middle & upper class households to purchase such a system.

That's right. (Candidate solves the guesstimate on paper)

That will bring us to an estimated market size of $1.5Bn, assuming we capture about 10% of the market and the price of 1 kit is $ 5000. Since this is above our benchmark, I believe it is an attractive market.

Great, then how do you suggest we go about it.

In terms of entering the market, since we've established attractiveness, I would like to know if they are financially sound for different modes of entry like starting from scratch, M&A or JV?

Yes, they are financially sound and capable.

Okay, and how about our operational capabilities? What are the distribution channels?

They distribute through retail and e-commerce channels and also provide post sales installation and repair.

Okay, then I suggest in such a case I think that there exists a lot of scope to integrate and have synergies with existing players or newer players who are already present in similar product categories. For e.g., for retail they can partner with existing players like Tata and RIL to come up with such an automation system to give competition to Philips and Havells.

Okay, that sounds okay and how about the E-Commerce capabilities?

For E-Commerce, the client can partner with Amazon/Flipkart to be their exclusive selling partners. In fact, in case of Amazon, they can bundle their products with Alexa or other such home controlling device if possible.

Great, that sounds good!

Home Automation Player

Market Entry | Hard | McKinsey & Co.

A European Home Automation Player wishes to enter the Indian Market. You have to figure out how they should go about it.

Case Facts & Notes

- HQ in Europe
- Manufacturing in China
- Home Use Customers– High income Groups
- Institutional Customers – Commercial buildings, offices
- 2 existing major players in the competition – Philips & Havells (line of connected bulbs). Our brand is unknown
- Objectives –
  - Global Expansion
  - Break even in 3-4 years
  - Market size should be $1B
- Home Automation Products –
  - Security (cameras)
  - Auto kit (appliance & lighting control.
- Financially capable & sound
- Distribution: Retail & E-commerce

Approach

Market Entry

- **Market Attractiveness**
  - Customer Analysis
  - Competition
  - Market Sizing
  - Regulatory Environment
- **Resources & Capabilities**
  - Product
  - Financial
  - Operational
  - Marketing
  - HR
- **Execution Strategy**
  - Start from scratch
  - Merger & Acquisition
  - Joint Venture
- **Risks & Synergies**
  - Barriers to exit
  - Reaction by competition

Competition Analysis

- **Large Brands**
  - Retail
  - Probably won't be interested in JV
- **End to end automation**
  - System Integrators (work with Interior designers)
  - High end brand names
- **White goods market**
  - Chinese Goods
  - Unofficial
- **Start-ups**
  - Not very big in size
  - Bangalore & Pune hubs

Market Sizing (Home Automation)

Pop. of India = 1.35B
of households= 340M

- **Households** 340M
  - **Rural (70%)**
  - **Urban (30%)** 00M
    - **Rest (80%)**
    - **Upper & Upper Middle Class (20%)** 20M
- **Institutional**
  - 50% markup on HH for easy calculation

Price of 1 kit=$5000, Estimated Market share capture=10%

Total = 20M * 5000 * 10% * 150% = $1.5B

Recommendations

- Partner up with start-ups or get new players into the market for partnerships – Tata, Reliance.
- Exclusive sales through Amazon/Flipkart
- Bundling with products like Alexa or any other home controller if possible..

Gold Mine in Mongolia

Goldman Sachs' Investment Division is considering buying a goldmine in Mongolia. The mine is fully operational and producing 120,000 units/annum. The government of Mongolia is selling the mine to raise foreign currency to pay their dollar-denominated debt. They want you to provide a go or no-go decision.

So, just to be on the same page, I would re-iterate the problem statement. GS's Investment division is considering buying a Goldmine which is fully operational & producing 120K Units/ annum in Mongolia & they want us to provide a go or no-go decision.

Yes, absolutely right. Go ahead!

Before delving deeper into the Case, I would like to ask a few clarifying questions. Is that fine?

Sure, go ahead!

What are the various Prices & Costs related to purchase & operations of the mine? Do we have any information on that?

Yes. The purchase price of mine is $200mn, operating cost is $800/unit & fixed cost is $25mn/annum.

Also, what are the various options client is considering? Are they thinking of increasing or reducing the capacity of the mine after purchase?

Good question! GS has the option of expanding the mine to produce addn. 20K units/ annum & in this case the additional purchase price is $20mn.

How will the expansion further affect the costs & how much time will it take to become operational at new capacity?

So the total development time for new capacity is 12 months after which the mine can be fully operated. It will increase the fixed cost by around 10% & variable cost by around 15%.

One more question! Do we know the market price of Gold & what are the final objectives that GS is keeping in mind?

Yes the Gold price is $1800/unit. Also, GS has 2 objectives: to generate 25% ROI in 3 years & to resell the asset at profit.

Sure sir, thank you! Just give me some time to gather my thoughts and analyse the problem.

Sure!

Sir, the prime question is whether GS should buy the Goldmine or not. For that I am looking at 3 important factors: Market attractiveness, asset attractiveness & ROI target. First, I would want to look into market attractiveness. Can you tell me how Gold prices & demand vary according to economic growth, interest rates & inflation?

Sure. Gold prices vary inversely with respect to economic growth. Gold demand increases during inflation & falls as interest rates rise.

Thank you sir. Also, attractiveness of Gold mine will depend upon Legal aspects, Political & Financial aspects, Environment & technological considerations & exit options. What do we know about these?

So, since we are dealing directly with the Mongolian Government, we are safe with respect to legal, political financial & exit factors. We have good technological partners in form of both local & global players. Environment conditions have also been taken care of.

That sounds great! That brings us to our last factor of ROI Target. So, ROI is (Gain-Investment)/Investment. Do we have any information on the Gain proceeds, WACC, Tax rate & P/E ratio. I am thinking of calculating and comparing the ROI in current scenario & in case of expansion to see in which case are they performing better & also if they are able to meet our ROI target at all or not.

This sounds good. So, the Gains will be coming from Operating income & Sales proceeds. WACC is 10%, Tax rate is 30% & P/E ratio is around 3.

Sure. Just give me a few minutes to do my calculations

Alright! Go ahead.

So, In current scenario of no expansion, we have 57.63% ROI in the first year itself which is more than our target of 25% ROI in 3 years. Also, if we choose to expand, in the first year we are making 44.15% ROI. In the second year, as Profit after tax is further increasing, so we will have even more ROI

That looks great to me. So, what are your final recommendations?

We should go for the buy decision & the option of expansion shouldn't be preferred because our ROI is decreasing and even NPV is decreasing further.

Gold Mine in Mongolia

Goldman Sachs' Investment Division is considering buying a goldmine in Mongolia. The mine is fully operational and producing 120,000 units/annum. The government of Mongolia is selling the mine to raise foreign currency to pay their dollar-denominated debt. They want you to provide a go or no-go decision.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Price & Costs (of Mine)-** Purchase price: $200mn,Operating cost:$800 /Unit, Fixed cost: $25mn/annum
- **Client-**
  - GS has option of expanding the mine to produce addn. 20K units/ annum
  - Purchase price on option to expand: $20mn
  - If expansion is done, total development time: 12 months & mine would immediately operate on new capacity.
  - With new capacity, Fixed cost: ↑10% ,Variable cost: ↑5%
- **Price (of Gold)** - $1800/Unit
- **Objective -**
  - Resell asset for a profit
  - Generate 25% ROI in 3 yrs.

Approach

Should GS buy Goldmine?

Market Attractiveness

- Economic Growth – Gold prices vary inversely with EG
- Interest Rates – Demand for Gold increases as interest rates fall
- Inflation – Gold demand increases during inflation (*inflation hedge*)

Asset Attractiveness

- Legal Aspects: Licenses, Permits, Labor laws
- Political Stability in Mongolia
- Environmental Considerations
- Technological Requirements
- Financial Aspects – liabilities
- Mine – reserves, life of asset
- Exit Options

ROI Target

- ROI = (Gain – Investment)/ Investment
- Gain will be from Operating Income & Sales Proceeds
- Assumed WACC of 10%, Tax Rate of 30% & P/E ratio ~3
- Evaluate ROI in the current scenario & in expansion option
- The ROI is higher with option of expanding the mine

Calculations

Current Scenario

Investment	20,00,00,000	Profit Per Annum (after tax)	6,65,00,000
Gold Price	1,800	P/E ratio	Assumed 3
Quantity	1,20,000	Selling Price	19,95,00,000
Revenue	21,60,00,000	PV of Sales Proceeds	31,52,60,000
Operating Costs	9,60,00,000	NPV	11,52,60,000
Fixed Costs	2,50,00,000	ROI	57.63%

Expansion Option

	Year 1	Year 2/3
Gold Price	1,800	1,800
Quantity	1,20,000	1,40,000
Revenue	21,60,00,000	25,20,00,000
Operating Costs	9,60,00,000	12,88,00,000
Fixed Costs	2,50,00,000	2,75,00,000
Option Purchase	2,00,00,000	
Profit Per Annum (after tax)	6,65,00,000	6,69,90,000
Tax Rate	30%	
P/E ratio	Assumed 3	
Selling Price	20,09,70,000	
PV of Sales Proceeds	31,71,40,000	
NPV	9,71,40,000	
ROI	44.15%	

Skin Care Manufacturer

A skin care manufacturer wants to enter the sunscreen market. Evaluate if they should enter the market or not? If yes, then suggest the ways for the same.

Sir, the firm had already made a decision to enter market or they are still evaluating it? And why is client looking to enter sunscreen market?

The client is yet to decide. They want to expand their portfolio & increase their market share

I would like know about the sunscreen market? Competitive landscape, size. Also, is the client looking to expand into any particular geography?

The market is highly competitive but stable. The key benefit is that people are aware about sunscreens but because of it being perfectly competitive, pricing is market driven. Initially we are targeting India

I would analyse the opportunity on four factors which are our product, customers, our capabilities and regulations. If we conclude to enter, then I would look at execution part

The approach looks good to me

Starting with the product, what is the USP of our product? How is our quality & offerings as compared to other products in the market?

Our products are made up of natural ingredients which makes it suitable for any skin including oily skins. Also, our products will be available in smaller SKUs, thus more affordable and easy to carry. The shelf life of our product is higher than average & we provide vast variety for different skins

Looking at our product, I believe our product is quite attractive to customers. Coming to customer segments specially in country like India, customers will be limited to urban areas?

Skin care products are a premium product for Indian consumer, especially sunscreen. So yes, we will target only tier 1 customers, since they are the ones who invest in skincare products

Owing to India's huge population, even that segment is huge in number. But do we have operational & financial capabilities to launch products in India? Also, how is our brand presence in India for other products?

The client is an established player in the skin care market with strong brand recall in India. We have manufacturing capabilities for all major products with an efficient distribution network. Most of our products are STAR as per BCG matrix. And company have strong financials

Most of these factors look favourable, what about the rules & regulations in India. Are there any barriers such as taxes, labour norms, stringent rules for foreign players?

Fortunately, India is an open market with no constraints, favourable tax regimes. We will have cost advantage too due to both production & distribution within India

As per my analysis, all the factors are favourable for the client to enter the Indian market, except the pricing power. If the R&D and manufacturing cost are as per the industry average, the client should go ahead. Would you like to explore the execution side of it?

Yes, now that we have decided to enter, let's explore the implementation side of it

We can either launch the product under our own brand name or a JV. But, since we are already an established player with good brand recall with existing manufacturing & distribution network, we should launch under our own brand provided we have the R&D facilities to manufacture

We have R&D capabilities & yes, the client would like to launch it under its own brand name

Coming to operational decisions, we can leverage the existing distribution network. Additional workforce and experts needs to be hired if required. We can use the existing manufacturing facilities & in future is current production capacity is not sufficient, looking at their strong financials, increasing the production capacity wouldn't be an issue

Sounds like a good plan

Though we are established brand, we currently have no presence in sunscreen market. So we need to market our product. We can leverage existing brand name to market the product, but we would also need to launch a unique marketing campaign to highlight our USP in this highly competitive segment. Since, India has huge celebrity following culture, we can rope in a known face to better market our product

The marketing plan looks effective for our product

I suggest we launch our product at a competitive price and try to capture the existing market. Further, once we have established ourselves, we can expand into new geographies and segments

We can surely launch it at such price point since R&D cost involved in this product is not significant and the client aims to capture market share as quickly as possible

Would you like me to explore any other aspect of the case?

We can conclude the case here. Have a great day ahead!

Skin Care Manufacturer

A skin care manufacturer wants to enter the sunscreen market. Evaluate if they should enter the market or not? If yes, then suggest the ways for the same.

Why Expand
- Reason: Portfolio Expansion; Growth- To increase market share
- Competitive, well established market
- Advantage: People are aware
- Disadvantage: Pricing, due to perfect competition. Wants to enter Indian market first.

Unique Features?
- Uniqueness of product: Natural, available in smaller SKUs; suitable for oily skin too
- Durability of the product
- Variety of creams available for different skins

Customers
- Mainly to target the tier-1 customers, who already invest in skin care products.
- Currently there is a market demand for the product but is limited to premium buyers only. People in tier 2 and 3 cities still reluctant to try.

Capabilities
- Already established player.
- Manufacturer of major skin care products. Has a well-established distribution network and market presence
- Most of the products still lie in the Star category of BCG matrix (Financially strong)
- One of the market leaders in skin care

Regulations
- No regulatory constraints as such, since is an already established market and player.
- Introducing within India.
- Easy exit
- Well known markets, easy tax compliances.
- Production and distribution within India

Based On Above Inputs We Decide To Enter The Sunscreen Market

Entry Options
Can launch under its own brand, without any JV or consortium, provided we have the R&D facilities to manufacture.

Operational Decisions
Leverage the existing distribution network. Additional workforce and experts to be hired if required. Use the existing manufacturing facilities.

Marketing Decisions
Use of existing brand name to market the product(established player). But, roping in a known face or a unique ad campaign to differentiate ourselves in a competitive market(can delve further).

Growth plan and Conclusion
We can launch the product at a competitive price and try to capture the existing market. Further, once we have established ourselves we can expand into new geographies and segments.

Smart Phone Market

The CEO of a US oil & gas company is excited about the growing smartphone market in India. Formulate an approach to enter this market.

Sir, just to be on the same page, Our client is an Oil and Gas company and they are looking to invest in the Indian smartphone market and I have to look for an approach to formulate this entry. Can I ask a few clarifying questions regarding the case?

Yes, go ahead!

Is the decision to launch enter already taken? What are the objectives here?

Yes. There are 2 objectives: – 1) Market entry into smartphone industry. 2) A metrics to evaluate business plan.

Okay. Can you tell me more about the company?

The company is an oil & gas company catering to US & Canada. It focusses on downstream activities, refining and distribution. They have good amount of capital to invest in India businesses.

Okay! And do they have experience of diversification like this? Have they entered some other region in the same industry before?

No, this will be their first entry.

Okay. Give me a few moment to structure my thoughts.

Sure! Take your time.

So I would want to start with a broad market analysis of competitors, customers, need gaps , growth estimates, product and channels. Customer viewpoint towards these phones can be categorized into: Smartphone features, pricing, elasticity and market trends.

Good start. But we you to start with the identification of market to enter.

Okay sir. So we can divide the market into Smartphones themselves, component suppliers (OEMs) and smartphone embedded services.

Hardware is a touch field to enter so we would like you to go ahead smartphone embedded services.

Okay Sir! So smartphone embedded services can be categories into app based services and OS based services like android and apple iOS.

Yes, good classification. OS is again a tough market to enter, let's move to app based services.

So app-based can be categorised into costumer centric and business centric. Given client inclination, I believe they will be willing to move into customer centric apps. They can be further categorized into Communication, Entertainment, Food, Shopping, Transport and Health, based apps. Is there a particular category you wish for me to analyse.

Yes, your assumption is right. Client is looking for something in the entertainment category in customer centric apps.

So entertainment can be further classified into OTT platforms, Gaming and audio services.

Move into OTT platforms. We are looking to do something in that category. This is the data we have for the current players: Hotstar, Amazon Prime Video and Netflix. (Shows data)

Okay. This is an growing field and something that can be targeted.

Good! On what metric will you evaluate this particular apps of yours.

Sure sir. Just give me a minute. We can evaluate the performance in 4 categories, customer satisfaction, financial, employees, and operations or processes. In the customer side of things, we can look for NPS and customer acquisition and retention rates (DAU/MAU). For financials, we can look at return on capital employed and customer lifetime value. In employees we can look at employee NPS and turnover rate and in operations and processes, we can look at technological prowess, ability to compete with existing players and quality of content.

Okay Thank you! You can leave now.

Thank you sir!

Smart Phone Market

The CEO of a US oil & gas company is excited about the growing smartphone market in India. Formulate an approach to enter this market.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Objective** – 1) Market entry into smartphone industry. 2) A metrics to evaluate business plan.
- **Company** - Oil & gas company catering to US & Canada. Focusses on downstream; refining and distribution.
- **Market Analysis Factors** – Competitors, Customers Need gap, growth estimates, products & channels.
- **Client's Experience in this**

Customer Viewpoints

- Smartphone Features
- Pricing / Elasticity
- Market Trends

Approach

- Smartphone Market
  - Phones Themselves
  - Smartphone Embedded Services
    - App Based Services
      - Consumer centric
        - Communication
        - Entertainment
          - Video Services
          - Gaming
          - Audio Services
        - Food
        - Shopping
        - Transport
        - Health
      - Business centric
    - OS Based Services
  - Part Suppliers (OEM)

Company	Type of service	Pricing
Netflix	Paid / Subscription	INR 600 per month
Hotstar	Freemium	INR 1500 per year
Amazon Prime	Paid	INR 1000 per year

Evaluation metrics

- Performance Metrics
  - Customer
    - Net promotor score (NPS)
    - Referrals
  - Financial
    - Return on capital employed
    - Profit Margin
    - Customer lifetime value
  - Ops/ Processes
    - Technological prowess
    - Content development
  - Employees
    - Employee NPS
    - Turnover rate
- Acquisition
  - Rate
  - Cost
- Retention
  - Average screen time
  - Trend of referrals
  - Satisfaction

Recommendations

- Introduction of a video on demand service, competing with Netflix, Hotstar.
- Close monitoring of parameters like avg increase in viewership per episode.
- High marketing efforts needed to make the consumers aware. YouTube and FB to be primary drivers for online marketing.

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South African PE Firm

Your client is a south African PE firm and wants to invest in Indian tech-consultancy and advisory company. Suggest how to do it?

Sir, if I understand correctly, our client is a South African Private Equity form and they want to invest in Indian tech-consultancy and advisory company. I need to devise a plan of action for the same.

Yes, you are right. Please go ahead!

First of all, I wanted to understand the objective of doing this investment. Is it from the growth perspective and to synergize with current holdings or is it their first investment in India or something totally different?

The client has no previous experience of investing in India and have decided to enter the market. The primary objective is to tap the growing Indian IT market and exit in 8-10 years.

Okay! Since the decision to enter has been taken I would like to start with understanding the Indian IT industry by looking at growth drivers and trends. I would then move to the various options we have by analysing various companies and finding the target company. At the same time I'll also establish a competitor study. At the end I'll suggest exit strategies for the same. Does this sound okay to you or is there something I should change?

That sound good. Please proceed. I want you to identify the parameters on which you'll evaluate the various headers you just listed.

Sure. I'll start with the industry analysis. I think to have a sound understanding about the industry, I need to know the market size, growth figures along with recent initiatives and investments by other players that maybe private and public.

What is the key factor that we are missing here?

Oh yes we also need to check the forecast for next decade since out exit is in 8-10 years.

That's right. Please go ahead.

I think now I'll define the parameters to find the company of choice for our client.
I think the key parameters are Sales, sources of revenue, financials, management and growth potential. Do you think this list is exhaustive or should I look at any other parameter as well.

For source of revenue as stated in the problem statement, we'll have 2 components – Tech consulting and software services. Both the components should be evaluated based on 3 key parameters – Market share, growth numbers & their forecast and finally, share in revenues.
In financials, 4 key parameters can be looked upon – Profitability, EV/EBITDA, Margins and ratios. These will define financial health of the company and back the qualitative assessment with quantitative assessment.
Since management forms a key bucket in the future of the investment, I suggest 3 key parameters for judging i.e. the quality of management(openness to new technology, focus on innovation), experience (past experiences help in understanding the vision of the company better) and average age (since it's a relatively long-term investment, it is important that the team sticks for the duration as well as is experienced enough) .
Future growth in IT sector is impacted by the projects in pipeline, innovation mindset and forward and backward tech integration.
Competitors can be analysed based on the same parameters.

That is quite detailed analysis. Can you suggest some good exit strategy for the business?

Sure. There can be multiple strategies like going for IPO, secondary sale and strategic acquisition.

Okay. Thank you for your detailed analysis.

Thank you for your time, Sir

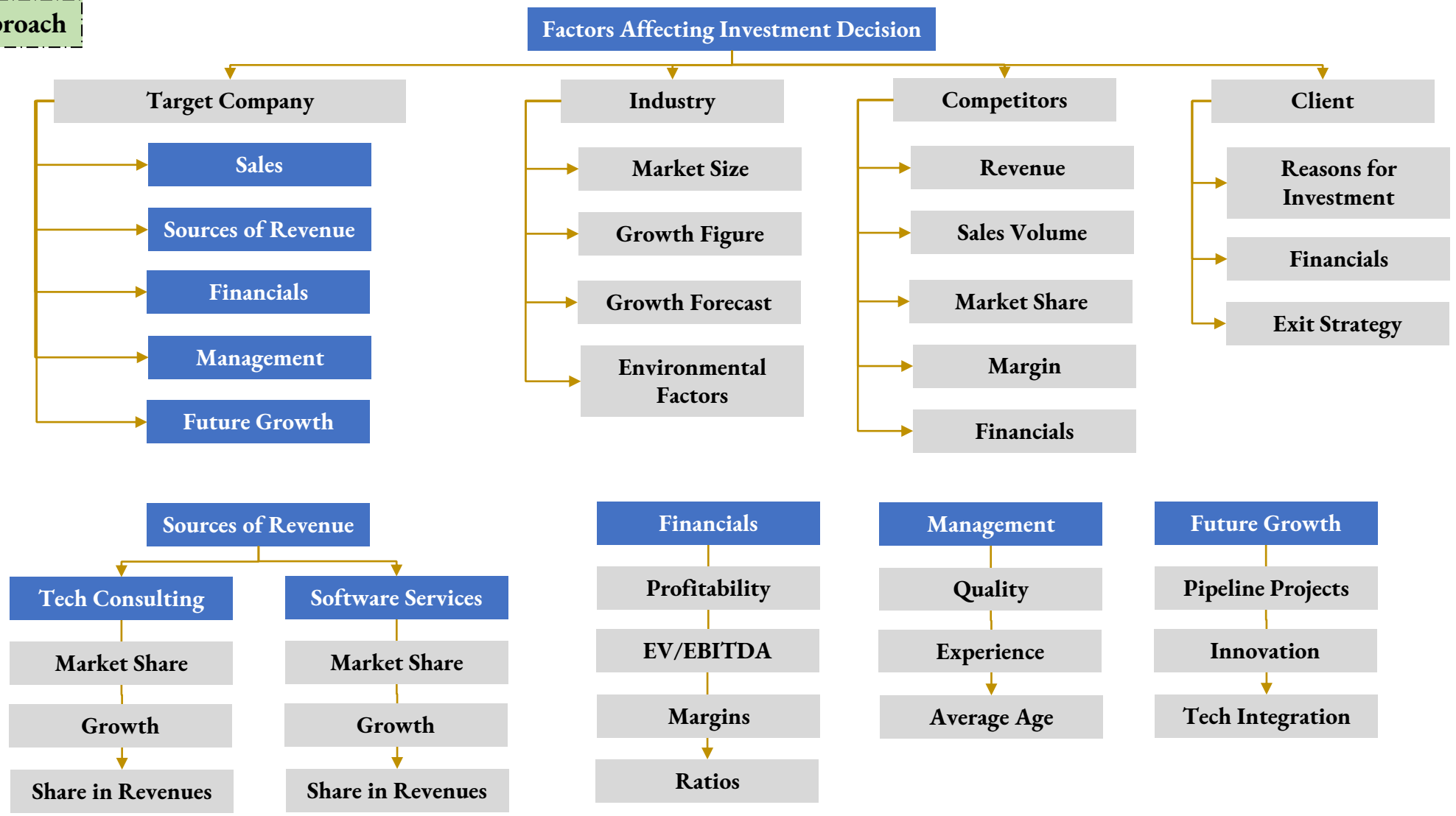
South African PE Firm

Your client is a south African PE firm and wants to invest in Indian tech-consultancy and advisory company. Suggest how to do it?

Case Facts & Notes

1. Decision to enter has been taken.
2. No previous investment experience in India
3. Objective: The objective is to tap the growing Indian IT market and exit in 8-10 years.

Approach



5G Launch in India

A telecom operator in India wants to launch 5G services, analyze this decision.

Sir, just to be on the same page, Our client is a 5G operator and they want to launch 5G services in India. Can I ask a few clarifying questions regarding the case?

Yes, go ahead!

Is the decision to launch 5G already taken? What parts of this decision you want me to analyse?

Yes. We are looking for financial profitability in the next 2 years. Apart from that we want you plan execution and pricing of service.

Okay. What is the current industry scenario like? Are there any other players in this domain?

At the moment there is no 5G player at present. There are 4 players in the market, 3 of them have 4G capabilities. There was disruption and price war recently in the industry but things are stabilizing now.

Thank you! I'd like to know more about the company. Why are they looking to move to 5G?

They want to be first movers in the market. 5G is the future. With this move, they wish to capture 40% of the market share in the industry and consolidate their customer base. Their core competencies are: Good brand image, international expertise and market experience.

Thank You! And can you tell me more about the customers? How adaptable are they?

The customers are very price sensitive. But when 4G was launched, 90% of the customers shifted to 4G within 2 years. We expect the same pattern with the launch of 5G.

Thank You! Can I have a few moments to gather my thoughts about the approach.

Sure! Take a minute.

Okay! As profitability is the objective, I will be approaching this case by finding the major costs and expected revenue we can generate. Revenues will depend on number of customers which will depend on customer adoption rate and benefits of 5G over 4G. Also the revenues will depend on our price. But I would like to analyse the cost side first.

The biggest cost will be spectrum costs. Other than this, infrastructure cost, procurement cost & installation cost I believe would be important since the tech. base of 5G is considerably different from 4G. Do we have any data regarding this?

The spectrum costs are 1500 cr. Apart from that, we are planning to install 2500 towers, each costing 2 Cr

That will make the total costs around 6500 Cr. Are there any other costs involved? If not, can I move to the revenue side? I would like to understand more about the customer adoption rate.

No these are the only costs. Customer adoption rate ffollows a normal curve with innovators (10%) adopting within 3 months, early adopters (20%) within 6 months, majority (50%) within 9 months and others adopting within 12 months (10%).

Okay. I can calculate number of customer from that. For price I need to understand the benefits of 5G over 4G and current prices of 4G services being offered first.

Good question. In 5G services, internet access speed (establishing connection) improves from 1s to 0.2s/10MB & call connection time improves from 2s to 0.4s. ? Current 4G packages are offered @Rs150 pm with 1.5GB of data per day. Estimate this to rise to 5GB a day in 5G.

Alright, to calculate price, we can take 3 approach-cost based pricing, value based pricing or competitive pricing. In this case the # of customers are coming to be #of 4g users (30 Cr)*market share (40%)*adoption rate = 7.2 Cr in the first year. Based on this, the price/month should ideally be Rs 75. But this is lower than 4G services. Since we are providing more value to customer. We can go for value based pricing.

How would you calculate the price of value being offered?

Sure. For that, we should calculate the value of added benefits over 4G. We can break the benefits into call & internet based. There are no considerable benefits over calls via 4G. However, in terms of data, there are 2 benefits, decrease in connection time and amount of data. The former is negligible, hence the only major benefit is 5 GB/day data over 1.5 GB/day today. Based on simple proportionality we can price our services anything from Rs. 150 to 450. To ensure faster adoption we can charge a 10% mark-up over our current offering and price the service at Rs. 165.

5G Launch in India

Pricing & Market Entry | Hard | Bain & Co.

A telecom operator in India wants to launch 5G services, analyze this decision.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Objective** - Financial profitability in 2 years. Execution & pricing of service.
- **Industry** - No 5G player present currently. Disruption and price wars recently.
- **Company** - First movers in 5G technology. Max market share (~40%).
- **Customers**-Upgrades to latest technology within 2 years. Very price sensitive.
- **Competitors**-Oligopolistic Market (3 players). All have 4G capability.

Core competencies of client company? - Good brand image, international expertise and market experience.

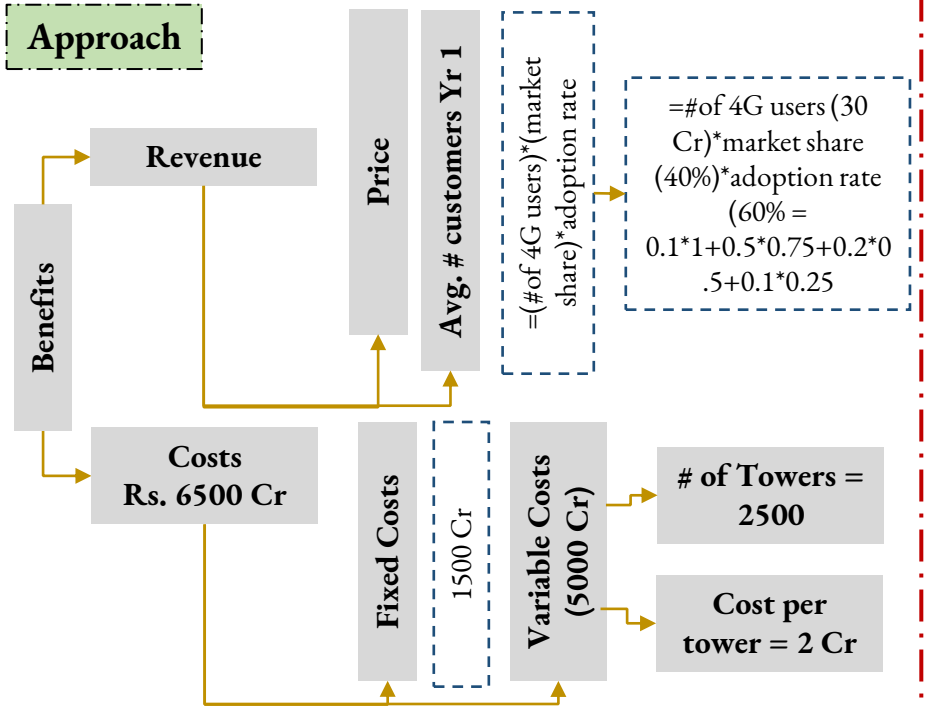
Customer adoption rate? Follows a normal curve with innovators (10%) adopting within 3 months, early adopters (20%) within 6 months, majority (50%) within 9 months and others adopting within 12 months (10%).

Costs for launching 5G? Spectrum allocation, new infrastructure and tower upgradation, need for high speed fiber cables, technical upgradation of HR.

Benefits of 5G over 4G? Internet access speed (establishing connection) improves from 1s to 0.2s/10MB & call connection time improves from 2s to 0.4s.

Pricing of 4G? Current packages are offered @Rs150 pm with 1.5GB of data per day. Estimate this to rise to 5GB a day in 5G.

Approach



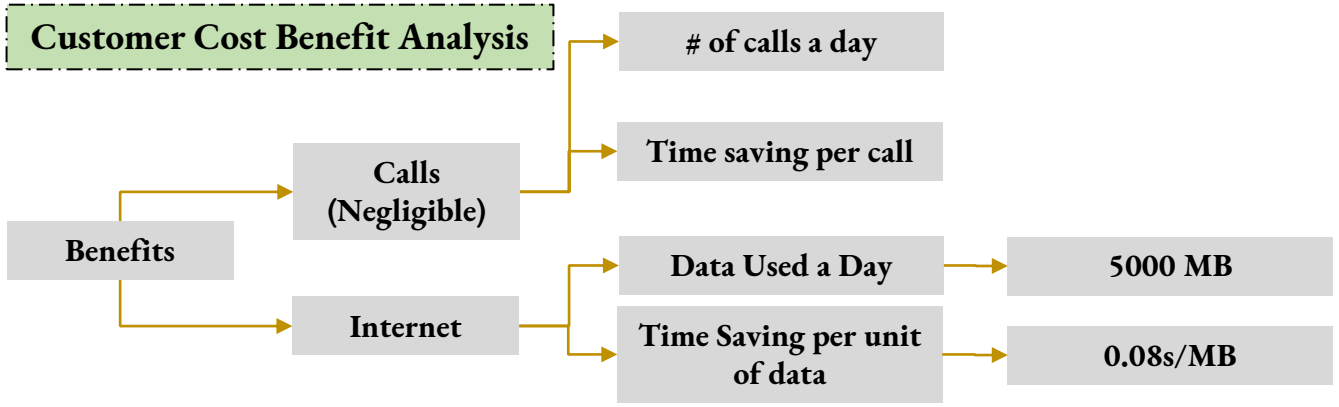
Pricing

- In order to break-even in an year:
- 7.2cr*price/month*12 = 6500cr => Price/month ~= Rs75
- Pricing can be done in these manners:
  - Cost plus pricing
  - Alternate benchmarking
  - Cost-benefit analysis
- First movers, want to maintain market dominance after competition enters the 5G space, use value based pricing and then switch to cost plus/competitive pricing.

Recommendations

- Should enter the 5G market.
- Can realize the investment within an year given current estimates.
- Would help gain market share given the pricing structure.
- **Pricing Strategy** – Price the service at Rs165/month initially and decrease/increase as the competition enters.

Customer Cost Benefit Analysis



Pricing Decision

- Total time saving = 400s ~= 10 min
- Assuming average income of person using 5G = Rs1500/day
- Rs 10 benefit/day
- Total benefit/month = Rs 300
- Therefore, the service can be priced anywhere between Rs150 – 450/month: To start can begin with 10% markup over original Rs.150

Coffee Capsule

Your client is global F&B company based out of Switzerland. They want to enter the Indian market with product which uses coffee capsules (or pods) for making coffee. They need your help in understanding how to do so.

I'd like to reiterate the problem. Our client is a global F&B company based out of Switzerland. They have come up with a product which uses coffee capsules/pods for making coffee and they want to enter the Indian market. Is my understanding correct?

Yes, you may proceed.

Okay. What is the objective for our client? Do we have a timeline that we need to follow? What does the product portfolio of our client look like?

Our client wishes to enter the Asian market through India and capture market share. They have already established a market in North America and Europe. We do not have a specific timeline in mind. Our client has a wide variety of products, but a subsidiary of this company just focuses on coffee; this subsidiary wishes to enter the Indian market with the machine as well as the capsules.

Understood. Has our client established a presence in India through another subsidiary or is this the first time we are entering the market? Who are our competitors?

The company has entered India with other products, even coffee, but not with this machine and capsules. We can try approaching the competitive scenario of this product when we dive into the case.

Okay, sure. So I'd also like to know where are our products manufactured currently and what our distribution channels are currently in India? Do we have sufficient financial resources to enter the market?

Our products are manufactured in Europe. Our distribution channels are through online & offline retailers. Yes we have sufficient financial resources

I'd like to know more about the products. As per my knowledge, a coffee capsule machine will be priced differently based on its features and the capsules will be priced differently based on the variety of flavours. Do we have any information regarding the pricing of both the machine and the capsules, the different flavours available and what we're planning to enter the market with? I assume since our USP is it's a coffee capsule machine, we will have no issue with differentiating ourselves from the market.

Good question. We are planning to enter the market with our most basic machine which is currently priced at about EUR 150. There are a total of 36 flavours in the European market, but we wish to enter the Indian market with 5 basic flavours; Vanilla, Hazelnut, Caramel, Chocolate and Coconut all priced the same. Your assumption about differentiation is correct.

I'd like to proceed by looking at these factors: first, I'd look at our market attractiveness in which I'll explore our target segment and our potential market size. Second, I'd look at the operational feasibility of our client entering the market wherein I'll explore the value chain. Third, I'd look at barriers to entry including our competitive scenario. Fourth, if our plan is feasible, I'd like to explore modes of entry. Does this seem alright or should I cover any other aspect as well?

This seems okay, but I'd also want you to look at how we can potentially price our product for India once we have established an understanding of our market.

Okay, I'll include it in the analysis. For segmenting our customers, I would assume that our customers belong to the upper-middle to upper income segment in the urban areas of India. For estimating the market size, I'd first look into the population of India, then the urban population, then upper-middle and upper income class population. I will then divide it on the basis of age wherein 15-40 would be the major coffee consumer category and then look at % of coffee drinkers in this category. I'd then look at frequency of coffee consumed and focus on those who consume frequently, say 3 cups of coffee a day. Would you like me to come up with a number as well?

Yes, that would be helpful. We can discuss the pricing later, but let me know your thoughts on the target population number.

Sure, I'll just take a few moments. As per my calculations, our population would be 1.34 Cr and cups of coffee consumed will be 4.03 crore cups of coffee.

Okay, this seems fair. Now let's talk about how we can price this product for the Indian market.

Sure, so I'd like to look at it in 3 ways; first, we could explore cost-based pricing wherein the costs involved for the machine and the capsules would be considered. Second, we could explore competitor-based pricing wherein we look at what our competitors in the market. Third, we could focus on value-based pricing.

Let's track down the costs associated with both the machine and the capsules.

Sure. So, based on what I know, the various cost heads for the machine would be:
a) Cost of raw materials such as plastic, metal, wiring, technology used. b) Cost of manufacturing which involves assembly of the sub-components and labour involved c) Cost of packaging for shipping d) Costs related to importing the finished machine from Europe e) Costs related to distribution and marketing e) Miscellaneous administrative costs

Coffee Capsule

Your client is global F&B company based out of Switzerland. They want to enter the Indian market with product which uses coffee capsules (or pods) for making coffee. They need your help in understanding how to do so.

That is quite thorough. Could you also list down the costs associated with just one capsule?

Sure, I can think of the following costs for the one capsule:
a) Costs associated with sourcing the coffee grounds to be filled in the capsule b) Cost of designing the capsule c) Costs of the material used for packaging the capsule (the capsule body, filter film.) d) Costs of assembling the capsule (labour, sealing, production expenses.) e) Cost of labelling the capsule and packing it f) Cost of distribution (margins) g) Cost of marketing and branding h) Miscellaneous administrative costs i) Cost of recycling and reverse supply chain. Do we have any data regarding the costs?

Thorough analysis! We don't have a breakdown of these cost heads. Let's explore competitor based pricing. Who do you think would be our direct competitors?

Our machine and capsule can be priced separately. We can carry forward the machine cost from the European market i.e. EUR 150. It would be about INR 13k. Is that okay?

Yes, that should be fine for now.

For the coffee capsule, since we're catering to a premium coffee segment, our competitors would be high-end cafes and chain stores such as Starbucks, Tim Hortons. I'd also assume that due to the nature of coffee capsules, it'd be similar to a "ready-to-go" coffee such as instant coffee.

Okay, let's consider Starbucks and instant coffee only.

Sure, I'd assume that an average cup of coffee from Starbucks would be priced somewhere between Rs. 300-400. Before I proceed to instant coffee, could I know what the average quantity of coffee in a capsule?

Let's take the average price of a Starbucks coffee to be about Rs 150 for the smallest size. The quantity of coffee in a capsule is about 5-7 grams.

Sure, so if I assume a coffee jar of 25g, it's priced at approximately Rs. 100. So, for a 7g coffee, it would be priced at Rs. 28. We can take a premium on this by 50% so our lower benchmark could be Rs. 42. We can assume Rs. 150 to be our upper benchmark. We can price a capsule at Rs. 100.

Okay, this sounds fine. Let's move on to the operational aspect of our analysis.

Sure, I'd explore the value chain in 4 components: sourcing of coffee, processing the coffee into the capsule & its packaging, distribution and sales & marketing. Would you want me to focus on one aspect or should I explore each of these one by one?

Let's explore each briefly.

Sure. We can have two varieties of coffee; one could be from Indian plantations so that our costs would reduce and our capsules are palatable to the Indian consumers and another could be from Switzerland to add a new collection to our portfolio.
For the processing of the coffee, we can set up our own plants or we can use our existing plants in Switzerland. But, initially, till the time we set up our own plants we can continue to source from Switzerland. We can continue to import the machines from Switzerland while we set up our own manufacturing plants here for the machine.
For packaging, we can sell the capsules along with the machine maybe in a SKU of initial 10 and we can also sell capsules in different SKUs such as 10, 50, 100 capsules and so on.
For distribution, we can continue to explore our established distributors in the offline and online retailer space and we can also target high-end cafes to sell our capsules individually.
We can run campaigns on social media to create awareness about our capsules and our machine.
Do you want me to explore the risks associated with our entry as well as the mode of entry as well?

I think we can wrap up the case here. We have all the information we need.

Thank you!

Coffee Capsule

Your client is global F&B company based out of Switzerland. They want to enter the Indian market with product which uses coffee capsules (or pods) for making coffee. They need your help in understanding how to do so.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Objective** – Capture market share with both machine and coffee capsules
- **Context** – Entering India with coffee subsidiary first time
- **Company** – Established in North America and Europe
- **Timeline** – No timeline
- **Manufactured** - Europe
- **Machine Price** - EUR 150
- **Product** – Machine & Capsules/pods
- **Capsules** – 36 flavours, enter India with 5 only
- **Distribution** – Existing online and offline retailers
- **No financial constraints**

Approach

Market Entry

- **Market Attractiveness**
  - Customer Analysis
  - Market Sizing
- **Competitors & Pricing**
  - Cost-based
  - Competitor-based
  - Separate for machine & capsule
- **Operational Feasibility**
  - **Process**
    - Varieties
    - Plants
    - Import
  - **Package**
    - SKUs of capsules (10/50/100)
  - **Distribution**
    - Current offline & online channels
- **Risks & Mode of Entry**
- **Sales & Marketing**

Pricing

- **Cost-Based**
  - Cost heads
  - Machine – EUR 150 i.e. Rs. 13k
- **Competitor-Based**
  - Starbucks, Tim Hortons
  - Instant coffee
  - Coffee shops

→ **Capsule**

- Starbucks – Rs. 150
- Instant coffee (7g) – Rs 28
- Premium (50%) – Rs. 42
- Capsule – Rs. 100

Market Sizing (Coffee Consumers)

Pop. of India = 140 crore

- **Urban Upper-Middle & Upper Class (20%)**
  - **15-40 years (60%)**
    - **Coffee Drinkers (40%)**
      - **High Frequency (20%)** → Let frequent coffee consumers consume 3 cups of coffee/day Total coffee consuming population = 140 * 0.2 * 0.6 * 0.4 * 0.2 = 1.34 cr
      - **Moderate Frequency (40%)**
      - **Low Frequency (40%)**
    - **Rest (60%)**
  - **Rest (40%)**
- **Rest (80%)**

Recommendations

- Pricing for coffee machine to be kept same as European market as it's a premium segment. Each capsule to be priced at Rs. 100. SKUs of capsules can be packaged (10/50/100 capsules)
- Same distribution channel to be followed as previously established, along with coffee shops
- Import from Switzerland, set up plants in India for manufacturing of machine and capsules

Growth

Case Index | Main Index

Appliance Distribution Company

Our client is a PE Firm which has recently invested $400mn in an appliance distribution company, ABC Ltd. You are hired to increase company's profits

Thank you sir, I'd just like to confirm my understanding. Our client is a PE Firm that has invested $400mn in an appliance distribution company and now they want us to help them increase profits. Right?

Yes, that's right

Okay, so I'd want to know if we have any minimum threshold of profit increase?

We are looking for an increase in profits by around $300 Mn.

Okay, thank you. I'd like to clarify a few more aspects regarding ABC. Where are we based, what are the goods we deal in, who our customers are and what the competition looks like?

ABC is based out of US, dealing in white goods like ACs, refrigerators, ovens and more. They're basically involved in distributing products to retailers, both big and large retailers all across US are their customers. The market is fragmented and has about 5-6 players.

Thank you sir! Can I also know a bit about the revenue and business model? Also, our USP?

Sure, no specific USP exists but as far as revenues are concerned, current revenue figures are at $1500Mn, 33% of which are profits.

Okay, so as I see it, we aim to increase about $300mn , i.e. about 20% of the current revenues.

Yes, that's right.

Okay. So would you want me to consider only one of increasing revenues or lowering costs to increase profits, or should I look into both?

You can focus on increasing revenues. Their costs are under control and competitive.

Okay, thank you. So I'll start by enlisting a few ways by which the company may increase its revenues and formulate a strategy for growth. The first would be geographical expansion.

Sure, that sounds good. What do you exactly mean by geographical expansion and what do you think would the pros & cons of your suggestion be?

Sure, pros could be that with expanding, they could tap into untapped markets and get access to new customers, technology. while cons would be that there may be a considerable amount of capital investment involved along with looking out for any regulatory constraints.

Okay, what else do you think could be ways to increase revenues?

The client can also expand into new products of the same categories like electronic equipment, consumer durables. Similarly, we can look to expand within the existing market too.

That sounds interesting, how do you propose to do that?

For this, I'd like to ask if our retailers purchase only from us or other distributors too?

That's a good question. Retailers currently purchase about 50% of their inventory from us while competitor retailers have 70% of their products worth from their major distributors.

Oh then that surely has a scope of improvement. We can work on negotiating terms to increase share in each retailer's inventory. We can also look to onboard other retailers in the long term.

Great, that sounds good! Any other solution?

For any inorganic growth option, I don't think it's very feasible currently since there is time yet to realise full potential in the current market, making capabilities to offer in case of a merger less attractive.

Right, that was insightful, thank you!

Thank you!

Appliance Distribution Company

Our client is a PE Firm which has recently invested $400mn in an appliance distribution company, ABC Ltd. You are hired to increase company's profits

Case Facts & Notes

- **Objective**: Gain a better return on investment/ increase profits for the ABC company both in the short and the long term.
- The metric is also to increase profits by $ 300 MN.

Note: Instead of applying a typical Profitability framework, we have to instead consider only the revenue part as we need to increase profits equal to 20% of present revenues, also the PE firm has already invested $400 MN. Hence, this is a case of growth strategy.

Approach

ABC Limited : Business

Client

- Based out of US dealing in goods like ACs, refrigerators, ovens.
- Basically, distributors who directly provide products to the retailers
- Present across USA

Market

- Competitive market with the presence of 5-6 big players
- No specific USP for our client
- Apart from major competition, fragmented market with a fixed revenue model based on sales by the retailer.

Customers

- Current revenue figures are at $ 1500 Mn.
- Both large retail chains and small individual retailers are currently present as customers for ABC Ltd.
- 33% of the revenue is the profit

Value Chain/Operations

- White goods are manufactured by different companies and kept in their respective warehouses.
- ABC Ltd. collects the same and transports them to the end retailers or retail chains.
- Currently client is only in the business of white goods.

Growth Strategy

- **Geographic Expansion**
- **Portfolio Expansion**
- **Inorganic Growth**
- **Existing Market**

Recommendations

- The client can expand geographically domestically or internationally. Uncertainty about the new markets; Capital investment; Unfavourable regulations would have to be kept in mind in this case. Moreover the client can still further expand in the existing geography
- The client can expand into new products of the same or related categories like electronic equipment, consumer durables, brown goods. This would lead to an increase in revenues.
- The client can add more retailers or can increase share from each retailer. If the retailers are using less of client's products as their total inventory compared to our competitors retailers, if we upsell, profits can rise.

Apparel Business Topline

Our client is in the apparel business in the US and wants to expand its top-line. How should we go about it.

Sir, just to be clear, out client wants to increase revenue? And, does he have any target in mind?

Yes, our clients wants to grow its top line by 25%

Sir I would like to ask a few clarifying questions.

Sure, go ahead!

What product does our client provide? What is its USP? What is the client's market share?

Our client provides mid-priced jeans which are known for quality at affordable prices. The market is quite fragmented, but our client is amongst the top 5 players in the market

Thank you sir! Since the jeans are know for their quality at affordable price, is it fair to assume that target customer are low income families? Or they want to target a new segment as well.

The clients targets low-income adults – both men and women. For now, lets focus on same segment

Thank you sir! The are two options available to us. Either the client can grow organically or via acquisition which would require huge capital investment form clients' ends

The client just want to grow organically for now.

Sure sir! Revenue is function of number of customer and revenue per customer. For organic growth we can increase both. For revenue/customer, either we can increase the price or/and increase the prices, though because of our USP, I would suggest not increase price. To increase number of customer, we can either enter new markets or penetrate deeper in existing markets

Sounds good to me. First let's explore revenue per customer. As you correctly pointed out, we can't increase price, so lets target the frequency of purchase

To increase the frequency, I suggest we can strategically tie-up with departmental stores and retail chains for cross-selling promotions. This would also help us expand our customer base. Second, We can also investigate the marketing activities over E-commerce segment and provide bulk discounts. Third, we can start with loyalty program if there aren't any.

That interesting. Let's explore how we can increase customers starting with new markets.

For new markets, either we can enter new geographies, we can target other customer segments like upper income group, kids, and we can launch new products to attract more customers

If the client goes with your first option of new markets, what factors should we consider?

As per my understanding, we should evaluate any new market considering size of the market in terms of demand for jeans and favorable attitude to jeans, paying capacity, competition and ease of setting up manufacturing/distribution operations.

Are there any potential risk as well?

Yes, with new markets there might be some associated risks as well. Let us say we select China as a new market to explore, potential risk I could foresee are; 1. Mid-priced jeans in US might be comparatively expensive in China, 2. Getting licenses and permissions might be difficult, and 3. Existing low-cost competitors in China

All these are legitimate concerns. We will keep them in mind while moving forward. What are your thoughts on existing markets?

To achieve deeper penetration in existing markets, we can look for new marketing campaigns to reach out to untapped costumer and simultaneously expand our existing distribution channels to serve more customers

We can present all these ideas to the client and ideate further. Thank you! Have a great day ahead.

Apparel Business Topline

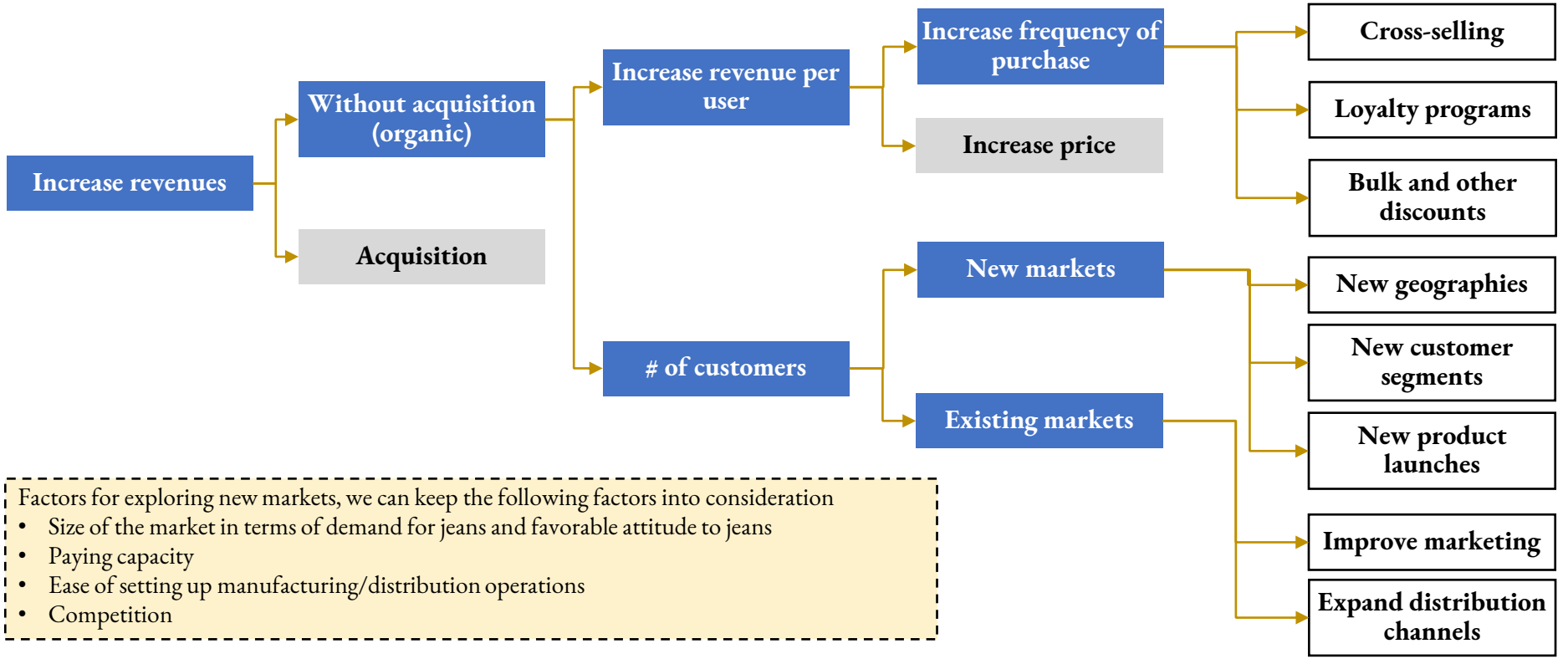
Our client is in the apparel business in the US and wants to expand its top-line. How should we go about it.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Objective**–Increase revenues. Target of 25% increase.
- **Product**- Mid-priced jeans. Known for quality at affordable prices.
- **Market**-Fragmented market. Client is one of the top 5 players
- **Target Segment**-Low-income adults – both men and women

Approach

As this is a fragmented market, there would be many small players. The company can investigate strategic acquisitions to expand into different customer segments or acquire differentiated product capabilities.



Factors for exploring new markets, we can keep the following factors into consideration

- Size of the market in terms of demand for jeans and favorable attitude to jeans
- Paying capacity
- Ease of setting up manufacturing/distribution operations
- Competition

Recommendations

1. Strategic tie-ups with departmental stores and retail chains for cross-selling promotions. This would also help us expand our customer base.
2. We can also investigate the marketing activities over E-commerce segment.
3. Starting loyalty programs.

However there might be some associated risks as well. Let us say we select China as a new market to explore

Potential risks / concerns

- Mid-priced jeans in US might be comparatively expensive in China
- Getting licenses and permissions
- Existing low-cost competitors in China

Book Publishing

A private equity firm wants to acquire a legal book publishing house, but is concerned about their future prospects. They want you to analyse if the market of the publishing house is attractive enough or not.

Okay, I would like to make sure I've understood the problem correctly. Our client wishes to acquire a legal book publishing house and they want to know whether this is a viable option and whether they can grow in the market if they go forward with the acquisition. Is that correct?

Yes, that's correct. How would you approach this?

I would like to ask a few questions just to understand the problem better. First, I'd like to know what is our objective? Second, I'd like to know if we have a specific timeline in mind?

The objective is to understand what kind of market we are looking at. They also want to know what are the avenues of growth we can explore i.e. new markets maybe. There's no timeline as such since this is just the exploration stage.

I'd like to know more about our client, the private equity firm. Do we have any information regarding their current portfolio and their debt to equity ratio? Where are they based out of?

We only know that they are based out of USA. Let's focus on the other aspect of the case i.e. the TargetCo. to acquire.

Sure. Where is our TargetCo. i.e. the legal book publishing house based out of? What kind of material do they publish?

The publishing house is based out of India. They publish one-time publishing material such as books and repetitive publishing material such as legal journals, cases. Can you think of segments to which the publishing house can cater to with these products?

As per my knowledge, we can cater to different individuals, such as students (i.e. aspirants preparing for bar exam or law students currently pursuing the subject), working professionals (i.e. lawyers, CAs or consultants who can use the books for research) and non-formal professions such as clerical work. Can I know which segment we're currently catering to?

We're only catering to D2C sales in specialty academic bookstores involving the segments you just mentioned. Our TargetCo. has been looking to expand for a while. What can you suggest?

Apart from this, we can also look at expanding into bookstores of institutions such as universities & colleges, schools. We can expand further into chain and independent bookstores which sell fiction and non-fiction books and not just academic bookstores.

Okay, this seems fair but let's explore more avenues. What else can you recommend?

We could also look into libraries of institutions along with public libraries. Also, we can explore legal conferences/conventions and seminars and try to set up exhibitions in these events.
Another avenue we can explore are D2C retailers such as Amazon, Flipkart and even the websites of bookstores where our product is selling. We can even create our own website for a long-term option and also offer subscription services once we have our own distribution channel set up.
As another option, we can explore second-hand online and offline marketplaces.
We can even distribute it to coaching classes to reach students better and companies wherein people look for legal material for research (i.e. CAs and consultants).

This is extremely thorough! To close out our case, how would you segment the population for our market? Only focus on one of our products and one of our avenues of distribution and try to come up with a formula.

I'd like to look into only books and only libraries of universities.
First we should segment the libraries on the basis of scale i.e. small, medium and large libraries based on the number of students in each university. Then we can take what % of these libraries have legal books. I'd also take into factor the no. of copies of a particular book maintained at the library
Should I explore each of these factors further?

No, this is sufficient. We can wrap up the case.

Thank you!

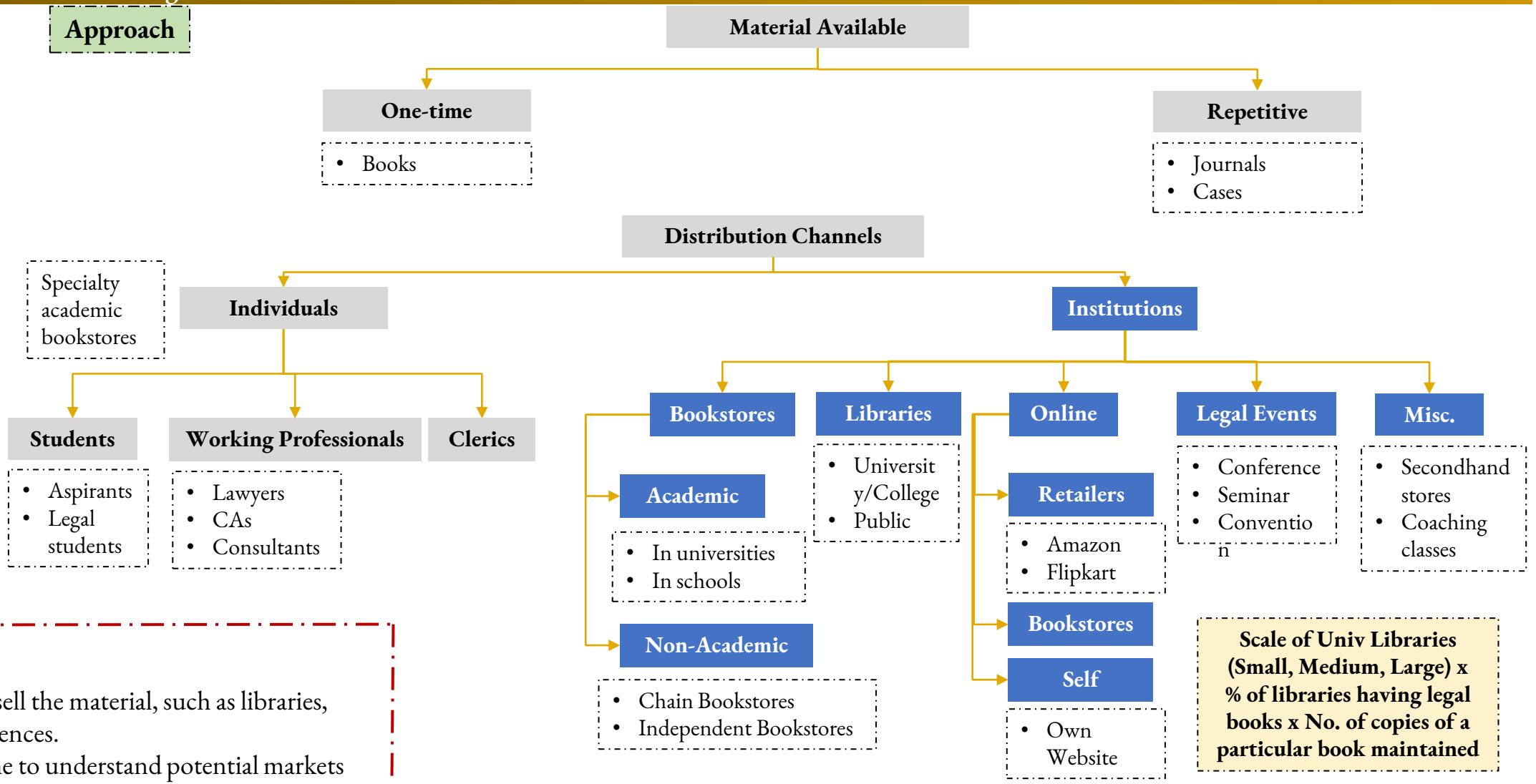
Book Publishing

A private equity firm wants to acquire a legal book publishing house, but is concerned about their future prospects. They want you to analyse if the market of the publishing house is attractive enough or not.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Context** – Exploration stage
- **Timeline** – No specific time provided
- **Objective** – Analyse potential markets
- **PE Firm** – based in USA
- **TargetCo**– based in India
- **Material** – Books, journals, cases.
- **Current distribution** – D2C sales through specialty academic bookstores

Approach



Recommendations

- Finding newer places to sell the material, such as libraries, online retail, legal conferences.
- Market sizing can be done to understand potential markets

Pediatric Vaccine Manufacturer

Your client is a pharma company that is selling pediatric vaccines. They are looking for strong growth in the next 3 years. Is it possible for us to grow in the market? If yes, then devise a plan for the same.

Reiterating the problem statement, our client is a pediatric vaccine manufacturer. They are looking to grow in the next 3 years and I need to propose a plan for the same.

Yes, that's correct. Go ahead!

I would like to know more about the vaccine. Assuming that it's a pediatric vaccine, it would be used primarily for children. Could I also know which age group is this vaccine made for?

It is a Hepatitis B vaccine. As you pointed out, it's used for children aged 0-2 years.

Okay! As per my understanding, vaccines are provided in multiple dosages, the first being given right after the birth of the child. Could I know what is the dosage schedule?

You are right. One dosage is right after birth, one 3 months after birth and the last one around 18-24 months after birth.

Thank you for the information, it's very helpful. Could I know if we have any price associated with the vaccine? Do we have any USP associated with our vaccine, in terms of efficacy, immunity or something else?

Yes, they are on the more expensive side. The price in a private clinic is Rs. 1500-2000 per dose. The vaccines are also available for free in government hospitals, but we want our growth to be driven by the private sector. No, we do not have any specific USP.

Do we have any information on our competitors in this space? What are their vaccines priced at?

Yes, there are few competitors. They have priced their vaccines in the same range as ours. But, we have a market share of 55% and we hope to grow to 75% in the next 3 years.

Thank you for the information. I would now want to understand the market where we're based and since when have we been operating in this space? Do we have any insight on whether we wish to expand internationally?

Our client is based out of India and has been operating in this market for the last 20 years so we have a lot of trust associated with our brand. We want our growth to be focused only in the Indian market.

I just have another question before proceeding to the case. I'm assuming that since our vaccine is on the expensive end, not all babies would be vaccinated with the same.

That is correct. This is not a mandatory vaccine. Only 10-15% of babies get this vaccine at birth. This number is what we want to focus on for growth.

Thank you! I have all the information I need. In order to understand whether the growth is possible or not, I would like to focus on the customer journey of the baby getting vaccinated and then understand on which segments we need to focus on in order to witness a growth. Is this okay?

That seems fair. Continue.

We should look at four stages to drive growth; first being need of the vaccine, second being awareness about it, third being can the parents access the vaccine at all and fourth would be if it's affordable to the parents.

Can you elaborate further?

Sure. Under need; since it is an optional vaccine I'm assuming parents would not know about the implication of Hepatitis B and why it is important for their children's health. For this, we would need to increase awareness for which we can have two ways i.e. offline and online. In offline, we can target the health care centres (such as private/government hospitals, paediatric centres, family physicians.). We can focus on digital marketing and utilise SEO techniques for parents who are looking for baby products. We can also release educational content on social media.

Yes, that sounds good. Let's now focus on the last stage which is affordability.

All right. Since our product is a premium vaccine, we need to target the upper class and upper-middle class parents first and we can improve on this once we penetrate the market.

Okay, but can you tell me how we can see an increase in affordability in the next 3 years?

I'll just take a few moments to gather my thoughts.
So according to my understanding, the affordability will increase when there is a rise in disposable income. This would depend on two major factor i.e. per capita income and cost of living.

All right, suppose there is a rise in disposable income, but how do we know that people would spend their extra income on our vaccine?

Okay. Specifically talking about our targets segment, in order to know if they've spent that extra income on our vaccine we should look at their spending pattern for the products that they buy for their babies i.e. the premium baby products such as diapers, baby toys, clothes. If we see an increase in this spending pattern, we can assume that if our awareness increases then they would spend their extra income on our vaccine as well.

Okay, this sounds great. We can wrap up the case, thank you!

Pediatric Vaccine Manufacturer

Your client is a pharma company that is selling pediatric vaccines. They are looking for strong growth in the next 3 years. Is it possible for us to grow in the market? If yes, then devise a plan for the same.

Case Facts & Notes

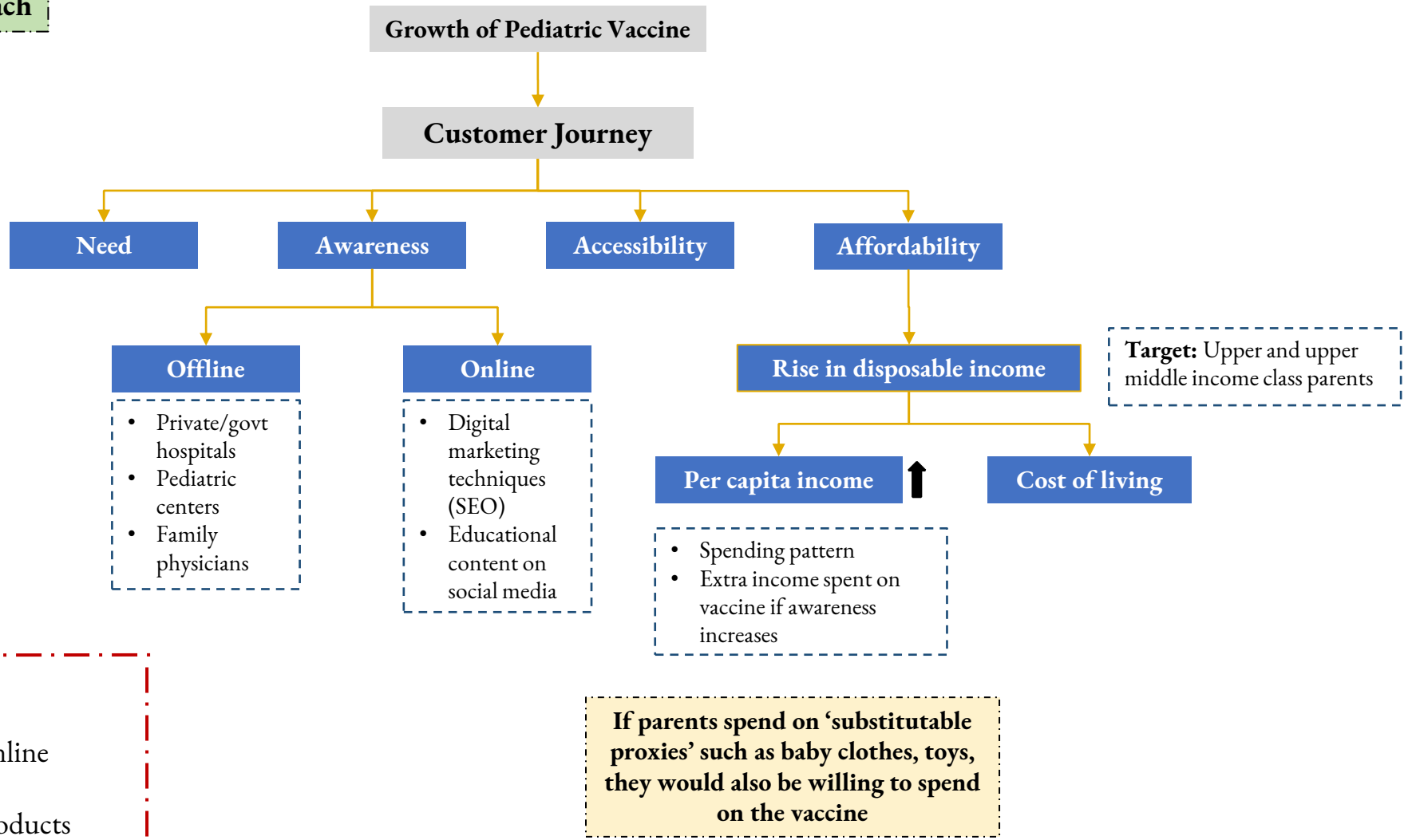
- **Context** – Client operating in India since 20 years
- Product - Hepatitis B vaccine meant for 0-2 year olds
- **Timeline & Objective** – 75% in the next 3 years
- **Pricing & USP** – Priced at Rs. 1500-2000/dose
- **Industry Scenario** – 55% market share
- **Value Chain** – Distribute to private and govt hospitals
- **Only 10-15% babies get this vaccine at birth**

Dose 1 – At birth

Dose 2 – 3 mos after birth

Dose 3 – 18-24 mos after birth

Approach



Recommendations

- Increase awareness of vaccine through offline, online methods
- Analyze spending pattern of parents for baby products

Truck Manufacturer

Growth | Moderate | BCG

Your client is a truck manufacturer looking for growth. They need your help in devising their growth plan.

I would like to confirm my objective before I proceed. Is the client looking for increase in their topline or is there some other objective as well? Also, do we know the growth rate they are targeting and the timeline to achieve the same?

They are looking for 20% revenue growth in next 3 years.

I would also want to understand the kind of trucks we manufacture and their price points. Also, do we have information about how each of our products are segmented in our portfolio i.e. the %?

There are three major kind of trucks we manufacture – Light Commercial Vehicle (LCVs) with a payload capacity of 5 tons, MCVs with a capacity of 5-7 tons and HCVs with capacity more than 7 tons. They are priced in the range 12.5L-50L. MCV & HCV trucks constitute 80% of our trucks manufactured.

I would also like to understand the value chain for this client. As far as my understanding goes, it involve the following steps: R&D, raw material procurement, manufacturing, distribution, sales & marketing and customer service. Is my understanding correct?

Yes. Your understanding is correct. Moreover, we are an OEM (Original Equipment manufacturer), so all parts are also manufactured in-house.

Okay, I would want to understand is the region of our operations and is who all are our clients? I assume this would mainly be a B2B business.

Yes, so as rightly mentioned, it's a B2B business and the clients are distributors and dealers across different locations. Coming to your first question, we are operating pan-India.

That helps. Before proceeding further, I would want to understand the market dynamics and the current position of our client in the market. Who are the major competitors in this space?

Right, so there are 4 major players in the market but are client has more than 50% of the market share and is the market leader in this space.

I will also want to understand the growth rate of the industry in order to understand the difference in the two and accordingly come up with a strategy.

Okay, so the industry is growing at CAGR of ~7% per annum.

In order to increase the revenues, we can look at growing organically or inorganically. Is there some specific preference of client towards organic/ inorganic growth?

Let's look at growing organically only.

Okay, so the revenues can be increased by increasing revenues from existing customers or look at revenue from new customers. Do you want me to look at some specific segment first?

Let's look at revenue from existing customers, first.

To improve revenue from existing customers, we can look at it from three aspects. First, improve the relationship with the dealer/distributor. Second, provide them incentives to push our products and third look at improving their capabilities (provide them training about usage and features).

Okay, what next ?

Now, let's dive into revenue from new customer. New customers can primarily come through new clients, new industries & new products and services . In new clients, we can look at geographical expansion into different countries where there is demand for truck, we can also look at building new client relationships in existing geographical locations.

Sure. What all would you look at under exploring newer industries?

For new industries, we should look at the current industries we are serving (logistics, transportation.) and then look at the other potential industries which can be served. For ex: Frozen foods industry in growing, if we could come up with refrigerated trucks, then we could tap on this industry. We can also supply certain parts and components to different industries. Do you want me to further identify such industries?

No, let's explore new products and services, for now.

In new products, we can start manufacturing other heavy duty automobiles. With shift towards sustainability, we can also look at how manufacturing electric trucks. This will require investment in R&D. We could also come up with refrigerated trucks as mentioned earlier.

Okay, anything else you want to look at?

In services, we can provide maintenance and repair services, driver training to improve safety & fuel efficiency, and end-to-end logistical support. Since technology is ruling the world, we could also explore providing some tech related services like telematics and GPS tracking.

Okay, we can wrap up the case. Thank you

Truck Manufacturer

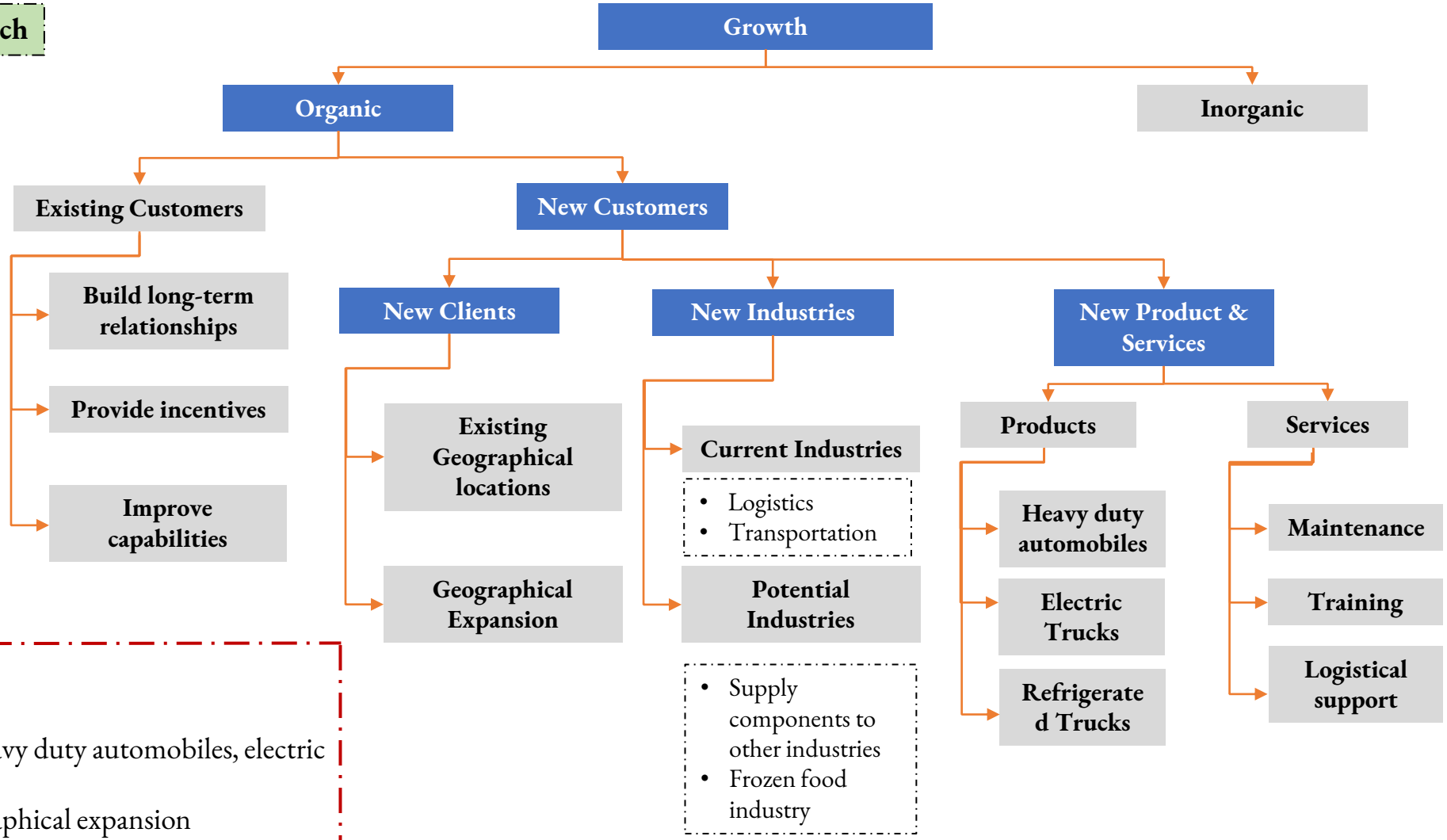
Growth | Moderate | BCG

Your client is a truck manufacturer looking for growth. They need your help in devising their growth plan.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Growth Target** -20%
- **Duration** - Next 3 years
- **Product portfolio** - HCVs, MCVs, LCVs with MCVs & HCVs ~ 80% of manufactured trucks
- **Operations** - B2B sales
- **Geography** -Pan India
- **Value Chain** - Typical value chain of an automobile industry, but not an OEM
- **Industry growth rate** – 7%

Approach



Recommendations

- Get into newer categories like other heavy duty automobiles, electric trucks.
- Get into newer markets through geographical expansion
- Provide additional services like maintenance & repair, training.

Fashion Retail Store

Your client is an international fashion retail store. Help them improve customer experience & marketing techniques by leveraging AI & ML

Reiterating the problem statement, our client is a fashion retail store and they have offline stores throughout the world. They want to leverage the power of Machine learning and AI to improve offline customer experience and make marketing more customer centric.

Yes, you are right. Please go ahead!

I would like to know more about our client. Where are they based out of and what is the competitive landscape they face?

The client is based out of USA but has stores all over the world. In terms of market share, they are one of the biggest players in their segment

Okay! To understand the business better, I would like to know about the products that they sell and the customer segment that they cater to.

The products that they sell can be compared to a fashion retail chain like Zara. The customer segment is mostly upper middle to upper class.

That puts things in perspective. I would like to know if they have any online presence? Do they also deliver products to the customer's home like Zara and other fashion retail chains?

Unfortunately, they only have a product catalogue that is displayed on their website. Apart from that, no online presence is there.

Well then it makes sense that they want to leverage AI & ML to grow their business. It is the talk of the town and no industry is devoid of technology today.

Yes, correct!

Does the client have any customer data collection mechanism?

The client only has records of transaction. However, customer data like their name, demographics and frequency of shopping is not collected

Okay. I think I have enough information to begin my analysis. My first recommendation would be for the client to set up a customer data collection mechanism. The client can use cloud offerings like AWS and Azure. Each customer should be mapped to a unique customer ID

This sounds like a fair ask.

This would allow us to get an idea about the buying behavior of each customer and also provide them specialized recommendations based on their previous purchases. We can also offer certain offers and discounts on their birthday/anniversary

This seems like a very interesting idea

Of course, the cloud service we hire will help use the power of machine learning to create recommendation systems for the consumer.

Yes, the client is also open to hiring data scientists for this particular task.

About the customer experience, the customer can develop a mobile application that harnesses the power of augmented reality. Instead of trying every cloth in the store, the customer can use AR to visualize how a particular piece of clothing will look on them.

That seems very unique. Can you talk a bit more about how we can use this app

Sure, Sir. This app will have a section where the user will scan the barcode and an image from the gallery will be put which will be wearing the clothing item in question. The application will also show the user profile and we can offer them some online discount coupons based on their frequency of purchase. The app can also direct the user to specific sections in the shop which contain the items that are similar to the user's previous bought items.

That is a very good suggestion. Is there a way we can start online delivery as well?

Yes Sir. The current online stores can be modified to increase the storage space in a manner that online delivery orders are also dispatched from the store. The inventory stock can be maintained in a similar application that will be for the usage of store owners only.

That is a really good idea. Can you talk about some KPIs that will help you measure the efficacy of your strategies.

With these strategies, I feel the customer churn rate is bound to go down. Similarly, the Customer Lifetime Value (CLV) and Average Order Value are some KPIs that we can track to measure the efficacy of our measures

Those are really helpful suggestions. Thank you for your analysis.

Fashion Retail Store

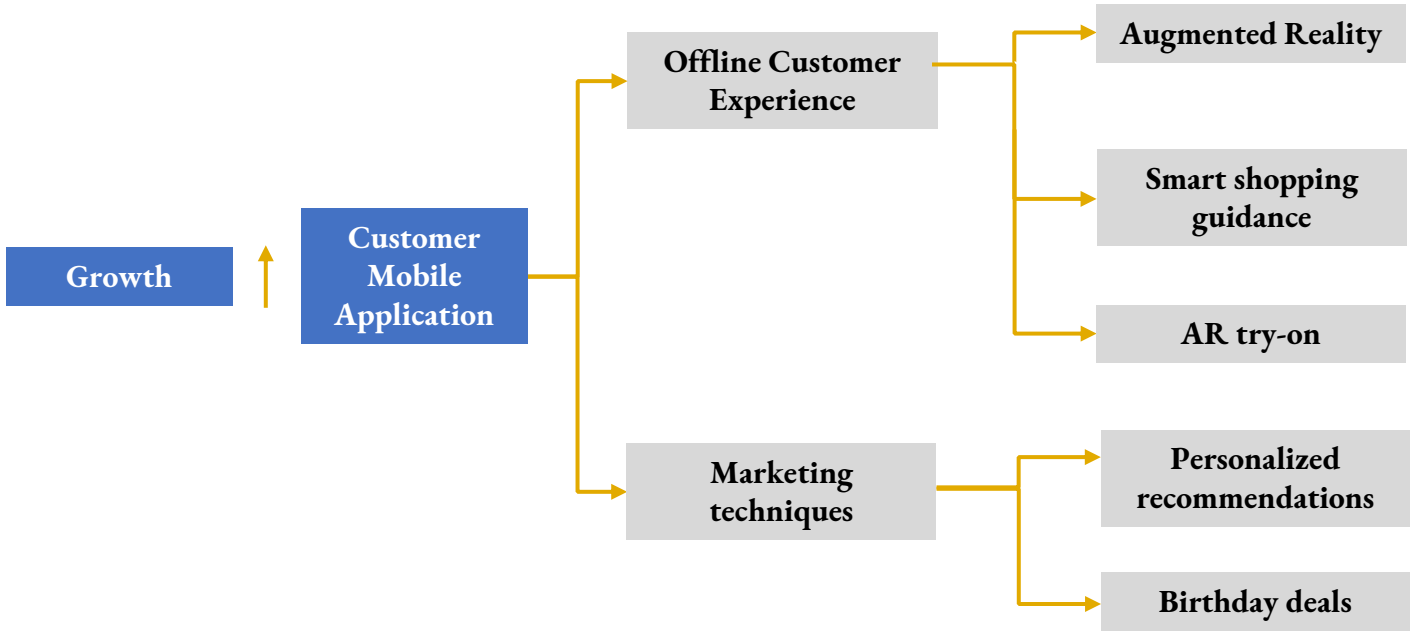
Your client is an international fashion retail store. Help them improve customer experience & marketing techniques by leveraging AI & ML

Case Facts & Notes

- **Objective** – Improve customer experience while shopping and make marketing more consumer centric.
- **Product** – Jeans, Shirts, Dresses, other fashion accessories
- **Market** – Client is the market leader in it's segment
- **Target Segment** – Medium to High income individuals

Approach

Since the client has no online presence as of yet, start by developing an application, followed by capitalizing on technological advancements and improving customer experience



Recommendations

- Create a user mobile application. Initiate E-commerce operations
- Offer personalized recommendations and birthday deals. Can also explore gambled price discounts

The first and foremost step in implementing these steps in creating an online customer database

- **Avail the usage of a cloud service provider (AWS/Azure) or create a data center of your own**
- **Simultaneously, invest in creating an application for the users as well as the store owners**
- **Track inventory in real time from the store end and use the store as a small shipping center as well while also simultaneously investing in creating warehouses for E-commerce operations**
- **Use ML & AI to understand the consumer behavior better**

Spare Part Manufacturer

Your client is a manufacturer of automobile spare parts. They have approached you to help devise a growth strategy.

Before we begin, I would like to ask a few clarifying questions to better understand the case. First, what is the industry growth rate, and how does our client's growth compare?

The industry is growing at 9%, but our client has only been growing at 6%.

What is our business model? Who are our customers?

We have a fully integrated supply chain management who manufacture two-wheeler and four-wheeler spare parts. 80% of our revenue comes from two-wheeler spare parts and 20% from four-wheeler parts
We sell our products through Mechanics, Retail showrooms and Other OEMs.

Where do we currently operate?

Our operations are currently limited to North and West India.

What are our individual growth rates for 2-wheeler and 4-wheeler segments?

Industry growth for both is 9%. Our growth rate for 2-wheeler is 7-8% however for 4-wheeler, it is 4%

As our growth rate for 2-wheeler is similar to the industry, is it okay to work on 4-wheeler for now? And what specific parts do we produce?

Yes sure that is perfectly fine, we currently produce side rear-view mirrors, gearboxes and front LED headlights.

Now let's move on to the growth strategy. We can either follow organic routes or inorganic routes like JVs or M&As. Based on our operations, I think we should focus on organic growth strategy. Do you think this is a fair approach?

Please focus only on organic growth for this case.

Alright. When it comes to organic growth, I would like to explore two primary levers:
Revenue per customer
Number of customers
Shall I begin with revenue per customer?

Yes, go ahead.

To improve revenue per customer, we can:
Launch a loyalty program to incentivize frequent buyers, especially given India's high rate of road accidents leading to repeat purchases.
Introduce product bundling e.g. sell side mirrors and headlights as a bundle at a discounted rate in case of accidents involving multiple parts.

That's good. Let's now focus more on the number of customers.

Here, to improve the number of customers we can grow through either expansion in existing markets and entry into new markets
Let me first discuss the existing market.
To push our current products, in the existing market we can diversify sales channels using B2B platforms like IndiaMart, Udaan. Here we can avoid B2C e-commerce due to the need for mechanic installation. Apart from that we need to strengthen retail and mechanic incentives by increasing margins/commissions to motivate partners, offer performance-based rewards like foreign trips, gifts, and recognition programs. We can also have promotional tie-ups where we collaborate with popular automobile brands for co-branding spare parts.

This sounds good, move ahead.

To expand in the market we are already operating in with new products, we can launch new products such as Rear headlights, Windshield wipers, Car accessories, EV-compatible spare parts to align with rising EV adoption.

Okay, these ideas seem pretty good to me. Move ahead.

Okay, thank you. Now to expand in new markets using our existing products we can go for geographic expansion by entering South and East India, where we currently don't operate, export products to international markets. We can also establish government partnerships to supply for public vehicle fleets.

Since you mentioned exports, what considerations would you make before entering a foreign market?

I'd evaluate both financial and non-financial factors. In financial factors, I would look at the cost of setting up operations with expected profitability. With respect to non-financial factors I would look at market potential and growth rate , government policies and ease of doing business along with the risks (e.g., political, currency, legal).

Spare Part Manufacturer

Your client is a manufacturer of automobile spare parts. They have approached you to help devise a growth strategy.

Sounds good.

Finally, to enter a new market with new products, we can also explore diversification in new vehicle segments like 3-wheelers (e.g., auto-rickshaws) and also launch insurance packages for spare parts where customers can pay a yearly premium and in case of damage, we offer free replacement. This won't cost much to run but could massively increase customer acquisition.

So with respect to all the growth strategies that you have mentioned, what would be the top 2 recommendations that you would suggest.

According to me, the top two recommendations would be to expand into South and East India, leveraging our existing capabilities, and to introduce complementary products like back headlights through our current distribution channels. These moves offer high impact with minimal operational changes.

Sounds good. You may close the case now.

Thank you.

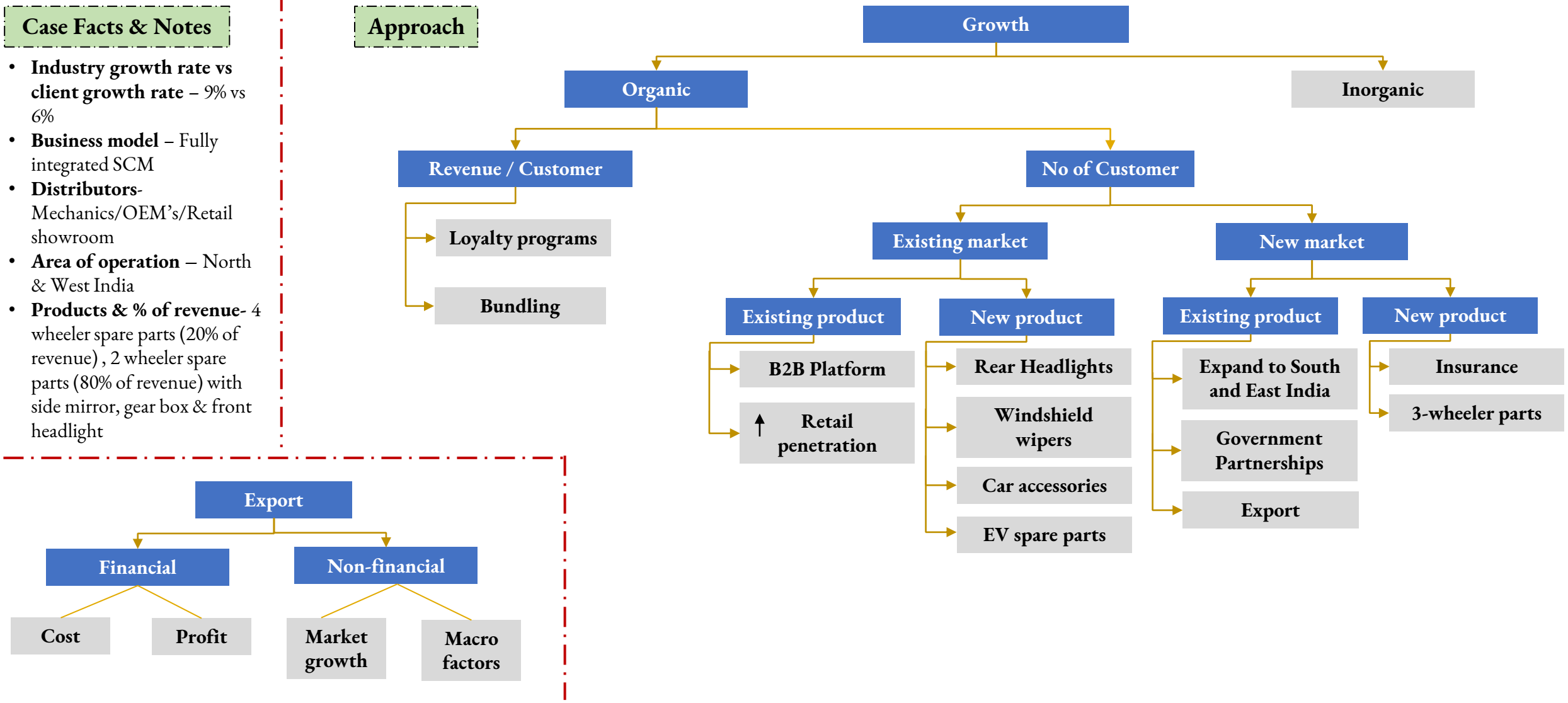
Spare Part Manufacturer

Your client is a manufacturer of automobile spare parts. They have approached you to help devise a growth strategy.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Industry growth rate vs client growth rate** – 9% vs 6%
- **Business model** – Fully integrated SCM
- **Distributors**- Mechanics/OEM's/Retail showroom
- **Area of operation** – North & West India
- **Products & % of revenue**- 4 wheeler spare parts (20% of revenue) , 2 wheeler spare parts (80% of revenue) with side mirror, gear box & front headlight

Approach



Water Treatment Equipment

A water treatment equipment manufacturer operating in three segments; pharmaceutical companies, industrial effluent treatment, and sewage systems; is currently ranked fourth in the market. The client seeks to improve its market position.

Before proceeding with the analysis, I would like to clarify a few points.

Sure, go ahead.

Could you confirm the geographical scope of operations? Also, does the company serve both private and government clients? Additionally, what is the company's growth rate and market position across different segments? Finally, where does our client stand in the value chain, and how does its market share compare to the industry leader?

The company operates pan-India and serves only private clients due to the complexities involved in working with public authorities. Its growth rate is approximately 6-7% across all segments, and it holds a position between third and fourth in each. The market share stands at 15%, while the leading player has 30%. Our client is involved in R&D, manufacturing, and partial distribution. Let's proceed.

Since the issue is not confined to a particular segment or region, we can explore both organic and inorganic growth strategies to enhance market share. Which one should I focus on first?

Let's focus on organic growth strategies.

Organic growth can be achieved by either increasing revenue per customer (through higher revenue per transaction or more frequent transactions) or by expanding the customer base.

Do you believe the revenue per transaction can be increased?

If our pricing aligns with competitors, increasing prices might drive customers away. Hence, price hikes may not be feasible.

Correct. Additionally, the equipment is a long-term asset, typically purchased every 7-8 years. How would you increase transaction frequency?

While primary equipment sales may be infrequent, we can boost transactions through auxiliary means. I would analyze two aspects- product-related enhancements & service-based value additions.
On the product side, we can introduce bundled solutions, customization options tailored to specific segment needs, subscription services for periodic maintenance, spare parts kits, and complementary products such as chemicals and fluids required for equipment operation.
On the service side, we can provide training programs for client employees, offer technical support and advisory services, introduce extended warranties for an additional fee, and implement premium maintenance services.

That sounds promising. Now, let's shift focus to customer acquisition relative to competitors.

I would analyze our value chain to identify differentiation points. Key areas include R&D and innovation, Inbound logistics (procurement and transportation of raw materials). Manufacturing process efficiency, Inventory management, Outbound logistics (distribution and transportation), Sales and marketing effectiveness and After-sales services. Are competitors implementing any major innovations in these areas?

Yes, the leading player has recently integrated AI-driven system monitoring. Let's discuss distribution.

How is our distribution structured? What proportion of sales occurs directly versus through third-party distributors?

40% of sales are managed in-house, while 60% go through third-party distributors.

Could you elaborate on the third-party distribution model? Do these sellers exclusively represent our brand, or do they also carry competitors' products?

They operate independently, leveraging their personal networks, and sell competitors' products as well.

Given this setup, how do we ensure our products receive adequate visibility and promotion?

We deploy a salesforce within stores and conduct direct client outreach when required.

I would assess our salesforce in terms of Quantity (Headcount adequacy), Quality (Motivation levels driven by incentives and supervision) and Efficiency (Frequency and effectiveness of client visits). Additionally, I would like to understand how the market leader structures its distribution.

The top player primarily sells directly to businesses to foster stronger relationships, improve feedback loops, and provide customized solutions. Only 25% of their sales occur through third parties to minimize distribution costs and maintain control over sales.

Based on these insights, I propose the following recommendations: Short-term: Enhance product and service offerings through bundled solutions, subscription services, and technical support; Optimize salesforce effectiveness via performance-linked incentives and better training and Negotiate lower commission structures with third-party distributors to improve margins.
Long-Term: Invest in R&D, particularly in AI integration, to enhance product differentiation, Establish exclusive contracts with third-party distributors to strengthen brand loyalty, Restructure distribution by increasing direct sales, benchmarking against market leaders and Explore collaborations with public sector entities if deemed feasible in the long run.

Water Treatment Equipment

Growth | Moderate | McKinsey & Co.

A water treatment equipment manufacturer operating in three segments; pharmaceutical companies, industrial effluent treatment, and sewage systems; is currently ranked fourth in the market. The client seeks to improve its market position.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Geography** – Pan-India
- **Clients** – Private
- **Growth Rate** – 6-7%
- **Market Share** – 15%
- **Market Leader**– 30%

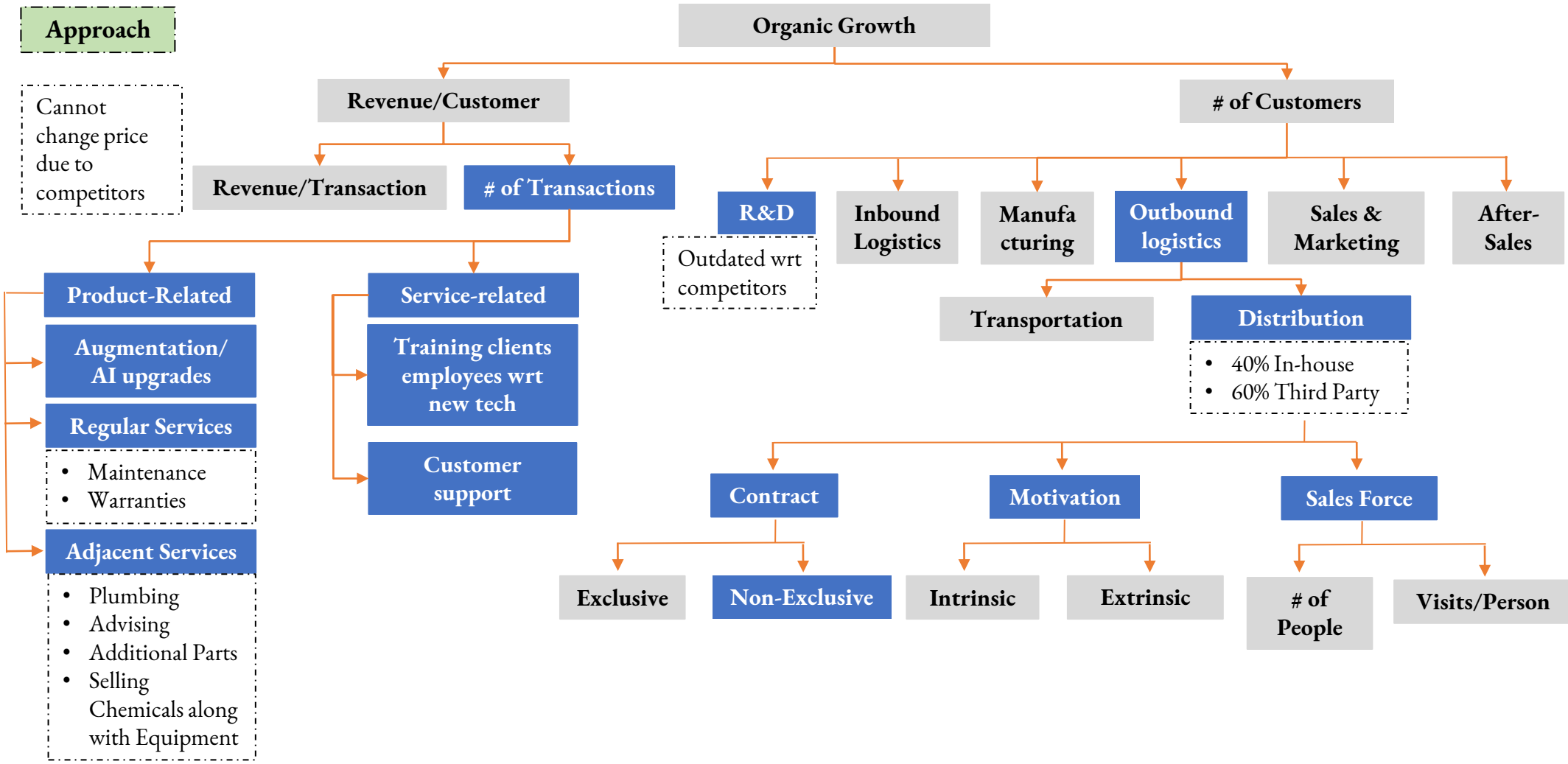
Recommendations

Short-Term Strategies:
Enhance product and service offerings through bundled solutions, technical support, etc.
Optimize salesforce via performance-linked incentives & better training.
Negotiate lower commission structures with third-party distributors.

Long-Term Strategies:
Invest in R&D, particularly in AI integration
Establish exclusive contracts with distributors
Restructure distribution by increasing direct sales, benchmarking against market leaders.
Explore collaborations with public sector entities if deemed feasible

Approach

Cannot change price due to competitors



Vacation Rental Company

Growth| Moderate |Bain & Co.

Your client is a hospitality startup in India an has acquired Vacasa an international vacation rental management company based in Portland, Oregon. Vacasa has 5000 houses listed on platform, you need to increase number of houses to 10000 in the next 10-18 months

Understood. I would like to know more about the Client. Would it be fine to ask some questions?

Sure. Go, Ahead!

Where are these houses located? What is the total market size of this market?

All these houses are located throughout the state of Oregon. There is a total of 150k houses in Oregon

I would like to understand the competitive scenario now. How many players are there in the market? What is our market share like?

There are 4 other major players. You can assume that all 4 players in the market have an equal number of houses on their platform, i.e., 4,000 each out of a total of 20,000 available houses.

This clearly means that there is stiff competition for these houses in the market. Can I assume that the rest 3,000 houses are not on any platform? What kind of houses are these? Where are they located? Are vacant spots rare to get?

Yes, you can assume that the other houses are not on any platform. All these houses are spread throughout the state of Oregon.

What are these house owners like? Are they alike/different segments for the customers?

All these house owners are rich or super rich people. This is their second house, and they love it so they aren't exactly looking for profits from the same. Since around 80% of them live outside the country, they may be convinced to put up on our platforms.

Ok, I get the overall idea of the scenario. What is the current growth of the platform?

The current growth rate of out platform is 5-6%. What are the ways we can go about improving the growth rate to in order to reach our target of 10k in the required timeline.

We can either try to acquire our competitors to get to that target quickly. Otherwise, we can also try to expand our user growth organically. Would you like me to focus on any particular way?

Makes sense. So yes, you can focus only on the organic growth as acquiring competitors requires a lot of capital and we are not looking to explore that option now due to financial constraints.

Okay, I think we can focus only on organic growth. We can go about both online and offline methods. I think we can streamline the process into three steps: 1. Create Awareness about the company and our offerings. 2. Generate Leads from interested homeowners. 3. Convert Leads into actual listings.

Okay, yes, this structure makes sense. What kind of tactics can you use to create awareness and get leads online?

As part of the online options, we can advertise on social media in specified geographical areas. We can also run awareness campaigns along with social media content creators to create awareness, specifically about Vacasa and how our platform is unique from others. Lastly, we could aggressively advertise on real estate sites. We can extract leads by getting traffic that lands up on the real estate websites.

These are great recommendations. What would you do differently when using an offline means?

These are a few other things that we can do in the offline space: • Have a conference at Oregon when they come for vacation. • Advertise at fairs and any happening places where we could find a lot of homeowners. • Establish physical offices at different popular locations in Oregon to build more sales executives' night touch with house owners.

This all makes sense. Now, can you help me figure out how many leads we need per month to reach our target of 10,000 houses from 5,000?

At 6% we need approx. 83000 leads in total. So, if take 12 months as our target it will come to 7000 leads per month.

Are you missing something.

Yes, I will have to consider churn rate as well. Since growth rate is 6% and total houses are 5000 so in one year we will have 5300 houses. But we acquire 60 house/month means a total of 720 houses. Since the difference 0f 720 and 300 is 420, the churn rate us approx. 8%.

Okay. I think we have discussed the case properly here in both qualitative and quantitative terms. We are good to go.

Vacation Rental Company

Growth| Moderate |Bain & Co.

Your client is a hospitality startup in India an has acquired Vacasa an international vacation rental management company based in Portland, Oregon. Vacasa has 5000 houses listed on platform, you need to increase number of houses to 10000 in the next 10-18 months

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company Goal** – Increase number of houses on platform from 5,000 to 10,000, current growth rate 6% .
- **Competitive Scenario** –
- 3 other major players
- Each have 5,000 houses on their platform for a total 20k out of 150k houses registered on platform

Recommendations

- Advertise aggressively on social media, real estate sites, fairs and other happening place
- Run awareness campaigns with social media and at conference offline
- Establish new offices at popular locations across country

Increase the number of houses on the platform

- **Organic Growth**
  - **Step 1: Create Awareness**
    Step 2: Generate leads
    Step 3: Covert Leads
    - **Online**
      - **Raise awareness by**
        - Advertise on social media in specified geographical area
        - Run awareness campaigns along with social media content creators
        - Aggressively advertise on real estate sites
    - **Offline**
      - **Raise awareness by**
        - Have a conference in Oregon when they come from vacation
        - Advertise at fair and any happening places
        - Establish physical offices at different popular locations in Oregon
- **Acquire Competition** ✖

Total Leads Needed @ 6% conversion rate currently

At 6 %, we need 5,000/0.06 = 83,334 leads, approx. 83,000

Every month, 83000/12 = 7000 leads are needed.

But 6% growth rate too, thus we have 5,300

But, at 6% conversion rate, we acquire 60 houses per month now that in 720 houses. Thus, churn rate is 720-300 which is 420, approx. 8% now.

Heritage Boutique Hotel Group

Your client operates a boutique hotel group running out of five restored heritage properties (havelis, forts) across Rajasthan. They want to grow revenue over the next three years. Advise them on how.

Reiterating the problem statement — our client operates five heritage boutique hotels in Rajasthan and wants to grow revenue over the next three years. I'd like to ask a few clarifying questions before structuring. Is this growth mandate driven by investor pressure, competition, or a proactive strategy?

Investors want 20% revenue growth over three years — no external competitive trigger.

Understood. Could I know the current occupancy rate across the five properties, and whether it varies by season?

Average annual occupancy is 55%, but it swings heavily — over 85% in peak season (Oct-March) and under 30% in off-season (April-Sept).

That's a useful pattern. Is revenue purely room-based, or are there other streams — dining, experiences, events?

Room revenue is about 70% of the total. The remaining 30% comes from in-house dining and a few curated experiences like heritage walks and cooking classes.

Understood. Are there existing properties we could expand to, or is growth limited to these five?

There's room to add 1-2 new properties, but the client hasn't committed capital yet — that's part of what we want your view on.

That's helpful. I'd like to structure this using the Growth framework — looking at four levers: growing within existing properties, growing into new properties/markets, growing via new revenue streams, and growth via partnerships. Given what you've told me, the off-season occupancy gap and the ancillary revenue mix both stand out as areas to dig into before considering new properties. Does that sound like the right starting point?

That's a reasonable starting point. Go ahead.

Starting with existing properties — the 85% to 30% seasonal swing is striking. Is the off-season drop driven by weather, or by a lack of demand generation during that period?

Primarily weather — Rajasthan summers are extreme, and most leisure travelers avoid it. But some business/wedding-related bookings still happen.

That suggests off-season demand isn't zero, just underdeveloped. Could I ask about the ancillary revenue — is the 30% non-room revenue growing, flat, or underutilized relative to capacity?

It's underutilized. Dining and experiences are only offered to in-house guests currently — there's no push to attract outside footfall.

That's a second clear lever. Before I move to new properties, has the client considered destination weddings or offsites as an off-season play, given the properties are heritage venues?

That's an interesting angle — they haven't pursued it systematically, though a couple of properties have hosted weddings opportunistically.

I'd like to move to recommendations now, prioritized by cost and speed. Would that be all right?

Go ahead.

First, monetize the shoulder/off-season through destination weddings and offsites — heritage properties command a premium for this, and it directly attacks the biggest gap, occupancy in the weakest months, without new capex. Second, open dining and experiences to outside guests, not just hotel residents, to lift the underutilized 30% ancillary revenue. Third, only after these two are running, evaluate 1-2 new properties — prioritizing locations that extend the wedding/offsite positioning, since that's where the proven demand now sits.

That's a well-reasoned, sequenced answer. Thank you.

Heritage Boutique Hotel Group

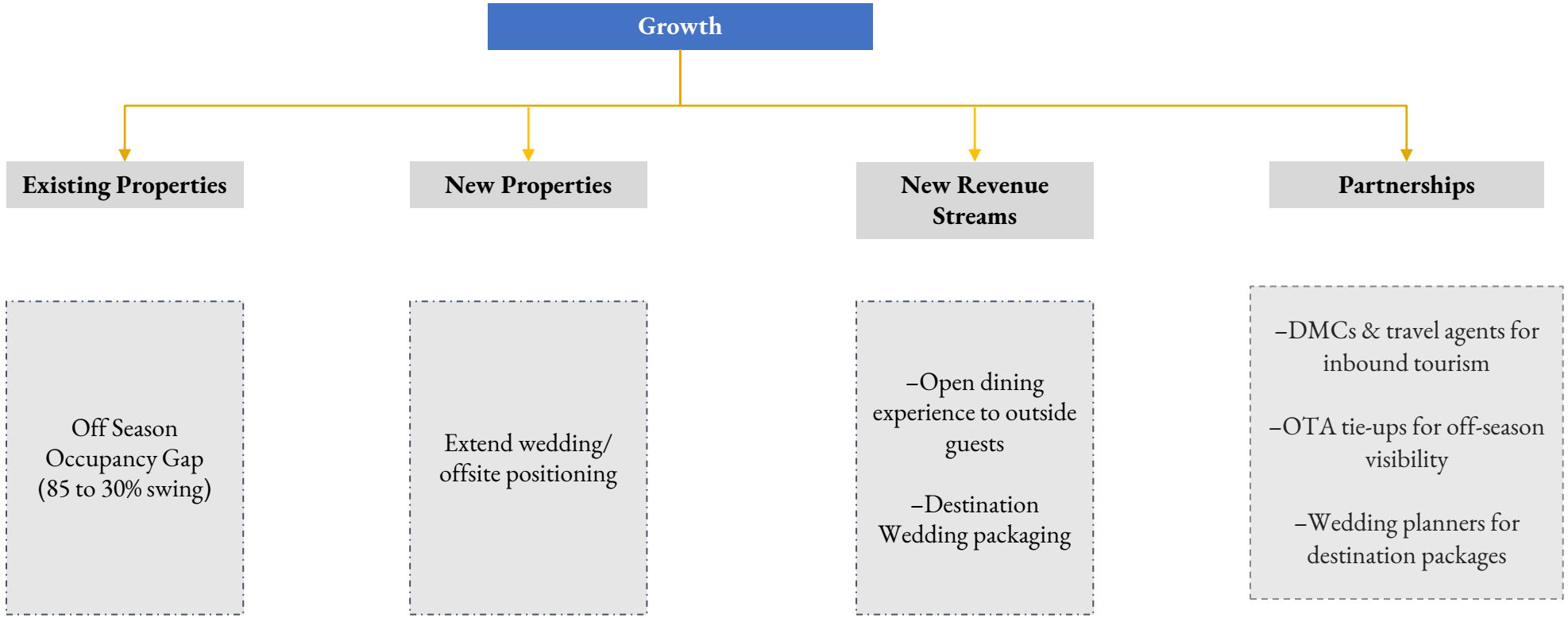
Your client operates a boutique hotel group running out of five restored heritage properties (havelis, forts) across Rajasthan. They want to grow revenue over the next three years. Advise them on how.

Case Facts & Notes

- 5 heritage properties (havelis/forts), Rajasthan
- **Avg. occupancy**: 55% annual — 85%+ peak (Oct-Mar), <30% off-season (Apr-Sept)
- **Revenue mix**: ~70% rooms, ~30% dining/experiences (in-house guests only)
- **Growth target**: 20% revenue over 3 years, investor-driven
- 1-2 new properties possible, capital not yet committed

Recommendations

- Monetize off-season via destination weddings/offsites
- Open F&B/experiences to non-resident guests
- Expand to 1-2 new properties only after the above are proven, prioritizing wedding/offsite-fit locations



Sequencing logic: Fix the off-season occupancy gap and open F&B first (low capex, fast payback) → layer in destination-wedding partnerships to lock in off-season demand → only commit capital to new properties once the model is proven.

Pricing

Case Index | Main Index

Golf Course

Pricing | Moderate | McKinsey & Co.

The client wants to setup a new golf course. They have hired you to come up with a pricing strategy for the same

Our client possess a huge field. They want to set up a golf course there, and they've hired you to help them come up with a price that they should keep for their customers to come and play golf.

Alright, so I'll just start by clarifying a few aspects and the objective, and then we could go into how we can arrive at the right price point. Is that fine?

Yes, that sounds good

Firstly, I will want to know if we have any prior experience in setting up this kind of a complex or golf-course?

No, this is the first time we're thinking of setting up such an entertainment/sports facility

Okay, so are there any competitors we have in this space?

Yes, this field is in Gurgaon, and as you may be knowing since you've worked there, there is a Golf Course nearby on the Golf Course road, owned by DLF.

Yes, right, I know about that. So, what is our aim i.e. what do we plan to achieve with the price? Profitability first or Market Share first?

The DLF Golf Course that is our competitor, charges a very high membership fee to its customers, i.e. around Rs 8000 per year. This doesn't allow a huge group of golf-lovers to come and enroll themselves. So, our aim is to capture that share of people.

Do we also want to keep an annual membership-fee based structure?

No, we do not have any rigid structure in mind. Whichever pricing plan you think will attract the target customers would be fine with us.

Alright. When we talk about pricing strategy, we can come up with three kinds of methods to arrive at a fair price. They are Cost Based, Competitor Based, and Value Based Pricing.

Okay, seems fair.

If we look at competitor-based pricing, we have the price of the DLF Course at hand, hence, we would be similarly priced or lower to tap into the economy segment. We can come back to this later, but first, I would want to know the costs involved in this effort so that I can achieve a minimum price using the cost-based approach that we can charge

Since we own the land ourselves, there is no cost involved there, Although there are maintenance and upkeep fee along with the expenditure for the initial construction of the facility.

Do we have numbers/data regarding these costs?

Currently, no. You can consider that you have a very short time to spend with your client and this is a conversation over coffee, hence an in-depth cost analysis and calculations aren't possible. You need to think of something quickly & produce an approach that is simple & easy to convince the client

Alright, in that case I think we should go by considering what our value proposition is.

Okay, tell me more about what you're thinking

Since we're trying to reach to an affordable price, to tap into the mid-income golf-lovers market, we should consider what are proxies for such an activity be, i.e. those activities that they undertake in place of playing golf as currently, it is too expensive.

Okay, that sounds interesting, carry on.

As an example, we can consider that currently, to indulge in a two/three-hour recreation, they can plan to go for a movie.

Right.

There, they spend about Rs. 500 on an average for a three-hour long engagement. So, here, if we consider that they want to come and play golf instead, they would be willing to pay at least that amount for a 2/3hr play, given that there's an option of no annual membership fee and they can pay on-demand instead, whenever they wish to come and play.

Yes, that seems right.

Now, since this option provides a whole new elite experience altogether because of the kind of sport golf is, we can attach a premium to it. Additionally, we can appeal to the people based on the fact that they are now able to indulge in their favorite activity at an affordable price, contrary to the prior scenario when they couldn't afford it due to the high fixed-fee subscription

Okay, that's great. How much premium due you intend to charge?

I believe we can ramp up the fee to be about 50% greater than the movie ticket prices, giving us a total of around Rs 750 for every 2 or 3 hrs spent. Also, since there's flexibility now around choosing your frequency of visit and paying on site, people would not be hesitant in spending this amount of money.

Great, that sounds like a perfect price. We too arrived at a range of around Rs. 700-800 for the fee without a subscription model.

Golf Course

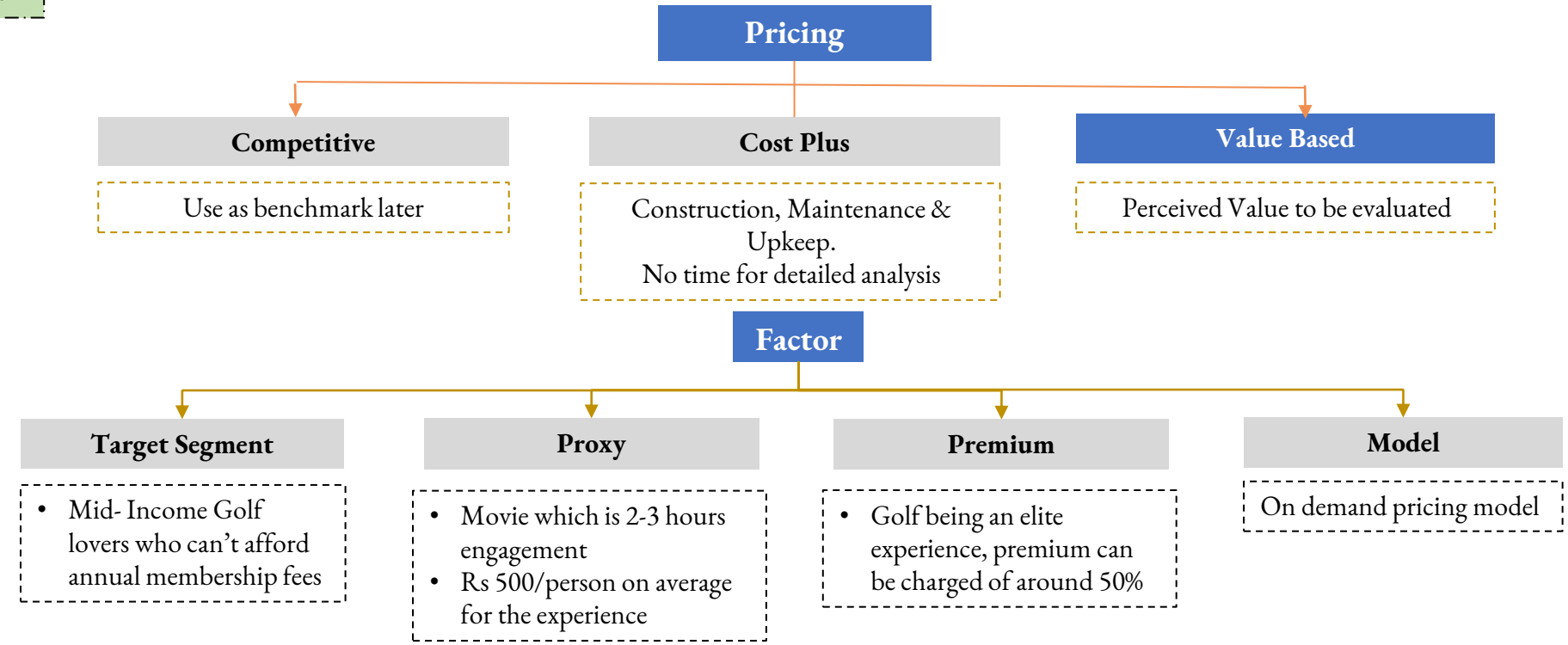
Pricing | Moderate | McKinsey & Co.

The client wants to setup a new golf course. They have hired you to come up with a pricing strategy for the same

Case Facts & Notes

- **Objective**
  - Access to Golf to maximum people
- **Previous Experience**
  - None
- **Location** - Gurgaon
- **Competition**
  - DLF Golf Course
  - Subscription – Rs. 8000 per annum
- **Constraints** - None

Approach



Recommendation

- Price based on value derived from the experience.
- Keep On- demand model to reduce hesitation of initial spending

Price = 1.5 * 500 = ~INR 750/session

Paint Manufacturer

Your client is a paint manufacturer who has developed a new paint that lasts three times longer than the original paint. Help them to price it.

Sir, if I understand correctly, our client is a paint manufacturer who has developed a new paint that lasts 3 times than the current paint that they sell. I have to figure out a price at which they should sell.

Yes, you are right. Please go ahead!

I would like to understand a few important details about our client. What is the geography we are operating in and how is our client's performance against competitors.

The client is Indian-based and has services across the country. They are a leading manufacturer of paint in the exterior paint category and enjoys a market share of 20% which makes them 3rd in the list.

Okay! Since this is a new product I would like to understand this as well as the old product from pricing, features like shades and durability.

The new product is 3 times as durable as the older paint. The old paint costs Rs 500/Litre and the new product is an innovative product and no substitute exist in the market. Both the paints are available in all major shades and kinds.

Oh! That's sounds like a great product for a TG which looks forward to a long duration product. Is there a pattern or target group that the company cater to or it has all kinds of customer?

The major customers belong to tier 1 and 2 cities and have an affinity towards durability.

Since we have to price this brand new product, so I wanted to know if there are any regulations?

There are no regulations and barrier in launch a new product and pricing it.

Okay! I would like to use Value Based Pricing since we are introducing a new product having superiority over existing products. I would calculate price based on the value addition provided by the new paint over the existing one. Does this approach sounds good to you?

Yes, this sounds good for a new product. You can proceed.

So, I'll calculate the cost needed to paint a 10,000 sq. ft area. I am assuming that 1 Ltr of paint can paint an area of 100 sq. ft. Hence 100 Ltr of paint will be used here.
Next cost head will be wages of the painter. Assuming 1 person can paint an area of 100 sq. ft. in 1 day
And charges Rs 1000/day. This brings the cost to Rs. 100,000/day. Are these estimates correct or they need to be altered?

These seem correct, you can continue with your approach.

Okay, thank you. I would like to see the cost to be paid by the customer with earlier product over 9 years as new paint will last 3 times the duration of older paint. The major cost heads are – paint, painter, overheads, convenience. Out of this paint and painter are the ones impacted in new product.
Earlier, total cost of paint would be 3x500x100 = 150k.
Cost of painter would be 3x100k = 300k
Total cost = 450k
Now, let the new price be p, then total cost will be px100+100k
Therefore p = Rs. 3500/ltr

That seems like a fair price. Thank you for your analysis.

Thank you Sir for your time.

Paint Manufacturer

Your client is a paint manufacturer who has developed a new paint that lasts three times longer than the original paint. Help them to price it.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Market/Client** - Leading Exterior Paint Manufacturer. Current Market share of 20%. Top 3 manufacturers
- **Product** - New, durable- thrice of current paint available. No benchmark available; Old paint cost Rs. 500/Ltr. Available in all shades and kinds.
- **Customers** - Tier-1 &2 cities. Would prefer durability due to obvious reasons.
- **Regulations** - No price ceiling/floor for paints. No barrier related to entry of any player or introduction of any new product

Approach

Pricing

- **Competitive**: Use as benchmark later
- **Cost Plus**: Maintenance and Upkeep. No time for detailed analysis
- **Value Based**: Perceived Value to be evaluated

Costs to Customer (Regular Paint Case)

- **Paint**
  - 1st yr-500x
  - 4th yr-500x
  - 7th yr-500x
  - where qty x= 100 ltr.
  - Total cost is 1500x = Rs. 150,000
- **Overheads**
- **Painter**
  - Rs. 1,00,000/-(one time)|will be used thrice in the 9 year period
- **Convenience**

Suppose we need to paint 10,000 Sq. ft. :
Costs involved:
1 Ltr. Can paint 100 Sq. ft; Hence 100 Ltr. will be used
Wages: 1 Person can paint 100 Sq. ft.;
Charges : Rs. 1000/day

Hence Total cost of getting painting done: Rs. 1,00,000/-
Note: Normal Paint Lasts 3 years, hence this will last 9 years

Recommendation

Hence total cost to customer in original paint case is 150k +3*100k = 450 k; which the customer can pay one time provided the paint lasts for 9 years.
Hence, total price = (450k-100k)/100 litre = Rs. 3500/Ltr

On Demand Truck Platform

An upcoming trucking platform wants to come up with a pricing structure. Analyze the factors affecting pricing.

Before we begin, I'd like to confirm my understanding. Our client is a trucking platform and wants us to come up with a pricing structure for the same?

That's right. Are you aware of what a trucking platform is?

Not exactly, but from my understanding it could be a platform providing on demand trucks?

That's correct, you can consider it to be similar to Uber for trucks. However, our client has their own fleet of trucks (rented).

Thank you for the clarification. I'd like to know what type of pricing structure is the client looking for? A dynamic pricing system – depending on location, route, peak hours or a fixed pricing system?

The clients wants a fixed pricing structure, subject to revision each quarter.

I wanted to know if the client will be providing inter city services or intra city services? I'd also like to know about our competitors if any and their pricing structures.

You can consider a singular route between Mumbai and Delhi for your analysis. We currently do not have any direct competitors.

There are two approaches that I can think of – first, pricing according to expected value addition to customers and second by calculating the costs incurred, then charging a margin over it.

Could you elaborate more on the first approach.

Sure, I'd like to determine the factors driving customer satisfaction, then benchmark our client's offerings to other alternatives. Then comparing to the pricing structure of other alternatives and cumulative scores on all parameters, I'd arrive at the pricing structure for our client. I'd like to compare our client's services with 3 party logistic providers and with the end customer having their own transportation. The parameters I can think of are i) availability of services ii) flexibility in services iii) capital expenditure iv) customer involvement

That seems fair, but we do not have data to benchmark with. Why don't you proceed by analysing the costs incurred

I can think of four broad categories of costs that would be incurred – costs related to travelling (fuel costs, toll payments, driver renumeration), costs related to vehicles (maintenance, rent, parking cost during non usage), costs related to maintaining the platform (servers, software development) and other administrative costs.

Good, you've been able to identify most of the factors. I'd like you to look into travelling costs and suggest methods to reduce it.

Okay, first looking into fuel costs – this would depend on the cost of fuel per litre, the mileage of the vehicle and the distance travelled. The price of fuel is a factor beyond the client's control so they could work on reducing the distance travelled and the mileage by regular maintenance of the vehicles and by regulating driving habits (speeding, sudden breaking).

Your analysis of the mileage seems fair, but for price per litre you are missing out on stealing by drivers, which is rather common. Could you provide solutions in reducing cost for both?

For mileage, we could have a tracking device installed and if a driver overspeeds/breaks too often, they could be given penalties for the same. As for stealing, from my understanding drivers usually make transactions which are then reimbursed. They tend to get bills of a higher value. This can be circumvented by tying up with certain petrol pumps who would directly bill the company, or have specific payment cards for these transactions.

Okay, could you also look into the distance travelled? Our client has found that the drivers are taking longer routes. Can you identify the reason for this?

Sure. The drivers could be taking longer routes to avoid tolls, avoid routes with bad roads, go through routes they are familiar with, go via routes which have better amenities (e.g. dhabas) or take detours to meet family/friends along the way.

The last case seems to be the situation. Can you suggest how the client can avoid this?

The previously mentioned tracking device can be used for tracking their route, and drivers can be penalised for taking long routes.

Integrating other solutions seems like a great idea. Thank you for your analysis of the case.

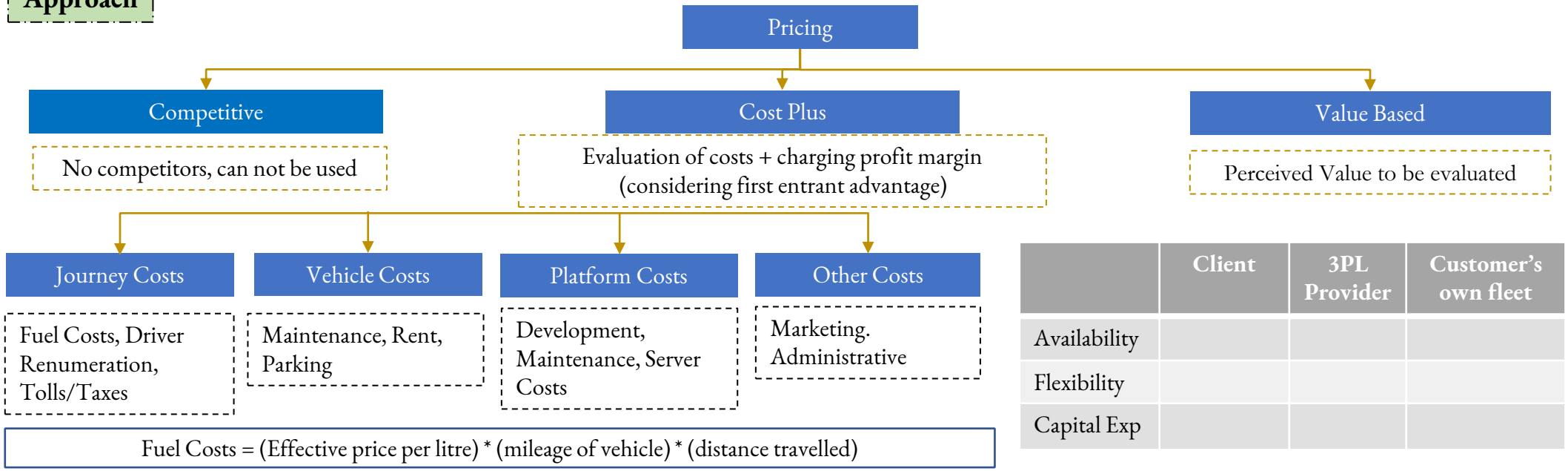
On Demand Truck Platform

An upcoming trucking platform wants to come up with a pricing structure. Analyze the factors affecting pricing.

Case Facts & Notes

- New platform, like an Uber for trucks
- Want a fixed pricing, subject to quarterly reviews
- No competitors
- Based in India
- Fleet rented by client, drivers hired
- Client also looking for solutions to minimize costs

Approach



	Client	3PL Provider	Customer's own fleet
Availability			
Flexibility			
Capital Exp			

Fuel Costs = (Effective price per litre) * (mileage of vehicle) * (distance travelled)

Effective Price per litre

- Transportation industry susceptible to stealing by drivers
- Most fuel transactions are cash and drivers reimbursed on bills. Drivers get bills of higher value, while getting less fuel filled

Mileage of Vehicle

- Mileage depends on specification of vehicle and the driving
- While specifications can not be changed for a specific vehicle; overspeeding, sudden breaking can be reduce to improve mileage

Distance Travelled

- Drivers found to be using longer routes
- Tend to take longer routes to meet family/friends

Recommendations

Pricing Structure

- Lower limit determined by cost plus method (monthly costs/total journeys)
- Upper limit determined from relative value to customers

- Tie up with petrol pumps & provision of fuel cards to drivers so that company immediately receives details of transactions

Reducing Fuel Costs

- IOT device to track route and speed of vehicle. Drivers given penalties and pay cuts for long routes/poor driving

- Speed limiting device to restrict top speed, improving mileage

Neighborhood Bakery Chain

Your client owns a small bakery chain with 3 outlets in a single locality of Delhi. They sell 3 products - cakes, pastries, and breads. Sales have been steady, but they feel they're leaving money on the table with their current flat pricing. Advise on pricing strategy.

Reiterating the problem — our client runs a 3-outlet bakery chain, selling cakes, pastries, and bread, currently at flat prices across all outlets. First, could I understand the current pricing — is it truly identical across all 3 outlets and all customer types?

Yes, completely flat — same price per item at every outlet, no discounts or tiers.

Understood. Are all 3 outlets in similar micro-locations, or do they differ — say, footfall type, nearby competition?

Good question — one outlet is right next to a corporate park (weekday lunch crowd), one is in a residential society (weekend family crowd), and one is near a college (price-sensitive, snack-driven).

That's a significant difference in customer type per outlet. Before going further, do we know how costs differ — is it the same cost to produce and deliver to all three?

Production cost is centralized and the same for all outlets, but the residential outlet has slightly higher last-mile delivery costs since they do more home deliveries.

Understood. I'd like to structure this using the three lenses of pricing — cost-based, value-based, and competition-based — and given what you've told me about outlet-level customer differences, I suspect the answer isn't one flat price, but some form of segmentation. Does that sound like a reasonable direction?

That's a fair hypothesis — go ahead and explore it.

Starting with the corporate park outlet — is there a specific product or time-of-day pattern there?

Yes — pastries and bread sell heavily on weekday mornings and lunch, cakes barely sell there at all.

That suggests convenience/time-value matters most there, not variety. What about the residential outlet?

Cakes are the top seller — mostly for birthdays and small celebrations, and customers there are less price-sensitive for a "special occasion" cake.

And the college outlet?

Bread and small pastries dominate — very price-sensitive, students often compare prices with nearby cheap bakeries.

I'd recommend outlet-level differentiated pricing rather than one flat price. At the corporate park outlet, price convenience-driven items (bread, pastries) at a slight premium given the weekday rush and low price sensitivity for a quick purchase. At the residential outlet, introduce a premium "celebration cake" tier with customization options, since customers there are paying for the occasion, not just the product — while keeping daily-bread pricing accessible for regular shoppers. At the college outlet, keep bread and small pastries priced competitively against nearby options, since that segment is genuinely price-sensitive, and instead look to introduce small, low-cost combo deals to lift basket size rather than raising per-item price.

That's a thoughtful, segmented answer. Thank you.

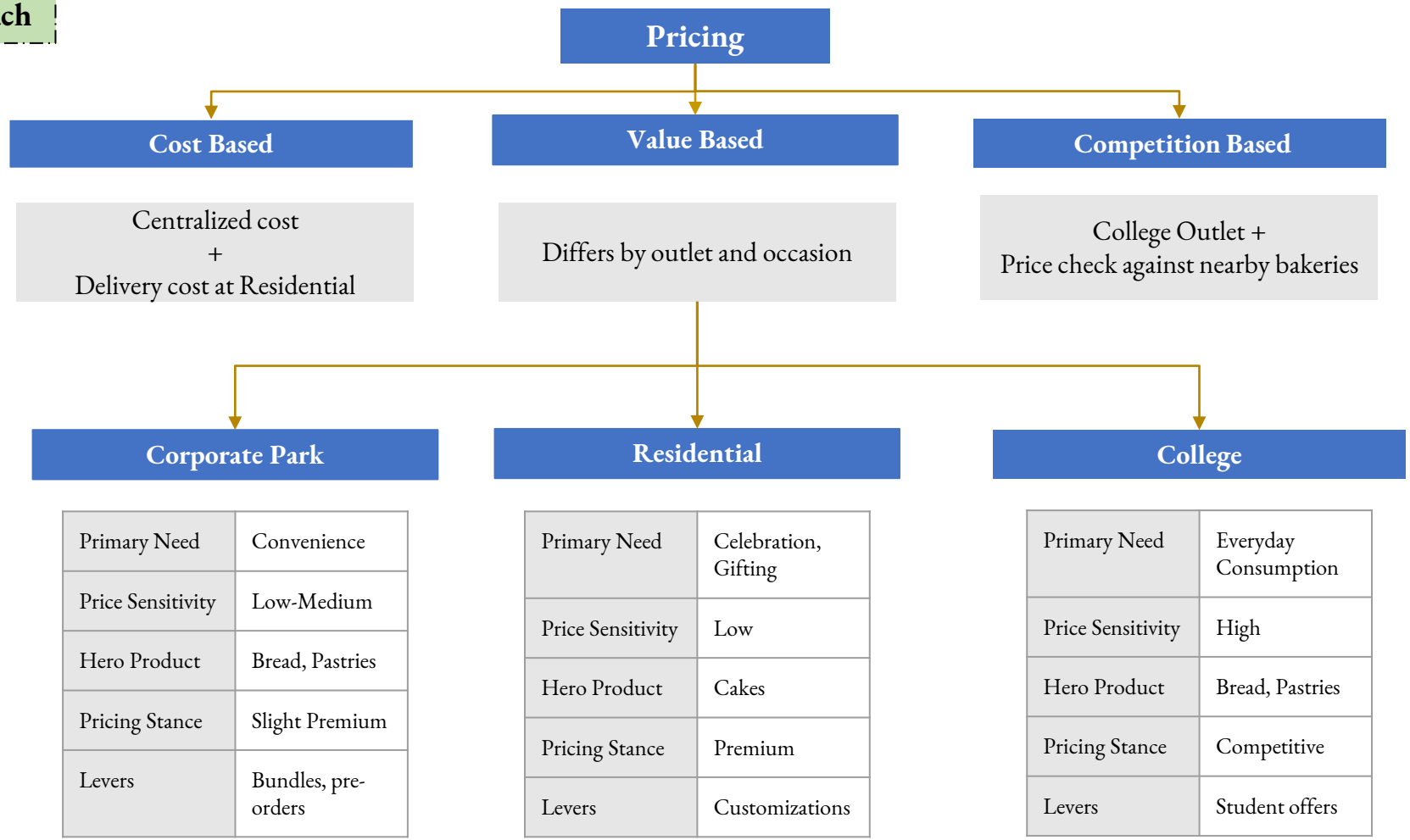
Neighborhood Bakery Chain

Your client owns a small bakery chain with 3 outlets in a single locality of Delhi. They sell 3 products - cakes, pastries, and breads. Sales have been steady, but they feel they're leaving money on the table with their current flat pricing. Advise on pricing strategy.

Case Facts & Notes

- 3 outlets, 1 locality in Delhi — Corporate park / Residential society / Near college
- **Products:** Cakes, Pastries, Bread — currently one flat price across all outlets
- **Production cost centralized**/same; residential outlet has slightly higher delivery cost
- **Corporate park**: pastries/bread, weekday AM-lunch
- **Residential:** cakes (celebration-driven), less price-sensitive

Approach



Primary Need	Convenience
Price Sensitivity	Low-Medium
Hero Product	Bread, Pastries
Pricing Stance	Slight Premium
Levers	Bundles, pre-orders

Primary Need	Celebration, Gifting
Price Sensitivity	Low
Hero Product	Cakes
Pricing Stance	Premium
Levers	Customizations

Primary Need	Everyday Consumption
Price Sensitivity	High
Hero Product	Bread, Pastries
Pricing Stance	Competitive
Levers	Student offers

Recommendations

Corporate park: slight premium on bread/pastries (**convenience/time-value pricing**)
Residential: premium customizable "celebration cake" tier, keep daily bread accessible
College: hold **competitive pricing** on bread/pastries, use combo deals to lift basket size instead of raising price

Highlight

Price differentiation is the key here.
Different customer needs + Different Willingness to Pay + Different Pricing Strategy

Hepatitis-B Drug

Our client is a pharmaceutical company. They recently invented a drug to cure Hepatitis-B. They have hired you to find the annual price range of treatment.

Before I dwell into the analysis, I would like to ask few clarifying questions in order to better understand the client, the product and the market. May I know the geography where our client is operating.

Yes, the client is based out of the US.

Can you tell me about the treatment?

The treatment goes on for 1 year. The cost of the treatment is borne by the health insurance cover provided by the government.

Does it have a substitute? I would also want to know the success rate of our drug compared to the existing drug.

Both are equally effective. They cure the patient completely in the given time-frame (1 year). Can you tell me about the parameters on which drugs can differ?

I think these the parameters on which drugs can differ are side-effects, effectiveness, mode of delivery, frequency of delivery

Great! The drugs primarily differ on "side-effects". While using the existing drug there is a 20% chance of going for a Liver Transplant (LT) whereas the new drug is free of all such risky side-effects.

Do we have data about the price of LT?

Yeah, the complete treatment costs close to $300,000.

To price this drug, I would like to suggest multiple approach. There can be 3 types of pricing strategies used cost-based, value-based and competition-based. Do we have information about the pricing of the current treatment?

There are 2 kind of existing drugs:
- Generic drug - $1,000 – 80% market share
- Niche drug for pregnant women - $10,000 – 20% market share

Do we have data from some credible source about the number of patients going for treatment?

There are close to 150,000 going for treatment each year according to Public Health Department.

I think to decide about the price, I'll use a mix of cost-based and value-based method. I'll find the base and add price of value created in the form of no risk of LT. The expected cost should be (20%*$300,000 = $60,000). The price range for the treatment hence should be $61,000-$70,000.

This figure matches the expectation of the client. Can you try to find out the total money spent by the government? Take adoption rate to be 50%.

I am assuming a 80-20 split in the generic and innovative niche treatment in the 50% adoption rate scenario. In one year, following are the major cost brackets for the government
- **Investments (assumed $1Bn)**
- **50% adoption rate implies 75,000 people to be treated**
- **Assuming price of $65,000 for the treatment**

Total spending = 1Bn + 75K*65K = $5.875Bn

What are the risks involved if the client decides to launch this new drug?

I can think of the following 3 major risks
- **Resistance from government due to high one-time costs**
- **Resistance from doctors and hospitals who depend on LT as an important component of income**
- **Competing firms can replicate the success of the drug and would eat the profit in the coming time**

Good work! This analysis sounds fair

Hepatitis-B Drug

Our client is a pharmaceutical company. They recently invented a drug to cure Hepatitis-B. They have hired you to find the annual price range of treatment.

Case Facts & Notes

- US based company
- Govt. provides health insurance
- Treatment takes 1 year
- Equally effective substitute
- 150k patients
- Current Drug Analysis
  - Generic – 80% Market Share - $1000
  - Niche – pregnant women – 20% M.S. - $10,000
- Liver Transplant treatment cost - $300,000

Approach

Pricing

- **Competitive** — Use as benchmark later
- **Cost Plus** — Maintenance and Upkeep. No time for detailed analysis
- **Value Based** — Perceived Value to be evaluated

Parameters of Difference in Drugs

- **Side Effects** — 20% chance of Liver Transplant
- **Effectiveness**
- **Mode of Delivery**
- **Frequency of Delivery**

Cost to Government

- Adoption rate – 50%
- Fixed Investments required - $1 Bn
- 50% of 150k x $65,000/patient + $1 Billion
- = $5.875 Billion

Risk involved

- Resistance from government due to high costs.
- Resistance from doctors and hospitals who depend on LT as an important component of income.
- Competing firms can replicate the success of the drug and would eat the profit in the coming time

Recommendation

Pricing – 20% of $300,000 + 1-10k
This gives price between 61k-70k

Ride hailing Helicopter Cab Service

A ride hailing service wants to start a helicopter based cab service in Indian market. You are required to price this service for them.

So, just to be on the same page, I would reiterate the problem statement. Our client is a ride hailing service who wants to start a helicopter based cab service in India & they want us to price this service for them.

Yes, absolutely right. Go ahead!

Before delving deeper into the case, I would like to ask a few clarifying questions. Is that fine?

Sure, go ahead!

Does the client operate only in India & are there any other operations run by the client ?

So, the client is Major cab aggregator service provider in Indian & global markets. You can take a Proxy as Uber.

Also, do we have any competition in air-cab service or any other competitor also planning to start similar service?

As of now, there is no direct competition in the air cab service segment as no such service is available anywhere else in world. Also, we don't know of any other player who is planning to start similar service.

Thank you sir! Do we have any information regarding the Customer segments we are planning to target with this new service & is this launch in India the first one for us?

So we are planning to target ride passengers only. No cargo/freight service. Yes, this is the first such launch for us & its going to be a pilot launch.

Also, has the launch decision be made already or we have to look into that also?

Good question! The launch decision is already made. Only the pricing is to be done & we want your help in that. Objective is finding the right audience & penetrating effectively. Break even is not a target

Sure sir, thank you! Just provide me a couple of minutes to gather my thoughts and analyse the problem.

Sure!

Sir, there can be 3 ways to do it: Competitive pricing, cost-plus pricing & value-based pricing. Since there is no competitor in this segment & cost is not a concern for the company right now, I think we can't apply competitive & cost-plus models here. Therefore, I am thinking of looking into value-based pricing as to know how much value is this service adding for a customer. Is that fine?

Sure, Go ahead!

We can look into 4 factors: Routes, feasibility/capability, Convenience/experience & Benchmarking. Regarding routes, I am thinking of Inter-city routes rather than Intra. In that also, we shall focus on Metro-Tier 1 or 2 cities as prospective routes. Major flight routes won't be preferred by customers. New routes would do much better we can take an example of Delhi-Indore

Fine, Go ahead!

Regarding feasibility, various remote routes shall be avoided since currently they won't have helipad facility for landing. Regarding convenience & experience, there will be lesser security (than airports), no baggage allowed, no in-flight meals, allowance of upto 4 passengers only, quicker speed than train but lower than flight, loud chopper noise & relatively less safety too than the flights. Benchmarking can be done based on target audience. For the middle class, train, car & ships & for businesses, flights & private jets.

That is quite insightful. So, what do you think finally about route, target audience & pricing?

For routes, we shall focus on Inter-city & Metro-to-Tier 1 which are not major flight routes. We can target both middle class & corporates. For middle class we can price lesser to give them affordable flying experience & for corporates, we focus on convenience. Pricing shall be higher than trains but lower than flights.

That looks great to me. Can you summarise your final recommendations?

Sure, we shall launch service on inter-city routes for middle class & corporates. Price be lesser than flights to attract middle class. We shall also launch for the routes that are not serviced by flights at all.

Good job! Hope to see you in the next round.

Ride hailing Helicopter Cab Service

A ride hailing service wants to start a helicopter based cab service in Indian market. You are required to price this service for them.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company** - Major cab aggregator service provider in Indian & global markets. Proxy-Uber
- **Customers** - Ride Passengers only. No cargo/freight service. Only for Indian market (Pilot Launch)
- **Competition** - No direct competitor in air-cab service. No such service available anywhere in the world
- **Objective** - Finding the right audience & penetrating effectively. Break even not a target.
- **Pricing Decisions** - Launch decision made. Only Pricing to be done

Approach

Pricing

- **Competitive**
- **Cost Plus**
- **Value Based**

Factors

Geographies/Routes

- Inter v/s Intra city routes
- Major cities to TI or TII cities

Feasibility/Capability

- Helipads are currently available only in airports.
- Remote routes incapable of service by aero-plane possible provided landing space is available

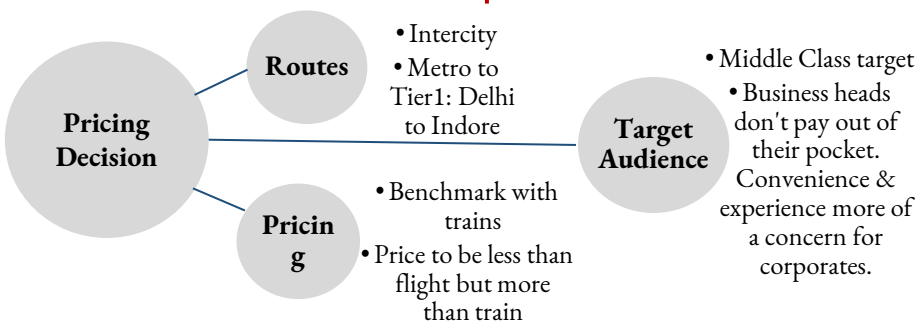
Convenience & Experience

- Relatively less security checks
- No baggage allowed
- No in-flight meal
- Loud chopper noise
- Only 4 passengers allowed
- Faster than trains but slower than aeroplane.
- Less safe than aero-plane.

Benchmarking

Benchmarking can be done on basis of target audience:

- Middle Class
  - Train
  - Car
  - Ship
- Businesses/Corporates
  - Flights
  - Private Jets



Routes

- Major flight routes would not be preferred by customers.
- New routes would be more popular

Target Audience

- Flying experience can be made affordable for middle class
- Business heads would shell out for convenience & speed

Pricing

- Delhi to Indore: Train: INR 1000/- , Aero-plane: INR 4500/, **Heli-cab ~ INR 3000/-**

Recommendations

- Start service on inter city routes for middle class & corporates.
- Pricing less than flights to attract middle class population.
- Launch for routes that are not serviced by aeroplanes as well.

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MBBK Consultants

A group of MBBK consultants is planning to launch a consulting preparation course at a top-tier B-school & has hired you to price the course monthly.

Alright, so I'll just start by clarifying a few aspects and the objective, and then we could go into how we can arrive at the right price point. Is that fine?

Yes, that sounds good

First, I'd like to understand the total duration of the course.

It will run for a period of approximately three months.

Okay, noted. For context, can I assume we are referring to a top-tier B-school such as FMS? Also in terms of frequency, how many sessions will be conducted each week?

Yes you can consider FMS for this case. There will be two sessions per week over the weekends.

That would translate into around eight sessions in a month, which totals to roughly 24 sessions across the entire course duration of three months. Are we targeting a particular profit margin from this offering? .

Yes, we are looking at a profit margin of around 20%.

Great, that's helpful. Lastly, how many consultants will be coming in to deliver the course and where would they come to deliver the course?

There will be two consultants involved who would be travelling from Mumbai.

Alright. When we talk about pricing strategy, we can come up with three kinds of methods to arrive at a fair price. They are Cost Based, Competitor Based, and Value Based Pricing. However, since this course is a niche and relatively new offering with no direct competitors currently offering something similar, I believe it would be more practical to proceed by exploring cost-based pricing and value-based pricing only.

Sounds good. Please walk me through both..

Alright, to begin with cost-based pricing, I'd like to identify the major cost components associated with delivering this course. Since the consultants are traveling from Mumbai to Delhi every week, we can consider the following key costs: accommodation, travel, food and opportunity cost.

Okay, so ignore the food cost and walk me through the rest of the costs.

First, regarding accommodation, since the consultants will be staying in Delhi for two nights each week, we are looking at two rooms booked per week, over a period of four weeks in a month. Assuming a reasonable rate of ₹4,000 per room per night in a business hotel, the monthly accommodation cost would be ₹32,000 per consultant.

Next, for travel, each consultant will need to fly between Mumbai and Delhi once a week. Considering one round trip per week and an average one-way airfare of ₹5,000, the cost per round trip would be ₹10,000 per consultant. For four weeks in a month, each consultant would incur ₹40,000 in travel expenses.

Okay, this seems fair. Could you also brief me on the opportunity cost?

Yes, sure. Now coming to opportunity cost, we know that MBBK consultants often work weekends and By committing their weekends to deliver this course, they potentially forgo some part of their earnings. Assuming that each consultant earns a monthly salary of around ₹2.5 lakhs, the opportunity cost per consultant for 4 weekends would be about 70000.
This brings our total cost to= (32000+40000+70000)*2= 2,84,000 approximately 3,00,000.
Adding a margin of 20% it brings the cost to 3,60,000 for a month.

That seems like a fair number, now could you give me the cost per student.

Yes, for sure, Now let's look at the potential student base for the course. At FMS, a typical batch consists of approximately 300 students. Out of these, it's fair to assume that around 70% of the students would be interested in consulting roles, let's say 90% are willing to take up this structured course and about 70% of them will be able to afford and enroll in the course, bringing the total number of likely enrolled students to roughly 130.

Hence the per student cost would be = 360000/130=2769.231 about 2800 monthly

That sounds good. Could you also give me a price based on the value-based approach?

Yes, for sure. The goal here is to link the price to the potential economic value that students derive from the course, in this case, an improvement in their internship outcomes.
Let's assume that an average summer internship stipend at a top-tier B-school is around ₹3 lakhs. However, if a student secures an internship at an MBBK firm, that stipend typically goes up to around ₹4 lakhs. This creates a differential or value gain of ₹1 lakh per student.

MBBK Consultants

A group of MBBK consultants is planning to launch a consulting preparation course at a top-tier B-school & has hired you to price the course monthly.

Okay move ahead.

About 30 students from a batch of 300 are able to secure offers from MBBK firms. We are assuming that with the structured and intensive training provided by this course, the number of students placed in MBBK could increase to around 40. That's an additional 10 students securing MBBK offers.

This improvement results in a total value creation of ₹10 lakhs across the batch. If we spread this value over the 130 students who would take the course, the per-head value created is around ₹7,700 to ₹8,000. So based on this approach, the course could justifiably be priced at ₹8,000 per student for the entire duration, which breaks down to ₹2,666 that is approximately ₹2700 per person.

That sounds like a well-reasoned and balanced pricing recommendation. Thank you.

Thank you so much.

MBBK Consultants

A group of MBBK consultants is planning to launch a consulting preparation course at a top-tier B-school & has hired you to price the course monthly.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Duration of course:** 3 months
- **B- School :** FMS
- **No of sessions:** 2 session every week (Saturday & Sunday), 8 sessions a month.
- **Profit margin**: 20% over cost
- **No of Consultants:** 2
- **Consultants travelling from:** Mumbai

No of students who will take the course:

- Batch strength = 300
- % of people interested in consulting= 70%
- % of students willing to take the course = 90%
- % of students able to take the course= 70%

Total enrollment= 300*0.70*0.90*0.70= 130

Approach

Pricing

- **Competitive**
- **Cost Plus**
  - **Accommodation**
    - Average cost of room= Rs. 4000
    - Cost per weekend (1 room) 4000*2= Rs.8000
    - Total cost (2 rooms) monthly= 8000*4*2= Rs.64000
  - **Travel**
    - Average cost of a round trip (Delhi- Mumbai)= Rs 10,000
    - No of round trips in a month = 4
    - Total cost (2 consultants) 10,000*4*2= Rs. 80,000
  - **Opportunity cost**
    - Average monthly salary of a MBBK Consultant= Rs. 2.5 lakhs
    - Salary for 4 weekends = (approx.) Rs. 70,000
    - Salary (2 consultants)= Rs. 1,40,000
- **Value Based**
  - **Perceived value to be evaluated**
    - Average internship stipend of B-school intern = Rs. 3,00,000
    - Average internship stipend of an MBBK intern= Rs. 4,00,000
    - Average no of students placed in MBBK before course = 30
    - Average no of students placed in MBBK after course = 40
    - Additional value generated = 1,00,000*10= Rs. 10,00,000
    - Price per student (3 months) = Additional value generated/ No of students ≈ 7800
    - Monthly cost per student = 7800/3 = Rs. 2,600

- Total cost = 64,000 +80,000 + 1,40,000 = Rs. 2,84,000 approx. Rs. 3,00,000
- Margin = 0.20*3,00,000= Rs. 60,000
- Price per student= Total cost/ No of students ≈ Rs. 2800

Recommendation

Monthly price of the course = Rs. 2,800

Unconventional

Case Index | Main Index

Logistics Efficiency

Your client is the ministry of road, transport & highways. They want to improve the logistics efficiency of the country. Give recommendations

Sir, just to be on the same page, ministry wants us to come up with ways to improve logistics efficiency. And what actually does client mean by logistics efficiency?

Yes and logistics efficiency, it means time taken to transport goods from A -> B

Is it fair to assume that ministry is considered only about road transportation and not other modes? Also, we are focussed on PAN India road or international routes too

Yes, the ministry is considered only about roadways PAN India and not international routes

Are there any operational or financial constraints that I should keep in mind?

There is no financial or operational constraints for the client

Thank you sir! Any timeline we are looking at to increase efficiency?

The project needs to completed as early as possible

Thank you sir! There are five external factors I can think of which impacts the efficiency namely road capacity, road quality, stoppage time, total average distance and transit permits. Other factors are vehicle & driving expertise but they lie within the purview of the companies.

That correct. Let's explore each of these and what ministry could to increase efficiency

Sure Sir. To increase road capacity client can increase number of lanes, develop alternate routes for busy routes, dedicate lanes for different vehicles, restrict truck/car width according to road dimension to fit maximum vehicle, and develop freight Corridors

Sounds good to me. What about road quality?

To improve road quality, client can ensure better quality of material is used, quick repair of potholes, preventive maintenance of the roads, conduct Audits and regular reporting of conditions, and perform timely/deadline-based repairs

What are your thoughts on stoppage time?

Sir, I believe stoppage time will depend on factors such as number of red lights, traffic jams, tool booth & government checkpoints.

That's correct. What steps do you think the client can take to reduce time at toll booth?

The average time by a vehicle spent on toll booths during its journey will depend on total number of toll booths it came across, wating time & processing time. To reduce the number of tool booths, we can optimize the toll network. To reduce the waiting time, we can increase the number of lanes. To reduce the processing time, the ministry can launch RFID tags, designate specific lanes based on kind of vehicle & hire mobile toll collection personnel.

All these sounds good to me. The client can surely look into these. What about the total average distance and transit permits?

To reduce the total average distance, we can the come up with a plan to optimize the road network and increase the total road length to connect more places via it. Though this would take considerable investment, effort and time. For transit permit, the we can create a centralised system & reduce the number of permits required. Also, if there is scope of reducing the time required to procure them, we should definitely come up with process to make it quicker. Lastly, if there are cross border check points, the ministry with support of central and state government can explore the option of removing them or at least make the process less time consuming

The ministry will excited to explore all the options in order to increase efficiency.

Sure sir. Would you like me to explore anything else?

That won't be required. We can close the case here. Have a good day!

Logistics Efficiency

Your client is the ministry of road, transport & highways. They want to improve the logistics efficiency of the country. Give recommendations.

Case Facts & Notes

Logistics Efficiency

Logistics efficiency = Time Taken to transport goods from A -> B

Key Medium

Roads are the primary medium

Geography

PAN India Implementation (not international routes)

Constraints

Financials – None
Operational - None

Objective

Initiative internally driven, to be completed at the earliest

Approach

Time

Road Capacity

- Increase number of lanes
- Develop alternate routes for busy routes
- Dedicate lanes for different vehicles
- Restrict truck/car width according to road dimension to fit maximum vehicle
- Freight Corridors

Road Quality

- Increase in quality of material used
- Reduction in number of potholes
- Preventive Maintenance of Roads
- Audits and regular reporting of conditions
- Timely/Deadline based repairs

Stoppage Time

- Red lights & traffic jams : More traffic policemen to control traffic
- Toll booth
- Government Check Points

Total Average Distance

- Optimization of road network
- Increasing average distance covered

Transit Permits

- Reduction in number of permits required
- Reduction in time taken to get permits
- Are there cross border checkpoints? If yes, can they be removed/checking time reduced

Time at toll booth

Number of toll booths

- Optimization of toll booth network

Number of lanes

- Increase in number of lanes at each toll booth

Processing/ Toll Collection Time

- RFID Tags/Fast Tag to decrease time spent per vehicle
- Separate lanes as per different types of vehicles
- Mobile toll collection personnel

Chatbot Development

Your client is an e-commerce website, like Myntra, and is planning on launching a chatbot, how will you go about it?

I would like to clarify a few things before I start analyzing the case.

Sure.

Have we decided on the development of the chatbot or do I also need to look at the feasibility of the chatbot, should we go ahead with that or not? Also, what is the timeline for the same?

So we have decided that chatbot has to be developed, you should focus more on the development aspect of the same. We want to launch the chatbot as soon as possible.

Got it. Could you help me with the objective behind the development of the chatbot? Are there any specific features that should be there in the chatbot?

Objective here is to help customer with in their shopping experience like a sales manager at a store. I would leave the features to be added to you.

Sure, I would like to look at 3 major buckets to develop & launch the chatbot: development, testing, launch & communication.

Alright, go ahead.

Within development bucket we can look first look at pain points followed by features and resources needed.

Alright

Pain point will include: 1) Don't know what product/size suits them well 2) Can't find what they are looking for 3) Confused about product return & refund policies
Do you think this is exhaustive?

This is fine.

The chatbot would be an AI powered bot which understands logic and sentiments of a customer which can have features like: 1) People can upload links/photos of similar products they want to buy 2) It will give customers personalized recommendations based on their past shopping behavior for alternative and complementing products 3) It will be also able to suggest products for certain occasions and situations 4) For male customers it will give direct to the point answers and for female customers it will give them complements and suggest more things that might suit them

Looks good.

In terms of resources we need a dedicated team, an AI solution provider like openAI/Meta and data to train the bot on.

Makes sense.

For testing stage we will have first the internal testing for bugs, AI hallucination, cyber security threats. Once this is done we can have testing with limited customers for their feedback and AI training

Good.

For Launch and communication phase, we should launch this chatbot on both website and app before a peak season like festivals or national holidays to make sure we will have time to resolve issues.
For communication, we can look at promotion to existing customers which would include pop-ups on website, app notifications, email campaigns and ads on delivery packets. For new customers we should do targeted ads on social media platforms with use cases of AI chatbot including Instagram reels and YouTube shorts.

Looks good, we can end the case here

Chatbot Development

Your client is an e-commerce website, like Myntra, and is planning on launching a chatbot, how will you go about it?

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company** - It is an e-commerce website like Myntra
- **Products** – Apparel & footwear, accessories, personal care, home & living
- **Customers** – 18+ years old
- **Objective** – To assist a customer like a sales person

Approach

Chatbot

Development → **Testing** → **Launch & Communication**

Development

Pain Points

- Don't know what product/size suits them well
- Can't find what they are looking for
- Confused about product return & refund policies

Resource Allocation

- Dedicated team
- AI Solution Providers
- Data Preparation

Features

- **AI Powered**
- **Upload pictures/links**
- **Demographics based recommendations**
- **Behavior based recommendations**

Testing

- Need to perform testing by internal teams for bugs, AI hallucination, cyber security threats
- Need to perform testing with limited customers for their feedback and AI training

Launch & Communication

Platforms

- On both app and website
- Avoid launching just before festive season or national holidays

Promotion

Existing Customers

- App notifications
- Email campaigns
- Pop-ups on website
- Ads on delivery packets

New Customers

- Targeted ads on social media with multiple use-cases including Instagram reels and YouTube shorts

Land Utilization

Your client has acquired a plot of land equivalent in size to the FMS campus. What would you recommend they do with it?

So, our client has bought a land equal to the size of FMS campus, and I need to suggest what they can do with it.

Yes, absolutely right. Go ahead!

Before delving deeper into the Case, I would like to ask a few clarifying questions. Is that fine?

Sure, go ahead!

Who is the client in this case? Do they have specific goals for the property — for example, are they aiming to generate profits or pursuing any other particular objective?

The client is a prominent industrialist based out of India, looking to maximize profits from the land, with no constraints on capital investment.

Ok where is the land located? And what are the existing zoning laws and permitted land uses?

Great question, the land is located within the North Campus region, approximately 4–5 km from FMS. This area comprises Institutional, Residential, and Public/Semi-Public (PSP) zones.

Are they also open to collaborating with institutions like Delhi University for potential land use or development?

Yes, they are open to collaborate with government and private institutions.

Alright, I feel I have enough information about the problem. I would like to start solving the case.

Sure, go ahead.

Since the client's primary objective is profit, they can explore two main options: sale: which could be an outright sale or a partial sale through a joint venture and keeping ownership, where they independently own the land. Would you like to explore one of these options or consider both?

Let's focus on the second option, where the client owns the land and maximizes returns.

Do we have any clarity on whether the client is interested in leasing the land to generate steady income or prefers to develop it on their own for potentially higher returns?

The client intends to develop the land independently, aiming to retain full control and maximize profit from the project.

Great! The client now has two key options: either construct residential or commercial buildings.

Let's look at both residential and commercial options

On the residential side, the client can develop apartments, hostels, or PG accommodations to serve students living in the area, and even collaborate with the government to provide faculty housing. On the commercial side, they can build a mixed-use complex with retail stores, cafés, stationery shops, salons, and similar amenities to meet local demand. Additionally, given the nearby government offices, setting up hotels presents a strong opportunity. The client could also explore partnerships with the government to establish learning academies.

That is quite insightful.

While the client's main goal is profit, alternative options can offer long-term value or social impact. These include setting up educational or healthcare institutions, public amenities like parks or libraries, and community-oriented spaces. Innovation hubs or startup incubators could also foster goodwill and future opportunities. Such initiatives may not yield immediate returns but can enhance land value and reputation over time.

Yes, these recommendations sound good.

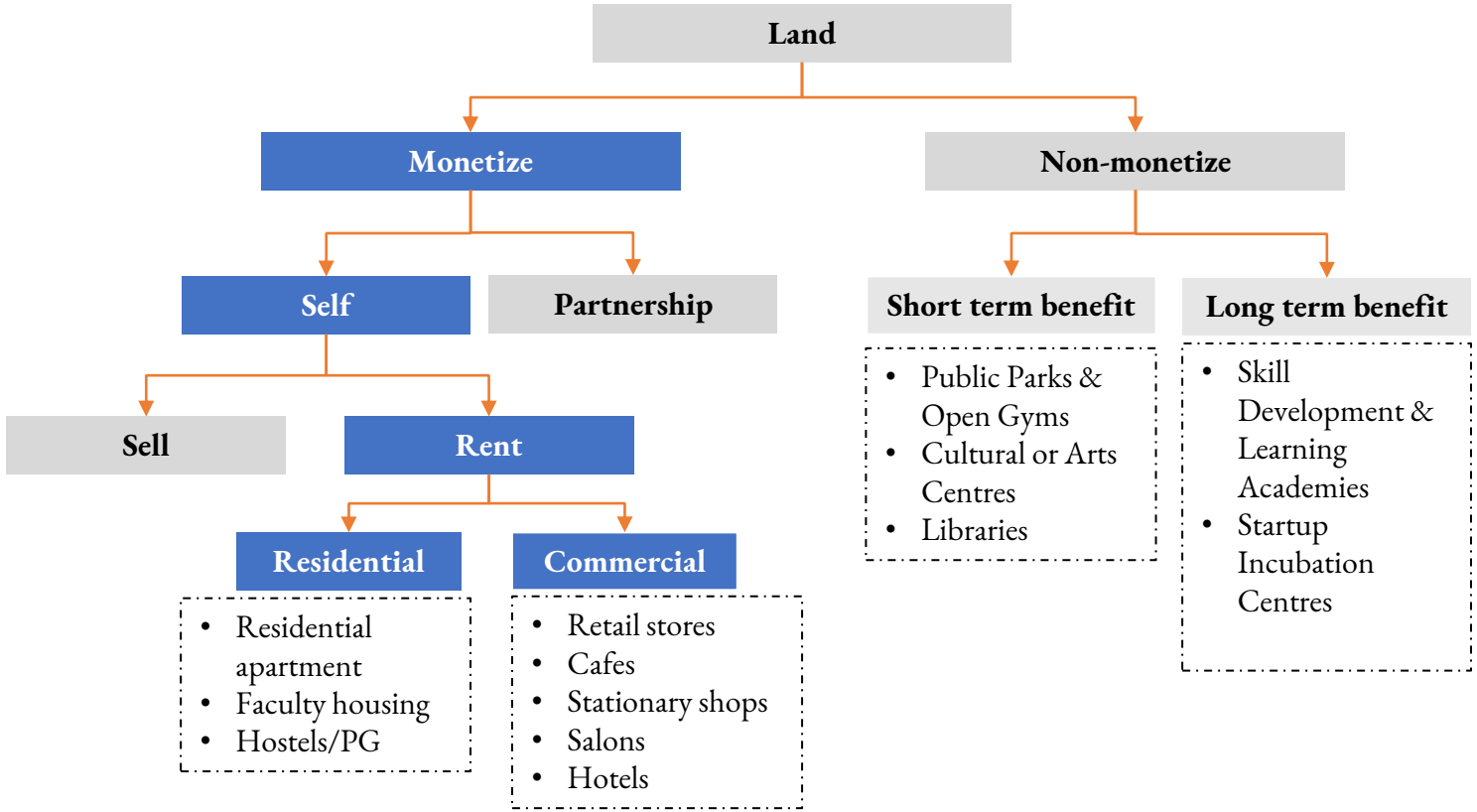
Land Utilization

Your client has acquired a plot of land equivalent in size to the FMS campus. What would you recommend they do with it?

Case Facts & Notes

- **Context** – land available in north campus region.
- **Objective** – Maximize profit
- **Zonal laws /Regulation** – Institutional, Residential, and Public/Semi-Public (PSP) zones

Approach



Recommendation

We recommend adopting a rental-based hybrid monetization strategy i.e. leasing portions of the land for commercial (cafes, shops) and residential (hostels, housing) use that are aligned with zoning regulations. This ensures long-term recurring income while retaining ownership and capitalizing on future land appreciation.

IT development

Your client is a home decor company aiming to enhance its business through digital transformation. How should they go about it.

So, the client is a home décor brand planning a digital transformation initiative, and I'm expected to suggest what they should do.

Yes, that's correct. Go ahead.

Before jumping in, I'd like to ask a few clarifying questions to understand their context better. Is that alright?

Sure, go ahead.

Thank you. Could you tell me more about the client's current setup? Are they primarily offline, or do they have an existing digital presence?

The client is a mid-sized home décor company that currently operates only through offline channels in India. They are keen to explore new opportunities and are open to experimenting with digital solutions to expand their business and stay competitive.

Also, what is the key goal — is it increasing sales, expanding reach, or improving customer experience?

Their main objective is to rapidly expand their customer reach by leveraging digital platforms. They are looking to tap into a broader audience without being limited by their current offline presence. At the same time, they want to maintain control over their pricing and profitability.

I believe I have sufficient information to proceed with the case. To ensure a structured and comprehensive approach, I'd like to analyze the situation through three key lenses: the business model, the operating model, and the execution process. This will help us identify where digital transformation can create the most impact. Would you like me to focus on any particular area, or would you prefer a holistic overview to start with?

Could you briefly walk me through all three areas?

The business model explains how a company creates, delivers, and captures value through elements like customer segments, value proposition, and revenue streams. The operating model focuses on how the company functions internally—its processes, people, technology, and resources. The execution process involves the practical steps to implement changes, including planning, timelines, and monitoring to ensure successful outcomes.

Yes, let's just focus on the business model.

I plan to assess whether digital transformation would require changes across the core components of the business model—such as customer segments, value proposition, revenue streams, cost structure, channels, customer relationships, key activities, key resources, and key partnerships. Would you like me to focus on any particular area?

Can you briefly explain each component of business model?

The business model outlines how a company creates, delivers, and captures value. It includes Customer Segments (target audiences) and the Value Proposition (the unique value offered). Channels refer to how products or services reach customers, while Customer Relationships define how the business engages with them. Revenue Streams and Cost Structure explain how the company earns and spends money. Supporting this are Key Activities, Key Resources, and Key Partnerships that enable the business to function effectively.

Great, I'd like you to focus on driving transformation through the company's channels.

The client can choose between direct channels like their own website or app, or indirect channels such as third-party marketplaces. Are they open to using external platforms to expand quickly, or do they prefer to build and rely solely on their own digital infrastructure?

Alright, they are keen on building their own direct channels.

Okay, there are two ways the client can build direct digital channels—through a mobile app and a website. The mobile app offers a personalized and convenient shopping experience, ideal for repeat customers and push-based engagement. The website, on the other hand, serves as a broader platform for product discovery, content, and attracting first-time visitors. Together, both can help the client expand their reach while maintaining full control over branding and margins. Since this is their first digital initiative, it would be advisable to start with the website.

Yes, let's proceed with the website. Could you walk me through what the process would look like?

Sure. We'd start with a clear strategy and roadmap, move into platform development, followed by thorough testing. Then comes focused marketing, a phased launch rollout, and finally, growth driven by user feedback and data insights.

Thankyou!, we can end the case here.

IT development

Your client is a home decor company aiming to enhance its business through digital transformation. How should they go about it.

Case Facts & Notes

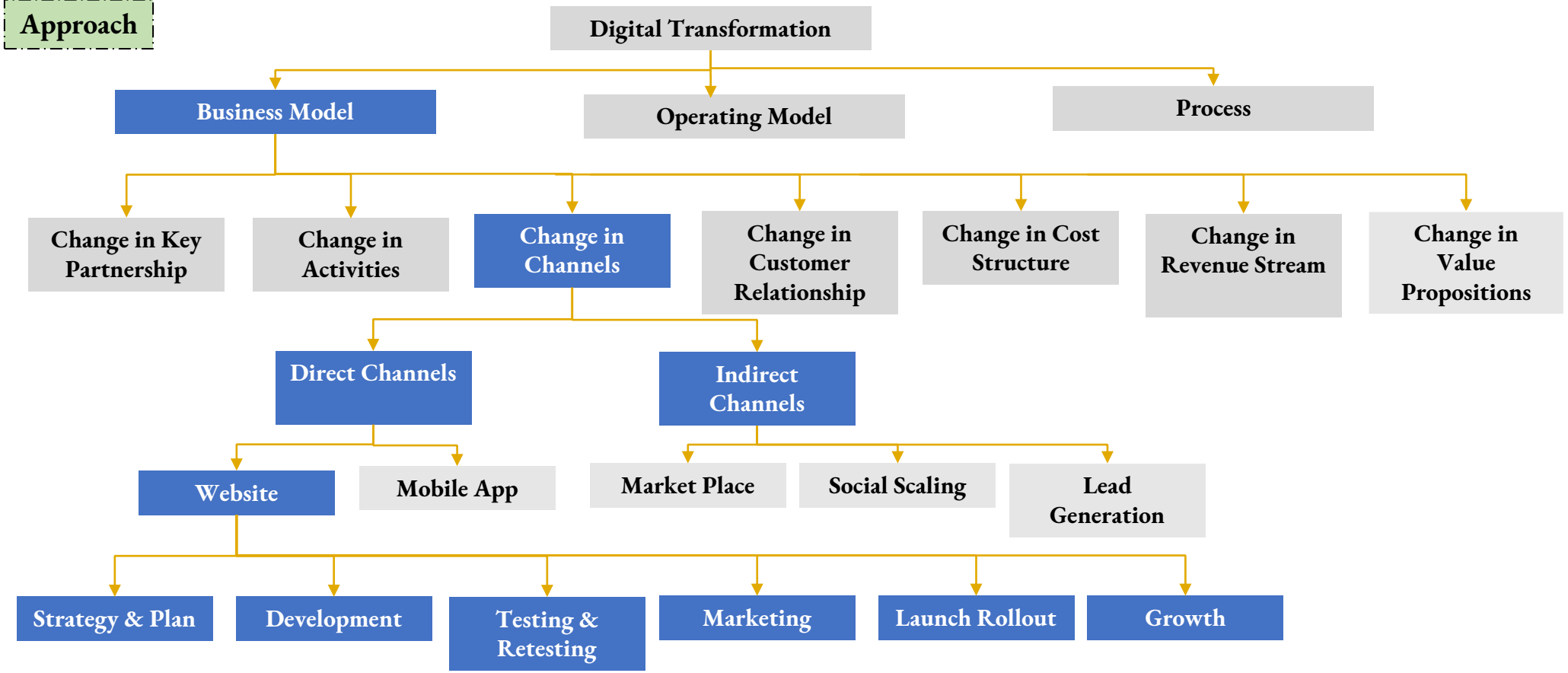
Context

- The client is a mid-sized home décor company.
- They are planning a digital transformation initiative.
- Currently operate only through offline channels in India.

Goal

- Expand rapidly and enhance customer reach by leveraging digital platforms.

Approach



Manufacturing Efficiency

A mining player in South Africa has seen a decrease in manufacturing efficiency for an intermediate product in raw materials

Before we begin, I'd like to first confirm my understanding. Our client is a mining player in South Africa and they have seen a decline in manufacturing efficiency for an intermediate product.

Yes, that's right.

I'd like to know more about the client and their operations. Do they currently only operate in South Africa? As per my understanding, the industry would be supplying to businesses so the we'd be involved in only B2B sales, is that correct?

Yes, our client is only involved in B2B operations solely in South Africa.

I'd like to further understand the manufacturing operations of our client. I am not very well-versed with the manufacturing process of the industry, but I'd like to outlay my understanding of the value chain. First there would be mining for the raw material, then manufacturing of an intermediate product, then distribution and sales. Could you aid me in understanding if I'm missing something?

As you mentioned, raw material such as limestone is mined. This limestone is then crushed and blended. This blended raw material is then heated in a kiln to produce a substance called clinker. This clinker is then mixed with additives to create cement. This cement is stored in bulk in silos before being packaged into bulk containers and then distributed. Cement is further mixed with aggregates such as water to produce concrete used in construction. Our client is involved in mining of limestone and manufacturing clinker.

Thank you, this is of great help! I'd also like to know how long have we been seeing this decline in efficiency? Is this problem being faced specifically by our client or the industry as well?

The client has been facing this issue for about 6 months now. The issue is only with our client.

Okay. According to my understanding, efficiency per person can be defined by the number of units produced per unit of time taken. So have we been facing an issue with either of these factors over the last 6 months? Have we seen a decline in the number of people who have been working with us?

This understanding seems fine. The client has been facing an issue in terms of more time being taken to produce the same unit of product. This means that what took previously 12 hours to produce X units of product is now taking 13 hours. There has been no change in our workforce number.

Okay, thank you. I think I have all the information I need. First I'd like to focus on evaluating each aspect of our client's value chain i.e. mining raw materials to manufacturing intermediate and final product and then distribution and sales. Does this approach seem okay to start with?

This is okay but I'd like you to only focus on the manufacturing part of the value chain

Sure, so under the manufacturing aspect of the value chain, I would look into 3 things: machinery, labour and the technology used. Is there anything specific I should explore out of these?

Let's look at just the labour aspect. How would you go about exploring it?

I'd like to look at the way the employee interacts with the client's workplace. That is, I'd like to walk through the customer journey. I'd like to divide looking at this into three parts, considering that they have a typical workday as any other employee in a company. First would be before lunch and the second during lunch and third after lunch.

That seems like a sound structure to follow. What would you explore in each of these 3 aspects?

Before lunch, the employee would log in/punch in to work. Then they would prepare to start working i.e. maybe write a to-do list. After that they would finish working the first half of the day and attend meetings. Second, a lunch break; either for eating, socializing. Now, after lunch break they would finish the rest of their work then maybe report their completed work. Then they would punch out of work. Is there anything else I should explore which I'm missing?

This is extremely thorough, thank you. We have identified that the issue is during lunch. There has been an overall increase of people spending lunch break from 1 to 2 to 1 to 2:40. What reasons can you identify could be the problem here?

Sure, either it would be an issue with the employee or with the Canteen/Mess.

The issue with the employee's time itself. The mess is the same as it was before.

For the employee's time, it would either be an internal or external issue. The employee would be napping, taking extended washroom breaks, spending too much time interacting with colleagues or getting involved in activities such as watching TV. It could also be an issue with the working conditions or there would be a protest/strike.

Okay. The employees seem to be taking more time sitting and watching TV. We have also installed Acs there making them spend more time. What would be your recommendations to rectify this?

Based on evaluation of increase in efficiency vs employee satisfaction; we can first implement an incentive-based approach wherein they are recognized for efficiency. Secondly, introduce a productivity challenge wherein they would get special prizes. Third, to provide flexible working hours. Would you want me to give more suggestions?

This should be sufficient. Thank you!

Manufacturing Efficiency

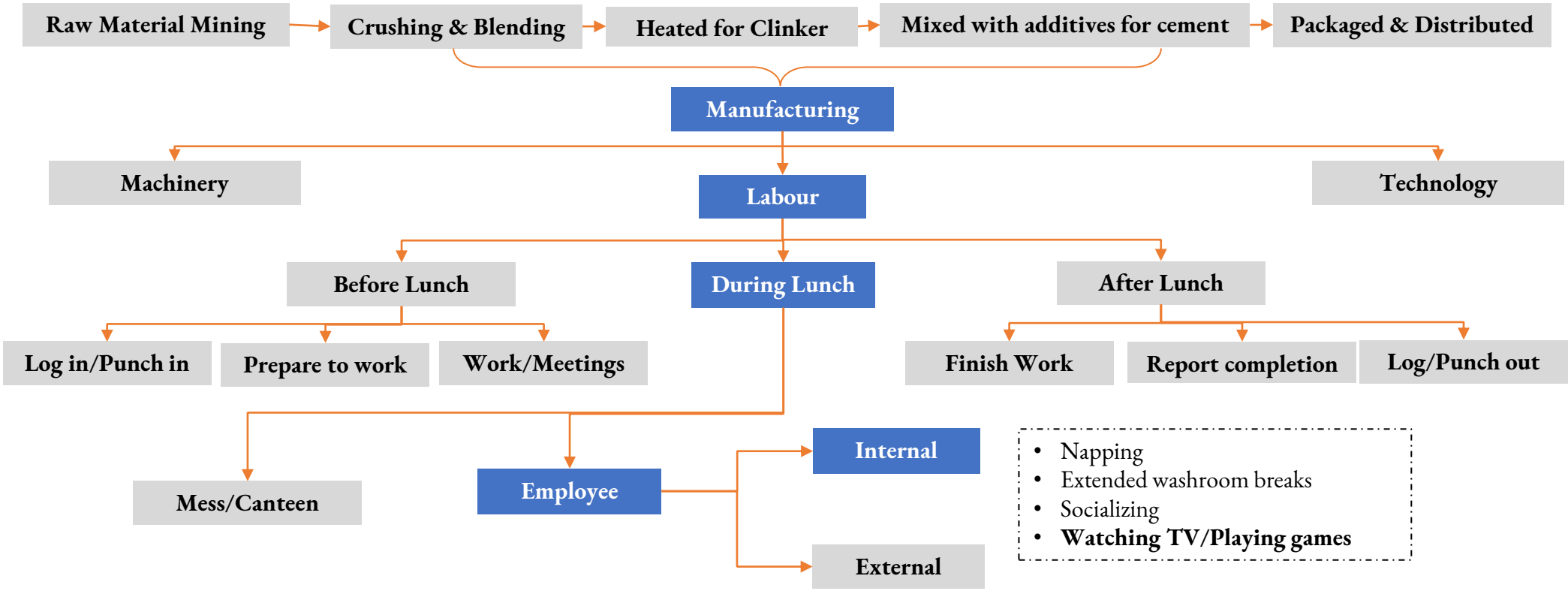
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A mining player in South Africa has seen a decrease in manufacturing efficiency for an intermediate product in raw materials

Case Facts & Notes

- **Duration** – Last 6 months
- **Operations** - B2B sales
- **Geography** – Solely in south Africa
- **Company vs. Industry** – only an issue with company
- **Efficiency** = Number of units produced / Time taken
- More time taken to produce same units
- **Value Chain** – Focused on manufacturing only

Approach



Recommendations

- Map out the significance of each initiative through an efficiency vs satisfaction matrix
- Incentive-based, motivational and positive approaches to increase morale and efficiency

Initiative	Efficiency Increase	Employee Satisfaction
Recognition programs	Moderate	High
Productivity challenge	High	High
Flexible working hours	Moderate	High

Time Management

Your client is a student at FMS, Delhi and they want to know how can they best utilize their time at the institute.

Thank you for the statement! Just to clarify again, our client is a student at a B-School and they wish to know how best they can utilize their time at the institute.

Yes, that's correct, please proceed.

I would like to clarify what does "best" mean in this scenario? And if we know which B-School they have joined?

"Best" in this statement refers to our client's pursuit of their short-term and long-term goals in the most efficient way possible. The B-School they have joined is FMS, Delhi.

I would also like to know more about the student; are they a new student at the institute? As per my understanding, a B-School has multiple programs such as Full-Time, Executive. So are they pursuing any of these?

The student has recently joined in the new batch and they are pursuing the Full-Time program.

I would also like to know what the profile of the student is so that I can get an idea of what their possible goals are? By profile, I mean a brief about their background, age, education.

The student is an undergraduate in mechanical engineering. They have work experience at a boutique consulting firm of about 3 years. They are currently aged 25 and are from a metropolitan city and belong to a well-educated family. They have also been an avid sportsperson all their life.

Now that I have a fair view about the student, I would solve the student's problem from two aspects. First, what are the student's short-term and long-term goals? Second, what can the B-School can offer to them?

Sure, go ahead.

In both the short-term and the long-term goals, I'd like to look at the various personal and professional goals that the student can pursue.

All right, that sounds good.

For the personal goals, we can divide it into three major segments; family, education and health.
In family goals, they might want to start a family in 3-5 years, own a house and a car.
In educational goals, they might want to be awarded with the merit list.
In health goals, they might want to follow a healthy lifestyle, be fit and active.

All right. Do you want to explore the professional goals?

Yes, in professional goals, we would again look at three segments i.e. financial, career progression and professional interest. In financial goals, they might want a starting package of a certain amount which would be ideal for them. In career progression, they might want a steep learning curve, fast-track growth and a lucrative position in the company in the future (Ex: CEO). In professional interests, they might want to excel in a particular domain (Ex: Consulting, Marketing) or a particular industry (Ex: FMCG, IT).

That sounds very thorough. Would you want to explore anything else as well?

Yes, so now that we've looked at the short-term and long-term goals, I would now like to look at what the institute can offer to them.

What all will you covering in this aspect? Let's dive into this.

According to my understanding, what B-Schools offer can be divided into four major categories:
1. Academic 2. Placements 3. Extra-curricular 4. Networking & socializing.

All right. Let's look at each of these now.

Okay. In the academic aspect, we can look into three factors: first is grades, where a student can achieve a good performance via high grades (Ex: CGPA). Second being faculty relations, wherein they can build rapport with the faculty, publish papers with them. Third being subjects where the students can choose the electives they want to major and/or minor in
For the Placements aspect, we can look at 2 angles: first, being summer and final placements, in which we can analyse companies that come to campus and the ones the student is interested in. The second would be case competitions and live projects that the student would participate in.

Okay, this sounds like a good plan. Let's talk about Extra-curriculars and Networking briefly.

In extra-curriculars, we can look at the clubs and societies the student can be a part of as well as sports and fitness facilities available. We can also look at international summer schools.
In Networking, we can look at interactions with peers (flats, classes, events), faculty (informal and formal connects) and companies (guest lectures, case competitions, live projects)

This sounds great! Thank you.

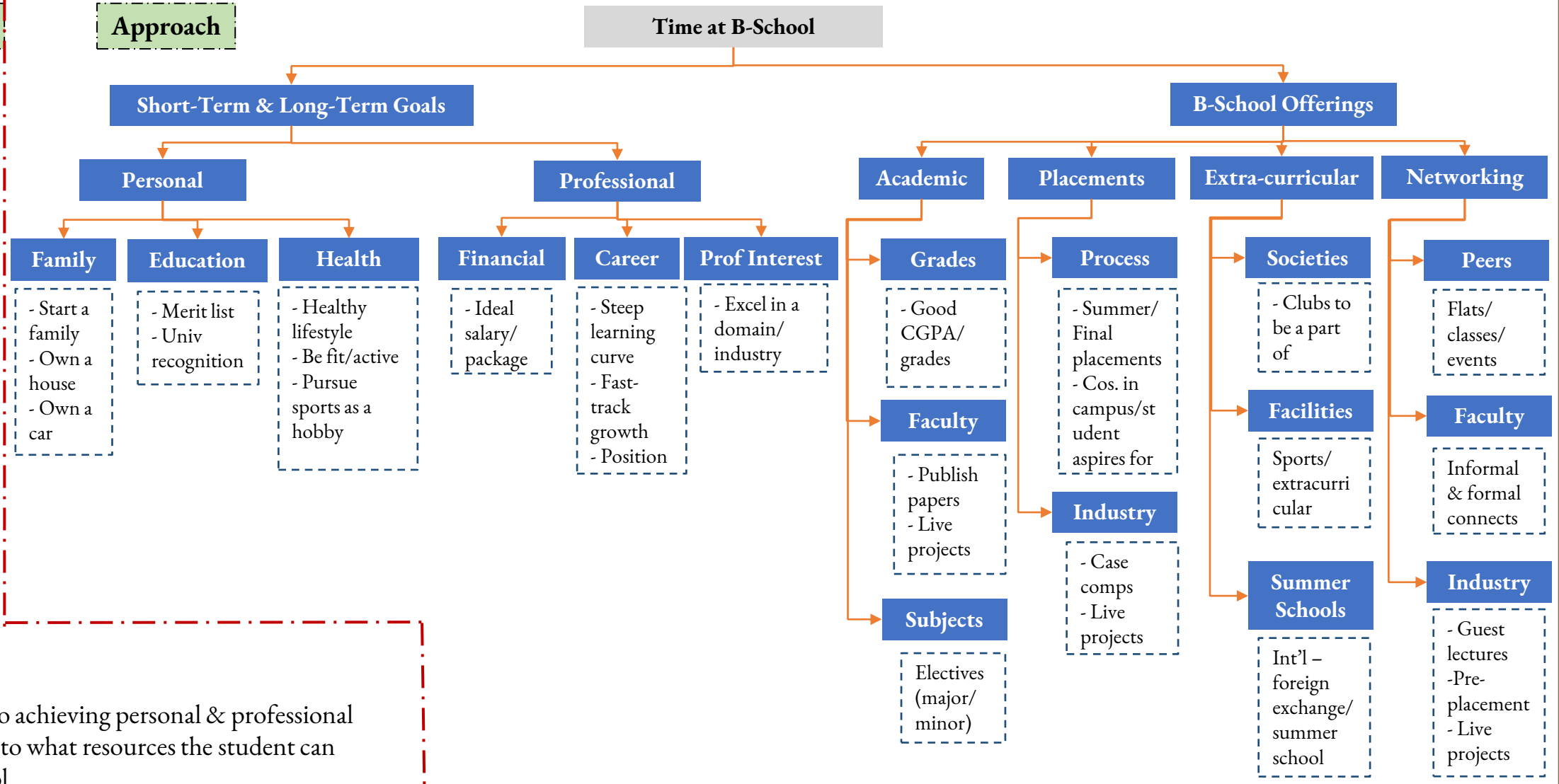
Time Management

Your client is a student at FMS, Delhi and they want to know how can they best utilize their time at the institute.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Context –** Student has joined FMS as a full-time student.
- The student is a mechanical engineer, aged 25, with 3 years of work experience in a boutique consulting firm with an interest in sports..
- **Break down the Problem Statement -** "Best" means that the student should fully utilize their resources

Approach



Recommendations

- Segment the time into achieving personal & professional goals and also look into what resources the student can utilise in the B-School

CO_2 Emissions

Your client is the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways. They wish to reduce CO_2 emissions of the road transportation sector. They have approached you for your help.

I'd like to re-iterate the statement; our client is the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways. They wish to reduce CO_2 emissions of the road transportation sector and they need our help.

That is correct. You can start.

I'd like to ask whether we want to reduce the emissions in a particular region or across India?

We'd like to reduce it pan-India.

All right. I also want to know if there is a drastic increase in emissions? Or are we just planning to reduce the existing level?

Good question. So, right now we're just focusing on reducing the current level. There's been no drastic increase as such.

Are we focusing on reducing the current emissions by a certain level i.e. a certain %?

No, we do not have a particular target in mind.

Sure. So as per my understanding, there could be multiple sources of CO_2 emissions; majorly from vehicles, both passenger and commercial, along with construction activities as well. Are we focusing on anything particular?

We are focusing primarily on vehicular emissions. You've mentioned a good point about emissions from construction activities, can you think of any other sources?

Yes, I can also think of emissions through commercial offices and residential buildings as well. Along with that, manufacturing and industrial activities and from waste management activities.

Lets focus on vehicular emissions and construction activities since they are associated with our Ministry.

Sure. I have a few other follow-up questions as well before I dive into the problem. We mentioned construction as a possible source, so do we have any information regarding who we are involved with for construction activities?

Yes, so we operate through 3 contract financing options; EPC contract i.e. Engineering, Procurement and Construction contract, PPP contract i.e. public-private partnership contracts and third is through tolls.

Could I get a bit more understanding on what do EPC and PPP contract models involve?

EPC contracts are focused on construction phase including site preparation, roadbed construction, they may even involve private players for expertise. PPP contracts involve a more long-term partnership between both the public sector and private sector for development, operation and maintenance of road infrastructure.

This is helpful, thank you. Now, I'd like to look into the problem through two avenues; first through vehicular emissions and second through construction activities.
Focusing on vehicular emissions, we can think of emissions through passenger vehicles and freight vehicles. Under passenger, I'd want to focus on 4 major aspects; first being vehicular improvements, second being sustainable fuel choices & infrastructure, third being traffic management and fourth, policy support. Would you want me to dive into each of these?

Yes, let's go ahead with each briefly.

So under vehicular improvements, we can look at promotion and adoption of EVs or hybrid vehicles, enforce stringent standards for vehicle manufacturers to ensure use of better emission technologies and encourage research and development of innovative vehicle technologies.
Under fuel choices and infrastructure, we can promote alternative fuels such as biofuels, CNG and hydrogen and also establish strict fuel quality standards for cleaner options, improve public infrastructure such as cycling, metro and install EV charging/hydrogen refueling options
Under traffic management, we can implement intelligent transportation systems for traffic optimization, promote and develop carpooling and invest in pedestrian-friendly infrastructure.
Lastly, under policy support, we can provide incentives and subsidies for low-emission vehicles, launch public awareness campaigns and implement emission & testing inspection programs.

Okay, this is great! Let's go forward to explore freight vehicles.

Sure, so we can have better fuel choices and vehicular technology, same as was discussed before. Specifically, for freight vehicles, we can look into 3 more additional aspects: first, fleet optimization which includes optimizing routes, reducing idling, low-resistance tires and supporting research. Second, sustainable practices such as improving intermodal transport, optimizing loading/unloading. Third, policy support, which includes emission reduction targets for freight transport and collaboration with private companies for establishing best practices

This is extremely thorough. Let's move on to construction. What all will you explore this?

I'd like to focus on the process of construction, specifically roads. First, we remove the vegetation to clear the path and level the ground, second we prepare the soil underneath the road by adding aggregates to make the surface stronger and compact. Third, we add a base such as crushed gravel, then fourth, we add in the asphalt for laying the road. Then, fifth, we smoothen the road and add markings. Is there any part of this process I should focus on for educing emissions?

CO2 Emissions

Your client is the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways. They wish to reduce CO2 emissions of the road transportation sector. They have approached you for your help.

Yes, let's focus on just the removing vegetation and laying road i.e. asphalt. How can we focus on making these processes better?

Okay. So, for removing vegetation, we can look at a few aspects to reduce emissions: one could be to reduce lesser vegetation, engage in sustainable clearing techniques such as mulching, prevent soil erosion, use eco-friendly equipment and engage in designing of roads with sustainability as a priority.
For road laying, we can use concrete as an alternate material, use recycled blocks and incentivize contractors for using better materials. We can also implement green roads and highways as a long-term strategy

Okay, this sounds good, let's wrap up the case here

Thank you

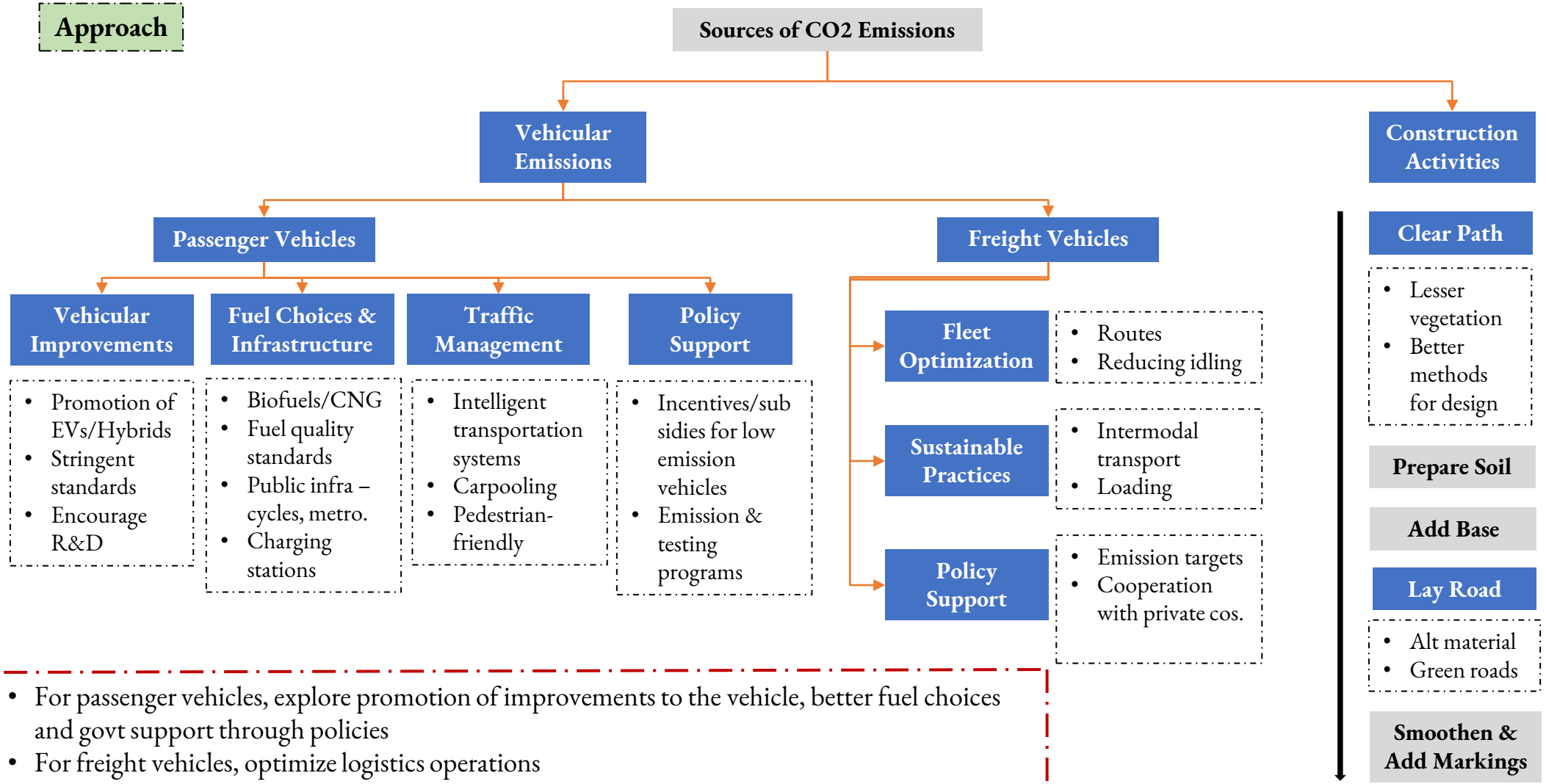
CO_2 Emissions

Your client is the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways. They wish to reduce CO_2 emissions of the road transportation sector. They have approached you for your help.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Location** - Pan-India
- **Objective** – Reduce current level
- **Sources of CO_2 emission** –
  - Vehicular
  - Construction
  - Buildings
  - Manufacturing
- **Contracting** – 3 options:
  - PPP
  - EPC
  - Tolls

Approach



Recommendations

- For passenger vehicles, explore promotion of improvements to the vehicle, better fuel choices and govt support through policies
- For freight vehicles, optimize logistics operations
- Improve the process of clearing vegetation and laying roads by better sustainable practices

Unborn Baby

Imagine you have an unborn baby as a client. Your task is to help this client decide whether to be born & brought up in the US or India.

This is an interesting scenario! I would like to clarify the problem statement: our client is an unborn baby and we want to help him/her decide the best location among US or India.

Yes, you are right. Please go ahead!

I would like to know more about the family of our client: The background of the family, their work location, and demographics like income status and ethnicity.

Both the parents are currently working from US, but the job requirement is remote & flexible. They can work from anywhere and they have NRI status. In terms of demographics, they belong to a middle-income segment & a Hindu family which is based out of India.

Got it! Could you also clarify if there are specific goals or priorities that the baby's family has which might influence this decision?

Let's assume the baby's family primarily values education opportunities, healthcare quality, and economic stability. They're also interested in cultural heritage and family connections as secondary factors.

Thank you! I will proceed with evaluating these parameters for both India and US, try to structure my approach using sub-parameters for exhaustive evaluation and then come-up with a decision. Does this sound fine?

Please go ahead, but I'm more interested in a quantitative approach. Can you think of one?

Sure! I2 will proceed with the sub-parameters approach within each parameter, and based on factual knowledge and my judgement of the quality of facilitates I'll rate both India and US on a common rating scale (1-5). Post that, we can take an average of all the sub-parameters.

Sounds fine! Let's do that.

Within healthcare facilities; I would be taking into account factors like Costs, Accessibility, Quality/ Innovation. For costs, a higher rating will mean affordable services; whereas for other factors, a higher rating will mean better services. In US, costs of healthcare and insurance services are higher whereas in India it would be generally affordable but varies greatly depending on type of hospital. I'm assuming- as the family belongs to middle-income segment, they can afford the healthcare costs in India(4) more so than in US(2). The Accessibility varies significantly by insurance coverage & geographical location, resulting in US(3)-India(2). Finally, talking about quality & innovation: Due to advanced medical technology & quality of medical care, US (5)-India(3).

Interesting, lets also go through other parameters once that we have in place.

The Education Quality can be broken down into 3 factors: Infrastructure, Curriculum and Higher Education Opportunities. For US (4), the infrastructure is well-equipped-both physical and digital-whereas in India (3), it is improving but still inconsistent. The Curriculum in US (4) is advanced and frequently updated whereas in India (3), it is being modernized, but often criticized for rote learning emphasis. Lastly, talking about higher education opportunities: US (5) is home to many of the world's top universities whereas in India (4); excellent institutions exist but are highly competitive and limited in number.

That's impressive!. Can you also go through economic stability, cultural heritage & family connections?

Absolutely! Within Economic Growth, we can consider only the factors that could directly impact the child throughout his development-which includes Employment, Inflation and Cost of Living. We can ignore macro factors like GDP growth rate, Income equality, etc. because these won't directly impact the child. Next, within Cultural heritage: let's consider Diversity of Cultures & Cultural Preservation as 2 factors that might enlighten the child. Lastly, within Family Connections: Proximity to Extended Family and Support from Entire Family.

Makes sense! Let's finish rating these, and then we can proceed with the approach for decision-making.

Sure! Keeping into mind current scenario and my subjective assessment- Within Economic Stability; Employment: US(4) and India(3), Inflation is prone to fluctuations especially in food price:- US(4) and India(3), Cost of living is higher in US(2) due to expensive services compared to India (4). Moving to Cultural heritage; Diversity: US (3)-India (5) and Preservation US (3)-India (4). Lastly, within Family Connections, as –other than the parents-- the rest of the family is staying in India, Proximity: US(1)-India(5) and Support: US(2)-India(5).

Great analysis! Now, how would you proceed further? Please assume that primary factors are twice more likely to be important for the family than secondary factors.

Got it! Assuming that within each parameter, the sub-parameters are of equal importance; I'll first average out the rating in each parameter. Post this, I'll take a weighted average of all parameters,, assigning weights as 2 and 1 to primary & secondary factors, respectively. This will be done for both US and India. After considering all the preferences and calculations, we can see that the final weighted score for India is higher than US. We should suggest our client to be born & brought up in India.

Unborn Baby

Imagine you have an unborn baby as a client. Your task is to help this client decide whether to be born & brought up in the US or India.

Case Facts & Notes

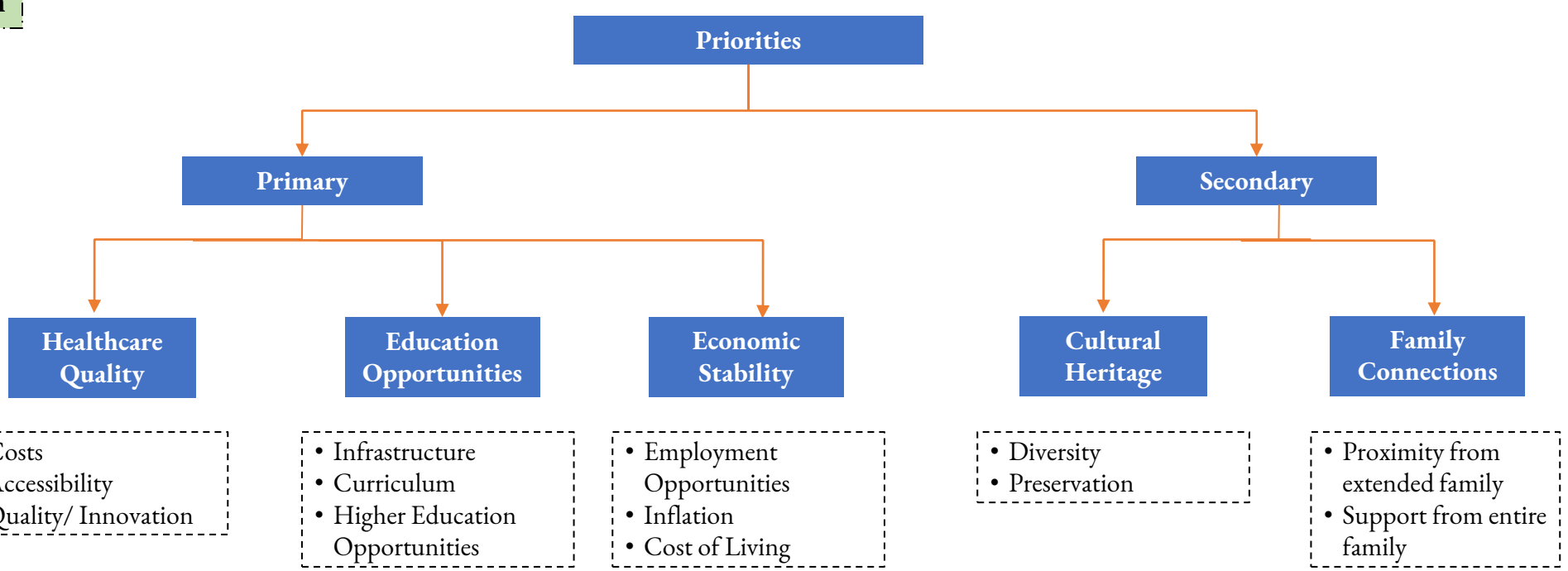
- **Context** – Unborn baby; wants to choose location among US or India
- **Family Background**– Extended family in India, Parents have remote work env., NRI status, middle income segment
- **Specific Priorities** – Primary: Education opportunities, healthcare quality, economic stability.

  Secondary: Cultural heritage, family connections

Recommendations

- After considering preferences and calculations, the final weighted score for India is higher than US. So, we should suggest our client to be born & brought up in India.

Approach



Healthcare	US	India
Costs	2	4
Accessibility	3	2
Quality	5	3
Average	**3.3**	**3.0**

Education	US	India
Infrastructure	4	3
Curriculum	4	3
Higher Edu.	5	4
Average	**4.3**	**3.3**

Eco. factors	US	India
Employment	4	3
Inflation	4	3
Cost of Living	2	4
Average	**3.3**	**3.3**

Cultural Heritage	US	India
Diversity	3	5
Preservation	3	4
Average	**3.0**	**4.5**

Family Conn.	US	India
Proximity	1	5
Support	2	5
Average	**1.5**	**5.0**

Parameters (Weight)	US	India
Healthcare (2)	3.3	3.0
Education (2)	4.3	3.3
Eco. Factors (2)	3.3	3.3
Cultural Heritage (1)	3.0	4.5
Family Connections (1)	1.5	5.0
Weighted Average	**3.3**	**3.6**

Launching a Green Airline

Your client intends to establish a new Airlines Company distinguished by its commitment to being an environmentally friendly, or 'green', airline. They have sought your expertise as a consultant to advise on strategies for making their airline eco-friendly.

By being 'green', do we mean adopting and excelling in sustainable practices or is there some other interpretation?

Yes, you are right. It means adopting sustainable practices.

Okay, could I know why the client wants to adopt this? What is his ultimate objective?

The client believes that global awareness of sustainable practices is on the rise. By positioning itself as a 'green' airline, the company anticipates attracting passengers even if ticket prices are somewhat higher.

Sure, I would want to understand a bit more about the company at this point. Will it be a low cost or a full-service airline? Does it plan to operate in international markets or in India?

They will prefer to be a full-service airline. It will primarily be an Indian airlines, but it will have international flights.

Could I understand a bit more about the current context? Have other players started with these practices? Do we have any benchmark?

No, we would be the first in the industry. There is no benchmark

Alright, I believe I have a grasp of the issue at hand. I'd like to continue by analyzing it through mapping out the value chain (begins drawing). Is there a specific area you'd like me to concentrate on, or should I begin with sourcing?

Start wherever you want. You are the consultant.

Okay, so I feel that sourcing would be that of fuel and aircraft. While I know that the suppliers are well established there are certain in-flight changes that can be introduced to reduce the weight of the flight. For example, lighter carbon fiber seats can be installed. Similarly, we could look at re-configuring the cabin crew or cockpit to reduce weight. For fuel, we could look at a mix of biodiesel and normal fuel something which was tried by Spice Jet.

Okay, what else?

That would cover sourcing. Next, I would like to come to planning operations. This would include flight & crew scheduling, route selection etc. (refer value chain). The flights need to be planned such that it minimizes fuel use. This would involve better scheduling, not flying flights at less than capacity and reducing idle waiting time at the runway.

Okay. Could you think of a metric in this respect which would be useful?

Fuel/passenger. I think we should focus on reducing this.

Okay. Please continue with your initial analysis.

Following the planning phase, I propose examining the pre-flight operations. This includes activities such as ticket counter operations, gate operations, baggage handling, and the pre-flight bus service. To enhance sustainability, we can consider eliminating paper tags and plastic zip locks by transitioning to e-boarding passes. Additionally, the use of aerobridges could reduce fuel consumption compared to operating buses. Substituting conventional diesel-powered ground service equipment with electric alternatives is also an option.

Interesting suggestions. Please continue with your analysis.

Moving on, I suggest examining the in-flight operations. This entails exploring ways to minimize paper and plastic usage on board, such as reducing or eliminating magazines and opting for lighter beverage carts. Considering our intention to offer full-service amenities, serving in-flight meals in biodegradable containers is another viable option.

Fair enough. What else?

Following that, we would address outbound logistics. In this aspect, we could opt for aerobridges or electric buses for transporting passengers to terminals. Baggage transfer from flights to collection belts could be facilitated using electric or solar-powered ground service equipment. In major terminals, such as metro cities, instead of the usual pick-up and drop car rental services, we could consider pooled-car or shuttle bus services as alternatives.

Do you think you have missed out any major factor in your overall analysis? What do you think a major airline operator will need to have to sustain its operations?

I apologize for the oversight. An important aspect to consider is the sustainability of the airline's corporate offices, which are spread across the country. We could explore implementing sustainable practices in these offices, such as utilizing solar energy and transitioning to a paperless system, to decrease our overall carbon footprint. Additionally, we could consider adopting environmentally friendly reporting practices, like ESG reporting in our financial statements, and conducting green audits with specialized firms..

What will be some of the major challenges in the initiatives suggested by you ?

Launching a Green Airline

Your client intends to establish a new Airlines Company distinguished by its commitment to being an environmentally friendly, or 'green', airline. They have sought your expertise as a consultant to advise on strategies for making their airline eco-friendly.

Initially, there are some challenges to consider. Firstly, the upfront costs will be higher, especially for acquiring electric or solar-powered ground equipment, which is not readily available in India and would necessitate special orders. Secondly, the proposed changes to cabin and cockpit configurations for weight reduction may require regulatory approvals. Lastly, there is the issue of customer comfort with e-boarding passes. Educating passengers about these new practices may incur additional costs, or there is a risk of potential sales loss.

Okay, Sounds good. Could you summarize the case for us?

Our client aims to introduce a new environmentally friendly airline and sought guidance on embracing sustainable practices. Following an analysis of the pertinent functions within the value chain, we identified several areas where the client could employ various methods. These include initiatives such as environmentally conscious sourcing, optimizing flight operations to decrease fuel consumption per passenger, minimizing paper and tag usage in pre-flight operations, reducing plastic usage during flights, lessening the carbon footprint in outbound logistics, and implementing sustainable practices in the corporate offices. These measures are expected to significantly contribute to our client's objective of establishing a 'green' airline.

Launching a Green Airline

Unconventional | Moderate| Bain & Co.

Your client intends to establish a new Airlines Company distinguished by its commitment to being an environmentally friendly, or 'green', airline. They have sought your expertise as a consultant to advise on strategies for making their airline eco-friendly.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Context** – Adopt sustainable practices in the Airline
- **Objective** – Position itself as a Green Airline and attract customers even if ticket prices are high
- **Company** – Full service Airline, primarily operations in India but will have international flights
- **Competition** – first mover advantage

Approach

Sourcing

Fuel Sourcing
- Biodiesel & normal fuel mix
- Research on alternative fuels

Aircraft & Components
- Lighter aircraft materials (carbon fiber seats)
- Reconfigure cabin/cockpit to reduce weight

Planning Operations

Flight Scheduling
- Minimize fuel use by optimizing schedules
- Avoid flights at less than capacity

Route Selection
- Choose fuel-efficient routes
- Reduce idle runway time

Crew Scheduling
- Efficient staffing to reduce operational cost

Key Metric - fuel consumption per passenger

Pre-flight Operations

Ticketing & Boarding
- Implement e-boarding passes to reduce paper use
- Eliminate paper tags/plastic zip locks

Ground Services
- Transition to electric buses for passenger transport
- Use aerobridges instead of buses
- Replace diesel ground equipment with electric versions

In-flight Operations

Paper/Plastic Reduction
- Eliminate paper magazines
- Use lighter beverage carts

Meal Service
- Switch to biodegradable meal containers
- Reduce plastic usage in cutlery/packaging

Outbound Logistics

Paper/Plastic Reduction
- Eliminate paper magazines
- Use lighter beverage carts

Meal Service
- Switch to biodegradable meal containers
- Reduce plastic usage in cutlery/packaging

Corporate Offices

Sustainability Initiatives
Implement solar energy systems
Paperless offices
Green audits and ESG reporting

Other Green Practices
Sustainable facilities management
Promote energy-efficient technology use

Challenges

- **High Costs**: Significant upfront investment for sustainable technologies.
- **Regulatory Hurdles**: Modifications may face approval challenges
- **Customer Resistance**: Adoption of eco-friendly practices may require education.

Client Stuck in an Island

Unconventional | Moderate| McKinsey

Your client is stranded on the Galapagos Island with only two fire sticks, a granola bar, and book. Figure out what the client should do.

I would like to clarify a few things before I start analyzing the case.

Sure, go ahead.

What is the client's primary goal, and how did the client end up in this situation?

So, there is not much information on how the client landed up here, it's just known that the client is stranded and the client's main goal is to survive and eventually escape the island.

Could you also tell me more about the island's terrain and conditions?

The Galapagos Island is known for its remote location, diverse wildlife, and a variety of terrains, including beaches, forests, and cliffs. The weather can be unpredictable, with hot, sunny days and cooler nights.

What sort of book is the client carrying?

So, the book is a blank notebook.

Is the client alone, or does he have company?

The client is completely alone.

Alright. So, I'd like to split the case into two key objectives: survival and escape. I'll prioritize survival with 60% weight and escaping with 40%. Does this sound reasonable?

That works. Can you think of any other considerations the client should focus on?

Apart from survival and escape, we could consider sub-priorities like food, water, shelter, and fire for survival, and both external and internal resources for escape. Is that okay?

Yes, that's a good approach. Let's start with survival.

For survival, I'll break it down into three main areas: food and water, shelter, and fire. Each area can be split into finding resources and sustaining them. Does that work?

For food and water, the client has a granola bar, which can sustain him temporarily. He should search the island for water sources like ponds or lakes and gather any edible fruits or plants he can find. For shelter, the client could first look for any existing huts or homes. If none are available, he could build a temporary shelter using sticks and wood found on the island. For fire, the fire sticks can be used to start a fire, and the paper from the notebook could help. Additionally, he could explore using rocks or friction-based methods for alternative fire-starting techniques.

Good, you've covered survival well. Now let's move on to escape.

I would split escaping into two categories: external and internal measures. Does this classification sound appropriate?

Yes, go ahead.

For internal measures, the client should first search for any abandoned boats or nearby materials to escape. If a boat is unavailable, he could try building one using available wood and materials. For external measures, to attract attention, the client could use fire and the notebook paper to create signals. He could create smoke signals to catch the attention of passing ships or aircraft and increase his chances of being rescued.

That sounds good. You've covered the essential aspects of the case. Now, what risks do you foresee in this whole situation?

There are several risks the client might face. First, the limited resources such as the granola bar, fire sticks, and blank notebook are not enough for long-term survival. The client would need to find additional sources of food and water soon. Second, dehydration and starvation pose immediate threats if no water bodies or edible food sources are found on the island. Third, exposure to harsh weather conditions could lead to severe health issues like hypothermia or heatstroke if adequate shelter is not built. Furthermore, there are wildlife dangers on the island that could threaten the client, either through direct encounters with animals or by consuming contaminated food or water. Finally, the psychological impact of isolation could impair the client's ability to make sound decisions, as stress and loneliness could take a toll on mental health.

We will stop the case here, Thank you.

Client Stuck in an Island

Unconventional | Moderate| McKinsey

Your client is stranded on the Galapagos Island with only two fire sticks, a granola bar, and book. Figure out what the client should do.

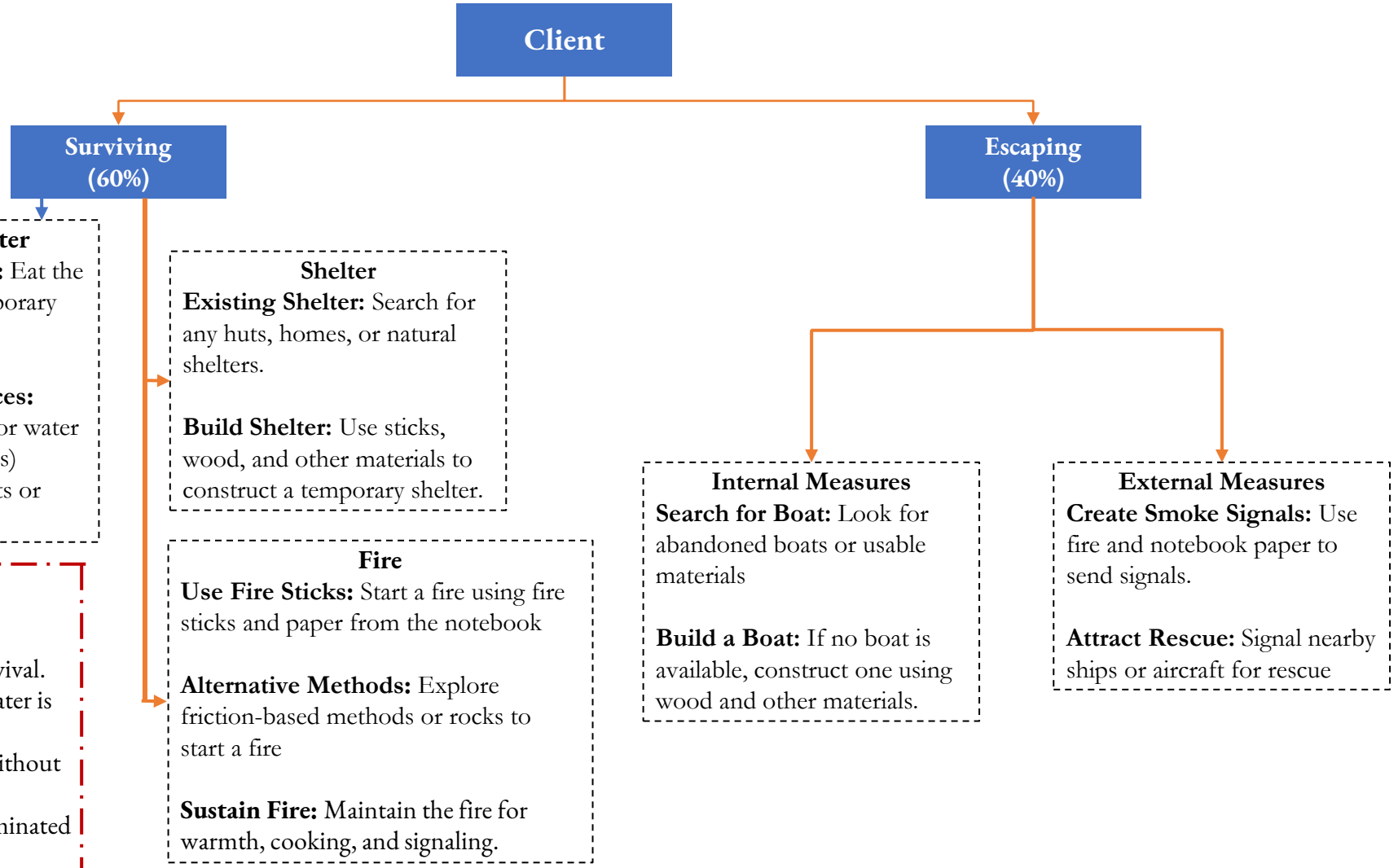
Case Facts & Notes

- **Client** – Stranded on Galapagos Island
- **Resources Available** – Two fire sticks, one granola bar, and a blank notebook.
- **Client's Goal** – To survive and eventually escape the island.
- **Situation** – The client is completely alone on the island with no external help.
- **Island Conditions:** Varied terrain (beaches, forests) and unpredictable weather.

Risks Identified

- **Limited Resources**: Insufficient supplies for long-term survival.
- **Dehydration and Starvation**: Risk if additional food or water is not found.
- **Exposure to Weather**: Vulnerability to harsh conditions without proper shelter.
- **Wildlife Dangers**: Potential threats from animals or contaminated food/water.
- **Mental Strain**: Isolation and stress could impair decision-making.

Approach



Increase in Product Returns

An ecommerce website is facing an issue of substantial increase in the number of returns. Find reasons and recommend solutions.

I would like to clarify a few things before I start analyzing the case. Can you tell if this problem is seen particularly in one of the product categories and a brand? What is the quantum of the increase in returns and since when is it happening?

It is seen in the category of smart TVs within a particular brand. AB TVs. It's been the case for3 months and the returns have seen an increase by 25%.

Is the problem seen in a particular geography? Also want to ask if the issue is with regarding to one of the customer segments. I take it that our customers will be mostly Urban households where they have a greater awareness about smart TVs. Is it correct or I'm missing any other customer segments?

No, Its seen across the customer segments and across India.

Okay. Got it. One last question, is this problem observed within any of our competitors?

Our competitors as well have seen some increase in the returns.

Okay. So mostly its an issue from the seller side itself. And the customers returning the product must be an issue with either the products or with the services. Is this approach fine with you?

Can you further explain what exactly comes under the two buckets?

Under the products you can have issues related to Mismatch from what is shown in the website to what is delivered or wrong product. Then you have issues related to build quality, damage or issues with functionality of the TVs that can be audio, video or connectivity issues with IOT devices since it's a smart TV.

Makes sense. The issue is regarding quality.

For quality related issues either there can be issue with unsatisfactory build quality of components like outer casing, display, etc or the product received has old/ used appearance or worse they have received a damaged product. May I know what is the exact issue here or I'm missing something?

Yes, the customers complained that most of them received a damaged product at the time of delivery itself. Can you analyse what can be the possible reasons?

Sure, to understand the exact reasons, we have to analyse the value chain of the process. May I know if this approach is correct and also does it have to start with the entire supply chain starting from R&D or just near the point from which ecommerce is involved.

This approach looks fine. As the issue here is related to damage of the product, you can start analyzing the value chain from the process of manufacturing. So, can you list out what are the process involved in the ecommerce delivery value chain?

Ok, Thank you for the suggestion. As I see it, The process that can be involved after Manufacturing could be packaging, Warehousing at the sellers' warehouse, Transportation to our clients' warehouse facilities, Shipping and Delivery upon order confirmation and After sales services. May I know if I'm missing something? And is there a process among these where I should be focusing?

The steps involved are exhaustive. However, I want to confirm one thing. Regarding the warehousing, the seller is currently using their own warehouse and not our clients. The shipping is directly done from the sellers' warehouse.

Got it, so is there an issue with warehouse of the seller that's causing the damage? Shall I go ahead with looking into the different possible problems in this step?

No. A check from the clients' side is done to ensure they are not shipping a damaged product. So, the damage is happening in later stages of the delivery.

So, In shipping and delivery there can be an issue with the driver, the loading team/unloading team, the roads, or the truck. May I know if it's an issue with these?

No, it's not an issue with any of these. Can you think of some other factors that can cause the damage?

That's interesting. The issue then can be with the product or with the packaging of the product. Since you mentioned that the perception of build quality is not an issue mentioned by the customers, can you confirm if this is an issue of packaging?

That's correct. Can you explore what can be the reasons?

It could be an issue involving the Men, Equipment, Method or the Material used for packaging. May I know if you want me to explore all these factors or focus my attention towards one of them?

You can focus on the Material related issue.

Material related issue can either be because of the change I the quality or the size/shape of the material that can make the products packed more prone to the damage. May I know where the issue exactly lies?

Yes, the issue is regarding the change in size of the thermocol used in packing the TV. The thickness is reduced from 4 inch to 2.5 inch as the seller wanted to do a cost cutting on packaging.

Increase in Product Returns

An ecommerce website is facing an issue of substantial increase in the number of returns. Find reasons and recommend solutions.

However, this has led to the TVs being more susceptible to damage during the shipping and delivery. Can you suggest what can be done to avoid the same other than increasing the thickness?

Ecommerce websites usually provide the seller with an option of using the ecommerce packaging material or the sellers own packaging material. So, The seller can start using the packaging material suggested by our client to avoid the damage or if better can start to opt our warehouse services that streamlines the entire delivery value chain and makes it easy for us to move the shipment across the value chain.

Okay. Got it. Thank you for your suggestions!

Increase in Product Returns

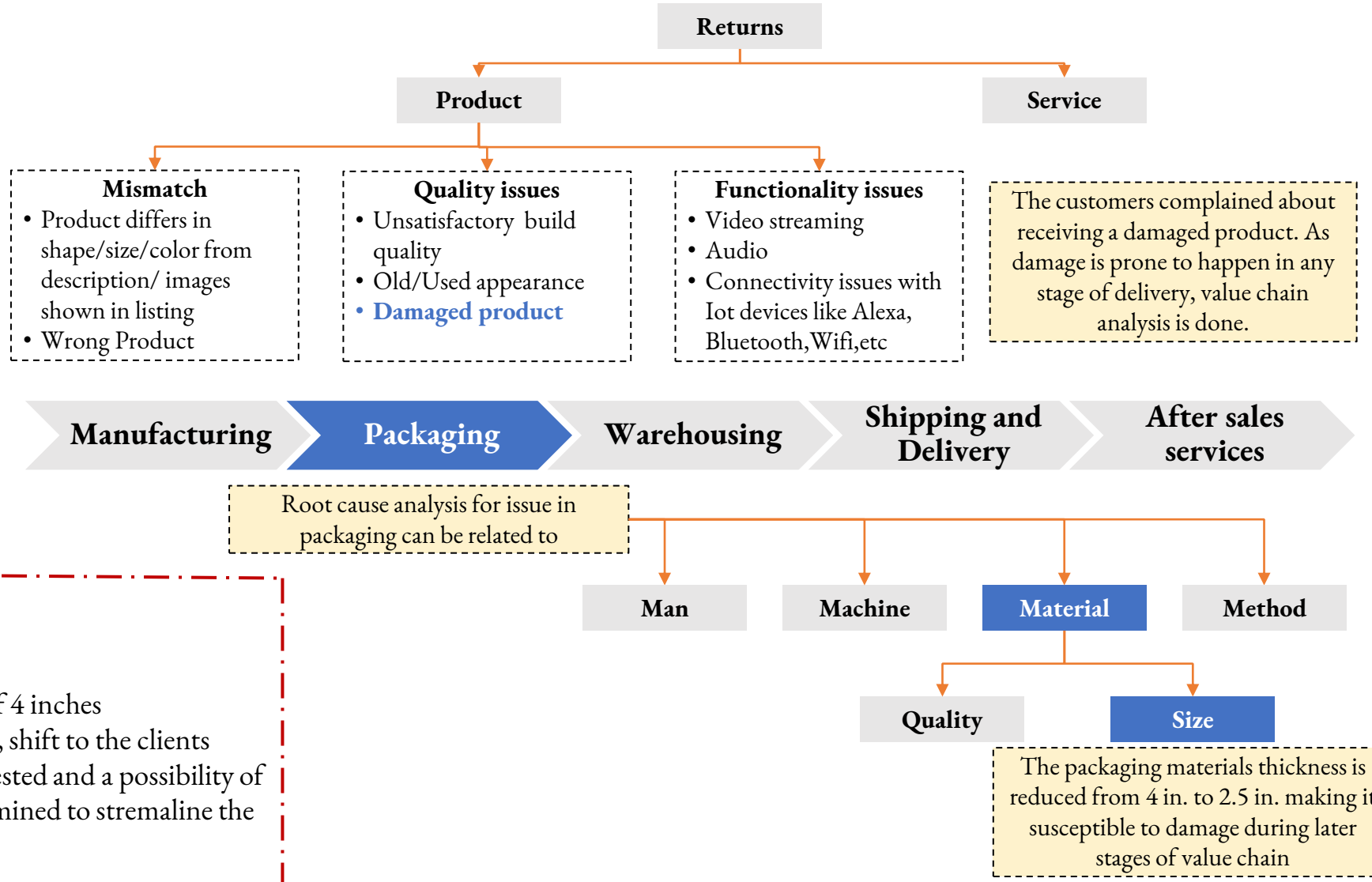
An ecommerce website is facing an issue of substantial increase in the number of returns. Find reasons and recommend solutions.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company** – Ecommerce
- **Context** – Facing an increase in product returns by 25% since 3 months
- **Geography** – India
- **Products** – Smart TV's from Brand A.B
- **Customers** – Urban Households

Recommendations

- Increase the thickness back to usual size of 4 inches
- Instead of seller's own packaging material, shift to the clients recommended packaging material is suggested and a possibility of utilising the clients warehouse can be examined to stremaline the entire operations.



Low Cost Airline

Low cost airline carrier facing an increase turnover time in Mumbai airport. You are asked to figure out why.

I would like to confirm the objective before I proceed. Client is a low-cost airline carrier which is facing an increase in their turnover time at Mumbai airport. And I have to figure out why is this happening.

That's right.

My understanding for turnover time is that it is the duration between landing and takeoff of a plane.

Yes, that's correct.

Do we have any data for the increased turnover time?

Earlier, the time interval between an aircraft's landing and its next takeoff used to be 30 minutes. Now it is taking 45 minutes for the same from past 3 months.

Can you provide me the business model for the client. Also is the issue faced by our client only or it is an industry wise phenomenon?

The client only operates domestically and has passenger flights. For the second part, only our client has been affected.

I would like to outline the airplane's journey during its turnover time. Once the plane lands on the runway, it taxis to the designated offboarding gate. Passengers deplane, after which the aircraft undergoes routine maintenance and refueling in preparation for its next flight. This is followed by passenger onboarding and finally, takeoff.

That was quite comprehensive. Can we look into each aspect and see where can the issue exist.

I would start with landing first. Once the client's planes are landed, they might be staying longer on runway for getting a designated gate from airport authority. There can also be some maintenance activities going on the runway which has decreased the speed of planes post landing. Lastly, there might be some new regulations by airport authority mandating a speed limit.

No, nothing of this sort has happened, in fact our boarding gate is now closer to the landing runway which has decreased our time by 5 minutes. You can move to next bucket.

Coming to the offboarding process, it majorly deals with two broad buckets People and Luggage. There might be a scenario where people are taking longer than required to deboard the plane, similarly for luggage too.

What can be some reasons that can add time for the luggage.

I would like to analyze the time on two aspects:
Human – Either the number of ground staff has decreased or their efficiency.
Non human – The conveyor belt that takes the luggage from plane to airport might not be working properly.
Do you want me to look for more reasons, or we can move to maintenance part?

That was good, we can skip the maintenance and move to fueling process.

Sure. I am assuming that the fueling is done through trucks. I would be analyzing it by taking:
Number of trucks x distance travelled x capacity
If the number of trucks has decreased, the trips would increase and it would take more time to fill the airplane.
As mentioned above, our boarding gate for departure has been shifted close to runway, the fueling tanks have to travel more now.
The capacity per truck could have reduced again adding to increased trips.

This looks quite exhaustive. The speed of trucks are 3km/hr and distance now has increased by 1km. Do you think that this is the issue?

Since the distance has increased by 1km, it has added extra 20 minutes in the process. But we also saved 5 minutes in offboarding process and hence, the total additional time is 15 mins.

Yes, you have got it. We can close the case now.

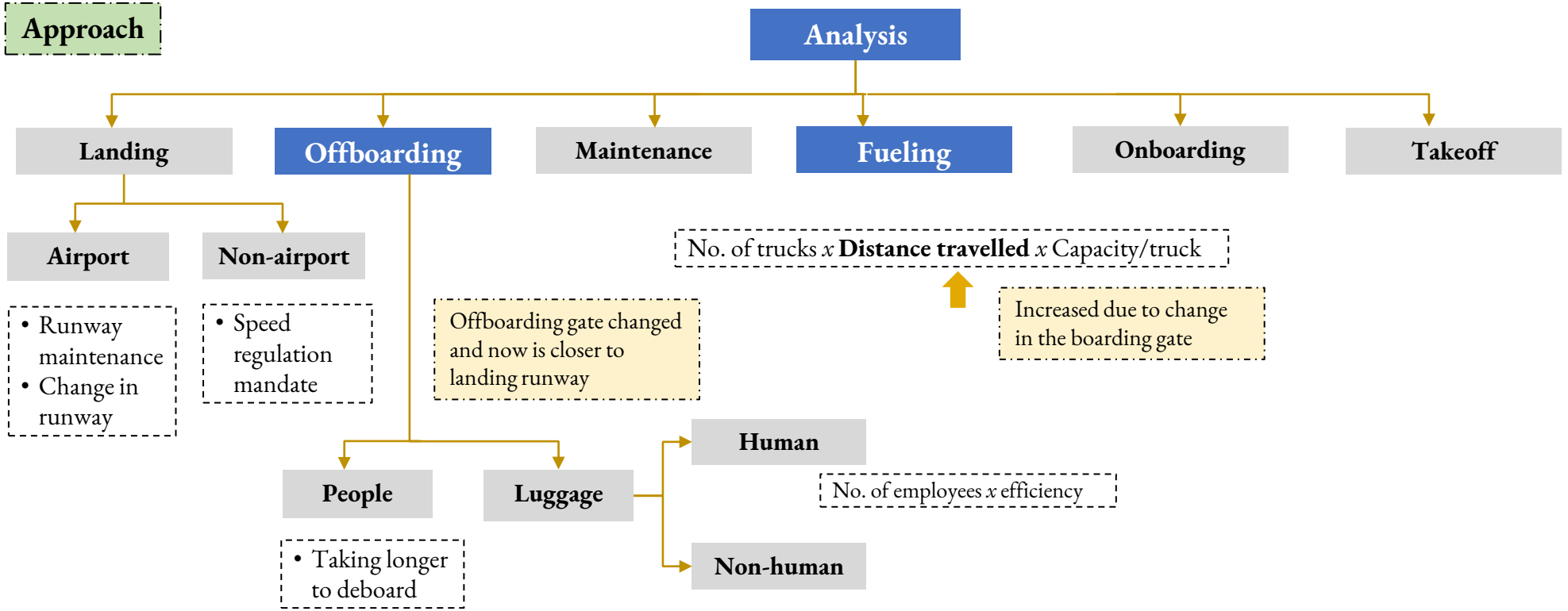
Low Cost Airline

Low cost airline carrier facing an increase turnover time in Mumbai airport. You are asked to figure out why.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Turnover-** time between landing and takeoff
- Past 3 months
- Only client being impacted
- Domestic passengers flight

Approach



Calculations

- Landing Offboarding: reduced by 5 mins
- Fueling: increased by 20 mins

Distance increased - 1km
Speed of truck - 3km/hr

Time increased by 15 mins

Organizing event

Unconventional and Pricing| Moderate | BCG

You are an Event Organizer organizing a concert in Mumbai. How do you go about it.

Hi, I would like to clarify a few things before I start analyzing the case

Sure

I want to know what our main objective is here.

To maximize our profits.

I want to know more about the concert. As in when we are planning to organize it. Which band is performing? Is it a live concert or a virtual one?

Cold play is the one which is playing, and We are planning to organize it one year from now. Also, it is a physical live concert.

Alright, are there any regulations and restrictions we should worry about and are there any competitors who are also trying to get this concert contract? Also, how many people can we accommodate at our venue?

No competitors and no restrictions for the no. of people either. We can accommodate any no. of people.

Ok. I would like to analyze the case now. I want to divide the concert timeline into three phases and list out all the activities that would be taking place in those phases. My idea behind this is to get a better understanding of cost drivers and revenue drivers for the concert. Can I go ahead by this approach?

Yeah, makes sense, go ahead

So, the three phases will be Pre-event, During and post event. In the Pre-event phase, we have to plan hospitality, logistics and security internally. Marketing the event and getting sponsorships comes under the external activities.
During the event, Managing the audience, organizing the performance, catering and security will be the main activities. Coming to post event, again logistics will be our main concern.

Can you jump into the financial aspects of these.

Alright, I'll get into the revenue and cost drivers. So, our major sources of revenue will be Advertisements, Merchandising, affiliate sales brand partnerships/ collaborations, ticket sales and sponsorships .

The major costs we will be incurring are production costs, logistics costs, hospitality, security, marketing and promotion, licensing and royalty, infrastructure costs, audience engagement and interaction costs, catering and salaries of workers.

That's very comprehensive. Can you try to think of one of the major cost.

Yeah. The artist fees are another major cost. So, now to calculate the revenue we can multiply the price of ticket with number of footfalls.

Can you give a rough figure of how many people we can expect as audience.

Sure, so we can arrive at a rough figure by taking population and dividing it based on age. Also, I am considering only the Mumbai people as of now as they will be in majority. Once we figure that out, we can add non-Mumbai people also by scaling it up by some percentage. Does that sound fair? Should I go along with this approach?

That sounds good. Go on.

So, the main audience we will be getting here is of ages 15-35 which is roughly 20% of Mumbai population. Taking Mumbai population as 2 crores, population of ages 15-35 will be 40 lakhs. Now, further dividing this age group based on their income group, 40% will be in low, 50% in middle and 10 % in high income groups. Assuming 10% of high income and 1% of middle-income groups go to the concert.

Audience with age group 15-35 = 40 * 0.5 * 0.01 + 40 * 0.1 * 0.1 = 60,000
This age group will add up to roughly 80% of the audience. So, scaling the figure up by 25% and also scaling it up by another 25% to account for non-Mumbai people, we arrive at a figure of roughly 80,000. Does that number looks fine?
Final value = 60000 * 1.25 * 1.25 = 93750

Yeah, and now as you have mentioned we have to multiply this with ticket price, right. So, can you tell me which type of pricing you are going to go with.

Yeah, Sure. So, since the concert is based on the customer experience and also once in a lifetime thing for so many people, I believe value-based pricing approach will be most appropriate here.

Organizing event

You are an Event Organizer organizing a concert in Mumbai. How do you go about it.

Okay, I'll give you some figures regarding the costs. Based on that try to price the ticket. Say our hospitality costs are 50 lakhs, logistics is another 50 lakhs, security is 20, salaries will be 20 lakhs more, marketing & promotion costs as 20 lakhs, infrastructure will be 40 lakhs, artist are charging 5 crores and take miscellaneous costs to be another 25 lakhs.

Okay, so our total cost will be:
Total cost = 50 + 50+ 20 + 20+ 500 + 25 + 20 + 40 = 725 lakhs = 7.25 crores.
And what about sponsorships, did we manage to get any?

Yeah, we got sponsorships worth 3 crores.

Okay, then we will breakeven at:
No of tickets * ticket price = Total cost – Sponsorships = 7.25– 3 = 4.25 crores.
Ticket price= 4.25 crores / total footfall = 4.25 crores / 93750= 453

So, we will breakeven if we price the ticket at 500 rupees approximately. From my personal experience, I have recently attended a concert of a famous band and there I heard it had 500% profits. As Coldplay is also one of the very well celebrated bands, I believe it will be fair to assume the same and charge a 10x premium to arrive at a final price of 3000 rupees.

Does this figure look fine?

Yeah, it is fine. Well, Done. We end the case here. Good luck

Organizing event

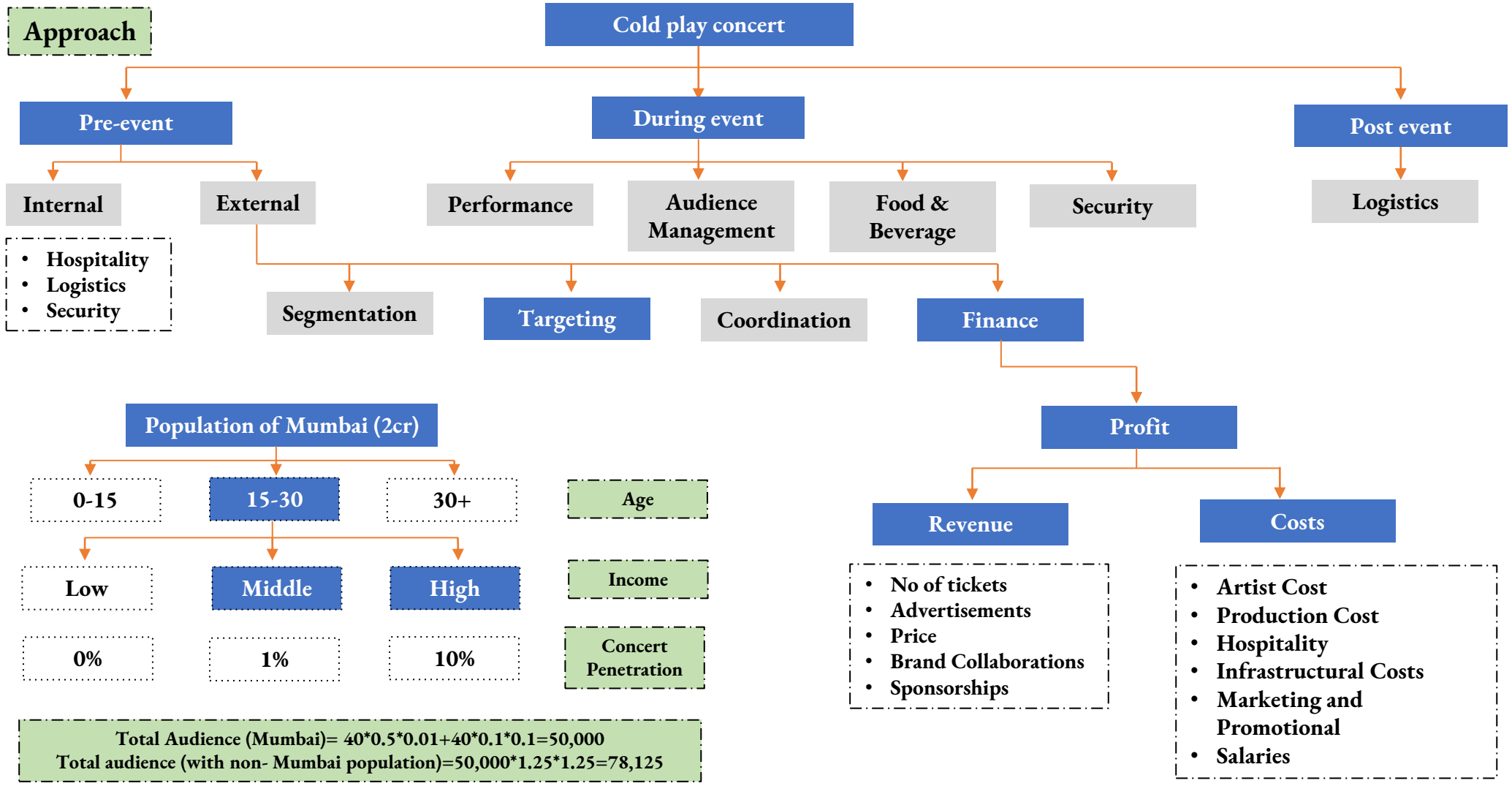
Unconventional and Pricing| Moderate | BCG

You are an Event Organizer organizing a concert in Mumbai. How do you go about it.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Objective-** Maximize Profit
- **Who is performing-** Coldplay
- **Mode of concert-** Offline
- **Restrictions/ Competitors-** None
- **Capacity of venue-** Assume we can accommodate any no of people
- **Cost breakdown-**
  Hospitality= 50 lakhs
  Logistics= 50 lakhs
  Security= 20 lakhs
  Marketing= 20 lakhs
  Infrastructure=40 lakhs
  Artist= 5 crore
  Extra costs= 25 lakhs.

Approach



Total Audience (Mumbai)= 40*0.5*0.01+40*0.1*0.1=50,000
Total audience (with non- Mumbai population)=50,000*1.25*1.25=78,125

Mining in SA

There is a mining company in South Africa, there production from mine has gone down from last three to four months. They want you to find reasons for it

Thanks for the case. Before starting, I would like to clarify a few things about the case.

Correct

Could you tell me more about the company and its operations? For example, how many mines does the company operate and what mineral is being extracted?

The company operates one aluminum mine in South America. The mine has been operational for several years and has an expected life of around 25 years.

Who are the primary customers of the company? Are we supplying aluminum directly to manufacturers or to intermediaries?

The company primarily sells aluminum ore to industrial buyers and manufacturers who further process it into finished aluminum products.

How competitive is the market? Are there many other mining companies operating in the region? Have they faced a similar decline?

Yes, there are around 3–4 competing mining companies in the region, which could create some competitive pressure. No, they haven't seen a similar decline.

How significant is the production drop? Do we know the percentage decline or the magnitude of the drop?

While exact numbers are not provided, the decline is noticeable enough to concern management and trigger this investigation.

Since the company has both existing mining areas and newly explored areas, I would like to understand whether the decline in production is coming from the older mines, the newer mines, or both.

The decline in production is primarily from the older mining areas, while the newer mining areas are performing as expected.

Please allow me few second to structure my thought.

Sure

Since the problem is a decline in production from the mine, I would like to structure the problem by analyzing the entire mining operations process, starting from activities before extraction up to final dispatch. Broadly, I would divide it into four stages:

- **Pre-Extraction**
- **Extraction**
- **Processing / Cleaning**
- **Packaging and Dispatch**

By analyzing each stage, we can identify where the operational bottleneck or inefficiency is occurring.

That sounds reasonable. Please proceed.

Before actual extraction begins, there are several preparatory activities that determine how efficiently the mining process operates. I would examine:
Land preparation and site readiness (especially differences between old vs new mining areas)

- **Geological assessment and ore quality**
- **Availability and preparation of equipment**
- **Workforce allocation and shift planning**
- **Safety and environmental compliance requirements**

Any issues in these areas? Or should I proceed further?

No issue in this, please move to packaging and dispatch.

In packaging and dispatch I would evaluate factors such as:

- **Packaging capacity**
- **Labor availability and productivity**
- **Conveyor belt performance**
- **Coordination between production and packaging teams**

Is there any issue with any of these?

You are on the right track. In fact, there has been an issue with the workers in the packaging department.

Mining in SA

There is a mining company in South Africa, there production from mine has gone down from last three to four months. They want you to find reasons for it

I would like to break packaging output into the following components:
Packaging Output = Number of Workers × Hours Worked per Worker × Efficiency per Hour
This will help identify which factor has changed.

That sounds like a reasonable approach.

I would like to check whether the number of workers in the packaging department has changed or workers have become less productive per hour, possibly due to skill issues or process inefficiencies or effective working time per worker decreased recently.

Yes, workers are spending slightly fewer hours actually working during their shifts.

To understand why working hours have declined, I would like to break hours worked into:
Shift Time = Productive Work Time + Break Time
If productive time has decreased, it may be due to an increase in break durations.

That is correct.

I would further divide break time into:
- **Lunch breaks**
- **Water breaks**
- **Washroom breaks**
- **Other informal breaks**

This will help identify which type of break has increased.

That seems fair.

Have lunch breaks increased recently?

Yes

Is there a particular reason for the longer lunch breaks?

Workers in the packaging department have been spending additional time discussing trade union matters during lunch breaks, which has extended the break duration.

That means the effective working hours of packaging workers have decreased, reducing packaging throughput. Since packaging is the final stage of the process, delays here cause processed material to accumulate, forcing upstream machines to slow down or stop temporarily. Thus, even though the issue originates in labor utilization in packaging, it affects overall production.

Yes, now since you have identified the problem, come up with some quick recommendations.

To address this issue, I would recommend:
- **Break Management: Enforce clear break duration policies. Monitor adherence through shift supervisors.**
- **Union Coordination: Coordinate with trade union representatives. Schedule discussions outside production hours.**
- **Operational Buffer: Introduce temporary buffers between processing and packaging so upstream machines do not stop immediately.**
- **Packaging Line Optimization: Improve packaging line flow and scheduling.**

We can close the case here. Thank you.

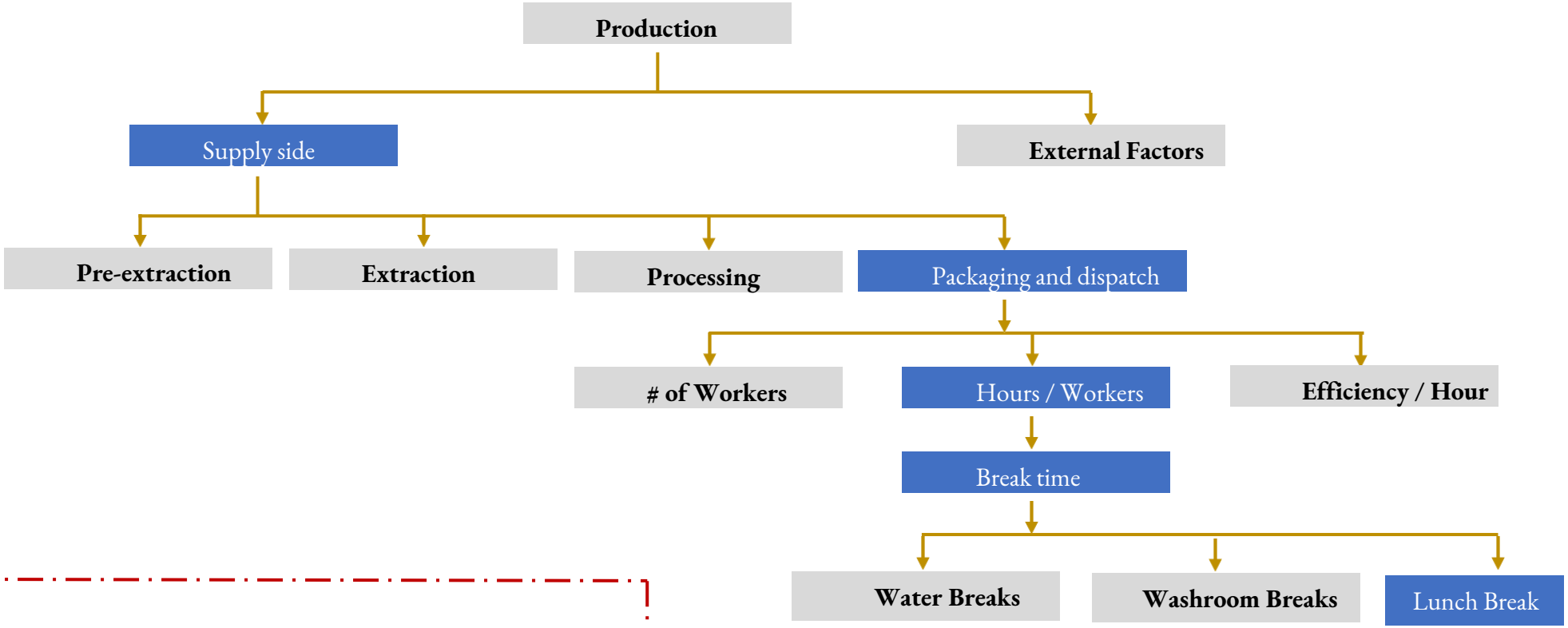
Mining in SA

There is a mining company in South Africa, there production from mine has gone down from last three to four months. They want you to find reasons for it

Case Facts & Notes

- **Company** – Aluminum mining company operating a single mine in South America
- **Customers** – Industrial buyers and aluminum manufacturers
- **Mine Status** – Decline observed primarily in older mining areas; newer areas performing as expected
- **Industry Scenario** – Competitors have not experienced a similar production decline
- **Production Decline** – Significant enough to trigger management investigation (exact magnitude not disclosed)

Approach



Recommendations

- Enforce standardized break durations and monitor adherence through shift supervisors.
- Schedule trade union discussions outside production hours in coordination with union representatives.
- Improve packaging line scheduling and workforce allocation to restore throughput.

Oil & Gas Conglomerate- Productivity Decline

A top oil and gas conglomerate is facing a productivity issue. Identify the root cause and suggest solutions.

Before structuring my approach, I'd like to clarify a few things about the business and the problem itself. First, could you tell me about the conglomerate - is it fully integrated across the value chain, and roughly what's its scale?

Yes, it's one of the largest integrated players in the country, with operations across exploration & production, pipelines & storage, refining, and a recently added renewables arm

That's helpful. Second, when you say "productivity," I want to make sure I solve for the right thing do you mean a financial/margin metric, such as something like Gross Refining Margin, or an operational metric like throughput or capacity utilization relative to installed capacity?

Think of it purely in operational terms how much output the company generates relative to its installed capacity or resources deployed. It isn't primarily a pricing or margin issue

Understood. Third, is this decline specific to this conglomerate, or is the broader industry seeing it too which would point to macro or regulatory factors rather than something company-specific?

It's specific to the company. Industry peers are operating at normal efficiency levels.

And over what time frame has this been observed?

Over the last 18–24 months. Before that, operational efficiency was stable and in line with historical levels.

That gives me a clear problem statement: company-specific operational productivity has declined over the last 18–24 months, and I need to find the root cause. Since this is an integrated conglomerate, I'd like to segment the business into its four main units - Upstream, Midstream, Downstream, and Renewables and check where the decline is concentrated before going deeper.

Reasonable. Go ahead

Could you tell me how each segment has performed on its productivity/utilization metrics over this period?

Upstream well uptime and production efficiency are steady around 94–95%. Downstream refinery utilization is steady at 90–92%. Renewables is new but scaling as planned. Midstream, however, has seen throughput efficiency fall from about 90% to roughly 74%.

That isolates the issue to Midstream. I'd like to break Midstream down using a value chain lens- processing (gathering & treating), storage, and transportation (pipeline, marine, rail, or road) and check each for signs of the decline.

Fair approach.

Starting with processing any change in throughput, downtime, or capacity there?

No, processing volumes and uptime are unchanged.

And transportation any change in transit times, volumes moved, or bottlenecks identified?

No, transportation is stable, no bottlenecks reported.

That leaves storage as the likely source. Have storage metrics like tank turnaround time or utilization changed?

Yes. The issue is concentrated in storage average tank turnaround time has nearly doubled.

Let's dig into storage itself. I'd segment it into crude oil storage, finished/intermediate products storage, off-spec or slop storage, and utility storage (water, chemicals etc). Which of these is driving the decline?

Products, slop, & utility storage are all functioning normally. The issue is isolated to crude storage.

So crude storage turnaround has nearly doubled, and it's dragging down midstream productivity while everything else is normal. Within crude storage, I see four broad buckets that could explain slower turnaround - infrastructure/physical constraints (tank damage, corrosion, reduced effective capacity), operational/scheduling issues (poor coordination between receipt and evacuation), a change in the nature of the crude being stored (requiring extra processing time before evacuation), or external logistics factors (vessel bunching or upstream delays filling tanks faster than they empty)

That's exhaustive enough, about 2 year ago, procurement began sourcing nearly a third of total volumes from a new region at $ 3-4/barrel discount.

Oil & Gas Conglomerate- Productivity Decline

A top oil and gas conglomerate is facing a productivity issue. Identify the root cause and suggest solutions.

Does this crude differ in quality- density, TAN, viscosity, or sediment and water content?

Yes. It carries meaningfully higher Basic Sediment & Water (BS&W) content than what the tanks were originally configured for.

That's likely the root cause. Higher-BS&W crude needs a longer gravity settling period before the water and sediment separate out and it can be safely evacuated, and it also requires more frequent tank-bottom cleaning as sludge builds up faster. Both effects take tanks out of rotation longer, reducing turns per tank per month even though physical capacity hasn't changed. In effect, the cost savings from cheaper crude are coming at the expense of storage productivity, because the infrastructure wasn't built to pre-treat this grade efficiently. Does that match what you're seeing

Exactly right. Settling and dwell time for this crude is roughly double that of the traditional slate, and cleaning frequency for tanks handling it has risen sharply that's the core driver.

That gives me a clear root cause: a procurement-driven shift to cheaper, higher-BS&W crude has increased tank dwell time and cleaning frequency, cutting effective storage throughput.
On recommendations, roughly in order of speed of impact:
Near-term - Add pre-treatment at the unloading point for this crude grade (electrostatic desalters, dehydration units, demulsifying chemical dosing), so separation happens before or as it enters storage rather than relying on tank dwell time. Also dedicate a subset of tanks to this grade, ideally with heating coils or agitation, so it doesn't disrupt turnaround for the rest of the tank farm.

Medium-term - Re-evaluate the sourcing decision on a fully-loaded cost basis factoring in incremental dwell cost, extra cleaning cost, and downstream risk not just the headline $3–4/bbl discount, and cap this crude's share of the mix at a level the infrastructure can absorb.

Longer-term - If the company wants to keep sourcing this crude at scale, invest in dedicated storage/treatment capacity built for higher-BS&W grades, and add real-time BS&W monitoring so crude moves forward the moment it's in spec, rather than on a fixed conservative settling schedule.

That’s detail enough, we can close the case

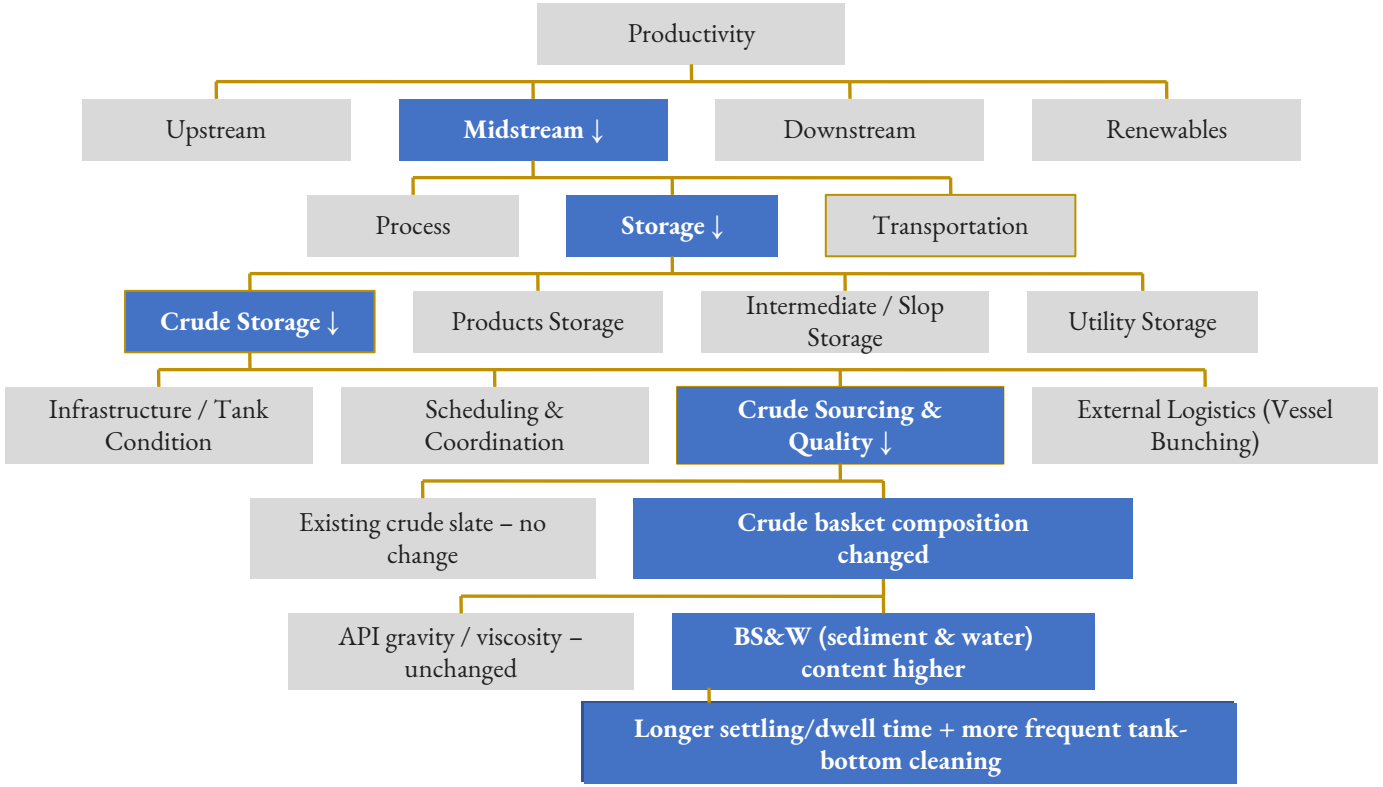
Oil & Gas Conglomerate- Productivity Decline

A top oil and gas conglomerate is facing a productivity issue. Identify the root cause and suggest solutions.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Conglomerate-** Fully integrated player E&P, pipelines & storage, refining, & a renewables arm.
- **Productivity metric-** Operational (capacity utilization / throughput)
- **Industry-wide or company specific-** Company specific, peers operating at normal efficiency.
- **Time frame-** Declined over the last 18-24 months, stable before that.
- **Segment performance-** Upstream 94–95%, Downstream 90–92% Midstream fell 90% to 74%.

Approach



Recommendation

- Add pre-treatment (desalters / dehydration, demulsifying dosing) at the unloading point to cut reliance on tank dwell time, dedicate select tanks to this crude grade.
- Re-evaluate sourcing on a fully-loaded cost basis, cap the high-BS&W share at what infrastructure can absorb, and invest in dedicated storage/treatment if scaling further.
- If the company wants to keep sourcing this crude at scale, invest in dedicated storage/treatment capacity built for higher-BS&W grades, and add real-time BS&W monitoring so crude moves forward the moment it's in spec, rather than on a fixed conservative settling schedule

Footfall of Church

The footfall in a city church has been dropping. You need to figure out what are the reasons and give recommendations on how to counter the same.

I'd like to re-iterate the statement to ensure I haven't missed anything. Our client is a city church who's footfall has been dropping. I need to figure out the cause and give recommendations.

Yes, you can proceed.

Okay, so my first question would be about the duration that we've been seeing this decline for and if we have any specific figure with the quantum of decline?

We've been witnessing a decline since the past 1 month and it's approximately a 20-30% drop.

I'd also like to know more about the location of the church and more about the city. Is the church on the outskirts or inside the city? Is the city a metropolitan city or a smaller city?

The church is located in the centre of the city. You can consider that the city is metropolitan like Delhi.

Okay. So can I assume that the demography of the city in would be similar to Delhi? That is, the income classes, ages, religions would be the same? Is our church open to all such segments?

Yes, the church is open to all. In fact, we've been seeing a decline across the board.

That's quite interesting. I have a few more questions before we proceed to the case; do we have any particular operating hours? Is there a peak time or non-peak time? Has there been any change in timings over the last 1 month?

The church operates from 9 AM to 5 PM. There are no peak/non-peak hours and no changes to the timings.

Thank you, I have all the information I need. I'd like to proceed with the problem by looking at two factors i.e. no. of hours spent by a visitor and the avg. number of visitors. Since we know that there has been no change to the hours, I would want to focus on two factors under the number of visitors; internal and external. Is this approach alright or should I look at it in any other way?

Let's not talk about the hours at all, like you mentioned. Let's focus on the visitors itself. Under internal what all would you explore?

Under internal, I would look at the journey of a visitor to our church. If we are exploring external as well, I'd explore the different external factors affecting our visitors such as political unrest.

What all would you explore under the visitor journey?

I can outlay the journey and then focus on the issue. Our visitor would travel to our church, then they would enter the church premises, they would then interact with the church through the services provided (praying, baptism), then they would receive communion and socialize, they would then exit the church and travel back home. Is there anything that I should focus on?

You've laid out a pretty thorough outlay of the journey, but let's only focus on the services offered by the church. You mentioned praying and baptism. Is there anything else you can think of?

Yes, so there could be community events such as a potluck, special occasions such as Christmas and Easter and occasions where the visitor would want to seek confessional services, as well.

Okay, so let's focus on what is involved in the confessional services.

Sure. Again, to outlay a brief journey for our visitor, they would seek out the clergyman and/or the hours for which this service is provided, they would enter the confessional box, they would reflect, confess and pray, the clergyman would engage with them, they would then leave the box.

Alright. So, we've seen a drop in our confessional services. Can you try to narrow down the reasons?

The reasons could involve the visitor, the clergyman or the infrastructure involved i.e. the box itself. For the clergyman, it could be an issue with experience, trust, or the clergyman is facing some personal issues. For the visitor, there could be the factor of trust again or they are not comfortable. The infrastructural issues could be related to wear and tear of the box, the benches.

This is a good analysis. Issue is with the clergyman's confidentiality. They seem to be leaking information. Before we proceed to the recommendations, I'd also like to tell you that we've also seen a decline due to our praying services albeit minor compared to the confessional issue. What could be the reasons for this?

For the praying services, I can think of problems with the visitor or with the church. The church could have infrastructural issues (internal or external to the church) or issues with the clergy as we have already explored in the confessional services. For the visitor, they might have cultural differences or conflicts with the church proceedings.

The issue is with the internal infrastructure of the church.

Internally, the issue could be with the idol, the seating, the lighting.

The issue is with the benches. They are wooden and have major wear-and-tear which is causing discomfort.

For the benches, I'd recommend to first repair the wear and tear, second would be to replace them with new wooden benches and third would be to get benches of a more durable material.
For the confessional services, we can first, address the issue by conducting an internal investigation, second would be to report this to higher authorities such as a governing body and third would be to conduct sensitization programs with the employees of the church. If we observe the same issue is persistent after the above process, we can look at employee turnover measures.

Okay, we can wrap up the case now.

Footfall of Church

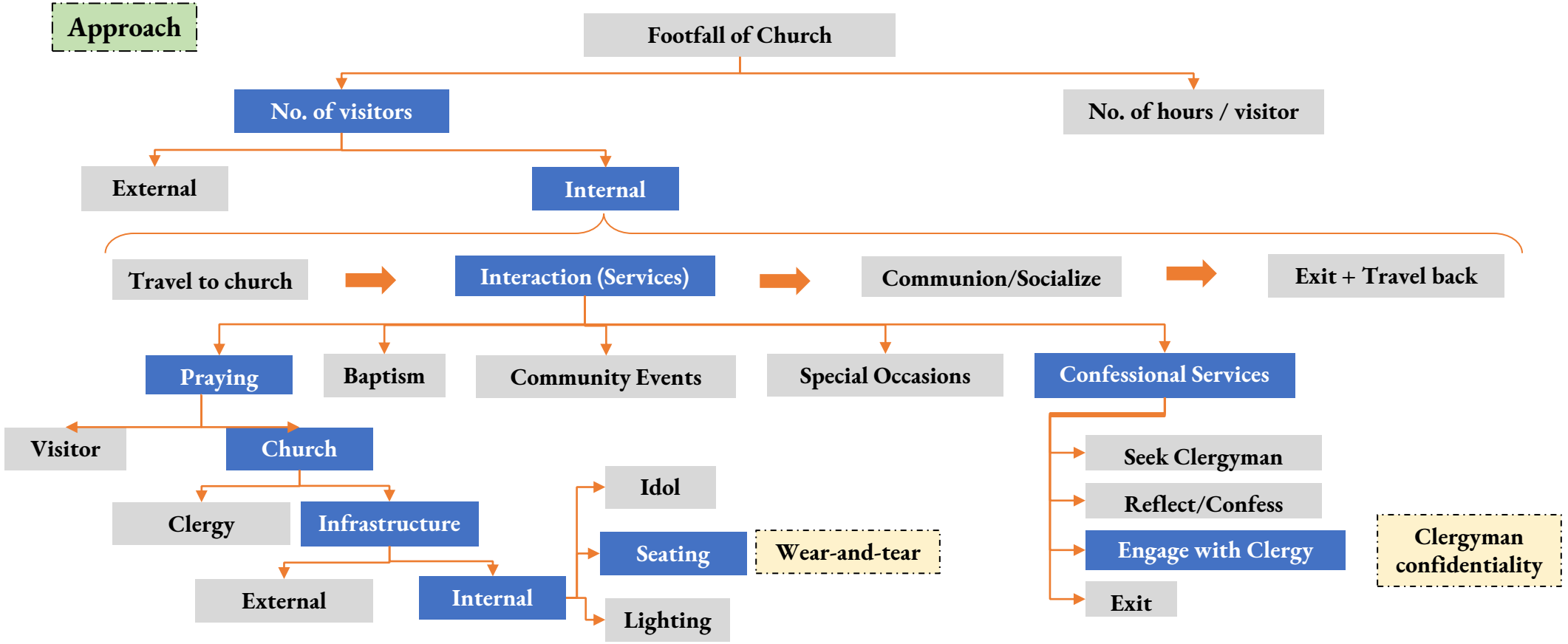
Unconventional | Hard | Bain & Co.

The footfall in a city church has been dropping. You need to figure out what are the reasons and give recommendations on how to counter the same.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Duration** – 1 month
- **Quantum** – ~20-30%
- **Location** – City center. Consider metropolitan city like Delhi.
- **Operational timings** – 9 AM to 5 PM. No peak hours, no changes to timings
- **Visitors to church** – All allowed, no restrictions.

Approach



Recommendations

A. Confessional services

1. Conduct internal investigation to find root of problem
2. Report to higher authorities, like a governing body
3. Conduct sensitization programs for the employees

Re-hire if problem still persists

B. Praying Services

1. Repair wear-and-tear immediately (short-term solution)
2. Replace with wooden benches
3. Invest in benches made of a more durable material

Money Heist

You are a thief planning a robbery. You have pinned down three places which you can rob: 1. A Chai Shop 2. An Archie's Gallery 3. A Luxury Furniture Shop. Which one will you choose and why?

Interesting, what's the objective of the thief, other than of course maximizing the loot?

The thief should not be caught and hence wants you to help out in terms of breaking in & out without alarming the police.

Understood. I would now want to know a bit more about the thief, especially the personal details.

The thief is a middle-aged, healthy man with no family and operates in a tier-2 city. He lives in a hideout outside the city. He doesn't have any major financial dependencies and needs cash for daily spend.

Okay. How experienced is the thief and does he have a police record? Also, what's his skill set and is he a lone wolf or works in a team?

He has been a thief for 7 years. He has never been caught and doesn't have a police record. He is not tech-savvy, uses a basic lever, hammer and cutter to break in. He prefers to work individually but has quite a few contacts in the community. He uses a 125cc motorcycle to get in and out.

Just one more thing, for the robbery, does he look for cash or kind or both? Also, is he interested in pickpocketing as well?

He prefers cash as he doesn't have black market links for selling stolen goods. He is not involved in any P2P activities including pickpocketing.

Thanks for the info. Have there been any incidents recently which would have increased police presence more than the usual?

Good Question. There have been a few robberies in the city mall and neighbouring areas which has increased police patrolling in those areas.

Understood. I would now like to know more about the robbery target places, especially their size, products and location.

Sure. Chai Shop is a small eatery located in a busy street on a crossroad. They sell Chai and Samosa and have no seating Arrangement. Archie's Gallery is a mid-segment gift shop in a congested market area. Furniture store is luxury furniture goods store located on the 2nd floor of the city Mall.

Got it. Also, what are the security measures in place at these stores?

Chai Shop has a metal shutter with a 3-lever lock. Archie's shop has an industry grade glass door and a passcode based alarm system. Furniture Store also has measures similar to that of Archie's, in addition it is located in the mall which has a couple of security guards in place.

Understood. Considering the location of each shop I'd suggest a night time robbery with the assumption that the cash is kept in the cash counter overnight. Should I go ahead?

Yeah, that's a good assumption. Go ahead.

I would like to plan the robbery on the basis of 3 factors: Cash revenue, Shop security & access and Police Presence. For cash calculation, I would like to consider hourly footfall, customer conversion rate, operating hours, avg customer spend and % cash payments out of the total transactions. I would like to assume that Chai shop operates for 12 hrs/day (early morning start) and the other two would operate for 10 hrs./day.

Good, carry on.

Starting with cash assessment, chai shop would have around 25 customers/hr with an avg. spend of Rs. 20 and 75% of them would pay in cash. This gives a daily cash revenue of Rs. 4500. Archie's gallery would have around 10 customers/hr with a conversion rate of 60%, avg spend of Rs. 250 and around 50% cash payments. Hence the daily cash would be Rs. 7500. Similarly, for the furniture shop, the hourly footfall would be around 4, with a conversion rate of 20%, avg. spend of Rs.15,000 and around 20% payments in cash. The daily cash revenue would be Rs. 24,000. Hence, Furniture shop would provide the maximum loot.

Okay. Assess the other parameters.

Right. Assessing security and access, the Chai shop's basic lock and shutter suit the thief's expertise. Furniture shop & Archie's have a industry grade glass door & alarm system which would be difficult for the thief to bypass without tech knowledge. In addition, mall's security deters entry to the furniture shop. Now considering the police presence, due to the recent incidents, patrolling is more frequent near the mall. Although the police presence might be similar for the other two but Archie's - in a congested locale - faces greater vulnerability and CCTV exposure. Considering all these variables, chai shop seems to be the safest bet.

Alright. Give me your final recommendations.

Weighing all the factors, if the thief operates solo, Chai Shop, despite modest returns, should be the preference as it is the safest option requiring no tech expertise. Alternatively, collaborating with a tech-savvy accomplice could make Archie's Gallery a profitable option.

Okay, thank you. Let's wrap the case here.

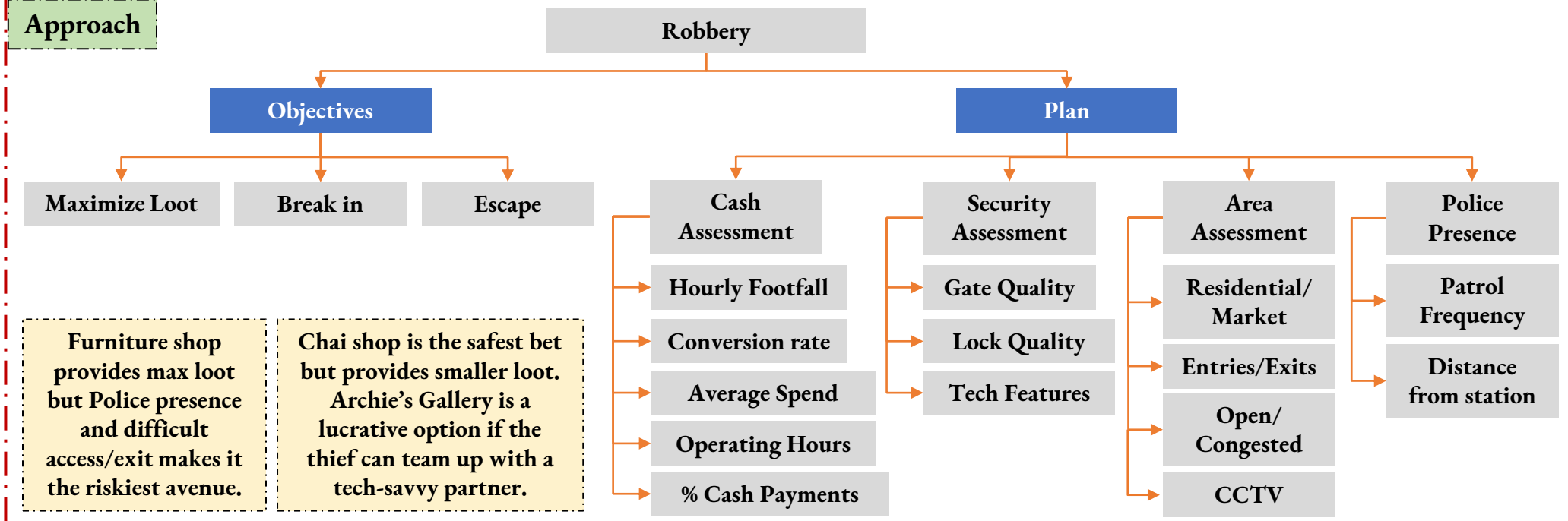
Money Heist

You are a thief planning a robbery. You have pinned down three places which you can rob: 1. A Chai Shop 2. An Archie's Gallery 3. A Luxury Furniture Shop. Which one will you choose and why?

Case Facts & Notes

- **Context** – Robbery planning; Loot maximization and safe breaking in and out.
- **Need** – Cash for daily spend
- **Thief Details** - Middle-aged, healthy man with no family; Operates in Tier-2 city, no financial dependencies.
- **Shop Details:**
  1. Chai Shop: Samosa, Tea; No seating Arrangement; On a busy street;
  - 2. Archie's Gallery: Gift Shop, Mid segment gift items; congested market area;
  - 3. Furniture Shop: Luxury items, high price point; Mall;

Approach



Furniture shop provides max loot but Police presence and difficult access/exit makes it the riskiest avenue.

Chai shop is the safest bet but provides smaller loot. Archie's Gallery is a lucrative option if the thief can team up with a tech-savvy partner.

Cash = Hourly Footfall * Customer conversion rate * Avg. Customer Spend * Operating Hours * % Cash payments

Shops	Cash	Rank	Security & Access	Rank	Police Presence	Rank	Preference
Chai Shop	25*1*20*12*0.75 = 4500	3	On a Crossroad; Metal Shutter; 3-lever Lock	1	Low	1	1st
Archie's Gallery	10*0.6*250*10*0.5 = 7500	2	Congested Area; Dark Street; Industry Grade glass door; Passcode Alarm	2	Moderate	2	2nd
Furniture Shop	4*0.2*15k*10*0.2 = 24000	1	Mall, 3rd Floor; Security Guards; Industry Grade Glass door; Passcode Alarm	3	High	3	3rd

Recommendations

- If working alone, Chai Shop should be the preference (Safest but less lucrative, doesn't require tech knowledge).
- If working with a tech-savvy partner, Archie's Gallery can be a lucrative option (depends on cash division).

Increase in Road Accidents

Your client is a state road and transport corporation and they are experiencing an increase in road accidents. Find all the reasons & give solutions.

Sir, just to be on the same page, our client is a state road and transport corporation and they are experiencing a rise in road accidents. We have to find out the cause of this and give solutions.

There can be multiple reasons. I want you to find all that you can. A state run transport corporation is responsible running government buses in the state. Take UPSRTC as a proxy.

Sir I would like to ask a few clarifying questions.

Sure, go ahead!

Since when are we facing this problem? And is it specific to a single state only?

Number of accidents have increased since 2013. On national level it has decreased.

Thank you! So what kind of services do we offer? Are the number of accidents increasing in all kind of services?

There are 3 types of services - Interstate, Intrastate, Intracity. Yes, all three services are seeing an increase in the number of accidents.

Okay. What about buses? Are all of the same kind? If not, are all facing issues?

Good Question! We have around 12500 buses. There are 20 different kind of buses. 6 new types of advanced buses have been introduced in the past 5 years and sadly, all 20 of them have accident issues.

Okay. What about the service of these buses? How is it carried out?

Good question! We have 250 depots to hold these buses. 80% of them have our own service centres.

Thank you! Just provide me with a couple of minute of gather my thoughts and analyse the problem.

Sure! Take your time.

So, since accidents can be caused due to a lot reasons, I would like to break the problems into internal and external. In internals reasons, I will break them into the bus, the driver, the passengers and the depot. In external, I will classify the reasons into weather, infrastructure and other issues.

Good approach. Lets start with the depot. What problems can you think of?

Before we proceed, I want to include management practices of SRC too. We can look at these in the depot only. So I will break this category into 2 things: the staff, and the maintenance issues. Has there been a decrease in staff at the corporation in the past 5 years?

Yes, so in our industry, staff is defined in terms of crew : bus ratio. It has decreased from 8:1 to 6.4:1 in the last 5 years.

Well this can be one reason. But we first need to establish what is a good crew : bus ratio.

The national ratio is 5. Some states even have a crew : bus ratio as low as 3.5 but are not facing any issues like this.

Okay. Maybe in culmination with other factors, it might be impacting the performance. Lets move to maintenance. What kind of maintenance schedule do we follow?

Good question. Buses are repaired when they are damaged. New buses are serviced regularly but as the bus gets older, the frequency of service and repair decreases. Can you think of the reasons for this?

Maybe as the bus gets older, the cost of repair and maintenance increases due to non availability of parts.

Good. Lets move to buses. As mentioned before, both old and new buses are facing issues. What do you think are the reasons here? Specially in the new buses.

Sure sir, as the old buses are serviced less, they might breakdown more frequently. As for the new buses, may I know where are they being used?

Yes, apart from service and maintenance, can you think of some other issue in old buses. Some along the technical lines. As for your other question, new buses are being used for intracity transport in big cities like Lucknow, Noida.

Well, I know that government has made it mandatory to install speed governors in new public transport vehicles and taxis. This is something that is not available in older buses. So over speeding might be occurring and because of it, the accidents.

Increase in Road Accidents

Your client is a state road and transport corporation and they are experiencing an increase in road accidents. Find all the reasons & give solutions.

Regarding new buses, are they complicated to drive?

Good reasoning for old buses. That in fact is one of the reasons. Define complicated to drive?

Are there too many controls? Any change in physical dimension of the bus?

Yes, the new buses are 13m in length whereas the older ones were only 11m in length. The drivers of the new buses are facing issues in driving longer buses in the dense city traffic.

Since you mentioned drivers, we have till now found two reasons that might be leading to a rise in the number of accidents. One is the lack of training on new buses and the second is over speeding of old buses due to lack of speed governors. Do we have any more reasons to attribute to drivers?

What impact do you think a decrease in the crew : bus ratio might have on long interstate travel buses?

Let me think! Well, less staff means current staff needs to work over longer periods of time. Long distance drives with a single driver might be contributing to more driver fatigue and hence leading to more accidents.

Okay. Good! Lets move to the final header under the internal factors; Passengers. How will they cause a rise in the number of accidents?

Well overloading of buses with passengers could be a big issue. It can result in both distraction of drivers and impact the general safety of the bus.

What if I say that the overall load factor is 70%.

Well then I will need to analyse the load factor of each type of service. Is it uniform across intracity, intrastate and interstate buses?

No it is not uniform. Intracity routes have a load factor of 90%, interstate, a load factor of 60%, but the intrastate buses have a load factor of 125%.

Well, then it will be a contributing factor. Should I analyse external factors too?

Sure, go ahead!

I will like to break the external factors into the weather conditions, the infrastructure and the government management. Would you like me to look into any particular header?

I would like you to deep dive into infrastructure.

Okay, So I can break the infrastructure into roads and other infrastructure. Has the condition of roads worsened over the years?

On the contrary, the conditions have improved drastically in the last 5 years. What would you cover under other infrastructure.

The other infrastructure would be the lighting on the road, the sign boards on the road. Are these properly installed across highways and new roads?

Yes, this is a problem. New roads are constructed but signs are not installed. Lets move to the solutions now.

Alright! There can be multiple solutions pertaining to each problem. Predictive maintenance instead of reactive maintenance for the buses. A proper audit of the maintenance schedules and processes. Retiring extremely old buses and end of life buses from the service. Retrofitting speed limiter devices in all the buses. Training drivers on the new buses. Starting an yearly training program for new buses, processes, routes, rules and regulations. Route Optimization on intrastate routes. Monitoring service wise load factor instead of total load factor to prevent overloading, urging the state government to install signs on the newly constructed roads, installing Navigation systems on the buses.

Great! Good solutions! It was fun doing the case with you. We will move you to the next round.

Thank You! It was a great experience.

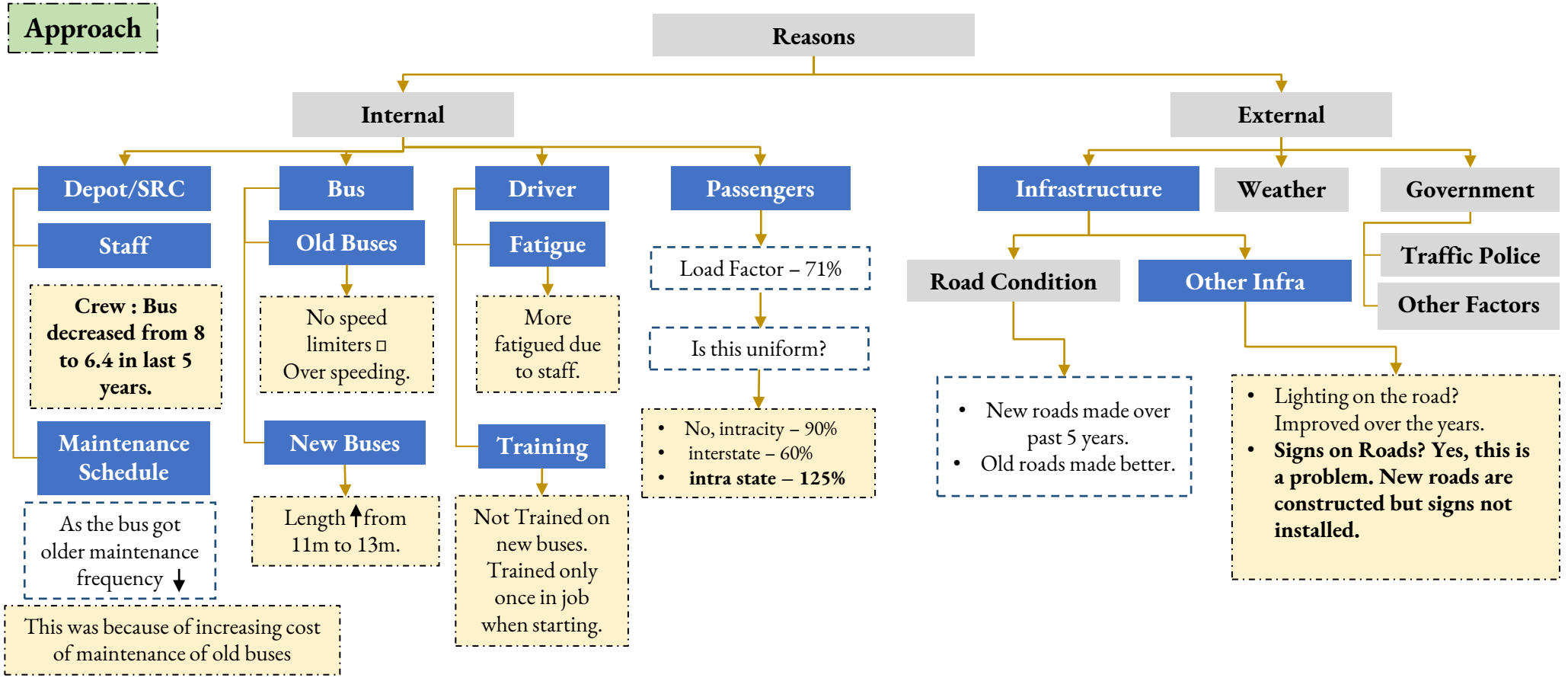
Increase in Road Accidents

Your client is a state road and transport corporation and they are experiencing an increase in road accidents. Find all the reasons & give solutions.

Case Facts & Notes

- State Run Transport is responsible running government buses in the state. Consider UPSRTC.
- No. of accidents have increased since past 5 years. On national level it has decreased.
- Type of service – Interstate, Intrastate, Intracity. Facing accident Issue in all types.
- 12500 buses. 20 different types. 6 new types introduced in the last 5 years. Problem in both old and new buses.
- 250 depots. 80% have service centers.

Approach



Recommendations

- Predictive maintenance instead of reactive maintenance of buses. A proper audit of maintenance schedule and process.
- Retiring Extremely old buses and end of life buses from the service. Retrofitting speed limiter devices on all buses.
- Training drivers on new buses. Starting an yearly training program for new buses, process, routes, rules and regulations.
- Route Optimization on intrastate routes. Monitoring service wise load factor instead of total load factor.
- Urge state government to install signs on new roads. Install Navigation systems on buses.

Swedish Government

Unconventional | Hard | McKinsey & Co.

In the 1960's, the Swedish Govt. wants to switch from driving on the left-hand side of the road to driving on the right. You are asked to chalk out a plan.

Sir, just to be on the same page, the government wants to switch from left hand side driving to on the right. May I know why do want to do it?

The government has observed that cars typically had the steering wheel on the left, leading to increased number of accidents on narrow roads. Thus, they want to switch to right. Many European nations have already shifted to right-hand side driving.

Sure Sir. Since few nations have already shifted, have we also tried attempting it before or is it the first time we are taking this initiative.

This is first time we are attempting it. In past decade, the ideas was voted down several times, so we never reached the implementation planning stage.

Okay, so do we have any timeline in mind? And any other constraints, operational or financial?

We are looking at time frame of 2 years with no financial or operational constraints.

Okay. The way I look at it, to switch to right hand side, we need to look at three key steps to implement it. First, change in the infrastructure, both vehicles and road infrastructure. Second, we need to have systems and processes in place. Third, to ensure that people adapt to this new system. Would you like me to look any other aspect here.

The approach looks good. Let's proceed with infrastructure first.

Sure sir. First, we would need to look at the current vehicles and what segment/percentage of them have right hand side driving?

Most of them are configured to right side except buses.

So, we would need to discuss manufactures and come up with a plan to modify the buses. Coming to road infrastructure, I believe the current system is designed for left hand driving?

Yes, your assumption is correct.

Okay, so we need to revamp the current infrastructure including intersections, traffic lights, road signs, landscaping, entry and exit points. All these would require significant investment. Since, we do not have any financial constraints, I believe the govt. can bear the cost for collective good.

The government can incur the investment. What about the systems and processes?

In systems and process, we need to all the legal aspect of this transition including permissions, following security protocols. Also, since it's a large scale transition, we need to create/revamp different departments to assist with the transition.

The client has sufficient resources and manpower to create new departments.

Coming to people, We need to work on awareness, acceptance and training of the people. For awareness, we can go for mass media advertisements along with use of physical stickers and logos. For acceptance, we need to come up with a long term education program, preferably remote along with physical demonstrations. Third, implement the training exercises for all kind of drivers, both long & short term and also for people who are yet to start driving.

What do you think can be potential risk or considerations while executing the plan?

First, since the idea was voted down several times, we need to consider the possibility of opposition turning decision against the current government. Second, We need to retrain the all drivers. Though younger generation could easily adapt to the change with sufficient training, it would be difficult for elderly and long-term drivers finding to adjust. Thirdly, since we have never attempted this before the government should take recommendations from countries who have already implemented and have similar demographics

Sounds like a good plan

Anything else you would like me to explore?

That will be all. Thank you for your time. Have a great day!

Swedish Government

Unconventional | Hard | McKinsey & Co.

In the 1960's, the Swedish Govt. wants to switch from driving on the left-hand side of the road to driving on the right. You are asked to chalk out a plan.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Objective** - European neighbors had shifted to right-hand side driving. Cars typically have the steering wheel on the left, leading to increased number of accidents on narrow roads.
- **Previous Attempts** - Idea voted down several times in past decades. First attempt to implement.
- **Time Frame** – 2 Years
- **Constraints** - None

Approach

Analysis

- **Infrastructure to be changed**
  - **Vehicles**
    - **Existing**
      - Most already configured to right-side.
      - Buses to be modified.
    - **New**
      - Discuss with Swedish manufacturers to modify.
  - **Road infrastructure**
    - Traffic Lights
    - Intersections
    - Road signs
    - Landscaping
    - Entry & Exit
- **Systems and Processes**
  - Legal Aspects to be covered
  - Different departments to be created to help with transition
- **People**
  - **Awareness**
    - Mass media advertisements
    - Stickers and logos
  - **Acceptance**
    - Long-term education program
  - **Training**
    - Long-time drivers
    - Short & Medium-term drivers
    - Yet to start driving

Recommendations & Risk Mitigation

Retraining
- Drivers to be retrained after initial phase.
- Especially elderly and long-term drivers finding it hard to adjust.

Political Factors
- Explore possibility of opposition turning decision against government.

Learn From Others
- Take recommendations from countries who have already implemented and have similar demographics.

The Dragon at India Gate

There is a dragon in front of you. What do you do?

Before I react, I would like to understand the situation. Is it aggressive? Where are we? Are there people around? And what do we know about it?

We are at India gate. It is evening, the area is crowded, and the dragon is currently calm.

My first priority would be public safety. I would divide my response into three steps: manage the crowd, understand the threat, and then decide what to do with the dragon.

How would you manage the crowd?

I would alert the police and emergency services, create a safe perimeter and gradually move people away from the area. I would avoid creating panic through a sudden announcement. At the same time, I would keep emergency routes clear.

Assume the area is now evacuated and the dragon is still calm. What next?

Before deciding what to do with it, I'd want to understand its behaviour and capabilities. I'd look at five dimensions: 1. Behaviour, Is it aggressive, defensive or curious? 2. Mobility, Can it fly? How fast? How far? 3. Physical capability, Size, strength, claws, teeth, etc. 4. Special abilities, Fire, electricity, venom, etc.? 5. Needs, Food, water, temperature, habitat, sleep?

Suppose it can fly, breathe fire and is roughly the size of a commercial aircraft.

Then I would treat it as a very high-risk threat because of its mobility and destructive capability. I would focus on preventing it from reaching populated areas while trying to understand whether it can be safely contained or relocated.

Now let's change the problem. Assume the dragon is completely calm, responds only to you, and you have somehow established that it does not pose a threat. The government asks you: "Give me 100 ways to monetise this dragon." What would you do?

Rather than immediately listing 100 ideas, I'd first identify the dragon's monetisable assets. I would classify them into: 1. Physical attributes 2. Capabilities 3. Experiential value 4. Scientific value 5. Intellectual property / knowledge 6. Media and cultural value. That gives us a structured way of generating ideas rather than producing 100 random ones.

Can you structure those ideas further?

Yes. I'd create a matrix of asset × sub-asset x end use. Starting with Physical Attributes:
Scales: luxury goods, jewellery, fashion, protective/materials research.
Teeth/claws: materials science, specialised tools, museums, collectibles (where legal/ethical).
Wings: aerodynamics, aviation R&D, biomimicry, education.
Then we have Capabilities
Flight: aviation, aerospace/defence, logistics research.
Fire: extreme-temperature, energy, industrial and fire-resistant materials research.
Strength: materials testing, robotics, heavy-load and industrial R&D.

Okay, great approach, I got the idea. Suppose I tell you that the dragon is actually capable of understanding human language, but it only listens to you. What would you do differently?

That changes the situation quite a bit. The dragon may be a sentient being, not just an asset. Before monetising it, I would understand whether it is self-aware, can communicate its preferences, and is willing to participate. I would also consider its legal status and whether commercial use is ethical. So I would focus on creating value while respecting its autonomy. For example, media appearances or tourism could be structured as mutually beneficial arrangements rather than treating the dragon as property.

Okay great. Now give me your final recommendation in 30 seconds.

My first priority would be public safety. I would secure the area, calmly move people away, involve the relevant authorities and avoid provoking the dragon while we understand its behaviour and capabilities. Once it is safely contained and confirmed to be non-hostile, I would assess whether relocation or controlled housing makes the most sense.
From a commercial perspective, I would start with media, tourism, education and licensing, while exploring longer-term scientific opportunities. If the dragon is sentient, I would make sure any commercial activity is safe, legal and mutually acceptable.
So my approach is simple: secure first, understand second, create value third.

Great, I think we can close the case here.

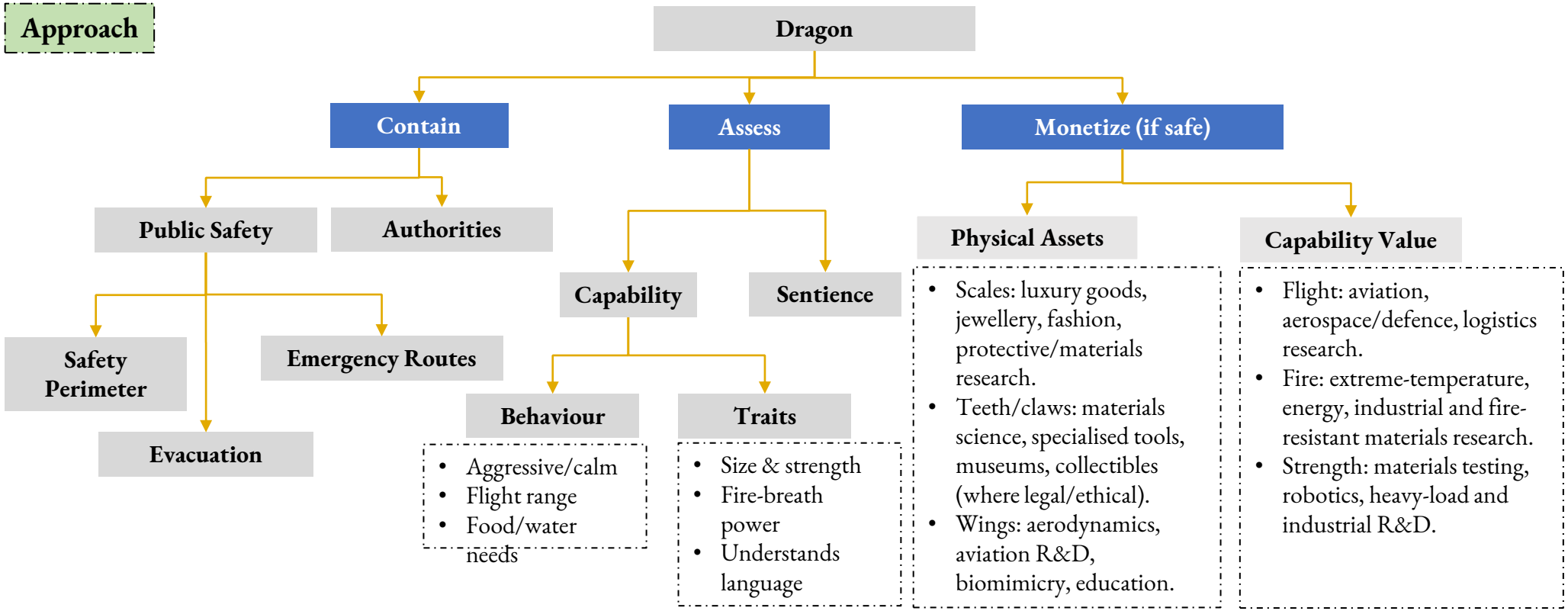
The Dragon at India Gate

There is a dragon in front of you. What do you do?

Case Facts & Notes

- **Setting** – India Gate, evening; crowd evacuated, area secured
- **Dragon** – Calm, aircraft-sized; can fly & breathe fire
- **Twist** – Later confirmed sentient; listens only to candidate

Approach



Recommendation

We recommend a three-step approach: secure the area and safely contain the dragon, assess its behaviour, capability and sentience, and only then monetize ethically. Monetization could be via media, tourism, licensing and R&D partnerships safeguarding public safety and, where sentience is confirmed, the dragon's consent.

Boosting India's GDP Growth Rate

The Government of India wants to raise the country's GDP growth rate from ~6.5% to 9–10%. How should it go about doing so?

Before I dive in, may I clarify a few things about the objective? Over what timeline does the government want this growth, and is there a budget or spending envelope I should work within?

Treat it as a five-year growth strategy. No budget has been fixed, assume the government can mobilise what it needs.

Understood. Are we targeting absolute GDP or GDP per capita? And is there a specific number in mind?

Absolute GDP. We are growing at roughly 6.5% today and the ambition is 9–10%.

That is a large jump. One last thing — does the mandate sit with the Centre alone or with the Centre and the states together, and is any sector in particular in focus?

Centre and states together. No sector has been singled out; the whole economy is on the table.

Thank you. I would like to structure this using the expenditure identity, GDP as consumption plus investment plus government spending plus net exports, and attach levers to each component.

Why that, rather than simply going sector by sector through agriculture, industry and services?

Two reasons. Each expenditure component maps to a policy instrument the government actually has, and the components sum to GDP without double counting, a sector list gives me neither.

Fair enough. Which component would you start with?

Consumption, since it is roughly 60% of GDP. I would split it into a demand side and a supply side, because the two have to move together.

Start with demand. How would you lift it?

Three levers, the RBI cutting the repo and bank rates to lower the cost of credit, income-tax relief that raises take-home pay, and direct transfers targeted at lower-income households, who spend more of every rupee.

If everyone suddenly has more money to spend, won't that just push up prices?

Only if supply cannot keep up, which is why I would move both together — MSME credit through OCEN-style digital lending and PLI support for large industry, so capacity expands alongside demand.

Good. Take investment and net exports quickly.

Investment splits into equity, debt and alternatives — easing FDI norms, infrastructure bonds, and REITs, InvITs and pension capital. Net exports means pushing PLI and trade agreements while substituting imports in electronics and energy. Both matter, but the government moves them indirectly and slowly, so I would treat them as second-order.

Then where is the biggest lever?

Government spending. On the revenue side, widening the tax base, disinvestment and monetising idle assets; on the expenditure side, shifting the mix away from revenue spending and toward capex.

Why does that shift matter so much?

The multiplier. A rupee of capital expenditure generates roughly 2.5 rupees of output against about 1 rupee for revenue spending, and it is the one instrument the government controls directly. I would sequence projects on stage of development, asset monetisability, growth impact and need of the hour.

Well structured. Thank you.

Boosting India's GDP Growth Rate

The Government of India wants to raise the country's GDP growth rate from ~6.5% to 9–10%. How should it go about doing so?

Case Facts & Notes

Client – Government of India — Centre and states together.

Objective – Raise absolute GDP growth, not GDP per capita.

Target – From ~6.5% today to 9–10%.

Timeline – A five-year growth strategy.

Budget – No spending envelope specified.

Scope – Whole economy; no sector or industry singled out.

Sub-question – How to prioritise between competing infrastructure projects.

Structure – Expenditure approach chosen over a primary / secondary / tertiary split; it ties every lever to a measurable component.

Approach

Raise GDP growth from ~6.5% to 9–10% over five years

GDP = C + I + G + (X – M) — attack each component

C | Consumption ~60% of GDP	I | Investment ~30% of GDP	G | Government spend ~10% of GDP	X – M | Net exports negative today
Demand – repo and bank rate cuts, income-tax relief, direct transfers	Equity – ease FDI norms, deepen domestic capital markets	Revenue – widen the tax base, disinvestment, asset monetisation	Exports – PLI, trade agreements, port and logistics capacity
Supply – MSME credit via OCEN, PLI for large industry, logistics	Debt – infrastructure bonds, cheaper credit, bank balance sheets	Expenditure – shift the mix from revenue spend toward capex	Imports – substitution in electronics, energy and defence
Rural demand – MSP, irrigation, agri-tech, allied income from dairy and poultry	Alternatives – REITs, InvITs, pension and sovereign wealth capital	Capex multiplier ≈ 2.5x against ~1x for revenue expenditure	Services – IT, global capability centres, healthcare and tourism

Lead with government capex — the highest-multiplier lever and the one the client directly controls
Sequence infrastructure by stage of development, monetisability, growth impact and need of the hour

Recommendations

- Lead with government capex — the highest-multiplier lever (~2.5x vs ~1x) and the one the client directly controls.
- Fund it by widening the tax base and monetising idle assets, not by deficit alone.
- Pair it with a demand–supply push so the stimulus lifts output rather than prices.

Customer Satisfaction

Case Index | Main Index

Light Bulb Company

Your client is a light bulb firm who sell through 2 channels – trade retailers (90%) and modern retailers (10%). Sales team (DSM) is responsible for selling to trade retailers. Each DSM has an app which tracks every call (visit) and a beat plan (call plan for 20 retailers per sales representative). On an average a DSM makes 15 calls a week of which only 5 are productive (industry average is 8). You have to suggest how they can increase the number of productive calls per DSM.

Ma'am, if I understand correctly, our client is a light bulb manufacturer which is facing low productivity issues in Sales team called DSM. We are clocking 33% conversion where industry average is more than 50%. I have to suggest a plan to increase the productivity of the team.

Yes, you are right. Please go ahead!

First of all, I would like to understand the model of running the team to understand the problem, then suggest a strategy to solve the problem. In that regard, I would like to understand what is the plan followed in a week and how are the clients allocated. Also since when are we facing this issue?

We have been facing this issue for the past 6 months when we included the productivity KPI for the team. Before, we didn't have any metric. As mentioned, the beat plan is used to allocate the clients to DSM every week. It tells when a person has to go to a particular client and which route to follow.

Okay! Which area are we operating in? Is it rural or urban?

We are operating in the Delhi NCR region.

Can you tell me more about the product line. Basically about various type of bulbs available.

We sell a single type of bulb and have been in business for 5 years.

Okay. So to understand the productivity, I would like to look at it from 2 segments:
1. **Total number of calls**
2. **Conversion rate**

Sure that sounds good.

The total number of calls/visits a DSM makes is a function of 3 factors:
1. **Total working hours 2. Idle Time 3. Time/visit and this can be segmented into Transit and Duration of visit.**

The conversion rate depends on major stakeholders: DSM and retailer.
DSM effectiveness can be attributed to her knowledge about the product, frequency of visit and her negotiation skills whereas retailer's willingness will be majorly impacted by the existing inventory, financial benefits and consumer demand for the products.
Is there any area I should focus on or do you want me to suggest a consolidated strategy?

You can develop a plan based on your finding which seem comprehensive to me.

One way of increasing the number of productive calls is increasing the total number of calls per DSM. This can be done by increasing total working hours, reducing idle time (like lunch breaks). The time per visit can also be reduced. Route optimization can help improve transit time.

The industry average is a total of 15 calls per week and we are meeting that, so there is no problem with the total number of calls.

Whether the call is productive or not depends on 2 factors – how well the DSM is doing his job and whether the retailer is willing to buy. DSM effectiveness depends on how well they know the product (training), price negotiation skills and whether they are actually visiting the retailer (can be tested through GPS records on the app).
Retailer willingness to buy would depend on financial incentives (margins compared to competition), end customer pull and whether the retailer actually needs the product when the DSM visits. If the retailer is a small counter where few customers buy, the stock will need to be replenished less frequently as opposed to a large counter. Hence, we could look at beat plan optimization so that the frequency of visits to a retailer is optimum leading to better call conversion.

That is a good strategy. Thank you for your analysis.

Thank you Ma'am for your time.

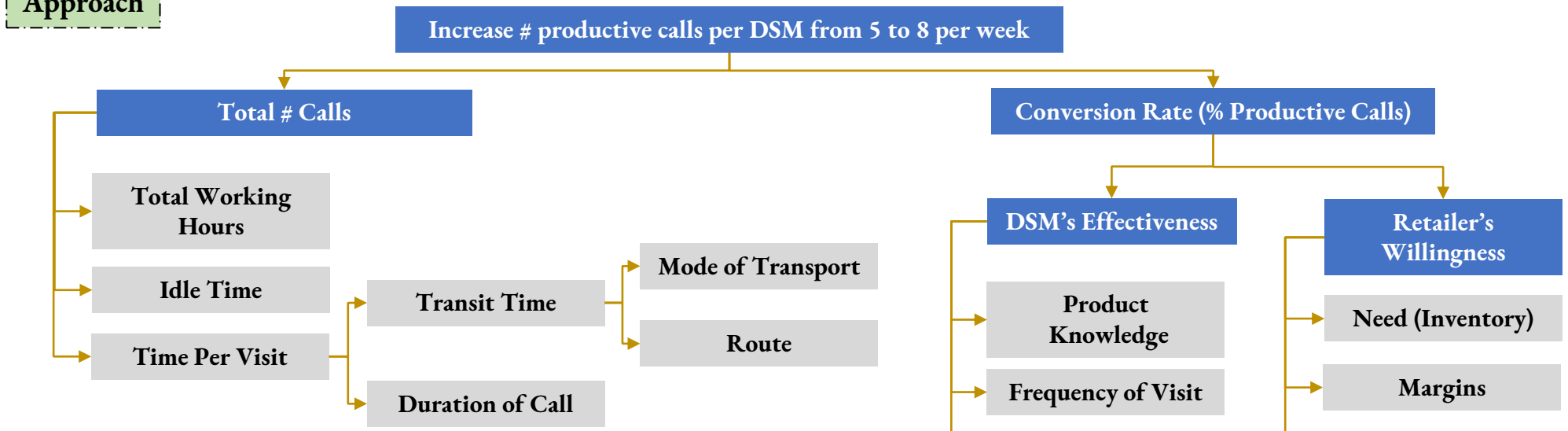
Light Bulb Company

Your client is a light bulb firm who sell through 2 channels – trade retailers (90%) and modern retailers (10%). Sales team (DSM) is responsible for selling to trade retailers. Each DSM has an app which tracks every call (visit) and a beat plan (call plan for 20 retailers per sales representative). On an average a DSM makes 15 calls a week of which only 5 are productive (industry average is 8). You have to suggest how they can increase the number of productive calls per DSM.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Objective**: Find reasons for low productivity of sales team and suggest ways to improve it.
- Delhi NCR based client
- **Customers:**
  - Trade Retailers (90%),
  - Modern Retailers(10%)

Approach



Increase it by-
- **Increasing working hours**
- **Reducing idle time**
- **Route optimization**

Recommendations

DSM effectiveness can be improved by
- Product knowledge
- Training on negotiation skills
- Keeping track of frequency using an app

Retailer's willingness can be tackled by
- Monetary incentive
- Increasing demand via advertisement locally
- Replenishment tracker
- Beat plan optimization synced with replenishment

Bottling Plant

Customer Satisfaction | Moderate | Kearney

A Cola Manufacturer's bottling plant has excess inventory and increased customer complaints. Find out reasons and recommend solutions.

Thank you sir, I'd like to confirm my understanding that our client is a cola manufacturer's bottling plant and they have the problem of excess inventory and customer complaints. We have to find reasons and help fix the issue, Right?

Yes, that's right

Okay, so I had a few questions to clarify my thoughts.

Sure, please go ahead

By bottling plant we mean that the client only does the bottling & no manufacturing of cola?

Yes you're right. The client receives all the made Cola from the manufacturer and their job is to only bottle it into different SKUs and be ready for distribution.

Okay, thank you. Also, I wanted to know if this problem is recent or has been persistent?

We've only recently started to face this problem since the last three months.

Okay, so I would need to figure out what has changed in the last three months to cause this problem. Have competitors also suffered?

Yes, that's right. No, the competition isn't facing this problem.

Okay, so to understand the problem of piling up inventory, I would start by looking at the client's complete value chain and then at each step try to find if any issue exists. Is that fine?

Sure.

Thank you. So, as I understand it, cola would be transported to our plant and then bottling would occur and finally the packaged Cola would be distributed. Is that right?

Yes, that's right. To add to your understanding, before bottling is done, first the bottles are sterilised and then filling is done of the bottles. Only post sterilising and filling is bottling done.

Okay. So I'd like to know if there has been any change in our inbound cola's quality/quantity?

Quality hasn't changed. Just our volumes have increased by almost 2x. Earlier, we used to receive 6000 bottles worth Cola in a day while now we receive roughly about 10000 bottles worth due to summers.

Oh, so maybe in that case it means our demand has increased but distribution has taken a hit which is why customers also seem unhappy.

Yes, that seems fair. I'd like you to find why distribution must have taken a hit.

Okay, so I'll move to the next step. Are our machines able to sterilise, fill and bottle 10000 bottles in a day? If yes, then I would look into outbound logistics, else will drill deeper.

That's a good question. We are not being able to bottle these high quantities demanded.

Okay, so could you tell me if we are running at full capacity?

Not entirely, but almost 100% capacity. We have the capabilities to sterilise 10,000 bottles a day, fill 9000 bottles a day and bottle 8000 bottles a day.

So this means that bottling is a bottleneck. Inventory must be piling up before this stage and we would not have been making enough finished goods to be distributed, leading to complaints.

Yes, that's absolutely right. Could you recommend ways to deal with this issue?

Sure, Sir. As I see it, we could do two things broadly, either fix the bottleneck at out own plant or outsource/shift this process to another plant.

Right, go deeper into the former please.

Okay, so for fixing the issue at our own plant, we can do three things. First, we can install new bottling machines, but that would involve Capex and I'm not sure if that would be feasible only for seasonal demand change. Second, we could share the workload among the other machines that are idle and capable, making it possible to increase production. Lastly, we can work on making sure that we run at 100% capacity by proper QA, however we may still not be able to completely fulfil demand in that case.

Great, that sounds good!

Bottling Plant

Customer Satisfaction | Moderate | Kearney

A Cola Manufacturer's bottling plant has excess inventory and increased customer complaints. Find out reasons and recommend solutions.

Case Facts & Notes

- Kind of inventory – inventory from suppliers
- Magnitude of increase – 2x increase
- Timeline of increase – last 3 months
- Nature of complaints – increased delivery time to customer by 5x
- Reduce inventory and lead times as much as possible
- Production process
  1. Sterilizing
  2. Filling
  3. Bottling

Approach

Reduce inventory and customer delivery times in bottling plant

Inbound Operations

Has there been in a change in the quantity supplied? Why?
Demand has gone up from 6000 to 10000 bottles a day, since it is summer.

Manufacturing

Has there been a change in the manufacturing process?
No

Outbound Operations

Why are customer orders delivered late?

The factory is not producing enough to meet demand, forcing us to cancel some shipments

How does Manufacturing Work?

Sterilize
10,000 bottles/day

→

Filling
9,000 bottles/day

→

Bottling
8,000 bottles/day

New Demand – 10,000 bottles/day
Demand > Supply => Product deficit

Recommendations

The bottling part of the manufacturing process causing inventory build-up leading to customer delays

- **Fix the bottleneck to eliminate inventory build-up**
  - **Move Q&A process before the bottleneck** → By moving the Q&A process before the bottleneck, we can ensure that the bottleneck is being used at max. capacity and hence, maximum product possible is produced
  - **Expand the bottleneck** → Will involve Capex which may not make sense for a seasonal demand surge
  - **Share bottleneck's workload** → Makes sense since the surge is seasonal
- **Outsource process or shift production to another plant**

Telecom Provider

Customer Satisfaction | Moderate | Kearney

A telecom provider in Kenya has seen a major dip in customer satisfaction levels.

Sir, just to be clear, our client is facing a dip in customer satisfaction level and wants to know reason behind it. Any secondary objective I should look for?

Yes, our clients want to increase customers satisfaction levels to retain subscription base

Sir I would like to ask a few clarifying questions.

Sure, go ahead!

What services does our client provide? What about the geography and market share?

Our client provides mobile services, Broadband, customer services. Its clients include both businesses and individuals with country wide operations. It currently owns 40% of the market.

Thank you sir! Regarding the problem – Since when is the client experiencing this problem? Are we the only ones suffering or are the competitors impacted too?

Well they have been experiencing this problem for the past few years. As far as we know, the competitors are not impacted by this problem.

Thank you sir! I would like to know about our operations in consumer service. What all services come under customer service and how does it operates? One of them I believe is customer calls.

So we provide support via call centres. The customer calls are routed via interactive voice response to our call centres where our staff assists the customer with complaint resolution

Thank you sir! Regarding service, I would like to break-down the operations in three steps, first IVR, then customer calls and finally the resolution and post call service.

Sounds good to me.

Coming to IVR, how many options do we have in it? And what are all the relevant options available and how easy is to for the customer to access them?

All the relevant options are available to the customer with options organised in order of most commonly opted to least.

Sir, as per my experience the primary reasons for calling customer center are for information, Requests & grievances. What is the breakup among these three?

Queries, requests and complaints comprises 20%, 20% & 60% of total calls respectively. Queries and requests are above industry average whereas as complaints are below industry average.

Either our services have improved suddenly in past few months, which is unlikely or, customer is unable to get through to customer service executive.

We have observed that complaints not getting through to CC staff, leading to high wait times & lower satisfaction levels.

I see that not being able to reach to CC staff is aggravating the situation. In order to counter it, I propose 1. We can educate the customers about common functionalities and Query or Requests through campaigns; 2. Improve the IVR system and add most common Query and Request option in main menu on a regular basis. For educating customers, we can educate customers through pamphlets, information booths, stores about Q&R functionalities to reduce call volume based on Q&R. Simultaneously we can move customers to digital platforms for Q&R. Incentivize use of these platforms. Both can be implemented in short term.

Sounds like a good plan. What about IVR?

We can implement AI & NLP solution to route customer calls & provide appropriate information. Since it would require considerable effort from tech division, I believe the time required to execute it will be substantially longer than the other two.

I think the client would be willing to implement it as a part of their long term strategy.

Would you like me to delve into resolution and post call service?

That won't be required. We can close the case here. Have a good day!

Telecom Provider

A telecom provider in Kenya has seen a major dip in customer satisfaction levels.

Case Facts & Notes

- **Services** - Services offered – Mobile services, Broadband, customer services.
- **Timeline of dip**– Past few months
- **Competition**- 40% market share. Company specific problem, industry satisfaction at normal levels.
- **Objectives** - Increase satisfaction levels of customers to avoid loss of subscription base.
- **Client Line** - Businesses & Individuals.
- **Country-wide operations**
- **Customer Service** - Calls routed through IVR. Call center with staff for resolution.

Approach

Optimize Operations

Interactive Voice Response (IVR)

The number of options on IVR?
All relevant options available
Ease of access of most used options & CC staff? Low

Customer Calls

Primary reasons for calling customer center are for information (Q), Requests (R) & grievances (C)
Increased average wait time
What are call volume divisions between these?

Query (20%)
Higher than industry avg

Request (20%)
Higher than industry avg

Complaints (60%)
Lower than industry avg

Complaints not getting through to CC staff, leading to high wait times & lower satisfaction levels

Resolution & Post Call Service

- Call center staff capability? - above average.
- No complaint post connection to staff.
- Efficiency & motivation of staff? - Optimal

Recommendations

The customers that call for complaints are not able to reach through to call center staff which aggravates the situation.

1. Educate the customers about common functionalities and Query or Requests through campaigns
   - Short term: Educate customers through pamphlets, information booths, stores about Q&R functionalities to reduce call volume based on Q&R
   - Short term: Move customers to digital platforms for Q&R. Incentivize use of these platforms
2. Improve the IVR system and add most common Query and Request option in main menu on a regular basis
   - Long term solution: Implement AI & NLP solution to route customer calls & provide appropriate information

M&A

Case Index | Main Index

Airline Acquisition

A major airline operator needs advice whether they should make an acquisition to drive up their revenues, and if so, which one.

So our client is a major airline operator needs advice whether they should make an acquisition to drive up their revenues, and if so, which one?

Yes

Sir I would like to ask a few clarifying questions.

Sure, go ahead!

What does the client's business look like, what kind of services are provided by the client and where does it operate?

The client offers passenger services and cargo and is present in all north, south, east, west and central regions the share of revenues of these regions is given in Exhibit B.

What is the objective of our client with this acquisition?

The client believes that broader coverage across the country will lead to an increase in revenues and profitability, so the client wants to diversify its footprint.

What is competitive landscape like, how much market share our client owns and what are other competitors?

The size of the industry has increased from $22.2B in 2010 t0 $29.5B in 2014, up by 25%, even though our revenues have increased, our market shares has gone down, the revenues for major competitors have been given in exhibit A.

Thank you! Just provide me a couple of minute of gather my thoughts and analyse the problem.

From exhibit B we can conclude that Our market share has increased in North, South and Central regions while our market share has decreased West and East regions.

Yes

Since our client wants to gain markets where the company doesn't has low market share, I would like to know the markets of all the competitors.

Competitor A: Major player operating routes that connects major cities across the country as well as connecting them to international destination
Competitor B: Emerging airline player operating flights in Central, West and East regions
Competitor C: Acquired by Competitor A in 2013
Competitor D: Emerging airline player operating in South and Central regions
Competitor E: Emerging airline player operating in North region

Based on insights from exhibits A and B and this data, we can generate a plot between 'degree of overlap' and 'revenue' for every player in the market. This plot will be useful in making a decision as to which player should be acquired. 'Degree of overlap' is an approximate measure that would indicate the overlap of customers between the client and the competitor. Our objective would be to choose a player that has greater revenues and smaller degree of overlap. Is this approach feasible?

Yes

Competitor B has the lowest degree of overlap and has good revenues as well, Henceforth, competitor B would be the recommended player for acquisition.

Okay

Do you also want me to look at operational synergies like aeroplane models.

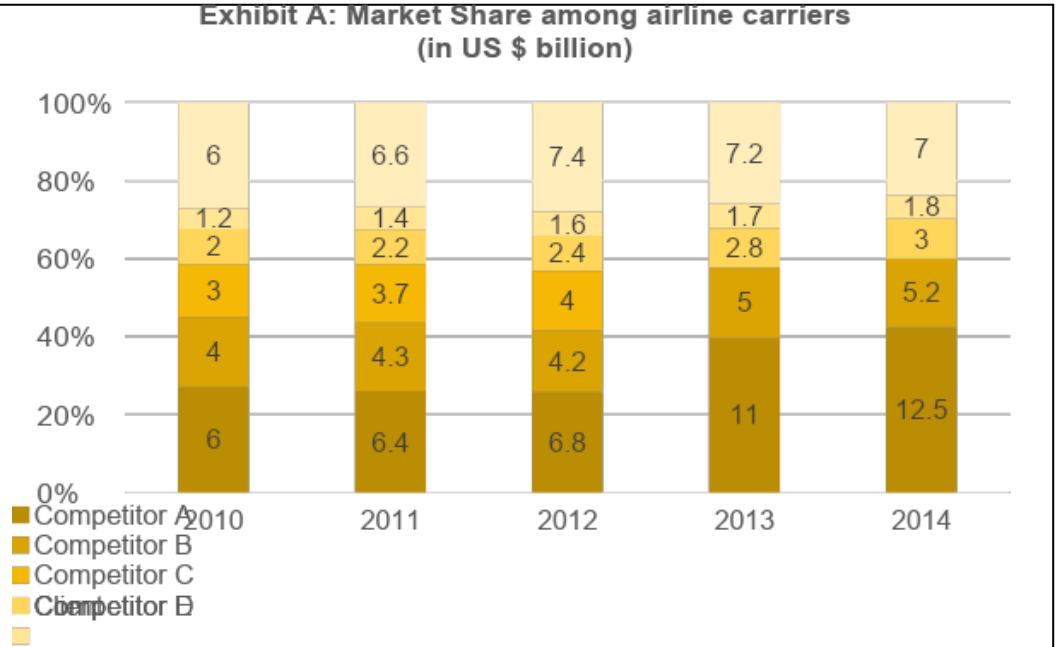
No, these recommendations look good

Airline Acquisition

A major airline operator needs advice whether they should make an acquisition to drive up their revenues, and if so, which one.

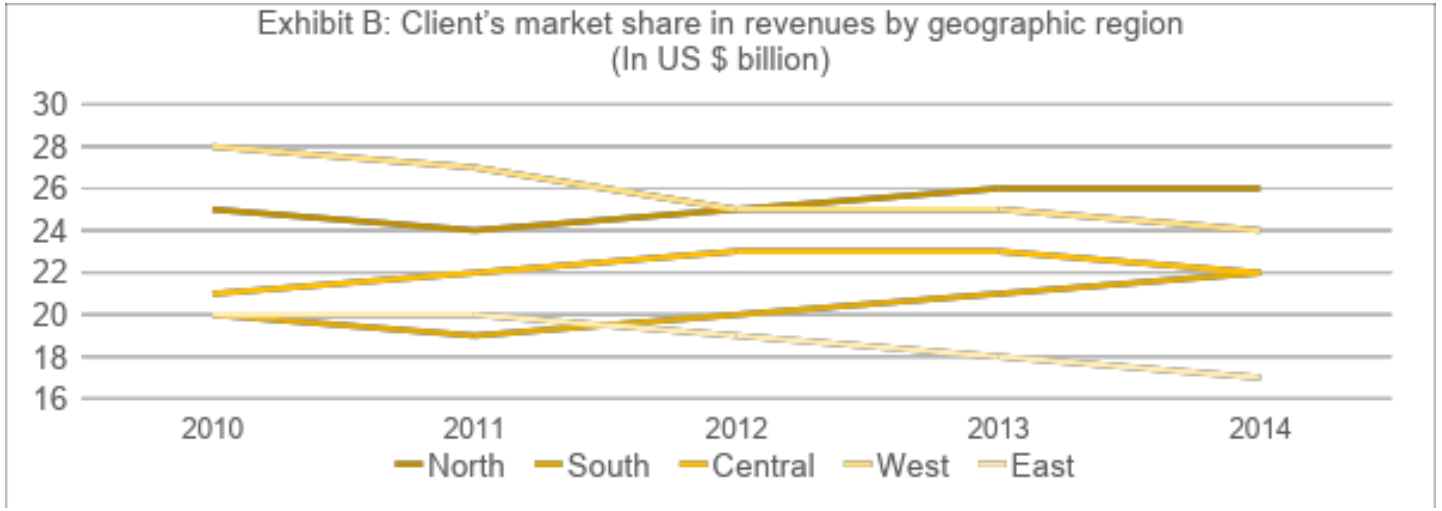
Approach

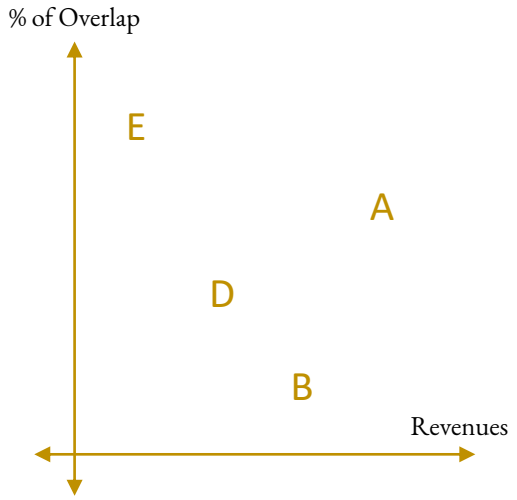
Need for acquisition → (Company + Industry) analysis → Due diligence → Valuation + Financing decisions → Exit strategies



Competitor A: Major player operating routes that connects major cities across the country as well as connecting them to international destination
Competitor B: Emerging airline player operating flights in Central, West and East regions
Competitor C: Acquired by Competitor A in 2013
Competitor D: Emerging airline player operating in South and Central regions
Competitor E: Emerging airline player operating in North region

Insights from Exhibit A and Exhibit B:
- The size of the industry has increased from $22.2B in 2010 t0 $29.5B in 2014, up by 25%
- Even though our revenues have increased, our market shares has gone down
- Our market share has increased in North, South and Central regions
- Our market share has decreased West and East regions





Based on insights from exhibits A and B, we can generate a plot between 'degree of overlap' and 'revenue' for every player in the market. This plot will be useful in making a decision as to which player should be acquired. 'Degree of overlap' is an approximate measure that would indicate the overlap of customers between the client and the competitor. Our objective would be to choose a player that has greater revenues and smaller degree of overlap. Henceforth, competitor B would be the recommended player for acquisition.

Note: Although the primary need for acquisition in this case would be to increase coverage revenues, listing down other possible objectives can help prioritize/decide between different options for acquisition. For example, in case of airline operators, operational synergies can be achieved by acquisition of a competitor which operates airplane models which are already present in our client's fleet.

PE Cosmetic Chain

Your client is a PE firm looking to invest in large chain of cosmetic stores in Australia. Figure out whether they should go ahead or not.

So our client is an PE firm which is looking to invest in cosmetic chains in Australia and I need to figure out whether they should go ahead with it.

Yes

Sir I would like to ask a few clarifying questions.

Sure, go ahead!

What are the objectives for client?

The client wants a 25% rate of return, high growth and a turn around time of 5 years.

What is the product mix of the client?

The client has a new product, a Botox substitute at 20% price. The Cosmetic clinics provide laser hair removal and Botox implants (anti-wrinkle injections)

What are target customers for our client?

The target customers for the client are high to middle income, middle aged women in Australia.

Thank you! Just provide me a couple of minute of gather my thoughts and analyse the problem.

Sure

I would like to first go understand the consumer and what is the consumer journey like, how do they buy, what brands are preferred and what other factors are?

Customer rely on doctor recommendations and no specific brand is preferred and customers will adopt Botox if price is slashed by 50%.

I would like do a market sizing to determine what kind revenues and profits our client can generate out of the business. We have 20 mil Australians, so 10 million women, out of which we can assume 30% can be assumed to be above 40 and 40% of those women can be from upper and middle income groups which give us 1.2 million people. Assuming 10% of that are interested and 60 % of them actually get it, we have 72,000 customers. How much market share we are expecting and what is the cost of our alternative.

We are expecting a 50% market share and the cost is around $1000 and you can expect 30% profit.

So, we have 36,000 customers, revenues of 36 million and profits of 11 million

That sounds about right.

Okay, we can also look at the potential growth drivers such as rising disposable income, reducing cost of cosmetics, adoption of Botox by younger people and lifestyle changes leading to more wrinkled faces.

Okay

When it comes to different risks and synergies, we can tap new customers in and increase volume Sales, growth in market share. But this acquisition will cannibalize the Korean drug and customers might perceive it to be an inferior product because of the low price.

Okay, So what are your recommendation?

Don't invest in the cosmetic chain due to possible cannibalization & reduced profits in future. The client can do a Close Study of Korean Market to understand drug response & launch drug in global markets, launch Korean drug into different markets to gain profits from drug. The client must evaluate other business segment (Hair Removal) as well. Evaluate the scenario & reactions in Korean Market to understand possibilities in Australia – Drug made money in Korea but the cosmetic chains crashed.

Yes, these recommendations sound good.

PE Cosmetic Chain

Your client is a PE firm looking to invest in large chain of cosmetic stores in Australia. Figure out whether they should go ahead or not.

Case Facts & Notes

- Investments in Pharma Co. in Korea
- Pharma Co has a new drug, Botox substitute at 20% price
- Target customers are mid & High Income Group, mostly middle aged women
- Objectives, 20-25% RoR, high growth, turn around time ~ 5 years
- 50% Market Share in Cosmetic Clinics with Company, 20% MS with ASC & 15% with CSC, rest with small players
- Cosmetic clinics provide laser hair removal and Botox implants (anti-wrinkle injections)

Approach

Investment Analysis

Customer Study

- Customers rely on Doctor's recommendations
- No specific brand is preferred
- Customers will adopt Botox if price is slashed by 50%

Financial Analysis

Revenue

Market Size* Mar. Share =120M *60% * 50%=$36M

Costs

70% Operating Cost

Profit = 30% * $36M = ~ $11M

Growth Drivers

- Rising Disposable Incomes
- Reducing Cost of Cosmetics
- Adoption of Botox by younger population
- Lifestyle changes leading to more wrinkled faces

Risks & Synergies

- Cannibalization of new Korean drug in Australian market
- Perception of bad quality due to low price
- Benefit – New customers can be tapped in
- Volume Sales in focus, growth in market share

Distribution Channels

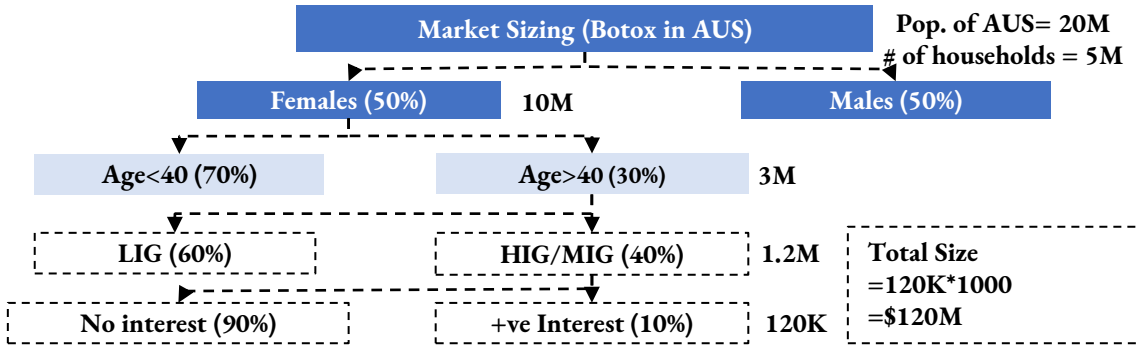
- Dermatologists (40%) - Fragmented
- Cosmetic Chain Clinics (60%) – 50% Market Share with co.
  - Doctors on call
  - Doctors prescribe implant & nurses administer

Pricing

- 4 shots in 1st year - $800 each
- One shot post 1st year - $200 each

Korean Drug

- Perfect Replacement/Substitute
- Lowered price, 20% of Botox, No side effects



Recommendations

- Don't invest in the cosmetic chain due to possible cannibalization & reduced profits in future.
- Close Study of Korean Market to understand drug response & launch drug in global markets, launch Korean drug into different markets to gain profits from drug.
- Must evaluate other business segment (Hair Removal) as well.
- Evaluate other business segment (Hair Removal), Competition (crash). Volume sales increase not enough to offset decrease in revenue due to price point fall.
- Evaluate the scenario & reactions in Korean Market to understand possibilities in Australia – Drug made money in Korea but Cosmetic chains crashed.

Cognac Conglomerate Acquisition

Your client is a global Private Equity (PE) firm evaluating whether to acquire a controlling stake in the world's finest cognac-producing conglomerate, headquartered in India. Should the client go ahead with the bid?

Let me just play the problem back to make sure I've got it right: our client is a global PE firm weighing whether to acquire a controlling stake in an Indian cognac conglomerate that markets itself as the world's finest, and we need to recommend whether they should go ahead with the bid. Before I structure my approach, I have a few clarifying questions across our client, the target, and the deal itself – is that alright?

Sure, go ahead.

First, could you tell me about the PE firm's existing portfolio, their typical investment horizon, and whether they invest only in India or globally?

The fund already holds stakes in a few food & beverage companies globally, including a couple of wineries. They typically hold investments for 5–10 years, and they invest globally.

Got it. And what's the client optimizing for on this deal, and are they looking at a full controlling stake, or would a minority investment also be of interest?

Their single objective on any deal is to maximise returns, and they're specifically evaluating a controlling stake in this case.

Turning to the target – how long has it been operating, and what does the competitive landscape look like?

It's been producing and exporting cognac for the last 10 years out of India. It's a fairly competitive market – a handful of established French houses and a couple of newer entrants, no single dominant player trying to undercut on price.

And what does 'world's finest' actually refer to, and is the company currently profitable?

It's picked up several international awards for quality, hence the 'world's finest' positioning. And yes, it's been profitable throughout its history, with margins gradually improving as its premium positioning has strengthened over the last few years.

Last question on constraints – is there anything specific I should keep in mind, such as promoter or family shareholding requirements, or a fixed timeline?

No major constraints – assume the client has flexibility on deal structure and timeline.

Great, that gives me what I need. I'd like to evaluate this across four buckets: strategic fit, market attractiveness, target strength, and risks & synergies. Does that sound like a reasonable structure to go ahead with?

That sounds great, please go ahead.

Based on what you've shared, this is a strategic-adjacent financial buyer: cognac fits neatly into the client's existing beverages portfolio, which could enable revenue and cost synergies, and the 5–10 year horizon works well for a premium brand that typically needs time to scale internationally. I'll keep that fit in mind as I look at the market and the target.

Good, continue.

Since the target is headquartered in India, I'd like to size the domestic Indian market for cognac and ultra-premium spirits – both to gauge category growth and to see if there's a domestic-expansion angle beyond the target's existing export business. Would it be okay if I built this top-down using population and income data?

Sure, go ahead with your market sizing.

Starting with India's population of roughly 1.4 billion, I'll assume about 65% are adults of legal drinking age, giving ~910 million adults. Premium spirits consumption is largely an urban phenomenon, so I'll narrow to urban adults – say 35%, or ~320 million. Within urban India, I'll take the top income decile – households that can regularly afford ultra-premium spirits – at about 10%, giving ~32 million people. Of these, I'd estimate 30% are regular spirits drinkers, or roughly 9.6 million, and of those, cognac/ultra-premium brandy drinkers – a fairly aspirational, still-niche habit in India – might be around 8%, giving roughly 770,000 domestic cognac consumers. Does that broadly match what you have?

That's a sound process, and a reasonable base to work with.

Beyond the headcount, I'd also expect this segment to be growing quite fast – probably in the mid-to-high teens annually – given rising disposable incomes, a broader premiumization trend among younger urban consumers, and expanding modern retail and e-commerce access to premium spirits, compared with a more mature, mid-single-digit growth rate for the category globally. Does that match what you're seeing?

Cognac Conglomerate Acquisition

Your client is a global Private Equity (PE) firm evaluating whether to acquire a controlling stake in the world's finest cognac-producing conglomerate, headquartered in India. Should the client go ahead with the bid?

That's about right – closer to 15–18% a year domestically, versus mid-single digits globally. Good instinct.

That confirms a real domestic-expansion lever for this asset post-acquisition, on top of its existing export footprint, which I'll bring back when I discuss synergies. Let's move to the target company itself.

On brand and competitive position: the target has a decade of operating history, an award-backed quality reputation that supports premium pricing, and it sits in a rational rather than cutthroat competitive set – all signs of a credible platform to build on, not a distressed or commoditised asset.

Agreed.

And on profitability: the company's been consistently profitable, with margins improving rather than declining, which further supports building on this platform rather than needing a turnaround. I don't think I need anything further here; let's move to risks and synergies.

Continue.

On synergies: the client's existing food & beverage portfolio could give this brand access to established global distribution and duty-free channels, shared marketing and procurement scale, and a playbook for premiumization the client has used elsewhere; and, as I flagged earlier, there's a domestic India growth lever – a fast-growing, under-penetrated cognac/premium spirits market that could add a second growth engine alongside exports. Is there anything you'd add or correct there?

That's in line with what we'd expect – distribution access, both international and the under-tapped domestic opportunity, is probably the single biggest lever.

On risks, I'd flag four: first, revenue is likely concentrated in a couple of export markets, so currency and geopolitical shifts could hit margins; second, alcohol is a heavily regulated category, especially in India where excise and distribution rules vary by state, so regulatory/licensing risk is real; third, if the client pushes hard to scale the domestic opportunity quickly, there's a risk of diluting the premium 'world's finest' positioning by over-extending into mass-market channels; and fourth, the pool of future strategic buyers for a niche cognac asset is fairly small, which could make an eventual exit harder to time well. Would you like me to prioritise any one of these?

No, that list is comprehensive. Go ahead and wrap up with your recommendation.

To summarise: the deal fits the client's existing beverages portfolio and long investment horizon well; the category is growing globally and growing especially fast and under-penetrated domestically in India, giving a genuine second growth lever beyond exports; and the target itself is a decade-old, award-backed, profitable brand with improving margins, competing in a rational rather than cutthroat market. Against that, the main risks – export/currency concentration, India's fragmented alcohol regulation, the risk of brand dilution from over-aggressive domestic scaling, and a thin pool of future buyers – are real but manageable through disciplined structuring and diligence rather than being deal-breakers. My recommendation is to proceed with the bid, conditional on a measured domestic-expansion plan that protects the premium brand, and a disciplined price negotiation once the client's deal team reviews the target's financials in detail.

Great structure and a well-reasoned recommendation. Let's stop here – thank you.

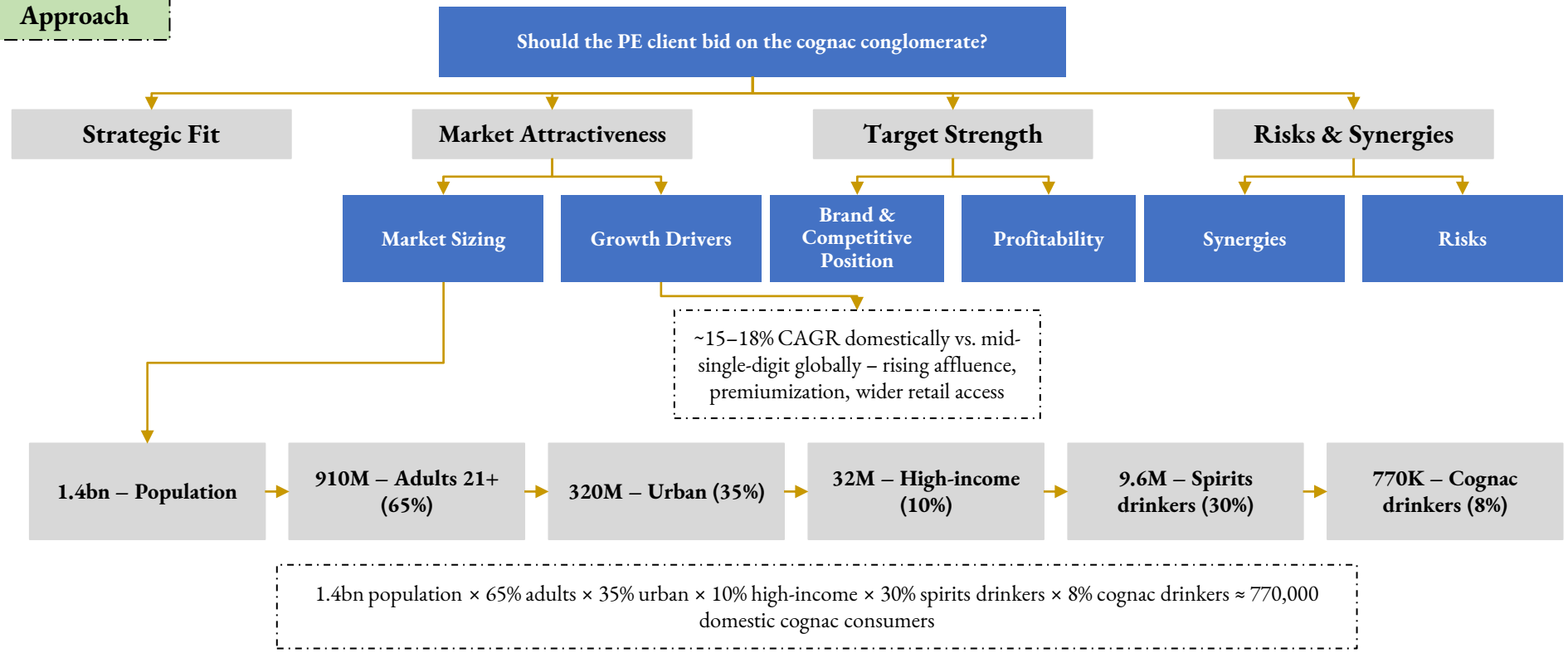
Cognac Conglomerate Acquisition

Your client is a global Private Equity (PE) firm evaluating whether to acquire a controlling stake in the world's finest cognac-producing conglomerate, headquartered in India. Should the client go ahead with the bid?

Case Facts & Notes

- **Client** – global PE firm; food & beverage portfolio; 5–10yr horizon; seeking a controlling stake
- **Objective** – maximise returns; no major deal constraints
- **Target** – cognac conglomerate, HQ India, 10 years old, fairly competitive market
- **Brand** – award-led 'world's finest' positioning
- **Profitability** – consistently profitable; margins improving
- **Market** – domestic India growing 15–18%/yr, well ahead of mid-single-digit global growth

Approach



Recommendations

- **Proceed with the bid** – strong strategic fit, a decade-old profitable award-backed brand in a rational competitive set, and a fast-growing, under-penetrated domestic India market.
- **Condition it** on a measured domestic-expansion plan that protects the premium brand, plus disciplined price negotiation.

Metro Investment in Dubai

Your client is a private equity firm headquartered in USA looking to invest in an infra-asset in Dubai.

Just to re-iterate the problem statement, our client is a PE firm headquartered in USA looking to invest in an infra-asset in Dubai. Is my understanding correct?

Yes, that's correct, please proceed.

I'd like to clarify what is the infra-asset referred to in the case?

The asset is a metro-line between the city centre and the city airport with no stops in between.

I'd also like to understand more about our client. What does their current investment portfolio look like? What would be our client's objective for this investment and what is the initial investment?

Our client has a well-balanced portfolio consisting of different sized investments. They do specialized projects in infrastructure globally (especially in airports, rails.) but they are planning to invest in Dubai for the first time. Our client's objective is to earn at least 15% RoI and initial investment is $1.4B.

I wanted to understand what is the sell-side vs. buy-side dynamics that we are looking at. Are we looking at an asset which is merged with another entity or is it a standalone one? What is the investment timeline we are looking at?

The sell-side partner of this deal is the government who owns the asset and has 2 deals on the table. The first is a 5-year deal wherein there is no subsidy provided. Second is a 20-year deal wherein the government would invest 40% initially. Also, this is a standalone asset with no synergies, and this is a non-competitive bid.

What would the exit process look like?

The exit process will be determined by the government depending on the deal we are opting for. Moreover, we will own and operate the asset for the entire investment timeline. The government will buy the asset once the deal is over at 40% discounted price.

Since RoI is an important factor to consider whether we should invest or not. First, we should look at the RoI and then second, the risks associated (i.e. with respect to the macro-environment or the project itself). Do you want me to focus on RoI or risks first?

Let's explore RoI first. How will you analyse which of the two deals is better?

For RoI, first I'd like to look at the revenue generated and identify the costs and then we can calculate the RoI.

Sure, let's proceed.

First I'll explore the revenues; this would include ticket revenue, revenue through advertisements and other additional sources such as stalls, art galleries, etc. Should I consider each of these revenue heads or focus on just one?

Let's just look at the ticket revenue.

Revenue/day from tickets would be # of passengers/day * ticket price. I'd assume that passengers would be people travelling to-and-fro from the airport and the city. Is this assumption fine?

Yes, this is fine. What will you do next?

Since our passengers are restricted to people travelling in flights, we can consider airport traffic as a proxy to arrive at the revenue figure excluding the airport/airline staff. Is this fine?

Okay, sure.

May I know about the # of runways in the airport? Also, is the airport operational 24x7? Do we have any information about the frequency of take-offs and landings?

Airport is operational 24x7. There are 2 runways, and the planes take off and land every 5 minutes.

So, that would mean in every 5 minutes, we have 2 airplanes using the runway (take-off & landing) which means, by my calculation, that would be 576 airplanes in a day.

Okay, what else would you consider?

Assuming that the capacity of international and domestic flights would be different, do we have any information regarding the break-up of the same?

20% of the flights are domestic. Rest are international. The capacity of domestic flights is 150 and international is twice of that.

Do we have the occupancy rate for both types of flights?

It's 90% for both.

I'd like to find out # of flight passengers/day. My calculations shows that this would be 140k. Now, considering that not all passengers would be travelling to the airport solely by metro-line, we should calculate the % of passengers who would be travelling by metro. Do we have any figure?

No, could you try to estimate the number for this?

Metro Investment in Dubai

Your client is a private equity firm headquartered in USA looking to invest in an infra-asset in Dubai.

I believe that the people coming out of flights can use 4 modes of transport; taxis, private vehicles, metro and some other public transport. Do we have an approximate distribution for this?

We don't have the exact numbers for these, but we do know that 30% of the flight passengers will continue to use taxis, but the passengers using private vehicles will continue using the same. So, can you now estimate the # of passengers using metro?

Since we don't have information about the people using private vehicles, let me try to estimate this number. Assuming all private vehicles need to be parked, we can look at the # of parking slots in order to find out the passengers using private vehicles.

How would you estimate that?

I'll just take a few moments to gather my thoughts.
We can use this formula:
of parking slots * [total time i.e. 24 hours / time per slot] * (% of slots filled) * (# of passengers / car). I'd also include the assumption that we are not considering time value of money for ease of calculation

you can assume that there are 20 levels in the parking area and at each level there are 50 cars. Each car is parked for 20 mins. Occupancy rate of the parking slot is 90%. Assume that the # of passengers/car is 1.1.

Okay. This gives me around 72k passengers. The expected number of people travelling via metro per day would be (140k) – 72k – 42k = 26k / day. Then 9.36M passengers would be travelling / year.

Okay, this is great! You can continue.

In order to get to the revenue, we'll have to know the price of the ticket. Do we have this data available?

Could you do the deal analysis to find the ticket price?

So going back to the objective, the RoI should not be less than 15%, which gives us the following formula: 1.15 = [(Revenue – Costs) * time + Sell value] / Initial investment.
Let me calculate the sell value first. Sell value is 60% of our initial investment as government purchases it at a 40% discount which gives us $840M. Revenue for one year, as calculated before is 9.36 * x where x is the selling price, which we need to calculate. But we will be needing the value for costs, do we have that number with us?

Okay, sure. The operational cost is expected to be $ 90 M per year. What would you do next?

Calculating the selling price for 5 years, it's ~ $26/ticket and for 20 years, it is ~$10/ticket.

Now that you've calculated the selling price, could you tell me which of the 2 deals is better?

Sure. In order to choose the better deal may I know the average taxi fare incurred by a flight passenger, since taxi users more likely to switch to the metro. This will only happen if there is some added benefit to make make that switch which is cheaper fare than taxi or some value addition such as less time.

Great. The average fare for a taxi from the city to the airport is around $15.

In that case the 20-year deal is better because because there is a steep difference between the prices and hence the passenger is more likely to switch to taking the metro in order to save money as compared to the 5-year deal where the metro is more expensive, and we are less likely to capture the consumers who prefer taking taxis.

Yes absolutely. I think this analysis is extremely thorough. I think we can wrap up this case.

Metro Investment in Dubai

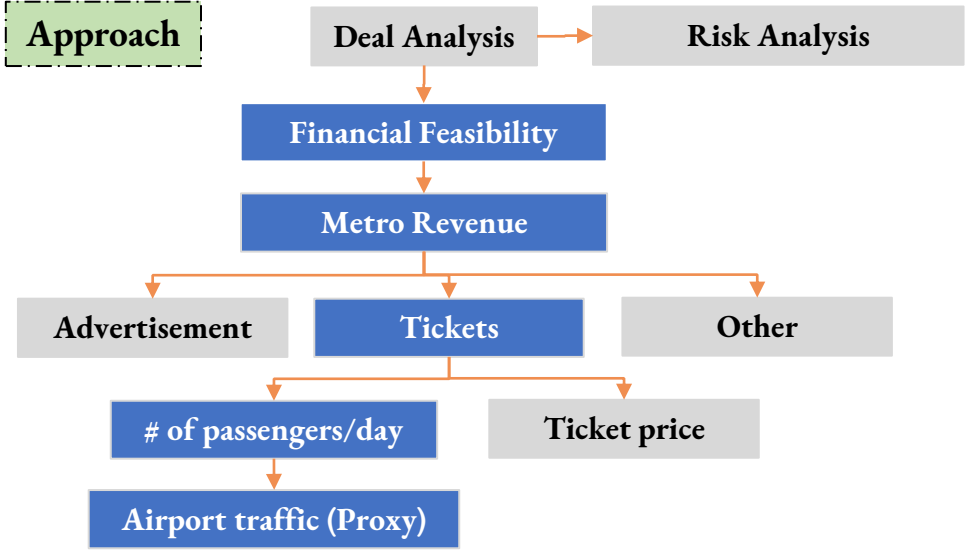
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Case Facts & Notes

- **Objective** – earn at least 15% RoI on initial investment $1.4B.
- **Company** – US based PE firm, specialize in infra projects, first project in Dubai
- **Deals** – 1) 5 years with no subsidy, 20 years with 40% subsidy by the gov. (Standalone), Gov to buy the infra at 40% discount
- **Customers**- People going to the airport from the city
- **Competitors**- Non-competitive bid

- **Airport** – 2 Runways,24X7, Landings/Takeoffs every 5 mins, 20% Domestic flits – 150 seats, 80% International flights – 300 seats, 90% occupancy rate
- **Taxis** – 30% travelers take taxis
- **Parking Slots** – 20 floors with 50 slots each, average parking time is 20 mins, 90% occupancy
- Skip risk analysis
- Assume share of Other public transport is negligible

Approach



Total Flights =
#runways * frequency of takeoff/landing
= 2 * ((60/5) * 24) = 576

Domestic Passengers = Domestic flights * Occupancy * No of seats
= (0.2 * 576)*(0.9 * 150)
= 15,552

Domestic Passengers = Domestic flights * Occupancy * No of seats
= 0.8 * 0.9 * 300 * 576
= 1,24,416

Total Passengers at the airport in a day
= 1,39,968. ~ 140000

How do passengers commute to and fro from the airport?

- **Taxis** → **0.3 * 140K = 42 K**
- **Private Vehicles** → **Parking Slots (Proxy)**
- **Metr**
- **Other Public Transport**

Private Vehicles Arriving at the airport
= # of parking slots * [total time = 24 hours / time per slot] * (% of slots filled) * (# of passengers / car).
= (50*20) * ((24*60)/20) * 0.9 * 1.1
= 71,280 ~ 72000

Expected no of people travelling by the metro
= (140k) – 72k – 42k = 26k / day

Expected no of people travelling by the metro annually
= 9.36 M

Metro Investment in Dubai

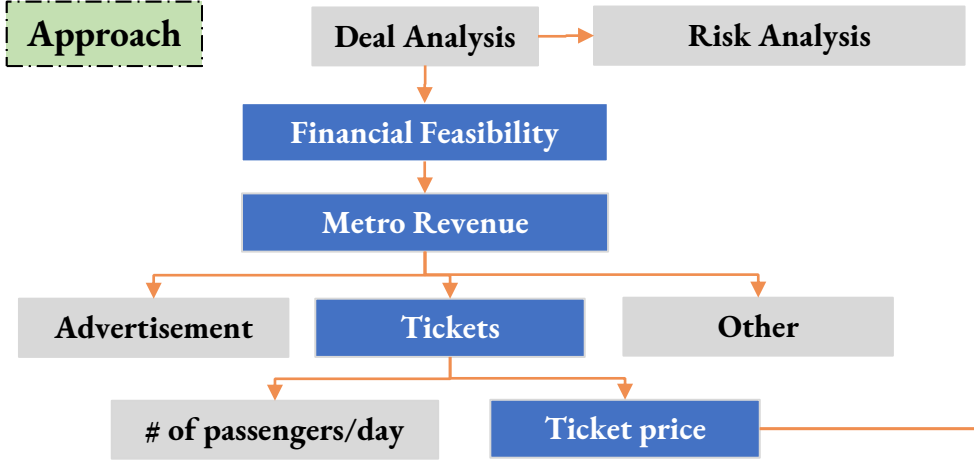
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- **Customers**- People going to the airport from the city
- **Competitors**- Non-competitive bid

- Revenue = 9.36 * price per ticket
- Operational cost = $ 90 M
- Sell Value = 40% of Investment = $ 840 M
- Average taxi fare to the airport is $ 20

Approach



Compare the ticket price with the avg taxi fare to the airport in order to determine which deal is better in terms of capturing the taxi taking customers

Avg price of taxi = $ 20

5-year deal

ROI = 1.15 = [(Revenue – Costs) * time + Sell value] / Initial investment.

1.15 = [(9.36 * X – 90 M) * 5 + 840] / 1.4 B

X = Ticket Price = $ 26

20-year deal

ROI = 1.15 = [(Revenue – Costs) * time + Sell value] / Initial investment.

1.15 = [(9.36 * X – 90 M) * 20 + 840] / 840 B

X = Ticket Price = $ 10 / ticket

Recommendations

- 20-year deal is better because because there is a steep difference between the prices ($ 20 Vs $ 10) and hence the passenger is more likely to switch to taking the metro in order to save money as compared to the 5-year deal where the metro is more expensive, and we are less likely to capture the consumers who are taking taxis currently.

Due Diligence

Case Index | Main Index

Coffee Shop

Your friend is selling his coffee shop in Delhi, for Rs. 10 lakh as he is not able to meet his ends meet due to COVID situation. Will you buy it?

I would like to clarify a few things before I start analyzing the case

Sure

Can you tell me the size and locality of coffee shop? Are there any competitors nearby. What kind of products it sells. Do we provide deliver services? Who are our common customers?

The coffee shop is just outside a college campus in a decently busy area and hence sees a lot of college students as its major customers. There are no competitors nearby. It sells hot coffee, pastries and mineral water bottles. We only provide dine-in facilities with limited seating capacity, just enough to accommodate maximum customers that the café sees at a time.

Alright. So, when we talk about buying the coffee shop, what all are we actually buying? Is it just the café business or will we also own the shop and some other fixed assets like table, chairs, coffee machines?

Your friend does not own the shop. However, you will own the other fixed assets, everything that is required to run a coffee shop. You are buying the business and the brand name.

Thank You Sir. According to my understanding the reason for my friend not being able to make his ends meet is decline in customer due to lockdown and social distancing. So, is it safe to assume that we will be able to earn revenues only after 2-3 months after we buy the shop. Also, will the business return back to its normal form post covid?

Yes, you are right in assuming the business will return back to its normal form that was pre-covid times.

Lastly I would like to know my source of capital given that I am currently a college student and I would be broke majority of the time.

You will have to take a loan to invest 10 lakh in this business.

Thank You Sir. In order to analyze if I should be buy the business, I would like to analyze the financial capability, operational feasibility and certain other associated risks. In financial capability I would like to calculate the revenue, cost and profit and hence calculate the break-even period. In operational feasibility I would like to assess the value chain of the business. Risks are some possible situations that can occur which will hamper our business.

I would like you to concentrate on financial capability first and then go ahead with calculating the potential risks with the business.

Ok Sir. In order to calculate the break even period I would like to know the revenue that the business was earning pre-covid times in terms of number of customers, number of units sold per customer and price of each of the different units.

Hours of the day	# Operating Hours		# Customers (per hour)	Products	Perc of Customers	Price per unit
	Mon-Fri	Sat		Hot Coffee	60%	40
Peak	4	12	20	Pastries	30%	30
Non-Peak	8	0	10	Water Bottle	10%	20

Thank you for the information. Now I would like to know the cost incurred by the company in terms of variable cost that is the cost incurred per unit of a product and fixed cost like Rent, Workers Salaries, Utilities, Maintenance and any other cost.

Rent is 5000 per month. There are 2 workers, combined salaries for whom is 11,520 per week. Variable cost incurred per unit is 50% selling price per unit. Consider utilities and maintenance to be covered in rent itself.

Alright. Now that I have all the information I would first calculate the revenue, cost and profit per week and then calculate the time period in which I will be able to break even my investment. Let me know if you would like me to consider the NPV of the cash flow to calculate B.E.P. Also, since I am only considering Gross profit, the period that I calculate will be lesser than the actual time taken to break even the investment. Hence, I will need the information on the value of fixed assets, depreciation amount per year and interest on the loan of 10 lakh rupees to calculate PBT.

You can ignore NPV for the simplicity of calculation. Value of fixed assets is Rs. 1,00,000 with a depreciation of 10%. Consider interest of 12% on the loan..

Coffee Shop

Your friend is selling his coffee shop in Delhi, for Rs. 10 lakh as he is not able to meet his ends meet due to COVID situation. Will you buy it?

Sure Sir. Now, I am done with my calculation. I got revenue per week as Rs. 36,400, cost as Rs. 30,970/week and hence gross profit of Rs. 5,430/week. Depreciation per year is equal to 10,000 which equals to Rs. 192 per week. The interest on loans is equal to 1.2 lakh per annum and Rs. 2,310 per week. Deducting depreciation and interest we get PBT as Rs. 2,928/week. Calculating BEP on Profit Before Tax we get ~341 weeks and ~6.5 years in which we will be able to break even our investment.

Good. Now analyze this break even period and other risks that the business will face and tell me if you would buy the business.

I would like to list few potential risks in the business. First one is the customer behavior Post-Covid times, which is most probable to change against the concept of dining out. Second is the threat of new entrant. Given the break even period is large we can expect new competitions to open in nearby areas. Third is the limited seating capacity, which restricts the expansion of café in terms of number of customers. At this stage I would suggest that we don't buy the coffee shop.

Sounds Good. Let us assume you really want to help your friend and decided to buy the shop. How will you make sure that you reduce your break even period.

We can reduce the break even period by increasing the revenues or decreasing the cost. To increase revenue – 1. Start online ordering and delivery services to attract more customers, 2. Increase product portfolio like snacks, chips, cold beverage 3. Open café on Sunday only during the peak hour, 4. Offer credit facilities given college students are usually broke, 5. Improve customer experience by including music, quirky quotes, games like Jhenga, Rubix cubes. To decrease cost – 1. Renegotiate worker's salaries, 2. Negotiate with suppliers to give discounts on materials required for coffee and other products.

Okay. We can wrap up the case now. Thank you.

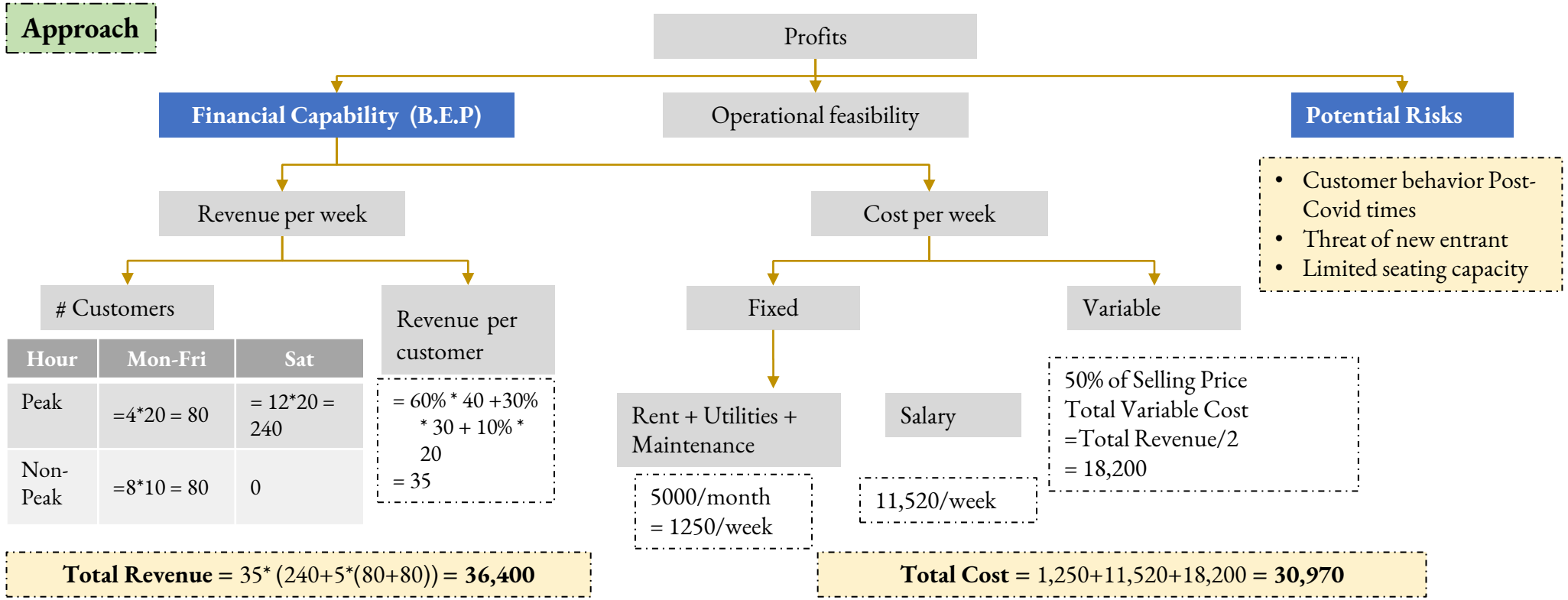
Coffee Shop

Your friend is selling his coffee shop in Delhi, for Rs. 10 lakh as he is not able to meet his ends meet due to COVID situation. Will you buy it?

Case Facts & Notes

- **Coffee shop**– Small with Limited seating capacity, No competition nearby.
- **Customer**– College Student
- **Product** – Hot coffee, Pastries and Water Bottle
- **Source of Capital** – Loan at 10% interest rate.
- **Value of Fixed Assets** – 1,00,000 at 10% depreciation
- Business will resume back to normal Post –Covid

Approach



Hour	Mon-Fri	Sat
Peak	=4*20 = 80	= 12*20 = 240
Non-Peak	=8*10 = 80	0

Total Revenue = 35* (240+5*(80+80)) = **36,400**

Total Cost = 1,250+11,520+18,200 = **30,970**

Recommendations

- I **will not buy** the coffee shop due to long B.E.P and the potential risks that business can face
- In case we have to buy the shop we can do the following to reduce the break even period
- **Increase Revenue** - Start online ordering and delivery services to attract more customers, Increase product portfolio, Open café on Sunday, Offer credit facilities, Improve customer experience
- **Decrease Cost** - Renegotiate worker's salaries, Negotiate with suppliers

Particulars	Amount
Gross Profit	5,430
Less Depreciation	- 192
Less Interest	-2,310
PBT (per week)	2,928

Break Even Period =
10,00,000/2928
= 341 weeks
~ 6.5 years

Fantasy Sports App

Our client is a VC firm and wants to conduct due diligence of a fantasy sports company. They want your help in doing the same.

So our client is a Venture Capital firm that wants our help with conducting the due diligence of a fantasy sports game? Does the client also want us to determine how much they should invest?

No, the client doesn't require us to determine how much to invest.

Okay before I dive into the analysis, I'd like to enquire about the fantasy sports company – their services, their business model, previous funding, operating locations and about the VC firm – their pre existing portfolio, their intention with this investment.

Sure, go ahead!

For the fantasy sports company, I am assuming it is an app which allows users to make their own imaginary teams. Which sports does the app include and is it available to global users?

Your understanding of fantasy sports is right. Currently the app only has cricket and while users across the globe can access it, the main target is the Indian market.

Okay, how long has the app been in the market and what is its current business model?

The company has been around for the past 4-5 years, and is now in its growth phase. It has a freemium model, so it earns via the paid users and via advertisements.

May I know what is the number of free & paid users and also if any other firms have previously invested in the company?

Around 90% of the 5cr users are on the free model. The company has previously received early stage funding.

Now I'd like to know about out client. What type of previous investments have they made and is this investment likely to cannibalise market share? I'd also like to know whether our client intends on selling their stake in the company at a later stage or just be an equity partner?

Our client has made investments in some entertainment companies, including a score checking app but don't expect this fantasy sports app to eat into the market share.
They plan on selling their stake at a later stage but till then they want to maximise the profit and the company is also willing to let our client to make changes for this.

I'm planning on first analysing the industry and the growth potential for the company in the same, followed by analysing how this investment aligns with other investments of our client, then look at ways to maximise profit followed by looking at the exit options. Is that fair?

You can leave out the exit options.

First I'd like to calculate the current size of the industry, considering only the Indian market. From my understanding this app would mostly have users in the 18-35 age demographic. I'll consider about 80% of this population has access to internet/smartphone.
Taking into consideration the gender split and percentage penetration in each gender, the market size comes out to be around 12cr users. Given that the app's current user base is 5cr and the same users may download multiple apps, there is quite some room for growth. Moreover the penetration rate of each segment can also be increased, indicating a greater potential

Anything else that you'd like to analyse for the industry?

I'd also like to understand the competitor scenario, and if there are any laws or regulations that may inhibit growth of this industry?

There are a few competitors, but this company is a leading player right now. There aren't any regulations against fantasy apps but many are questioning its legality – whether it is gambling or not.

Okay, so that seems like a major risk factor. Other than that, the industry seems lucrative, with the size likely to increase as market penetration increases. Since cost of entry is low, it is likely to see some more competitors entering in the market.
Should I now go ahead with analysing our current portfolio and how this company aligns with it?

Why do you feel the need to analyse this?

We've ruled out cannibalisation, but I'd still like to see if there are any benefits or losses the rest of our portfolio is likely to face from the fantasy sports company.

You can go ahead then.

The fantasy sports company is not likely to have much effect on most entertainment companies, but if there are other online games in the portfolio they might be affected. We can also work towards

Fantasy Sports App

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leveraging the fantasy sports app to increase our score checking app usage and vice versa.

Okay what else?

I'd like to next move onto seeing how we can maximise the profits for the company. We can do this by working on either of the two lever – revenue and costs. I'd like to proceed with revenues first as it is a growing market and potential for revenue increase would be high. Is that okay?

Sure, go ahead!

Okay, looking into revenues we can either increase number of users or ARPU (average revenue per user). I'd like to look into number of users first. I can think of 4 broad ways to do so – app related changes, promotions, acquisitions of other players and diversification into new geographies, other games.

Currently the fantasy sports platform is not in the capacity for acquisitions. Diversification would also strain the financials, moreover the company wants to focus on its core operations as of now.

Now it makes more sense to look into the first two alternatives only. For app related changes we could either make UI/UX changes or provide more/better features than the competitors like easier transfer of winnings, in-app purchases.
They could also increase promotion activities – get cricketers to promote the app, become partners for cricket tournaments, have experience centres (kiosks) in stadiums, malls.
We could also create a linkage between this app and the score checking app that the client has invested in. The users of score checking app can be given advertisements for the fantasy sports app and vice versa, increasing user base for both.

Okay, can you now analyse how we can shift our users from the free model to the paid model?

Yes, the other way to increase revenue would be to try to shift users to paid model. We should also try to restrict paid customers from shifting back to the free model.
To do the former we could try to either increase benefits in the paid model or restrict usage in the free model. Benefits of paid content could include allowing changing of teams, no restriction to number of games played, access to premium content. We could also try to put restriction on the winnings, games, player changes in the free model to encourage shift to the paid model. At the same time, something extra would have to be provided in the paid model to minimise
shifting back to the free model. For this, a loyalty programme could be introduced or the aforementioned benefits provided.

A major reason for switching back to free model is the fact that users lose money even though they are paying for the services. How can we counter this?

We could devise a system in which even if a user is not winning they are given rewards, say on the basis of number of games they play, the score they make. This would ensure their likeliness of getting benefits.

Okay, anything else we can do for profit maximization?

We can also look into the costs, which according to me would be divided into 3 components – app maintenance and development costs, supports costs (e.g. customer support) and promotional costs.
As the company tries to increase its revenues it is likely to see an increase in these costs. We can however look to optimize the costs. When user base grows large enough, customer support staff can be replaced by chatbot services. Another thing, the company could look into having its promotion targeted to a specific audience only – reducing channels, hence reducing costs.

Okay that seems fair. Can you summarize your entire analysis and give your top 3 recommendations to increase profits.

We were asked by our client to do the due diligence of a fantasy sports company. In doing so we realized that the industry has a huge growth potential, has certain legal risks but due to ease of entry is likely to see an increase in competition. This investment will be complementary to our client's past investments and hence on the basis of these parameters we conclude that it might be good for the client to invest in the fantasy sports company.
We also looked into ways to maximize profitability for the company, and to me the top 3 ways seem to be – increase number of customers via promotional activities (getting cricketers onboard for advertisements and promoting cricketing events) and by increasing the conversion from free to premium users by providing added benefits in the paid version.

Fantasy Sports App

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Case Facts & Notes

- VC firm past investments in entertainment companies including score checking app
- Fantasy sports company – app where users make imaginary team and win on basis of their real life performance
- Current target market: India
- Sport: Cricket
- Launched 5-6 years ago
- Freemium model. 90% of 5 cr users on free model

Recommendations

- Good potential to grow, however competition likely to increase, some legal issues
- To increase profits primary focus should be on rev increase via increasing user base (growing mkt)
- Increase promotion & improve app; simultaneously focus on increasing paid base

Approach

Due Diligence

Industry Growth Potential

- Current ind. size: 12 cr
- Competitors: few; likely to increase with ↑ing mkt penetration & ease of entry.
  Co. one of the largest players
- Legality in question (gambling?)

Alignment with past investments

- Past investments in ent co.'s , including score checking app
- Investments would be complimentary

Profit maximization

- Increase rev or dec costs
- Growing industry, better to inc rev
- Inc no. of users or %age of paid users

Exit options

- Barriers to exit
- Potential purchasers

Industry Size (Fantasy Sports Company) — Pop. of India = 1.35B

- <18 years
- 18-35 years
- >35 years

% age of population = 40%
Population = 540M

- Male: % age of pop.= 50%, Penetration = 40%, 108M
- Female: % age of pop.= 50%, Penetration = 5%, 13.5M

~ 120M

Profits

Revenues

No. of customers

App related

- UI/UX changes
- Features: easy transfers, customizations.

Promotional

- Have cricketers promote
- Tie up with cricket tourn.
- Experience kiosks

Acquisitions

- Acquire smaller comp./ company catering to diff. market

Diversification

- Entering other geog.
- Including other sports

Revenue per user

Free to premium

- Restrict usage in free model (no. of games, winnings, customizations.
- Special features/content only for premium players

Restrict to premium

- Main reason to switch back – not winning
- Premium users to get more rewards (for a certain score, no. of games played etc.

Costs

App dev. & maint.

- Need to incur these costs to grow
- Likely to stabilize after market becomes mature

Support services

- Customer support, admin costs
- Replace w/chatbots

Promotional

- Targeted promotions over mass promotions
- Reduce no. of channels

Part J – Appendix

Main Index

Glossary

S.No.	Term	Definition
1.	Backward integration	A form of vertical integration in which a company expands its role to fulfill tasks formerly completed by businesses up the supply chain (acquires or merges with suppliers/manufacturers).
2.	Balanced Scorecard	Performance measurement framework; customer satisfaction, internal processes, employee engagement and financial outcomes
3.	Benchmarking	Comparing performances between companies against best standards/practices. Ex: A company comparing its products with the market leader
4.	Blue chip companies	Large, well-established, financially stable, and typically leaders in their respective industries
5.	Blue Ocean Strategy	Creating new market through innovative products/services. Ex: Netflix
6.	Boiling the Ocean	Undertaking an impossible task or an overly ambitious task
7.	Bottomline	Company's net profits or net income after deducting expenses. It represents the final financial result of a company.
8.	Brown Goods	Smaller electronic devices such as gaming consoles, smartphones.
9.	Brownfield Strategy	Repurposing an existing business or project reusing existing resources. Ex: Renovating an existing property for new venture
10.	Business Process Reengineering	Redesigning and re-aligning business processes within an organization to achieve improvements in efficiency, quality.
11.	Change Management	Process of planning, implementing and managing organizational changes to ensure smooth changes
12.	Customer Lifetime Value (CLV)	The predicted net profit from a customer over their relationship with a company.
13.	Divestiture	Sale or disposal of business assets/units.
14.	Due Diligence	Thorough investigation and analysis conducted before an investment/merger/acquisition/new deal.
15.	Forward integration	A form of vertical integration wherein a company obtains more control over activities that occur in the later stages of the value chain, i.e. "moving downstream".

Glossary

S.No.	Term	Definition
16.	Greenfield Strategy	Creating a new business/project from scratch often in a new location. Ex: Entering a new country and building a brand new manufacturing facility
17.	Horizontal integration	Expanding a company's operations by acquiring or merging with competitors or companies in the same industry.
18.	KPI	Key Performance Indicator; measure to evaluate effectiveness of a business in achieving objectives
19.	KRAs	Key Result Areas are the most important areas for achieving strategic objectives.
20.	Leveraged Buyout (LBO)	A type of acquisition where a significant portion of the purchase price is financed through debt.
21.	Low-Hanging fruits	Easily attainable opportunities or solutions that requires minimal effort.
22.	OEM	Original Equipment Manufacturer: Any company that manufactures products or components that are to be incorporated into end products of other companies.
23.	Outsourcing	Contracting external suppliers to complete certain products/services
24.	Red Ocean Strategy	Competing in existing markets where competitive rivalry is high. Ex: Cola wars
25.	RFQ	Request for Quotation; a document used to solicit bids from suppliers
26	Synergy	The additional value or benefits created by the combination of two companies in an M&A.
27.	TargetCo	A target company is a company that is the subject of an attempted acquisition by a potential buyer.
28.	Topline	Company's revenue or gross revenue i.e. total sales from a company's primary business activities before deducting any costs or expenses
29.	Vertical integration	Expanding a company's operations into different stages of the supply chain, either backward (upstream) or forward (downstream).
30.	White Goods	Large appliances such as washing machines, ovens.

Supplementary Frameworks

These supplementary frameworks bring depth and granularity to the case analysis and can be used to analyse sub-issues within the larger case issue tree

Growth	**Intensive**		Market Penetration, Market Development, Product Development
	Integrative		Forward integration with Customers, Backward integration with Suppliers, Horizontal Mergers, partnerships
	Extensive		Diversification through Spinoffs, Acquisitions, New Ventures
Marketing	**Awareness**		Brand awareness, Product knowledge, Persuasiveness
	Acceptability		Customer expectations v/s Product performance
	Affordability		Economic ability to pay, Psychological Willingness to Pay
	Accessibility		Availability, Convenience
Merger & Acquisitions	**Scope**	**Objective**	Growth, Diversification, Competitive Response, Synergies
		Industry	Size, Growth, Life Cycle, Competition, External Environment
		Type	Horizontal, Forward Integration, Backward Integration, Diversification
	Due Diligence	**Standalone**	Suppliers, Products, Customers, Value Chain, Management
		Merged	Cost and Revenue Synergies, Valuation
	Post Deal	**Risks**	Regulation, Competitive Response, Exit Options, Opportunity Cost
		Implementation	Deal Structure, Keep v/s Sell, Financing

Supplementary Frameworks

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Barriers to Entry	**Demand Side**		High Switching Costs, Loyalty Programs, Network Effects
	Supply Side		Learning Curve, Research & Development, Economies of Scale, Supplier Relations, Access of Inputs
	Government		Ease of Opening Business, Licensing, Patents, Lobbying
	Competitive		Build Excess Capacity, Large Cash Reserves, Reputation, No gaps in the market
Process Analysis	**People**	**Man**	Strength, Efficiency, Productivity, Skills, Operating Hours
	Process	**Method**	Processes, Operating Procedures
		Measurement	Accuracy, Frequency, Nature
	Technology	**Machine**	Efficiency, Productivity, Capacity, Downtime
		Material	Leakage, Quality, Wastage, Quantity
Operations Optimization	**Demand Planning**		Made to Order v/s Made to Stock, Demand forecasting
	Inventory Management		Just in Time v/s Safety Stock, Raw material, WIP, Finished goods, Merchandise
	Production Planning		Capacity Utilization, efficiency, Lead Times, Down time
	Production Systems		Job Shop, Batch production, Mass Production, Degree of Specialization
	Layout Planning		Work study, Process Flow Design,
	Automation		Precision, High volume efficiency v/s Cost, Customizability
	Outsourcing		Make or Buy, Third Party providers

Connect With Us

The Consulting Club
Faculty of Management Studies
Professor N.D. Kapoor Marg
Delhi University – 110007
www.fms.edu

Linkedin

Website

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Mail

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